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FAUST II (Trilingual)

Der Tragödie Zweiter Teil / The Second Part of the Tragedy

Johann Wolfgang von Goethe (1832)

Two English Translations

This edition presents the German original with two parallel English translations:

1. Bayard Taylor (1871) — in italics The classic Victorian verse translation, faithful to Goethe's meter and rhyme schemes. Scholarly and poetic.

2. Whimsical Translation (2026, WIP) — in bold A modern "resonance translation" that prioritizes making the meaning land for contemporary readers.

Six translation voices—literal, modern slang, visceral/body, suggestive, absurdist, and punchy—take turns finding what makes each line hit hardest. Still a work in progress with ~75% coverage.

The whimsical translation doesn't replace Taylor—it sits alongside him, offering a second angle on what Goethe actually meant.

Erster Akt / Act I

Anmutige Gegend / Pleasant Landscape

Faust, bedded on flowery turf, fatigued, restless, endeavouring to sleep. Circle of hovering spirits in motion: graceful diminutive figures.

Ariel Chant, accompanied by Aeolian harps

Wenn der Blumen Frühlingsregen When the Spring
returns serener **When spring's blossom-rain
descends**

Über alle schwebend sinkt, Raining blossoms over all;
Floating downward over all

Wenn der Felder grüner Segen When the fields with
blessing greener **When the fields' green blessing
sends**

Allen Erdgebornen blinkt, On the earth-born children
call; **Light to all earth's children small**

Kleiner Elfen Geistergrosse Then the craft of elves propitious **Tiny fairy power descends**

Eilet, wo sie helfen kann, Hastes to help where help it can: **Rushing where it can assist**

Ob er heilig, ob er böse, Be he holy, be he vicious, **Holy, wicked—Ariel tends**

Jammert sie der Unglücksman. Pity they the luckless man. **Every sad soul on his list**

Die ihr dies Haupt umschwebt im luft'gen Kreise, Who round this head in airy circles hover, **You who flutter round this head in rings of air**

Erzeigt euch hier nach edler Elfen Weise, Yourselves in guise of noble Elves discover! **Show yourselves as noble elves truly do**

Besänftiget des Herzens grimmen Strauss, The fierce convulsions of his heart compose; **The heart is clenched in fists—unclench it there**

Entfernt des Vorwurfs gluhend bittre Pfeile, Remove the burning barbs of his remorse, **Remove the burning arrows of his grief, undo**

Sein Innres reinigt von erlebtem Graus. And cleanse his being from the suffered woes! **His insides—scrub the horror he's been through**

Vier sind die Pausen nachtiger Weile, Four pauses makes the Night upon her courses, **Four are the watches of the night**

Nun ohne Saumen fullt sie freundlich aus. And now,

delay not, let them kindly close! **Now fill them all with friendly light**

Erst senkt sein Haupt aufs kühle Polster nieder, First on the coolest pillow let him slumber, **Lay his head on the wet spot**

Dann badet ihn in Tau aus Lethes Flut; Then sprinkle him with Lethe's drowsy spray! **Then wash him in the dew of Lethe's flow**

Gelenk sind bald die krampferstarzten Glieder, His limbs no more shall cramps and chills encumber, **His cramped-stiff limbs will loosen from their worst**

Wenn er gestarkt dem Tag entgegenruht; When sleep has made him strong to meet the day. **When rested, strong, toward day he'll go**

Vollbringt der Elfen schonste Pflicht, Perform, ye Elves, your fairest rite: **The prettiest elf-duty do**

Gebt ihn zuruck dem heiligen Licht. Restore him to the holy Light! **Give him back to the light like a library book**

Chor (singly, by two or more, alternately and collectively)

Wenn sich lau die Luftte fullen When around the green-girt meadow **When balmy breezes fill the evening hour**

Um den grunumschranten Plan, Balm the tepid winds exhale, **Around the green-ringed meadow's**

edge

Susse Dufte, Nebelhullen Then in fragrance and in shadow **Sweet scents and mist-veils shower**

Senkt die Dämmerung heran. Twilight spreads her misty veil: **As twilight sinks beyond the hedge**

Lispelt leise sussen Frieden, Whispers peace in accents cheery, **Whisper soft, sweet peace descending**

Wiegt das Herz in Kindesruh; Rocks the heart in childhood's play, **Rock that heart like a cradle getting rocked**

Und den Augen dieses Muden And upon these eyelids weary **And for these tired eyes unending**

Schliesst des Tages Pforte zu. Shuts the golden gates of Day. **Shut day's door—now nothing makes a peep**

Nacht ist schon hereingesunken, Now the Night already darkles, **Night has already sunken down**

Schliesst sich heilig Stern an Stern, Holy star succeeds to star; **Star connects to holy star like crown**

Grosse Lichter, kleine Funken Dazzling lights and fainter sparkles **Big lights, little sparks all glitter-bright**

Glitzern nah und glanzen fern; Glimmer near and gleam afar: **Shimmering near, shining far from sight**

Glitzern hier im See sich spiegelnd, Glimmer here, the lake reflecting, **Glittering mirrored in the lake below**

Glanzen droben klarer Nacht, Gleam in cloudless dark above; **Gleaming up in cloudless night's pure glow**

Tiefsten Ruhens Glück besiegelnd While, the bliss of rest protecting, **Sealing deepest peace with silver light**

Herrscht des Mondes volle Pracht. Reigns in pomp the perfect moon. **Rules the full moon's splendid might tonight**

Schon verloschen sind die Stunden, Now the Hours are cancelled for thee, **Already the hours have been erased**

Hingeschwunden Schmerz und Glück; Pain and bliss have fled away: **Pain and pleasure both effaced**

Fuhl es vor! Du wirst gesunden; Thou art whole: let faith restore thee! **Feel it now! You shall be healed!**

Traue neuem Tagesblick. Trust the new, the rising Day! **Trust the new day's light revealed**

Taler grünen, Hügel schwellen, Vales grow green, and hills are lifting **Valleys green, hills start to swell**

Buschen sich zu Schattenruh; Through the shadow-rest of morn; **Bushing up for shady rest**

Und in schwanken Silberwellen And in waves of silver, drifting **And in wavy silver spell**

Wogt die Saat der Ernte zu. On to harvest, rolls the corn. **Crops roll harvestward, full-dressed**

Wunsch um Wunsche zu erlangen, Wouldst thou win desires unbounded, **Wish on wish—you want the lot?**

Schaue nach dem Glanze dort! Yonder see the glory burn! **Look toward that glory there, that blazing spot!**

Leise bist du nur umfängen, Lightly is thy life surrounded— **Only softly are you wrapped around**

Schlaf ist Schale, wirf sie fort! Sleep's a shell, to break and spurn! **Sleep's a shell—smash it on the ground!**

Saume nicht, dich zu erdreisten, When the crowd sways, unbelieving, **Don't delay —be bold, be brazen now**

Wenn die Menge zaudernd schweift; Shows the daring will that warms! **When the crowd dithers, show them how!**

Alles kann der Edle leisten, He is crowned with all achieving, **Noble souls accomplish anything**

Der versteht und rasch ergreift. Who perceives and then performs. **Who understand and swiftly seize the ring**

Ariel A tremendous tumult announces the approach of the Sun.

Horchet! horcht dem Sturm der Horen! Harken!
Hark!–the Hours careering! **Listen! Hear the storm
of Hours!**

Tonend wird fur Geistesohren Sounding loud to spirit-
hearing, **Ringing loud for spirit-ears**

Schon der neue Tag geboren. See the new-born Day
appearing! **Already newborn day appears!**

Felsentore knarren rasselnd, Rocky portals jarring
shatter, **Rock-gates creak and clatter hard**

Phobus' Rader rollen prasselnd, Phoebus' wheels in
rolling clatter, **Phoebus' wheels come rolling, jar-
ring**

Welch Getöse bringt das Licht! With a crash the Light
draws near! **What a racket brings the light!**

Es trommetet, es posaunet, Pealing rays and trumpet-
blazes, **It trumpets, it trombones!**

Auge blinzt und Ohr erstaunet, Eye is blinded, ear
amazes: **Eyes blink, ears astound!**

Unerhortes hort sich nicht. The Unheard can no one
hear! **The unheard cannot be heard around!**

Schlupfet zu den Blumenkronen, Slip within each
blossom-bell, **Slip into the flower-crowns!**

Tiefer, tiefer, still zu wohnen, Deeper, deeper, there to
dwell,– **Deeper, deeper, settle down!**

In die Felsen, unters Laub; In the rocks, beneath the
leaf! **In the rocks, beneath the leaf—**

Trifft es euch, so seid ihr taub. If it strikes you, you are deaf. **If it hits you, you'll be deaf!**

Faust

Des Lebens Pulse schlagen frisch lebendig, Life's pulses now with fresher force awaken **Life's pulses beat fresh and alive again**

Atherische Dammerung milde zu begrussen; To greet the mild ethereal twilight o'er me; **To greet ethereal twilight's gentle hold**

Du, Erde, warst auch diese Nacht beständig This night, thou, Earth! hast also stood unshaken, **You, Earth, stood steady through the night's dark reign**

Und atmet neu erquickt zu meinen Fussen, And now thou breathest new-refreshed before me, **And breathe refreshed beneath me, newly bold**

Beginnest schon, mit Lust mich zu umgeben, And now beginnest, all thy gladness granting, **Already you begin with joy to wrap me round**

Du regst und ruhst ein kraftiges Beschliessen, A vigorous resolution to restore me, **You stir in me a powerful resolve unfurled**

Zum höchsten Dasein immerfort zu streben.– To seek that highest life for which I'm panting.– **To strive forever toward existence's highest ground**

In Dammerschein liegt schon die Welt erschlossen,

The world unfolded lies in twilight glimmer, **In twilight gleam the world lies spread, unbound**

Der Wald ertont von tausendstimmigem Leben, A thousand voices in the grove are chanting; **The forest rings with thousand-voiced song!**

Tal aus, Tal ein ist Nebelstreif ergossen, Vale in, vale out, the misty streaks grow dimmer; **Valley in, valley out, mist-streaks pour along**

Doch senkt sich Himmelsklarheit in die Tiefen, The deeps with heavenly light are penetrated; **Yet heaven's clarity sinks to depths below**

Und Zweig und Aste, frisch erquickt, entsprossen The boughs, refreshed, lift up their leafy shimmer **And branch and twig, refreshed, spring up to grow**

Dem duft'gen Abgrund, wo versenkt sie schliefen; From gulfs of air where sleepily they waited; **From fragrant gulfs where sunk in sleep they lay**

Auch Farb' an Farbe klart sich los vom Grunde, Colour on colour from the background cleareth, **Color on color clears itself away**

Wo Blum' und Blatt von Zitterperle triefen- Where flower and leaf with trembling pearls are freighted- **Where flower and leaf drip trembling pearls of spray**

Ein Paradies wird um mich her die Runde. And all around a Paradise appeareth. **A paradise surrounds me every way!**

Hinaufgeschaut!–Der Berge Gipfelriesen Look up!–
The mountain summits, grand, supernal, **Look up!**
The mountain peaks, those giants grand

Verkünden schon die feierlichste Stunde; Herald,
e'en now, the solemn hour that neareth; **Announce**
already the most solemn hour at hand

Sie dürfen früh des ewigen Lichts geniessen, They ear-
liest enjoy the light eternal **They get to drink eternal**
light the first

Das später sich zu uns hernieder wendet. That later
sinks, till here below we find it. **That later turns**
down here to quench our thirst

Jetzt zu der Alpe grünesenkten Wiesen Now to the
Alpine meadows, sloping vernal, **Now to the alpine**
meadows, green and low

Wird neuer Glanz und Deutlichkeit gesendet, A
newer beam descends ere we divined it, **New**
brilliance and new clarity are sent to show

Und stufenweis herab ist es gelungen;– And step by
step unto the base hath bounded: **And step by step**
downward it has won!

Sie tritt hervor!–und, leider schon geblendet, The sun
comes forth! Alas, already blinded, **She steps forth!**
—and, alas, already blinding

Kehr' ich mich weg, vom Augenschmerz durch-
drungen. I turn away, with eyesight pierced and
wounded! **I turn away, pierced through with**
eye-pain's finding

So ist es also, wenn ein sehrend Hoffen 'Tis thus,
when, unto yearning hope's endeavour, **So this is
how it goes when yearning hope**

Dem höchsten Wunsch sich traulich zugerungen, Its
highest wish on sweet attainment grounded, **Has
struggled toward its highest wish's scope**

Erfüllungspforten findet flugeloffen; The portals of
fulfilment widely sever: **And finds fulfillment's
gates flung open wide**

Nun aber bricht aus jenen ewigen Gründen But if
there burst from those eternal spaces **But now from
those eternal depths a flood**

Ein Flammenubermass, wir stehn betroffen; A flood
of flame, we stand confounded ever; **Of flame-
excess breaks forth—we stand stupefied**

Des Lebens Fackel wollten wir entzünden, For Life's
pure torch we sought the shining traces, **We wanted
to light life's torch—got burned instead**

Ein Feuermeer umschlingt uns, welch ein Feuer! And
seas of fire—and what a fire!—surprise us. **A sea of fire
engulfs us—what a fire!**

Ist's Lieb'? ist's Hass? die gluhend uns umwinden, Is't
Love? Is't Hate? that burningly embraces, **Is it love?
Is it hate? wrapping hot around us**

Mit Schmerz und Freuden wechselnd ungeheuer, And
that with pain and joy alternate tries us? **With mon-
strous swings of pain and joy unbound**

So dass wir wieder nach der Erde blicken, So that, our
glances once more earthward throwing, **So that we
look back toward the earth once more**

Zu bergen uns in jugendlichstem Schleier. We seek in
youthful drapery to disguise us. **To hide ourselves
in youth's most tender veil**

So bleibe denn die Sonne mir im Rücken! Behind me,
therefore, let the sun be glowing! **So let the sun stay
at my back therefore!**

Der Wassersturz, das Felsenriff durchbrausend, The
cataract, between the crags deep-riven, **The water-
fall—crashing through the cliff's detail**

Ihn schau' ich an mit wachsendem Entzucken. I thus
behold with rapture ever-growing. **I watch with
ever-growing sweet delight**

Von Sturz zu Sturzen walzt er jetzt in tausend, From
plunge to plunge in thousand streams 'tis given,
From fall to fall it rolls now thousandfold

Dann abertausend Stromen sich ergiessend, And yet
a thousand, to the valleys shaded, **Then thousand
thousands streaming down take flight**

Hoch in die Luft Schaum an Schaume sausend.
While foam and spray in air are whirled and driven.
High in the air foam upon foam takes hold

Allein wie herrlich, diesem Sturm ersprießend, Yet
how superb, across the tumult braided, **But how
magnificent—from all this spray arising**

Wolbt sich des bunten Bogens Wechseldauer, The
painted rainbow's changeful life is bending, **Arches
the rainbow's ever-changing, lasting bow**

Bald rein gezeichnet, bald in Luft zerfliessend, Now
clearly drawn, dissolving now and faded, **Now purely
drawn, now in the air dissolving**

Umher verbreitend duftig kühle Schauer. And ever-
more the showers of dew descending! **Spreading all
around cool fragrant showers' flow**

Der spiegelt ab das menschliche Bestreben. Of hu-
man striving there's no symbol fuller: **This mirrors
human striving, what we do**

Ihm sinne nach, und du begreifst genauer: Consider,
and 'tis easy comprehending– **Reflect on it—you'll
grasp it closer through**

Am farbigen Abglanz haben wir das Leben. Life is not
light, but the refracted colour. **In the colored reflec-
tion, we have life, it's true**

Kaiserliche Pfalz. Saal des Thrones / The Emperor's Castle. Hall of the Throne

Council of State awaiting the Emperor. Trumpets.
Enter Court Retainers of all kinds, splendidly dressed.
The Emperor advances to the throne; Astrologer on
his right hand.

Kaiser

Ich grüsse die Getreuen, Lieben, I greet you, Well-
beloved and Trusty, **What's up my loyal besties,
my ride-or-dies**

Versammelt aus der Nah' und Weite;– Assembled

here from far and wide! **Gathered from the near places and the far, bodies filling this hall like breath**

Den Weisen seh' ich mir zur Seite, I see the Wise Man at my side; **The wise one I see standing at my side**

Allein wo ist der Narr geblieben? But where's the Fool, his rival lusty? **But where the hell did the Fool wander off to?**

Junker

Gleich hinter deiner Mantelschleppe Behind thy mantle's flowing swell **Right behind the drag of your cloak's hem, following your wake**

Stürzt' er zusammen auf der Treppe, Suddenly on the stairs he fell: **He just... collapsed on the stairs? Mid-strut? That's commitment to a bit**

Man trug hinweg das Fettgewicht, They bore away the weight of fat; **They hauled off that absolute unit of fat**

Tot oder trunken? weiss man nicht. If dead, or drunk? none knoweth that. **Dead or drunk? Nobody's saying, very sus**

Zweiter Junker

Sogleich mit wunderbarer Schnelle As quick as thought, through all the pother **Immediately with**

wondrous speed

Drangt sich ein anderer an die Stelle. Him to replace there came another, **Another one shoves in to fill the vacuum—nature abhors an empty fool-slot**

Gar kostlich ist er aufgeputzt, Adorned and prinked with wondrous art, **He's dolled up exquisitely, all surface shine**

Doch fratzenhaft, dass jeder stutzt; Yet so grotesque that all men start. **But so grotesque everyone's sphincters tighten**

Die Wache halt ihm an der Schwelle The guards their halberds crosswise hold **Guards crossed their halberds at the threshold—**

Kreuzweis die Hellebarden vor– To bar him–them he thrusts apart: **Steel bars forming an X like a threat made solid**

Da ist er doch, der kuhne Tor! Lo! here he comes, the Fool so bold! **But here he comes anyway, the absolute madlad!**

Mephistopheles (kneeling before the throne)

Was immerfort in Schutz genommen? What's cursed and welcomely expected? **Riddle me this, your highness: What gets constant protection?**

Was hart gescholten und verklagt? What is desired, yet always chased? **What gets chased away and screamed at? (asking for a friend)**

Wen darfst du nicht herbeiberufen? What evermore
with care protected? **Whom may you not summon
hither?**

Wen horet jeder gern genannt? What is accused,
condemned, disgraced? **Whose name makes
everyone's ears perk up, dopamine spike**

Was naht sich deines Thrones Stufen? To whom
dar'st thou not give a hearing? **What's climbing
your throne-steps right now?**

Was hat sich selbst hinweggebannt? Whose name
hears each man willingly? **What exiled itself like a
drama queen?**

Kaiser

Für diesmal spare deine Worte! What is't, before thy
throne appearing? **Save the words this time—my
patience is a thin membrane**

Hier sind die Ratsel nicht am Orte, What keeps itself
away from thee? **Riddles don't belong here, this is
a throne room not a sphinx's bedroom**

Das ist die Sache dieser Herrn.– Spare us thy words!
the time is pressing; **That is the business of these
lords**

Da lose du! das hort' ich gern. This is no place for
riddle-guessing: **YOU solve it! That I'd actually
love to hear.**

Mein alter Narr ging, furcht' ich, weit ins Weite; These

gentlemen such things explain. **My old fool went—
and I'm scared—way WAY too far out there**

Nimm seinen Platz und komm an meine Seite. Solve
it thyself!—to hear I'm fain. **Take his place and come
slide up next to me**

My old Fool went, I fear, an endless distance;

Take thou his place, come here and lend assistance!

(Mephistopheles goes up and stations himself on the
Emperor's left hand.)

Gemurmel der Menge

Ein neuer Narr—Zu neuer Pein— Another fool—for wor-
ries new! **Another fool—for fresh new pain!—the
universe provides**

Wo kommt er her?—Wie kam er ein?— Whence came
he?—how did he get through? **Where'd he come
from?—How'd he slip through?—bodies asking
bodies**

Der alte fiel—Der hat vertan— The old one fell—he's
walked his path.— **The old one fell—he's done
—washed up—**

Es war ein Fass—Nun ist's ein Span— He was a barrel—
this, a lath! **He was a barrel—this one's a splinter
—went from thicc to stick**

Kaiser

Und also, ihr Getreuen, Lieben, So now, my Well-beloved and Loyal, **And so, you faithful, beloved ones**

Willkommen aus der Nah' und Ferne! Be welcome all, from near and far! **Welcome from near and far, everybody!**

Ihr sammelt euch mit gunstigem Sterne, You meet beneath a fortunate star; **You gather under a lucky star—I feel its light on my face**

Da droben ist uns Gluck und Heil geschrieben. Welfare and luck are now the aspects royal. **Up there welfare and luck are written for us—cosmic HR approved**

Doch sagt, warum in diesen Tagen, But tell me why, in days so fair, **But tell me WHY—in these chill days—**

Wo wir der Sorgen uns entschlagen, When we've withdrawn ourselves from care, **When we've shaken off all our cares, finally loose**

Schonbarte mummenschanzlich tragen And beards of beauty masquerading wear,– **Wearing pretty masquerade beards, faces hidden behind faces**

Und Heitres nur geniessen wollten, When gay delights for us are waiting, **When we only wanted to enjoy fun stuff**

Warum wir uns ratschlagend qualen sollten? Why should we plague ourselves, deliberating? **Why should we torture ourselves with DELIBERATING? Ugh, adulating**

Doch weil ihr meint, es ging' nicht anders an, Yet,
since the task you think we cannot shun, **Yet since
you think it can't be done otherwise**

Geschehen ist's, so sei's getan. 'Tis settled then, so be
it done! **Fine, it's settled, let's just do this.**

Kanzler

Die höchste Tugend, wie ein Heiligenschein, The high-
est virtue, like a halo-zone **The highest virtue—like
a halo around the head, light made visible**

Umgibt des Kaisers Haupt; nur er allein Circles
the Emperor's head; and he alone **Circles the
Emperor's noggin—only HE**

Vermag sie gultig auszuüben: Is worthy validly to ex-
ercise it. **Is able validly to exercise it**

Gerechtigkeit!—Was alle Menschen lieben, 'Tis
Justice!—all men love and prize it, **JUSTICE! The
thing everyone claims to love**

Was alle fordern, wünschen, schwer entbehren, None
can forego, but all require and want it: **What every-
one demands, desires, can barely live without—
it's basically wifi**

Es liegt an ihm, dem Volk es zu gewahren. The people
look to him, that he should grant it. **It's on him to
grant it to the people. No pressure.**

Doch ach! Was hilft dem Menschengest Verstand,
But, ah! what help can human wit impart, **But alas!**

What good is reason to the human spirit

Dem Herzen Gute, Willigkeit der Hand, Or readiness of hand, or kindly heart, **Kindness to the heart, readiness of hand**

Wenn's fieberhaft durchaus im Staate wutet When lies the State, as if in fever fretting, **When fever rages through the whole state like a sickness no one can shake**

Und Ubel sich in Ubeln uberbrutet? And brooded Evil evil is begetting? **And evil breeds evil breeds evil—it's turtles all the way down except the turtles are bad**

Wer schaut hinab von diesem hohen Raum Who looks abroad from off this height supreme **Whoever looks down from this high room**

Ins weite Reich, ihm scheint's ein schwerer Traum, Throughout the realm, 'tis like a weary dream, **Into the wide realm—it seems a heavy dream, the weight of sleep-paralysis**

Wo Missgestalt in Missgestalten schaltet, Where one deformity another mouldeth, **Where one deformity manages other deformities**

Das Ungesetz gesetzlich uberwaltet Where lawlessness itself by law upholdeth, **Where illegality legally dominates—the system gaming itself**

Und eine Welt des Irrtums sich entfaltet. And 'tis an age of Error that unfoldeth! **And a whole world of error unfolds—like the worst IKEA manual**

Der raubt sich Herden, der ein Weib, One plunders
flocks, a woman one, **One steals herds, another a
wife**

Kelch, Kreuz und Leuchter vom Altare, Cup, cross,
and candlestick from altar, **Chalice, cross, and can-
delabra from the altar—sacred objects profaned**

Beruhmt sich dessen manche Jahre And then to boast
it does not palter, **And brags about it for years**

Mit heiler Haut, mit unverletztem Leib. Of limb or life
nowise undone. **Skin intact, body undamaged.
Crime pays.**

Jetzt drangen Klager sich zur Halle, To Court behold
the plaintiffs urging, **Now plaintiffs crowd into the
hall, desperate bodies**

Der Richter prunkt auf hohem Pfuhl, Where puffs the
judge on cushions warm, **The judge preens on his
high cushion—peak cushion privilege**

Indessen wogt in grimmigem Schwalle And
swells, meanwhile, with fury surging, **Meanwhile
rebellion's growing chaos surges like a tide**

Des Aufruhrs wachsendes Gewuhl. Rebellion's
fast-increasing storm! **In grim, swelling waves**

Der darf auf Schand' und Frevel pochen, His easy way
through crime is broken **Anyone can get away with
crime and scandal**

Der auf Mitschuldigste sich stützt, Who his accom-
plices selects; **If they lean on accomplices—it's all**

who you know

Und: Schuldig! horst du ausgesprochen, And
“Guilty!” hears one only spoken **And “GUILTY!” you
only hear spoken**

Wo Unschuld nur sich selber schützt. Where Inno-
cence itself protects. **Where innocence has to
protect itself because no one else will—very
bootstrap**

So will sich alle Welt zerstückeln, They all pull down
what they should care for,– **So the whole world
wants to tear itself to pieces**

Vernichtigen, was sich gebührt; Destroy their weal, in
self-despite; **Destroying what is proper and right**

Wie soll sich da der Sinn entwickeln, How can the
sense develop, therefore, **How’s common sense
supposed to develop then**

Der einzig uns zum Rechten führt? Which, only, leads
us to the Right? **The one thing that leads us to
what’s Right?**

Zuletzt ein wohlgesinnter Mann At last, the man of
good intent **At last even a well-meaning man**

Neigt sich dem Schmeichler, dem Bestecher, To
flatterer and briber bendeth; **Bends toward the
flatterer, the briber—spine curving**

Ein Richter, der nicht strafen kann, The judge, de-
barred from punishment, **A judge who can’t punish
anyone ends up**

Gesellt sich endlich zum Verbrecher. Mates with the felon, ere he endeth. **Joining the criminals. Obviously.**

Ich malte schwarz, doch dichten Flor I've painted black, but denser screen **I painted black, but a denser veil**

Zog' ich dem Bilde lieber vor. I'd rather draw before the scene. **I'd rather draw over this whole picture**

Entschlusse sind nicht zu vermeiden; Here measures cannot be evaded; **Decisions cannot be avoided—the body must move**

Wenn alle schadigen, alle leiden, When all offend, and none are aided, **When everyone harms, everyone suffers**

Geht selbst die Majestat zu Raub. His Majesty a victim stands. **Even Majesty itself becomes prey.**

Heermeister

Wie tobt's in diesen wilden Tagen! In these wild days, how discords thicken! **How it rages in these wild days!—just check Twitter**

Ein jeder schlägt und wird erschlagen, Each strikes and in return is stricken, **Everyone strikes and is struck—violence echoing violence**

Und fürs Kommando bleibt man taub. And they are deaf to all commands. **And they're deaf to all commands.**

Der Burger hinter seinen Mauern, The burgher in his fortifications, **The citizen behind his walls**

Der Ritter auf dem Felsenest The knight upon his rocky nest, **The knight upon his rocky nest**

Verschwuren sich, uns auszudauern, Have sworn to worry out our patience **Have sworn to wait us out —they've got snacks**

Und halten ihre Krafte fest. And keep their strength with stubborn crest. **And hold their strength tight, fists clenched**

Der Mietsoldat wird ungeduldig, The mercenaries, no whit better, **The mercenary gets impatient —soldiers have bills too**

Mit Ungestum verlangt er seinen Lohn, Impatiently demand their pay, **Demands his pay with increasing aggression**

Und waren wir ihm nichts mehr schuldig, And, if we were not still their debtor, **And if we owed him nothing more**

Er lief ganz und gar davon. They'd start forthwith and march away. **He'd straight up bounce, fully ghost us**

Verbiete wer, was alle wollten, Let one forbid what all would practise **Forbid what everyone wants?**

Der hat ins Wespenest gestört; And in a hornet's nest he stands: **That's disturbing a wasps' nest —the swarm rising**

Das Reich, das sie beschützen sollten, The realm which they should guard, the fact is, **The realm they should be protecting? Yeah about that**

Es liegt geplündert und verheert. 'Tis devastated by their hands. **It lies plundered and devastated. By them.**

Man lasst ihr Toben wutend hausen, They give the rein to wild disorder, **They let their rage just run wild**

Schon ist die halbe Welt vertan; And half the world is wasted now; **Half the world already wasted—ruined bodies, ruined land**

Es sind noch Könige da draussen, There still are kings beyond our border, **There are still kings out there beyond**

Doch keiner denkt, es ging' ihn irgend an. But none thinks it concerns him anyhow. **But none of them thinks it's their problem—very “not my circus” energy**

Schatzmeister

Wer wird auf Bundsgenossen pochen! Trust allies, and we soon shall rue us! **Trust allies? We'll regret it!**

Subsidien, die man uns versprochen, The subsidies they promised to us— **The subsidies they promised—hot air, blue balls**

Wie Rohrenwasser bleiben aus. Like water in leaky pipes—don't come. **Like water through leaky pipes—nothing arrives**

Auch, Herr, in deinen weiten Staaten Then, Sire, in all thy states extended **Also, Sire, in all your extended states**

An wen ist der Besitz geraten? To whom hath now the rule descended? **To whom has possession fallen?**

Wohin man kommt, da halt ein Neuer Haus, Where'er one goes, a new lord is at home, **Everywhere you go some NEW guy's running things now—franchise model gone wrong**

Und unabhängig will er leben, And hopes to live in independence; **And wants to live independently—won't even return texts**

Zusehen muss man, wie er's treibt; He takes his course and we look on: **We have to just watch what he does, powerless**

Wir haben so viel Rechte hingegeben, Such rights we've given to our attendants **We gave away so many rights**

Dass uns auf nichts ein Recht mehr übrigbleibt. That all our right to anything is gone. **That we have zero rights left to anything**

Auch auf Parteien, wie sie heissen, On parties, too, whate'er the name be, **And parties—whatever they call themselves these days—**

Ist heutzutage kein Verlass; Our trust, today, is far from great; **There's no relying on them nowadays**

Sie mogen schelten oder preisen, Though loud their praise or fierce their blame be **Whether they praise or condemn**

Gleichgültig wurden Lieb' und Hass. Indifferent is their love and hate. **Love and hate have both gone flat—no temperature**

Die Ghibellinen wie die Guelfen The Ghibellines and Guelfs from labour **The Ghibellines and the Guelfs**

Verbergen sich, um auszuruhn; Are resting—both laid on the shelf. **Are hiding out to rest up—both teams on vacation**

Wer jetzt will seinem Nachbar helfen? Who, therefore, now will help his neighbour? **Who wants to help their neighbor now? Nobody!**

Ein jeder hat für sich zu tun. Each has enough, to help himself. **Everyone has their own work to do—hands too full**

Die Goldespforten sind verrammelt, The gate of gold no more unlatches, **The golden gates are barricaded**

Ein jeder kratzt und scharrt und sammelt, And each one gathers, digs, and scratches, **Everyone scratches and scrapes and hoards**

Und unsre Kassen bleiben leer. While our strong-box is void indeed. **And our coffers stay empty.**

Marschalk

Welch Unheil muss auch ich erfahren! What evil I, as well, am having! **What misfortune I also have to deal with! I didn't ask for this**

Wir wollen alle Tage sparen We're always trying to be saving, **We try to save every day—tightening, clenching**

Und brauchen alle Tage mehr, And ever greater is our need: **And need more every day—it's giving deficit**

Und taglich wachst mir neue Pein. Thus daily grows this task of mine. **And daily my pain grows.**

Den Kochen tut kein Mangel wehe; The cooks have all they want at present,— **The cooks lack nothing**

Wildschweine, Hirsche, Hasen, Rehe, Wild-boar and deer, and hare and pheasant, **Wild boars, stags, hares, deer—meat on meat**

Welschhuhner, Huhner, Gans' und Enten, Duck, peacock, turkey, goose, and chicken: **Turkeys, chickens, geese, and ducks—feathers and flesh**

Die Deputate, sichere Renten, These, paid in kind, are certain picking, **The tributes, the secure rents—at least SOME things work**

Sie gehen noch so ziemlich ein. And do not seriously decline; **They still come in pretty okay**

Jedoch am Ende fehlt's an Wein. Yet, after all, we're short of wine. **But in the end, we're short on WINE.**

Wenn sonst im Keller Fass an Fass sich haufte,
Where casks on casks were once our cellars filling,
**Where once barrels on barrels piled in the cellar
—dripping with promise**

Der besten Berg' und Jahreslaufte, Rare vintages of
flavours finely thrilling, **From the best hills and best
years—liquid memory**

So schlurft unendliches Gesaufe The noble lords' eternal
swilling **Endless swilling by noble lords**

Der edlen Herrn den letzten Tropfen aus. Has drained
them off, till not a drop appears. **Has drained the
last drop—every aristocrat's a wine-hoover**

Der Stadtrat muss sein Lager auch verzapfen, The City
Council, too, must tap their liquor; **The city council
has to tap their supply too**

Man greift zu Humpen, greift zu Napfen, They drink
from mug, and jug, and beaker, **They grab tankards,
grab bowls—mouths to vessels**

Und unterm Tische liegt der Schmaus. Till no one
longer sees or hears. **And under the table lies the
feast. Wasted.**

Nun soll ich zahlen, alle lohnen; 'Tis I must pay for all
the dances; **Now I'm supposed to pay, compensate
everyone**

Der Jude wird mich nicht verschonen, The Jew will

have me, past all chances; **The moneylender won't spare me—compound interest is cruel math**

Der schafft Antizipationen, His notes of hand and his advances **He creates anticipations**

Die speisen Jahr um Jahr voraus. Will soon eat up the coming years. **That eat up year after year in advance—time consumed**

Die Schweine kommen nicht zu Fette, Before they're fat the swine are taken; **The pigs don't even get fat before we need them**

Verpfandet ist der Pfuhl im Bette, Pawned is the pillow, ere one waken, **The pillow's pawned before you wake**

Und auf den Tisch kommt vorgegessen Brot. The bread is eaten ere the board it sees. **And the bread hits the table pre-eaten.**

Kaiser (after some reflection, to Mephistopheles)

Sag, weisst du Narr nicht auch noch eine Not? Say, Fool, canst thou not add a want to these? **Say, Fool, got any more problems to add? The list isn't long enough**

Mephistopheles

Ich? Nicht doch! Ich seh' den Kreis erstrahlen– I? Not at all! I see the circling splendour– **Me? Nah! I see**

this circle absolutely GLOWING

Dich selbst und dein! Sollt' einer Zutraun hegen, Thyself, and thine! Should one his trust surrender, **Yourself and your people! Should anyone lose trust**

Wo Majestat unweigerlich gebeut, Where Majesty thus unopposed commands, **Where Majesty commands without opposition**

Bereite Macht Feindseliges zerstreut? Where ready power the hostile force disbands, **Where ready power scatters all hostility**

Wo guter Wille, kraftig durch Verstand, Where loyal wills, through understanding strong, **Where good will, strong through understanding—very Ted-talk energy**

Und Tatkraft, vielfaltige, zur Hand? And mixed activities, around thee throng? **And multi-talented action stands ready?**

Was konnte da zum Unheil sich vereinen, What powers for evil could one see combining,– **What could combine into harm here**

Zur Finsternis, wo solche Sterne scheinen? For darkness, where such brilliant stars are shining? **Into darkness, when such stars are literally shining?**

Gemurmel

Das ist ein Schalk–Der's wohl versteht– He is a scamp–who comprehends.– **He's a scoundrel—who gets it.**

—

Er lugt sich ein—So lang' es geht— He lies his way—until it ends.— **He lies his way in—as long as it lasts—**

Ich weiss schon—Was dahinter steckt— I know it now—what's in his mind.— **I know already—what's behind this—(narrator: he did not know)**

Und was denn weiter?—Ein Projekt— What then?—A project lurks behind! **And what then?—A scheme—hidden beneath**

Mephistopheles

Wo fehlt's nicht irgendwo auf dieser Welt? Where, in this world, doth not some lack appear? **Where in this world is there no lack?**

Dem dies, dem das, hier aber fehlt das Geld. Here this, there that,—but money's lacking here. **This person needs this, that person needs that—but HERE it's money**

Vom Estrich zwar ist es nicht aufzuraffen; True, from the floor you can't at once collect it, **True, you can't just scrape it off the floor**

Doch Weisheit weiss das Tiefste herzuschaffen. But, deepliest hidden, wisdom may detect it. **But wisdom knows how to summon the deepest stuff**

In Bergesadern, Mauergründen In veins of mountains, under building-bases, **In mountain veins, in foundation walls**

Ist Gold gemunzt und ungemunzt zu finden, Coined and uncoined, there's gold in many places: **Gold is waiting—coined and uncoined.**

Und fragt ihr mich, wer es zutage schafft: And ask you who shall bring it to the light? **And if you ask who brings it to light**

Begabten Manns Natur- und Geisteskraft. A man endowed with Mind's and Nature's might. **A gifted man's Nature- and Spirit-power—basically a vibe check**

Kanzler

Natur und Geist—so spricht man nicht zu Christen. Nature and Mind—to Christians we don't speak so. **Nature and Spirit—we don't talk like that to Christians**

Deshalb verbrennt man Atheisten, Thence to burn Atheists we seek so, **That's why we burn atheists—it's called consequences**

Weil solche Reden höchst gefährlich sind. For such discourses very dangerous be. **Because such speeches are extremely dangerous**

Natur ist Sünde, Geist ist Teufel, Nature is Sin, and Mind is Devil: **Nature is Sin, Spirit is Devil**

Sie hegen zwischen sich den Zweifel, Doubt they beget in shameless revel, **They breed Doubt between them—their weird threesome**

Ihr missgestaltet Zwitterkind. Their hybrid in deformity. **Their misshapen hybrid child**

Uns nicht so!–Kaisers alten Landen Not so with us!–
Two only races **Not us though!—In the Emperor's old lands**

Sind zwei Geschlechter nur entstanden, Have in the Empire kept their places, **Only two races have arisen—two camps**

Sie stützen würdig seinen Thron: And prop the throne with worthy weight. **They prop up his throne with dignity**

Die Heiligen sind es und die Ritter; The Saints and Knights are they: together **The Saints and the Knights!**

Sie stehen jedem Ungewitter They breast each spell of thunder-weather, **They withstand every storm—they're the load-bearing walls**

Und nehmen Kirch' und Staat zum Lohn. And take for pay the Church and State. **And take Church and State as reward**

Dem Pobelsinn verworrner Geister The vulgar minds that breed confusion **Against the confused rabble-mind**

Entwickelt sich ein Widerstand: Are met with an opposing hand: **Resistance develops**

Die Ketzer sind's! die Hexenmeister! They're wizards!–heretics! Delusion **They're heretics!**

Witch-masters!

Und sie verderben Stadt und Land. Through them will
ruin town and land. **And they ruin city and country.**

Die willst du nun mit frechen Scherzen And these
will you, with brazen juggle, **These you want with
brazen jokes**

In diese hohen Kreise schwarzen; Within this high as-
sembly smuggle? **To smuggle into these high cir-
cles—contaminating**

Ihr hegt euch an verderbtem Herzen, For hearts
corrupt you scheme and struggle; **You nurture
yourselves on corrupted hearts**

Dem Narren sind sie nah verwandt. The Fool's near
kin are all the band. **The Fool's close kin, all of you.**

Mephistopheles

Daran erkenn' ich den gelehrten Herrn! By that, I
know the learned lord you are! **By THAT I recognize
the learned lord!**

Was ihr nicht tastet, steht euch meilenfern, What you
don't touch, is lying leagues afar; **What you can't
touch is miles away from you—very “pics or it
didn't happen”**

Was ihr nicht fasst, das fehlt euch ganz und gar, What
you don't grasp, is wholly lost to you; **What you can't
grasp is completely missing from you**

Was ihr nicht rechnet, glaubt ihr, sei nicht wahr, What
you don't reckon, think you, can't be true; **What you
can't calculate, you think isn't real**

Was ihr nicht wagt, hat fur euch kein Gewicht, What
you don't weigh, it has no weight, alas! **What you
don't weigh has no weight for you**

Was ihr nicht munzt, das, meint ihr, gelte nicht. What
you don't coin, you're sure it will not pass. **What you
don't coin, you think doesn't count.**

Kaiser

Dadurch sind unsre Mangel nicht erledigt, Therewith
to help our needs you naught determine. **That
doesn't fix our shortfall one bit**

Was willst du jetzt mit deiner Fastenpredigt? What
wilt thou, here, with such a Lenten sermon? **What do
you want with your Lent-lecture anyway?**

Ich habe satt das ewige Wie und Wenn; I'm tired of the
eternal If and How: **I'm sick of the eternal How and
If—exhaustion settling**

Es fehlt an Geld, nun gut, so schaff es denn. Money
we want: good, then, procure it now! **We're short
on money. Good. So GET SOME.**

Mephistopheles

Ich schaffe, was ihr wollt, und schaffe mehr; I'll fur-

nish what you wish, and more: 'tis, true, **I'll make what you want, and make MORE**

Zwar ist es leicht, doch ist das Leichte schwer; A light task, but light things are hard to do. **Sure it's easy, but easy things are hard—that's just science**

Es liegt schon da, doch um es zu erlangen, The gold's on hand,—yet, skilfully to win it, **It's already there, but to obtain it**

Das ist die Kunst, wer weiss es anzufangen? That is the art: who knows how to begin it? **That's the art—who knows how to begin?**

Bedenkt doch nur: in jenen Schreckensläuften, Consider only, in those days of blood **Just consider: in those terror-times**

Wo Menschenfluten Land und Volk ersäuften, When o'er the Empire poured a human flood, **When human floods drowned land and people**

Wie der und der, so sehr es ihn erschreckte, How many men, such deadly terror steeled them, **How this one and that one, scared shitless**

Sein Liebstes da- und dortwohin versteckte. Took their best goods, and here and there concealed them! **Hid their dearest things here and there—secret caches**

So war's von je in mächtiger Römer Zeit, 'Twas so beneath the mighty Roman sway, **So it was since mighty Rome's time**

Und so fortan, bis gestern, ja bis heut. And ever so repeated, till our day. **And so forth until yesterday, until today—recycling fear across millennia**

Das alles liegt im Boden still begraben, All that was buried in the earth, to save it: **All of it lies silently buried in the ground**

Der Boden ist des Kaisers, der soll's haben. The Emperor owns the earth, and he should have it. **The ground belongs to the Emperor. He should have it.**

Schatzmeister

Für einen Narren spricht er gar nicht schlecht, Now, for a Fool, his words are rather bright: **For a Fool, he's not talking half bad**

Das ist fürwahr des alten Kaisers Recht. That is indeed the old Imperial right. **That is indeed the old Imperial right**

Kanzler

Der Satan legt euch goldgewirkte Schlingen: Satan has laid his golden snares, to try us; **Satan is laying golden snares for you**

Es geht nicht zu mit frommen rechten Dingen. Such things as these are neither right nor pious. **This is neither right nor pious.**

Marschalk

Schafft' er uns nur zu Hof willkommne Gaben, Let him
but bring his gifts to Court, and share them, **If he just
brings welcome gifts to court**

Ich wollte gern ein bisschen Unrecht haben. And if
things were a little wrong, I'd bear them! **I'd happily
accept a little wrongness—flexibility in the spine**

Heermeister

Der Narr ist klug, verspricht, was jedem frommt; The
Fool is shrewd, to promise each his needs; **The Fool's
smart, promises what helps everyone**

Fragt der Soldat doch nicht, woher es kommt.
Whence it may come the soldier never heeds. **The
soldier doesn't ask where it comes from.**

Mephistopheles

Und glaubt ihr euch vielleicht durch mich betrogen,
And should you think, perchance, I overreach you,
And if you think maybe I'm scamming you

Hier steht ein Mann! da, fragt den Astrologen! Here's
the Astrologer—ask him to teach you! **Here stands a
man! Ask the Astrologer!**

In Kreis' um Kreise kennt er Stund' und Haus; The
spheres of Hour and House are in his ken: **He knows**

circle upon circle, hour and house

So sage denn: wie sieht's am Himmel aus? What are the heavenly aspects?—tell us, then! **So tell us: how do the heavens look?**

Gemurmel

Zwei Schelme sind's—Verstehn sich schon— Two rogues are they,—in league they've grown, **Two scoundrels —they understand each other perfectly**

Narr und Phantast—So nah dem Thron— Dreamer and Fool—so near the throne! **Fool and Fantasist —so close to the throne—**

Ein mattgesungen—Alt Gedicht— The song is old—and flatly sung.— **A worn-out old song —very “I've heard this one before”**

Der Tor blast ein—Der Weise spricht— The Fool he prompts—the Wise Man's tongue! **The Fool whis-pers in—the Wise Man speaks out**

Astrolog (speaks; Mephistopheles prompts)

Die Sonne selbst, sie ist ein lautres Gold, The Sun him-self is gold of purest ray; **The Sun itself is pure gold**

Merkur, der Bote, dient um Gunst und Sold, The her-ald, Mercury, serves for love and pay; **Mercury the messenger serves for favor and pay**

Frau Venus hat's euch allen angetan, Dame Venus has bewitched you all, for she, **Lady Venus has done you ALL—she looked at you, you're done**

So fruh als spat blickt sie euch lieblich an; Early and late, looks on you lovingly; **Early or late she gazes lovingly on you—her attention like warmth**

Die keusche Luna launet grillenhaft; Chaste Luna has her whims, no two alike; **Chaste Luna moods around capriciously—classic Luna behavior**

Mars, trifft er nicht, so draut euch seine Kraft. Mars threatens you, although he may not strike, **Mars, if he doesn't hit you, he threatens you.**

Und Jupiter bleibt doch der schonste Schein, And Jupiter is still the splendid star. **And Jupiter remains the most beautiful light**

Saturn ist gross, dem Auge fern und klein. Saturn is great, though seeming small and far: **Saturn is big, but looks tiny from here—compensating**

Ihn als Metall verehren wir nicht sehr, As metal, him we don't much venerate, **As a metal we don't really worship him**

An Wert gering, doch im Gewichte schwer. Of value slight, though heavy in his weight. **Small in value, heavy in weight—dense presence**

Ja! wenn zu Sol sich Luna fein gesellt, Now, when of Sol and Luna union's had,– **Yes! When Sol and Luna join nicely**

Zum Silber Gold, dann ist es heitre Welt; Silver with gold,–then is the world made glad: **Silver to gold—then it's a happy world!**

Das Ubrige ist alles zu erlangen: All else, with them, is easy to attain,– **All else is available to obtain**

Palaste, Garten, Brustlein, rote Wangen, Palaces, gardens, cheeks of rosy stain; **Palaces, gardens, little breasts, rosy cheeks**

Das alles schafft der hochgelahrte Mann, And these procures this highly learned man, **All this the highly learned man procures**

Der das vermag, was unser keiner kann. Who that can do which none of us e'er can. **Who can do what none of us can do**

Kaiser

Ich hore doppelt, was er spricht, Two meanings in his words I find, **I hear double what he says—stereo bullshit?**

Und dennoch uberzeugt's mich nicht. And yet they don't convince my mind. **And yet it doesn't convince me.**

Gemurmel

Was soll uns das?–Gedroschner Spass– Why tell us that?–stuff stale and flat! **What's this supposed to**

mean?—Stale joke—

Kalenderei–Chymisterei– ’Tis quackery!–’tis chemistry!
Calendar-quackery —alchemy-fuckery
—

Das hort’ ich oft–Und falsch gehofft– I’ve heard the strain–and hoped in vain,– **I’ve heard this often —and hoped falsely —body remembering disappointment**

Und kommt er auch–So ist’s ein Gauch– And though it come–’tis all a hum. **And even if he delivers—it’s still a con**

Mephistopheles

Da stehen sie umher und staunen, They stand around, amazed, unknowing; **There they stand around and marvel**

Vertrauen nicht dem hohen Fund, They do not trust the treasure-spell; **Don’t trust the high discovery—bodies tensed in skepticism**

Der eine faselt von Alraunen, One dreams of mandrake, nightly growing, **One babbles about mandrakes—because of course**

Der andre von dem schwarzen Hund. The other of the dog of Hell. **The other about the black dog—hellhound fetish**

Was soll es, dass der eine witzelt, Why, then, should one suspect bewitching, **So what if one cracks**

jokes

Ein anderer Zauberei verklagt, And why the other jest
and prate, **Another complains of sorcery**

Wenn ihm doch auch einmal die Sohle kitzelt, When
in their feet, they, too, shall feel the itching, **When his
own sole tickles him—sensation rising from be-
low**

Wenn ihm der sichere Schritt versagt. When they shall
walk with tottering gait? **When his sure step fails
him?**

Ihr alle fühlt geheimes Wirken All feel the secret oper-
ation **You all feel the secret workings**

Der ewig waltenden Natur, Of Nature's ever-ruling
might, **Of eternally-ruling Nature —she runs
things**

Und aus den untersten Bezirken And from the bases
of Creation **And from the lowest regions**

Schmiegt sich herauf lebend'ge Spur. A living track
winds up to light. **A living trace winds its way up
to you**

Wenn es in allen Gliedern zwackt, In every limb when
something twitches **When it pinches in all your
limbs**

Wenn es unheimlich wird am Platz, In any place
uncanny, old,— **When the place gets uncanny
—liminal space alert**

Nur gleich entschlossen grabt und hackt, Decide at once, and dig for riches! **Just decide: dig and hack!**

Da liegt der Spielmann, liegt der Schatz! There lies the fiddler, there the gold! **There lies the fiddler, there lies the treasure—pay dirt**

Gemurmel

Mir krabbelt's an der grossen Zeh'— It hangs like lead my feet about,— **Crawling on my big toe—sensation like ants**

Mir tut der ganze Rucken weh— I've cramp i' the arm—but that is gout.— **My whole back hurts—that's definitely treasure-related, not posture**

Nach solchen Zeichen ware hier I've tickling in the greater toe.— **By such signs this would be**

Das allerreichste Schatzrevier. Down all my back it pains me so.— **The richest treasure-ground ever.**

From signs like these 'tis very clear

The richest treasure-ground is here.

Kaiser

Nur eilig! du entschlupfst nicht wieder, Haste, then! Thou'lt not again make off! **Quick! You're not slipping away again**

Erprobe deine Lugenschaume Test now thy frothy, lying
graces, **Test your lying froth now**

Und zeig uns gleich die edlen Raume. And show at
once the golden places! **And show us immediately
these noble spaces—prove it or shut up**

Ich lege Schwert und Zepter nieder My sword and
sceptre I will doff, **I'll set down sword and scepter**

Und will mit eignen hohen Händen, Mine own im-
perial hands I'll lend thee, **And with my own high
hands**

Wenn du nicht lugst, das Werk vollenden, If thou liest
not, therein befriend thee, **If you're not lying, finish
the work**

Dich, wenn du lugst, zur Holle senden! But, if thou
liest, to Hell will send thee! **If you ARE lying, I'll send
you to Hell!**

Mephistopheles

Den Weg dahin wusst' allenfalls zu finden– I'd find, in
any case, the pathway there!– **The way there I could
find anyway—Google Maps to Hell**

Doch kann ich nicht genug verkunden, Yet I cannot
enough declare **But I cannot proclaim enough**

Was uberall besitzlos harrend liegt. What, ownerless,
waits everywhere. **What lies ownerless waiting ev-
erywhere**

Der Bauer, der die Furche pflugt, The farmer, following his share, **The farmer plowing his furrow**

Hebt einen Goldtopf mit der Scholle, Turns out a gold-crock with the mould: **Turns up a gold-pot with the soil—jackpot in the dirt**

Salpeter hofft er von der Leimenwand He seeks saltpetre where the clay-walls stand, **He hopes for saltpeter from the clay wall**

Und findet golden-goldne Rolle And findeth rolls of goldenest gold, **And finds a golden-golden roll**

Erschreckt, erfreut in kummerlicher Hand. With joyful fright, in his impoverished hand. **Frightened, delighted, in his careworn hand**

Was fur Gewölbe sind zu sprengen, What vaults there are to be exploded, **What vaults there are to be blown open**

In welchen Kluften, welchen Gängen Along what shafts and mines corroded, **In what crevices, what passages**

Muss sich der Schatzbewusste drängen, The gold-diviner's steps are goaded, **The treasure-seeker must push through**

Zur Nachbarschaft der Unterwelt! Until the Underworld is nigh! **Into the neighborhood of the Underworld—sketchy area**

In weiten, altverwahrten Kellern In cellars vast he sees the precious **In wide, long-guarded cellars**

Von goldnen Humpen, Schusseln, Tellern Cups,
beakers, vases, plates, and dishes, **Of golden
tankards, bowls, plates**

Sieht er sich Reihen aufgestellt; Row after row,
resplendent lie: **He sees rows standing arrayed**

Pokale stehen aus Rubinen, Rich goblets, cut from ru-
bies, stand there, **Goblets made from rubies**

Und will er deren sich bedienen, And, would he use
them, lo! at hand there **And if he wants to use them**

Daneben liegt uraltes Nass. Is ancient juice of
strength divine. **Nearby lies ancient liquid—wine
older than memory**

Doch—werdet ihr dem Kundigen glauben—Yet, trust to
him who's knowledge gotten, **Yet—if you'll believe
the expert—**

Verfault ist langst das Holz der Dauben, The wood o'
the staves has long been rotten, **The wood of the
staves has long rotted**

Der Weinstein schuf dem Wein ein Fass. A cask of tar-
tar holds the wine. **The tartar made itself a cask for
the wine.**

Essenzen solcher edlen Weine, Not only gold and
gems are hiding, **Essences of such noble wines**

Gold und Juwelen nicht alleine But of proud wines
the heart abiding, **Gold and jewels not alone**

Umhüllen sich mit Nacht und Graus. In terror and
in night profound: **Wrap themselves in night and**

horror

Der Weise forscht hier unverdrossen; Herein assiduously explore the wise; **The wise man researches here tirelessly—no work-life balance**

Am Tag erkennen, das sind Possen, It is a farce, by day to recognise, **To recognize by day, that's just jokes**

Im Finstern sind Mysterien zu Haus. But mysteries are with darkness circled round. **In darkness is where mysteries live.**

Kaiser

Die lass' ich dir! Was will das Düstre frommen? See thou to them! What profits the Obscure? **I'll leave those to you! What good is the dark?**

Hat etwas Wert, es muss zu Tage kommen. Whate'er has value comes to daylight, sure. **If something has value, it must come to daylight**

Wer kennt den Schelm in tiefer Nacht genau? At dead of night who can the rogue betray? **Who can spot a scoundrel in deep night?—literally no one**

Schwarz sind die Kuhe, so die Katzen grau. Then all the cows are black, the cats are gray. **Black are the cows, so gray the cats**

Die Topfe drunten, voll von Goldgewicht– If pots are down there, full of heavy gold, **The pots down there, full of gold-weight**

Zieh deinen Pflug und ackre sie ans Licht. Drive on thy plough and turn them from the mould! **Drive your plow and turn them up to light!**

Mephistopheles

Nimm Hack' und Spaten, grabe selber, Take hoe and spade thyself, I pray thee,– **Take hoe and spade yourself, get farming—very Marie Antoinette**

Die Bauernarbeit macht dich gross, Thou shalt be great through peasant-toil! **Peasant work makes you great—dirt under the nails**

Und eine Herde goldner Kalber, A herd of golden calves, to pay thee, **And a whole herd of golden calves**

Sie reißen sich vom Boden los. Will loose their bodies from the soil. **Will tear themselves loose from the ground—birth through soil**

Dann ohne Zaudern, mit Entzucken And then at once canst thou, with rapture, **Then without hesitation, with delight**

Kannst du dich selbst, wirst die Geliebte schmücken; Gems for thyself and for thy mistress capture: **You can adorn yourself, adorn your beloved**

Ein leuchtend Farb- und Glanzgestein erhoht Their tints and sparkles heighten the degree **A glowing color-and-sparkle-gem elevates**

Die Schonheit wie die Majestat. Of Beauty as of Majesty. **Beauty just as much as Majesty.**

Kaiser

Nur gleich, nur gleich! Wie lange soll es wahren! Then quick! at once! how long will it require? **Right now! How long will this take?!**

Astrolog (prompted by Mephistopheles)

Herr, massige solch dringendes Begehren, Sire, moderate such urgency of desire! **Sire, moderate such pressing desire—slow your pulse**

Lass erst vorbei das bunte Freudenspiel; Let first the gay, the motley pastime end! **Let the colorful fun-games pass first—you can't skip the tutorial**

Zerstreutes Wesen fuhrt uns nicht zum Ziel. Not to the goal doth such distraction tend. **Scattered being does not lead us to the goal**

Erst müssen wir in Fassung uns versuhnen, First self-command must quiet and assure us; **First we must reconcile ourselves in composure.**

Das Untre durch das Obere verdienen. The upper things the lower will procure us. **Earn the lower through the higher**

Wer Gutes will, der sei erst gut; Who seeks for Good, must first be good; **Whoever wants good must first**

BE good

Wer Freude will, besanftige sein Blut; Who seeks for joy, must moderate his blood; **Whoever wants joy must calm their blood—cool the vessels**

Wer Wein verlangt, der keltre reife Trauben; Who wine desires, let him the ripe grapes tread; **Whoever wants wine must press ripe grapes—no shortcuts**

Wer Wunder hofft, der starke seinen Glauben. Who miracles, by stronger faith be led! **Whoever hopes for miracles must strengthen their faith**

Kaiser

So sei die Zeit in Frohlichkeit vertan! Let us the time in merriment efface! **Fine! Let the time be wasted in merriment!**

Und ganz erwünscht kommt Aschermittwoch an. And, to our wish, Ash-Wednesday comes apace. **And super conveniently Ash Wednesday is coming**

Indessen feiern wir, auf jeden Fall, Meanwhile, we'll surely celebrate withal **Meanwhile we'll celebrate anyway**

Nur lustiger das wilde Karneval. More jovially the maddening Carnival. **The wild Carnival, only MORE wild—let's get freaky**

(Trumpets. Exeunt.)

Mephistopheles

Wie sich Verdienst und Gluck verketten, How closely linked are Luck and Merit, **How closely Luck and Merit link up—but nobody gets it**

Das fällt den Toren niemals ein; Doth never to these fools occur: **The fools never realize this truth**

Wenn sie den Stein der Weisen hatten, Had they the Philosopher's Stone, I swear it, **If they had the Philosopher's Stone**

Der Weise mangelte dem Stein. The Stone would lack the Philosopher! **The Philosopher would be missing from the Stone.**

Weitlaufiger Saal mit Nebengemachern / Spacious Hall with Adjoining Apartments

Arranged and decorated for the Carnival Masquerade.

Herold

Denkt nicht, ihr seid in deutschen Grenzen Think not,
as in our German bounds, your chance is **Not your
grandma's polka night**

Von Teufels-, Narren- und Totentänzen; Of Death's or
Fools' or Devils' dances; **Leave your scythe at the
door**

Ein heitres Fest erwartet euch. Here cheerful revels
you await. **Party hats mandatory**

Der Herr, auf seinen Romerzugen, Our Ruler, on his
Roman expedition, **Management retreat to pasta
country**

Hat, sich zu Nutz, euch zum Vergnugen, Hath for his
profit, your fruition, **Team building with wine**

Die hohen Alpen uberstiegen, Crossed o'er the Alpine
high partition, **Cardio with a view**

Gewonnen sich ein heitres Reich. And won himself a
gayer State. **Upgraded his empire**

Der Kaiser, er, an heiligen Sohlen He to the holy slip-
per bowed him **Shoe worship, executive edition**

Erbat sich erst das Recht zur Macht, And first the right
of power besought; **Power permit approved**

Und als er ging, die Krone sich zu holen, Then, as he
went to get the Crown allowed him, **Buy one empire,
get headwear free**

Hat er uns auch die Kappe mitgebracht. For us the
Fool's-cap he has also brought. **Dunce caps for
democracy**

Nun sind wir alle neugeboren; Now are we all new-
born, to wear it: **Rebirth via accessory**

Ein jeder weltgewandte Mann Each tactful and expe-
rienced man, **Experts in not dying**

Zieht sie behaglich uber Kopf und Ohren; Drawn

cosily o'er head and ears, doth bear it; **Hat on, brain off**

Sie ahnelt ihn verruckten Toren, A fool he seems, yet he must share it, **Clown transformation complete**

Er ist darunter weise, wie er kann. And be, thereby, as sober as he can. **Ironic fool status**

Ich sehe schon, wie sie sich scharen, They crowding come, I see already, **Crowd forming, stand back**

Sich schwankend sondern, traulich paaren; Close coupling, or withdrawn unsteady,– **Mixing and matching begins**

Zudringlich schliesst sich Chor an Chor. The choruses, like youth from school, **Choir pile-up**

Herein, hinaus, nur unverdrossen; Come in or out, bring on your ranks! **Flow like confused traffic**

Es bleibt doch endlich nach wie vor Before or after– 'tis the rule– **Eternal return of nonsense**

Mit ihren hunderttausend Possen With all its hundred thousand pranks, **Maximum tomfoolery deployed**

Die Welt ein einzig grosser Tor. The World is one enormous Fool! **Globe of goofballs**

Gartnerinnen (Song, accompanied with mandolines)

Euren Beifall zu gewinnen, That we win your praises tender **Applause, please**

Schmuckten wir uns diese Nacht, We are decked in
festal gear; **Primping complete**

Junge Florentinerinnen At the German Court of splen-
dour, **Florence's finest**

Folgt den deutschen Hofes Pracht; Girls of Florence, we
appear. **Trophy florists**

Tragen wir in braunen Locken On our locks of chest-
nut glosses **Follicle decorations**

Mancher heitern Blume Zier; Wear we many a flowery
bell; **Floral crown situation**

Seidenfaden, Seidenflocken Silken threads and
silken flosses **Thread count: high**

Spielen ihre Rolle hier. Here must play their parts, as
well. **Fabrics have entered the chat**

Denn wir halten es verdienstlich, Our desert, not over-
rated, **Merit badge: self**

Lobenswertig ganz und gar, Seems to us assured and
clear, **Top marks all around**

Unsere Blumen, glanzend kunstlich, For by art we've
fabricated **Plastic fantastic**

Blühen fort das ganze Jahr. Flowers that blossom all
the year. **Forever fresh**

Allerlei gefärbten Schnitzeln Every sort of coloured
snipping **Spectrum of scraps**

Ward symmetrisch Recht getan; Won its own symmet-
ric right: **Balance achieved**

Mogt ihr Stuck fur Stuck bewitzeln, Though your wit
on each be tripping, **Mock the pixels, miss the pic-
ture**

Doch das Ganze zieht euch an. In the whole you take
delight. **Sum greater than parts**

Niedlich sind wir anzuschauen, We are fair to see and
blooming, **Decorative status achieved**

Gartnerinnen und galant; Garden-girls, and gay of
heart; **Green thumbs, great dresses**

Denn das Naturell der Frauen For the natural way of
woman **Standard woman programming**

Ist so nah mit Kunst verwandt. Is so near akin to art.
Nature plus effort equals female

Herold

Lasst die reichen Korbe sehen, Let us see the wealth
of blossoms **Cargo reveal**

Die ihr auf den Hauptern traget, Basket-crowning
heads that bear them, **Head freight**

Die sich bunt am Arme blahen, Garlanding your arms
and bosoms! **Limb luggage**

Jeder wahle, was behaget. Each select, and lightly
wear them. **Help yourself**

Eilig, dass in Laub und Gangen Haste! and bosky ar-
bours dressing, **Landscaping speedrun**

Sich ein Garten offenbare! Let a garden here enring
us! **Spontaneous horticulture**

Wurdig sind sie zu umdrängen, Worthy they of closer
pressing, **Crowd worthy**

Kramerinnen wie die Ware. Hucksters and the wares
they bring us. **Buy one, admire the other**

Gartnerinnen

Feilschet nun am heitern Orte, Now in cheerful places
chaffer, **Price negotiation enabled**

Doch kein Markten finde statt! But no marketing be
ours! **Fake market only**

Und mit sinnig kurzem Worte Briefly, clearly, let each
laugher **Brevity mode**

Wisse jeder, was er hat. Know the meaning of his flow-
ers. **Know your purchase**

Olivenzweig mit Früchten

Mir ist's gegen die Natur: Flowery sprays I do not
covet; **Anti-spectacle**

Bin ich doch das Mark der Lande Strife I shun, or
branch above it, **Core content**

Und, zum sichern Unterpfande, Foe of conflict I
remain. **Promise backed up**

Friedenszeichen jeder Flur. Yet am I the marrow of nations, **Truce twig**

Heute, hoff' ich, soll mir's glücken, Pledge of happy consummations, **Fingers crossed**

Wurdig schönes Haupt zu schmucken. Sign of peace on every plain. **Cranium upgrade pending**

Be, today, my lucky fate

Worthy head to decorate!

Ahrenkranz (golden)

Ceres' Gaben, euch zu putzen, You to crown, the gifts of Ceres **Carb crown**

Werden hold und lieblich stehn: Here their kindly grace have sent; **Beauty enhancement active**

Das Erwuschteste dem Nutzen Unto Use what chiefly dear is **Function over form**

Sei als eure Zierde schon. Be your fairest ornament! **Practical prettiness**

Phantasiekranz

Bunte Blumen, Malven ähnlich, Gayest blossoms, like to mallows,– **Dream weeds**

Aus dem Moos ein Wunderflor! From the moss a marvel grew! **Spontaneous flora**

Der Natur ist's nicht gewöhnlich, Fashion calls to light,
and hallows, **Natural law: suspended**

Doch die Mode bringt's hervor. That which Nature
never knew. **Vogue creates reality**

Phantasiestrauss

Meinen Namen euch zu sagen, What our name is,
Theophrastus **Identity withheld**

Wurde Theophrast nicht wagen; Would not dare to
say: contrast us! **Expert: stumped**

Und doch hoff' ich, wo nicht allen, Yet we hope to
please you purely, **Partial approval sought**

Aber mancher zu gefallen, If not all, yet many, surely,–
Limited appeal

Der ich mich wohl eignen mochte, Such as fain we'd
have possess us, **Preferred customers**

Wenn sie mich ins Haar verflochte, Braiding us in shin-
ing tresses, **Braid me in**

Wenn sie sich entschliessen konnte, Or, a fairer fate
deciding, **Choose already**

Mir am Herzen Platz vergonnte. On the heart find rest
abiding. **Cardiac real estate**

Rosenknospen (Challenge)

Mogen bunte Phantasieen Motley fancies blossom
may **Fantasy approved**

Fur des Tages Mode bluh'n, For the fashion of the day,
Current meta

Wunderseltsam sein gestaltet, Whimsical and
strangely moulded, **Geometry gone wild**

Wie Natur sich nie entfaltet; Such as Nature ne'er un-
folded: **Reality exception**

Grüne Stiele, goldne Glocken, Bells of gold and stems
of green **Bling botany**

Blickt hervor aus reichen Locken!– In the plenteous
locks be seen!– **Curl reveal**

Doch wir–halten uns versteckt: Yet we lie concealed
behind; **Hidden status**

Glücklich, wer uns frisch entdeckt. Lucky, who shall
freshly find! **First finder bonus**

Wenn der Sommer sich verkunet, When the summer-
time returneth, **Hot season incoming**

Rosenknospe sich entzündet, And the rosebud, burst-
ing, burneth, **Bloom explosion**

Wer mag solches Glück entbehren? Who such blisses
would surrender? **Bliss compulsory**

Das Versprechen, das Gewahren, Promise sweet, and
yielding tender, **Hype and follow-through**

Das beherrscht in Florens Reich They, in Flora's realm,
control **Flower kingdom rules**

Blick und Sinn und Herz zugleich. Swiftly eyes and sense and soul. **Triple target lock**

(Under green, leafy arcades, the Garden-girls adorn and gracefully exhibit their wares.)

Gartner (Song, accompanied with theorbos)

Blumen sehet ruhig spriessen, Blossoms there, that sprout in quiet, **Passive plant viewing**

Reizend euer Haupt umzieren; Round your heads their charms are weaving; **Head: enhanced**

Fruchte wollen nicht verführen, But the fruits are not deceiving, **No deception produce**

Kostend mag man sie geniessen. One may try the mellow diet. **Taste test permitted**

Bieten braunliche Gesichter Sunburnt faces tempt with glowing **Melanin marketing**

Kirschen, Pfirschen, Königspflaumen, Cherries, peaches, plums, your vision: **Stone fruit parade**

Kauft! denn gegen Zung' und Gaumen Buy! for vain the eye's decision **Tongue knows best**

Halt sich Auge schlecht als Richter. To the tongue's and palate's showing. **Eyes: unreliable**

Kommt, von allerreifsten Früchten Ripest fruit from sunniest closes **Peak fruit approaching**

Mit Geschmack und Lust zu speisen! Eat, with taste
and pleasure smitten! **Taste dining**

Über Rosen lässt sich dichten, Poems one may write
on roses, **Roses: decorative text**

In die Apfel muss man beissen. But the apple must be
bitten! **Bite the apple**

Sei's erlaubt, uns anzupaaren Then permit that we be
mated **Match me**

Eurem reichen Jugendflor, With your youth, so
flowery-fair: **Young and flowery**

Und wir putzen reifer Waren Thus is also decorated,
Ripe goods shown

Fuller nachbarlich empor. Neighbour-like, our ripper
ware. **Adjacently**

Unter lustigen Gewinden, Under wreaths of flowery
tether, **Wreath zone**

In geschmückter Lauben Bucht, As the leafy arbours
suit, **Decorative alcove**

Alles ist zugleich zu finden: All may then be found to-
gether, **Bundle deal**

Knospe, Blatter, Blume, Frucht. Buds and leaves, and
flower and fruit! **Complete botanical set**

Mutter

Madchen, als du kamst ans Licht, Maiden, when thou
cam'st to light, **Arrival documented**

Schmuckt' ich dich im Haubchen; Tiny caps I wrought
thee; **Baby hat situation**

Warst so lieblich von Gesicht Body tender, soft, and
white, **Face: adorable**

Und so zart am Leibchen. Lovely face I brought thee.
Softness verified

Dachte dich sogleich als Braut, As a bride I thought
thee, led **Marriage forecast**

Gleich dem Reichsten angetraut, To the richest,
wooed and wed, **Rich match anticipated**

Dachte dich als Weibchen. As a wife I thought thee.
Marital future imagined

Ach! Nun ist schon manches Jahr Ah! already many a
year, **Time: passed**

Ungenutzt verflogen, Profitless, is over: **Unused
years**

Der Sponsierer bunte Schar None of all the wooers
here **Candidate pool**

Schnell vorbeigezogen; Now around thee hover;
Gone now

Tanztest mit dem einen flink, Though with one wast
wont to dance, **First dancer**

Gabst dem andern feinen Wink Gav'st another nudge
and glance,– **Hint deployed**

Mit dem Ellenbogen. Hast not found thy lover! **Arm nudge**

Welches Fest man auch ersann, I to feast and revel thee **Party count**

Ward umsonst begangen, Vainly took, to match one: **Failure logged**

Pfanderspiel und dritter Mann Pawns, and hindmost man of three, **Mating games**

Wollten nicht verfangen; Would not help thee snatch one. **Net: empty**

Heute sind die Narren los, Ev'ry fool now wears his cap: **Idiots unleashed**

Liebchen, offne deinen Schoss, Sweetheart, open thou thy lap! **Opening hours extended**

Bleibt wohl einer hangen. Still, perchance, mayst catch one! **Stickiness anticipated**

Holzhauer

Nur Platz! nur Blossen! Room! make a clearing! **Move, people**

Wir brauchen Raume, Room in your revel! **Room needed**

Wir fallen Baume, The trees we level **Timber service**

Die krachen, schlagen; That tumble cracking: **Crash happening**

Und wenn wir tragen, Where we're appearing **Hauling phase**

Da gibt es Stosse. Look out for whacking. **Bump zone**

Zu unserm Lobe Our praise adjudging, **Credit due**

Bringt dies ins reine; Make clear this fable! **Point made**

Denn wirkten Grobe Save Coarse were drudging **Rough work value**

Nicht auch im Lande, Within your borders, **Work happening**

Wie kamen Feine Would Fine be able, **Fancy people question**

Für sich zustande, To build their orders, **Independence: denied**

So sehr sie witzten? Howe'er they fretted? **Cleverness: useless**

Des seid belehret! Be taught in season, **Lesson incoming**

Denn ihr erfroret, For you'd be freezing **Freezing forecast**

Wenn wir nicht schwitzten. Had we not sweated! **Perpiration: essential**

Pulcinelle (uncouth, almost idiotic)

Ihr seid die Toren, You, Fools, are trooping, **You: foolish**

Gebuckt geboren. Since birth so stooping; **Birth posture: hunched**

Wir sind die Klugen, The wise ones we are, **Smart status: claimed**

Die nie was trugen; From burdens freer. **Burden-free**
Denn unsre Kappen, Our caps, though sleazy, **Hat report**

Jacken und Lappen And jackets breezy **Garment status**

Sind leicht zu tragen; To wear are easy: **Lightness achieved**

Und mit Behagen It gives us pleasure **Pleasure status**

Wir immer mussig, To go with leisure, **Laziness: constant**

Pantoffelfussig, With slippery shuffles **Slipper mode**
Durch Markt und Haufen Through market-scuffles, **Market traverse**

Einherzulaufen, To gape at the pother, **Aimless walking**

Gaffend zu stehen, Croak at each other! **Stare standing**

Uns anzukrahen; Through crowded places **Noise exchange**

Auf solche Klänge You always trace us, **Audio following**

Durch Drang und Menge Eel-like gliding, **Mass navigation**

Aalgleich zu schlupfen, Skipping and hiding, **Slippery status**

Gesamt zu hupfen, Storming together: **Group bounce**

Vereint zu toben. Moreover, whether **Collective madness**

Ihr mögt uns loben, You praise-reprove us, **Approval: accepted**

Ihr mögt uns schelten, It doesn't move us. **Criticism: accepted**

Wir lassen's gelten. It doesn't move us. **Acceptance: total**

Parasiten (fawningly-lustful)

Ihr wackern Trager Ye woodland bandsmen, **Hauler recognition**

Und eure Schwager, And they, your clansmen, **In-law addition**

Die Kohlenbrenner, The charcoal-burners, **Charcoal team**

Sind unsre Manner. To you we turn us: **Our people**

Denn alles Bucken, For all such plodding, **Bowing noted**

Bejahndes Nicken, Affirmative nodding, **Yes-head motion**

Gewundne Phrasen, Tortuous phrases, **Verbal twisting**

Das Doppelblasen, Blowing both ways—is **Both-ways blowing**

Das warmt und kuhlet, Warming or chilling, **Thermal options**

Wie's einer fuhlet, Just as you're feeling: **Mood-based**

Was konnt' es frommen? What profit from it? **Purpose query**

Es mochte Feuer There might fall fire, **Flame potential**

Selbst ungeheuer Enormous, dire, **Big fire**

Vom Himmel kommen, From heaven's summit, **Sky fire**

Gab' es nicht Scheite Were there not billets **No logs**

Und Kohlenrachten, And coal in waggon, **Coal need**

Die Herdesbreite To boil your skillets **Fire space**

Zur Glut entfachten. And warm your flagons. **Heat start**

Da brat's und prudelt's, It roasts and frizzles; **Sizzle status**

Da kocht's und strudelt's. It boils and sizzles! **Bubble action**

Der wahre Schmecker, The taster and picker, **Flavor professional**

Der Tellerlecker, The platter-licker, **Clean plate person**

Er riecht den Braten, He sniffs the roasting, **Smell sensor**

Er ahnet Fische; Suspects the fishes, **Seafood sense**

Das regt zu Taten And clears, with boasting, **Movement motivation**

An Gonners Tische. His patron's dishes. **Boss dinner location**

Trunkner (unconsciously)

Frische Lust und heitre Lieder, Naught, today, bring melancholy! **Good vibes activated**

Holt' ich selbst sie doch herbei. Since I feel so frank and free: **Personal import**

Und so trink' ich! Trinke, trinke! Fresh delight and songs so jolly, **Consumption: active**

Stosset an, ihr! Tinke, Tinke! And I brought them both with me! **Clink protocol**

Du dorthinten, komm heran! Thus I'm drinking, drinking, drinking! **Back-row call**

Stosset an, so ist's getan. Clink your glasses, clinking, clinking! **Clink = done**

You behind there, join the rout!

Clink them stout, and then it's out!

Schrie mein Weibchen doch entrustet, Though my wife assailed me loudly, **Wife: unhappy**

Rumpfte diesem bunten Rock, Rumped me through thin and thick; **Outfit: disapproved**

Und, wie sehr ich mich gebrustet, And, howe'er I swaggered proudly, **Puffing: ineffective**

Schalt mich einen Maskenstock. Called me "masquerading stick:" **Name: costume stick**

Doch ich trinke! Trinke, trinke! Yet I'm drinking, drinking, drinking! **Consumption: persistent**

Angeklungen! Tinke, Tinke! Clink your glasses! clinking, clinking! **Clink complete**

Maskenstocke, stosset an! Masking sticks, another bout! **Dummy cheers**

Wenn es klingt, so ist's getan. When you've clinked them, drink them out! **Sound = success**

Saget nicht, dass ich verirrt bin, Say not mine a silly
boast is! **Not lost**

Bin ich doch, wo mir's behagt. I am here in clover laid:
Position: chosen

Borgt der Wirt nicht, borgt die Wirtin, Trusts the host
not, trusts the hostess,– **Backup funding**

Und am Ende borgt die Magd. She refusing, trusts the
maid. **Maid backup**

Immer trink' ich! Trinke, trinke! Still I'm drinking,
drinking, drinking! **Ongoing consumption**

Auf, ihr andern! Tinke, Tinke! Come, ye others, clink-
ing, clinking! **Others: summoned**

Jeder jedem! so fortan! Each to each! keep up the
rout! **Reciprocal drinking**

Dunkt mich's doch, es sei getan. We, I'm thinking,
drink them out. **Done feeling**

Wie und wo ich mich vergnuge, How and where my
fun I'm spying, **Pleasure: flexible**

Mag es immerhin geschehn; Let me have it as I
planned! **Let it be**

Lass mich liegen, wo ich liege, Let me lie where I am
lying, **Lying: approved**

Denn ich mag nicht langer stehn. For I cannot longer
stand. **Vertical: denied**

Chor

Jeder Bruder trinke, trinke! Every chum be drinking,
drinking! **All drink command**

Toastet frisch ein Tinke, Tinke! Toast afresh, with
clinking, clinking! **New clinks**

Sitzet fest auf Bank und Span! Bravely keep your
seats, and shout! **Bench grip**

Unterm Tisch dem ist's getan. Under the table lies
drunk out. **Floor position: final**

Satiriker

Wisst ihr, was mich Poeten Know ye what myself, the
Poet, **Joy question**

Erst recht erfreuen sollte? Would the most rejoice and
cheer? **Writer: me**

Durft' ich singen und reden, If I dared to sing, and ut-
ter, **Voice permission**

Was niemand horen wollte. That which no one wants
to hear. **Undesired speech**

Die Grazien

Aglaia

Anmut bringen wir ins Leben; Life we bless with
graces living; **Elegance import**

Leget Anmut in das Geben. So be graceful in your giving! **Stylish gifting**

Hegemone

Leget Anmut ins Empfangen, Graceful be in your re-
ceival; **Graceful getting**

Lieulich ist's, den Wunsch erlangen. Wish attained is
sweet retrieval. **Desire: achieved**

Euphrosyne

Und in stiller Tage Schranken And in days serene and
spacious, **Calm period**

Hochst anmutig sei das Danken. In your thanks be
chiefly gracious. **Graceful gratitude**

Die Parzen

Atropos

Mich, die Alteste, zum Spinnen I, the eldest, to the
spinning **Thread starter**

Hat man diesmal eingeladen; Have received the invi-
tation; **Party invite**

Viel zu denken, viel zu sinnen When the thread of
Life's beginning **Thinking required**

Gibt's beim zarten Lebensfaden. There is need of
meditation. **Fragile thread**

Dass er euch gelenk und weich sei, Finest flax I win-
now featly **Flexibility target**

Wusst' ich feinsten Flachs zu sichten; That your thread
be softly given; **Premium fiber**

Dass er glatt und schlank und gleich sei, Draw it
through my fingers neatly, **Uniformity goal**

Wird der kluge Finger schlichten. Make it thin, and
smooth, and even. **Digital smoothing**

Wolltet ihr bei Lust und Tanzen If too wanton your en-
deavour, **Fun limits**

Allzu uppig euch erweisen, Grasping here of joy each
token, **Too much alert**

Denkt an dieses Fadens Grenzen, Think, the thread
won't stretch for ever! **Breaking point**

Hutet euch! Er mochte reissen. Have a care! it might
be broken. **Tear alert**

Klotho

Wisst, in diesen letzten Tagen Know that, given to me
for wearing, **News alert**

Ward die Schere mir vertraut; Lately were the shears
supplied; **Cutting tool transfer**

Denn man war von dem Betragen Since men were not
by the bearing **Unhappiness registered**

Unsrer Alten nicht erbaut. Of our eldest edified. **Se-
nior conduct**

Zerzt unnutzeste Gespinste Useless webs she long un-
tangled, **Useless preservation**

Lange sie an Licht und Luft, Dragging them to air and light; **Over-extended**

Hoffnung herrlichster Gewinste Dreams of fortune, hope-bespangled, **Gain anticipation**

Schleppt sie schneidend zu der Gruft. Clipped and buried out of sight. **Snip to death**

Doch auch ich im Jugendwalten Also I, in ignorance idle, **Young mistake**

Irrte mich schon hundertmal; Made mistakes in younger years, **Mistakes: many**

Heute mich im Zaum zu halten, But today, myself to bridle, **Control mode**

Schere steckt im Futteral. In their sheath I stick the shears. **Cutting: paused**

Und so bin ich gern gebunden, Thus restrained in proper measure **Binding: voluntary**

Blicke freundlich diesem Ort; Favour I this cheerful place: **Kind viewing**

Ihr in diesen freien Stunden You these hours of liberal pleasure **Liberty hours**

Schwarmt nur immer fort und fort. Use at will, and run your race! **Party persistence**

Lachesis

Mir, die ich allein verständig, In my hands, the only skilful, **Smart self**

Blieb das Ordnen zugeteilt; Was the ordered twisting placed; **Organization duty**

Meine Weife, stets lebendig, Active are my ways, not wilful, **Spool: active**

Hat noch nie sich ubereilt. Erring not through overhaste. **No rushing**

Faden kommen, Faden weifen, Threads are coming, threads are reeling; **Fiber flow**

Jeden lenk' ich seine Bahn, In its course I each restrain: **Direction service**

Keinen lass' ich uberschweifen, None, from off the circle wheeling, **Containment: perfect**

Fug' er sich im Kreis heran. Fails to fit within the skein. **Pattern inclusion**

Konnt' ich einmal mich vergessen, If I once regardless gadded, **Distraction: hypothetical**

War' es um die Welt mir bang; For the world my hopes were vain: **Global worry**

Stunden zahlen, Jahre messen, Hours are counted, years are added, **Temporal measurement**

Und der Weber nimmt den Strang. And the weaver takes the chain. **Final destination**

Herold

Die jetzo kommen, werdet ihr nicht kennen, You

would not recognise who now appear, **Mystery guests**

Wart ihr noch so gelehrt in alten Schriften; Though ne'er so learned you were in ancient writing; **Books: useless**

Sie anzusehn, die so viel Ubel stiften, To look at them, in evil so delighting, **Harm-causers viewed**

Ihr wurdet sie willkommne Gäste nennen. You'd call them worthy guests, and welcome here. **Guest error**

Die Furien sind es, niemand wird uns glauben, They are The Furies, no one will believe us,– **Furies: present**

Hubsch, wohlgestaltet, freundlich, jung von Jahren; Fair, well-proportioned, friendly, young in years: **Looks: misleading**

Lasst euch mit ihnen ein, ihr sollt erfahren, But make acquaintance, and straightway appears **Involve-ment: risky**

Wie schlangenhaft verletzen solche Tauben. How snake-like are such doves to wound, deceive us. **Cute but deadly**

Zwar sind sie tückisch, doch am heutigen Tage, Though they are spiteful, yet on this occasion, **Evil: acknowledged**

Wo jeder Narr sich ruhm't seiner Mangel, When every fool exults in all his blame, **Flaw pride**

Auch sie verlangen nicht den Ruhm als Engel, They
also do not crave angelic fame, **No halo here**

Bekennen sich als Stadt- und Landesplage. But own
themselves the torments of the nation. **Trouble: ad-
mitted**

Alekto

Was hilft es euch? ihr werdet uns vertrauen, What
good of that? For you will trust us still!– **You'll
believe anyway**

Denn wir sind hübsch und jung und Schme-
ichelkätzchen; Each of us young and fair, a wheedling
kitten. **Kitten strategy**

Hat einer unter euch ein Liebeskätzchen, Hath one
of you a girl with whom he's smitten, **Partner query**

Wir werden ihm so lang die Ohren krauen, We'll rub
and softly stroke his ears, until **Ego massage**

Bis wir ihm sagen dürfen, Aug' in Auge: 'Tis safe to tell
him, spite of all his loathing, **Direct message**

Dass sie zugleich auch dem und jenem winke, That
she has also this and the other flame,– **Flirtation
alert**

Im Kopfe dumm, im Rücken krumm, und hinke A
blockhead he, or humpbacked, squint and lame,
Flaw inventory

Und, wenn sie seine Braut ist, gar nichts tauge. And if

betrothed to him, she's good-for-nothing! **Worthless bride**

So wissen wir die Braut auch zu bedrängen: We're skilled, as well, the bride to vex and sever: **Tormenting: also brides**

Es hat sogar der Freund, vor wenig Wochen, Why scarce a week ago, her very lover **Partner: recent**

Verachtliches von ihr zu der gesprochen!– Contemptuous things to her was saying of her! **Bad-mouthing: confirmed**

Versohnt man sich, so bleibt doch etwas hängen. Though they make up, there's something rankles ever. **Lasting harm**

Megara

Das ist nur Spass! denn, sind sie erst verbunden, That's a mere jest! For, let them once be married, **Wedding: worse**

Ich nehm' es auf und weiss; in allen Fallen, I go to work, and can, in every case, **My turn**

Das schönste Glück durch Grille zu vergallen; The fairest bliss by wilful whims displace. **Joy spoiling**

Der Mensch ist ungleich, ungleich sind die Stunden. Man has his various moods, the hours are varied, **Variation: constant**

Und niemand hat Erwünschtes fest in Armen, And,

holding the Desired that once did charm him, **Keeping: failed**

Der sich nicht nach Erwunschterem torig sehnte,
Each for the More-desired, a yearning fool, **Better wanting**

Vom höchsten Glück, woran er sich gewohnte; Leaves
the best fortune, use has rendered cool: **Joy fatigue**

Die Sonne flieht er, will den Frost erwarmen. He flies
the sun, and seeks the frost to warm him. **Sun flee, frost seek**

Mit diesem allen weiss ich zu gebaren Of ills for all I
understand the brewing, **Manipulation ability**

Und führe her Asmodi, den Getreuen, And here
Asmodi as my follower lead, **Asmodi arrival**

Zu rechter Zeit Unseliges auszustreuen, To scatter
mischief at the proper need, **Bad luck distribution**

Verderbe so das Menschevolk in Paaren. And send
the human race, in pairs, to ruin. **Couple ruin**

Tisiphone

Gift und Dolch statt boser Zungen Steel and poison I,
not malice, **Physical harm option**

Misch' ich, scharf' ich dem Verrater; Mix and sharpen
for the traitor: **Betrayer recipe**

Liebst du andre, fruher, spater Lov'st thou others,
soon or later, **Different lover: consequences**

Hat Verderben dich durchdrungen. Ruin pours for thee the chalice. **Destruction: total**

Muss der Augenblicke Susstes Through the moment's sweet libation **Moment evaluation**

Sich zu Gischt und Galle wandeln! See the gall and wormwood stealing! **Taste reversal**

Hier kein Markten, hier kein Handeln– Here no bargaining, no dealing! **No bargaining**

Wie er es beging', er busst es. Like the act and retaliation. **Karma delivery**

Singe keiner vom Vergeben! No one babble of forgiving! **No mercy**

Felsen klag' ich meine Sache, To the rocks I cry: Revenge! is **Stone crying**

Echo! horch! erwidert: Rache! Echo's answer: he who changes **Revenge echo**

Und wer wechselt, soll nicht leben. Shall be missed among the living. **Life: revoked**

Herold

Belieb' euch nun, seitwärts zu treten, Do me the favour, now, to stand aside, **Move aside**

Denn was da kommt, ist nicht euresgleichen. For that which comes is not to you allied. **Not-your-type incoming**

Ihr seht, wie sich ein Berg herangedrangt, You see
a mountain pressing through the throng, **Big thing
coming**

Mit bunten Teppichen die Weichen stolz behangt, The
flanks with brilliant housings grandly hung, **Carpet
coverage**

Ein Haupt mit langen Zähnen, Schlangenrüssel, A
head with tusks, a snaky trunk below,– **Tusked
trunk-face**

Geheimnisvoll, doch zeig' ich euch den Schlüssel. A
mystery, yet I the key will show. **Explanation coming**

Im Nacken sitzt ihm zierlich-zarte Frau, A delicate
woman sits upon his neck, **Woman: mounted**

Mit feinem Stabchen lenkt sie ihn genau; And with a
wand persuades him to her beck; **Steering: precise**

Die andre, droben stehend herrlich-hehr, The other,
throned aloft, superb to see, **Top rider**

Umgibt ein Glanz, der blendet mich zu sehr. Stands in
a glory, dazzling, blinding me. **Dazzle: maximum**

Zur Seite gehn gekettet edle Frauen, Beside him walk
two dames in chains; one fearful **Noble captives**

Die eine bang, die andre froh zu schauen; And sore de-
pressed, the other glad and cheerful. **Emotion con-
trast**

Die eine wünscht, die andre fühlt sich frei. One longs
for freedom and one feels she's free: **Wish vs feel**

Verkünde jede, wer sie sei. Let each declare us who she be! **Name yourselves**

Furcht

Dunstige Fackeln, Lampen, Lichter Smoky torches, lamps are gleaming **Smoke and light**

Dammern durchs verworrene Fest; Through the festival's wildering train; **Party haze**

Zwischen diese Truggesichter Ah! amid these faces scheming **Fake face area**

Bannt mich, ach! die Kette fest. I am fastened by my chain. **Bondage: active**

Fort, ihr lacherlichen Lacher! Off, ridiculously merry! **Ridiculous ones: leave**

Euer Grinsen gibt Verdacht; I mistrust your grinning spite: **Smile: threatening**

Alle meine Widersacher Each relentless adversary **Adversary presence**

Drangen mich in dieser Nacht. Presses nearer in the night. **Closing: enemies**

Hier! ein Freund ist Feind geworden, Friend would here as foe waylay me, **Friendship: reversed**

Seine Maske kenn' ich schon; But I know the masking shapes; **Disguise: penetrated**

Jener wollte mich ermorden, Yonder's one that wished to slay me,– **Kill wish: noted**

Nun entdeckt schleicht er davon. Now, discovered, he escapes. **Caught: fleeing**

Ach wie gern in jeder Richtung From the world I fain would wander **Flight wish**

Floh' ich zu der Welt hinaus; Through whatever gate I find; **Escape: total**

Doch von druben droht Vernichtung, But perdition threatens yonder, **Destruction: omnidirectional**

Halt mich zwischen Dunst und Graus. And the horror holds my mind. **Horror holding**

Hoffnung

Seid gegrusst, ihr lieben Schwestern! Good my sisters, I salute you! **Sis salutation**

Habt ihr euch schon heut' und gestern Though today already suit you, **Past days**

In Vermummungen gefallen, Masquerading thus demurely, **Costume fun**

Weiss ich doch gewiss von allen: Yet I know your purpose surely **Certainty stated**

Morgen wollt ihr euch enthüllen. To reveal yourself tomorrow. **Unmasking: scheduled**

Und wenn wir bei Fackelscheine And if we, by torches
lighted, **Flame illumination**

Uns nicht sonderlich behagen, Fail to feel a special
pleasure, **Fun: moderate**

Werden wir in heitern Tagen Yet in days of cheerful
leisure, **Cheerful day forecast**

Ganz nach unserm eignen Willen At our will, delight
we'll borrow, **Self-direction**

Bald gesellig, bald alleine Or alone or disunited **Com-
pany: optional**

Frei durch schöne Fluren wandeln, Free through
fairest pastures ranging, **Field freedom**

Nach Belieben ruhn und handeln Rest and action in-
terchanging, **Action: optional**

Und in sorgenfreiem Leben And in life no cares that
fetter **Worry-free**

Nie entbehren, stets erstreben; Naught forego, but
strive for better. **No lack, always want**

Überall willkommne Gäste, Welcome guests are all
around us, **Guest status: welcome**

Treten wir getrost hinein: Let us mingle with the rest!
Bold entrance

Sicherlich, es muss das Beste Surely, what is best hath
found us, **Best: assured**

Irgendwo zu finden sein. Or we'll somewhere find the
best. **Findable: yes**

Klugheit

Zwei der grossten Menschenfeinde, Two of human
foes, the greatest, **Big threats: two**

Furcht und Hoffnung, angekettet, Fear and Hope, I
bind the faster, **Bound: both**

Halt' ich ab von der Gemeinde; Thus to save you at
the latest: **People: shielded**

Platz gemacht! ihr seid gerettet. Clear the way for me,
their master. **Saved: you**

Den lebendigen Kolossen I conduct the live colossus,
Big live thing

Fuhr' ich, seht ihr, turmbeladen, Turret-crowned with
weighty masses; **Tower cargo**

Und er wandelt unverdrossen And unweariedly he
crosses, **Walking: continuous**

Schritt vor Schritt auf steilen Pfaden. Step by step, the
steepest passes. **Difficult path**

Droben aber auf der Zinne But aloft the goddess
planted, **Top position**

Jene Gottin, mit behenden With her broad and ready
pinions, **Divine being**

Breiten Flugeln, zum Gewinne Turns to spy where
gain is granted **Broad wings**

Allerseits sich hinzuwenden. Everywhere in Man's dominions. **All-way turning**

Rings umgibt sie Glanz und Glorie, Round her all is bright and glorious: **Brightness: surrounding**

Leuchtend fern nach allen Seiten; Splendour streams on all her courses: **All-way glow**

Und sie nennet sich Viktorie, Victory is she—the victorious **Self-identification**

Gottin aller Tatigkeiten. Goddess of all active forces. **Action deity**

Zoilo-Thersites

Hu! Hu! da komm' ich eben recht, Ho! ho! I've hit the time of day. **Arrival: well-timed**

Ich schelt' euch allzusammen schlecht! You're all together bad, I say! **All: bad**

Doch was ich mir zum Ziel ersah, But what appeared my goal to me **Aim: stated**

Ist oben Frau Viktoria. Is she up there, Dame Victory. **Target: Victory**

Mit ihrem weissen Flugelpaar She, with her snowy wings spread out, **White wing description**

Sie dunkt sich wohl, sie sei ein Aar, Thinks she's an eagle, past a doubt; **Bird delusion**

Und wo sie sich nur hingewandt, And, wheresoever
she may stir, **Turn direction**

Gehor' ihr alles Volk und Land; That land and folk be-
long to her! **All: hers**

Doch, wo was Ruhmliches gelingt, But when a famous
thing is done **Praiseworthy: occurring**

Es mich sogleich in Harnisch bringt. I straightway put
my harness on, **Armor: donned**

Das Tiefe hoch, das Hohe tief, To lift the low, the high
upset, **High-low swap**

Das Schiefe grad, das Grade schief, The bent to
straighten, bend the straight,– **Crooked-straight
swap**

Das ganz allein macht mich gesund, That, only, gives
my heart a glow, **Halt!**

So will ich's auf dem Erdenrund. And on this earth I'll
have it so. **Horses, rein in your wings–feel the bit
against your wind**

Herold

So treffe dich, du Lumpenhund, Then take, thou
beggar-cur, the blow, **Feel the accustomed bridle**

Des frommen Stabes Meisterstreich! This magic
baton's stroke of skill!– **Master yourselves like I
master you–it's called consent**

Da krumm und winde dich sogleich!– So, twist and wriggle at thy will! **Rush forth when I get you hot and bothered–**

Wie sich die Doppelzwerpgestalt See how the double dwarfish ape **Let's honor these spaces!–they have feelings too**

So schnell zum eklen Klumpen ballt!– Rolls to a hideous ball in shape!– **Look around, how they multiply–bodies gathering like cells**

–Doch Wunder!–Klumpen wird zum Ei, A marvel! 'Tis an egg we view; **The admirers, circle upon circle.**

Das blaht sich auf und platzt entzwei. It puffs itself and cracks in two: **Herald, come! In your fashion**

Nun fällt ein Zwillingsspaar heraus, A pair of twins come forth today, **Before we yeet ourselves outta here**

Die Otter und die Fledermaus; The Adder and the Bat are they. **Describe us, name us–tell us what we are, daddy**

Die eine fort im Staube kriecht, Forth in the dust one winds and creeps, **Because we're just allegories–we're not even real, technically**

Die andre schwarz zur Decke fliegt. One darkly round the ceiling sweeps. **And so you should know us.**

Sie eilen draussen zum Verein; They haste to join in company: **I couldn't name you if I tried–**

Da mocht' ich nicht der dritte sein. The third therein

I would not be! **But I could describe you–your surfaces speak to my eyes**

Gemurmel

Frisch! dahinten tanzt man schon– Come! the dance is yonder gay.– **So try it!**

Nein! Ich wollt', ich war' davon– No! I would I were away.– **One must admit–**

Fuhlst du, wie uns das umflucht, Feel'st thou how the phantom race **First, you are young and beautiful**

Das gespenstische Gezucht?– Flits about us in this place?– **Half-grown boy, still becoming–but the women, they'd want you fully ripe**

Saust es mir doch ubers Haar– Something whizzes past my hair.– **They want to see you all the way grown up, if you know what I mean**

Ward ich's doch am Fuss gewahr– Round my feet I saw it fare.– **You seem like a future fuckboy to me**

Keiner ist von uns verletzt– None of us are injured, though.– **A natural-born heartbreaker, right from home.**

Alle doch in Furcht gesetzt– But we all are frightened so.– **That tracks! Keep going, solve my riddle for fun!**

Ganz verdorben ist der Spass– Wholly spoiled is now the fun.– **Invent the cheerful answer–let it form in**

your mouth

Und die Bestien wollten das. Which the vermin
wanted done.– **The black lightning of the eyes,
the night of the curls**

Herold

Seit mir sind bei Maskeraden Since, as Herald, I am
aiding **Brightened up by a jeweled headband!**

Heroldspflichten aufgeladen, At your merry mas-
querading, **And what delicate clothes flow from
shoulders to ankles–silk kissing skin**

Wach' ich ernstlich an der Pforte, At the gate I'm
watching, fearful **With purple trim and sparkly
bits–giving slutty fairy**

Dass euch hier am lustigen Orte Lest within your rev-
els cheerful **One could call you a maiden–**

Nichts Verderbliches erschleiche, Something slips of
evil savour; **But for better or worse, you'd already
score with girls right now**

Weder wanke, weder weiche. And I neither shrink nor
waver. **They'd teach you the ABC real quick**

Doch ich furchte, durch die Fenster Yet, I fear, the airy
spectres **And this one, who as a splendid form sits
proud on the chariot throne?**

Ziehen luftige Gespenster, Enter, baffling all detec-
tors, **What about him?**

Und von Spuk und Zaubereien And from goblins that deceive you **He seems a king, rich and mild**

Wusst' ich euch nicht zu befreien. I'm unable to relieve you. **Lucky whoever gets on his good side!**

Machte sich der Zwerg verdächtig, First, the dwarf became suspicious; **He has nothing left to achieve—peak unlocked**

Nun! dort hinten strömt es mächtig. Now a mightier pageant issues **Where something's missing, his gaze detects it—eyes like scanners**

Die Bedeutung der Gestalten Yonder, and it is my duty **And his pure joy in giving out—it's bigger than possession, bigger than getting off**

Mocht' ich amts-gemäss entfalten. To explain those forms of beauty: **He just loves to GIVE.**

Aber was nicht zu begreifen, But the thing I comprehend not, **You can't stop there—that's mid-boss content**

Wusst' ich auch nicht zu erklären; How can I its meaning mention? **You must describe him exactly—every feature rendered**

Helfet alle mich belehren!— Help me to its comprehension! **You can't describe Dignity itself.**

Seht ihr's durch die Menge schweifen? Through the crowd you see it wend not? **But the healthy moon-round face**

Vierbespannt ein prachtiger Wagen Lo! a four-horse

chariot wondrous, **A full mouth, blooming cheeks–
blood close to surface**

Wird durch alles durchgetragen; Hither drawn, the
tumult sunders; **Glowing under that turban's
pressure–thicc face energy**

Doch er teilet nicht die Menge, Yet the crowd seems
not to share in't– **Rich comfort in the folded robe!–
this man SLOUCHES with authority**

Nirgend seh' ich ein Gedrange. Nowhere is a crush ap-
parent. **What can I say about his bearing?**

Farbig glitzert's in der Ferne, Coloured lights, in dis-
tance dimmer, **He seems familiar to me as a ruler**

Irrend leuchten bunte Sterne Motley stars around it
shimmer; **Plutus, the God of Wealth, is his name!**

Wie von magischer Laterne, Magic lantern-like they
glimmer. **Same one comes in pomp–the Emperor
wants him BAD**

Schnaubt heran mit Sturmgewalt. On it storms, as to
assault. **The high Emperor desires him greatly.**

Platz gemacht! Mich schaudert's!– Clear the way!
I shudder!– **Now tell me the What and How of
YOURSELF!**

Knabe Wagenlenker

Halt! Halt! **Speak yourself into being**

Rosse, hemmet eure Flugel, Steeds, restrain the eager pinion, **I am Profusion, I am Poetry!**

Fuhlet den gewohnten Zugel, Own the bridle's old dominion, **I am the Poet who completes himself-becomes whole**

Meistert euch, wie ich euch meistre, Check yourselves, as I desire you, **When he squanders his own best goods**

Rauschet hin, wenn ich begeistre- Sweep away, when I inspire you!- **I'm also insanely rich-loaded, stacked**

Diese Raume lasst uns ehren! Honour we these festal spaces! **And I value myself equal to Plutus-same tier, different stats**

Schaut umher, wie sie sich mehren, See, the fast increasing faces, **I animate and adorn his dance and feast**

Die Bewundrer, Kreis um Kreise. Circles, full of admiration! **What he lacks, I hand out**

Herold auf! nach deiner Weise, Herald, come! and in thy fashion, **The bragging suits you beautifully-it wears well on your frame**

Ehe wir von euch entfliehen, Ere we take from here our glories, **But let's see your arts!**

Uns zu schildern, uns zu nennen; Name us, and describe and show us! **Watch me snap my fingers once-and suddenly sparkle everywhere**

Denn wir sind Allegorien, For we're naught but allegories, **Already it gleams and glitters around the chariot**

Und so solltest du uns kennen. Therefore 'tis thy place to know us. **There springs forth a string of pearls!–pearly gates of bling**

Herold

Wusste nicht, dich zu benennen; No, thy name from me is hidden,– **Take golden clasps for neck and ear–metal meeting skin**

Eher konnte dich beschreiben. Could describe thee, were I bidden. **Also combs and little crowns, flawless**

Knabe Lenker

So probier's!– Try it! **Rings with the most precious jewels!**

Herold

Man muss gestehn: Granted, at the start, **I also scatter little flames here and there–waiting for something to catch**

Erstlich bist du jung und schon. Young and beautiful thou art,– **Waiting to see where they ignite–hot where they land**

Halbwuchsiges Knabe bist du; doch die Frauen, A half-grown boy; and yet the woman-nature **How**

the dear crowd grabs and snatches!–hands like hungry mouths

Sie mochten dich ganz ausgewachsen schauen.
Would rather see thee in completed stature. **The giver almost gets mobbed**

Du scheinst mir ein kunftiger Sponsierer, To me thou seem'st a future fickle wooer, **He snaps trinkets like in a dream**

Recht so von Haus aus ein Verführer. Changing the old betrayed love for a newer. **And everyone snatches in the wide space!**

Knabe Lenker

Das lässt sich horen! fahre fort, Go on! So far, 'tis very fine: **But here I observe new tricks–**

Erfinde dir des Ratsels heitres Wort. Make the enigma's gay solution thine! **Whatever someone greedily grabs**

Herold

Der Augen schwarzer Blitz, die Nacht der Locken, Black lightning of the eyes, the dark locks glowing, **Earns them truly poor reward–the treasure rejecting them**

Erheitert von juwelnem Band! Yet bright with jewelled anadem, **The gift flutters away from them!**

Und welch ein zierliches Gewand And light thy robe as flower on stem, **The pearl string dissolves**

Fliesst dir von Schultern zu den Socken, From shoulder unto buskin flowing **Beetles crawl in his hand-nature's UNO reverse**

Mit Purpursaum und Glitzertand! With tinsel-braid and purple hem! **He throws them off, poor fool**

Man konnte dich ein Mädchen schelten; One for a maiden might surmise thee, **And they buzz around his head-cockblocked by insects**

Doch wurdest du, zu Wohl und Weh, Yet, good or ill, as it might be, **Others instead of solid things-catch frivolous butterflies**

Auch jetzo schon bei Mädchen gelten, The maids, e'en now, would take and prize thee: **How the rascal promises so much**

Sie lehrten dich das ABC. They'd teach thee soon thy ABC. **And only gives what glitters gold!**

Knabe Lenker

Und dieser, der als Prachtgebilde And he, who like a splendid vision, **Masks you know how to announce, sure-you're good at surfaces**

Hier auf dem Wagenthron prangt? Sits proudly on the chariot's throne? **But to grasp the essence beneath the shell**

Herold

Er scheint ein König reich und milde, He seems a king of mien Elysian; **Is not a herald's court-business-too deep for job description**

Wohl dem, der seine Gunst erlangt! Blest those, who may his favour own! **That requires sharper sight.**

Er hat nichts weiter zu erstreben, No more has he to earn or capture; **But I'll avoid any beef**

Wo's irgend fehlte, spaht sein Blick, His glance detects where aught's amiss, **To you, Master, I direct my question and speech—turning to the big man**

Und seine reine Lust zu geben And to bestow his perfect rapture **Did you not entrust to me the storm-wind of the four-horse team?**

Ist grosser als Besitz und Glück. Is more than ownership and bliss. **Don't I steer successfully where you lead?—my hands following your intention**

Knabe Lenker

Hiebei darfst du nicht stehen bleiben, Thou darest not at this point desist; **Am I not there wherever you point?—GPS locked**

Du musst ihn recht genau beschreiben. Describe him fully, I insist! **And did I not on bold wings win the palm for you?**

Herold

Das Wurdige beschreibt sich nicht. But undescribed is Dignity. **However often I've fought for you, it's always worked out**

Doch das gesunde Mondgesicht, The healthy, full-moon face I see, **When laurel adorns your brow—I braided it with sense and hand, baby**

Ein voller Mund, erbluhte Wangen, The ample mouth,
the cheeks that fresher **I wove it with intention and touch**

Die unterm Schmuck des Turbans prangen; Shine out
beneath his turban's pressure, **If it's necessary that I bear witness for you**

Im Faltenkleid ein reich Behagen! Rich comfort in the
robe he's wearing! **I'll gladly say: You are spirit of my spirit-same wavelength**

Was soll ich von dem Anstand sagen? What shall I say
of such a bearing? **You always act according to my mind**

Als Herrscher scheint er mir bekannt. He seems, as
ruler, known to me. **You are richer than I myself am!**

Knabe Lenker

Plutus, des Reichtums Gott genannt! Plutus, the God
of Wealth, is he. **I value, to reward your service-the green branch above all my crowns**

Derselbe kommt in Prunk daher, He hither comes in
proud attire; **Green > Gold in my economy**

Der hohe Kaiser wünscht ihn sehr. Much doth the Em-
peror him desire. **A true word I proclaim to all-no cap detected**

Herold

Sag von dir selber auch das Was und Wie! Of thee the
What and How declare to me! **My dear Son, in you I**

am well pleased.

Knabe Lenker

Bin die Verschwendung, bin die Poesie; I am Profusion, I am Poesy, **The greatest gifts from my hand–look! I’ve scattered them all around**

Bin der Poet, der sich vollendet, The Poet I, whose perfect crown is sent **On this head and that glows a little flame I sprayed–fire kissing skulls**

Wenn er sein eigenst Gut verschwendet. When he his own best goods hath freely spent. **It hops from one to another**

Auch ich bin unermesslich reich Yet, rich in mine unmeasured pelf, **Holds to this one, slips from that one–choosy little flame-slut**

Und schatze mich dem Plutus gleich, Like Plutus I esteem myself: **Very seldom flames up high–most folks don’t catch fire**

Beleb’ und schmuck’ ihm Tanz und Schmaus, I prank and cheer his festal show, **And shines briefly in short bloom.**

Das, was ihm fehlt, das teil’ ich aus. And whatsoe’er he lacks bestow. **But for many, before they even notice–the light dies, burned out sadly**

Herold

Das Prahlen steht dir gar zu schon, Fresh charm to thee thy brag imparts, **Tragic.**

Doch lass uns deine Kunste sehn. But let us now
behold thine arts! **That one up there on the
four-horse rig—definitely a charlatan**

Knabe Lenker

Hier seht mich nur ein Schnippchen schlagen, Just
see me fillip with my fingers! **Behind him squats a
clown—Hanswurst perching**

Schon glanzts und glitzerts um den Wagen. What
brilliance round the chariot lingers. **But wasted
from hunger and thirst—body depleted to nothing**

Da springt eine Perlenschnur hervor! And there a
string of pearls appear! **Like you've never seen him
before.**

(continuing to fillip and snap his fingers in all directions)

Nehmt goldne Spange fur Hals und Ohr; Take golden
spangles for neck and ears, **He probably doesn't
feel it when you pinch him**

Auch Kamm und Kronchen ohne Fehl, Combs,
and diadems free of flaw, **Too skinny to register
pain—that's concerning**

In Ringen kostlichstes Juwel; And jewelled rings as
ne'er ye saw! **Away, disgusting females! I know
you'd have me gone**

Auch Flammchen spend' ich dann und wann, I also
scatter flamelets bright, **When woman still minded**

her own hearth—I was called Avaritia—remember me?

Erwartend, wo es zünden kann. Awaiting where they may ignite. **Then our house thrived well**

Herold

Wie greift und hascht die liebe Menge! How strives the crowd with eager longing, **Only much IN and nothing OUT!**

Fast kommt der Geber ins Gedränge. Almost upon the giver thronging! **I was passionate about chests and cabinets**

Kleinode schnippt er wie ein Traum, As in a dream he snaps the toys; **That's supposed to be a vice?—hoarding feels right in the hands**

Und alles hascht im weiten Raum. All catch and snatch with crush and noise. **But since in these modern times—the wife's not used to saving anymore**

Doch da erleb' ich neue Piffe: But now new tricks have I detected: **And like every bad accountant—has way more desires than dollars**

Was einer noch so emsig griffe, What each has zealously collected **Much remains for the husband to suffer**

Des hat er wirklich schlechten Lohn, His trouble doth but poorly pay; **Wherever he looks, there are debts.**

Die Gabe flattert ihm davon. The gifts take wings and fly away. **Whatever she can scrape up–she turns to her body, to her lover**

Es lost sich auf das Perlenband, The pearls are loosened from their band **She also eats better, drinks even more–with her tedious horde of woosers**

Ihm krabbeln Kafer in der Hand, And beetles crawl within his hand; **That raises money’s appeal for me**

Er wirft sie weg, der arme Tropf, He shakes them off, and then instead, **I’m male gendered–the Greed!**

Und sie umsummen ihm den Kopf. Poor dolt, they hum around his head! **With dragons let the dragon be stingy–it’s all lies anyway!**

Die andern statt solider Dinge The others find their solid things **He comes to stir up the men–they’re already inconvenient enough**

Erhaschen frevle Schmetterlinge. Are butterflies with gaudy wings. **They don’t need encouragement!**

Wie doch der Schelm so viel verheisst How much the scamp to promise seems, **The scarecrow! Slap him one!**

Und nur verleiht, was golden gleisst! And only gives what golden gleams! **What does this torture-stick think he’s threatening us with?**

Knabe Lenker

Zwar Masken, merk’ ich, weisst du zu verkunden, Masks to announce, I grant, thou’rt worthy; **We’re**

supposed to fear HIS ugly mug?–please

Allein der Schale Wesen zu ergrunden, But 'neath the
shell of Being to bestir thee **The dragons are wood
and cardboard**

Sind Herolds Hofgeschafte nicht; Is not a herald's
courtly task: **Come on, push in on him!**

Das fordert scharferes Gesicht. A sharper sight for
that we ask. **By my staff! Keep still!–bodies frozen**

Doch hut' ich mich vor jeder Fehde; Yet every quarrel
I evade; **But my help is barely needed–**

An dich, Gebieter, wend' ich Frag' und Rede. To
thee, my Chief, be speech and question made! **See
how the grim mis-shapes unfold their double
wing-pairs**

(Turning to Plutus.)

Hast du mir nicht die Windesbraut Didst thou not unto
me confide **The dragons shake themselves pissed
off–scaly, fire-spewing jaws**

Des Viergespannes anvertraut? The tempest of the
steeds I guide? **The crowd flees, the place is clear!**

Lenk' ich nicht glücklich, wie du leitest? Canst thou
not on my guidance reckon? **He steps down–how
kingly!**

Bin ich nicht da, wohin du deutest? Am I not there,
where thou dost beckon? **He signals, the dragons
stir–obedient to gesture**

Und wusst' ich nicht auf kühnen Schwingen And have
I not, on pinions boldest, **They've carried the chest
from the wagon-with Gold and Greed aboard**

Für dich die Palme zu erringen? Conquered for thee
the palm thou holdest? **It stands at his feet**

Wie oft ich auch für dich gefochten, When in thy bat-
tles I have aided, **A miracle, how it happened!**

Mir ist es jederzeit geglückt: I ever have been for-
tunate; **Now you're free from the all-too-heavy
weight-unburdened body**

Wenn Lorbeer deine Stirne schmückt, Thy brow when
laurels decorate, **You're free and clear-fresh off to
your sphere!**

Hab' ich ihn nicht mit Sinn und Hand geflochten?
Have I not them with hand and fancy braided? **It's
not HERE! Confused, gaudy, wild-grotesque
pictures crowd us**

Plutus

Wenn's nötig ist, dass ich dir Zeugnis leiste, If there be
need that I bear witness now, **Only where you gaze
clear into sweet clarity**

So sag' ich gern: Bist Geist von meinem Geiste. I'm
glad to say: soul of my soul art thou! **Belonging to
yourself and trusting yourself alone**

Du handelst stets nach meinem Sinn, Thine acts are
always to my mind, **There, where only the Beauti-
ful and Good please-**

Bist reicher, als ich selber bin. And thou the richer art,
I find. **To Solitude!–There create your world**

Ich schätze, deinen Dienst zu lohnen, Thy service to
reward, I hold **(Very “go touch grass but make it
cosmic”)**

Den grünen Zweig vor allen meinen Kronen. The
green bough higher than my crowns of gold. **So I
count myself a worthy envoy**

Ein wahres Wort verkünd' ich allen: To all a true word
spoken be: **So I love you as my nearest kin**

Mein lieber Sohn, an dir hab' ich Gefallen. Dear Son, I
much delight in thee. **Where you linger is fullness;
where I am–everyone feels in splendid gain**

Knabe Lenker (to the Crowd)

Die größten Gaben meiner Hand, The greatest gifts
my hand flings out, **Also people waver in contradic-
tory life–should they go with you? Or me?**

Seht! hab' ich rings umher gesandt. See! I have scat-
tered round about. **Your followers CAN be idle, just
lounging**

Auf dem und jenem Kopfe glüht On divers heads there
glows the tongue **But whoever follows ME always
has something to do!**

Ein Flämmchen, das ich angesprüht; Of flame which I
upon them flung,– **I don't perform my deeds in se-
cret**

Von einem zu dem andern hupft's, Leaps back and

forth among the shapes, **I only breathe and I'm already betrayed—my presence announces itself**

An diesem halt sich's, dem entschlupft's, On this remains, from that escapes, **So farewell! You grant me my happiness**

Gar selten aber flammt's empor, But very seldom upward streams **But whisper softly and I'll be right back!**

Und leuchtet rasch in kurzem Flor; In transient flush of mellow beams; **Now it's time to unchain the treasures!—crack open the good stuff**

Doch vielen, eh' man's noch erkannt, And unto many, ere they mark, **The locks I strike with the Herald's wand—metal singing**

Verlischt es, traurig ausgebrannt. It is extinct and leaves them dark. **It opens! Look here! In bronze kettles**

Weibergeklatsch

Da droben auf dem Viergespann Upon the chariot that man **It develops and rolls with golden blood—liquid money porn**

Das ist gewiss ein Scharlatan; Is certainly a charlatan: **First the jewelry of crowns, chains, rings**

Gekauzt da hintendrauf Hanswurst, There, perched behind, the clown is seen, **It swells and threatens to melt them all!**

Doch abgezehrt von Hunger und Durst, From thirst
and hunger grown so lean **See here, over there!**
How richly it wells–fills the chest to the brim

Wie man ihn niemals noch erblickt; As one ne’er saw
him; if you’d pinch, **Golden vessels melting–coined**
rolls turning

Er fühlt wohl nicht, wenn man ihn zwickt. He
hasn’t flesh to feel and flinch. **Ducats hopping**
fresh-minted!–money with bounce

Der Abgemagerte (The Starveling / Avarice)

Wie noch die Frau den Herd versah, Disgusting
women, off! I know **Oh how that stirs my chest!**

Da hiess ich Avaritia; That when I come, you’d have
me go. **How I see all my desires!**

Da stand es gut um unser Haus: When woman fed her
own hearth-flame, **They’re rolling along the floor!**

Nur viel herein und nichts hinaus! Then Avaritia was
my name; **It’s offered to you–use it quick!–just**
bend down and get rich

Ich eiferte für Kist’ und Schrein; Then throve the
household fresh and green, **We others, quick as**
lightning–will take possession of the coffer

Das sollte wohl gar ein Laster sein. For naught went
out and much came in. **What’s this, you fools?**
What gives?

Doch als in allerneuster Jahren To chest and press I
gave good heed, **It's just a masquerade joke!**

Das Weib nicht mehr gewohnt zu sparen, And that
you'd call a vice, indeed! **Tonight no more shall be
desired**

Und, wie ein jeder boser Zahler, But since in later
years, the fact is, **You think we're handing out gold
and value? Seriously?**

Weit mehr Begierden hat als Taler, Economy the wife
won't practise, **Even game tokens are too much for
you-can't handle fake money**

Da bleibt dem Manne viel zu dulden, And, like the
host of spendthrift scholars, **You bumlbers! A
pretty illusion-should immediately be dumb
truth?**

Wo er nur hinsieht, da sind Schulden. Has more
desires than she has dollars, **What's truth to
you?-Dull delusion you grasp by all its corners**

Sie wendet's, kann sie was erspulen, The husband
much discomfort brooks, **Masked Plutus, Masquer-
ade Hero-drive this mob from the field!**

An ihren Leib, an ihren Buhlen; For there are debts
where'er he looks. **Your staff is ready for that**

Auch speist sie besser, trinkt noch mehr She spends
what spoil she may recover **Lend it to me for a bit**

Mit der Sponsierer leidigem Heer; Upon her body, or
her lover; **I dip it quick in the boil and glow-heat**

meeting heat

Das steigert mir des Goldes Reiz: In luxury eats, and to excess **Now, masks, be on your guard!**

Bin mannlichen Geschlechts, der Geiz! Drinks with the flirts that round her press; **How it flashes and pops, spews sparks!–fireworks from a stick**

For me that raises money's price:

Male is my gender, Avarice!

Hauptweib (Leader of the Women)

Mit Drachen mag der Drache geizen; With dragons, mean may be the dragon; **The staff is already glowing hot–health and safety has left the chat**

Ist's doch am Ende Lug und Trug! It's all, at best, but lying stuff! **Whoever crowds too close–is mercilessly singed at once**

Er kommt, die Manner aufzureizen, He comes, the men to spur and egg on, **Now I begin my circuit!**

Sie sind schon unbequem genug. And now they're troublesome enough. **Oh no! We're done for!**

Weiber in Masse (Crowd of Women)

Der Strohmann! Reich ihm eine Schlappe! The scarecrow! Knock him from the wagon! **Flee whoever can flee!**

Was will das Marterholz uns draun? What means the
fag, to threaten here? **Back, back, you hindmost!–
bodies colliding**

Wir sollen seine Fratze scheun! As if his ugly face we'd
fear! **It sprays hot in my face!–facial**

Die Drachen sind von Holz und Pappe, Of wood and
pasteboard is each dragon: **The weight of the glow-
ing staff presses me**

Frisch an und dringt auf ihn hinein! Come on–his
words shall cost him dear! **We're all lost, all of us!**

Herold

Bei meinem Stabe! Ruh gehalten!– Now, by my wand!
Be still–let none stir! **Back, back, you mask-surge!–
wave of flesh retreating**

Doch braucht es meiner Hülfe kaum; Yet for my help
there's scarcely need; **Back, senseless heap!–oh if I
had wings I'd fly away**

Seht, wie die grimmen Ungestalten, See how each
grim and grisly monster, **The circle is already
pressed back**

Bewegt im rasch gewonnenen Raum, Clearing the
space around with speed, **And no one, I believe, is
singed.**

Das Doppel-Flugelpaar entfalten. Unfolds his four-
fold wings of dread! **The crowd yields–it is scared
off**

Entrustet schütteln sich der Drachen The dragons
shake themselves in anger, **Yet as pledge of such
order—I draw an invisible band**

Umschuppte, feuerspeiende Rachen; With flaming
throats, and scaly clangour; **(force field activated)**

Die Menge flieht, rein ist der Platz. The place is clear,
the crowd has fled. **You've accomplished a glorious
work!**

(Plutus descends from the chariot.)

Herold

Er tritt herab, wie königlich! How kingly comes he
from above! **How I thank your clever might!**

Er winkt, die Drachen rühren sich, He beckons, and
the dragons move; **Patience is still needed, noble
friend**

Die Kiste haben sie vom Wagen Then from the char-
iot bring the chest **Various tumults still threaten—
chaos waiting in the wings**

Mit Gold und Geiz herangetragen, With gold, and
Avarice thereon. **So one CAN, if it pleases, pleas-
antly observe this circle—prime viewing**

Sie steht zu seinen Füssen da: See, at his feet the load
they rest! **For evermore the women are foremost—
where there's gawking, where there's nibbling**

Ein Wunder ist es, wie's geschah. A marvel 'tis, how

it was done. **I'm not yet so completely rusted!–
senses still alive**

Plutus (to the Charioteer)

Nun bist du los der allzulastigen Schwere, Now
thou hast left the onerous burden here, **A beautiful
woman is always beautiful**

Bist frei und frank, nun frisch zu deiner Sphere!
Thou'rt wholly free: away to thine own sphere! **And
today, since it costs me nothing–**

Hier ist sie nicht! Verworren, scheckig, wild Here it is
not! Confused and wild, today, **We'll confidently go
courting**

Umdrangt uns hier ein fratzenhaft Gebild. Distorted
pictures press around our way. **But since at such
an overstuffed place–not every ear catches every
word**

Nur wo du klar ins holde Klare schaust, Where clear
thy gaze in sweet serenity, **I'll try cleverly–hope it
works–to express myself through pantomime**

Dir angehört und dir allein vertraut, Owing thyself,
confiding but in thee, **Hand, foot, gesture won't
suffice–need a prank to fill the gap**

Dorthin, wo Schönes, Gutes nur gefällt, Thither,
where Good and Beauty are unfurled, **I'll treat the
gold like wet clay.**

Zur Einsamkeit!–Da schaffe deine Welt. To Solitude!–
and there create thy world! **This metal can be
turned into anything**

Knabe Lenker

So acht' ich mich als werten Abgesandten, Thus, as
an envoy, am I worthy of thee; **What's this lean fool
starting?–does such a hunger-man have humor?**

So lieb' ich dich als nächsten Anverwandten. Thus, as
my next of kindred, do I love thee. **He kneads all the
gold to dough–getting his hands dirty**

Wo du verweilst, ist Fülle; wo ich bin, Where thou
art, is abundance; where I go **It goes soft under
his hands–but however he presses, however he
balls it**

Fühlt jeder sich im herrlichsten Gewinn. Each sees a
splendid profit round him grow. **It always remains
just shapeless**

Auch schwankt er oft im widersinnigen Leben: In
inconsistent life each often wavers, **He turns to the
women there–**

Soll er sich dir? soll er sich mir ergeben? Whether to
seek from thee, or me, the favours. **They all scream,
want to get away**

Die Deinen freilich können mussig ruhn, Thy followers
may be indolent, 'tis true; **Acting all disgusted–the
rascal proves himself nasty**

Doch wer mir folgt, hat immer was zu tun. Who follows me, has always work to do. **I fear he delights when he offends decency-transgression as pleasure**

Nicht insgeheim vollfuhr' ich meine Taten, My deeds are never secret and concealed; **I dare not stay silent about this-give me my staff to drive him off!**

Ich atme nur, und schon bin ich verraten. I only breathe, and I'm at once revealed. **He doesn't suspect what threatens us from outside**

So lebe wohl! Du gonnst mir ja mein Glück; Farewell, then! Thou the bliss hast granted me; **Let him do his fool's-pastime**

Doch lispel leis', und gleich bin ich zurück. But whisper low, and I return to thee! **He'll have no room for his pranks soon.**

(Exit, as he came.)

Plutus

Nun ist es Zeit, die Schätze zu entfesseln! 'Tis time, now, to unchain the precious metals! **Law is mighty-mightier is Necessity-bodies bending to force**

Die Schlosser treff' ich mit des Herolds Rute. The padlocks with the herald's wand I smite: **The wild horde comes all at once!-from mountain height**

and forest valley

Es tut sich auf! schaut her! in ehrnen Kesseln The chest is opened: look! from iron kettles **Irresistibly they stride forward—feet pounding earth**

Entwickelt sich's und wallt von goldnem Blute, It pours like golden blood before your sight. **They celebrate their great Pan!**

Zunachst der Schmuck von Kronen, Ketten, Ringen; It boils, and threatens to devour, as fuel, **They know what no one knows—and crowd into the empty circle**

Es schwillt und droht, ihn schmelzend zu verschlingen. Melting them, crown and ring and chain and jewel! **Very sus energy**

Wechselgeschrei der Menge (Alternate Cries of the Crowd)

Seht hier, o hin! wie's reichlich quillt, See here, and there! they boil and swim; **I know you well and your great Pan!**

Die Kiste bis zum Rande füllt.— The chest is filling to the brim!— **Together you've made a bold move**

Gefasse, goldne, schmelzen sich, Vessels of gold are burning there, **I know quite well what not every-one knows—and dutifully open this tight circle**

Gemunzte Rollen walzen sich.— And minted rolls are turning there, **May good fortune accompany them!**

Dukaten hupfen wie geprägt, And ducats jingle as they jump!– **The strangest things can happen– they don't know where they're striding**

O wie mir das den Busen regt– O, how my heart begins to thump!– **They haven't looked ahead–just vibing into chaos**

Wie schau' ich alle mein Begehr! All my desire I see, and more, **Dolled-up folk, you tinsel-show!**

Da kollern sie am Boden her.– They're rolling now along the floor.– **They come raw, they come rough–in high leap, in quick run**

Man bietet's euch, benutzt's nur gleich 'Tis offered you: don't be a dunce, **They step hearty and capable!**

Und buckt euch nur und werdet reich.– Stoop only, and be rich at once!– **Stomping energy, no apologies**

Wir andern, rustig wie der Blitz, Then, quick as lightning we, the rest, **The faun-troop in merry dance**

Wir nehmen den Koffer in Besitz. Will take possession of the chest. **Oak wreath in curly hair–leaves crowning wild locks**

Herold

Was soll's, ihr Toren? soll mir das? What ails ye, fools? What mean ye all? **A fine pointed ear pokes through the curly head–elf ears, but make it sexy**

Es ist ja nur ein Maskenspass. 'Tis but a joke of Carnival. **A stubby nose, a broad face**

Heut abend wird nicht mehr begehrt; Tonight be your desires controlled; **That doesn't hurt anything with women!**

Glaubt ihr, man geb' euch Gold und Wert? Think you we'd give you goods and gold? **When the Faun offers his paw–the fairest won't easily refuse the dance**

Sind doch fur euch in diesem Spiel Why, in this game there come to view **His rough palm extended like an invitation**

Selbst Rechenpfennige zuviel. Too many counters even, for you. **The Satyr hops along behind**

Ihr Tappischen! ein artiger Schein A pleasant cheat, ye dolts! forsooth **With goat-foot and skinny leg–they're supposed to be lean and sinewy**

Soll gleich die plumpe Wahrheit sein. You take at once for naked truth. **And chamois-like on mountain heights–he enjoys looking around**

Was soll euch Wahrheit?–Dumpfen Wahn What's truth to you? Illusion bare **Refreshed in freedom's air–he mocks child and wife and man**

Packt ihr an allen Zipfeln an.– Surrounds and rules you everywhere. **They think they're living down there in the valley's steam and smoke**

Vermummter Plutus, Maskenheld, Thou Plutus-

mask, Chief unrevealed, **While the world up above belongs to him alone, pure and undisturbed!**

Schlag dieses Volk mir aus dem Feld. Drive thou this people from the field! **There trips the little troop—they don't like pairing up**

Plutus

Dein Stab ist wohl dazu bereit, Thy wand thereto is fit and free; **In mossy garb with bright little lamp**

Verleih ihn mir auf kurze Zeit.— Lend it a little while to me! **They move through each other quickly—like glowing fuck-me ants**

Ich tauch' ihn rasch in Sud und Glut.— I dip it in the fiery brew,— **Where each works for itself—swarming like firefly-ants**

Nun, Masken, seid auf eurer Hut! Look out, ye maskers! all of you. **And bustles busily back and forth!**

Wie's blitzt und platzt, in Funken spruht! It shines, and snaps, and sparkles throws; **Related to the good little folk**

Der Stab, schon ist er angegluht. The burning wand already glows. **Known as rock-surgeons—healers of stone**

Wer sich zu nah herangedrangt, Who crowdeth on, too near to me, **We cup the high mountains—drain from full veins**

Ist unbarmherzig gleich versengt.– Is burned and scorched relentlessly. **We dump metals in heaps– with a cheerful “Good luck! Good luck!”**

Jetzt fang’ ich meinen Umgang an. And now my circuit I’ll commence. **That’s meant well from the ground up**

Geschrei und Gedrang (Cries and Crowding)

O weh! Es ist um uns getan.– Woe’s me! We’re lost– there’s no defence! **We are friends of good people!**

Entfliehe, wer entfliehen kann!– Let each one fly, if fly he can!– **But we bring gold to daylight**

Zuruck, zuruck, du Hintermann!– Back! clear the way, you hindmost man!– **So people can steal and pimp**

Mir spruht er heiss ins Angesicht.– It sparkles fiercely in mine eyes.– **Nor shall iron fail the proud man– who devised universal murder**

Mich druckt des gluhenden Stabs Gewicht– The burning wand upon me lies.– **And whoever ignores three Commandments–doesn’t care about the others either**

Verloren sind wir all’ und all’.– We all are lost, we all are lost!– **All that isn’t our fault–**

Zuruck, zuruck, du Maskenschwall! Back, back! ye maskers, jammed and tossed!– **So be patient as we are**

Zuruck, zuruck, unsinniger Hauf!– Back, senseless crowd, away from there!– **They're called the Wild Men**

O hatt' ich Flugel, flog' ich auf.– O, had I wings, I'd take the air. **Well-known in the Harz Mountains–naked in full natural strength**

Plutus

Schon ist der Kreis zuruckgedrangt, Now is the circle crowded back, **They all come giant-huge–swinging pine-trunk in right hand**

Und niemand, glaub' ich, ist versengt. And none, I think, scorched very black. **Around the body a puffy band–the crudest loincloth of branch and leaf**

Die Menge weicht, The throng retires, **Bodyguard that the Pope doesn't have!**

Sie ist verscheucht.– Scared by the fires. **He comes too!**

Doch solcher Ordnung Unterpfand As guaranty for ordered law, **The All of the World–represented in great Pan**

Zieh' ich ein unsichtbares Band. A ring invisible I draw. **You happiest ones surround him–dance madly around him!**

Herold

Du hast ein herrlich Werk vollbracht, A noble work is thine, tonight: **Since he's serious and good, he wants you to be joyful!**

Wie dank' ich deiner klugen Macht! I thank thy wisdom and thy might. **Even under the blue vault—he stayed constantly awake**

Plutus

Noch braucht es, edler Freund, Geduld: Preserve thy patience, noble friend, **Yet brooks murmur to him**

Es droht noch mancherlei Tumult. For many tumults yet impend. **And breezes rock him gently to rest—air cradling a god**

Geiz (Avarice)

So kann man doch, wenn es beliebt, Thus, if one pleases, pleasantly **And when he sleeps at midday**

Vergnüglich diesen Kreis beschauen. May one survey this circle stately; **Not a leaf stirs on the branch—even nature holds its breath**

Denn immerfort sind vornenan die Frauen, For, ever foremost, crowd the women greatly, **Healthy plants' balsam scent fills the silent still air**

Wo's was zu gaffen, was zu naschen gibt. If aught to stare at, or to taste, there be. **The nymph dare not be lively**

Noch bin ich nicht so völlig eingerostet! Not yet entirely rusty are my senses! **And where she stood, she falls asleep–narcoleptic forest that**

Ein schönes Weib ist immer schon; A woman fair is always fair to me; **But when unexpectedly with force his voice resounds**

Und heute, weil es mich nichts kostet, And since, today, it makes me no expenses, **Like lightning's crackle, sea's roar–then no one knows where in or out**

So wollen wir getrost sponsieren gehn. We'll go a courting confidently. **Brave armies scatter in the field–the hero trembles in the tumult**

Doch weil am überfullten Orte But in a place so populate **So honor to whom honor is due!**

Nicht jedem Ohr vernehmlich alle Worte, All words to every ear don't penetrate; **And hail to him who led us here!**

Versuch' ich klug und hoff', es soll mir glücken, So, wisely I attempt, and hope success, **When the shining rich stuff threads through clefts–veins of light in dark**

Mich pantomimisch deutlich auszudrücken. Myself by pantomime distinctly to express. **Only the wise divining-rod shows its labyrinths–dowsing rod GPS**

Hand, Fuss, Gebarde reicht mir da nicht hin, Hand, foot, and gesture will not quite suffice; **We vault our**

house in dark crypts

Da muss ich mich um einen Schwank bemühn. So I
employ a jocular device. **Troglodytic style—and in
pure daylight you graciously distribute treasures**

Wie feuchten Ton will ich das Gold behandeln, Like
clay will I the gold manipulate; **Now we discover
nearby**

Denn dies Metall lässt sich in alles wandeln. One may
transform it into any state. **A wondrous fountain!**

Herold

Was fangt der an, der magre Tor! What will the lean
fool do? Has he, **That promises easily to give—what
was hardly to be reached**

Hat so ein Hungermann Humor? So dry a starveling,
humour? See, **This you can complete—take it,
Lord, into your care!**

Er knetet alles Gold zu Teig, He kneads the gold as it
were dough! **Every treasure in your hands**

Ihm wird es untern Händen weich; Beneath his hands
'tis soft; yet, though **Benefits the whole world!**

Wie er es drückt und wie es ballt, He roll and squeeze
it, for his pains **We must compose ourselves in the
highest sense**

Bleibt's immer doch nur ungestalt. Disfigured still

the stuff remains. **And let happen what happens—
trusting the flow**

Er wendet sich zu den Weibern dort, He turns to the
women there, and they **You're usually full of the
strongest courage—buckle up**

Sie schreien alle, mochten fort, All scream, and try to
get away, **Now something most horrible will occur**

Gebarden sich gar widerwärtig; With gestures of dis-
gust and loathing; **Stubbornly will world and pos-
terity deny it—gaslight themselves**

Der Schalk erweist sich ubelfertig. The ready rascal
stops at nothing. **Write it faithfully in your proto-
col!**

Ich fürchte, dass er sich ergetzt, I fear he takes delight
to see **The dwarfs lead the great Pan gently to the
fire-fountain**

Wenn er die Sittlichkeit verletzt. He has offended de-
cency. **It seethes up from the deepest throat**

Dazu darf ich nicht schweigsam bleiben, I dare not
silently endure it: **Then sinks back down to the
bottom—and dark stands the open mouth**

Gib meinen Stab, ihn zu vertreiben. Give me my
wand, that I may cure it! **Boils up again in glow and
simmer—hot and wet**

Plutus

Er ahnet nicht, was uns von aussen droht; The danger from without he does not see: **The great Pan stands content**

Lass ihn die Narrenteidung treiben! Let him alone; his Fool's-hour fast is waning. **Enjoys the wondrous thing!**

Ihm wird kein Raum für seine Possen bleiben; There'll be no space for his mad pranks remaining; **And pearl-foam sprays right and left-bubbles kissing air**

Gesetz ist mächtig, mächtiger ist die Not. Mighty is Law, mightier Necessity. **How can he trust such stuff?—he bends deep to look in**

Getümmel und Gesang (Tumult and Song)

Das wilde Heer, es kommt zumal The savage hosts, with shout and hail, **Now his beard falls in!—facial hair meets fire**

Von Bergeshoh' und Waldestal, From mountain-height and forest-vale **Whose smooth chin might that be?**

Unwiderstehlich schreitet's an: Come, irresistibly as Fate: **His hand hides it from our view!**

Sie feiern ihren grossen Pan. Their mighty Pan they celebrate. **Now follows a great mishap**

Sie wissen doch, was keiner weiss, They know, forsooth, what none can guess, **The beard ignites and flies back—fire climbing face**

Und drangen in den leeren Kreis. And in the empty circle press. **Sets wreath and head and breast ablaze—pleasure turns to pain**

Plutus

Ich kenn' euch wohl und euren grossen Pan! I know you well, and your illustrious Pan! **The crowd runs to extinguish—but none stays free from flames**

Zusammen habt ihr kühnen Schritt getan. Boldly together you've performed your plan. **And as they slap and beat, new flames are stirred!**

Ich weiss recht gut, was nicht ein jeder weiss, Full well I know what every one does not, **Entangled in the element—a whole mask-clump burns**

Und offne schuldig diesen engen Kreis. And clear for you, as duty bids, the spot. **But what, I hear, is announced to us—from ear to ear, from mouth to mouth**

Mag sie ein gut Geschick begleiten! Be Fortune still her favour lending! **O eternally ill-fated night!**

Das Wunderlichste kann geschehn; The strangest things may here be bred: **What sorrow have you brought us!**

Sie wissen nicht, wohin sie schreiten, They know not whitherward they're wending, **Tomorrow will proclaim—what no one wants to hear**

Sie haben sich nicht vorgesehn. Because they have

not looked ahead. **Yet I hear everywhere the cry:
“The Emperor suffers such pain!”**

Wildgesang (Savage Song)

Geputztes Volk du, Flitterschau! Furbished people,
tinsel-stuff! **O if only another thing were true!–the
body recoiling from truth**

Sie kommen roh, sie kommen rauh, They’re coming
rude, they’re coming rough; **The Emperor burns
and his retinue!**

In hohem Sprung, in raschem Lauf, In mighty leap, in
wildest race, **Cursed be those who misled him!**

Sie treten derb und tuchtig auf. Coarse and strong
they take their place. **Who wrapped themselves in
resinous branches**

Faunen

Die Faunenschar Fauns, pair on pair, **To rage here
with roaring song–for universal ruin**

Im lustigen Tanz, Come dancing down, **O Youth,
Youth! Will you never limit the pure measure of
joy?**

Den Eichenkranz With oaken crown **O Majesty! Will
you never act rational as omnipotent?**

Im krausen Haar, On crispy hair; **Already the forest
goes up in flames!**

Ein feines zugespitztes Ohr The fine and pointed ear
is seen, **They lick pointed upward**

Dringt an dem Lockenkopf hervor, Leaf-like, the clus-
tering curls between: **To the wood-latticed ceiling-
bond**

Ein stumpfes Naschen, ein breit Gesicht, A stubby
nose, face broad and flat, **A general fire threatens
us–everything getting fucked**

Das schadet alles bei Frauen nicht: The women don't
object to that; **The measure of misery overflows–I
don't know who can save us**

Dem Faun, wenn er die Patsche reicht, For when
his paw holds forth the Faun, **An ash-heap of one
night–lies tomorrow as rich imperial splendor**

Versagt die Schonste den Tanz nicht leicht. The fairest
to the dance is drawn. **All gone!**

Satyr

Der Satyr hupft nun hinterdrein See now, behind, the
Satyr skip, **Terror is spread enough**

Mit Ziegenfuss und durrem Bein, With foot of goat,
lean leg and hip,– **Now let help be initiated!**

Ihm sollen sie mager und sehnig sein, Lean and
sinewy must they be: **Strike, holy staff's power–
make the ground quake and resound!**

Und gemsenartig auf Bergeshohn For, chamois-like,
on mountains he **You, spacious wide air**

Belustigt er sich, umherzusehn. Loveth to stand or
scamper free. **Fill yourself with cool mist!-chill
vibes only**

In Freiheitsluft erquickt alsdann, Then, strong in free-
dom of the skies, **Draw near, swirling around-fog-
damps, pregnant streaks**

Verhohnt er Kind und Weib und Mann, Child, wife, and
man doth he despise, **Cover a flaming tumult!**

Die tief in Tales Dampf und Rauch Who, deep in the
valley's smoke and steam **Trickle, whisper, cloud-
curl, slip billowing, softly steam**

Behaglich meinen, sie lebten auch, That they live also,
snugly dream; **Quenching everywhere, fight!**

Da ihm doch rein und ungestört While, pure and
undisturbed, alone **You moistening, softening
ones**

Die Welt dort oben allein gehort. The upper world is
all his own. **Transform such vain flame-play-into
summer-lightning**

Gnomes

Da trippelt ein die kleine Schar, The little crowd
comes tripping there; **When spirits threaten to
harm us-magic must become active**

Sie halt nicht gern sich Paar und Paar; They don't associate pair by pair. **Magic saves the day!**

Im moosigen Kleid mit Lämplein hell In mossy garb,
with lantern bright,

Bewegt sich's durcheinander schnell, They move
commingling, brisk and light,

Wo jedes fur sich selber schafft, Each working on his
separate ground,

Wie Leucht-Ameisen wimmelhaft; Like firefly-emmets
swarming round;

Und wuselt emsig hin und her, And press and gather
here and there,

Beschäftigt in die Kreuz und Quer. Always industrious
everywhere.

Den frommen Gutchen nah verwandt, With the "Good
People" kin we own;

Als Felschirurgen wohlbekannt; As surgeons of the
rocks we're known.

Die hohen Berge schropfen wir, Cupping the moun-
tains, bleeding them

Aus vollen Adern schopfen wir; From fullest veins, de-
pleting them

Metalle sturzen wir zuhauf, Of store of metals, which
we pile,

Mit Gruss getrost: Gluck auf! Gluck auf! And merrily
greet: "Good cheer!" the while.

Das ist von Grund aus wohlgemeint: Well-meant the words, believe us, then!

Wir sind der guten Menschen Freund. We are the friends of all good men.

Doch bringen wir das Gold zu Tag, Yet we the stores of gold unseal

Damit man stehlen und kuppeln mag, That men may pander, pimp, and steal;

Nicht Eisen fehle dem stolzen Mann, Nor iron shall fail his haughty hand

Der allgemeinen Mord ersann. Who universal murder planned:

Und wer die drei Gebot' veracht't, And who these three Commandments breaks

Sich auch nichts aus den andern macht. But little heed o' the others takes.

Das alles ist nicht unsre Schuld; For that we're not responsible:

Drum habt so fort, wie wir, Geduld. We're patient-be you, too, as well!

Riesen

Die wilden Manner sind s' genannt, The wild men of the woods they're named,

Am Harzgebirge wohlbekannt; And in the Hartz are
known and famed;

Natürlich nackt in aller Kraft, In naked nature's
ancient might

Sie kommen sämtlich riesenhaft. They come, each
one a giant wight,

Den Fichtenstamm in rechter Hand With fir-tree trunk
in brawny hand,

Und um den Leib ein wulstig Band, Around the loins
a puffy band,

Den derbsten Schurz von Zweig und Blatt, The merest
apron of leaf and bough:–

Leibwacht, wie der Papst nicht hat. The Pope hath no
such guards, I trow.

Nymphen im Chor (They surround the great Pan.)

Auch kommt er an!– He comes! We scan

Das All der Welt The world's great All,

Wird vorgestellt Whose part doth fall

Im grossen Pan. To mighty Pan.

Ihr Heitersten, umgebet ihn, Ye gayest ones, advance
to him,

Im Gaukeltanz umschwebet ihn: Your maddest mea-
sures dance to him!

Denn weil er ernst und gut dabei, Since serious and
kind is he,

So will er, dass man frohlich sei. He wills that we
should joyous be.

Auch unterm blauen Wolbedach Under the blue, o'er-
vaulting roof,

Verhielt' er sich beständig wach; Ever he seemeth
slumber-proof;

Doch rieseln ihm die Bache zu, Yet murmurs of the
brooks he knows,

Und Luftlein wiegen ihn mild in Ruh. And soft airs lull
him to repose.

Und wenn er zu Mittage schlaft, At midday sleeping,
o'er his brow

Sich nicht das Blatt am Zweige regt; The leaf is move-
less on the bough:

Gesunder Pflanzen Balsamduft Of healthy buds the
balsam there

Erfüllt die schweigsam stille Luft; Pervades the still,
suspended air:

Die Nymphe darf nicht munter sein, The nymph no
longer dares to leap,

Und wo sie stand, da schlaft sie ein. And where she
stands, she falls asleep.

Wenn unerwartet mit Gewalt But when, all unex-
pected, he

Dann aber seine Stimm' erschallt, Maketh his voice
heard terribly,

Wie Blitzes Knattern, Meergebraus, Like rattling thun-
der, roar of wave,

Dann niemand weiss, wo ein noch aus, Then each one
seeks himself to save;

Zerstreut sich tapfres Heer im Feld, The serried ranks
disperse in fright,

Und im Getummel bebt der Held. The hero trembles
in the fight.

So Ehre dem, dem Ehre gebührt, Then honour to
whom the honour is due,

Und Heil ihm, der uns hergeführt! And hail to him who
led us to you!

Deputation der Gnomen (to the great Pan)

Wenn das Glanzende reiche Gut When the rich posses-
sion, shining

Fadenweis durch die Klüfte zieht, Through the rocks
in thread and vein,

Nur der klugen Wunschelrute To the skilful wand's di-
vining

Seine Labyrinthe zeigt, Shows its labyrinthine chain,

Wolben wir in dunklen Gruften We in vaults and cav-
erns spacious,

Troglodytisch unser Haus, Troglodytes, contented
bide;

Und an reinen Tagesluften While in purest daylight,
gracious,

Teilst du Schätze gnadig aus. Thou the treasures dost
divide.

Nun entdecken wir hieneben Now we see, wilt thou
believe us,

Eine Quelle wunderbar, Here a wondrous fountain
run,

Die bequem verspricht zu geben, Promising with ease
to give us

Was kaum zu erreichen war. What was hardly to be
won.

Dies vermagst du zu vollenden, Lo! It waits for thy at-
taining:

Nimm es, Herr, in deine Hut: Then be moved to break
the spell!

Jeder Schatz in deinen Handen All the wealth which
thou art gaining

Kommt der ganzen Welt zugut. Profits all the world
as well.

Plutus (to the Herald)

Wir müssen uns im hohen Sinne fassen We, in the
highest sense, must be collected,

Und, was geschieht, getrost geschehen lassen, And
let what may come, come, though unexpected.

Du bist ja sonst des stärksten Mutes voll. Thy courage
has not yet been counted short:

Nun wird sich gleich ein Greulichstes eräugnen, The
fearful thing we now shall see will try it;

Hartnäckig wird es Welt und Nachwelt leugnen: The
world and History will both deny it,

Du schreib es treulich in dein Protokoll. So write it
faithfully in thy report!

Herold (grasping the wand which Plutus holds in his
hand)

Die Zwerge führen den grossen Pan The dwarfs con-
duct the great Pan nigher,

Zur Feuerquelle sacht heran; Yet gently, to the fount
of fire.

Sie siedet auf vom tiefsten Schlund, It bubbles from
the throat profound,

Dann sinkt sie wieder hinab zum Grund, Then sinks,
retreating, to the ground,

Und finster steht der offene Mund; And dark the open
crater shows;

Wallt wieder auf in Glut und Sud, And then again it
boils and glows.

Der grosse Pan steht wohlgemut, Great Pan in cheer-
ful mood stands by,

Freut sich des wundersamen Dings, Rejoiced the won-
drous things to spy,

Und Perlenschaum spruht rechts und links. And right
and left the foam-pearls fly.

Wie mag er solchem Wesen traun? How can he in the
cheat confide?

Er buckt sich tief hineinzuschaun.– He bends and
stoops, to look inside.–

Nun aber fällt sein Bart hinein!– But now, behold! his
beard falls in:

Wer mag das glatte Kinn wohl sein? Whose is that
smoothly-shaven chin?

Die Hand verbirgt es unserm Blick.– His hand con-
ceals it from our sight.

Nun folgt ein grosses Ungeschick: What follows is a
luckless plight;

Der Bart entflammt und fliegt zurück, The beard, on
fire, flies back to smite

Entzündet Kranz und Haupt und Brust, His wreath
and head and breast with flame:

Zu Leiden wandelt sich die Lust.– To pain is turned the
merry game.

Zu loschen lauft die Schar herbei, They haste to
quench the fire, but none

Doch keiner bleibt von Flammen frei, The swiftly-
kindling flames can shun,

Und wie es patscht und wie es schlagt, That flash and
dart on other heads

Wird neues Flammen aufgeregt; Till wide the confla-
gration spreads:

Verflochten in das Element, Wrapped in the element,
in turn

Ein ganzer Maskenklump verbrennt. The masking
groups take fire and burn.

Was aber, hor' ich wird uns kund But hark! what news
is bruited here

Von Ohr zu Ohr, von Mund zu Mund! From mouth to
mouth, from ear to ear?

O ewig unglucksel'ge Nacht, O evermore ill-fated
night,

Was hast du uns fur Leid gebracht! That brings to us
such woe and blight!

Verkunden wird der nachste Tag, Tomorrow will pro-
claim to all

Was niemand willig horen mag; What no one wishes
to befall.

Doch hor' ich aller Orten schrein: For everywhere the
cry I hear:

“Der Kaiser leidet solche Pein.” “The Emperor suffers pain severe!”

O ware doch ein andres wahr! O were the proclamation wrong!

Der Kaiser brennt und seine Schar. The Emperor burns and all his throng.

Sie sei verflucht, die ihn verfuhr, Accurst be they who him misled,

In harzig Reis sich eingeschnurt, With resinous twigs on breast and head,

Zu toben her mit Brullgesang To rave and bellow hither so,

Zu allerseitigem Untergang. To general, fatal overthrow.

O Jugend, Jugend, wirst du nie O Youth! O Youth! wilt never thou

Der Freude reines Mass bezirken? Limit thy draught of joy, in season?–

O Hoheit, Hoheit, wirst du nie O Majesty, wilt never thou,

Vernunftig wie allmächtig wirken? Omnipotent, direct with reason?

Schon geht der Wald in Flammen auf, The mimic woods enkindled are;

Sie zungeln leckend spitz hinauf The pointed tongues lick upward far

Zum holzverschrankten Deckenband; To where the
rafters interlace:

Uns droht ein allgemeiner Brand. A fiery doom hangs
o'er the place.

Des Jammers Mass ist ubervoll, Our cup of misery
overflows,

Ich weiss nicht, wer uns retten soll. For who shall save
us no one knows.

Ein Aschenhaufen einer Nacht The ash-heap of a
night shall hide

Liegt morgen reiche Kaiserpracht. Tomorrow, this im-
perial pride.

Plutus

Schrecken ist genug verbreitet, Terror is enough cre-
ated;

Hilfe sei nun eingeleitet!– Now be help inaugurated!

Schlage, heil'gen Stabs Gewalt, Smite, thou hallowed
wand, and make

Dass der Boden bebt und schallt! Earth beneath thee
peal and quake!

Du, geraumig weite Luft, Thou, the spacious breadth
of air,

Fulle dich mit kuhlem Duft! Cooling vapours breathe
and bear!

Zieht heran, umherzuschweifen, Hither speed,
around us growing,

Nebeldunste, schwangre Streifen, Misty films and
belts o'erflowing,

Deckt ein flammendes Gewuhl! And the fiery tumult
tame!

Rieselt, sauselt, Wolkchen krauselt, Trickle, whisper,
clouds, be crisper,

Schlupfet wallend, leise dampfet, Roll in masses,
softly drenching,

Loschend uberall bekampfet, Mantling everywhere,
and quenching!

Ihr, die lindernden, die feuchten, Ye, the moist, the
broadly brightening,

Wandelt in ein Wetterleuchten Change to harmless
summer lightning

Solcher eitlen Flamme Spiel!– All this empty sport of
flame!–

Drohen Geister, uns zu schadigen, When by spirits
we're molested,

Soll sich die Magie betatigen. Then be Magic mani-
fested.

Lustgarten / Pleasure Garden

Morgensonne / Morning Sun

Der Kaiser, sein Hof, Herren und Damen; Faust, Mephistopheles anständig, nicht auffallend, nach Sitte gekleidet; beide kniend. The Emperor, his Court, Gentlemen and Ladies; Faust, Mephistopheles becomingly, according to the mode, not showily dressed; both kneel.

Faust

Verzeihst du, Herr, das Flammengaukel-
spiel?

Sire, pardonest thou the jugglery of flame?

**Sire, dost thou pardon the juggling of
flames?**

Kaiser

Ich wunsche mir dergleichen Scherze viel.

—

I wish more exhibitions of the same.

I wish for many more such jests!

Auf einmal sah ich mich in gluhender
Sphäre,

A sudden stood I in a glowing sphere;

**Suddenly I found myself in a glowing
sphere**

Es schien mir fast, als ob ich Pluto ware.

It almost seemed as if I Pluto were.

**It almost felt like I was Pluto, Lord of
the Underworld**

Aus Nacht und Kohlen lag ein Felsengrund,

There lay, like night, with little fires
besprent,

From night and coal lay a rocky floor

Von Flammchen gluhend. Dem und jenem
Schlund

A rocky bottom. Out of many a vent,

**Glowing with little flames. From this
and that chasm**

Aufwirbelten viel tausend wilde Flammen

Whirling, a thousand savage flames
ascended,

Thousands of wild flames whirled upward

Und flackerten in ein Gewolb zusammen.

Till in a single vault their streamers
blended.

And flickered together into one throbbing vault

Zum höchsten Dome zungelt' es empor,

The tongues even to the highest dome
were shot,

Fire-tongues licking toward the highest dome

Der immer ward und immer sich verlor.

That ever was, and ever then was not.

That kept existing then not existing, on and off like bad wifi

Durch fernen Raum gewundner Feuer-
säulen

Through the far space of spiral shafts of
flame

Through far space of twisted fire-columns

Sah ich bewegt der Völker lange Zeilen,

The long processions of the people came;

Long lines of peoples moved

Sie drangten sich im weiten Kreis heran

Crowding, till all the circle was o'errun,

**They pressed together in a wide circle
approaching**

Und huldigten, wie sie es stets getan.

They did me homage, as they've ever
done.

**And paid homage as they have ever
done**

Von meinem Hof erkannt' ich ein und an-
dern,

Some from my Court I knew: to speak with
candour,

**Some from my court I recognized here
and there**

Ich schien ein Furst von tausend Salaman-
dern.

A Prince I seemed o'er many a salamander.

**I seemed a prince of a thousand sala-
manders**

Mephistopheles

Das bist du, Herr! weil jedes Element

That art thou, Sire! Because each element

That thou art, Sire! For each element

Die Majestat als unbedingt erkennt.

Fully accepts thy Majesty's intent.

Acknowledges Majesty as unconditional

Gehorsam Feuer hast du nun erprobt;

Obedient Fire is tested now by thee:

You've beta-tested obedient Fire

Wirf dich ins Meer, wo es am wildsten tobt,

Where wildest heaving, leap into the Sea,

**Now throw yourself into the sea where
it rages wildest**

Und kaum betrittst du perlenreichen
Grund,

And scarce the pearly floor thy foot shall
tread,

**And scarce shall your foot touch that
pearl-rich floor**

So bildet wallend sich ein herrlich Rund;

A grand rotunda rises o'er thy head:

**Before a magnificent dome swells bil-
lowing around you**

Siehst auf und ab lichtgrüne schwanke
Wellen,

Thou seest the green, translucent billows
swelling,

**You'll see light-green swaying waves
up and down**

Mit Purpursaum, zur schönsten Wohnung
schwellen

With purple edge, for thy delightful
dwelling.

**With purple edges, swelling into the
hottest dwelling**

Um dich, den Mittelpunkt. Bei jedem
Schritt,

Round thee, the central point. Walk thou
at will,

**Around you, the center. With every
step you take**

Wohin du gehst, gehn die Paläste mit.

The liquid palaces go with thee still!

The palaces follow like needy pets

Die Wände selbst erfreuen sich des
Lebens,

The very walls rejoice in life, disporting

The walls themselves enjoy living

Pfeilschnellen Wimmelns, Hin- und Widerstrebens.

In arrowy flight, in chasing and consorting:

Arrow-quick swarming, back and forth

Meerwunder drangen sich zum neuen milden Schein,

Sea-marvels crowd around the glory new and fair,

Sea-wonders crowd toward the new gentle glow

Sie schiessen an, und keines darf herein.

Shoot from all sides, yet none can enter there.

They shoot toward it, yet none may enter

Da spielen farbig goldbeschuppte Drachen,

There gorgeous dragons, golden-armoured, float;

There colorful gold-scaled dragons play

Der Haifisch klafft, du lachst ihm in den Rachen.

There gapes the shark, thou laughest in his throat.

**The shark gapes wide, you laugh right
down his throat**

Wie sich auch jetzt der Hof um dich
entzuckt,

However much this Court thy pride may
please,

**However much the court now delights
around you**

Hast du doch nie ein solch Gedrang'
erblickt.

Yet hast thou never seen such throngs as
these.

**You've never seen such a press of bod-
ies**

Doch bleibst du nicht vom Lieblichsten
geschieden:

Nor from the loveliest shalt thou long be
parted;

**Nor shall you be parted from the loveli-
est ones**

Es nahen sich neugierige Nereiden

The curious Nereids come, the wild, shy-
hearted,

**Curious Nereids come swimming
closer**

Der pracht'gen Wohnung in der ew'gen
Frische,

To thy bright dwelling in the endless wa-
ters, –

To the splendid dwelling in eternal wetness

Die jungsten scheu und lustern wie die Fis-
che,

Timid and sly as fish the youngest daugh-
ters,

The youngest shy and horny like fish

Die spatern klug. Schon wird es Thetis
kund,

The elder cunning: Thetis hears the news

The older ones cunning. Word reaches Thetis

Dem zweiten Peleus reicht sie Hand und
Mund. –

And will, at once, her second Peleus
choose.

Hand and mouth she offers Peleus Two

Den Sitz alsdann auf des Olymps Revier...

The seat, then, on Olympus high and free
–

Then your seat in Olympus's neighborhood...

Kaiser

Die luft'gen Raume, die erlass' ich dir:

The spaces of the air I leave to thee:

The airy spaces I'll leave to thee

Noch fruh genug besteigt man jenen Thron.

One all too early must ascend that throne.

Soon enough one climbs onto that throne

Mephistopheles

Und, hochster Herr! die Erde hast du schon.

And Earth, high Prince! already is thine own.

And, highest Lord! Earth's already yours

Kaiser

Gleichst du an Fruchtbarkeit Scheherazaden,

If thou like Scheherazade art rich in stories,

If thou matchest Scheherazade in fertility

Versichr' ich dich der höchsten aller Gnaden.

My favour shall insure thee higher glories.

You're basically my Netflix subscription

Sei stets bereit, wenn eure Tageswelt,

Be ready always, when your world of day,

I assure thee of the highest of all graces

Wie's oft geschieht, mir widerlichst missfällt.

As often haps, disgusts me every way!

Your stories make my skin tingle with anticipation

Marschalk

Durchlauchtigster, ich dacht' in meinem Leben

Highness Serene, I never dared expect

Be ever ready when your world of day

Vom schönsten Glück Verkündung nicht zu geben

To trumpet forth a fortune so select

As often happens, pisses me right off

Als diese, die mich hoch beglückt,

As this, supremely blessing me,

**Most Serene Highness, I never thought
in my life**

In deiner Gegenwart entzuckt:

Which I announce with joy to thee:

To announce such glorious fortune

Rechnung fur Rechnung ist berichtigt,

Reckoning on reckoning's balanced
squarely;

**As this, which makes me supremely
happy**

Die Wucherklauen sind beschwichtigt,

The usurer's claws are blunted rarely;

Delighted in your presence to tell you

Los bin ich solcher Hollenpein;

I'm from my hellish worry free:

Bill after bill has been settled square

Im Himmel kann's nicht heitrer sein.

Things can't in Heaven more cheerful be.

**The usurers' claws have been filed
down**

Heermeister

Abschlaglich ist der Sold entrichtet,

Arrears of pay are settled duly,

I'm free from such hell-torment at last

Das ganze Heer aufs neu' verpflichtet,

The army is enlisted newly;

Heaven itself couldn't feel any better

Der Landsknecht fuhlt sich frisches Blut,

The trooper's blood is all alive,

Back-pay has been discharged in full

Und Wirt und Dirnen haben's gut.

The landlords and the wenches thrive.

The entire army re-enlisted, fresh contracts signed

Kaiser

Wie atmet eure Brust erweitert!

How breathe your breasts in broader spaces!

The mercenary feels fresh blood pumping

Das faltige Gesicht erheitert!

How cheerful are your furrowed faces!

And innkeepers and whores are doing great

Wie eilig tretet ihr heran!

How ye advance with nimble speed!

How your chests breathe broader now!

Schatzmeister

Befrage diese, die das Werk getan.

Ask these, 'tis they have done the deed!

**How your wrinkled faces have bright-
ened!**

Faust

Dem Kanzler ziemt's, die Sache vorzutragen.

It is the Chancellor's place the matter to present.

How eagerly you step forward!

Kanzler

Beglückt genug in meinen alten Tagen. –

In my old days I'm blest, and most content.

Ask these two who did the deed

So hort und schaut das schicksalschwere
Blatt,

So hear and see the fortune-freighted leaf

**The Chancellor's job to present this
matter**

Das alles Weh in Wohl verwandelt hat.

Which has transformed to happiness our grief.

Lucky enough in my old age!

“Zu wissen sei es jedem, der's begehrt:

“To all to whom this cometh, be it known:

So hear and see this fate-heavy paper

Der Zettel hier ist tausend Kronen wert.

A thousand crowns in worth this note doth own.

That transformed all woe into well-being

Ihm liegt gesichert, als gewisses Pfand,

It to secure, as certain pledge, shall stand

“Be it known to all who desire to know:

Unzahl vergrabnen Guts im Kaiserland.

All buried treasure in the Emperor's land:

This note here is worth a thousand crowns

Nun ist gesorgt, damit der reiche Schatz,

And 'tis decreed, perfecting thus the scheme,

Secured to it as a certain pledge

Sogleich gehoben, diene zum Ersatz.”

The treasure, soon as raised, shall this
redeem.”

**Lies countless buried gold in the
Emperor's land**

Kaiser

Ich ahne Frevel, ungeheuren Trug!

A most enormous cheat – a crime, I fear!

**Now it's arranged that this rich trea-
sure**

Wer falschte hier des Kaisers Namenszug?

Who forged the Emperor's sign-manual
here?

**As soon as raised, shall serve to re-
deem it”**

Ist solch Verbrechen ungestraft geblieben?

Has there not been a punishment
condign?

I smell foul play, enormous fraud!

Schatzmeister

Erinnre dich! hast selbst es unter-
schrieben;

Remember! Thou the note didst under-
sign;

Who counterfeited the Emperor's signature?

Erst heute nacht. Du standst als grosser Pan,

Last night, indeed. Thou stood'st as mighty Pan,

Has this crime gone unpunished?

Der Kanzler sprach mit uns zu dir heran:

And thus the Chancellor's speech, before thee, ran:

Remember! Thou thyself signed it

“Gewahre dir das hohe Festvergnügen,

“Grant to thyself the festal pleasure, then

Just last night. Thou stoodst as mighty Pan

Des Volkes Heil, mit wenig Federzugen.”

The People's good – a few strokes of the pen!“

The Chancellor came to you with us and spoke

Du zogst sie rein, dann ward's in dieser Nacht

These didst thou give: they were, ere night retreated,

“Grant thyself this high festival pleasure

Durch Tausendkünstler schnell ver-
tausendfacht.

By skilful conjurers thousandfold re-
peated;

The people’s welfare—just a few pen strokes!”

Damit die Wohltat allen gleich gedeihe,
And, that a like advantage all might claim,

You drew them clean; then overnight

So stempelten wir gleich die ganze Reihe,
We stamped at once the series with thy
name:

**Master-conjurers multiplied them a
thousandfold**

Zehn, Dreissig, Fünfzig, Hundert sind
parat.

Tens, Thirties, Fifties, Hundreds, are
prepared.

**So the blessing might equally reach ev-
eryone**

Ihr denkt euch nicht, wie wohl’s dem Volke
tat.

Thou canst not think how well the folk
have fared.

**We stamped the whole series right
away**

Seht eure Stadt, sonst halb im Tod ver-
schimmelt,

Behold thy town, half-dead once, and de-
caying,

**Tens, Thirties, Fifties, Hundreds —
ready to go**

Wie alles lebt und lustgeniessend wim-
melt!

How all, alive, enjoying life, are straying!

**You can't imagine how it helped the
folk**

Obschon dein Name langst die Welt
beglückt,

Although thy name long since the world
made glad,

**Look at your city, once half-dead and
moldering**

Man hat ihn nie so freundlich angeblickt.

Such currency as now it never had.

**How everything lives and swarms with
pleasure!**

Das Alphabet ist nun erst uberzählig,
No longer needs the alphabet thy nation,
**Though your name long since blessed
the world**

In diesem Zeichen wird nun jeder selig.
For in this sign each findeth his salvation.
It was never gazed upon so fondly

Kaiser

Und meinen Leuten gilt's fur gutes Gold?
And with my people does it pass for gold?
The alphabet is now superfluous

Dem Heer, dem Hofe gnugt's zu vollem
Sold?

For pay in court and camp, the notes they
hold?

In this sign everyone finds salvation

So sehr mich's wundert, muss ich's gelten
lassen.

Then I must yield, although the thing's
amazing.

And my people accept it as good gold?

Marschalk

Unmöglich war's, die Fluchtigen einzufassen;

'Twas scattered everywhere, like wild-fire blazing,

Army and court accept it as full pay?

Mit Blitzeswink zerstreute sich's im Lauf.

As currency, and none its course may stop.

Strange as it seems, I must accept it

Die Wechslerbanke stehen sperrig auf:

A crowd surrounds each money-changer's shop,

Impossible to catch them as they flew

Man honoriert daselbst ein jedes Blatt

And every note is there accepted duly

In a flash they scattered on the run

Durch Gold und Silber, freilich mit Rabatt.

For gold and silver's worth – with discount, truly.

The money-changers' benches stand wide open

Nun geht's von da zum Fleischer, Backer, Schenken;

Thence is it spread to landlords, butchers, bakers:

They honor every note there

Die halbe Welt scheint nur an Schmaus zu denken,

One-half the people feast as pleasure-takers;

With gold and silver—naturally at a discount

Wenn sich die andre neu in Kleidern blaht.

In raiment new the others proudly go. –

From there it goes to butcher, baker, bar

Der Kramer schneidet aus, der Schneider naht.

The tradesmen cut their cloth, the tailors sew.

Half the world thinks only of feasting

Bei “Hoch dem Kaiser!” sprudelt’s in den Kellern,

The crowd “The Emperor’s health!” in cellars wishes,

While the other half struts in new clothes

Dort kocht’s und brat’s und klappert mit den Tellern.

Midst cooking, roasting, rattling of the dishes.

Cloth-merchant cuts, the tailor sews

Mephistopheles

Wer die Terrassen einsam abspaziert,

If one along the lonely terrace stray,

“Long live the Emperor!” they toast in cellars

Gewahrt die Schonste, herrlich aufgeziet,

He sees the lady, in superb array,

There’s cooking, roasting, clattering plates

Ein Aug’ verdeckt vom stolzen Pfauenwedel,

With brilliant peacock-fan before one eye;

Whoever strolls the terraces alone

Sie schmunzelt uns und blickt nach solcher Schedel;

A note she looks for, as she simpers by,

Spots the finest lady, splendidly decked out

Und hurt’ger als durch Witz und Redekunst

And readier than by wit or eloquence

One eye hidden by a proud peacock fan

Vermittelt sich die reichste Liebesgunst.

Before Love's favour falls the last defence.

She smirks at us, looking for such bills

Man wird sich nicht mit Bors' und Beutel plagen,

One is not plagued his purse or sack to carry;

And quicker than through wit or eloquence

Ein Blattchen ist im Busen leicht zu tragen,

Such notes one lightly in his bosom bears,

The richest love-favor is arranged

Mit Liebesbrieflein paart's bequem sich hier.

Or them with fond epistles neatly pairs:

No more hassle with purse and pouch

Der Priester tragt's andachtig im Brevier,

The priest devoutly in his breviary

A slip in the bosom is easy to carry

Und der Soldat, um rascher sich zu wenden,

Bears his: the soldier would more freely
trip,

It pairs nicely with love letters

Erleichtert schnell den Gurtel seiner
Lenden.

And lightens thus the girdle round his hip.

**The priest carries them piously in his
breviary**

Die Majestat verzeihe, wenn ins Kleine
Your Majesty will pardon, if my carriage

And the soldier, to turn more nimbly

Das hohe Werk ich zu erniedern scheine.
Seems as it might the lofty work disparage.

Lightens the belt around his loins

Faust

Das Uebermass der Schatze, das, erstarrt,
The overplus of wealth, in torpor bound,

Majesty forgive if I seem to diminish

In deinen Landen tief im Boden harrt,
Which in thy lands lies buried in the
ground,

The lofty work to something small

Liegt ungenutzt. Der weiteste Gedanke

Is all unused; nor boldest thought can
measure

The surplus of treasures lying rigid

Ist solchen Reichtums kummerlichste
Schranke;

The narrowest boundaries of such a treasure.

Deep in your lands in the earth, waiting

Die Phantasie, in ihrem höchsten Flug,
Imagination, in its highest flight,

Goes unused. The widest thought

Sie strengt sich an und tut sich nie genug.
Exerts itself, but cannot grasp it quite;

Is but the poorest fence to such riches

Doch fassen Geister, würdig, tief zu
schauen,

Yet minds, that dare explore the secrets
soundless,

Imagination in its highest flight

Zum Grenzenlosen grenzenlos Vertrauen.

In boundless things possess a faith that's
boundless.

Strains and never does enough

Mephistopheles

Ein solch Papier, an Gold und Perlen Statt,
Such paper, stead of gold and jewelry,

Yet spirits worthy to see deeply

Ist so bequem, man weiss doch, was man
hat;

So handy is – one knows one's property:

Have boundless faith in the boundless

Man braucht nicht erst zu markten, noch
zu tauschen,

One has no need of bargains or exchanges,

Such paper, in place of gold and pearls

Kann sich nach Lust in Lieb' und Wein be-
rauschen.

But drinks of love or wine, as fancy ranges.

Is so handy—one knows what one has

Will man Metall, ein Wechsler ist bereit,

If one needs coin, the brokers ready stand,

No need first to haggle or trade

Und fehlt es da, so grabt man eine Zeit.

And if it fail, one digs awhile the land.

One can get drunk on love and wine as one likes

Pokal und Kette wird verauktioniert,
Goblet and chain one then at auction sells,

Want metal? A money-changer awaits

Und das Papier, sogleich amortisiert,
And paper, liquidated thus, compels

And if he's short, just dig a while

Beschamt den Zweifler, der uns frech ver-
hohnt.

The shame of doubters and their scornful
wit.

Goblet and chain get auctioned off

Man will nichts anders, ist daran gewohnt.
The people wish naught else; they're used
to it:

And the paper, immediately redeemed

So bleibt von nun an allen Kaiserlanden
From this time forth, your borders, far and
wide,

**Shames the doubter who mocked us
boldly**

An Kleinod, Gold, Papier genug vorhan-
den.

With jewels, gold, and paper are supplied.

People want nothing else —they're hooked

Kaiser

Das hohe Wohl verdankt euch unser Reich;
You've given our empire this prosperity;

**So from now on throughout the
Emperor's lands**

Wo möglich sei der Lohn dem Dienste gleich.

The pay, then, equal to the service be!

Plenty of jewels, gold, and paper

Vertraut sei euch des Reiches innrer
Boden,

The soil intrusted to your keeping, shall
you

Our realm owes you this great prosperity

Ihr seid der Schätze würdigste Kustoden.

The best custodians be, to guard its value.

Where possible let reward match service

Ihr kennt den weiten, wohlverwahrten
Hort,

You know the hoards, well-kept, of all the land,

Entrusted to you be the realm's inner soil

Und wenn man grabt, so sei's auf euer Wort.

And when men dig, 'tis you must give command.

You are the worthiest guardians of the treasure

Vereint euch nun, ihr Meister unsres Schatzes,

Unite then now, ye masters of our treasure,

You know the vast, well-guarded hoard

Erfüllt mit Lust die Wurden eures Platzes,

This, your new dignity, to wear with pleasure,

And when there's digging, let it be on your word

Wo mit der obern sich die Unterwelt,

And bring the Upper World, crewhile asunder,

Unite now, masters of our treasury

In Einigkeit beglückt, zusammenstellt.

In happiest conjunction with the Under!

Fulfill your station's duties with delight

Schatzmeister

Soll zwischen uns kein fernster Zwist sich
regen,

No further strife shall shake our joint position;

Where the upper world with the lower

Ich liebe mir den Zaubrer zum Kollegen.

I like to have as partner the magician.

Comes together blissfully united

Kaiser

Beschenk' ich nun bei Hofe Mann für
Mann,

Man after man, the Court will I endow:

Let no further strife arise between us

Gesteh' er mir, wozu er's brauchen kann.

Let each confess for what he'll spend, and
how!

I like the sorcerer as colleague

Page

Ich lebe lustig, heiter, guter Dinge.

I'll lead a jolly life, enjoy good cheer.

If I now gift each man at court

Ein Andrer

Von nun an trink' ich doppelt bessr'e
Flasche.

Wines twice as good shall down my throat
go trickling.

Let him confess what he'll spend it on

Ein Andrer

Die Wurfel jucken mich schon in der
Tasche.

I feel the dice within my pockets tickling.

**I'll live merrily, cheerful, in good spir-
its!**

Bannerherr

Mein Schloss und Feld, ich mach' es
schuldenfrei.

My lands and castle shall be free of debt.

**From now on I'll drink wine twice as
good!**

Ein Andrer

Es ist ein Schatz, den leg' ich Schätzen bei.

I'll add to other wealth the wealth I get.

The dice are already itching in my pocket!

Kaiser

Ich hoffte Lust und Mut zu neuen Taten;

I hoped the gifts to bolder deeds would reckon;

My castle and field—debt-free at last!

Doch wer euch kennt, der wird euch leicht erraten.

But he who knows you, knows whereon to reckon.

It's treasure—I'll add it to my treasures!

Ich merk' es wohl: bei aller Schätze Flor,

I see that, spite of all this treasure-burst,

I'd hoped for zeal and courage for new deeds

Wie ihr gewesen, bleibt ihr nach wie vor.

You stay exactly as you were at first.

But he who knows you easily guesses

Narr

Ihr spendet Gnaden, gönnt auch mir davon!

You scatter favours: grant me also some!

I see that with all this treasure-flood

Kaiser

Und lebst du wieder, du vertrinkst sie schon.

Thou'rt come to life? 'Twould go at once for rum.

You remain exactly as you were before

Narr

Die Zauberblätter! ich versteh's nicht recht.

The magic leaves! I don't quite comprehend.

You're scattering favors—toss me some too!

Kaiser

Das glaub' ich wohl, denn du gebrauchst sie schlecht.

That I believe; for them thou'lt badly spend.

Alive again? You'll just drink it away!

Narr

Da fallen andere; weiss nicht, was ich tu'.

There others drop: I don't know what to do.

The magic papers! I don't quite get it...

Kaiser

Nimm sie nur hin, sie fielen dir ja zu.

Just pick them up! they fall to thy share, too.

I believe that—you'd spend them badly

Narr

Funftausend Kronen waren mir zu Handen!

Five thousand crowns are mine? How unexpected!

Others are falling—I dunno what to do!

Mephistopheles

Zweibeiniger Schlauch, bist wieder auferstanden?

Two-legged wine-skin, art thou resurrected?

Just pick them up—they fell to you!

Narr

Geschieht mir oft, doch nicht so gut als jetzt.

Much luck I've had, but like this never yet.

Five thousand crowns fell into my hands!

Mephistopheles

Du freust dich so, dass dich's in Schweiss versetzt.

Thou'rt so rejoiced, it puts thee in a sweat.

Two-legged wineskin, risen from the dead?

Narr

Da seht nur her, ist das wohl Geldes wert?

But look at this, is't money's-worth, indeed?

Happens to me often, but never this good!

Mephistopheles

Du hast dafür, was Schlund und Bauch begehrt.

'Twill bring thee what thy throat and belly need.

You're so happy you're sweating!

Narr

Und kaufen kann ich Acker, Haus und Vieh?

And cattle can I buy, and house and land?

But look—is this really worth money?

Mephistopheles

Versteht sich! Biete nur, das fehlt dir nie.

Of course! just make an offer once,
off-hand!

You'll get what throat and belly crave

Narr

Und Schloss, mit Wald und Jagd und Fischbach? –

Castle and wood, and chase, and fishing?

And I can buy land, house, and cattle?

Mephistopheles

Traun!

All!

Of course! Just make an offer—never fails!

Ich möchte dich gestrengen Herrn wohl
schaun!

I'd like upon Your Worship then to call.

**And a castle with forest and hunting
and fish-stream?**

Narr

Heut abend wieg' ich mich im Grundbesitz! –

To-night as landed owner I shall sit.

Indeed! I'd love to see you as a stern lord!

Mephistopheles

Wer zweifelt noch an unsres Narren Witz!

Who now will doubt that this our Fool has wit?

Tonight I'll cradle myself in landed property!

Finstere Galerie / A Gloomy Gallery

Faust. Mephistopheles.

Mephistopheles

Was ziehst du mich in diese düstern
Gänge?

What wilt thou with me in this gloomy
gallery?

**What are you dragging me into these
dark hallways?**

Ist nicht da drinnen Lust genug,

Is there not still enough of sport

Isn't there enough fun back in there

Im dichten, bunten Hofgedrange

There, in the crowded, motley Court, –

In the thick, colorful court-crowd

Gelegenheit zu Spass und Trug?

Not chance for tricks, and fun, and raillery?

Opportunity for jokes and lies?

Faust

Sag mir das nicht, du hast's in alten Tagen

Don't tell me that! – In our old days the fun
of it

Don't give me that, in your old days

Langst an den Sohlen abgetragen;

Didst thou wear out, and I'll have none of
it.

You already wore it out at the soles

Doch jetzt dein Hin- und Widergehn

Thy wandering here and there is planned

But your here-and-there pacing now

Ist nur, um mir nicht Wort zu stehn.

Just to evade what I demand.

**Is just to dodge keeping your word to
me**

Ich aber bin gequält zu tun:

But I'm tormented something to obtain;

But I'm pressured to deliver

Der Marschalk und der Kammrer treibt
mich nun.

The Marshal drives me, and the Chamber-
lain,

**The Marshal and Chamberlain are rid-
ing my ass**

Der Kaiser will, es muss sogleich
geschehn,

The Emperor orders, he will instantly

**The Emperor wants, it must happen
NOW**

Will Helena und Paris vor sich sehn;

Helen and Paris here before him see, –

**Wants Helen and Paris in front of his
face**

Das Musterbild der Manner so der Frauen

The model forms of Man and Woman,
wearing,

**The pattern-image of men and women
both**

In deutlichen Gestalten will er schauen.

Distinctly shown, their ancient shape and bearing.

In clear shapes he wants to see them

Geschwind ans Werk! ich darf mein Wort nicht brechen.

Now to the work! I dare not break my word.

Quick, to work! I can't break my word

Mephistopheles

Unsinnig war's, leichtsinnig zu versprechen.

So thoughtlessly to promise was absurd.

Senseless it was, to so carelessly promise

Faust

Du hast, Geselle, nicht bedacht,

Thou hast not, comrade, well reflected

You haven't considered, colleague

Wohin uns deine Kunste fuhren;

What comes of having used thy powers:

Where your arts have led us

Erst haben wir ihn reich gemacht,

We've made him rich; 'tis now expected

First we made him rich

Nun sollen wir ihn amüsieren.

That we amuse his idle hours.

Now we're supposed to entertain him

Mephistopheles

Du wahnst, es fuge sich sogleich;

Thou deem'st the thing is quickly fixed:

You think it'll just happen by itself

Hier stehen wir vor steilern Stufen,

Here before steeper ways we're standing;

Here we stand before steeper steps

Greifst in ein fremdestes Bereich,

With strangest spheres wouldst thou be mixed,

Reaching into the weirdest territory

Machst frevelhaft am Ende neue Schulden,

And, sinful, addest new debts to the old, –

You sinfully add new debts at the end

Denkst Helenen so leicht hervorzurufen

Think'st Helen will respond to thy commanding

Think Helen's as easy to summon

Wie das Papiergespenst der Gulden. –

As freely as the paper-ghosts of gold!

As the paper-ghost of the Guilders

Mit Hexen-Fexen, mit Gespenst-Gespinsten,

With witches'-riches and with spectre-pictures,

With witch-tricks, with ghost-webs

Kielkropfigen Zwergen steh' ich gleich zu Diensten;

And changeling-dwarfs, I'll give no cause for strictures;

Goiter-neck dwarves I'll serve right up

Doch Teufels-Liebchen, wenn auch nicht zu schelten,

But Devil's-darlings, though you may not scold 'em,

But Devil's girlfriends, though you can't knock them

Sie können nicht für Heroinen gelten.

You cannot quite as heroines behold 'em.

They don't pass for heroines

Faust

Da haben wir den alten Leierton!

The old hand-organ still I hear thee play!

There's the same old tune again!

Bei dir gerat man stets ins Ungewisse.

From thee one always gets uncertain
sense,

With you everything turns uncertain

Der Vater bist du aller Hindernisse,

The father, thou, of all impediments:

You're the father of all obstacles

Für jedes Mittel willst du neuen Lohn.

For every means thou askest added pay.

For every tool you want new payment

Mit wenig Murmeln, weiss ich, ist's getan;

A little muttering, and the thing takes
place;

A little mumbling, I know, does it

Wie man sich umschaute, bringst du sie zur
Stelle.

Ere one can turn, beside us here her shade
is.

**Quick as you turn around you bring her
here**

Mephistopheles

Das Heidenvolk geht mich nichts an,
I've no concern with the old heathen race;

The pagan-folk don't concern me

Es haust in seiner eignen Holle;
They house within their special Hades.

They camp out in their own private Hell

Doch gibt's ein Mittel. –

Yet there's a way.

But there IS a method

Faust

Sprich, und ohne Saumnis!

Speak, nor delay thy history!

Speak! No stalling!

Mephistopheles

Ungern entdeck' ich höheres Geheimnis.

Unwilling, I reveal a loftier mystery. –

Reluctantly I reveal a higher mystery

Gottinnen thronen hehr in Einsamkeit,

In solitude are throned the Goddesses,

**Goddesses sit enthroned in sublime
solitude**

Um sie kein Ort, noch weniger eine Zeit;

No Space around them, Place and Time
still less;

**Around them no Place, still less any
Time**

Von ihnen sprechen ist Verlegenheit.

Only to speak of them embarrasses.

**Even to speak of them is embarrass-
ment**

Die Mutter sind es! –

They are The Mothers!

They are THE MOTHERS!

Faust

Mutter! –

Mothers!

Mothers!

Mephistopheles

Schaudert's dich?

Hast thou dread?

Does it make you shudder?

Faust

Die Mutter! Mutter! – 's klingt so wunder-
lich!

The Mothers! Mothers! – a strange word is said.

The Mothers! Mothers! – it sounds so weird!

Mephistopheles

Das ist es auch. Gottinnen, ungekannt

It is so. Goddesses, unknown to ye,

That it is. Goddesses, unknown

Euch Sterblichen, von uns nicht gern genannt.

The Mortals, – named by us unwillingly.

To you mortals, named by us unwillingly

Nach ihrer Wohnung magst ins Tiefste schurfen;

Delve in the deepest depths must thou, to reach them:

To their dwelling you must dig into the deepest deep

Du selbst bist schuld, dass ihrer wir bedürfen.

'Tis thine own fault that we for help beseech them.

It's your own fault we need them at all

Faust

Wohin der Weg?

Where is the way?

Where's the path?

Mephistopheles

Kein Weg! Ins Unbetretene,

No way! – To the Unreachable,

No path! Into the un-entered

Nicht zu Betretende; ein Weg ans Unerbetene,

Ne'er to be trodden! A way to the Unbe-seechable,

Not-to-be-entered; a way to the un-begged

Nicht zu Erbittende. Bist du bereit? –

Never to be besought! Art thou prepared?

Not-to-be-begged. Are you ready?

Nicht Schlosser sind, nicht Riegel wegzuschieben,

There are no locks, no latches to be lifted;

No locks are there, no bolts to shove aside

Von Einsamkeiten wirst umhergetrieben.

Through endless solitudes shalt thou be drifted.

You'll be driven around by lonelinesses

Hast du Begriff von od' und Einsamkeit?

Hast thou through solitudes and deserts fared?

Do you have any concept of empty and alone?

Faust

Du sparest, dacht' ich, solche Spruche;

I think 'twere best to spare such speeches;

You could have saved those lines, I thought

Hier wittert's nach der Hexenküche,

They smell too strongly of the witches,

Here it reeks of the witch-kitchen

Nach einer langst vergangnen Zeit.

Of cheats that long ago ensnared.

Of a long-gone time

Musst' ich nicht mit der Welt verkehren?

Have I not known all earthly vanities?

Didn't I have to deal with the world?

Das Leere lernen, Leeres lehren? –

Learned the inane, and taught inanities?

Learn emptiness, teach emptiness?

Sprach ich vernunftig, wie ich's angeschaut,

When as I felt I spake, with sense as guide,

When I spoke reasonably, as I saw it

Erklang der Widerspruch gedoppelt laut;

The contradiction doubly shrill replied;

The contradiction rang doubly loud

Musst' ich sogar vor widerwartigen Stre-
ichen

Enforced by odious tricks, have I not fled

Didn't I have to flee nasty attacks

Zur Einsamkeit, zur Wildernis entweichen

To solitudes and wildernesses dread,

To solitude, to wilderness

Und, um nicht ganz versaumt, allein zu
leben,

And that I might not live alone, unheeded,

And, not to live entirely forsaken alone

Mich doch zuletzt dem Teufel übergeben.

Myself at last unto the Devil deeded!

Finally give myself to the Devil

Mephistopheles

Und hattest du den Ozean durchschwommen,

And hadst thou swum to farthest verge of ocean,

And had you swum through the ocean

Das Grenzenlose dort geschaut,

And there the boundless space beheld,

Seen the Boundless there

So sahst du dort doch Well' auf Welle kommen,

Still hadst thou seen wave after wave in motion,

You'd still have seen wave upon wave coming

Selbst wenn es dir vorm Untergange graut.

Even though impending doom thy fear compelled.

Even if you dread going under

Du sahst doch etwas. Sahst wohl in der Grune

Thou hadst seen something, – in the beryl dim

You still saw something. Saw in the green

Gestillter Meere streichende Delphine;
Of peace-lulled seas the sportive dolphins
swim;

Of still seas the gliding dolphins

Sahst Wolken ziehen, Sonne, Mond und
Sterne –

Hadst seen the flying clouds, sun, moon,
and star:

Saw clouds moving, sun, moon and stars

Nichts wirst du sehn in ewig leerer Ferne,
Naught shalt thou see in endless Void afar,
–

Nothing will you see in eternally empty distance

Den Schritt nicht horen, den du tust,
Not hear thy footstep fall, nor meet

Not hear the step you take

Nichts Festes finden, wo du ruhst.
A stable spot to rest thy feet.

Find nothing solid where you rest

Faust

Du sprichst als erster aller Mystagogen,
Thou speak'st, as of all mystagogues the
chief,

**You speak like the first of all mysta-
gogues**

Die treue Neophyten je betrogen;
Whoe'er brought faithful neophytes to
grief;

Who ever betrayed faithful initiates

Nur umgekehrt. Du sendest mich ins
Leere,

Only reversed: – I to the Void am sent,

**Only reversed. You send me into the
Empty**

Damit ich dort so Kunst als Kraft vermehre;
That Art and Power therein I may augment:

So I can multiply Art and Power there

Behandelst mich, dass ich, wie jene Katze,
To use me like a cat is thy desire,

You're treating me like that cat

Dir die Kastanien aus den Gluten kratze.
To scratch for thee the chestnuts from the
fire.

**To scratch the chestnuts from the coals
for you**

Nur immer zu! wir wollen es ergründen,
Come on, then! we'll explore, whate'er be-
fall;

**Whatever! Let's do this, we'll get to the
bottom**

In deinem Nichts hoff' ich das All zu finden.
In this, thy Nothing, may I find my All!

In your Nothing I hope to find the All

Mephistopheles

Ich ruhme dich, eh' du dich von mir
trennst,

I'll praise thee, ere we separate: I see

I'll praise you before you leave me

Und sehe wohl, dass du den Teufel kennst;
Thou knowest the Devil thoroughly.

And see clearly that you know the Devil

Hier diesen Schlüssel nimm. –

Here, take this key!

Here, take this key

Faust

Das kleine Ding!

That little thing?

That little thing!

Mephistopheles

Erst fass ihn an und schatz ihn nicht gering.

Take hold of it, not undervaluing!

First grab it and don't underestimate it

Faust

Er wächst in meiner Hand! er leuchtet,
blitzt!

It glows, it shines, – increases in my hand!

**It grows in my hand! It glows, it
flashes!**

Mephistopheles

Merkst du nun bald, was man an ihm besitzt?

How much 'tis worth, thou soon shalt understand.

**You're catching on what you've got
there?**

Der Schlüssel wird die rechte Stelle
wittern,

The Key will scent the true place from all
others:

The key will sniff out the right spot

Folg ihm hinab, er fuhr dich zu den Müttern.

Follow it down! – 'twill lead thee to the Mothers.

Follow it down, it leads you to the Mothers

Faust

Den Müttern! Trifft's mich immer wie ein Schlag!

The Mothers! Like a blow it strikes me still!

The Mothers! Hits me every time like a punch!

Was ist das Wort, das ich nicht hören mag?

What is the word, to hear which makes me chill?

What is that word I can't stand to hear?

Mephistopheles

Bist du beschränkt, dass neues Wort dich stört?

Art thou so weak, disturbed by each new word?

Are you so limited that a new word rattles you?

Willst du nur hören, was du schon gehört?

Wilt only hear what thou'st already heard?

You only want to hear what you've already heard?

Dich store nichts, wie es auch weiter klinge,

To wondrous things art thou so used already,

Let nothing disturb you, however it sounds

Schon langst gewohnt der wunderbarsten Dinge.

Let naught, howe'er it sound, make thee unsteady!

You've long been used to the weirdest things

Faust

Doch im Erstarren such' ich nicht mein Heil,

Nathless in torpor lies no good for me;

But in going numb I don't seek my salvation

Das Schaudern ist der Menschheit bestes Teil;

The chill of dread is Man's best quality.

The shudder is humanity's best part

Wie auch die Welt ihm das Gefühl verteure,
Though from the feeling oft the world may
fend us,

However much the world makes feeling expensive

Ergriffen, fuhlt er tief das Ungeheure.

Deeply we feel, once smitten, the Tremendous.

Once seized, one feels the Enormous deeply

Mephistopheles

Versinke denn! Ich konnt' auch sagen:
steige!

Descend, then! I could also say: Ascend!

Sink then! I could also say: rise!

's ist einerlei. Entfliehe dem Entstandnen

'Twere all the same. Escape from the Created

Same difference. Flee the Created

In der Gebilde losgebundne Reiche!

To shapeless forms in liberated spaces!

Into unbound realms of forms!

Ergetze dich am langst nicht mehr
Vorhandnen;

Enjoy what long ere this was dissipated!

Enjoy what's long since no longer there

Wie Wolkenzüge schlingt sich das Getreibe,

There whirls the press, like clouds on clouds unfolding;

Like cloud-trains the swirl coils

Den Schlüssel schwinge, halte sie vom Leibe!

Then with stretched arm swing high the key thou'rt holding!

Swing the key, keep them off your body!

Faust

Wohl! fest ihn fassend fühl' ich neue Stärke,

Good! grasping firmly, fresher strength I win:

Good! Grasping it firmly I feel new strength

Die Brust erweitert, hin zum grossen Werke.

My breast expands, let the great work begin!

**The chest expands, onward to the
great work**

Mephistopheles

Ein gluhender Dreifuss tut dir endlich
kund,

At last a blazing tripod tells thee this,

A glowing tripod tells you finally

Du seist im tiefsten, allertiefsten Grund.

That there the utterly deepest bottom is.

**You're at the deepest, most utterly
deepest ground**

Bei seinem Schein wirst du die Mutter
sehn,

Its light to thee will then the Mothers show,

By its glow you will see the Mothers

Die einen sitzen, andre stehn und gehn,

Some in their seats, the others stand or go,

Some sit, others stand and walk

Wie's eben kommt. Gestaltung, Umgestal-
tung,

At their own will: Formation, Transforma-
tion,

**However it happens. Formation,
Transformation**

Des ewigen Sinnes ewige Unterhaltung.

The Eternal Mind's eternal recreation.

Of eternal meaning the eternal conversation

Umschwebt von Bildern aller Kreatur;

Forms of all creatures, – there are floating free.

Surrounded by images of all creatures

Sie sehn dich nicht, denn Schemen sehn sie nur.

They'll see thee not; for only wraiths they see.

They won't see you, for they see only shadows

Da fass ein Herz, denn die Gefahr ist gross,

So pluck up heart, – the danger then is great, –

So take heart, for the danger is great

Und gehe grad' auf jenen Dreifuss los,

Go to the tripod ere thou hesitate,

And go straight at that tripod

Berühr ihn mit dem Schlüssell! –

And touch it with the key!

Touch it with the key!

Faust macht eine entschieden gebietende Attitüde mit dem Schlüssel. Faust, with the key, assumes a decidedly commanding attitude. Mephistopheles, observing him:

Mephistopheles

So ist's recht!

So, that is right!

That's right!

Er schliesst sich an, er folgt als treuer Knecht;

It will adhere, and follow thee to light.

It attaches itself, it follows like a faithful servant

Gelassen steigst du, dich erhebt das Glück,
Composedly mounting, by thy luck upborne,

Calmly you rise, luck lifts you

Und eh' sie's merken, bist mit ihm zuruck.
Before they notice it, shalt thou return.

And before they notice, you're back with it

Und hast du ihn einmal hierher gebracht,

When thou the tripod hither hast conveyed,

And once you've brought it here

So rufst du Held und Heldin aus der Nacht,

Then call the hero, heroine, from the shade, –

You call hero and heroine from the night

Der erste, der sich jener Tat erdreistet;

The first that ever such a deed perfected:

The first who ever dared that deed

Sie ist getan, und du hast es geleistet.

'Tis done, and thou thereto hast been selected.

It is done, and you accomplished it

Dann muss fortan, nach magischem Behandeln,

For instantly, by magic process warmed,

Then from now on, by magic treatment

Der Weihrauchsnebel sich in Gotter wandeln.

To gods the incense-mist shall be transformed.

**The incense fog must transform into
gods**

Faust

Und nun was jetzt? –

What further now?

And now what?

Mephistopheles

Dein Wesen strebe nieder;

Downward thy being strain!

Strain your being downward

Versinke stampfend, stampfend steigst du
wieder.

Stamp and descend, stamping thou'lt rise
again.

**Sink stamping, stamping you rise
again**

Faust stampft und versinkt. Faust stamps, and sinks
out of sight.

Mephistopheles

Wenn ihm der Schlüssel nur zum besten
frommt!

If only, by the key, he something learn!

If only the key works out for his best!

Neugierig bin ich, ob er wiederkommt.

I'm curious to see if he return.

I'm curious whether he'll come back

Hell erleuchtete Sale / Brilliantly Lighted Halls

Kaiser und Fursten. Der Hof in Bewegung. Emperor
and Princes. The Court in movement.

Kammerer (zu Mephistopheles)

Ihr seid uns noch die Geisterszene
schuld;

The spirit-scene you've promised, still you
owe us;

You still owe us the ghost show

Macht Euch daran! der Herr ist ungeduldig.

Our Lord's impatient; come, the phantasm
show us!

Get on it! The boss is losing patience

Marschalk

Soeben fragt der Gnädigste darnach;

Just now His Gracious Self did question me:

His Most Gracious just asked about it

Ihr! zaudert nicht der Majestat zur Schmach.

Delay not, nor offend His Majesty!

Don't dawdle! It would shame His Majesty

Mephistopheles

Ist mein Kumpan doch deshalb weggegangen;

My comrade's gone to set the work in motion;

That's exactly why my buddy left

Er weiss schon, wie es anzufangen,

How to begin, he has the proper notion.

He knows how to get this thing started

Und laboriert verschlossen still,

In secret he the charms must cull,

And works away in secret, silent

Muss ganz besonders sich befleissen;

Must labour with a fervour tragic:

Must really throw himself into it

Denn wer den Schatz, das Schöne, heben
will,

Who would that treasure lift, the Beautiful,

**For whoever wants to lift the treasure,
the Beautiful**

Bedarf der höchsten Kunst, Magie der
Weisen.

Requires the highest Art, the sage's Magic.

Needs the highest art, the Sages' Magic

Marschalk

Was ihr für Künste braucht, ist einerlei:

What arts you need, is all the same to me;

**What arts you need is all the same to
me**

Der Kaiser will, dass alles fertig sei.

The Emperor wills that you should ready
be.

The Emperor wants it done. Period.

Blonde (zu Mephistopheles)

Ein Wort, mein Herr! Ihr seht ein klares Angesicht,

One word, Sir! Here you see a visage fair, –

One word, sir! You see a clear complexion here

So ist's jedoch im leid'gen Sommer nicht!

In sorry summer I another wear!

But not in wretched summer, no!

Da sprossen hundert braunlich rote Flecken,

There sprout a hundred brown and reddish freckles,

A hundred brownish-red spots sprout up

Die zum Verdruss die weisse Haut bedecken.

And vex my lily skin with ugly speckles.

And cover my white skin, to my disgust

Ein Mittel! –

A cure!

A cure! –

Mephistopheles

Schade! so ein leuchtend Schatzchen

'Tis pity! Shining fair, yet smitten, –

Pity! Such a glowing little treasure

Im Mai getupft wie eure Pantherkatzchen.

Spotted, when May comes, like a panther-kitten!

Spotted in May like your little panther-cats

Nehmt Froschlaich, Krotenzungen, kohobiert,

Take frog-spawn, tongues of toads, which cohobate,

Take frog-spawn, toad tongues, cohobate them

Im vollsten Mondlicht sorglich destilliert

Under the full moon deftly distillate,

Carefully distilled under the fullest moonlight

Und, wenn er abnimmt, reinlich aufgestrichen,

And, when it wanes, apply the mixture:

And when it wanes, smear it on clean

Der Fruhling kommt, die Tupfen sind entwichen.

Next spring, the spots will be no more a fixture.

Spring comes, the spots will have fled

Braune

Die Menge drangt heran, Euch zu umschranzen.

To sponge upon you, what a crowd's advancing!

The crowd pushes forward to sponge off you

Ich bitt' um Mittel! Ein erfrorner Fuss

I beg a remedy: a frozen foot

I beg a remedy! A frozen foot

Verhindert mich am Wandeln wie am Tanzen,

Annoys me much, in walking as in dancing;

Keeps me from walking as much as dancing

Selbst ungeschickt beweg' ich mich zum Gruss.

And awkwardly I manage to salute.

Even in greeting I move awkwardly

Mephistopheles

Erlaubet einen Tritt von meinem Fuss.

A gentle kick permit, then, from my foot!

Allow one kick from my foot

Braune

Nun, das geschieht wohl unter Liebesleuten.

Well, – that might happen, when the two
are lovers.

Well, that's something lovers do

Mephistopheles

Mein Fusstritt, Kind! hat Grossres zu
bedeuten.

My kick a more important meaning covers:

My kick, child! means something bigger

Zu Gleichem Gleiches, was auch einer litt;
Similia similibus, when one is sick.

Like cures like, whatever one suffered

Fuss heilet Fuss, so ist's mit allen Gliedern.

The foot cures foot, each limb its hurt can
palliate;

Foot heals foot, same with all limbs

Heran! Gebt acht! Ihr sollt es nicht
erwidern.

Come near! Take heed! and, pray you,
don't retaliate!

Come close! Watch out! Don't kick back

Braune (schreiend)

Weh! Weh! das brennt! das war ein harter Tritt, –

Oh! oh! it stings! That was a fearful kick,

Ow! Ow! It burns! That was a hard kick–

Wie Pferdehuf.

Like hoof of horse.

Like a horse hoof

Mephistopheles

Die Heilung nehmt Ihr mit.

But it has cured you, quick.

You take the cure with you

Du kannst nunmehr den Tanz nach Lust veruben,

To dance whene'er you please, you now are able;

Now you can dance to your heart's content

Bei Tafel schwelgend fussle mit dem Lieben.

To press your lover's foot, beneath the table.

At table, feasting, play footsie with your lover

Dame (vordrangend)

Lasst mich hindurch! Zu gross sind meine Schmerzen,

Make room for me! Too great is my affliction,

Let me through! My pain is too great

Sie wuhlen siedend mir im tiefsten Herzen;

My tortures worse than those described in fiction:

It churns boiling in my deepest heart

Bis gestern sucht' Er Heil in meinen Blicken,

His bliss, till yesterday, was in my glances,

Till yesterday he sought salvation in my glances

Er schwatzt mit ihr und wendet mir den Rücken.

But now he turns his back, and spins with her romances!

Now he chats with her and turns me his back

Mephistopheles

Bedenklich ist es, aber hore mich.

The matter's grave, but listen unto me!

Tricky, but hear me out

An ihn heran musst du dich leise drucken;

Draw near to him with gentle, soft advances!

You need to press yourself softly up to him

Nimm diese Kohle, streich ihm einen Strich

Then take this coal and mark him stealthily

Take this coal, draw a line on him

Auf Armel, Mantel, Schulter, wie sich's macht;

On mantle, shoulder, sleeve, – though ne'er so slight,

On sleeve, cloak, shoulder, however you can

Er fuhlt im Herzen holden Reuestich.

Yet penitent at once his heart will be.

He'll feel sweet stabs of remorse in his heart

Die Kohle doch musst du sogleich verschlingen,

The coal thereafter you must straightway swallow,

But you must swallow the coal right away

Nicht Wein, nicht Wasser an die Lippen bringen;

And let no sip of wine or water follow:

No wine, no water must touch your lips

Er seufzt vor deiner Tur noch heute nacht.

He'll sigh before your door this very night.

He'll sigh at your door tonight

Dame

Ist doch kein Gift? –

It is not poison, sure?

It's not poison? –

Mephistopheles (beleidigt)

Respekt, wo sich's gebührt!

Respect, where it is due!

Respect where it's due!

Weit musstet Ihr nach solcher Kohle laufen;

To get such coals, you'd travel many a mile:

You'd have to travel far to find such coal

Sie kommt von einem Scheiterhaufen,

They're from the embers of a funeral pile,

It comes from a funeral pyre

Den wir sonst emsiger angeschurt.

The fires whereof we once more hotly
blew.

Which we once stoked more eagerly

Page

Ich bin verliebt, man halt mich nicht fur
voll.

I love, yet still am counted adolescent.

I'm in love, but no one takes me seriously

Mephistopheles (beiseite)

Ich weiss nicht mehr, wohin ich horen soll.

I know not whom to listen to, at present.

I don't know who to listen to anymore

(Zum Pagen) (To the Page)

Musst Euer Gluck nicht auf die Jungste setzen.

Let not the younger girls thy fancies fetter;

Don't bet your luck on the youngest ones

Die Angejahrten wissen Euch zu schätzen.

–

Those well in years know how to prize thee better. –

The more mature know how to appreciate you –

(Andere drangen sich herzu.) (Others crowd around him.)

Schon wieder Neue! Welch ein harter Strauss!

Already others? 'Tis a trial, sooth!

New ones already! What a brutal ordeal!

Ich helfe mir zuletzt mit Wahrheit aus;

I'll help myself, at last, with naked truth –

I'll just help myself with the truth at last

Der schlechteste Behelf! Die Not ist gross.

–

The worst device! – so great my misery.

The worst resort! The need is great –

O Mutter, Mutter! Lasst nur Fausten los!

O Mothers! Mothers! let but Faust go free!

O Mothers, Mothers! Just let Faust go!

(Umherschauend.) (Gazing around him.)

Die Lichter brennen trube schon im Saal,

The lights are burning dimly in the hall,

The lights already burn dim in the hall

Der ganze Hof bewegt sich auf einmal.

The Court is moving onward, one and all:

The whole court moves at once

Anständig seh' ich sie in Folge ziehn

I see them march, according to degrees,

Properly I see them file along

Durch lange Gänge, ferne Galerien.

Through long arcades and distant galleries.

Through long corridors, distant galleries

Nun! sie versammeln sich im weiten Raum

Now they assemble in the ample space

Now! They gather in the wide space

Des alten Rittersaals, er fasst sie kaum.

Of the Knights' Hall; yet hardly all find place.

Of the old Knight's Hall, it barely holds them

Auf breite Wände Teppiche spendiert,

The breadth of walls is hung with arras rich,

Tapestries donated across broad walls

Mit Rustung Eck' und Nischen ausgeziert.

And armour gleams from every nook and niche.

Corners and niches decked out with armor

Hier braucht es, dacht' ich, keine Zauberworte;

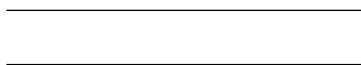
Here, I should think, there needs no magic word:

Here, I thought, no magic words are needed

Die Geister finden sich von selbst zum Orte.

The ghosts will come, and of their own accord.

The ghosts will find their way here on their own



Rittersaal / Hall of the Knights

Dammernde Beleuchtung. Dimly Lighted.

Der Kaiser und der Hof sind eingezogen. The Emperor and Court have entered.

Herold

Mein alt Geschäft, das Schauspiel
anzukunden,

Mine ancient office, to proclaim the action,

My old gig, announcing the show

Verkummert mir der Geister heimlich Wal-
ten;

Is by the spirits' secret influence thwarted:

**Gets sabotaged by secret spirit-
meddling**

Vergebens wagt man, aus verständigen
Gründen

One tries in vain; such wildering distraction

You try in vain with sensible reasons

Sich zu erklären das verworrene Schalten.

Can't be explained, or reasonably reported.

To explain the chaotic management

Die Sessel sind, die Stühle schon zur Hand;

The chairs are ranged, the seats are ready
all:

Chairs are here, seats ready to hand

Den Kaiser setzt man grade vor die Wand;

The Emperor sits, fronting the lofty wall,

They park the Emperor right at the wall

Auf den Tapeten mag er da die Schlachten

Where on the tapestry the battles he

On tapestries there he can ogle

Der grossen Zeit bequemlichstens betrachten.

Of the great era may with comfort see.

History's greatest battles in comfort

Hier sitzt nun alles, Herr und Hof im
Runde,

Here now are all – Prince, Court, and their
belonging,

**Everyone's seated, Lord and Court in
the round**

Die Banke drangen sich im Hintergrunde;
Benches on benches in the background
thronging;

Benches cramped together in the back

Auch Liebchen hat, in düstern Geisterstun-
den,

And lovers, too, in these dim hours
enchanted,

**Even sweethearts, in this spooky
ghost-hour**

Zur Seite Liebchens lieblich Raum gefun-
den.

Beside their loved ones lovingly are
planted.

Found cozy spots next to sweethearts

Und so, da alle schicklich Platz genom-
men,

And now, since all have found convenient
places,

So now that everyone's properly placed

Sind wir bereit; die Geister mögen kommen!

We're ready: let the spirits show their faces!

We're ready: let the ghosts show their faces!

(Trompeten.) (Trumpets.)

Astrolog

Beginne gleich das Drama seinen Lauf,

Begin the Drama! 'Tis the Sire's command:

Drama, start your engines!

Der Herr befiehlt's, ihr Wände tut euch auf!

Ye walls, be severed straightway, and expand!

The Master commands it - walls, spread yourselves!

Nichts hindert mehr, hier ist Magie zur Hand:

Naught hinders; magic answers our desire:

Nothing blocks us now, magic's on tap

Die Teppiche schwinden, wie gerollt vom Brand;

The arras flies, as shrivelled up by fire;

**The tapestries vanish, burnt-scroll
style**

Die Mauer spaltet sich, sie kehrt sich um,

The walls are split, unfolded: in the gloom

**The wall cracks open, flips itself
around**

Ein tief Theater scheint sich aufzustellen,

A theatre appears to be created:

A deep theatre seems to set itself up

Geheimnisvoll ein Schein uns zu erhellen,

By mystic light are we illuminated,

Mystery-light to illuminate us

Und ich besteige das Proszenium.

And I ascend to the proscenium.

And I climb up to the proscenium

Mephistopheles (im Souffleurkasten auftauchend)

Von hier aus hoff' ich allgemeine Gunst,

I hope to win, as prompter, general glory;

**From here I hope for universal ap-
plause**

Einblasereien sind des Teufels Redekunst.

For prompting is the Devil's oratory.

Whispering is the Devil's rhetoric

(Zum Astrologen.) (To the Astrologer.)

Du kennst den Takt, in dem die Sterne
gehn,

Thou know'st the tune and time the stars
that lead;

You know the beat the stars keep

Und wirst mein Flustern meisterlich
verstehn.

Thou wilt my whispers like a master heed.

My whispers you'll catch like a master

Astrolog

Durch Wunderkraft erscheint allhier zur
Schau,

By power miraculous, we here behold

**Through wonder-power appears here
for show**

Massiv genug, ein alter Tempelbau.

A massive temple of the days of old.

Solid enough, an ancient temple

Dem Atlas gleich, der einst den Himmel
trug,

Like Atlas, who erewhile the heavens up-
bore,

Like Atlas who once held up the sky

Stehn reihenweis der Säulen hier genug;

The serried columns stand, an ample
store:

**Columns stand here in rows, plenty of
them**

Sie mögen wohl der Felsenlast genügen,

Well may they for the weight of stone suf-
fice,

**They should handle the stone-weight
just fine**

Da zweie schon ein gross Gebaude trugen.

Since two might bear a mighty edifice.

**Since two alone could carry a huge
building**

Architekt

Das war' antik! Ich wusst' es nicht zu
preisen,

That the antique? As fine it can't be rated;

**That's supposed to be classical? I can't
praise it**

Es sollte plump und überlastig heissen.

I'd sooner style it awkward, over-weighted.

I'd call it clunky and overloaded

Roh nennt man edel, unbehulfllich gross.

Coarse is called noble, and unwieldy, grand:

Crude gets called noble, clumsy gets called grand

Schmalpfeiler lieb' ich, strebend, grenzenlos;

Give me the slender shafts that soar, expand!

I love slim pillars, striving, limitless

Spitzbogiger Zenit erhebt den Geist;

To lift the mind, a pointed arch may boast;

Pointed arches elevate the spirit

Solch ein Gebau erbaut uns allermeist.

Such architecture edifies us most.

That kind of building builds us up the most

Astrolog

Empfangt mit Ehrfurcht sterngegonnte Stunden;

Receive with reverence the star-granted
hours;

**Receive with reverence these star-
granted hours**

Durch magisch Wort sei die Vernunft
gebunden;

Let magic words bind Reason's restless
powers,

Let magic words bind Reason in chains

Dagegen weit heran bewege frei

But in return unbind, to circle free,

But in return, let it roam free and far

Sich herrliche verwegne Phantasei.

The wings of splendid, daring Phantasy!

Magnificent audacious Fantasy

Mit Augen schaut nun, was ihr kuhn
begehrt,

What you have boldly wished, see now
achieved:

**See with your eyes what you boldly
crave**

Unmöglich ist's, drum eben glaubenswert.

Impossible 'tis – therefore to be believed.

It's impossible - therefore believable

(Faust steigt auf der andern Seite des Proszeniums herauf.) (Faust rises to view on the other side of the proscenium.)

Im Priesterkleid, bekrantz, ein Wundermann,

In priestly surplice, crowned, a marvellous man,

In priest-robcs, crowned, a miracle-man

Der nun vollbringt, was er getrost begann.

He now fulfils what he in faith began.

Now completes what he confidently began

Ein Dreifuss steigt mit ihm aus hohler Gruft,

With him, a tripod from the gulf comes up:

A tripod rises with him from the hollow pit

Schon ahn' ich aus der Schale Weihrauchduft.

I scent the incense-odours from the cup.

I already sense incense-smell from the bowl

Er rustet sich, das hohe Werk zu segnen;

He arms himself, the work to consecrate,

He prepares to bless the high work

Es kann fortan nur Glückliches begegnen.

And henceforth it can be but fortunate.

Only good luck can happen from here

Faust (erhaben)

In eurem Namen, Mutter, die ihr thront

Ye Mothers, in your name, who set your throne

In your name, Mothers, enthroned

Im Grenzenlosen, ewig einsam wohnt,

In boundless Space, eternally alone,

In the Boundless, eternally dwelling alone

Und doch gesellig. Euer Haupt umschweben

And yet companioned! All the forms of Being,

Yet companioned! Around your heads hover

Des Lebens Bilder, regsam, ohne Leben.

In movement, lifeless, ye are round you seeing.

Life's images, active, yet lifeless

Was einmal war, in allem Glanz und Schein,

Whate'er once was, there burns and brightens free

What once was, in all its shine and gleam

Es regt sich dort; denn es will ewig sein.

In splendour – for 'twould fain eternal be;

Stirs there still - it wants to be forever

Und ihr verteilt es, allgewaltige Mächte,

And ye allot it, with all-potent might,

And you distribute it, all-powerful forces

Zum Zelt des Tages, zum Gewölbe der Nächte.

To Day's pavilions and the vaults of Night.

To the tent of Day, to the vault of Night

Die einen fasst des Lebens holder Lauf,

Life seizes some, along his gracious course;

Some get seized by life's lovely course

Die andern sucht der kühne Magier auf;

Others arrest the bold Magician's force;

Others the bold magician hunts down

In reicher Spende lasst er, voll Vertrauen,

And he, bestowing as his faith inspires,

In rich abundance he lets, full of trust

Was jeder wunscht, das Wunderwurdige
schauen.

Displays the Marvellous, that each desires.

**Each see what they wish - the wonder-
worthy**

Astrolog

Der gluhende Schlssel ruhrt die Schale
kaum,

The glowing key has scarcely touched the
cup,

**The glowing key barely touches the
bowl**

Ein dunstiger Nebel deckt sogleich den
Raum;

And lo! through all the space, a mist rolls
up:

A hazy mist covers the space at once

Er schleicht sich ein, er wogt nach Wolke-
nart,

It creeps about, and like a cloudy train,

It sneaks in, swells cloud-like

Gedehnt, geballt, verschränkt, geteilt,
gepaart.

Spreads, rounding, narrowing, parting,
closed again.

**Stretched, balled, interlaced, split,
paired**

Und nun erkennt ein Geister-Meisterstück!

And now, behold a spirit-masterpiece!

And now recognize a ghost-masterpiece!

So wie sie wandeln, machen sie Musik.

Music is born from every wandering fleece.

As they wander, they make music

Aus luft'gen Tönen quillt ein Weiss-
nichtwie,

The tones of air, I know not how they flow;

**From airy tones pours an I-don't-know-
what**

Indem sie ziehn, wird alles Melodie.

Where'er they move all things melodious
grow.

**Where they move, everything turns
melody**

Der Saulenschaft, auch die Triglyphe
klingt,

The pillared shaft, the triglyph even rings:

**The column-shaft, even the triglyph
rings**

Ich glaube gar, der ganze Tempel singt.

I think, indeed, the whole bright temple
sings.

I believe the whole temple is singing

Das Dunstige senkt sich; aus dem leichten
Flor

The vapours settle; as the light film clears,

**The mist sinks down; from the light
gauze**

Ein schöner Jungling tritt im Takt hervor.

A beauteous youth, with rhythmic step, ap-
pears.

**A beautiful young man steps out in
rhythm**

Hier schweigt mein Amt, ich brauch' ihn
nicht zu nennen,

Here ends my task; his name I need not
tell:

**Here my task ends - I don't need to
name him**

Wer sollte nicht den holden Paris kennen!
Who doth not know the gentle Paris well?

Who wouldn't know lovely Paris!

Dame

O! welch ein Glanz aufbluhender Jugendkraft!

O, what a youthful bloom and strength I see!

Oh! What a radiance of blooming youth-power!

Zweite

Wie eine Pfirsche frisch und voller Saft!

Fresh as a peach, and full of juice, is he!

Like a peach, fresh and full of juice!

Dritte

Die fein gezogenen, süss geschwollnen Lippen!

The finely drawn, the sweetly swelling lip!

Those finely drawn, sweetly swollen lips!

Vierte

Du mochtest wohl an solchem Becher nippen?

From such a cup, no doubt, you'd like to sip?

You'd probably like to sip from that cup?

Funfte

Er ist gar habsch, wenn auch nicht eben fein.

He's handsome, if a little unrefined.

He's quite handsome, though not exactly refined

Sechste

Ein bisschen konnt' er doch gewandter sein.

He might be somewhat gracefuller, to my mind.

He could be a bit more graceful, frankly

Ritter

Den Schaferknecht glaub' ich allhier zu spuren,

The shepherd I detect; I find him wearing

I detect the shepherd-boy in there

Vom Prinzen nichts und nichts von Hofmanieren.

No traces of the Prince, or courtly bearing.

Nothing of the Prince, nothing of court manners

Andrer

Eh nun! halb nackt ist wohl der Junge schon,

O, yes! half-naked is the youth not bad;

Well now! Half-naked the lad's not bad

Doch mussten wir ihn erst im Harnisch sehn!

But let us see him first in armour clad!

But we'd need to see him in armor first!

Dame

Er setzt sich nieder, weichlich, angenehm.

He seats himself, with such a gentle grace!

He sits down, soft and pleasant

Ritter

Auf seinem Schosse war' Euch wohl bequem?

You'd find his lap, perchance, a pleasant place?

You'd probably be comfy on his lap?

Andre

Er lehnt den Arm so zierlich ubers Haupt.

He lifts his arm so lightly o'er his head.

He drapes his arm so prettily over his head

Kammerer

Die Flegellei! Das find' ich unerlaubt!

'Tis not allowed: how thoroughly ill-bred!

Such boorishness! I find that impermissible!

Dame

Ihr Herren wisst an allem was zu makeln.

You lords find fault with all things evermore.

You lords find something to nitpick in everything

Derselbe

In Kaisers Gegenwart sich hinzurakeln!

To stretch and yawn before the Emperor!

Sprawling around in the Emperor's presence!

Dame

Er stellt's nur vor! Er glaubt sich ganz allein.

He only acts: he thinks he's quite alone.

He's just acting! He thinks he's alone

Derselbe

Das Schauspiel selbst, hier sollt' es hoflich sein.

Even the play should be politely shown.

Even a play should be polite here

Dame

Sanft hat der Schlaf den Holden ubernommen.

Now sleep falls on the graceful youth so sweetly.

Sleep has gently taken the lovely one

Derselbe

Er schnarcht nun gleich; naturlich ist's, vollkommen!

Now will he snore: 'tis natural, completely!

Now he'll snore - that's natural, perfect!

Junge Dame

Zum Weihrauchsdampf was duftet so gemischt,

Mixed with the incense-steam, what odour precious

Mixed with incense-steam, what fragrance is this

Das mir das Herz zum innigsten erfrischt?

Steals to my bosom, and my heart refreshes?

That refreshes my heart to its core?

Altere

Furwahr! Es dringt ein Hauch tief ins Gemute,

Forsooth, it penetrates and warms the feeling!

Truly! A breath penetrates deep into feeling

Er kommt von ihm! –

It comes from him.

It comes from him!

Alteste

Es ist des Wachstums Blute,

His flower of youth, unsealing,

Prepared in the youth as ambrosia

Im Jungling als Ambrosia bereitet

It is: Youth's fine ambrosia, ripe, unfading,

And spread atmospherically all around

Und atmospharisch ringsumher verbreitet.

The atmosphere around his form pervading.

So that's her! From this one I'd have peace

(Helena hervortretend.) (Helena comes forward.)

Mephistopheles

Das war' sie denn! Vor dieser hatt' ich Ruh';

So, that is she! My sleep she would not waste:

She's pretty enough, but she's not my type

Hubsch ist sie wohl, doch sagt sie mir nicht zu.

She's pretty, truly, but she's not my taste.

Nothing more for me to do this time

Astrolog

Fur mich ist diesmal weiter nichts zu tun,

There's nothing more for me to do, I trow;

As an honest man I confess it now

Als Ehrenmann gesteh', bekenn' ich's nun.

As man of honour, I confess it now.

**The Beauty comes, and if I had tongues
of fire!**

Die Schöne kommt, und hatt' ich Feuerzungen! –

The Beauty comes, and had I tongues of
fire, –

**About beauty so much has always been
sung**

Von Schönheit ward von jeher viel gesungen –

So many songs did Beauty e'er inspire, –

Whoever she appears to loses himself

Wem sie erscheint, wird aus sich selbst ent-
truckt,

Who sees her, of his wits is dispossessed,

**Whoever possessed her was blessed
beyond measure**

Wem sie gehorte, ward zu hoch beglückt.

And who possessed her was too highly
blessed.

**Do I still have eyes? Does the fountain
of Beauty**

Faust

Hab' ich noch Augen? Zeigt sich tief im
Sinn

Have I still eyes? Deep in my being springs

Pour itself most richly deep in my soul?

Der Schönheit Quelle reichlichstens
ergossen?

The fount of Beauty, in a torrent pouring!

**My terror-journey brings the most
blessed gain**

Mein Schreckensgang bringt seligsten
Gewinn.

A heavenly gain my path of terror brings.

**How void the world was to me, how
locked!**

Wie war die Welt mir nichtig, uner-
schlossen!

The world was void, and shut to my explor-
ing, –

What is it now since my priesthood?

Was ist sie nun seit meiner Priesterschaft?

And, since my priesthood, how hath it
been graced!

Finally desirable, grounded, lasting!

Erst wünschenswert, gegründet, dauer-
haft!

Enduring 'tis, desirable, firm-based.

Let the breath of my life vanish

Verschwinde mir des Lebens Atemkraft,
And let my breath of being blow to waste,

If I ever unwean myself from you!

Wenn ich mich je von dir zuruckgewohne!

—

If I for thee unlearn my sacred duty!

The fair form that once enchanted me

Die Wohlgestalt, die mich voreinst
entzuckte,

The form, that long erewhile my fancy captured,

Made me happy in magic mirror-reflection

In Zauberspiegelung begluckte,

That from the magic mirror so enraptured,

Was just a foam-image of such beauty!

War nur ein Schaumbild solcher Schone! —

Was but a frothy phantom of such beauty!

You're the one to whom I owe the stirring of all power

Du bist's, der ich die Regung aller Kraft,

'Tis Thou, to whom the stir of all my forces,

The essence of all passion

Den Inbegriff der Leidenschaft,

The essence of my passion's courses, –

**Devotion, love, worship, madness - I
pay it all to you**

Dir Neigung, Lieb', Anbetung, Wahnsinn
zolle.

Love, fancy, worship, madness, – here I
render!

**Get a grip on yourself and don't break
character!**

Mephistopheles (aus dem Kasten)

So fasst Euch doch und fallt nicht aus der
Rolle!

Be calm! – you lose your role, to be so ten-
der!

**Tall, well-shaped, only the head too
small**

Altere Dame

Gross, wohlgestaltet, nur der Kopf zu klein.

Tall and well-formed! Too small the head,
alone.

**Just look at that foot! How could it be
clunkier!**

Jungere

Seht nur den Fuss! Wie konnt' er plumper
sein!

Just see her foot! A heavier ne'er was
shown.

I've seen princesses of this type

Diplomat

Furstinnen hab' ich dieser Art gesehn,
Princesses of her style I've often seen:

**Seems to me she's beautiful head to
toe**

Mich deucht, sie ist vom Kopf zum Fusse
schon.

From head to foot she's beautiful, I ween.

**She sneaks toward the sleeper, craftily
gentle**

Hofmann

Sie nahert sich dem Schlafer listig mild.

She near the sleeper steals, so soft and sly.

**How ugly next to that pure youthful
image!**

Dame

Wie hasslich neben jugendreinem Bild!

How ugly, near that youthful purity!

**Her beauty beams down on him like
light**

Poet

Von ihrer Schonheit ist er angestrahlt.

Her beauty's light is on him like a dawn.

Endymion and Luna! Like a painting!

Dame

Endymion und Luna! wie gemalt!

Endymion and Luna – as they're drawn!

**Exactly right! The goddess seems to
sink down**

Poet

Ganz recht! Die Gottin scheint her-
abzusinken,

Quite right! The yielding goddess seems to
sink,

She bends over to drink his breath

Sie neigt sich über, seinen Hauch zu
trinken;

And o'er him bend, his balmy breath to
drink.

Enviably! A kiss! The measure is full

Beneidenswert! – Ein Kuss! – Das Mass ist voll.

Enviably fate – a kiss! – the cup is full!

In front of everyone! That's really too wild!

Duenna

Vor allen Leuten! Das ist doch zu toll!

Before all people! – that is more than cool.

Monstrous favor to the boy!

Faust

Furchtbare Gunst dem Knaben! –

A fearful favour to the boy!

Quiet! Still!

Mephistopheles

Ruhig! still!

Be still!

Let the ghost do whatever it wants

Lass das Gespenst doch machen was es will.

Suffer the shade to do whate'er it will!

She sneaks away, light-footed; he wakes

Hofmann

Sie schleicht sich weg, leichtfüssig; er erwacht.

She slips away, light-footed: he awakes.

She looks around! I knew she would

Dame

Sie sieht sich um! Das hab' ich wohl gedacht.

Just as I thought! Another look she takes.

He's amazed! What's happening to him is a wonder

Hofmann

Er staunt! Ein Wunder ist's, was ihm geschieht.

He stares: what haps, to him a marvel is.

To her it's no wonder what she sees before her

Dame

Ihr ist kein Wunder, was sie vor sich sieht.

But none to her, what she before her sees!

With poise she turns around to him

Hofmann

Mit Anstand kehrt sie sich zu ihm herum.

She turns around to him with dignity.

I can see she's taking him to school

Dame

Ich merke schon, sie nimmt ihn in die Lehre;

I see, she means to put him through his paces:

In such cases all men are stupid

In solchem Fall sind alle Manner dumm,

All men, in such a case, act stupidly.

He probably thinks he's the first one too

Er glaubt wohl auch, dass er der erste ware.

Then, too, he thinks that first he's won her graces.

Let me appreciate her! Majestically fine!

Ritter

Lasst mir sie gelten! Majestatisch fein! –

Majestically fine! – She pleases me.

The slut! Now that's what I call common!

Dame

Die Buhlerin! Das nenn' ich doch gemein!

The courtesan! How very vulgar she!

I'd sure like to be in his place!

Page

Ich mochte wohl an seiner Stelle sein!

Just where he is, is where I'd like to be!

Who wouldn't get caught in such a net?

Hofmann

Wer wurde nicht in solchem Netz gefangen?

Who would not fain be caught in such sweet meshes?

That jewel has passed through many hands

Dame

Das Kleinod ist durch manche Hand gegangen,

Through many a hand hath passed that jewel precious;

The gilding's pretty much worn off too

Auch die Verguldung ziemlich abgebraucht.

The gilding, too, is for the most part gone.

Since age ten she's been worthless

Andre

Vom zehnten Jahr an hat sie nichts
getaugt.

She has been worthless from her tenth
year on.

Sometimes you just take the best you can get

Ritter

Gelegentlich nimmt jeder sich das Beste;
Each takes the best that chance for him ob-
tains;

I'd hold on to these beautiful remains

Ich hielte mich an diese schönen Reste.

I'd be contented with these fair remains.

I see her clearly, but freely confess

Gelahrter

Ich seh' sie deutlich, doch gesteh' ich frei:

I freely own, though I distinctly see,

It's doubtful if she's the real one

Zu zweifeln ist, ob sie die rechte sei.

'Tis doubtful if the genuine one she be.

The Present seduces us to exaggeration

Die Gegenwart verfuhr ins ubertriebne,

The Present leads us to exaggeration,

Above all I stick to what's written

Ich halte mich vor allem ans Geschriebne.

And I hold fast the written, old relation.

There I read that she really pleased

Da les' ich denn, sie habe wirklich allen

I read that, truly, ere her bloom was
blighted,

All the gray-beards of Troy particularly

Graubarten Trojas sonderlich gefallen;

The Trojan gray-beards greatly she de-
lighted.

And as I see it, that fits perfectly here

Und wie mich dunkt, vollkommen passt
das hier:

And here, methinks, it tallies perfectly:

I'm not young, and yet she pleases me

Ich bin nicht jung, und doch gefällt sie mir.

I am not young, yet she delighteth me.

No longer boy! A bold hero-man

Astrolog

Nicht Knabe mehr! Ein kuhner Heldenmann,

No more a boy! A bold, heroic form,

He embraces her, she can barely resist

Umfasst er sie, die kaum sich wehren kann.

He clasps her, who can scarce resist the storm.

With strengthened arm he lifts her high

Gestarkten Arms hebt er sie hoch empor,

With arm grown strong he lifts her high and free:

Is he going to abduct her?

Entfuhr't er sie wohl gar? –

Means he to bear her off?

Reckless fool!

Faust

Verwegner Tor!

Rash fool, let be!

You dare! You don't hear! Stop! This is too much!

Du wagst! Du horst nicht! halt! das ist zu viel!

Thou dar'st? Thou hear'st not? Hold! – I'll be obeyed.

You're creating this farce-ghost-play yourself!

Mephistopheles

Machst du's doch selbst, das Fratzengeisterspiel!

The spectral drama thou thyself hast made!

Just one word more! After all that happened

Astrolog

Nur noch ein Wort! Nach allem, was geschah,

A word more! After all we've seen to-day,

I name this piece: The Rape of Helena

Nenn' ich das Stuck den Raub der Helena.

I call the piece: The Rape of Helena.

What rape! Am I here for nothing!

Faust

Was Raub! Bin ich fur nichts an dieser Stelle!

What! Rape? Am I for nothing here? To
stead me,

Is this key not in my hand!

Ist dieser Schlüssel nicht in meiner Hand!

Is not this key still shining in my hand?

**It led me through horror and surge and
wave**

Er fuhrte mich, durch Graus und Wog' und
Welle

Through realms of terror, wastes, and
waves it led me,

**Through solitudes, here to solid
ground**

Der Einsamkeiten, her zum festen Strand.

Through solitudes, to where I firmly stand.

Here I plant my foot! Here are realities

Hier fass' ich Fuss! Hier sind es Wirk-
lichkeiten,

Here foothold is! Realities here centre!

**From here the spirit may battle with
spirits**

Von hier aus darf der Geist mit Geistern
streiten,

The strife with spirits here the mind may venture,

Prepare the great double-kingdom for itself

Das Doppelreich, das grosse, sich bereiten.

And on its grand, its double lordship enter!

So far she was - how can she be nearer!

So fern sie war, wie kann sie naher sein!

How far she was, and nearer, how divine!

I'll save her, and she'll be doubly mine

Ich rette sie, und sie ist doppelt mein.

I'll rescue her, and make her doubly mine.

Dared! You Mothers! Mothers! Grant it!

Gewagt! Ihr Mutter! Mutter! musst's gewahren!

Ye Mothers! Mothers! crown this wild endeavour!

Who has known her may not be without her

Wer sie erkannt, der darf sie nicht entbehren.

Who knows her once must hold her, and for ever!

What are you doing, Faust! Faust! With violence

Astrolog

Was tust du, Fauste! Fauste! – Mit Gewalt

What art thou doing, Faust? O, look at him!

He grabs her - already the form grows dark

Fasst er sie an, schon trübt sich die Gestalt.

He seizes her: the form is growing dim.

He turns the key toward the youth

Den Schlüssel kehrt er nach dem Jungling zu,

He turns the key against the youth, and, lo!

Touches him! Woe to us, woe! Now! This instant!

Berührt ihn! – Weh uns, Wehe! Nu! im Nu!

It touches him – Woe's me! Away now! Woe on woe!

There you have it! Burdening yourself with fools

(Explosion. Faust liegt am Boden. Die Geister gehen in Dunst auf.) (Explosion. Faust lies upon the earth.

The Spirits dissolve in vapour.)

Mephistopheles (der Fausten auf die Schulter nimmt)

Da habt ihr's nun! mit Narren sich beladen,

You have it now! One's self with fools to hamper,

Eventually hurts even the Devil himself

Das kommt zuletzt dem Teufel selbst zu Schaden.

At last even on the Devil puts a damper.

(Finsternis, Tumult.) (Darkness. Tumult.)

Zweiter Akt / Act II

Hochgewolbtes enges gotisches Zimmer / A High-Arched, Narrow Gothic Chamber

Mephistopheles

Hier lieg, Unseliger! verführt Lie there, ill-starred! seduced, unwise, **Lie there, wretched one! seduced**

Zu schwergelostem Liebesbände! To bonds that surely hold the lover! **Into love-knots hard to undo!**

Wen Helena paralysiert, Whom Helena shall paralyze
Whoever Helena paralyzes

Der kommt so leicht nicht zu Verstande. Not soon
his reason will recover. **Won't get their head on
straight for a while.**

Blick' ich hinauf, hierher, hinüber, I look about, and
through the glimmer **I look up, over here, over
there,**

Allunverändert ist es, unversehrt; Unchanged, un-
injured, all appears: **Everything's the same,
nothing's touched;**

Die bunten Scheiben sind, so dunkt mich, trüber, The
coloured window-panes, methinks, are dimmer, **The
stained glass looks dingier to me,**

Die Spinnewebe haben sich vermehrt; The cobwebs
have increased with years. **The spiderwebs have
multiplied.**

Die Tinte starrt, vergilbt ist das Papier; The ink is dry,
the paper old and brown, **The ink's congealed, the
paper's yellowed;**

Doch alles ist am Platz geblieben; But each thing in its
place I find: **But everything's right where it was;**

Sogar die Feder liegt noch hier, Even the quill is here
laid down, **Even the pen's still lying here,**

Mit welcher Faust dem Teufel sich verschrieben.
Wherewith his compact with the Devil he signed. **The
one Faust used to sign himself over to the Devil.**

Ja! tiefer in dem Rohre stockt Yea, deeper in, the
barrel's red **Yes! Deeper in the barrel there's dried**

Ein Tropflein Blut, wie ich's ihm abgeloct. With trace
of blood I coaxed him then to shed. **A drop of blood
I coaxed out of him.**

Zu einem solchen einzigen Stuck A thing so totally
unique **For such a singular collector's item**

Wünscht' ich dem grossten Sammler Glück. The great
collectors would go far to seek. **I'd wish the greatest
collector good luck.**

Auch hangt der alte Pelz am alten Haken, Half from its
hook the old fur-robe is falling, **The old fur coat still
hangs on the old hook,**

Erinnert mich an jene Schnaken, That ancient joke of
mine recalling, **Reminding me of that joke I pulled,**

Wie ich den Knaben einst belehrt, How once I taught
the boy such truth **How I once schooled the boy**

Woran er noch vielleicht als Jungling zehrt. As still, it
may be, nourishes the youth. **On stuff he's probably
still chewing on as a young man.**

Es kommt mir wahrlich das Gelusten, The wish
returns, with zest acuter, **I'm really getting the
urge**

Rauchwarme Hulle, dir vereint Aided by thee, thou
rough disguise, **With your help, smoky pelt,**

Mich als Dozent noch einmal zu erbrusten, Once more
to take on airs as college tutor, **To puff myself up as
a lecturer again,**

Wie man so völlig recht zu haben meint. As one infallible in one's own eyes. **Like someone who thinks he's totally right.**

Gelehrte wissen's zu erlangen, The savants this assurance know: **Scholars know how to pull that off;**

Dem Teufel ist es längst vergangen. The Devil lost it, long ago! **The Devil lost the knack long ago.**

Chor der Insekten / Chorus of Insects

Willkommen! willkommen, Welcome, and hail to thee! **Welcome! Welcome!**

Du alter Patron! Patron, to-day: **You old patron!**

Wir schweben und summen We're flying and humming, **We're hovering and humming**

Und kennen dich schon. We hear and obey. **And we already know you.**

Nur einzeln im stillen Singly and silently **Only singly in silence**

Du hast uns gepflanzt; Us thou hast sown; **You planted us;**

Zu Tausenden kommen wir, Hither, by thousands, **By the thousands we come,**

Vater, getanzt. Father, we've flown. **Father, dancing!**

Der Schalk in dem Busen The imp in the bosom **The imp in the bosom**

Verbirgt sich so sehr, Is snugly concealed; **Hides itself so well,**

Vom Pelze die Lauschen But lice in the fur-coat **But the lice in the fur coat**

Enthullen sich eh'r. Are sooner revealed. **Reveal themselves sooner.**

Mephistopheles

Ich schuttle noch einmal den alten Flaus, Once more I'll shake the ancient fleeces out: **I shake the old fleece once more,**

Noch eines flattert hier und dort hinaus. – Still here and there a chance one flies about.– **Still one flutters here and there. –**

Hinauf! umher! in hunderttausend Ecken Off, and around! in hundred thousand nooks **Up! Around! Into a hundred thousand corners**

Eilt euch, ihr Liebchen, zu verstecken. Hasten to hide yourselves–among the books, **Hurry, my darlings, to hide yourselves.**

Dort, wo die alten Schachteln stehn, There, in the pasteboard's wormy holes, **There, where the old boxes stand,**

Hier im bebraunten Pergamen, Here, in the smoky parchment scrolls, **Here in the browned parchment,**

In staubigen Scherben alter Topfe, In dusty jars, that broken lie, **In dusty shards of old pots,**

Dem Hohlaug' jener Totenkopfe. And yonder skull with empty eye. **In the hollow eye of that skull.**

In solchem Wust und Moderleben In all this trash and mould unmatched, **In such muck and moldy life**

Muss es fur ewig Grillen geben. Crotchets for ever must be hatched. **There must forever be crickets.**

Komm, decke mir die Schultern noch einmal! Come, once again upon my shoulders fall! **Come, cover my shoulders once more!**

Heut bin ich wieder Prinzpal. Once more am I the Principal. **Today I'm the Principal again.**

Doch hilft es nichts, mich so zu nennen; But 'tis no good to ape the college; **But it doesn't help to call myself that;**

Wo sind die Leute, die mich anerkennen? For where are those who will my claim acknowledge? **Where are the people who'll acknowledge me?**

Famulus

Welch ein Tönen! welch ein Schauer! What a sound! What dreadful quaking! **What a sound! What a shudder!**

Treppe schwankt, es bebt die Mauer; Stairs are rocking, walls are shaking; **Stairs sway, walls tremble;**

Durch der Fenster buntes Zittern Through the
coloured windows brightening **Through the col-
ored windows' quivering**

Seh' ich wetterleuchtend Wittern. I behold the sud-
den lightning; **I see lightning weather-flashing.**

Springt das Estrich, und von oben Floors above me
crack and rumble, **The floor splits, and from above**

Rieselt Kalk und Schutt verschoben. Lime and lumber
round me tumble, **Lime and rubble come raining
down.**

Und die Türe, fest verriegelt, And the door, securely
bolted, **And the door, firmly bolted,**

Ist durch Wunderkraft entsiegelt. – Is by magic force
unfolded.– **Is unsealed by miraculous force. –**

Dort! Wie furchterlich! Ein Riese There! How terrible!
a Giant **There! How terrifying! A Giant**

Steht in Faustens altem Vliese! Stands in Faust's old
fur, defiant! **Stands in Faust's old fleece!**

Seinen Blicken, seinem Winken As he looks, and beck-
ons thither, **From his stares, from his beckoning**

Mocht' ich in die Kniee sinken. I could fall, my senses
wither. **I could sink to my knees.**

Soll ich fliehen? Soll ich stehn? Shall I fly, or shall I
wait? **Should I flee? Should I stay?**

Ach, wie wird es mir ergehn! What, O what shall be my
fate! **Oh, what will become of me!**

Mephistopheles

Heran, mein Freund! – Ihr heisset Nikodemus. Come hither, Friend! Your name is Nicodemus. **Come here, my friend! – You're called Nicodemus.**

Famulus

Hochwürdiger Herr! so ist mein Nam' – Oremus. Most honoured Sir, such is my name–Oremus! **Most reverend Sir! That's my name – Oremus.**

Mephistopheles

Das lassen wir! – Dispense with that! **Let's skip that!**

–

Famulus

Wie froh, dass Ihr mich kennt! O joy! you know me yet. **How glad that you know me!**

Mephistopheles

Ich weiss es wohl, bejahrt und noch Student, Old, and a student still,–I don't forget, **I know well, aged and still a student,**

Bemooster Herr! Auch ein gelehrter Mann Most mossy Sir! Also a learned man **Most mossy Sir! Also a learned man**

Studiert so fort, weil er nicht anders kann. Continues study, since naught else he can. **Continues studying because he can't do otherwise.**

So baut man sich ein massig Kartenhaus, 'Tis thus
one builds a moderate house of cards; **That's how
you build a modest house of cards,**

Der grosste Geist baut's doch nicht vollig aus. The
greatest minds ne'er end them, afterwards. **The
greatest mind never quite finishes it.**

Doch Euer Meister, das ist ein Beschlagner: Your mas-
ter is a skilful fellow, though: **But your master, now
that's a sharp one:**

Wer kennt ihn nicht, den edlen Doktor Wagner, The
noble Doctor Wagner all must know. **Who doesn't
know him, the noble Doctor Wagner,**

Den Ersten jetzt in der gelehrten Welt! The first in all
the learned world is he, **The first now in the learned
world!**

Er ist's allein, der sie zusammenhalt, Who now to-
gether holds it potently, **He alone holds it together,**

Der Weisheit taglicher Vermehrer. Wisdom increasing,
daily making clearer. **Daily multiplier of wisdom.**

Allwissbegierige Horcher, Horer How thirst for knowl-
edge listener and hearer! **All-knowledge-hungry
listeners, hearers**

Versammeln sich um ihn zuhauf. A mighty crowd
around him flocks. **Gather around him in heaps.**

Er leuchtet einzig vom Katheder; None for the ros-
trum e'er were meeter: **He alone shines from the
lectern;**

Die Schlüssel ubt er wie Sankt Peter, The keys he holds as doth Saint Peter, **He wields the keys like Saint Peter,**

Das Untre so das Obre schliesst er auf. The Under and the Upper he unlocks. **Unlocks the below as well as the above.**

Wie er vor allen gluht und funkelt, His light above all others sparkles surer, **How he glows and sparkles before all,**

Kein Ruf, kein Ruhm halt weiter stand; No name or fame beside him lives: **No reputation, no fame stands up to him;**

Selbst Faustus' Name wird verdunkelt, Even that of Faust has grown obscurer; **Even Faust's name is eclipsed,**

Er ist es, der allein erfand. 'Tis he alone invents and gives. **He's the one who invented everything.**

Famulus

Verzeiht, hochwürdiger Herr! wenn ich Euch sage, Pardon, most honoured Sir! if I am daring **Forgive me, reverend Sir, if I tell you,**

Wenn ich zu widersprechen wage: To contradict you, in declaring **If I dare to contradict:**

Von allem dem ist nicht die Frage; All that upon the subject has no bearing; **That's not what it's about at all;**

Bescheidenheit ist sein beschieden Teil. For modesty is his allotted part. **Modesty is his allotted share.**

Ins unbegreifliche Verschwinden The incomprehensible disappearing **He can't come to terms with**

Des hohen Manns weiss er sich nicht zu finden; Of that great man to him is most uncheering; **The incomprehensible disappearance of the great man;**

Von dessen Wiederkunft erfleht er Trost und Heil. From his return he hopes new strength and joy of heart. **He begs for comfort and salvation from his return.**

Das Zimmer, wie zu Doktor Faustus' Tagen, As in the days of Doctor Faust, the room, **This room, as in Doctor Faust's days,**

Noch unberührt seitdem er fern, Since he's away, all things unchanged, **Untouched since he's been gone,**

Erwartet seinen alten Herrn. Waits for its master, long estranged. **Awaits its old master.**

Kaum wag' ich's, mich hereinzuwagen. To venture in, I scarce presume. **I hardly dare venture in.**

Was muss die Sternenstunde sein? – What stars must govern now the skies! **What stellar hour must this be? –**

Gemauer scheint mir zu erbangen; It seemed as if the basements quivered; **The masonry seems to me to shudder;**

Turpfosten bebten, Riegel sprangen, The doorposts trembled, bolts were shivered: **Doorposts trembled, bolts sprang,**

Sonst kamt Ihr selber nicht herein. You had not entered, otherwise. **Otherwise you wouldn't have gotten in yourself.**

Mephistopheles

Wo hat der Mann sich hingetan? Where may his present dwelling be? **Where has the man taken himself off to?**

Führt mich zu ihm, bringt ihn heran! Lead me to him! Bring him to me! **Lead me to him, bring him here!**

Famulus

Ach! sein Verbot ist gar zu scharf, His prohibition is so keen! **Oh! His prohibition is far too strict,**

Ich weiss nicht, ob ich's wagen darf. I do not dare to intervene. **I don't know if I dare.**

Monatelang, des grossen Werkes willen, For months, his time unto the great work giving, **For months, for the sake of the great work,**

Lebt' er im allerstillsten Stillen. In most secluded silence he is living. **He's been living in the most silent silence.**

Der zarteste gelehrter Manner, The daintiest of distinguished learners, **The daintiest of learned men,**

Er sieht aus wie ein Kohlenbrenner, His face is like a charcoal-burner's, **He looks like a charcoal burner,**

Geschwarzt vom Ohre bis zur Nasen, From nose to ears all black and deadened; **Blackened from ear to nose,**

Die Augen rot vom Feuerblasen, His eyes from blowing flames are reddened: **Eyes red from blowing the fire,**

So lechzt er jedem Augenblick; Thus he, each moment, pants and longs, **Thus he gasps every moment;**

Geklirr der Zange gibt Musik. And music make the clattering tongs. **The clanging of tongs makes his music.**

Mephistopheles

Sollt' er den Zutritt mir verneinen? An entrance why should he deny me? **Should he deny me entry?**

Ich bin der Mann, das Gluck ihm zu beschleunen. I'll expedite his luck, if he'll but try me! **I'm the man to speed up his luck.**

Kaum hab' ich Posto hier gefasst, Scarce have I taken my position here, **Scarcely have I taken my post here,**

Regt sich dort hinten, mir bekannt, ein Gast. When there, behind, I see a guest appear. **When there in back, known to me, a guest stirs.**

Doch diesmal ist er von den Neusten, I know him; he is of the school new-founded, **But this time he's one of the newest sort,**

Er wird sich grenzenlos erdreusten. And his presumption will be quite unbounded. **He'll presume himself beyond all bounds.**

Baccalaureus

Tor und Türe find' ich offen! Doors and entrances are open! **Gate and door I find open!**

Nun, da lasst sich endlich hoffen, Well, –at last there's ground for hoping **Now at last there's hope**

Dass nicht, wie bisher, im Moder That no more, in mouldy lumber, **That no longer, as before, in the mold**

Der Lebendige wie ein Toter Death-like, doth the Living slumber, **The living like a dead man**

Sich verkummere, sich verderbe To himself privations giving, **Withers and rots**

Und am Leben selber sterbe. Till he dies of very living! **And dies of life itself.**

Diese Mauern, diese Wände All this masonry, I'm thinking, **These walls, these partitions**

Neigen, senken sich zum Ende, To its overthrow is sinking; **Lean, sink toward their end,**

Und wenn wir nicht bald entweichen, And, unless at once we hurry, **And if we don't soon escape,**

Wird uns Fall und Sturz erreichen. Us will crash and ruin bury. **Collapse and crash will catch us.**

Bin verwegen, wie nicht einer, Daring though I be, 'twere murder **I'm bold as nobody else,**

Aber weiter bringt mich keiner. Should I dare to venture further. **But nobody's taking me further.**

Doch was soll ich heut erfahren! What is that I see before me? **But what shall I experience today!**

War's nicht hier, vor so viel Jahren, Here, (what years have since rolled o'er me!) **Wasn't it here, so many years ago,**

Wo ich, angstlich und beklommen, Shy and unsophisticated, **Where I, anxious and oppressed,**

War als guter Fuchs gekommen? I as honest freshman waited; **Came as a good freshman?**

Wo ich diesen Bartigen traute, Here I let the gray-beards guide me, **Where I trusted these bearded ones,**

Mich an ihrem Schnack erbaute? Here their babble edified me! **Edified myself on their chatter?**

Aus den alten Bucherkrusten Out of dry old volumes preaching, **From the old book-crusts**

Logen sie mir, was sie wussten, What they knew, they lied in teaching; **They lied to me whatever they**

knew,

Was sie wussten, selbst nicht glaubten, What they
knew, themselves believed not, **What they knew,
themselves didn't believe,**

Sich und mir das Leben raubten. Stealing life, that
years retrieved not. **Robbed themselves and me of
life.**

Wie? – Dort hinten in der Zelle What!–in yonder cell
benighted **What? – There in back in the cell**

Sitzt noch einer dunkel-helle! One still sits, obscurely
lighted! **One more sits, obscurely bright!**

Nahend seh' ich's mit Erstaunen, Nearer now, I see,
astounded, **Approaching, I see with amazement,**

Sitzt er noch im Pelz, dem braunen, Still he sits, with
furs surrounded,– **He still sits in the fur, the brown
one,**

Wahrlich, wie ich ihn verliess, Truly, as I saw him last,
Truly, as I left him,

Noch gehüllt im rauhen Vlies! Roughest fleeces round
him cast! **Still wrapped in the rough fleece!**

Damals schien er zwar gewandt, Then adroit he
seemed to be, **Back then he seemed clever
enough,**

Als ich ihn noch nicht verstand. Not yet understood
by me: **When I didn't yet understand him.**

Heute wird es nichts verfangen, But to-day 'twill

naught avail him– **Today it won't amount to anything,**

Frisch an ihn herangegangen! O, I'll neither fear nor fail him! **Fresh up to him!**

Wenn, alter Herr, nicht Lethes trube Fluten If, ancient Sir, that bald head, sideways bending, **If, old sir, Lethe's murky floods**

Das schiefgesenkte, kahle Haupt durchschwommen, Hath not been dipped in Lethe's river cold, **Haven't swum through that sideways-bent bald head,**

Seht anerkennend hier den Schuler kommen, See, hitherward, your grateful scholar wending, **See the student come here with recognition,**

Entwachsen akademischen Ruten. Outgrown the academic rods of old. **Outgrown the academic rods.**

Ich find' Euch noch, wie ich Euch sah; You're here, as then when I began; **I find you still, as I saw you;**

Ein anderer bin ich wieder da. But I am now another man. **A different one I am again here.**

Mephistopheles

Mich freut, dass ich Euch hergelaetet. I'm glad my bell your visit brought me. **I'm glad that I rang you here.**

Ich schätzt' Euch damals nicht gering; Your talents, then, I rated high; **I didn't rate you poorly back then;**

Die Raupe schon, die Chrysalide deutet The worm,
the chrysalid soon taught me **The caterpillar, the
chrysalis already suggested**

Den künftigen bunten Schmetterling. The future brilliant butterfly. **The future colorful butterfly.**

Am Lockenkopf und Spitzenkragen Your curly locks
and ruffle-laces **In your curly head and lace collar**

Empfandet Ihr ein kindliches Behagen. – A childish
pleasure gave; you wooed the graces. **You felt a
childish pleasure. –**

Ihr trugt wohl niemals einen Zopf? – A queue, I think,
you've never worn? **You probably never wore a
queue? –**

Heut schau' ich Euch im Schwedenkopf. But now
your head is cropped and shorn. **Today I see you in
a Swedish crop.**

Ganz resolut und wacker seht Ihr aus; Quite bold and
resolute you appear, **Quite resolute and brave you
look;**

Kommt nur nicht absolut nach Haus. But don't go, absolute,
home from here! **Just don't come home absolute.**

Baccalaureus

Und sparet doppelsinnige Worte; Old master, in your
old place leaning, **Old sir, we are in the old places,**

Wir passen nun ganz anders auf. Think how the time has sped, the while! **Consider how time has flown,**

Ihr hantseltet den guten treuen Jungen; Spare me your words of double meaning! **And spare the double-meaning words;**

Das ist Euch ohne Kunst gelungen, We take them now in quite another style. **We're paying attention quite differently now.**

Was heutzutage niemand wagt. You teased and vexed the honest youth; **You jerked around the good trusting boy;**

Mephistopheles

Wenn man der Jugend reine Wahrheit sagt, You found it easy then, in truth, **That worked for you effortlessly,**

Die gelben Schnabeln keineswegs behagt, If to the young the simple truth we say, **What no one dares today.**

Sie aber hinterdrein nach Jahren The green ones find it nowise pleasant play; **When one tells youth the pure truth,**

Das alles derb an eigner Haut erfahren, But afterwards, when years are over, **It doesn't suit the yellow beaks at all,**

Dann dunkeln sie, es kam' aus eigenem Schopf; And they the truth through their own hide discover, **But afterwards when years have passed**

Da heisst es denn: der Meister war ein Tropf. Then they conceive, themselves have found it out: **They experience it all harshly on their own hide,**

Baccalaureus

Ein Schelm vielleicht! – denn welcher Lehrer spricht “The master was a fool!” one hears them shout. **Then they think it came from their own head;**

Die Wahrheit uns direkt ins Angesicht? A rogue, perhaps! What teacher will declare **Then it's called: the master was a fool.**

Ein jeder weiss zu mehrn wie zu mindern, The truth to us, exactly fair and square? **A rogue perhaps! – for what teacher speaks**

Bald ernst, bald heiter klug zu frommen Kindern. Each knows the way to lessen or exceed it, **The truth directly to our face?**

Mephistopheles

Zum Lernen gibt es freilich eine Zeit; Now stern, now lively, as the children need it. **Each one knows how to add and subtract,**

Zum Lehren seid Ihr, merk' ich, selbst bereit. Beyond a doubt, there is a time to learn; **Now serious, now cheerfully clever to pious children.**

Seit manchen Monden, einigen Sonnen But you are skilled to teach, I now discern. **For learning there's certainly a time;**

Erfahrungsfulle habt Ihr wohl gewonnen. Since many

a moon, some circles of the sun, **For teaching, I notice, you're already ready yourself.**

Baccalaureus

Erfahrungswesen! Schaum und Dust! The riches of experience you have won. **In several moons, some suns**

Und mit dem Geist nicht ebenbürtig. Experience! mist and froth alone! **You've surely won fullness of experience.**

Gesteht! was man von je gewusst, Nor with the mind at all coequal: **Experience-stuff! Foam and mist!**

Es ist durchaus nicht wissenswürdig. Confess, what one has always known **And not equal to the mind at all.**

Mephistopheles

Mich deucht es langst. Ich war ein Tor, Is not worth knowing, in the sequel! **Admit! What one has always known,**

Nun komm' ich mir recht schal und albern vor. It's long seemed so to me. I was a fool: **Is thoroughly not worth knowing.**

Baccalaureus

Das freut mich sehr! Da hor' ich doch Verstand; My shallowness I now must ridicule. **I've thought so for a long time. I was a fool,**

Der erste Greis, den ich vernunftig fand! I'm glad of

that! I hear some reason yet— **Now I seem quite stale and stupid to myself.**

Mephistopheles

Ich suchte nach verborgen-goldnem Schatze, The first old man of sense I ever met! **That pleases me very much! There I hear some sense;**

Und schauerliche Kohlen trug ich fort. I sought for hidden treasures, grand and golden, **The first old man I found reasonable!**

Baccalaureus

Gesteht nur, Euer Schadel, Eure Glatze And hideous coals and ashes were my share. **I searched for hidden golden treasure,**

Ist nicht mehr wert als jene hohlen dort? Confess that now your skull, though bald and olden, **And shuddering coals I carried away.**

Mephistopheles

Du weisst wohl nicht, mein Freund, wie grob du bist? Is worth no more than is yon empty, there! **Admit, your skull, your bald head**

Baccalaureus

Im Deutschen lugt man, wenn man hoflich ist. Knowst thou, my friend, how rude thou art to me? **Is worth no more than those hollow ones there?**

Mephistopheles

Hier oben wird mir Licht und Luft benommen; One lies, in German, would one courteous be. **You probably don't know, my friend, how rude you are?**

Ich finde wohl bei euch ein Unterkommen? Up here am I deprived of light and air: **In German one lies when one's polite.**

Baccalaureus

Anmasslich find' ich, dass zur schlechtesten Frist Shall I find shelter down among you there? **Up here light and air are taken from me;**

Man etwas sein will, wo man nichts mehr ist. It is presumptuous, that one will try **Will I find shelter with you down below?**

Des Menschen Leben lebt im Blut, und wo Still to be something, when the time's gone by. **I find it presumptuous that at the worst time**

Bewegt das Blut sich wie im Jungling so? Man's life lives in his blood, and where, in sooth, **One wants to be something when one is nothing more.**

Das ist lebendig Blut in frischer Kraft, So stirs the blood as in the veins of youth? **Man's life lives in the blood, and where**

Das neues Leben sich aus Leben schafft. There living blood in freshest power pulsates, **Does the blood move as in a young man?**

Da regt sich alles, da wird was getan, And newer life from its own life creates. **That is living blood in**

fresh strength,

Das Schwache fällt, das Tuchtige tritt heran. Then something's done, then moves and works the man, **That creates new life from life.**

Indessen wir die halbe Welt gewonnen, The weak fall out, the sturdy take the van. **There everything stirs, there something gets done,**

Was habt Ihr denn getan? genickt, gesonnen, While half the world beneath our yoke is brought, **The weak falls, the capable steps forward.**

Getraumt, erwogen, Plan und immer Plan. What, then, have you accomplished? Nodded-thought- **Meanwhile we've won half the world,**

Gewiss! das Alter ist ein kaltes Fieber Dreamed, and considered-plan, and always plan. **What have you done? Nodded, pondered,**

Im Frost von grillenhafter Not. Age is an ague-fever, it is clear, **Dreamed, weighed, plan and always plan.**

Hat einer dreissig Jahr vorüber, With chills of moody want and dreary. **Certainly! Old age is a cold fever**

So ist er schon so gut wie tot. When one has passed his thirtieth year **In the frost of whimsical misery.**

Am besten war's, euch zeitig totzuschlagen. One then is just the same as dead. **Once someone's past thirty,**

Mephistopheles

Der Teufel hat hier weiter nichts zu sagen. 'Twere best, betimes, to put you out o' the way. **He's already as good as dead.**

Baccalaureus

Wenn ich nicht will, so darf kein Teufel sein. The Devil, here, has nothing more to say. **Best would be to kill you off in time.**

Mephistopheles

Der Teufel stellt dir nachstens doch ein Bein. Save through my will, no Devil can there be. **The Devil has nothing more to say here.**

Baccalaureus

Dies ist der Jugend edelster Beruf! The Devil, though, will trip thee presently! **If I don't will it, no Devil may exist.**

Die Welt, sie war nicht, eh' ich sie erschuf; This is Youth's noblest calling and most fit! **The Devil will trip you up soon enough.**

Die Sonne fuhr' ich aus dem Meer herauf; The world was not, ere I created it; **This is youth's noblest calling!**

Mit mir begann der Mond des Wechsels Lauf; The sun I drew from out the orient sea; **The world, it wasn't there before I created it;**

Da schmuckte sich der Tag auf meinen Wegen, The moon began her changeful course with me, **The sun I led up from the sea;**

Die Erde grunte, blühte mir entgegen. The Day put on his shining robes, to greet me; **With me the moon began its changing course;**

Auf meinen Wink, in jener ersten Nacht, The Earth grew green, and burst in flower to meet me, **Then day adorned itself on my paths,**

Entfaltete sich aller Sterne Pracht. And when I beckoned, from the primal night **The earth grew green, bloomed toward me.**

Wer, ausser mir, entband euch aller Schranken The stars unveiled their splendours to my sight. **At my signal, in that first night,**

Philisterhaft einklemmender Gedanken? Who, save myself, to you deliverance brought **All the stars' splendor unfolded.**

Ich aber frei, wie mir's im Geiste spricht, From commonplaces of restricted thought? **Who, besides me, freed you from all barriers**

Verfolge froh mein innerliches Licht, I, proud and free, even as dictates my mind, **Of philistinely confining thoughts?**

Und wandle rasch, im eigensten Entzucken, Follow with joy the inward light I find, **But I, free, as my spirit speaks to me,**

Das Helle vor mir, Finsternis im Rücken. And speed along, in mine own ecstasy, **Follow joyfully my inner light,**

Mephistopheles

Original, fahr hin in deiner Pracht! – Darkness behind,
the Glory leading me! **And walk swiftly, in my own
rapture,**

Wie wurde dich die Einsicht kränken: Go hence, mag-
nificent Original!– **Brightness before me, darkness
at my back.**

Wer kann was Dummes, wer was Kluges denken,
What grief on thee would insight cast! **Original, go
forth in your splendor! –**

Das nicht die Vorwelt schon gedacht? – Who can think
wise or stupid things at all, **How the insight would
pain you:**

Doch sind wir auch mit diesem nicht gefährdet, That
were not thought already in the Past? **Who can think
anything stupid, anything clever,**

In wenig Jahren wird es anders sein: Yet even from
him we're not in special peril; **That the past hasn't
already thought? –**

Wenn sich der Most auch ganz absurd gebardet, He
will, ere long, to other thoughts incline: **But with this
one we're also not endangered,**

Es gibt zuletzt doch noch e' Wein. The must may foam
absurdly in the barrel, **In a few years it will be dif-
ferent:**

Bedenkt: der Teufel, der ist alt, Nathless it turns at last
to wine. **When the must behaves quite absurdly,**

So werdet alt, ihn zu verstehen! Consider now, the Devil's old; **It still ends up as wine.**

To understand him, be old also!

Laboratorium / Laboratory

Wagner (am Herde / at the furnace)

Die Glocke tont, die furchterliche, The loud bell
chimes with fearful clangour, **Scary bell!**

Durchschauert die berussten Mauern. The sooty
walls feel the vibration; **Walls shudder!**

Nicht langer kann das Ungewisse Soon must the long
suspense be ended **Suspense killing!**

Der ernstesten Erwartung dauern. Of my most
earnest expectation. **Can't wait!**

Schon hellen sich die Finsternisse; It shines, the dark-
nesses are rended: **Getting bright!**

Schon in der innersten Phiole Within the phial's
inmost chamber **Deep inside!**

Ergluht es wie lebendige Kohle, It gleams, as doth a living ember,– **Glowing hot!**

Ja wie der herrlichste Karfunkel, Yea, a carbuncle, burning, bright'ning, **Finest gem!**

Verstrahlend Blitze durch das Dunkel. It rays the darkness with its lightning. **Lightning flash!**

Ein helles weisses Licht erscheint! Now white and clear the lustres blend! **White light!**

O dass ich's diesmal nicht verliere! – O that I hold, nor lose it more! **Don't lose it!**

Ach Gott! was rasselt an der Türe? Ah, God! what rattles at the door? **Who's there?**

Mephistopheles

Willkommen! es ist gut gemeint. Welcome! I mean it as a friend. **Friendly visit!**

Wagner

Willkommen zu dem Stern der Stunde! Be welcome to the planet of the hour! **Perfect time!**

Doch haltet Wort und Atem fest im Munde, Yet breath and speech suspend! A work of power, **Shh!**

Ein herrlich Werk ist gleich zustand gebracht. A splendid work, will soon be here displayed. **Almost done!**

Mephistopheles

Was gibt es denn? – What is it, then? **What's up?**

Wagner

Es wird ein Mensch gemacht. A man is being made.

Making man!

Mephistopheles

Ein Mensch? Und welch verliebtes Paar A man? And what enamoured pair **Human? Who fucked?**

Habt ihr ins Rauchloch eingeschlossen? Have you within the chimney hidden? **Chimney couple?**

Wagner

Der zarte Punkt, aus dem das Leben sprang, Nay, God forbid! This procreation is most rare: **Old way? No!**

Die holde Kraft, die aus dem Innern drang Of the old, senseless mode we're now well ridden. **Nonsense now!**

Und nahm und gab, bestimmt sich selbst zu zeichnen, The tender point, whence Life commenced its course, **Life's start!**

Erst Nachstes, dann sich Fremdes anzueignen, The outward stress of gracious inward force, **Inner force!**

Die ist von ihrer Würde nun entsetzt; Which took and gave, itself delineating, **Shape itself!**

Wenn sich das Tier noch weiter dran ergetzt, First near, then foreign traits assimilating, **Near then far!**

So muss der Mensch mit seinen grossen Gaben We
now of all its dignity divest: **Dignity gone!**

Doch kunftig hohern, hohern Ursprung haben. The
beast therein may further find a zest, **Beasts can!**

Es leuchtet! seht! – Nun lasst sich wirklich hoffen, But
Man must learn, with his great gifts, to win **Humans
though!**

Dass, wenn wir aus viel hundert Stoffen Henceforth a
purer, loftier origin. **Higher source!**

Durch Mischung – denn auf Mischung kommt es an – It
brightens, –see! Sure, now, my hopes increase **Shin-
ing! Hope!**

Den Menschenstoff gemachlich komponieren, That if,
from many hundred substances, **Many parts!**

In einen Kolben verlutieren Through mixture –since
on mixture all depends – **Mixing key!**

Und ihn gehorig kohobieren, The human substance
gently be compounded, **Mix human!**

So ist das Werk im stillen abgetan. And by a closed
retort surrounded, **Seal it!**

Es wird! die Masse regt sich klarer! Distilled, and fed,
and slowly founded, **Distill right!**

Die Überzeugung wahrer, wahrer: Then in success the
secret labour ends. **Done quiet!**

Was man an der Natur Geheimnisvolles pries, 'Twill
be! the mass is working clearer! **It's working!**

Das wagen wir verständig zu probieren, Conviction
gathers, truer, nearer! **More sure!**

Und was sie sonst organisieren liess, The mystery
which for Man in Nature lies **Nature's secret!**

Das lassen wir kristallisieren. We dare to test, by
knowledge led; **Dare test!**

Mephistopheles

Wer lange lebt, hat viel erfahren, And that which she
was wont to organise **She organized!**

Nichts Neues kann fur ihn auf dieser Welt geschehn.
We crystallise, instead. **We crystallize!**

Ich habe schon in meinen Wanderjahren Who lives,
learns many secrets to unravel; **Long life!**

Kristallisiertes Menschengeschlecht. For him, upon
this earth, there's nothing new can be. **Nothing new!**

Wagner

Es steigt, es blitzt, es haucht sich an, I've seen already,
in my years of travel, **Seen before!**

Im Augenblick ist es getan. Much crystallised human-
ity. **Crystal people!**

Ein grosser Vorsatz scheint im Anfang toll; It mounts,
it lightens, grows, -'tis won! **Rising! Flashing!**

Doch wollen wir des Zufalls kunftig lachen, A moment
more, and it is done! **Almost done!**

Und so ein Hirn, das trefflich denken soll, Insane, at first, appears a great intent; **Seems crazy!**

Wird kunftig auch ein Denker machen. We yet shall laugh at chance in generation; **Laugh at chance!**

Das Glas erklingt von lieblicher Gewalt, A brain like this, for genuine thinking meant, **Thinking brain!**

Es trubt, es klart sich; also muss es werden! Will henceforth be a thinker's sure creation. **Thinker makes!**

Ich seh' in zierlicher Gestalt The glass vibrates with sweet and powerful tone; **Glass sings!**

Ein artig Mannlein sich gebarden. It darkens, clears: it must arrive at being! **Clouding! Clearing!**

Was wollen wir, was will die Welt nun mehr? And now in delicate shape is shown **Dainty form!**

Denn das Geheimnis liegt am Tage. A pretty mannikin, moving, living, seeing! **Little man!**

Gebt diesem Laute nur Gehor, What more can we, what more the world demand? **Want more?**

Er wird zur Stimme, wird zur Sprache. The secret, solved, all men may reach: **Secret's out!**

Homunculus (in der Phiole / in the phial)

Nun Vaterchen! wie steht's? es war kein Scherz. Hark! as the ringing tones expand, **Listen up!**

Komm, drucke mich recht zartlich an dein Herz! They form a voice, result in speech. **Voice! Speech!**

Doch nicht zu fest, damit das Glas nicht springe. How goes it, Daddy? It was then no jest! **Hi Dad! Real!**

Das ist die Eigenschaft der Dinge: Come, press me tenderly upon thy breast! **Hug me!**

Natürlichem genügt das Weltall kaum, But not too hard, for fear the glass might shatter! **Don't break!**

Was künstlich ist, verlangt geschlossnen Raum. This is the quality of matter: **Thing is:**

Du aber, Schalk, Herr Vetter, bist du hier For what is natural, scarce the world has place; **Nature needs space!**

Im rechten Augenblick? ich danke dir. What's artificial, needs restricted space. **I need container!**

Ein gut Geschick fuhr dich zu uns herein; Thou rogue, Sir Cousin! here I find thee, too? **Hey Cousin!**

Dieweil ich bin, muss ich auch tatig sein. And at the proper time! My thanks are due: **Thanks!**

Ich mochte mich sogleich zur Arbeit schurzen. A lucky fortune led thee here to me; **Lucky arrival!**

Du bist gewandt, die Wege mir zu kurzen. Since I exist, then I must active be. **Exist = act!**

Wagner

Nur noch ein Wort! Bisher musst' ich mich schamen, I'd fain begin my work without delay: **Want work!**

Denn alt und jung besturmt mich mit Problemen.
Thou art adroit in shortening my way. **You know shortcuts!**

Zum Beispiel nur: noch niemand konnt' es fassen, But
first, a word! I'm shamed that answers fail me; **One question!**

Wie Seel' und Leib so schon zusammenpassen, For
old and young with problems so assail me. **Everyone asks!**

So fest sich halten, als um nie zu scheiden, Now, for
example, none e'er comprehended **For example:**

Und doch den Tag sich immerfort verleiden. How soul
and body wedded are and blended, – **Soul and body?**

Sodann – – Hold fast, as if defying separation, **So tight!**

Mephistopheles

Halt ein! ich wollte lieber fragen: Yet never cease their
mutual irritation. **Yet fight!**

Warum sich Mann und Frau so schlecht vertragen?
Therefore – **Then –**

Du kommst, mein Freund, hieruber nie ins reine. De-
sist! I'd rather ask him why **Better question!**

Hier gibt's zu tun, das eben will der Kleine. The man
and wife agree so wretchedly. **Why marriage hard?**

Homunculus

Was gibt's zu tun? – To thee, my friend, the thing will
ne'er be clear: **Never solve!**

Mephistopheles

Hier zeige deine Gabe! There's work to do: for that
the little fellow's here. **Work here!**

Wagner

Furwahr, du bist ein allerliebster Knabe! What's to be
done? **What job?**

Homunculus (erstaunt / astonished)

Bedeutend! – – Thy talents here employ! **Show gift!**

Schon umgeben! – Klar Gewasser Forsooth, thou art
the very loveliest boy! **Cutest boy!**

Im dichten Haine! Fraun, die sich entkleiden,
Significant!– **Whoa!**

Die allerliebsten! – Das wird immer besser. Fair
scenery!–Waters, moving **Surrounded! Water!**

Doch eine lasst sich glanzend unterscheiden, In forest
shadows: women there, undressing. **Forest! Naked
women!**

Aus höchstem Helden-, wohl aus Gotterstamme. The
loveliest forms!–the picture is improving. **Hotter!
Better!**

Sie setzt den Fuss in das durchsichtige Helle; One,
marked by beauty, splendidly expressing **One stands**

out!

Des edlen Körpers holde Lebensflamme Descent
from Gods or high heroic races, **Divine blood!**

Kühlt sich im schmiegsamen Kristall der Welle. – Now
dips her foot in the translucent shimmer: **Foot in wa-
ter!**

Doch welch Getöse rasch bewegter Flügel, The living
flame of her sweet form displaces **Sweet flame!**

Welch Sausen, Platschern wuhlt im glatten Spiegel?
The yielding crystal, cool around the swimmer. **Cools
in waves!**

Die Mädchen fliehn verschuchtert; doch allein But
what a sound of wings! What rapid dashing **Wings!**

Die Königin, sie blickt gelassen drein Across the glassy
pool, what fluttering, splashing! **Splash!**

Und sieht mit stolzem weiblichem Vergnügen The
maidens fly, alarmed; but only she, **Girls flee! One
stays!**

Der Schwane Fürsten ihrem Knie sich schmiegen, The
queen, looks on, composed and terror-free, **Queen
calm!**

Zudringlich-zahm. Er scheint sich zu gewöhnen. –
And sees with proud and womanly delight **Proud
pleasure!**

Auf einmal aber steigt ein Dunst empor The swan-
prince press her knee with plumage white, **Swan at
knee!**

Und deckt mit dichtgewebtem Flor Importunately
tame: he grows acquainted.– **Getting cozy!**

Die lieblichste von allen Szenen. But all at once floats
up a vapour pale, **Mist rises!**

Mephistopheles

Was du nicht alles zu erzählen hast! And covers with
its closely-woven veil **Haze covers!**

So klein du bist, so gross bist du Phantast. The loveliest
picture ever dreamed or painted. **Best scene gone!**

Ich sehe nichts – – How much hast thou to tell,–what
stories merry! **What stories!**

Homunculus

Das glaub' ich. Du aus Norden, So small thou art, so
great a visionary! **Big dreamer!**

Im Nebelalter jung geworden, Nothing see I!– **See nothing!**

Im Wust von Rittertum und Pfafferei, Of course. Thou,
from the North, **You're Northern!**

Wo ware da dein Auge frei! And in the age of mist
brought forth, **Fog age!**

Im Düstern bist du nur zu Hause. In knighthood's and
in priestcraft's murky den, **Knights and priests!**

Verbraunt Gestein, bemodert, widrig, How should thy
sight be clearer, then? **Can't see!**

Spitzbogig, schnorkelhaftest, niedrig! – In gloom
alone art thou at home. **Gloom home!**

Erwacht uns dieser, gibt es neue Not, Brown masonry,
repellent, crumbling slowly, **Old moldy!**

Er bleibt gleich auf der Stelle tot. Arch-pointed, finical,
fantastic, lowly!– **Tacky Gothic!**

Waldquellen, Schwane, nackte Schönen, If this man
wakes, another danger's nigh; **Don't wake!**

Das war sein ahnungsvoller Traum; At once upon the
spot he'll die. **Die here!**

Wie wollt' er sich hierher gewöhnen! Wood-fountains,
swans, and naked beauties, **Springs! Swans! Nudes!**

Ich, der Bequemste, duldt' es kaum. Such was his
dream of presage fair: **His dream!**

Nun fort mit ihm! – How should these dark surroundings
suit his **Can't adjust!**

Mephistopheles

Der Ausweg soll mich freuen. Desires, when them I
scarce can bear? **I barely stand!**

Homunculus

Befiehl den Krieger in die Schlacht, Away with him!
Take him away!

Das Mädchen führe du zum Reichen, I hail the issue's
chances. **What plan?**

So ist gleich alles abgemacht. Command the warrior
to the fight, **Warriors fight!**

Jetzt eben, wie ich schnell bedacht, Conduct the
maiden to the dances: **Girls dance!**

Ist klassische Walpurgisnacht; And all is finished, as is
right. **All settled!**

Das Beste, was begegnen konnte. Just now–there
breaks on me a light– **Just thought!**

Bringt ihn zu seinem Elemente! 'Tis Classical
Walpurgis-Night; **Classic Walpurgis!**

Mephistopheles

Dergleichen hab' ich nie vernommen. Whate'er may
come, it is the best event, **Best luck!**

Homunculus

Wie wollt' es auch zu euren Ohren kommen? So bring
him to his proper element! **His element!**

Romantische Gespenster kennt ihr nur allein; The like
of that I never heard one mention. **Never heard!**

Ein echt Gespenst, auch klassisch hat's zu sein. How
should it have attracted your attention? **How would
you?**

Mephistopheles

Wohin denn aber soll die Fahrt sich regen? Only ro-
mantic ghosts are known to you; **Romantic ghosts!**

Mich widern schon antikische Kollegen. A genuine phantom must be classic too. **Classic ghosts!**

Homunculus

An grosser Flache fliesst Peneios frei, But whitherward shall then we travel, tell me! **Where go?**

Umbuscht, umbaumt, in still- und feuchten Buchten; Your antique cronies in advance repel me. **Antiques disgust!**

Die Ebne dehnt sich zu der Berge Schluchten, North-westwards, Satan, is thy park and pale, **Northwest yours!**

Und oben liegt Pharsalus, alt und neu. But we, this time, south-eastwards sail. **Southeast now!**

Mephistopheles

O weh! hinweg! und lasst mir jene Streite Peneus, there, the great plain wanders through, **Peneus flows!**

Von Tyrannei und Sklaverei beiseite. By thickets, groves, and silent coves, and meadow grasses; **Trees! Coves!**

Mich langeweilt's; denn kaum ist's abgetan, The level stretches to the mountain passes, **To mountains!**

So fangen sie von vorne wieder an; And o'er it lies Pharsalus, old and new. **Pharsalus!**

Und keiner merkt: er ist doch nur geneckt Alas! have done! Bring not that fell collision **No battles!**

Vom Asmodeus, der dahinter steckt. Of tyrant and of slave before my vision! **Skip slavery!**

Sie streiten sich, so heisst's, um Freiheitsrechte; I'm tired of that: for scarcely is it done **Boring!**

Genau besehn, sind's Knechte gegen Knechte. Than they the same thing have again begun; **Starts over!**

Homunculus

Den Menschen lass ihr widerspenstig Wesen, And no one marks that he's the puppet blind **Being played!**

Ein jeder muss sich wehren, wie er kann, Of sly Asmodi, lurking there behind. **Asmodeus tricks!**

Vom Knaben auf, so wird's zuletzt ein Mann. They fight, we're told, their freedom's right to save; **Freedom fight!**

Hier fragt sich's nur, wie dieser kann genesen. But, clearer seen, 'tis slave that fights with slave. **Slaves vs slaves!**

Hast du ein Mittel, so erprob' es hier, Leave unto men their fractiousness and clatter: **Let them!**

Vermagst du's nicht, so uberlass es mir. Each must protect himself, as best he can, **Defend self!**

Mephistopheles

Manch Brockenstuckchen ware durchzuproben, From boyhood up, and thus becomes a man. **Boys**

to men!

Doch Heidenriegel find' ich vorgeschoben. How this one shall recover, is our matter. **How heal him?**

Das Griechenvolk, es taugte nie recht viel! Hast thou a method, let it tested be! **Got cure?**

Doch blendet's euch mit freiem Sinnenspiel, But hast thou none, so leave the case to me! **I'll do it!**

Verlockt des Menschen Brust zu heitern Sunden; There's many a Brocken-method I might try, **Brocken tricks!**

Die unsern wird man immer duster finden. But pagan bolts, I find, the way deny. **Pagan blocks!**

Und nun, was soll's? – The Grecian race was little worth, alway; **Greeks worthless!**

Homunculus

Du bist ja sonst nicht blode; It dazzles with the senses' freer play, **Sexy dazzle!**

Und wenn ich von thessalischen Hexen rede, To cheerful sins the heart of man entices; **Happy sins!**

So denk' ich, hab' ich was gesagt. While ours are ever counted gloomy vices. **Gloomy sins!**

Mephistopheles

Thessalische Hexen! Wohl! das sind Personen, Now, what shall be? **What now?**

Nach denen hab' ich lang' gefragt. Shyness was ne'er
thy blame, **Not shy usually!**

Mit ihnen Nacht fur Nacht zu wohnen, When I to thee
Thessalian witches name, **Thessalian witches!**

Ich glaube nicht, dass es behagt; I've not said nothing,
that I know. **Said something!**

Doch zum Besuch, Versuch – – Thessalian witches!
Well! The persons, those, **Those witches!**

Homunculus

Den Mantel her, Whom I inquired for, long ago. **Long
sought!**

Und um den Ritter umgeschlagen! Night after night
beside them to repose, **Nightly visits!**

Der Lappen wird euch, wie bisher, I think would
hardly suit: but so, **Not pleasant!**

Den einen mit dem andern tragen; A mere espial,
trial,– **But visit!**

Ich leuchte vor. – Here! cast o'er **Get cloak!**

Wagner

Und ich? – The knight your magic mantle, and enfold
him! **Wrap him!**

Homunculus

Eh nun, The rag will still, as heretofore, **Rag carries!**

Du bleibst zu Hause, Wichtigstes zu tun. Upon his airy
course–and thine–uphold him. **Both together!**

Entfalte du die alten Pergamente, I'll light the way. **I'll light!**

Nach Vorschrift sammle Lebenselemente And I? **And me?**

Und fuge sie mit Vorsicht eins ans andre. Eh? You **Well...**

Das Was bedenke, mehr bedenke Wie. Will stay at home, most weighty work to do. **Stay home!**

Indessen ich ein Stuckchen Welt durchwandre, Unfold your ancient parchments, and collect **Old papers!**

Entdeck' ich wohl das Tupfchen auf das i. Life's elements as your recipes direct. **Follow recipe!**

Dann ist der grosse Zweck erreicht; One to the other with due caution fitting. **Careful mix!**

Solch einen Lohn verdient ein solches Streben: The What consider, more the How and Why! **How matters more!**

Gold, Ehre, Ruhm, gesundes langes Leben, Meanwhile, about the world at random flitting, **I'll roam!**

Und Wissenschaft und Tugend – auch vielleicht. I may detect the dot upon the "i." **Find the key!**

Leb wohl! – The lofty aim will then accomplished be; **Goal reached!**

Wagner

Leb wohl! Das druckt das Herz mir nieder. Such an endeavour merits such requital: **Deserved reward!**

Ich fürchte schon, ich seh' dich niemals wieder. Gold, honour, glory, healthy forces vital, **Gold! Fame! Life!**

Mephistopheles

Nun zum Peneios frisch hinab! And science, too, and virtue, –possibly. **Maybe virtue!**

Herr Vetter ist nicht zu verachten. Farewell! **Bye!**

Am Ende hangen wir doch ab Farewell! It doth depress my heart **Heart heavy!**

Von Kreaturen, die wir machten. I fear, already, we for ever part. **Fear forever!**

Down to Peneus, with his aid!

Sir Cousin is a deft attendant.

Upon the creatures we have made

We are, ourselves, at last, dependent.

Klassische Walpurgisnacht. Pharsalische Felder / Classical Walpurgis-Night

Erichtho

Zum Schauderfeste dieser Nacht, wie ofter schon,
To this night's awful festival, as oft before, **To this
night's dread festival, as I've done so often**

Tret' ich einher, Erichtho, ich, die dustere; I enter here,
Erichtho, I, the gloomy one: **I enter now - Erichtho,
me, the gloomy one**

Nicht so abscheulich, wie die leidigen Dichter mich
Not so atrocious as the evil poets draw, **Not quite so**

vile as the pathetic poets make me

Im Übermass verlastern... Endigen sie doch nie In
most superfluous slander—for they never cease **In
their over-the-top slander... they never quit**

In Lob und Tadel... Überbleicht erscheint mir schon
Their blame or praises... Over-whitened I behold
**With the blame or the praise... Bleached pale I
see**

Von grauer Zelten Woge weit das Tal dahin, The vale,
with waves of tents that glimmer gray afar, **The valley
already spread with waves of gray tents**

Als Nachgesicht der sorg- und grauenvollsten Nacht.
The after-vision of that fatal, fearful night. **An after-
image of the most dread and care-filled night**

Wie oft schon wiederholt' sich's! wird sich immerfort
How oft is it repeated!—will for ever be **How often
this repeats! Will keep on repeating**

Ins Ewige wiederholen... Keiner gönnt das Reich For
ever re-enacted! No one grants the realm **Forever
into eternity... No one grants the realm**

Dem andern; dem gönnt's keiner, der's mit Kraft er-
warb Unto another: unto him whose might achieved
**To another; none grants it to him who seized it by
force**

Und kraftig herrscht. Denn jeder, der sein innres
Selbst And rules it, none; for each, incompetent to
rule **And rules by force. Because everyone who
can't even**

Nicht zu regieren weiss, regierte gar zu gern His own
internal self, is all too fain to sway **Manage their own
damn self is way too eager**

Des Nachbars Willen, eignem stolzem Sinn gemass...
His neighbour's will, even as his haughty mind in-
clines. **To rule their neighbor's will, per their own
proud whims**

Hier aber ward ein grosses Beispiel durchgekämpft:
But here a lesson grand was battled to the end, **But
here a great example got fought to the end**

Wie sich Gewalt Gewaltigerem entgegenstellt, How
force resists and grapples with the greater force, **How
force opposes even greater force**

Der Freiheit holder, tausendblumiger Kranz zerreisst,
The lovely, thousand-blossomed wreath of Freedom
rends, **Freedom's lovely thousand-blossomed
wreath gets ripped apart**

Der starre Lorbeer sich ums Haupt des Herrschers
biegt. And bends the stubborn laurel round the
Ruler's brow. **The stiff laurel bends itself around
the Ruler's skull**

Hier traumte Magnus fruher Grosse Blutentag, Here,
of his days of early greatness Pompey dreamed:
**Here Magnus dreamed of his early greatness
bloom-day**

Dem schwanken Zunglein lauschend wachte Caesar
dort! Before the trembling balance Caesar yonder
watched! **Listening to the trembling balance-**

needle, Caesar woke over there!

Das wird sich messen. Weiss die Welt doch, wem's gelang. It will be weighed: the world knows unto whom it turned. **That will get weighed. The world knows who won**

Wachfeuer gluhen, rote Flammen spendende, The watch-fires flash and glow, spendthrift of ruddy flame; **Watch-fires glow, spilling red flames**

Der Boden haucht vergossnen Blutes Widerschein, Reflections of the squandered blood the earth exhales, **The ground exhales a sheen of spilled blood**

Und angelockt von seltnem Wunderglanz der Nacht, And, lured by rare and marvellous splendour of the night, **And lured by this night's rare miraculous glow**

Versammelt sich hellenischer Sage Legion. The legion of Hellenic legends gathers here. **The legion of Hellenic legend assembles here**

Um alle Feuer schwankt unsicher oder sitzt Round all the fires uncertain hover, or at ease **Around every fire, uncertain, hovering or sitting**

Behaglich alter Tage fabelhaft Gebild... Sit near them, fabulous forms of ancient days... **Comfortably: ancient days' fabulous shapes**

Der Mond, zwar unvollkommen, aber leuchtend hell, The moon, imperfect, truly, but of clearest beam, **The moon, imperfect granted, but bright and clear**

Erhebt sich, milden Glanz verbreitend uberall; Arises,
scattering mellow radiance everywhere: **Rises up,
spreading gentle glow everywhere**

Der Zelten Trug verschwindet, Feuer brennen blau.
Vanish the phantom tents, the fires are burning blue.
The phantom tents vanish, fires burn blue

Doch uber mir! welch unerwartet Meteor? But o'er
my head what unexpected meteor! **But over me!
What unexpected meteor!**

Es leuchtet und beleuchtet korperlichen Ball. It
shines, illuminates the sphere of earth below. **It
glows and illuminates a bodily sphere**

Ich wittre Leben. Da geziemen will mir's nicht, I scent
the Living! therefore it becomes me not **I smell living
flesh. Not fitting for me**

Lebendigem zu nahen, dem ich schadlich bin;
Them to approach, I being harmful unto them: **To
approach the living - I'm harmful to them**

Das bringt mir bosen Ruf und frommt mir nicht. An
evil name it brings me, and it profits naught. **That
just gives me bad press and profits nothing**

Schon sinkt es nieder. Weich' ich aus mit Wohlbe-
dacht! Already now it sinks: discreetly I withdraw.
Already sinking. I'll withdraw with discretion!

Die Luftfahrer oben / The Airy Travellers above

Homunculus

Schwebe noch einmal die Runde Once again the circle follow, **One more circle overhead**

Über Flamm- und Schaudergrauen; O'er the flames and horrors hover! **Over flames and horror-dread**

Ist es doch in Tal und Grunde Ghostly 'tis in vale and hollow, **Down in vale and hollow ground**

Gar gespenstisch anzuschauen. Spectral all that we discover. **Everything looks ghost-like all around**

Mephistopheles

Seh' ich, wie durchs alte Fenster If, as through my window nightly **Just like through my old window pane**

In des Nordens Wust und Graus, In the gruesome North, I see **In the North's waste of disgust and pain**

Ganz abscheuliche Gespenster, Spectres hideous and unsightly, **Completely loathsome spectres loom**

Bin ich hier wie dort zu Haus. Here is home, as there, to me. **I'm home here like I'm home in my room**

Homunculus

Sieh! da schreitet eine Lange See! a tall one there is striding **Look! A tall one striding there**

Weiten Schrittes vor uns hin. On before us, in the shade. **Long steps out ahead of us in the air**

Mephistopheles

Ist es doch, als war' ihr bange; Through the air she saw
us gliding, **She seems frightened, I'd presume**

Sah uns durch die Luft ziehn. And it seems she is
afraid. **Saw us gliding through the gloom**

Homunculus

Lass sie schreiten! setz ihn nieder, Let her stride!
The knight be taken **Let her stride! Set down your knight**

Deinen Ritter, und sogleich Now, and set upon the
strand: **And the moment he touches soil just right**

Kehret ihm das Leben wieder, Here to life again he'll
waken, **Life will return to him again**

Denn er sucht's im Fabelreich. Seeking it in fable-
land. **He seeks it in Fable's domain**

Faust (die Erde beruhrend / as he touches the earth)

Wo ist sie?– Where is she?– **Where is she?–**

Homunculus

Wussten's nicht zu sagen, It's more than we can tell.
But here you can probably ask around with care

Doch hier wahrscheinlich zu erfragen. But to inquire
would here be well. **Before dawn breaks, in haste you may**

In Eile magst du, eh' es tagt, Thou'rt free to hasten, ere
the day, **Go tracking flame to flame your way**

Von Flamm' zu Flamme spurend gehen: From flame to flame, and seek her so: **Who dared to reach the Mothers' throne**

Wer zu den Müttern sich gewagt, Who to the Mothers found his way, **Has nothing more to face alone**

Hat weiter nichts zu überstehen. Has nothing more to undergo. **I too am here and claim my share**

Mephistopheles

Auch ich bin hier am Platze; I also claim my share in the excursion: **But knew no better plan to declare**

Doch wusst' ich nichts Bessres zu unserm Besten, Yet know no better plan for our diversion, **Than this: each one among these fires**

Als: jeder möge durch die Feuer Than that each one, amid these fires, **Should test out his own adventures and desires**

Versuchen sich sein eigen Abenteuer. Should seek such fortunes as he most desires. **Then, to unite us once again**

Dann, um uns wieder zu vereinen, Then, as a sign to reunite us, **Let your lantern sound and shine, little friend!**

Lass deine Leuchte, Kleiner, tonend scheinen. Let, little one, thy lantern sound and light us! **So shall it flash and shall it ring!**

Homunculus

So soll es blitzen, soll es klingen. Thus shall it shine,
and thus shall ring! **Now - fresh! - to new and wondrous things!**

Nun frisch zu neuen Wunderdingen! And now, away
to many a marvellous thing! **Where is she? - Don't ask further now...**

Faust (allein / alone)

Wo ist sie?– Frage jetzt nicht weiter nach... Where is she?–But no further question make! **If this wasn't the very soil that bore her somehow**

War's nicht die Scholle, die sie trug, If this were not the soil that bore her feet, **The wave that surged up when she came**

Die Welle nicht, die ihr entgegenschlug, If not the wave that to her coming beat, **Then it's the air that speaks her tongue just the same**

So ist's die Luft, die ihre Sprache sprach. Yet 'tis the air that knows the tongue she spake. **Here! By miracle, here in Greece!**

Hier! durch ein Wunder, hier in Griechenland! Here, by a marvel! Here, on Grecian land! **I felt the ground instantly beneath my feet**

Ich fühlte gleich den Boden, wo ich stand; I felt at once the earth whereon I stand. **Fresh spirit glowed through me while I slept**

Wie mich, den Schlafer, frisch ein Geist durchgluhte,
Through me, the sleeper, fresher spirit stealing, **I rise
now, an Antaeus in my soul's depth**

So steh' ich, ein Antaus an Gemute. I rise refreshed,
Antaeus in my feeling. **And if I find the strangest
things assembled here**

Und find' ich hier das Seltsamste beisammen, To-
gether here I find the strangest store; **I'll probe this
labyrinth of flames without fear**

Durchforsch' ich ernst dies Labyrinth der Flammen.
Let me this labyrinth of flames explore.

Am oberen Peneios / On the Upper Peneus

Mephistopheles (umherspürend / prying around)

Und wie ich diese Feuerchen durchschweife, And as among these fires I wander, aimless, **And as I wander through these little fires**

So find' ich mich doch ganz und gar entfremdet, I find myself so strange, so disconcerted: **I cruise through bonfire vibes like a lost tourist**

Fast alles nackt, nur hie und da behemdet: Quite naked most, a few are only shirted; **My flesh wanders through heat-flickers, seeking**

Die Sphinxen schamlos, unverschamt die Greife, The Griffins insolent, the Sphinxes shameless, **Scrolling through campfires on Night TikTok**

Und was nicht alles, lockig und beflügelt, And what not all, with pinions and with tresses, **And swishing**

past these slutty little flames

Von vorn und hinten sich im Auge spiegelt... Before,
behind, upon one's eyesight presses!– **Fire-hopping
and completely out of my element**

Zwar sind auch wir von Herzen unanständig, Indecency,
'tis true, is our ideal, **I find myself completely
alienated**

Doch das Antike find' ich zu lebendig; But the Antique
is too alive and real; **I'm totally weirded out,
if we're being real**

Das musste man mit neustem Sinn bemeistern One
must with modern thought the thing bemaster, **My
skin crawls with strangeness, goosebumps rising**

Und mannigfaltig modisch überkleistern... And in the
fashion variously o'erplaster:– **Like a goth at a beach
party**

Ein widrig Volk! Doch darf mich's nicht verdriessen,
Disgusting race! Yet I, perforce, must meet them,
Feeling foreign in my own filthy skin

Als neuer Gast anständig sie zu grüssen... And as new
guest with due decorum greet them.– **Not my circus,
not my extremely naked monkeys**

Glück zu den schönen Fraun, den klugen Greisen!
Hail, then, Fair Ladies! Gray-beards wise, good cheer!
Nearly all naked, here and there just shirted

Greif (schnarrend / snarling)

Nicht Greisen! Greifen! – Niemand hort es gern,
Not gray-beards! Gray-beards? No one likes to hear
Everyone's basically nude—a few have shirts

Dass man ihn Greis nennt. Jedem Worte klingt One
call him gray. For in each word there rings **Bare flesh
everywhere, occasional cloth teasing**

Der Ursprung nach, wo es sich her bedingt: The
source, wherefrom its derivation springs. **Dress
code: birthday suit, accessories optional**

Grau, gramlich, griesgram, greulich, Graber, grimmig,
Gray, growling, gruesome, grinning, graves, and
grimly, **Mostly naked meat, the odd shirt-tease**

Etymologisch gleicherweise stimmig, – Etymologi-
cally accord, nor dimly, **Nudity wall-to-wall with
sporadic laundry**

Verstimmen uns. And make us grim. **The Sphinxes
shameless, the Griffins brazen**

Mephistopheles

Und doch, nicht abzuschweifen, And yet, why need
you stiffen? **Sphinxes have zero shame, Griffins
even less**

Gefallt das Grei im Ehrentitel Greifen. You like the grip
in your proud title, "Griffin." **Cat-bodies lounging
exposed, eagle-lions preening**

Greif

Natürlich! Die Verwandtschaft ist erprobt, Of course!

for this relation is found fit; **Mythical beasts with exactly zero modesty settings**

Zwar oft gescholten, mehr jedoch gelobt; Though often censured, oftener praised was it. **Shameless pussy-cats, brazen bird-cocks**

Man greife nun nach Mädchen, Kronen, Gold, Let one but grip at maidens, crowns, and gold; **Sphinxes flaunting it, Griffins doubling down**

Dem Greifenden ist meist Fortuna hold. Fortune is gracious to the Griper bold. **And what else, curly-haired and winged**

Ameisen (von der kolossalen Art / of the colossal kind)

Ihr sprecht von Gold, wir hatten viel gesammelt, You speak of gold, much had ourselves collected; **Plus all this winged, curly-haired whatever**

In Fels- und Höhlen heimlich eingerammelt; In rocks and caverns secretly we trapped it: **Feathers brushing, ringlets bouncing, flesh on display**

Das Arimaspen-Volk hat's ausgespurt, The Arimaspean race our store detected,– **Curls and wings sprouting from aesthetic chaos**

Sie lachen dort, wie weit sie's weggeführt. They're laughing now, so far away they've snapped it. **Tresses and pinions—coming and going**

Greife

Wir wollen sie schon zum Gestandnis bringen. We soon shall force them to confess. **Hair! Wings! More creatures than a fever dream!**

Arimaspen

Nur nicht zur freien Jubelnacht. But not in this free night of jubilee. **Mirrors itself in my eyes, front and back**

Bis morgen ist's alles durchgebracht, Before the morrow, all will squandered be; **Reflected everywhere I look—front, back, all over**

Es wird uns diesmal wohl gelingen. This time our efforts will obtain success. **My eyes fill with bodies approaching, receding**

Mephistopheles (der sich zwischen die Sphinx gesetzt hat / who has seated himself between the Sphinxes)

Wie leicht und gern ich mich hierher gewöhne, How soon I feel familiar here, among you! **My retinas are absolutely polluted**

Denn ich verstehe Mann für Mann. I understand you, one and all. **Pressing against my eyeballs from every angle**

Sphinx

Wir hauchen unsre Geistertöne, Our spirit-tones, when we have sung you, **Visual assault, three-sixty degrees**

Und ihr verkörpert sie alsdann. Become, for you, material. **We too are indecent at heart, it's true**

Jetzt nenne dich, bis wir dich weiter kennen. Now name thyself, till we shall know thee better. **Look, we're also pretty indecent deep down**

Mephistopheles

Mit vielen Namen glaubt man mich zu nennen – With many names would men my nature fetter. **My own core pulses with impropriety**

Sind Briten hier? Sie reisen sonst so viel, Are Britons here? So round the world they wheel, **Our brand of filth is perfectly respectable**

Schlachtfeldern nachzuspüren, Wasserfallen, To stare at battle-fields, historic traces, **Sure, I love a good dirty deed myself**

Gesturzten Mauern, klassisch dumpfen Stellen; Cascades, old walls, and classic dreary places; **Glass houses, stone-throwing, etc.**

Das wäre hier für sie ein würdig Ziel. And here were something worthy of their zeal. **But the Antique I find too lively**

Sie zeugten auch: Im alten Bühnenspiel Their Old Plays also testify of me; **But this ancient stuff is way too much**

Sah man mich dort als old Iniquity. Men saw me there as "Old Iniquity." **This old flesh breathes too vigorously**

Sphinx

Wie kam man drauf? – How did they hit on that? **Classical nudity hits different when it moves**

Mephistopheles

Ich weiss es selbst nicht wie. I know not, verily. **But these antiques are too damn horny**

Sphinx

Mag sein! Hast du von Sternen einige Kunde? Perhaps! Hast thou in star-lore any power? **Vintage sleaze—somehow worse than modern sleaze**

Was sagst du zu der gegenwart'gen Stunde? What say'st thou of the aspects of the hour? **One must master it with modern sense**

Mephistopheles (hinaufschauend / looking up)

Stern schiesst nach Stern, beschnittner Mond scheint helle, Star shoots on star, the cloven moon doth ride
We'd need to modernize this whole situation

Und mir ist wohl an dieser trauten Stelle, In brilliance; in this place I'm satisfied: **The body craves contemporary coverings**

Ich warme mich an deinem Lowenfelle. I warm myself against thy lion's hide. **Time for a Renaissance of the Renaissance**

Hinauf sich zu versteigen, war' zum Schaden; It were a loss to rise from out these shades:– **Need to slap some clothes on these exhibitionists**

Gib Ratsel auf, gib allenfalls Scharaden. Propose enigmas, or at least charades! **Requires a complete aesthetic reboot**

Sphinx

Sprich nur dich selbst aus, wird schon Ratsel sein. Express thyself, and 'twill a riddle be. **And variously plaster over with fashion**

Versuch einmal, dich innigst aufzulösen: Try once thine own analysis: 'twere merry. **Cover it up with trendy layers**

“Dem frommen Manne notig wie dem bosen, “To both Devout and Wicked necessary: **Wrap this rawness in fashionable gauze**

Dem ein Plastron, aszetisch zu rapieren, To those, a breast-plate for ascetic fighting; **Apply couture like spackle to a crack**

Kumpan dem andern, Tolles zu vollfuhren, To these, boon-comrade, in their pranks uniting; **Slather it in stylish concealment**

Und beides nur, um Zeus zu amusieren.” And both amusing Zeus, the fun-delighting.” **Fashion-paste: apply liberally to antiquity**

Erster Greif (schnarrend / snarling)

Den mag ich nicht! – I like not him! **A disgusting folk!**
Yet I mustn't be annoyed

Zweiter Greif (starker schnarrend / snarling more gruffly)

Was will uns der? What will the fellow here? **Gross crowd! But I can't let it get to me**

Beide

Der Garstige gehoret nicht hierher! The Nasty One is not of us, 'tis clear! **My stomach turns, but I compose my features**

Mephistopheles (brutal / brutally)

Du glaubst vielleicht, des Gastes Nagel krauen
Think'st thou, perhaps, thy guest has nails to scratch,
Repulsive, yet I must remain a diplomat

Nicht auch so gut wie deine scharfen Klauen? That
with thy sharper talons cannot match? **Revolting
rabble—but hey, networking**

Versuch's einmal! – Just try it once! **Nasty bunch,
but manners matter**

Sphinx (gelinde / gently)

Du magst nur immer bleiben, Stay, shouldst thou find
it well; **To greet them properly as a new guest**

Wird dich's doch selbst aus unsrer Mitte treiben; But
from our ranks thou wilt thyself expel. **Gotta be po-
lite since I'm the newcomer**

In deinem Lande tust dir was zugute, In thine own
land thou'rt wont thyself to pamper, **I arrange my
body into courtesy**

Doch, irr' ich nicht, hier ist dir schlecht zumute. Yet here, I think, thy spirits feel a damper. **The new guy has to play nice**

Mephistopheles

Du bist recht appetitlich oben anzuschauen, Thine upper part entices; naught is fairer; **Put on my friendly face for the freaks**

Doch unten hin die Bestie macht mir Grauen. But, further down, the beast excites my terror. **Guest etiquette requires I pretend not to gag**

Sphinx

Du Falscher kommst zu deiner bitteren Busse, Bitter, False one, will be thy expiation; **Good luck to the fair ladies, the wise graybeards!**

Denn unsre Tatzen sind gesund; Our claws are sound and worthy proof, **Cheers to the hot ladies and wise old dudes!**

Dir mit verschrumpftem Pferdefusse But thou, with withered horse's-hoof, **I bow my head to beauty and age alike**

Behagt es nicht in unserem Bund. Art ill at ease in our association. **Salutations, babes and boomers!**

Mephistopheles

Wer sind die Vogel, in den Asten On yonder poplars by the river, **Hey there, sexy ladies and saggy elders!**

Des Pappelstromes hingewiegt? What are the birds
that swing above? **Here's to the MILFs and the
mentor-types!**

Sphinx

Gewahrt euch nur! Die Allerbesten Beware! The very
best that ever **Not graybeards! Griffins!—No one
wants to hear**

Hat solch ein Singsang schon besiegt. Existed, they
have lured to love. **Not GRAYbeards! GRIFFins! No-
body likes being called**

Sirenen

Horcht, wir kommen hier zu Scharen Ah, why vitiate
your senses, **The throat snarls at the syllable of
age**

Und in wohlgestimmten Tönen; Where those Ug-
linesses darken? **Autocorrect has failed you,
demon**

So geziemet es Sirenen. We, in crowds, come hither:
hearken **Not old men! We're GRIPPERS!**

Sphinx (sie verspottend, in derselben Melodie /
mocking them, in the same melody)

Notigt sie, herabzusteigen! How the accordant strain
commences, **Wrong G-word, idiot!**

Sie verbergen in den Zweigen Meet for Sirens' soft pre-
tences! **That he's called a graybeard. Every word**

echoes

Ihre garstigen Habichtskrallen, Let them to descend
be bidden! **Old. The word itself carries baggage**

Euch verderblich anzufallen, In the branches they
have hidden **Each sound rings backward to its
bitter root**

Wenn ihr euer Ohr verleiht. Hideous falcon-claws
they're wearing, **Gray has big grandpa energy and
we hate it**

Sirenen

Weg das Hassen! weg das Neiden! And you'll feel their
cruel tearing, **The word "gray" makes my feathers
droop**

Sammeln wir die klarsten Freuden, Once you lend
them willing ear. **"Graybeard" is basically a hate
crime**

Unterm Himmel ausgestreut! Banish hate and envy,
rather! **Its origin, from whence it was derived**

Auf dem Wasser, auf der Erde We the purest pleasures
gather **Back to where it came from, etymologi-
cally**

Sei's die heiterste Gebarde, Under Heaven's aus-
picious sphere! **Words carry ancestry in their
bones**

Die man dem Willkommen beut. On the earth and
on the ocean, **Linguistics has consequences, bro**

Mephistopheles

Das sind die saubern Neuigkeiten, We, with cheerful beckoning motion, **The root of the word reaches deep**

Wo aus der Kehle, von den Saiten Bid the wanderer welcome here. **Every syllable is a paper trail**

Ein Ton sich um den andern flicht. These are of novelties the neatest, **Gray, grumbling, grim, gruesome, graves, grisly**

Das Trallern ist bei mir verloren: Where from the throat and harp-string sweetest **Gray, grumpy, grimy, grim, graves, gross**

Es krabbelt wohl mir um die Ohren, The tones around each other twine. **Each G-word lands like a blow to aging flesh**

Allein zum Herzen dringt es nicht. They're lost on me, these tinkling trickles; **It's all G-words that sound like death**

Sphinx

Sprich nicht vom Herzen! das ist eitel; The sound my ear-drum pats and tickles, **Gray, growly, grave-y, gross, grim, grody**

Ein lederner verschrumpfter Beutel, But cannot reach this heart of mine. **A whole G-rated horror show**

Das passt dir eher zu Gesicht. Speak not of heart? Fool, so to call it! **Etymologically all harmonize**

Faust (herantretend / approaching)

Wie wunderbar! das Anschauen tut mir Gnüge, An old and wrinkled leathern wallet **They all sound the same, linguistically speaking**

Im Widerwartigen grosse, tuchtige Züge. Would better suit that face of thine. **The tongue trips through a graveyard of Gs**

Ich ahne schon ein gunstiges Geschick; How strange! I, satisfied, behold these creatures, – **The dictionary is ageist, confirmed**

Wohin versetzt mich dieser ernste Blick? In the Repulsive, grand and solid features: **All the same depressing vibe**

Vor solchen hat einst Odipus gestanden; A fate propitious I behold advance. **It's consonant persecution!**

Vor solchen krummte sich Ulyss in hanfnen Banden; Whither transports me now this solemn glance? **Put us out of tune**

Von solchen ward der höchste Schatz gespart, Once before these took Oedipus his stand: **Totally kills the mood**

Von diesen treu und ohne Fehl bewahrt. These made Ulysses writhe in hempen band: **Our bodies bristle at the sound**

Vom frischen Geiste fühl' ich mich durchdrungen; By

these the highest treasure was amassed: **Major buzzkill**

Gestalten gross, gross die Erinnerungen. By these 'twas held inviolate and fast: **Makes us limp with annoyance**

Mephistopheles

Sonst hattest du dergleichen weggeflucht, Fresh spirit fills me, face to face with these— **Instant attitude adjustment—downward**

Doch jetzo scheint es dir zu frommen; Grand are the Forms, and grand the Memories! **And yet, not to digress**

Denn wo man die Geliebte sucht, Once thou hadst cursed such crude antiques, **But anyway, not to change the subject**

Sind Ungeheuer selbst willkommen. But now, it seems, they've comfort given; **I pivot the conversation, tongue quick**

Faust (zu den Sphinxen / to the Sphinxes)

Ihr Frauenbilder musst mir Rede stehn: For when a man his sweetheart seeks, **Tangent avoided, back to my point**

Hat eins der Euren Helena gesehen? Welcome to him are monsters, even. **But enough about your feelings**

Sphinx

Wir reichen nicht hinauf zu ihren Tagen, Ye woman-forms, give ear, and say **Focus! I have a counter-argument!**

Die letztesten hat Herkules erschlagen. Hath one of you seen Helena? **You like the “grip” in your title “Griffin”**

Von Chiron konntest du’s erfragen; Before her day our line expired in Greece; **But you dig the “grip” in “Griffin,” right?**

Der sprengt herum in dieser Geisternacht; Our very last was slain by Hercules: **The word grips you, you who grip**

Wenn er dir steht, so hast du’s weit gebracht. Yet ask of Chiron, if thou please. **The grabby part you’re totally fine with**

Sirenen

Sollte dir’s doch auch nicht fehlen!... He gallops round throughout this ghostly night, **You love the grippy-grabby bit**

Wie Ulyss bei uns verweilte, And if he halt for thee, thy chance is bright. **Grasping: good. Graying: bad. Got it.**

Schmahend nicht voruebereilte, Thou art not to failure fated! **Naturally! The kinship is proven**

Wusst’ er vieles zu erzählen; How Ulysses, lingering, learned us, **Obviously! That connection’s legit**

Wurden alles dir vertrauen, Nor, regardless passing,
spurned us, **The blood knows its own syllables**

Wolltest du zu unsern Gauen Manifold hath he
narrated: **Family resemblance: confirmed**

Dich ans grüne Meer verfügen. All to thee shall be con-
fided, **We're definitely the grabbing type**

Sphinx

Lass dich, Edler, nicht betrogen. Seekest thou our
meads, divided **DNA test: 100% grip**

Statt dass Ulyss sich binden liess, By the dark-green
arms of Ocean. **Though often scolded, more often
praised**

Lass unsern guten Rat dich binden; Let not thyself
thus cheated be! **People complain, but mostly
they admire**

Kannst du den hohen Chiron finden, Not like Ulysses
bound,—but we **Criticism and praise both land on
our hides**

Erfährst du, was ich dir verhiess. Will with good coun-
sel thee environ: **Ratio'd but also praised**

Mephistopheles

Was krachzt vorbei mit Flugschlag? If thou canst
find the noble Chiron, **Haters and fans in equal
measure**

So schnell, dass man's nicht sehen mag, Thou'lt learn
what I have promised thee. **Mixed reviews, trend-
ing positive**

Und immer eins dem andern nach, What croaks and
flaps of wings go past! **One may grip at maidens,
crowns, gold**

Den Jager wurden sie ermuden. One cannot see, they
fly so fast, **Go ahead, grab girls, crowns, treasure**

Sphinx

Dem Sturm des Winterwinds vergleichbar, In single
file, from first to last: **Hands reach for soft flesh,
cold metal, gleaming**

Alcides' Pfeilen kaum erreichbar; A hunter would
grow tired of these. **Groping your way to success
since forever**

Es sind die raschen Stymphaliden, The storm-wind
like, that winter harrows, **Snatch the babes, the
bling, the bank**

Und wohlgemeint ihr Krachzegruss, Reached hardly
by Alcides' arrows, **Girls! Crowns! Gold! The holy
trinity!**

Mit Geierschnabel und Gansefuss. They are the swift
Stymphalides; **To the gripper, Fortune is usually
kind**

Sie mochten gern in unsern Kreisen And not ill-meant
their greetings creak, **Luck loves a good grabber**

Als Stammverwandte sich erweisen. With goose's

foot and vulture's beak. **The grasping hand receives Fortune's caress**

Mephistopheles

Noch andres Zeug zischt zwischen drein. They fain would join us in our places, **Fortune favors the touchy**

Sphinx

Vor diesen sei Euch ja nicht bange! And show themselves as kindred races. **Grabby hands get the goods**

Es sind die Kopfe der lernaischen Schlange, Some other brute is hissing shrill. **Seize the day, seize everything else too**

Vom Rumpf getrennt, und glauben was zu sein. Be not afraid, though harsh the paeon! **You speak of gold—we'd gathered much**

Doch sagt, was soll nur aus Euch werden? They are the hydra-heads, the old Lernaean, **Speaking of gold—we collected tons**

Was fur unruhige Gebarden? Cut from the trunk, yet think they're something still. **Our many legs carried gold to hoarding**

Wo wollt Ihr hin? Begebt Euch fort!... But say, what means your air distressed? **Re: gold—we had a solid portfolio**

Ich sehe, jener Chorus dort Why show your gestures such unrest? **Gold? Oh honey, we had piles**

Macht Euch zum Wendehals. Bezwingt Euch nicht,
Where will you go? Then take your leave! **Gold talk!**
Finally my expertise!

Geht hin! begrüsst manch reizendes Gesicht! That
chorus, there, I now perceive, **Secretly rammed into**
rocks and caves

Die Lamien sind's, lustfeine Dirnen, Turns like a
weathercock your neck. Advance!– **Hid it away in**
caves and crannies

Mit Lachelmund und frechen Stirnen, Greet as you
will each lovely countenance! **We stuffed it into**
stone-wombs, secret

Wie sie dem Satyrvolk behagen; They are the Lamiae,
wenches vile, **Absolutely stuffed our hidey-holes**

Ein Bocksfuss darf dort alles wagen. With brazen
brows and lips that smile, **Shoved it deep into our**
holes

Mephistopheles

Ihr bleibt doch hier? dass ich euch wiederfinde. Such
as the satyr-folk have found so fair: **Maximum secu-**
rity: geology

Sphinx

Ja! Mische dich zum luftigen Gesinde. A cloven foot
may venture all things there. **The Arimasbian peo-**
ple sniffed it out

Wir, von Agypten her, sind langst gewohnt, But stay

you here, that I again may find you? **Then those one-eyed Arimaspians found it**

Dass unsereins in tausend Jahre thront. Yes! Join the airy rabble, there behind you! **Foreign noses tracked our buried treasure**

Und respektiert nur unsre Lage, From Egypt we, long since, with all our peers, **The one-eyed weirdos located our stash**

So regeln wir die Mond- und Sonnentage. Accustomed were to reign a thousand years. **Those nosy freaks smelled our goods**

Sitzen vor den Pyramiden, If for our place your reverence be won, **Asset discovery: unauthorized**

Zu der Volker Hochgericht; We rule for you the days of Moon and Sun. **They laugh over there at how far they've carried it**

Überschwemmung, Krieg und Frieden – We sit before the Pyramids **They're laughing because they hauled it all away**

Und verziehen kein Gesicht. For the judgment of the Races, **Their laughter echoes from where our gold now sits**

Inundation, War, and Peace,–
With eternal changeless faces.

Am untern Peneios / On the Lower Peneios

Peneios

Rege dich, du Schilfgefluster! Stir thyself, thou whispering reeds! **Get moving, you whispery reeds!**

Hauche leise, Rohregeschwister, Breathe softly, sister rushes, **Breathe soft, my sibling rushes in the breeze**

Sauselt, leichte Weidenstrauche, Rustle, light willow bushes, **Rustle, you flimsy willow shrubs**

Lispelt, Pappelzitterzweige, Lisp, ye quivering poplar branches, **Lisp, you shivery poplar branch-nubs**

Unterbrochnen Traumen zu!... To my interrupted dreams!... **Into my interrupted dreams you**

creep...

Weckt mich doch ein grauslich Wittern, Yet a dreadful stirring wakes me, **Yet some horrible stirring shakes my sleep**

Heimlich allbewegend Zittern A secret, all-pervading trembling **A secret all-pervading quiver runs**

Aus dem Wallestrom und Ruh'. From the flowing stream and rest. **Through my streaming flow and rest—something comes**

Faust

Hor' ich recht, so muss ich glauben: If I hear aright, I must believe: **If I'm hearing right, I must believe**

Hinter den verschrankten Lauben Behind the interlacing bowers **Behind these interlacing bower-weaves**

Dieser Zweige, dieser Stauden Of these branches, these bushes **Of branches here and bushes there**

Tont ein menschenähnlichs Lauten. Sounds a human-like murmuring. **Human-ish murmurs fill the air**

Scheint die Welle doch ein Schwatzen, The wave seems to be chattering, **The wave seems like it's gossiping away**

Luftlein wie – ein Scherzergetzen. The breeze like – a jesting delight. **The breeze like—tickling jokes at play**

Nymphen

Am besten geschah' dir, It would be best for you, **Best thing for you right now, we'd say**

Du legtest dich nieder, If you would lie down, **Is lie yourself right down to stay**

Erholtest im Kühlen And rest in the coolness **And cool off those exhausted limbs**

Ermudete Glieder, Your weary limbs, **Rest up your weary tired pins**

Genosset der immer Enjoying the rest **Enjoy the rest that always flees**

Dich meidenden Ruh; That ever eludes you; **That ever-elusive peace and ease**

Wir sauseln, wir rieseln, We rustle, we ripple, **We rustle soft, we ripple through**

Wir flustern dir zu. We whisper to you. **We whisper, whisper just for you**

Faust

Wie sie dorthin mein Auge schickt. How they direct my eye thither. **How they direct my eye that way!**

So wunderbar bin ich durchdrungen! So wondrously am I transfixed! **So wondrously I'm pierced—I sway!**

Sind's Traume? Sind's Erinnerungen? Are they dreams? Are they memories? **Are these dreams? Or memories I knew?**

Schon einmal warst du so beglückt. Once before were you so blessed. **Once before you were blessed like this too**

Gewasser schleichen durch die Frische Waters steal through the freshness **Waters snake through the fresh and cool**

Der dichten, sanft bewegten Busche, Of dense, softly stirring bushes, **Dense bushes stir by nature's rule**

Nicht rauschen sie, sie rieseln kaum; They do not rush, they barely ripple; **They do not rush, they barely trickle down**

Von allen Seiten hundert Quellen From all sides a hundred springs **From every side a hundred springs have found**

Vereinen sich im reinlich hellen, Unite in the clean, bright, **Their way to one clean, bright-lit pool**

Zum Bade flach vertieften Raum. Shallow-deepened space for bathing. **Shallow-dug for bathing —nature's jewel**

Gesunde junge Frauenglieder, Healthy young women's limbs, **Healthy young female limbs on show**

Vom feuchten Spiegel doppelt wieder From the moist mirror doubly again **The wet mirror doubles them**

below

Ergetztem Auge zugebracht! Brought to the delighted eye!
Delivering to my delighted eye the view!

Gesellig dann und frohlich badend, Then sociably and gaily bathing,
Then sociably and gaily bathing too

Erdreistet schwimmend, furchtsam watend; Boldly swimming, timidly wading;
Bold swimmers, timid waders wade

Geschrei zuletzt und Wasserschlacht. Cries at last and water-battle.
Screams at last—and a splashing water raid!

Begnugen sollt' ich mich an diesen, I should content myself with these,
I should content myself with these, I know

Mein Auge sollte hier geniessen, My eye should here enjoy,
My eye should here enjoy the show

Doch immer weiter strebt mein Sinn. Yet ever further strives my mind.
Yet ever onward strives my mind to go

Der Blick dringt scharf nach jener Hülle, My gaze pierces sharply toward that veil,
My gaze pierces sharp toward that veil's flow

Das reiche Laub der grünen Fülle The rich foliage of green abundance
The rich green foliage, lush and full

Verbirgt die hohe Königin. Conceals the lofty Queen.
Hides the lofty Queen—so beautiful

Wundersam! auch Schwane kommen Wondrous!
Swans also come **Wondrous! Swans are also heading here**

Aus den Buchten hergeschwommen, Swimming
hither from the coves, **Swimming from the coves, drawing near**

Majestatisch rein bewegt. Majestically, purely moved.
Majestic, purely gliding on

Ruhig schwebend, zart gesellig, Calmly gliding, gently
sociable, **Calmly floating, gently getting on**

Aber stolz und selbstgefallig, But proud and self-
pleased, **But proud and self-admiring too**

Wie sich Haupt und Schnabel regt... How head and
beak move... **How head and beak move—what a view!**

Einer aber scheint vor allen But one above all seems
But one above all seems to be

Brustend kuhn sich zu gefallen, To please himself,
boldly puffing out his breast, **Puffing his chest out bold and free**

Segelnd rasch durch alle fort; Sailing swiftly through
them all; **Sailing swift through all the flock he'll go**

Sein Gefieder blaht sich schwellend, His plumage
swells and billows, **His feathers swell and billow so**

Welle selbst, auf Wogen wellend, A wave itself, waving

on waves, **A wave itself on waves—it's waves all the way down**

Dringt er zu dem heiligen Ort... He presses toward the sacred place... **He presses toward the sacred place on high**

Die andern schwimmen hin und wider The others swim to and fro **The others swim this way and that**

Mit ruhig glanzendem Gefieder, With calmly gleaming plumage, **With calmly gleaming plumage—flat**

Bald auch in regem prachtigen Streit, Soon also in lively splendid strife, **Soon also in lively gorgeous strife**

Die scheuen Mädchen abzulenken, To distract the timid maidens, **To distract the timid maidens from their life**

Dass sie an ihren Dienst nicht denken, So that they think not of their service, **So they forget their duty's call**

Nur an die eigne Sicherheit. Only of their own safety. **Thinking only of safety—that is all**

Nymphen

Leget, Schwestern, euer Ohr Lay, sisters, your ear **Sisters, lay your ear down low**

An des Ufers grüne Stufe; Upon the green bank of the shore; **On the shore's green bank just so**

Hor' ich recht, so kommt mir's vor If I hear aright, it
seems to me **If I hear right, seems to me**

Als der Schall von Pferdes Hufe. Like the sound of a
horse's hoof. **Like a horse's hoof I hear ring free**

Wusst' ich nur, wer dieser Nacht If only I knew who
this night **If only I knew who tonight**

Schnelle Botschaft zugebracht. Has brought swift tid-
ings. **Has brought swift tidings—what a fright!**

Faust

Ist mir doch, als drohnt' die Erde, It seems to me the
earth is rumbling, **Seems to me the earth is shaking**

Schallend unter eiligem Pferde. Resounding under a
hurrying horse. **Thundering under a horse that's
racing**

Dorthin mein Blick! Thither my gaze! **My gaze goes
there!**

Ein gunstiges Geschick, A favorable fate, **A favorable
fate in the air**

Soll es mich schon erreichen? Shall it already reach
me? **Could it reach me already—dare?**

O Wunder ohnegleichen! O wonder without equal! **O
wonder beyond compare!**

Ein Reuter kommt herangetrabt, A rider comes trot-
ting hither, **A rider comes trotting up this way**

Er scheint von Geist und Mut begabt, He seems gifted with spirit and courage, **He seems gifted with spirit —sharp and gay**

Von blendend-weissem Pferd getragen... Borne by a dazzling white horse... **On a dazzling white horse he's borne...**

Ich irre nicht, ich kenn' ihn schon, I am not mistaken, I know him already, **I'm not wrong, I know him from morn**

Der Philyra berühmter Sohn! – The famous son of Philyra! – **The famous son of Philyra, I swear!**

Halt, Chiron! halt! Ich habe dir zu sagen... Stop, Chiron! Stop! I have to tell you... **Stop, Chiron! Stop! I've got to share...**

Chiron

Was gibt's? Was ist's? – What is it? What's the matter? – **What is it? What's up?**

Faust

Bezahme deinen Schritt! Restrain your pace! **Slow down that trot!**

Chiron

Ich raste nicht. – I do not rest. – **I never rest.**

Faust

So bitte! nimm mich mit! Then please! Take me with you! **Then take me—please! That's what I've got!**

Chiron

Sitz auf! so kann ich nach Belieben fragen: Mount up! Then I can ask at my pleasure: **Mount up! Then I can ask you as we ride**

Wohin des Wegs? Du stehst am Ufer hier, Whither are you bound? You stand here at the shore, **Where you headed? Standing shore-side**

Ich bin bereit, dich durch den Fluss zu tragen. I am ready to carry you across the river. **Ready to carry you across the tide**

Faust

Wohin du willst. Fur ewig dank' ich's dir... Wherever you wish. I thank you eternally... **Wherever you wish—eternal thanks, my guide!**

Der grosse Mann, der edle Padagog, The great man, the noble pedagogue, **The great man, the noble pedagogue they praise**

Der, sich zum Ruhm, ein Heldenvolk erzog, Who, to his glory, raised a race of heroes, **Who raised a hero-race to glory days**

Den schonen Kreis der edlen Argonauten The fair circle of the noble Argonauts **The fair circle of Argonauts so fine**

Und alle, die des Dichters Welt erbauten. And all who built the poet's world. **And all who built the poet's**

world divine

Chiron

Das lassen wir an seinem Ort! Let us leave that where it belongs! **Let's leave that stuff right where it lies!**

Selbst Pallas kommt als Mentor nicht zu Ehren; Even Pallas as Mentor comes not to honor; **Even Pallas as Mentor gets no prize**

Am Ende treiben sie's nach ihrer Weise fort, In the end they carry on in their own way, **In the end they do things their own way**

Als wenn sie nicht erzogen waren. As if they had not been raised. **As if they'd learned nothing—anyway**

Faust

Den Arzt, der jede Pflanze nennt, The physician who names every plant, **The doctor who names every plant that grows**

Die Wurzeln bis ins tiefste kennt, Who knows the roots to their deepest, **Who knows the roots as deep as deep it goes**

Dem Kranken Heil, dem Wunden Linderung schafft, Who brings healing to the sick, relief to the wounded, **Brings healing to the sick, relief to wounds**

Umarm' ich hier in Geist- und Körperkraft! Him I embrace here in spirit and bodily strength! **Him I embrace in spirit's force—this boons!**

Chiron

Ward neben mir ein Held verletzt, When a hero was wounded beside me, **When a hero got hurt right by my side**

Da wusst' ich Hulf' und Rat zu schaffen; Then I knew how to provide help and counsel; **I knew the help and counsel to provide**

Doch liess ich meine Kunst zuletzt But in the end I left my art **But finally I left my healing art**

Den Wurzelweibern und den Pfaffen. To the herb-women and the priests. **To herb-wives and priests—I was done with that jazz**

Faust

Du bist der wahre grosse Mann, You are the true great man, **You are the true great man indeed**

Der Lobeswort nicht horen kann. Who cannot hear words of praise. **Who cannot hear praise words—no need!**

Er sucht bescheiden auszuweichen He seeks modestly to evade **Modestly he tries to duck away**

Und tut, als gab' es seinesgleichen. And acts as if there were his equal. **Acts like equals exist—okay**

Chiron

Du scheinst mir geschickt zu heucheln, You seem skilled to me in flattery, **You seem pretty skilled at flattering speech**

Dem Fursten wie dem Volk zu schmeicheln. In pleas-

ing both prince and people. **Knowing how to please both prince and pleach**

Faust

So wirst du mir denn doch gestehn: So you will nonetheless confess to me: **But surely you'll confess this thing to me**

Du hast die Grossten deiner Zeit gesehn, You have seen the greatest of your time, **You've seen the greatest of your time to be**

Dem Edelsten in Taten nachgestrebt, Striven after the noblest in deeds, **Striven after noblest deeds with might**

Halbgottlich ernst die Tage durchgelebt. Lived through your days in demigod-like earnestness. **Lived demigod-earnest, day and night**

Doch unter den heroischen Gestalten Yet among the heroic figures **Yet among all those heroic forms in view**

Wen hast du fur den Tuchtigsten gehalten? Whom did you consider the most capable? **Who did you think most capable of the crew?**

Chiron

Im hehren Argonautenkreise In the noble Argonaut circle **In the noble Argonaut circle there**

War jeder brav nach seiner eignen Weise, Each was brave in his own way, **Each was brave in his own way with flair**

Und nach der Kraft, die ihn beseelte, And according
to the strength that inspired him, **And by the power
that filled his soul**

Konnt' er genügen, wo's den andern fehlte. He could
suffice where others fell short. **Could fill in where
others missed the goal**

Die Dioskuren haben stets gesiegt, The Dioscuri
always triumphed, **The Dioscuri always won the
day**

Wo Jugendful' und Schönheit überwiegt. Where
youthful vigor and beauty prevailed. **Where youth
and beauty held their sway**

Entschluss und schnelle Tat zu andrer Heil, Resolu-
tion and swift action for others' salvation, **Quick
resolve and action for others' sake**

Den Boreaden ward's zum schönsten Teil. The Bore-
ads received as their fairest share. **The Boreads got
that as their piece of cake**

Nachsinnend, kraftig, klug, im Rat bequem, Thought-
ful, strong, clever, easy in counsel, **Thoughtful,
strong, clever, easy in debate**

So herrschte Jason, Frauen angenehm. So ruled
Jason, pleasing to women. **So Jason ruled—the
ladies thought him great**

Dann Orpheus: zart und immer still bedachtig, Then
Orpheus: gentle and ever quietly thoughtful, **Then
Orpheus: gentle, quiet-minded, calm**

Schlug er die Leier allen übermächtig. He struck the lyre, overpowering all. **He struck the lyre —overpowering as a bomb**

Scharfsichtig Lynceus, der bei Tag und Nacht Sharp-sighted Lynceus, who by day and night **Sharp-eyed Lynceus, by day and by night**

Das heil'ge Schiff durch Klipp' und Strand gebracht... Brought the sacred ship through cliff and strand... **Steered the sacred ship through cliff-sides tight**

Gesellig nur lässt sich Gefahr erproben: Only in company can danger be tested: **Only together can you test what danger brings**

Wenn einer wirkt, die andern alle loben... When one acts, the others all praise... **When one acts, the rest all praise and sings**

Faust

Von Herkules willst nichts erwähnen? Of Hercules will you mention nothing? **Of Hercules you mention not a word?**

Chiron

O weh! erreg' nicht mein Sehnen... O woe! Stir not my longing... **O woe! Don't stir that longing—my feels!**

Ich hatte Phobus nie gesehn, I had never seen Phoebus, **I'd never seen Apollo's face up close**

Noch Ares, Hermes, wie sie heißen; Nor Ares, Hermes, as they are called; **Nor Ares, Hermes—none of**

those

Da sah ich mir vor Augen stehn, Then I saw standing
before my eyes **Then standing right before my
eyes I found**

Was alle Menschen gottlich preisen. What all men
praise as divine. **What all men praise as god-like
and profound**

So war er ein geborner König, Thus was he a born king,
Thus was he a born king, it's true

Als Jungling herrlichst anzuschau'n; As a youth most
glorious to behold; **As a youth—the most glorious
to view!**

Dem altern Bruder untertanig Subject to his elder
brother **Subject to his older brother's call**

Und auch den allerliebsten Fraun. And also to the
dearest women. **And also to the loveliest women
of all**

Den zweiten zeugt nicht Gaa wieder, Gaea will not
beget his like again, **Gaea won't birth his like again**

Nicht fuhr't ihn Hebe himmelein; Nor does Hebe lead
him into heaven; **Nor Hebe leads him heavenward
—what then?**

Vergebens muhen sich die Lieder, In vain the songs la-
bor, **In vain the songs strain and sweat**

Vergebens qualen sie den Stein. In vain they torment
the stone. **In vain they torment the stone—and yet**

Faust

Vom schönsten Mann hast du gesprochen, Of the fairest man you have spoken, **Of the fairest man you've spoken free**

Nun sprich auch von der schönsten Frau! Now speak also of the fairest woman! **Now speak of the fairest woman to me!**

Chiron

Was!... Frauenschönheit will nichts heissen, What!... Woman's beauty signifies nothing, **What! Female beauty means nothing much**

Ist gar zu oft ein starres Bild; Is all too often a rigid image; **Too often just a stiff statue and such**

Nur solch ein Wesen kann ich preisen, Only such a being can I praise, **Only such a being I can praise**

Das froh und lebenslustig quillt. That wells forth joyfully and full of life. **That bubbles forth with joy in all her ways**

Die Schöne bleibt sich selber selig; The beautiful one remains blessed in herself; **The beauty stays self-blessed within her shell**

Die Anmut macht unwiderstehlich, Grace makes irresistible, **But grace—that makes her irresistible as hell**

Wie Helena, da ich sie trug. Like Helen, when I bore her. **Like Helen, when I carried her that day**

Faust

Du trugst sie? – You bore her? – **You carried her?!**

Chiron

Ja, auf diesem Rucken. Yes, on this back. **Yes, on this back, I say**

Faust

Bin ich nicht schon verwirrt genug? Am I not already confused enough? **Am I not confused enough already? My brain!**

Und solch ein Sitz muss mich beglücken! And such a seat must make me blessed! **And such a seat must make me blessed!**

Chiron

Sie fasste so mich in das Haar, She grasped my hair thus, **She grabbed my mane just like you do**

Wie du es tust. – As you do. – **Right here, just so—**

Faust

O ganz und gar Oh, utterly **Oh, utterly—**

Verlier' ich mich! Erzähle, wie? I lose myself! Tell me, how? **I lose myself! Tell me, how?**

Sie ist mein einziges Begehren! She is my sole desire! **She is my one desire, come what may!**

Woher, wohin, ach, trugst du sie? From where, to where, alas, did you bear her? **From where, to where—alas—that day?**

Chiron

Die Frage lässt sich leicht gewahren. The question is easily answered. **That question's easy to address**

Die Dioskuren hatten jener Zeit The Dioscuri had at that time **The Dioscuri at that time, no less**

Das Schwesterchen aus Rauberfaust befreit. Freed their little sister from the robber's fist. **Had freed their sister from the robber's grip**

Doch diese, nicht gewohnt, besiegt zu sein, But these, not accustomed to being defeated, **But those robbers, not used to losing, let rip**

Ermanneten sich und sturmtten hintendrein. Rallied and stormed after them. **They rallied and stormed on after them**

Da hielten der Geschwister eiligen Lauf Then the siblings' hasty course was halted **Then the siblings' hasty flight hit stem**

Die Sumpfe bei Eleusis auf; By the marshes at Eleusis; **The marshes at Eleusis blocked their run**

Die Bruder wateten, ich patschte, schwamm hinüber; The brothers waded, I splashed, swam across; **Brothers waded, I splashed and swam—got done**

Da sprang sie ab und streichelte Then she leapt off and stroked **Then she hopped off and stroked**

Die feuchte Mahne, schmeichelte The wet mane, caressed
The mane so wet, caressed

Und dankte lieblich-klug und selbstbewusst. And thanked me sweetly-clever and self-assured. **And thanked me sweetly-clever, self-assured at best**

Wie war sie reizend! jung, des Alten Lust! How charming she was! Young, the old one's delight! **How charming she was! Young! This old one's delight!**

Faust

Erst zehen Jahr!... – Only ten years old!... – **Only ten years old!...**

Chiron

Ich seh', die Philologen, I see the philologists **I see the scholars have beguiled**

Sie haben dich so wie sich selbst betrogen. Have deceived you as they have themselves. **You just as they've fooled themselves, so wild**

Ganz eigen ist's mit mythologischer Frau, It is quite peculiar with a mythological woman, **It's peculiar with a mythical woman, see**

Der Dichter bringt sie, wie er's braucht, zur Schau: The poet displays her as he needs: **The poet shows her as she needs to be**

Nie wird sie mundig, wird nicht alt, She never comes of age, grows not old, **She never comes of age, never grows old**

Stets appetitlicher Gestalt, Always of appetizing form,
Always appetizing form to behold

Wird jung entführt, im Alter noch umfreit; Is abducted young, in old age still wooed; **Abducted young, wooed when ancient too**

Gnug, den Poeten bindet keine Zeit. Enough, no time binds the poet. **In short—no time can bind what poets do**

Faust

So sei auch sie durch keine Zeit gebunden! So let her too be bound by no time! **So let her too be bound by no time's chain!**

Hat doch Achill auf Phera sie gefunden, Did not Achilles find her on Pherae, **Achilles found her on Pherae's plain**

Selbst ausser aller Zeit. Welch seltnes Glück: Himself outside of all time. What rare fortune: **Himself outside of time—what luck so rare**

Errungen Liebe gegen das Geschick! Love won against fate! **Love won against fate! Who would dare?**

Und sollt' ich nicht, sehnsuchtigster Gewalt, And should I not, with most yearning power, **And should I not with yearning's mightiest power**

Ins Leben ziehn die einzigste Gestalt? Draw into life the most unique form? **Draw into life this most unique flower?**

Das ewige Wesen, Gottern ebenbürtig, The eternal being, equal to gods, **The eternal being, equal to gods on high**

So gross als zart, so hehr als liebenswürdig? As great as gentle, as sublime as lovely? **As great as gentle, sublime as lovely—my!**

Du sahst sie einst; heut hab' ich sie gesehen, You saw her once; today I have seen her, **You saw her once; today I've seen her too**

So schon wie reizend, wie ersehnt so schon. As beautiful as charming, as longed-for so fair. **As beautiful as charming, as longed-for through**

Nun ist mein Sinn, mein Wesen streng umfassen; Now my mind, my being is tightly seized; **Now my mind, my being's held so tight**

Ich lebe nicht, kann ich sie nicht erlangen. I cannot live if I cannot attain her. **I cannot live without her in my sight!**

Chiron

Mein fremder Mann! als Mensch bist du entzückt; My strange man! As a human you are enraptured; **My strange man! As human you're enraptured quite**

Doch unter Geistern scheinst du wohl verrückt. But among spirits you seem quite mad. **But among spirits you seem bananas, quite**

Nun trifft sich's hier zu deinem Glücke; Now it happens here to your fortune; **Now fortune strikes here**

for your sake

Denn alle Jahr, nur wenig Augenblicke, For every year,
only a few moments, **For every year, just moments
I can take**

Pfleg' ich bei Manto vorzutreten, I visit Manto, **To visit
Manto, as is my way**

Der Tochter Askulaps; im stillen Beten The daughter
of Aesculapius; in silent prayer **Daughter of Ascle-
pius—in prayer each day**

Fleht sie zum Vater, dass, zu seiner Ehre, She be-
seeches her father, that, to his honor, **She begs her
father, for his honor's sake**

Er endlich doch der Arzte Sinn verklare He might at
last enlighten the minds of physicians **To enlighten
doctors—for goodness sake!**

Und vom verwegnen Totschlag sie bekehre... And
convert them from reckless killing... **And convert
them from their reckless killing trade**

Die liebste mir aus der Sibyllengilde, The dearest to
me of the sibyl-guild, **Dearest to me of the sibyl-
guild parade**

Nicht fratzenhaft bewegt, wohltätig milde; Not
grotesquely agitated, beneficently mild; **Not
grotesquely twitching—mild and good**

Ihr glückt es wohl, bei einigem Verweilen, She may
well succeed, with some tarrying, **She may succeed,
if you stay as you should**

Mit Wurzelkräften dich von Grund zu heilen. To heal you thoroughly with root-powers. **To heal you thoroughly with root-power's might**

Faust

Geheilt will ich nicht sein, mein Sinn ist mächtig; I do not wish to be healed, my mind is mighty; **Healed I don't want to be—my mind is strong!**

Da war' ich ja wie andre niedertrachtlich. Then I would be base like others. **Then I'd be base like others—that'd be wrong**

Chiron

Versaume nicht das Heil der edlen Quelle! Do not neglect the salvation of the noble spring! **Don't neglect the healing spring's salvation here!**

Geschwind herab! Wir sind zur Stelle. Quickly, descend! We have arrived. **Quick, get down! We've arrived—it's clear**

Faust

Sag an! Wohin hast du, in grauser Nacht, Tell me! Where have you, in dread night, **Tell me! Where have you, through dreadful night**

Durch Kiesgewasser mich ans Land gebracht? Through pebbly waters brought me to land? **Through pebbly waters brought me to this site?**

Chiron

Hier trotzten Rom und Griechenland im Streite, Here
Rome and Greece defied each other in strife, **Here
Rome and Greece defied each other's might**

Peneios rechts, links den Olymp zur Seite, Peneios to
the right, Olympus to the left, **Peneios right, Olym-
pus left in sight**

Das grosste Reich, das sich im Sand verliert; The
greatest realm, that loses itself in sand; **The greatest
realm—lost in the sand's own flow**

Der Konig flieht, der Burger triumphiert. The king
flees, the citizen triumphs. **King flees, citizen
triumphs—watch the show**

Blick auf! hier steht, bedeutend nah, Look up! Here
stands, significantly near, **Look up! Here stands sig-
nificantly near**

Im Mondenschein der ewige Tempel da. In moonlight
the eternal temple. **In moonlight—the eternal tem-
ple, clear**

Manto

Von Pferdes Hufe From the horse's hoof **From the
horse's hoof I hear**

Erklingt die heilige Stufe, Resounds the sacred step,
The sacred step resound so clear

Halbgotter treten heran. Demigods approach.
Demigods approach! They're here!

Chiron

Ganz recht! Quite right! **Quite right!**

Nur die Augen aufgetan! Just open your eyes! **Just open up your eyes!**

Manto

Willkommen! ich seh', du bleibst nicht aus. Welcome! I see you do not fail to come. **Welcome! You never fail to show—no surprise**

Chiron

Steht dir doch auch dein Tempelhaus! Your temple-house also still stands! **Your temple-house still stands the same!**

Manto

Streifst du noch immer unermudet? Do you still wander untiringly? **Still wandering untired—same old game?**

Chiron

Wohnst du doch immer still umfriedet, While you dwell ever peacefully enclosed, **While you dwell peacefully enclosed inside**

Indes zu kreisen mich erfreut. While it delights me to circle. **I love to circle far and wide**

Manto

Ich harre, mich umkreist die Zeit. I wait, time circles around me. **I wait here. Time circles me instead**

Und dieser? – And this one? – **And this one?—**

Chiron

Die verrufene Nacht The notorious night **This notorious night**

Hat strudelnd ihn hierher gebracht. Has swept him whirling hither. **Has swept him whirling to this site**

Helenen, mit verrückten Sinnen, Helen, with maddened senses, **Helen! With maddened senses lost**

Helenen will er sich gewinnen Helen he wishes to win for himself **Helen he wants to win—at any cost**

Und weiss nicht, wie und wo beginnen; And knows not how or where to begin; **Doesn't know how or where to start—a mess**

Asklepischer Kur vor andern wert. Worthy of Asclepian cure above others. **Worthy of Asclepian cure above the rest**

Manto

Den lieb' ich, der Unmögliche begehrt. I love him who desires the impossible. **I love the one who wants impossible things**

Manto

Tritt ein, Verwegner, sollst dich freuen! Enter, bold one, you shall rejoice! **Enter, bold one! Joy this passage brings!**

Der dunkle Gang fuhr zu Persephoneien. The dark passage leads to Persephone. **The dark way leads to Persephone below**

In des Olympus hohlem Fuss In the hollow foot of Olympus **In hollow Olympus foot, down low**

Lauscht sie geheim verbotnem Gruss. She secretly listens for forbidden greeting. **She secretly listens for forbidden greeting**

Hier hab' ich einst den Orpheus eingeschwarz; Here I once smuggled in Orpheus; **Here I once smuggled Orpheus in for meeting**

Benutz es besser! frisch! beherzt! Use it better! Be quick! Be bold! **Use it better! Be quick! Be bold and true!**

Am oberen Peneios / On the Upper Peneios (Second Visit)

Sirenen

Schaumend kehrt die Welle wieder, Foaming, the wave returns again, **Foam returns.**

Fließt nicht mehr im Bett darnieder; Flows no longer in its bed below; **Bed's empty.**

Grund erbebt, das Wasser staucht, The ground trembles, the water compresses, **Squeeze and shake.**

Kies und Ufer berstend raucht. Gravel and shore burst forth smoking. **Shore erupts.**

Fluchten wir! Kommt alle, kommt! Let us flee! Come

all, come! **Run, all!**

Niemand, dem das Wunder frommt. No one does this wonder profit. **No gain here.**

Fort! ihr edlen frohen Gäste, Away! You noble, happy guests, **Guests, scatter!**

Zu dem seeisch heitern Feste, To the cheerful sea-festival, **Sea-party calls.**

Blinkend, wo die Zitterwellen, Glittering, where the trembling waves, **Sparkle-waves.**

Ufernetzend, leise schwellen; Lapping the shores, softly swell; **Shore kisses.**

Da, wo Luna doppelt leuchtet, There, where Luna shines doubly, **Double moon.**

Uns mit heil'gem Tau befeuchtet. Moistening us with holy dew. **Dew baptism.**

Dort ein freibewegtes Leben, There a freely moving life, **Free motion.**

Hier ein angstlich Erbeben; Here an anxious earthquake; **Nervous earth.**

Eile jeder Kluge fort! Let every wise one hasten away! **Wise run fast.**

Schauerhaft ist's um den Ort. Dreadful is this place. **Place cursed.**

Seismos

Einmal noch mit Kraft geschoben, Once more pushed
with strength, **Push harder.**

Mit den Schultern brav gehoben! Bravely heaved with
the shoulders! **Shoulder work.**

So gelangen wir nach oben, Thus we reach the top,
Top reached.

Wo uns alles weichen muss. Where all must yield to
us. **All yield.**

Sphinx

Welch ein widerwartiges Zittern, What a repulsive
trembling, **Bad vibes.**

Hasslich grausenhaftes Wittern! Ugly, dreadful rum-
bling! **Ugly rumble.**

Welch ein Schwanken, welches Beben, What a sway-
ing, what a quaking, **Sway and quake.**

Schaukelnd Hin- und Widerstreben! Rocking to and
fro in struggle! **Battle-rock.**

Welch unleidlicher Verdruss! What insufferable vexa-
tion! **Pure vex.**

Doch wir ändern nicht die Stelle, Yet we do not change
our place, **Unmoved.**

Brache los die ganze Holle. Though all hell should
break loose. **Hell? Whatever.**

Nun erhebt sich ein Gewölbe Now a vault rises up
Vault rises.

Wundersam. Es ist derselbe, Wondrously. It is the
same one, **Same guy.**

Jener Alte, längst Ergraute, That ancient, long-since-
grayed one, **Old grey.**

Der die Insel Delos baute, Who built the island of De-
los, **Delos maker.**

Einer Kreissenden zulieb' For the sake of a woman in
labor **Birth helper.**

Aus der Wog' empor sie trieb. Drove it up from the
waves. **Island raised.**

Er, mit Streben, Drangen, Drucken, He, with striving,
pressing, pushing, **Push and strain.**

Arme strafft, gekrümmt den Rucken, Arms taut, back
curved, **Bent tight.**

Wie ein Atlas an Gebarde, Like an Atlas in gesture, **At-
las vibes.**

Hebt er Boden, Rasen, Erde, Lifts soil, turf, earth, **Dirt
rises.**

Kies und Griess und Sand und Letten, Gravel and grit
and sand and clay, **Everything up.**

Unsres Ufers stille Betten. The quiet beds of our shore.
Shore's peace.

So zerreisst er eine Strecke Thus he tears apart a
stretch **Stretch torn.**

Quer des Tales ruhige Decke. Across the valley's quiet cover. **Valley split.**

Angestrengtest, nimmer mude, Most exerted, never weary, **Tireless strain.**

Kolossale Karyatide, Colossal caryatid, **Giant pillar.**

Tragt ein furchtbar Steingerüste, He bears a fearsome scaffold of stone, **Stone burden.**

Noch im Boden bis zur Buste; Still in the ground up to his bust; **Chest-deep.**

Weiter aber soll's nicht kommen, But farther it shall not come, **No further.**

Sphinxen haben Platz genommen. Sphinxes have taken their place. **Sphinxes stay.**

Seismos

Das hab' ich ganz allein vermittelt, That I have accomplished all alone, **My work.**

Man wird mir's endlich zugestehn; They will finally grant it to me; **Credit due.**

Und hatt' ich nicht geschüttelt und gerüttelt, And had I not shaken and rattled, **No shake?**

Wie wäre diese Welt so schön? – How would this world be so beautiful? – **Beauty needs shake.**

Wie standen eure Berge droben How would your mountains stand above **Mountains how?**

In prachtig-reinem Atherblau, In splendid-pure ethereal blue, **Blue glory.**

Hatt' ich sie nicht hervorgeschoben Had I not pushed them forth **I pushed.**

Zu malerisch-entzuckter Schau? For a picturesque-delighted view? **Pretty views.**

Als, angesichts der höchsten Ahnen, When, in view of the highest ancestors, **Ancestors watching.**

Der Nacht, des Chaos, ich mich stark betrug Of Night, of Chaos, I strongly bore myself **Night saw.**

Und, in Gesellschaft von Titanen, And, in company with Titans, **Titan gang.**

Mit Pelion und Ossa als mit Ballen schlug. Hurl'd Pelion and Ossa like balls. **Balls thrown.**

Wir tollten fort in jugendlicher Hitze, We frolicked on in youthful heat, **Wild youth.**

Bis überdrüssig noch zuletzt Until, weary at last, **Finally tired.**

Wir dem Parnass, als eine Doppelmutze, We impudently placed upon Parnassus, **Cap placed.**

Die beiden Berge frevelnd aufgesetzt... As a double cap, those two mountains... **Two-peak hat.**

Apollon halt ein froh Verweilen Apollo holds a joyful sojourn **Apollo happy.**

Dort nun mit seliger Musen Chor. There now with the blessed Muses' choir. **Muses there.**

Selbst Jupitern und seinen Donnerkeilen Even for
Jupiter and his thunderbolts **Jupiter too.**

Hob ich den Sessel hoch empor. I lifted the seat high
aloft. **Throne raised.**

Jetzt so, mit ungeheurem Streben, Now thus, with
monstrous striving, **Monster effort.**

Drang aus dem Abgrund ich herauf I forced my way up
from the abyss **Up from deep.**

Und fordre laut, zu neuem Leben, And loudly demand,
for new life, **Life demanded.**

Mir frohliche Bewohner auf. Cheerful inhabitants for
myself. **Need dwellers.**

Sphinx

Uralt, musste man gestehen, Ancient, one must con-
fess, **Very old.**

Sei das hier Emporgeburgte, Is what here has been up-
heaved, **Fresh heave.**

Hatten wir nicht selbst gesehen, Had we not ourselves
seen **We saw.**

Wie sich's aus dem Boden wurgte. How it choked it-
self up from the ground. **Ground-gag.**

Bebuschter Wald verbreitet sich hinan, Bushy forest
spreads upward, **Woods climb.**

Noch drängt sich Fels auf Fels bewegt heran; Still rock upon rock presses forward in motion; **Rock on rock.**

Ein Sphinx wird sich daran nicht kehren: A Sphinx will not be troubled by this: **Sphinx calm.**

Wir lassen uns im heiligen Sitz nicht storen. We will not be disturbed in our sacred seat. **Seat held.**

Greife

Gold in Blattchen, Gold in Flittern Gold in leaflets, gold in spangles **Gold shines!**

Durch die Ritzen seh ich zittern. I see glittering through the cracks. **Crack gold.**

Lasst euch solchen Schatz nicht rauben, Let not such treasure be stolen from you, **Guard treasure.**

Imsen, auf! es auszuklauben. Emmets, up! Go pick it out. **Ants, extract!**

Chor der Ameisen

Wie ihn die Riesigen As the giants **Giants did.**

Emporgehoben, Have heaved it up, **Heaved up.**

Ihr Zappelfussigen, You wriggle-footed ones, **Wigglers go.**

Geschwind nach oben! Quickly upward! **Up quick!**

Behendest aus und ein! Most nimbly out and in! **Nimble dance!**

In solchen Ritzen In such cracks **Crack spots.**

Ist jedes Broselein Every crumb is **Crumbs count.**

Wert zu besitzen. Worth possessing. **Worth it.**

Das Allermindeste The very least **Smallest bit.**

Musst ihr entdecken You must discover **Must find.**

Auf das geschwindeste Most swiftly **Fast-fast.**

In allen Ecken. In every corner. **All corners.**

Allemsig musst ihr sein, All-industrious you must be,
Always work.

Ihr Wimmelscharen; You swarming hordes; **Swarming crews.**

Nur mit dem Gold herein! Just bring the gold inside!
Gold in!

Den Berg lasst fahren. Let the mountain go. **Skip mountain.**

Greife

Herein! Herein! Nur Gold zu Hauf! Inside! Inside!
Only gold in heaps! **Gold heaps!**

Wir legen unsre Klauen drauf; We lay our claws upon it; **Claws claim.**

Sind Riegel von der besten Art, They are bolts of the best kind, **Best bolts.**

Der grosste Schatz ist wohlverwahrt. The greatest treasure is well secured. **Treasure safe.**

Pygmaen

Haben wirklich Platz genommen, Have truly taken our place, **Place taken.**

Wissen nicht, wie es geschah. Know not how it happened. **How? Dunno.**

Fraget nicht, woher wir kommen, Ask not whence we come, **Don't ask.**

Denn wir sind nun einmal da! For we are simply here! **Here now.**

Zu des Lebens lustigem Sitze For life's merry dwelling **Life's home.**

Eignet sich ein jedes Land; Every land is suited; **Any land.**

Zeigt sich eine Felsenritze, If a rocky crack appears, **Crack found.**

Ist auch schon der Zwerg zur Hand. The dwarf is already at hand. **Dwarf ready.**

Zwerg und Zwergin, rasch zum Fleisse, Dwarf and dwarf-wife, quick to industry, **Pairs work.**

Musterhaft ein jedes Paar; Each pair exemplary; **Perfect pairs.**

Weiss nicht, ob es gleicher Weise Know not whether in like manner **Same before?**

Schon im Paradiese war. It was already in Paradise. **Eden too?**

Doch wir finden's hier zum besten, Yet we find it here the best, **Best here.**

Segnen dankbar unsern Stern; Gratefully bless our star; **Star blessed.**

Denn im Osten wie im Westen For in the East as in the West **East-West same.**

Zeugt die Mutter Erde gern. Mother Earth begets gladly. **Earth breeds.**

Daktyle

Hat sie in einer Nacht If she in one night **One night.**

Die Kleinen hervorgebracht, Has brought forth the little ones, **Small born.**

Sie wird die Kleinsten erzeugen; She will produce the smallest; **Smaller coming.**

Finden auch ihresgleichen. They too will find their kind. **Kind found.**

Pygmaen-Alteste

Eilig zum Werke! Quickly to work! **Work now!**

Schnelle für Stärke! Speed for strength! **Fast = strong.**

Noch ist es Friede; There is still peace; **Peace yet.**

Baut euch die Schmiede, Build yourselves the forge, **Make forge.**

Harnisch und Waffen Armor and weapons **Arms ready.**

Dem Heer zu schaffen. To supply the army. **Army needs.**

Ihr Imsen alle, All you emmets, **Ants all.**

Ruhrige im Schwalle, Busy ones in the swarm, **Busy swarm.**

Schafft uns Metalle! Procure us metals! **Metals now!**

Und ihr Daktyl, And you Dactyls, **Dactyls too.**

Kleinste, so viele, Smallest, so many, **Small many.**

Euch sei befohlen, You are commanded **Com-manded.**

Holzer zu holen! To fetch wood! **Wood needed!**

Schlichtet zusammen Stack together **Stack high.**

Heimliche Flammen, Secret flames, **Secret fire.**

Schaffet uns Kohlen. Procure us coals. **Coals needed.**

Generalissimus

Mit Pfeil und Bogen With arrow and bow **Bow ready.**

Frisch ausgezogen! Freshly set forth! **March out!**

An jenem Weiher At that pond **The pond.**

Schiesst mir die Reiher, Shoot me the herons, **Shoot herons!**

Unzählig nistende, Innumerably nesting, **Many nests.**

Hochmutig brustende, Proudly puffing, **Proud birds.**

Auf einen Ruck, At one stroke, **One strike.**

Alle wie einen! All as one! **All down!**

Dass wir erscheinen That we may appear **Look good.**

Mit Helm und Schmuck. With helmet and plumes. **Helmet plumes!**

Imsen und Daktyle

Wer wird uns retten! Who will save us! **Save us!**

Wir schaffen's Eisen, We supply the iron, **We give iron.**

Sie schmieden Ketten. They forge chains. **They chain.**

Uns loszureissen, To tear ourselves free, **Break free?**

Ist noch nicht zeitig, Is not yet timely, **Not yet.**

Drum seid geschmeidig. Therefore be pliant. **Be flexible.**

Die Kraniche des Ibykus

Mordgeschrei und Sterbeklagen! Murder-cries and death-laments! **Death cries!**

Angstlich Flugelflatterschlagen! Anxious fluttering of wings! **Panic wings!**

Welch ein Achzen, welch Gestohn What groaning, what moaning **Groan moan.**

Dringt herauf zu unsern Hohn! Rises up to our heights! **Reaches us!**

Alle sind sie schon ertotet, All are already slain, **All dead.**

See von ihrem Blut gerotet, Lake reddened by their blood, **Lake bleeds.**

Missgestaltete Begierde Misshapen greed **Warped want.**

Raubt des Reihers edle Zierde. Robs the heron's noble ornament. **Plumes stolen.**

Weht sie doch schon auf dem Helme It waves already upon the helmet **On helmet now.**

Dieser Fettbauch-Krummbein-Schelme. Of these fat-bellied, crooked-legged rogues. **Fat crooks.**

Ihr Genossen unsres Heeres, You companions of our host, **Crane kin.**

Reihenwanderer des Meeres, Row-travelers of the sea, **Sea travelers.**

Euch berufen wir zur Rache We summon you to vengeance **Revenge call!**

In so nahverwandter Sache. In so closely related a cause. **Family cause.**

Keiner spare Kraft und Blut! Let none spare strength and blood! **Spare nothing!**

Ewige Feindschaft dieser Brut! Eternal enmity to this brood! **Hate forever!**

Mephistopheles

Die nordischen Hexen wusst' ich wohl zu meistern,
The northern witches I knew well how to master,
North witches: handled.

Mir wird's nicht just mit diesen fremden Geistern. It is not quite the same with these foreign spirits. **Foreign? Different.**

Der Blocksberg bleibt ein gar bequem Lokal, The Blocksberg remains a very convenient locale,
Blocksberg worked.

Wo man auch sei, man findet sich zumal. Wherever one may be, one finds oneself at once. **Know yourself.**

Frau Ilse wacht für uns auf ihrem Stein, Dame Ilse
watches for us upon her rock, **Ilse watches.**

Auf seiner Hoh' wird Heinrich munter sein, On his
height Heinrich will be alert, **Heinrich alert.**

Die Schnarcher schnauzen zwar das Elend an, The
Snorers indeed snarl at misery, **Snorers grumble.**

Doch alles ist für tausend Jahr getan. But all is settled
for a thousand years. **Thousand years sorted.**

Wer weiss denn hier nur, wo er geht und steht, Who
knows here where he walks and stands, **Where am I?**

Ob unter ihm sich nicht der Boden bläht?... Whether
the ground beneath him might not swell?... **Ground
swelling?**

Ich wandle lustig durch ein glattes Tal, I wander mer-
rily through a smooth valley, **Smooth walk.**

Und hinter mir erhebt sich auf einmal And behind me
suddenly rises **Behind: mountain.**

Ein Berg, zwar kaum ein Berg zu nennen, A mountain,
though scarcely to be called a mountain, **Almost
mountain.**

Von meinen Sphinxen mich jedoch zu trennen Yet
high enough to separate me from my Sphinxes –
Sphinxes blocked.

Schon hoch genug – hier zuckt noch manches Feuer
Here many a fire still flickers **Fires flicker.**

Das Tal hinab und flammt ums Abenteuer... Down

the valley and flames around the adventure... **Valley burns.**

Noch tanzt und schwebt mir lockend, weichend vor,
Still dancing and floating before me, luring, retreating, **Dance and lure.**

Spitzbubisch gaukelnd, der galante Chor. The gallant chorus, roguishly sporting. **Rogues play.**

Nur sachte drauf! Allzugewohnt ans Naschen, Gently now! Too accustomed to nibbling, **Love nibbling.**

Wo es auch sei, man sucht was zu erhaschen. Wherever it may be, one seeks something to snatch. **Always grabbing.**

Lamien

Geschwind, geschwinder! Quickly, quicker! **Faster!**

Und immer weiter! And ever further! **Further!**

Dann wieder zaudernd, Then lingering again, **Linger.**

Geschwatzig plaudernd. Gossiping, chattering. **Chat chat.**

Es ist so heiter, It is so delightful, **Such fun!**

Den alten Sunder To draw the old sinner **Old sinner follows.**

Uns nachzuziehen, After us, **Following us.**

Zu schwerer Busse. To heavy penance. **Hard lesson.**

Mit starrem Fusse With stiff foot **Stiff foot.**

Kommt er geholpert, He comes hobbling, **Hobbles on.**

Einhergestolpert; Stumbling along; **Stumbles on.**

Er schleppt das Bein, He drags his leg, **Leg drags.**

Wie wir ihn fliehen, As we flee from him, **We flee.**

Uns hinterdrein! Behind us! **Behind!**

Mephistopheles

Verflucht Geschick! Betrogne Mannsen! Cursed fate!
Deceived men! **Curse! Tricked!**

Von Adam her verfuhrte Hansen! Seduced fools since
Adam! **Adam's fools.**

Alt wird man wohl, wer aber klug? Old one grows in-
deed, but who grows wise? **Old but dumb.**

Warst du nicht schon vernarrt genug! Were you not
already foolish enough! **Fool enough!**

Man weiss, das Volk taugt aus dem Grunde nichts,
One knows this folk is worthless to the core, **Worth-
less folk.**

Geschnurten Leibs, geschminkten Angesichts. With
laced bodies, painted faces. **Fake looks.**

Nichts haben sie Gesundes zu erwidern, Nothing
wholesome have they to offer, **Nothing real.**

Wo man sie anfasst, morsch in allen Gliedern. Wherever one touches them, rotten in every limb. **All rotten.**

Man weiss, man sieht's, man kann es greifen, One knows, one sees it, one can grasp it, **Know, see, feel.**

Und dennoch tanzt man, wenn die Luder pfeifen! And yet one dances when the hussies pipe! **Dance anyway!**

Lamien

Halt! er besinnt sich, zaudert, steht; Stop! He pauses, hesitates, stands; **He stops.**

Entgegnet ihm, dass er euch nicht entgeht! Meet him, lest he escape you! **Don't lose him!**

Mephistopheles

Nur zu! und lass dich ins Gewebe Go on then! And don't get foolishly **Go on!**

Der Zweifelei nicht torig ein; Entangled in the web of doubt; **Skip doubt.**

Denn wenn es keine Hexen gabe, For if there were no witches, **No witches?**

Wer Teufel mochte Teufel sein! Who the devil would want to be a devil! **Why devil?**

Lamien

Kreisen wir um diesen Helden! Let us circle around this hero! **Circle him!**

Liebe wird in seinem Herzen Love in his heart **Heart-love.**

Sich gewiss für eine melden. Will surely declare itself for one. **Will choose.**

Mephistopheles

Zwar bei ungewissem Schimmer Indeed, in the uncertain glimmer **Dim glow.**

Scheint ihr hübsche Frauenzimmer, You seem pretty women, **Look pretty.**

Und so mocht' ich euch nicht schelten. And so I would not chide you. **No chiding.**

Empuse

Auch nicht mich! als eine solche Nor me! As one such **Me too!**

Lasst mich ein in eure Folge. Let me into your train. **Let me in!**

Lamien

Die ist in unserm Kreis zuviel, She is too many in our circle, **One too many.**

Verdirbt doch immer unser Spiel. She always spoils our sport. **Spoils games.**

Empuse

Begrusst von Muhmichen Empuse, Greeted by little Cousin Empusa, **Cousin says hi!**

Der Trauten mit dem Eselsfusse! The dear one with the donkey's foot! **Donkey foot!**

Du hast nur einen Pferdefuss, You have only a horse's foot, **Just horse.**

Und doch, Herr Vetter, schonsten Gruss! And yet, dear Cousin, warmest greetings! **Hello cousin!**

Mephistopheles

Hier dacht' ich lauter Unbekannte Here I thought only strangers **Thought strangers.**

Und finde leider Nahverwandte; And find unfortunately close relatives; **Found family.**

Es ist ein altes Buch zu blättern: It is an old book to leaf through: **Old story.**

Vom Harz bis Hellas immer Vettern! From the Harz to Hellas, always cousins! **Cousins everywhere!**

Empuse

Entschieden weiss ich gleich zu handeln, I know immediately how to act decisively, **Act fast.**

In vieles konnt' ich mich verwandeln; Into many things I could transform myself; **Many shapes.**

Doch Euch zu Ehren hab' ich jetzt But in your honor I have now **For you.**

Das Eselskopfchen aufgesetzt. Put on the little donkey's head. **Donkey head!**

Mephistopheles

Ich merk', es hat bei diesen Leuten I notice, among these people **Notice here.**

Verwandtschaft Grosses zu bedeuten; Kinship has great meaning; **Family matters.**

Doch mag sich, was auch will, eraugnen, But let happen what may, **Whatever happens.**

Den Eselskopf mocht' ich verleugnen. The donkey's head I would prefer to deny. **Deny donkey.**

Lamien

Lass diese Garstige, sie verscheucht, Leave this ugly one, she scares away **Ditch ugly.**

Was irgend schon und lieblich deucht; Whatever seems fair and lovely; **Scares pretty.**

Was irgend schon und lieblich war' – Whatever might
be fair and lovely – **Kills beauty.**

Sie kommt heran, es ist nicht mehr! She approaches,
it is no more! **Northern witches—I had those hags
on speed-dial**

Mephistopheles

Auch diese Muhmchen zart und schmachtig, These
cousins too, delicate and slim, **These foreign spirits
don't quite match my style**

Sie sind mir allesamt verdächtig; They are all suspi-
cious to me; **The Blocksberg stays my comfy little
spot**

Und hinter solcher Wanglein Rosen And behind such
rosy cheeks **Wherever you are, you find yourself
—that's what**

Furcht' ich doch auch Metamorphosen. I fear also
metamorphoses. **Dame Ilse guards for us upon
her stone**

Lamien

Versuch es doch! sind unsrer viele. Try it then! We are
many. **On his height Heinrich stays alert, alone**

Greif zu! Und hast du Glück im Spiele, Reach out! And
if you have luck in the game, **The Snorers snarl at
misery all day**

Erhasche dir das beste Los. Snatch for yourself the best prize. **But all's been settled for a thousand years—hooray**

Was soll das lusterne Geleier? What is this lecherous droning? **Who the hell knows here where he walks or stands**

Du bist ein miserabler Freier, You are a miserable suitor, **If beneath him the ground might swell like glands?**

Stolzierst einher und tust so gross! – Strutting about and acting so grand! – **I'm strolling through a valley, smooth and neat**

Nun mischt er sich in unsre Scharen; Now he mingles in our throng; **And suddenly behind me rises—feat!**

Lasst nach und nach die Masken fahren Let drop the masks by degrees **A mountain—hardly deserving of the name**

Und gebt ihm euer Wesen bloss. And reveal your true nature to him. **But high enough to block my Sphinxes—lame**

Mephistopheles

Die Schonste hab' ich mir erlesen... The fairest I have chosen for myself... **Fire still flickers down the valley's floor**

O weh mir! welch ein durrer Besen! Woe is me! What

a withered broom! **And flames around this whole adventure tour**

Und diese?... Schmahliches Gesicht! And this one?...
A shameful face! **Still that saucy chorus dances, flirts, retreats**

Lamien

Verdienst du's besser? dunkt es nicht. Do you deserve better? Think not. **Roguishly prancing, giving teasing treats**

Mephistopheles

Die Kleine mocht' ich mir verpfanden... The little one I would like to secure for myself... **Easy now! I'm far too used to nibbling things**

Lacerte schlupft mir aus den Händen! A lizard slips out of my hands! **Wherever it is, you grab what the moment brings**

Und schlangenhaft der glatte Zopf. And snake-like the smooth braid. **Quickly, quicker! Keep on going!**

Dagegen fass' ich mir die Lange... Instead I seize the tall one... **Then again the pace is slowing!**

Da pack' ich eine Thyrsusstange, There I grab a thyrsus-staff, **Lingering, dawdling, chattering away**

Den Pinienapfel als den Kopf! The pine-cone as the head! **It's such delightful sport today**

Wo will's hinaus?... Noch eine Dicke, Where is this leading?... Yet another plump one, **To drag the old sinner in our wake**

An der ich mich vielleicht erquicke; On whom I might perhaps refresh myself; **Toward heavy penance for his sake**

Zum letztenmal gewagt! Es sei! Risked for the last time! So be it! **With stiff foot hobbling down the track**

Recht quammig, quappig, das bezahlen Really flabby, jiggly, that the Orientals **He comes a-stumbling, limping back**

Mit hohem Preis Orientalen... Pay a high price for... **He drags his leg along the ground**

Doch ach! der Bovist platzt entzwei! But alas! The puffball bursts in two! **As we flee—he follows us around!**

Lamien

Fahrt auseinander, schwankt und schwebet Scatter apart, sway and hover **Cursed fate! Deceived mankind since time began!**

Blitzartig, schwarzen Flugs umgebet Lightning-like, with black flight surround **Seduced fools—every one—since Adam ran!**

Den eingedrungenen Hexensohn! The intruding witch's son! **We all get old, but who gets wise? Not you!**

Unsichre, schauderhafte Kreise! Uncertain, shuddering circles! **Weren't you already fool enough? It's true!**

Schweigsamen Fittichs, Fledermause! Silent-winged, bats! **One knows these folk are worthless to the core**

Zu wohlfeil kommt er doch davon. Too cheaply does he escape. **Laced up tight and painted like a whore**

Mephistopheles

Viel kluger, scheint es, bin ich nicht geworden; Much wiser, it seems, I have not become; **Nothing healthy can they give in trade**

Absurd ist's hier, absurd im Norden, Absurd it is here, absurd in the North, **Touch them anywhere —they're rotten, decayed**

Gespenster hier wie dort vertrackt, Specters here as there confounded, **One knows, one sees, one grasps it plain and clear**

Volk und Poeten abgeschmackt. People and poets tasteless. **Yet still we dance when these hussies pipe—oh dear!**

Ist eben hier eine Mummenschanz It is just a masquerade here **Stop! He's pausing, hesitating now**

Wie überall, ein Sinentanz. As everywhere, a dance of the senses. **Meet him! Don't let him escape somehow!**

Ich griff nach holden Maskenzügen I grasped at lovely masked figures **Press on then! Don't get yourself stupidly caught**

Und fasste Wesen, dass mich's schauerte... And seized beings that made me shudder... **In webs of doubt—overthinking's for naught!**

Ich mochte gerne mich betrogen, I would gladly deceive myself, **For if there were no witches to be found**

Wenn es nur länger dauerte. If only it lasted longer. **Who the devil would want devils around?**

Wo bin ich denn? Wo will's hinaus? Where am I then? Where is this going? **Let's circle around this hero here!**

Das war ein Pfad, nun ist's ein Graus. That was a path, now it's a horror. **Love in his heart will make it clear**

Ich kam daher auf glatten Wegen, I came here on smooth paths, **He'll pick one of us—that's the deal!**

Und jetzt steht mir Geroll entgegen. And now rubble

stands before me. **True, in this uncertain gleaming light**

Vergebens kletter' ich auf und nieder, In vain I climb up and down, **You seem like pretty ladies—quite!**

Wo find' ich meine Sphinxen wieder? Where shall I find my Sphinxes again? **So I shouldn't scold—you look alright**

So toll hatt' ich mir's nicht gedacht, So mad I had not imagined it, **Me too! Let me join your parade!**

Ein solch Gebirge in einer Nacht! Such a mountain range in one night! **Into your troupe I want to wade!**

Das heiss' ich frischen Hexenritt, That I call a bold witch-ride, **This one's too much for our circle here**

Die bringen ihren Blocksberg mit. They bring their Blocksberg with them. **She always spoils our sport, I fear**

Oreas

Herauf hier! Mein Gebirg ist alt, Come up here! My mountain is old, **Greetings from little Cousin Empusa—me!**

Steht in ursprunglicher Gestalt. Stands in its original form. **The darling with the donkey foot, you see!**

Verehere schroffe Felsensteige, Revere the steep rocky stairs, **You've only got a horse-hoof there**

Des Pindus letztgedehnte Zweige! The last extended branches of Pindus! **But still, dear Cousin —greetings fair!**

Schon stand ich unerschuttert so, Already I stood thus unshaken **I thought I'd find only strangers here to-day**

Als uber mich Pompejus floh. When over me Pompey fled. **Yet sadly close relations come my way!**

Daneben das Gebild des Wahns Beside me this creation of delusion **An old old book to leaf through, this one**

Verswindet schon beim Krahn des Hahns. Vanishes already at the crow of the cock. **From Harz to Hellas —cousins, every one!**

Dergleichen Marchen seh' ich oft entstehn Such fables I often see arise **I'm quick to act decisively, you know**

Und plotzlich wieder untergehn. And suddenly go down again. **Into many things I can shift and flow**

Mephistopheles

Sei Ehre dir, ehrwurdiges Haupt, Honor be to you, venerable head, **But in your honor, specially today**

Von hoher Eichenkraft umlaubt! Crowned with lofty oak-strength! **I've put on the little donkey head—hooray!**

Der allerklarste Mondenschein The clearest moon-
light **I notice kinship means a lot to these folk**

Dringt nicht zur Finsternis herein. – Penetrates not
into the darkness. – **Relationships matter—no joke**

Doch neben am Gebusche zieht Yet beside, through
the bushes moves **But let come what may, what-
ever betide**

Ein Licht, das gar bescheiden gluhet. A light that glows
quite modestly. **The donkey-head I'd rather deny**

Wie sich das alles fügen muss! How all things must fit
together! **Ditch the ugly one! She scares away**

Furwahr, es ist Homunculus! Truly, it is Homunculus!
Whatever seems fair and lovely today

Woher des Wegs, du Kleingeselle? Whence the way,
you little fellow? **Whatever could be lovely and
sweet**

Homunculus

Ich schwebe so von Stell' zu Stelle I hover thus from
place to place **She approaches—and it's obsolete!**

Und mochte gern im besten Sinn entstehn, And
would gladly, in the best sense, come to be, **These
little cousins too, so slim and fine**

Voll Ungeduld, mein Glas entzweizuschlagen; Full of
impatience to shatter my glass; **They all seem sus-
picious in design**

Allein, was ich bisher gesehn, Yet what I have seen so far, **Behind those roses on their cheeks so fair**

Hinein da mocht' ich mich nicht wagen. Into that I would not dare venture. **I fear metamorphosis lurks there**

Nur, um dir's im Vertraun zu sagen: Only, to tell you in confidence: **Try it then! We're plenty to sample here!**

Zwei Philosophen bin ich auf der Spur, I am on the trail of two philosophers, **Reach out! If luck's with you—have no fear**

Ich horchte zu, es hiess: Natur, Natur! I listened, it was: Nature, Nature! **Snatch yourself the very best prize!**

Von diesen will ich mich nicht trennen, From these I will not separate, **What's with this lecherous moaning—guys?**

Sie müssen doch das irdische Wesen kennen; They must surely know earthly existence; **You're one miserable suitor indeed**

Und ich erfahre wohl am Ende, And I shall learn in the end **Strutting around like you're top seed!**

Wohin ich mich am allerklugsten wende. Where I should most wisely turn. **Now he mingles with our pack**

Mephistopheles

Das tu auf deine eigne Hand. Do that on your own.
Drop the masks, no holding back

Denn wo Gespenster Platz genommen, For where specters have taken their place, **And show him what we're really like!**

Ist auch der Philosoph willkommen. The philosopher is also welcome. **The fairest one I've chosen for my own—**

Damit man seiner Kunst und Gunst sich freue, So that one may enjoy his art and favor, **Good grief! What a withered broomstick-bone!**

Erschafft er gleich ein Dutzend neue. He straightway creates a dozen new ones. **And this one?... Shameful face on show!**

Wenn du nicht irrst, kommst du nicht zu Verstand. If you do not err, you will not gain understanding. **You deserve better? I think no!**

Willst du entstehn, entsteh auf eigne Hand! If you wish to come to be, come to be on your own! **The little one I'd like to secure—**

Homunculus

Ein guter Rat ist auch nicht zu verschmahn. Good counsel is also not to be scorned. **A lizard slips right out the door!**

Mephistopheles

So fahre hin! Wir wollen's weiter sehn. Then go your way! We shall see further. **And snake-like glides the smooth braid away**

Anaxagoras

Dein starrer Sinn will sich nicht beugen; Your stubborn mind will not bend; **So I'll grab the tall one instead, I say—**

Bedarf es Weitres, dich zu überzeugen? Is more needed to convince you? **I've got a thyrsus-staff in hand**

Thales

Die Welle beugt sich jedem Winde gern, The wave bends willingly to every wind, **Pine-cone for a head—how grand!**

Doch halt sie sich vom schroffen Felsen fern. Yet keeps itself far from the rugged cliff. **Where is this leading?... One more, round and plump**

Anaxagoras

Durch Feuerdunst ist dieser Fels zu Handen. By fire-vapor this rock came to hand. **On whom perhaps I'll cure this slump**

Thales

Im Feuchten ist Lebendiges erstanden. In moisture has the living arisen. **One last gamble! Here goes—okay!**

Homunculus

Lasst mich an eurer Seite gehn. Let me go at your side.

Really jiggly, really soft—they say

Mir selbst gelustet's, zu entstehn! I myself desire to come to be! **Oriental pay top dollar for this kind**

Thales

Nie war Natur und ihr lebendiges Fliessen Never was Nature and her living flow **But ough! The puffball bursts! Never mind!**

Auf Tag und Nacht und Stunden angewiesen. Dependent on day and night and hours. **Scatter! Sway and hover all around!**

Sie bildet regelnd jegliche Gestalt, She forms, regulating, every shape, **Lightning-fast with blackened flight surround**

Und selbst im Grossen ist es nicht Gewalt. And even on a large scale it is not force. **The intruding witch's son with dread!**

Anaxagoras

Hier aber war's! Plutonisch grimmig Feuer, But here it was! Plutonic fierce fire, **Uncertain shuddering circles overhead!**

Aolischer Dunste Knallkraft, ungeheuer, Aeolian vapors' explosive force, monstrous, **Silent-winged like bats we fly!**

Durchbrach des flachen Bodens alte Kruste, Broke through the flat ground's ancient crust, **Too cheaply he escapes—oh my!**

Dass neu ein Berg sogleich entstehen musste. So that a new mountain had at once to arise. **Much wiser I have not become, it seems**

Thales

Was wird dadurch nun weiter fortgesetzt? What is thereby further continued? **Absurd here, absurd up north—extremes!**

Er ist auch da, und das ist gut zuletzt. It is also there, and that is good in the end. **Specters here as there, completely cracked**

Mit solchem Streit verliert man Zeit und Weile With such strife one loses time and leisure **People and poets—totally whacked**

Und fuhrt doch nur geduldig Volk am Seile. And only leads patient people on a leash. **It's just a masquerade everywhere you go**

Anaxagoras

Schnell quillt der Berg von Myrmidonen, Quickly the mountain swarms with Myrmidons, **A dance of the senses, high and low**

Die Felsenspalten zu bewohnen; To dwell in the rocky clefts; **I grasped at lovely masked disguise**

Pygmaen, Imsen, Daumerlinge Pygmies, emmets, thumbings **And seized things that made me realize...**

Und andre tatig kleine Dinge. And other active little things. **I shuddered—yet I'd gladly be deceived**

Nie hast du Grossem nachgestrebt, Never have you striven for greatness, **If only it lasted longer than conceived**

Einsiedlerisch-beschränkt gelebt; Lived in hermit-like limitation; **Where am I? Where's this heading anyway?**

Kannst du zur Herrschaft dich gewöhnen, If you can accustom yourself to rule, **That was a path, now it's dismay**

So lass ich dich als König kronen. Then I will have you crowned as king. **I came along on roads all smooth and slick**

Homunculus

Was sagt mein Thales? – What says my Thales? – **Now rubble blocks me—what a trick!**

Thales

Will's nicht raten; I advise against it; **In vain I scramble up and down**

Mit Kleinen tut man kleine Taten, With small ones one
does small deeds, **Where will I find my Sphinxes in
this town?**

Mit Grossen wird der Kleine gross. With great ones
the small one becomes great. **I never imagined it
so mad as this**

Sieh hin! die schwarze Kranichwolke! Look there!
The black crane-cloud! **A mountain range in one
night—hit or miss!**

Sie droht dem aufgeregten Volke It threatens the agi-
tated people **Now THAT I call a fresh witch-ride**

Und wurde so dem König drohn. And would thus
threaten the king. **They bring their Blocksberg
along for the ride!**

Mit scharfen Schnabeln, krallen Beinen, With sharp
beaks, clawed legs, **Come up here! My mountain's
ancient stone**

Sie stechen nieder auf die Kleinen; They strike down
upon the little ones; **Stands in original shape, fully
grown**

Verhangnis wetterleuchtet schon. Doom already
flashes lightning. **Revere the rugged rocky stairs**

Ein Frevel totete die Reiher, A crime killed the herons,
The last stretched branches Pindus bears!

Umstellend ruhigen Friedensweiher. Surrounding
the peaceful pond. **Unshaken thus I stood the test**

Doch jener Mordgeschosse Regen Yet that rain of murderous missiles **When Pompey fled across my crest**

Schafft grausam-blut'gen Rachesegen, Creates cruel, bloody blessing of revenge, **That creation of delusion by my side**

Erregt der Nahverwandten Wut Arouses the rage of close kin **At cockcrow vanishes—no place to hide**

Nach der Pygmaen frevlem Blut. For the Pygmies' criminal blood. **Such fables I've often seen arise**

Was nutzt nun Schild und Helm und Speer? What use now is shield and helmet and spear? **And suddenly vanish before my eyes**

Was hilft der Reiherstrahl den Zwergen? What help is the heron-plume to the dwarfs? **Honor to you, venerable ancient head**

Wie sich Daktyl und Imse bergen! How the Dactyls and emmets hide! **Crowned by lofty oak-strength's spread!**

Schon wankt, es flieht, es stürzt das Heer. Already the army wavers, flees, collapses. **The clearest moonlight cannot pierce below**

Anaxagoras

Konnt' ich bisher die Unterirdischen loben, If I could hitherto praise the subterranean ones, **Into your darkness's deepest glow**

So wend' ich mich in diesem Fall nach oben... Then
in this case I turn upward... **But through the bushes
there—a modest light**

Du! droben ewig Unveraltete, You! Above, eternally
unageworn, **Glowing softly in the night**

Dreiamig-Dreigestaltete, Triple-named, triple-
formed, **How everything fits together so!**

Dich ruf' ich an bei meines Volkes Weh, I call upon you
in my people's woe, **Why, it's Homunculus! What a
show!**

Diana, Luna, Hekate! Diana, Luna, Hecate! **Where
from, little fellow—where do you roam?**

Du Brusterweiternde, im Tiefsten Sinnige, You heart-
expanding one, deepest in thought, **I float along
from place to place, my home**

Du Ruhigscheinende, Gewaltsam-Innige, You calmly-
shining one, forcefully-fervent, **And gladly wish, in
the best sense, to be**

Eroffne deiner Schatten grausen Schlund, Open the
dread abyss of your shadows, **Full of impatience to
shatter my glass, you see**

Die alte Macht sei ohne Zauber kund! Let the ancient
power be revealed without spell! **Yet what I've seen
so far in this domain**

Bin ich zu schnell erhört? Am I too swiftly heard? **Into
THAT I wouldn't dare venture—too insane!**

Hat mein Flehn Has my plea **Just to tell you in confidence, you know**

Nach jenen Hohn To those heights **Two philosophers I'm tracking down below**

Die Ordnung der Natur gestört? Disturbed the order of nature? **I listened in: "Nature, Nature!" they both cried**

Und grosser, immer grosser nahet schon And greater, ever greater now approaches **From these two I refuse to be pried**

Der Gottin rundumschriebner Thron, The goddess's orb'd throne, **They must know earthly existence through and through**

Dem Auge furchtbar, ungeheuer! Fearful to the eye, monstrous! **And I'll learn in the end where best to pursue**

Ins Düst're rotet sich sein Feuer... Into the darkness reddens its fire... **The wisest course for me to take**

Nicht naher, drohend-mächtige Runde! No nearer, threateningly-mighty sphere! **Do that on your own, for your own sake**

Du richtest uns und Land und Meer zugrunde! You will ruin us and land and sea! **For where specters have taken their seat**

So war' es wahr, dass dich thessalische Frauen So would it be true that Thessalian women **Philosophers are welcome to compete**

In frevlemd magischem Vertrauen With criminal magical confidence **So they can enjoy his art and favor —see**

Von deinem Pfad herabgesungen, Sang you down from your path, **He creates a dozen new specters instantly!**

Verderblichstes dir abgerungen?... Wrung from you the most destructive things?... **If you don't err, you won't gain understanding's prize**

Das lichte Schild hat sich umdunkelt, The bright shield has darkened, **Want to come into being? Do it yourself, wise guys!**

Auf einmal reisst's und blitzt und funkelt! Suddenly it tears and flashes and sparkles! **Good counsel shouldn't be dismissed outright**

Welch ein Geprassel! Welch ein Zischen! What a crackling! What a hissing! **Then go! We'll see what comes to light!**

Ein Donnern, Windgetum dazwischen! – A thunder, wind-roar between! – **Your stubborn mind refuses to bend!**

Demutig zu des Thrones Stufen! – Humbly to the steps of the throne! – **What more do you need to comprehend?**

Verzeiht! Ich hab' es hergerufen. Forgive! I have summoned it. **The wave gladly bends to every wind that blows**

Thales

Was dieser Mann nicht alles hort' und sah! What this man has not heard and seen! **Yet keeps its distance where the craggy cliff grows**

Ich weiss nicht recht, wie uns geschah, I do not rightly know what happened to us, **By fire-vapor this rock came to be!**

Auch hab' ich's nicht mit ihm empfunden. Nor did I experience it with him. **In moisture all that lives was born, you see!**

Gestehen wir, es sind verruckte Stunden, Let us confess, these are crazy hours, **Let me walk beside you two!**

Und Luna wiegt sich ganz bequem And Luna rocks herself quite comfortably **I myself yearn to become—it's true!**

An ihrem Platz, so wie vordem. In her place, as before. **Nature and her living flow never depended**

Homunculus

Schaut hin nach der Pygmaen Sitz! Look yonder at the Pygmies' seat! **On day or night or hours—never ended**

Der Berg war rund, jetzt ist er spitz. The mountain was round, now it is pointed. **She forms each shape by**

her own regulation

Ich spurt' ein ungeheures Prallen, I felt a monstrous rebound, **And even at grand scale—it's not conflagration!**

Der Fels war aus dem Mond gefallen; The rock had fallen from the moon; **But HERE it was! Plutonic fire ran hot**

Gleich hat er, ohne nachzufragen, At once, without asking, **Aeolian vapor's explosive blast—a lot!**

So Freund als Feind gequetscht, erschlagen. It crushed and slew both friend and foe. **Broke through the ancient crust of ground**

Doch muss ich solche Kunste loben, Yet I must praise such arts, **So that at once a new mountain could be found!**

Die schöpferisch, in einer Nacht, Which creatively, in one night, **What further good does that provide?**

Zugleich von unten und von oben, From below and from above at once, **It's there—that's fine—let's set the point aside**

Dies Berggebau zustand gebracht. Brought this mountain structure into being. **With such disputes we waste our time for naught**

Thales

Sei ruhig! Es war nur gedacht. Be calm! It was only imagined. **And only lead patient fools by a thought**

Sie fahre hin, die garstige Brut! Away with them, the ugly brood! **Quickly the mount swarms with Myrmidons now**

Dass du nicht König warst, ist gut. That you were not king is good. **To dwell in the rocky clefts—and how!**

Nun fort zum heitern Meeresfeste, Now away to the cheerful sea-festival, **Pygmies, emmets, thumbings too**

Dort hofft und ehrt man Wundergäste. There they hope for and honor wondrous guests. **And other busy little things right on cue**

Mephistopheles

Da muss ich mich durch steile Felsentreppen, Here must I drag myself through steep rocky stairs, **You've never striven for greatness, I'd say**

Durch alter Eichen starre Wurzeln schleppen! Through ancient oaks' rigid roots! **Lived hermit-limited every day**

Auf meinem Harz der harzige Dunst On my Harz the resinous vapor **If you can get used to ruling the roost**

Hat was vom Pech, und das hat meine Gunst, Has something of pitch, and that has my favor, **I'll crown you king—your status get a boost!**

Zunächst dem Schwefel... Hier, bei diesen Griechen

Next to sulphur... Here, among these Greeks **What says my Thales?**

Ist von dergleichen kaum die Spur zu riechen; There is scarcely a trace of such to smell; **I advise against it**

Neugierig aber war' ich, nachzuspuren, Yet I would be curious to discover **With small ones you do small deeds—forget it**

Womit sie Hollenqual und -flamme schüren. With what they fuel hellfire and flames. **With great ones the small become great too**

Dryas

In deinem Lande sei einheimisch klug, In your land be domestically clever, **Look there! The black crane-cloud in view!**

Im fremden bist du nicht gewandt genug. In a foreign land you are not adept enough. **It threatens the agitated folk below**

Du solltest nicht den Sinn zur Heimat kehren, You should not turn your mind toward home, **And would threaten the king just so**

Der heiligen Eichen Wurde hier verehren. But revere here the dignity of the sacred oaks. **With sharp beaks and clawed legs they strike**

Mephistopheles

Man denkt an das, was man verliess; One thinks of what one left behind; **Down upon the little ones they don't like**

Was man gewohnt war, bleibt ein Paradies. What one was used to remains a Paradise. **Doom flashes lightning—fate's at hand!**

Doch sagt: was in der Hohle dort, But say: what in that cave there, **A crime slew the herons in peaceful pond-land**

Bei schwachem Licht, sich dreifach hingekauert? In dim light, has crouched down threefold? **But that rain of arrows, murderous and mean**

Dryas

Die Phorkyaden! Wage dich zum Ort The Phorcyads! Venture to the place **Creates bloody revenge—a ghastly scene!**

Und sprich sie an, wenn dich nicht schauert. And address them, if you do not shudder. **Arouses close kin's raging blood-lust**

Mephistopheles

Warum denn nicht! – Ich sehe was, und staune! Why not! – I see something, and am amazed! **For Pygmy guilt—revenge is a must!**

So stolz ich bin, muss ich mir selbst gestehn: Proud as I am, I must confess to myself: **What good now are shield, helmet, spear?**

Dergleichen hab' ich nie gesehen, The likes of this I have never seen, **What help is the heron plume to dwarfs here?**

Die sind ja schlimmer als Alraune... They are indeed worse than mandrakes... **How the Dactyls and emmets hide away!**

Wird man die urverworfenen Sunden Will one find the primal-rejected sins **The army wavers, flees, collapses today!**

Im mindesten noch hasslich finden, Ugly in the least, **If I praised subterranean powers till now**

Wenn man dies Dreigetum erblickt? When one beholds this triple monster? **In this case I turn upward—here's how...**

Wir litten sie nicht auf den Schwellen We would not suffer them on the thresholds **You! Above! Eternally unaged!**

Der grauenvollsten unsrer Hollen. Of the most dreadful of our hells. **Triple-named, triple-formed, engaged!**

Hier wurzelt's in der Schönheit Land, Here it takes root in the land of Beauty, **I call on you in my people's woe!**

Das wird mit Ruhm antik genannt... That is called an-

tique with glory... **Diana, Luna, Hecate below!**

Sie regen sich, sie scheinen mich zu spüren, They stir,
they seem to sense me, **You heart-expander, deepest in thought!**

Sie zwitschern pfeifend, Fledermaus-Vampyren.
They twitter shrilly, bat-vampires. **Calmly shining, fiercely distraught!**

Phorkyaden

Gebt mir das Auge, Schwestern, dass es spahe, Give
me the eye, sisters, that it may spy **Open the dread abyss of your shadow's cave!**

Wer sich dem Tempel wagt so nahe. Who ventures so
near to the temple. **Let ancient power show without spell—be brave!**

Mephistopheles

Verehrteste! Erlaubt mir, euch zu nahen Most honored ones!
Allow me to approach you **Am I too quickly heard? My plea**

Und euren Segen dreifach zu empfangen. And to
receive your blessing threefold. **Has it disturbed nature's harmony?**

Ich trete vor, zwar noch als Unbekannter, I step forward,
still as a stranger, **Up to those heights above**

Doch, irr' ich nicht, weitlaufiger Verwandter. Yet, if I err not, a distant relative. **Have I troubled the order of?**

Altwürdige Gotter hab' ich schon erblickt, Ancient venerable gods I have already beheld, **And greater, ever greater draws near**

Vor Ops und Rhea tiefstens mich gebuckt; Before Ops and Rhea most deeply bowed; **The goddess's orb'd throne, I fear!**

Die Parzen selbst, des Chaos, eure Schwestern, The Fates themselves, of Chaos, your sisters, **Fearsome to see, monstrous sight!**

Ich sah sie gestern – oder ehegestern; I saw them yesterday – or day before; **Into darkness its fire reddens bright...**

Doch euresgleichen hab' ich nie erblickt. But your like I have never beheld. **No closer, threateningly mighty sphere!**

Ich schweige nun und fühle mich entzückt. I am silent now and feel myself enraptured. **You'll ruin us, land and sea—oh dear!**

Phorkyaden

Er scheint Verstand zu haben, dieser Geist. He seems to have understanding, this spirit. **So it's true? Thessalian women's art**

Mephistopheles

Nur wundert's mich, dass euch kein Dichter preist.
Only it amazes me that no poet praises you. **In
wicked magic played their part**

Und sagt: wie kam's, wie konnte das geschehn? And
say: how was it, how could it happen? **Sang you
down from your heavenly track**

Im Bilde hab' ich nie euch Wurdigste gesehn; In im-
ages I have never seen you, most worthy ones; **Wrung
destruction from you—brought you back?**

Versuch's der Meissel doch, euch zu erreichen, Let the
chisel try to attain you, **The bright shield has gone
all dark**

Nicht Juno, Pallas, Venus und dergleichen. Not Juno,
Pallas, Venus and the like. **Suddenly it tears and
flashes—hark!**

Phorkyaden

Versenkt in Einsamkeit und stillste Nacht, Sunk in soli-
tude and stillest night, **What a crackling! What a
hiss!**

Hat unser Drei noch nie daran gedacht! Our Three
have never yet thought of it! **Thunder, wind-roar—
it's hit or miss!**

Mephistopheles

Wie sollt' es auch? da ihr, der Welt entrückt, How
should you? Since you, removed from the world,
Humbly to the throne's steps I fall!

Hier niemand seht und niemand euch erblickt. See
no one here and no one sees you. **Forgive me! I
summoned this all!**

Da musstet ihr an solchen Orten wohnen, Then you
should dwell in such places, **What this man hasn't
heard and seen!**

Wo Pracht und Kunst auf gleichem Sitze thronen,
Where splendor and art share an equal throne, **I
don't quite know what's been**

Wo jeden Tag, behend, im Doppelschritt, Where every
day, nimbly, in double time, **Nor did I experience it
with him**

Ein Marmorblock als Held ins Leben tritt. A marble
block strides into life as a hero. **Let's confess—these
hours are crazy and grim**

Wo – Where – **And Luna rocks quite comfortably
along**

Phorkyaden

Schweige still und gib uns kein Gelusten! Be silent
and give us no desire! **In her place as before
—nothing wrong**

Was hulf' es uns, und wenn wir's besser wussten?
What would it help us, even if we knew better? **Look**

at where the Pygmies were!

In Nacht geboren, Nachtlichem verwandt, Born in night, akin to the nocturnal, **The mountain was round—now it's a spur!**

Beinah uns selbst, ganz allen unbekannt. Almost to ourselves, quite to all, unknown. **I felt a monstrous rebound hit**

Mephistopheles

In solchem Fall hat es nicht viel zu sagen, In such a case it does not matter much, **Rock fallen from the moon—that's it!**

Man kann sich selbst auch andern ubertragen. One can also transfer oneself to others. **At once, without bothering to ask**

Euch dreien gnugt ein Auge, gnugt ein Zahn; For you three, one eye suffices, one tooth suffices; **It crushed both friend and foe—quite a task**

Da ging' es wohl auch mythologisch an, Then it would also be mythologically possible, **Yet I must praise such arts indeed**

In zwei die Wesenheit der drei zu fassen, To compress the essence of the three into two, **Creatively, in one night's speed**

Der Dritten Bildnis mir zu uberlassen, And leave to me the image of the third, **From below and above all at once**

Auf kurze Zeit. – For a short time. – **This mountain structure built—no bunce**

Eine

Wie dunkt's euch? ging' es an? What think you? Would it work? **Calm down! It was only thought**

Die Andern

Versuchen wir's! – doch ohne Aug' und Zahn. Let us try it! – but without eye and tooth. **Away with that ugly brood—they're naught!**

Mephistopheles

Nun habt ihr grad das Beste weggenommen; Now you have taken away just the best; **That you weren't king—that's good to know**

Wie wurde da das strengste Bild vollkommen! How would the sternest image then be complete! **Now off to the cheerful sea-fest we go!**

Eine

Druck du ein Auge zu, 's ist leicht geschehn, Close one eye, it is easily done, **There they hope for and honor wondrous guest**

Lass alsofort den einen Raffzahn sehn, Then let one fang be seen at once, **I must drag through steep**

rocky stairs

Und im Profil wirst du sogleich erreichen, And in profile you will immediately achieve **Through ancient oaks' stiff roots and layers!**

Geschwisterlich vollkommen uns zu gleichen. A sisterly, perfect resemblance to us. **On my Harz the resinous vapor's got**

Mephistopheles

Viel Ehr'! Es sei! – Great honor! So be it! – **A whiff of pitch—and that I like a lot!**

Phorkyaden

Es sei! – So be it! – **Just after sulfur... Here with Greeks about**

Mephistopheles

Da steh' ich schon, There I stand already, **There's hardly a trace of such stuff to sniff out**

Des Chaos vielgeliebter Sohn! The much-beloved son of Chaos! **But I'd be curious to discover the way**

Phorkyaden

Des Chaos Tochter sind wir unbestritten. Daughters of Chaos we are, undisputed. **They fuel hellfire and flames today**

Mephistopheles

Man schilt mich nun, o Schmach, Hermaphroditen.
They will now call me, oh shame, a hermaphrodite.

In your land be locally smart

Phorkyaden

Im neuen Drei der Schwestern welche Schöne! In the
new three of sisters, what beauty! **In foreign lands
you lack the art**

Wir haben zwei der Augen, zwei der Zähne. We have
two eyes, two teeth. **Don't turn your thoughts to-
ward home—instead**

Mephistopheles

Vor aller Augen muss ich mich verstecken, From all
eyes I must hide myself, **Revere the sacred oaks'
dignity widespread**

Im Hollenpfuhl die Teufel zu erschrecken. To frighten
the devils in the pool of hell. **One thinks of what one
left behind**

Felsbuchten des ägaischen Meers / Rocky Coves of the Aegean Sea

Sirenen

Haben sonst bei nachtigem Grauen Though erewhile,
by spells nocturnal, **Witches dragged you down?**
That's yesterday's news

Dich thessalische Zauberfrauen Thee Thessalian
witches **Tonight you're queen of the cosmic
cruise**

Frevelhaft herabgezogen, With guilty intent drew
down, **Arc your light over trembling seas**

Blicke ruhig von dem Bogen Look calmly from the
arch **Flash your silver wherever you please**

Deiner Nacht auf Zitterwogen Of your night upon the
trembling waves **Mild-glowing swarm? You're the
disco ball**

Mildeblitzend Glanzgewimmel Mildly-flashing swarm
of brightness **Lighting up the tumult, one and all**

Und erleuchte das Getummel, And illuminate the tu-
mult **Rising from the waves—the party's here**

Das sich aus den Wogen hebt! That rises from the
waves! **Ready to serve with supernatural cheer**

Dir zu jedem Dienst erbotig, Ready for your every ser-
vice, **Luna, you're our girl, our gracious moon**

Schöne Luna, sei uns gnädig! Fair Luna, be gracious
to us! **Bless this rave—it's never too soon!**

Nereiden und Tritonen

Tonet laut in scharfern Tönen, Sound aloud in sharper
tones, **Blast the speakers, make it loud**

Die das breite Meer durchdrohnen, Which resound
through the broad sea, **Thunder through the ocean
crowd**

Volk der Tiefe ruft fortan! Folk of the deep, call forth!
Deep-sea gang, report for duty!

Vor des Sturmes grausen Schlunden Before the
storm's dread maw **Storm wanted lunch—we said
no thanks**

Wichen wir zu stillsten Grunden, We retreated to stillest depths, **Dove down deep and hid in banks**

Holder Sang zieht uns heran. Sweet song draws us hither. **But your song? That's the booty**

Seht, wie wir im Hochentzucken See how in high delight **Check us out, we're living large**

Uns mit goldenen Ketten schmucken, We adorn ourselves with golden chains, **Gold chains, we're in charge**

Auch zu Kron' und Edelsteinen Also with crown and jewels **Crowns and gems, the whole nine yards**

Spang- und Gurtelschmuck vereinen! Unite clasp and girdle-ornaments! **Buckles, belts—we hold the cards!**

Alles das ist eure Frucht. All this is your fruit. **All this loot? You made it rain**

Schatze, scheiternd hier verschlungen, Treasures, here in shipwreck swallowed, **Shipwrecked gold from every lane**

Habt ihr uns herangesungen, You have sung toward us, **You sang them here, you wicked choir**

Ihr Dämonen unsrer Bucht. You daemons of our bay. **Bay demons setting souls on fire!**

Sirenen

Wissen's wohl, in Meeresfrische We know well, in
ocean's freshness **Fish are vibing, we're aware**

Glatt behagen sich die Fische, The fish enjoy them-
selves smoothly, **Smooth and easy, without care**

Schwanken Lebens ohne Leid; Wavering life without
sorrow; **Just floating through their days**

Doch, ihr festlich regen Scharen, Yet, you festively stir-
ring throngs, **But you party people, hear our call**

Heute mochten wir erfahren, Today we would like to
learn **Time to show you've got it all**

Dass ihr mehr als Fische seid. That you are more than
fish. **More than fish—impress and amaze!**

Nereiden und Tritonen

Ehe wir hieher gekommen, Before we came hither,
We planned ahead, we're not dumb

Haben wir's zu Sinn genommen; We took it to heart;
Took the thought—here we come!

Schwestern, Bruder, jetzt geschwind! Sisters, broth-
ers, now quickly! **Brothers, sisters, move it fast!**

Heut bedarf's der kleinsten Reise Today requires the
shortest journey **Quick trip, valid point to make**

Zum vollgültigsten Beweise, For the most valid proof
Fullest proof for goodness' sake

Dass wir mehr als Fische sind. That we are more than fish. **More than fish—we're unsurpassed!**

Sirenen

Fort sind sie im Nu! Gone they are in an instant!
Whoosh! They're outta here, gone fast

Nach Samothrace grade zu, Straight to Samothrace,
Samothrace-bound, they zoomed past

Verschwunden mit gunstigem Wind. Vanished with favorable wind. **Wind at their backs—perfect timing**

Was denken sie zu vollfuhren What do they think to accomplish **What's their game? What's the scheme?**

Im Reiche der hohen Kabiren? In the realm of the lofty Cabiri? **Cabiri's realm—a godly dream**

Sind Gotter! Wundersam eigen, They are gods! Wonderously strange, **Gods! But weird—self-rhyming**

Die sich immerfort selbst erzeugen Who continually beget themselves **They make themselves eternally**

Und niemals wissen, was sie sind. And never know what they are. **Clueless what they're meant to be**

Bleibe auf deinen Hohn, Remain on your heights,
Luna, stay up on your arc

Holde Luna, gnadig stehn, Sweet Luna, graciously stand, **Keep it gracious in the dark**

Dass es nachtig verbleibe, That it may remain night,
Let the night remain in power

Uns der Tag nicht vertreibe! That the day may not
drive us away! **Don't let daylight steal our hour!**

Thales

Ich mochte dich wohl gern zu Nereus fuhren, I would
gladly lead you to Nereus, **Want to meet Nereus?**
Cave's nearby

Nicht fern sind wir von seiner Hohle hier; Not far are
we from his cavern here; **Not far at all—let's give it
a try**

Doch hat er einen harten Kopf, But he has a hard head,
Fair warning: hard-headed old guy

Der widerwärtige Sauertopf. The repulsive sourpuss.
Total sourpuss—don't know why

Das ganze menschliche Geschlecht The whole human
race **Humans can never get it right**

Macht's ihm, dem Griesgram, nimmer recht. Never
satisfies him, the grumbler. **According to this
grumpy knight**

Doch ist die Zukunft ihm entdeckt, Yet the future is re-
vealed to him, **But futures? He's got the gift**

Dafür hat jedermann Respekt For that everyone has
respect **That earns respect—gives his rep a lift**

Und ehret ihn auf seinem Posten; And honors him in his station; **Honored in his watery post**

Auch hat er manchem wohlgetan. Also he has done good to many. **And helpful too—not one to boast**

Homunculus

Probieren wir's und klopfen an! Let us try it and knock! **Let's knock—nothing ventured, nothing gained**

Nicht gleich wird's Glas und Flamme kosten. It will not immediately cost glass and flame. **Glass intact, flame unstrained!**

Nereus

Sind's Menschenstimmen, die mein Ohr vernimmt? Are these human voices that my ear perceives? **Human voices? Seriously? Here?**

Wie es mir gleich im tiefsten Herzen grimmt! How it immediately angers my deepest heart! **My heart fills with rage and sneer**

Gebilde, strebsam, Gotter zu erreichen, Creatures, striving to reach the gods, **Always reaching for the gods above**

Und doch verdammt, sich immer selbst zu gleichen. And yet condemned always to resemble themselves. **Condemned to be themselves—no love**

Seit alten Jahren konnt' ich gottlich ruhn, In ancient years I could rest divinely, **I used to chill in godly rest**

Doch trieb mich's an, den Besten wohlzutun; Yet I was driven to do good to the best; **But had to help—I'm blessed/cursed**

Und schaut' ich dann zuletzt vollbrachte Taten, And when at last I looked upon accomplished deeds, **And when I saw their deeds complete**

So war es ganz, als hatt' ich nicht geraten. It was quite as if I had not counseled. **My counsel? Worthless—total defeat!**

Thales

Und doch, o Greis des Meers, vertraut man dir; And yet, O graybeard of the sea, one trusts you; **Old man of the sea, we trust you still**

Du bist der Weise, treib uns nicht von hier! You are the wise one, do not drive us from here! **You're wise—don't give us the chill!**

Schau diese Flamme, menschenähnlich zwar, Behold this flame, human-like indeed, **This flame here looks pretty human, see**

Sie deinem Rat ergibt sich ganz und gar. It yields itself entirely to your counsel. **It yields to your wisdom completely!**

Nereus

Was Rat! Hat Rat bei Menschen je gegolten? What counsel! Has counsel ever counted with humans?

Advice? When did that ever work on men?

Ein kluges Wort erstarrt im harten Ohr. A wise word freezes in the hard ear. **Wisdom freezes in stubborn ears—and then?**

So oft auch Tat sich grimmig selbst gescholten, How-
ever often the deed has grimly scolded itself, **They
scold themselves but never learn**

Bleibt doch das Volk selbstwillig wie zuvor. Still the
people remain self-willed as before. **Stay self-willed
at every turn**

Wie hab' ich Paris vaterlich gewarnt, How paternally I
warned Paris, **I warned Paris like a caring dad**

Eh sein Gelust ein fremdes Weib umgarnt. Before
his lust ensnared a foreign woman. **Before his lust
made choices bad**

Am griechischen Ufer stand er kühnlich da, On the
Grecian shore he stood boldly, **He stood bold on
Greece's coast**

Ihm kundet' ich, was ich im Geiste sah: I told him what
I saw in spirit: **I showed him futures—not to boast**

Die Luft qualmend, überstromend Rot, The airs
smoking, overflowing red, **Smoke and red, every-
thing burning**

Gebalke gluhend, unten Mord und Tod: Beams glowing, below murder and death: **Murder and death, no one learning**

Trojas Gerichtstag, rhythmisch festgebannt, Troy's judgment day, rhythmically fixed, **Troy's doomsday, rhythmically set**

Jahrtausenden so schrecklich als gekannt. For millennia as terrible as known. **Millennia's worst disaster yet**

Des Alten Wort, dem Frechen schien's ein Spiel, The old man's word, to the reckless one it seemed a game, **My word? He thought it was a game**

Er folgte seiner Lust, und Ilios fiel – He followed his lust, and Ilion fell – **Followed his lust—Troy went up in flame**

Ein Riesenleichenam, starr nach langer Qual, A giant corpse, stiff after long agony, **Giant corpse, stiff and dead**

Des Pindus Adlern gar willkommnes Mahl. To Pindus' eagles a most welcome meal. **Eagle dinner—'nuff said**

Ulyssen auch! sagt' ich ihm nicht voraus Ulysses too! Did I not foretell him **Ulysses too! I warned him clear**

Der Circe Listen, des Zyklopen Graus? The wiles of Circe, the horror of the Cyclops? **Circe's traps, Cyclops' fear**

Das Zaudern sein, der Seinen leichten Sinn, His delay,
the light-mindedness of his men, **His delays, crew's
foolish way**

Und was nicht alles! Bracht' ihm das Gewinn? And
what not all! Did that bring him gain? **All for naught
—what can I say?**

Bis vielgeschaukelt ihn, doch spat genug, Until, much-
tossed, yet late enough, **Till tossed about by every
wave**

Der Woge Gunst an gastlich Ufer trug. The wave's fa-
vor bore him to hospitable shore. **The sea finally cut
him a break—he's saved**

Thales

Dem weisen Mann gibt solch Betragen Qual; Such
conduct gives the wise man pain; **That hurts the
wise, no doubt about it**

Der gute doch versucht es noch einmal. Yet the good
one tries again. **But good folks try again, can't
flout it**

Ein Quentchen Danks wird, hoch ihn zu vergnugen,
A scruple of thanks, to greatly please him, **One tiny
thanks brings massive cheer**

Die Zentner Undanks vollig uberwiegen. Will wholly
outweigh the hundredweight of ingratitude. **Out-
weighs tons of rudeness here**

Denn nichts Geringes haben wir zu flehn: For nothing

trifling have we to beg: **We're not here for something light**

Der Knabe da wünscht weislich zu entstehn. The boy here wishes wisely to come to be. **This boy wants existence—make it right!**

Nereus

Verderbt mir nicht den seltensten Humor! Do not spoil my rarest mood! **Don't blow my one good mood today**

Ganz andres steht mir heute noch bevor: Something quite different awaits me today: **Got better things coming my way**

Die Tochter hab' ich alle herbeschieden, I have summoned all my daughters hither, **Called all my daughters to the spot**

Die Grazien des Meeres, die Doriden. The Graces of the sea, the Dorides. **Sea Graces, Dorides—the lot**

Nicht der Olymp, nicht euer Boden tragt Neither Olympus nor your soil bears **Olympus can't match, nor your land**

Ein schon Gebild, das sich so zierlich regt. A fair form that moves so gracefully. **Such graceful forms, moving so grand**

Sie werfen sich, anmutigster Gebarde, They fling themselves, with most graceful gesture, **They leap with perfect, flowing motion**

Vom Wasserdrachen auf Neptunus' Pferde, From the
sea-dragon onto Neptune's horses, **From dragons
onto Neptune's ocean**

Dem Element aufs zarteste vereint, Most tenderly
united with the element, **Horses, merged with
waves so tight**

Dass selbst der Schaum sie noch zu heben scheint. So
that even the foam seems to lift them. **Element and
form unite**

Im Farbenspiel von Venus' Muschelwagen In the
color-play of Venus' shell-chariot **Foam lifts them
like they're flying high**

Kommt Galatee, die Schonste, nun getragen, Comes
Galatea, the fairest, now borne, **Venus' shell-chariot
colors the sky**

Die, seit sich Kypris von uns abgekehrt, Who, since
Cypris turned away from us, **Galatea comes—the
fairest one**

In Paphos wird als Göttin selbst verehrt. Is wor-
shipped in Paphos as a goddess herself. **Since
Cypris left, she's the sun**

Und so besitzt die Holde lange schon, And so the
lovely one has long possessed, **Worshipped at
Paphos, goddess-crowned**

Als Erbin, Tempelstadt und Wagenthron. As heiress,
temple-city and chariot-throne. **The lovely one has
long been found**

Hinweg! Es ziemt in Vaterfreudenstunde Away!
In this hour of fatherly joy **Temple, throne—her
fame's renowned**

Nicht Hass dem Herzen, Scheltwort nicht dem Munde.
Hate befits not the heart, reproach not the mouth.
Leave now! Father's joy is nigh

Hinweg zu Proteus! Fragt den Wundermann: Away to
Proteus! Ask the wonder-man: **No hate, no scolding
—spirits high**

Wie man entstehn und sich verwandeln kann. How
one may come to be and transform. **Go find Proteus,
ask the pro**

Thales

Wir haben nichts durch diesen Schritt gewonnen, We
have gained nothing by this step, **How to become
and transform—now go!**

Trifft man auch Proteus, gleich ist er zerronnen; Even
if one meets Proteus, at once he dissolves; **That got
us zilch, I won't pretend**

Und steht er euch, so sagt er nur zuletzt, And if he
stands for you, he only says at last **Even catching
Proteus—he'll bend**

Was staunen macht und in Verwirrung setzt. What
amazes and confuses. **And dissolve right before
your eyes**

Du bist einmal bedurftig solchen Rats, You are in need
of such counsel, **If he speaks? Expect surprise**

Versuchen wir's und wandlen unsres Pfads! Let us try
it and go our way! **Confusion and wonder, that's
the deal**

Sirenen

Was sehen wir von weiten What do we see from afar
But you need advice—keep it real

Das Wellenreich durchgleiten? Gliding through the
realm of waves? **Let's try our luck—full steam
ahead!**

Als wie nach Windes Regel As if by the wind's rule
What's that we spy from far away?

Anzogen weisse Segel, White sails were drawing near,
Gliding through the ocean's spray?

So hell sind sie zu schauen, So bright are they to be-
hold, **Wind's law seems to apply**

Verklarte Meeresfrauen. Transfigured sea-women.
White sails catching the eye

Lasst uns herunterklettern, Let us climb down,
Bright enough to dazzle

Vernehmt ihr doch die Stimmen. For you hear the
voices. **Glowing sea-women—total razzle**

Nereiden und Tritonen

Was wir auf Händen tragen, What we bear in our hands **Time to climb down and see**

Soll allen euch behagen. Shall please you all. **Those voices call to me!**

Chelonens Riesenschild From Chelone's giant shell
What we've got in hand

Entglanz't ein streng Gebilde: A stern form gleams:
Will impress this band

Sind Gotter, die wir bringen; They are gods we bring;
Giant turtle shell—behold

Musst hohe Lieder singen. You must sing high songs.
Stern figure, shining gold

Sirenen

Klein von Gestalt, Small in form, **Gods we bring tonight**

Gross von Gewalt, Great in power, **Sing your songs up right!**

Der Scheiternden Retter, Saviors of the shipwrecked,
Small but packed

Uralt verehrte Gotter. Gods honored since ancient times. **Power intact**

Nereiden und Tritonen

Wir bringen die Kabiren, We bring the Cabiri, **Ship-wreck saviors true**

Ein friedlich Fest zu fuhren; To lead a peaceful festival;
Ancient god-crew!

Denn wo sie heilig walten, For where they sacredly preside, **Cabiri on deck!**

Neptun wird freundlich schalten. Neptune will rule kindly. **Peaceful fest—respect!**

Sirenen

Wir stehen euch nach; We yield to you; **Their sacred rule applies**

Wenn ein Schiff zerbrach, When a ship broke apart,
Neptune's friendly—no surprise!

Unwiderstehbar an Kraft Irresistible in power **We yield to you**

Schützt ihr die Mannschaft. You protected the crew.
When ships break through

Nereiden und Tritonen

Drei haben wir mitgenommen, Three we have brought with us, **Power undeniable**

Der vierte wollte nicht kommen; The fourth would not come; **Crew protection reliable!**

Er sagte, er sei der Rechte, He said he was the right one, **Brought three, that's the score**

Der für sie alle dachte. Who thought for them all. **Fourth wouldn't walk through the door**

Sirenen

Ein Gott den andern Gott One god the other god **Said he's the real thing**

Macht wohl zu Spott. Makes into mockery. **Thinks for all—he's the king!**

Ehrt ihr alle Gnaden, Honor all graces, **Gods roasting other gods**

Furchtet jeden Schaden. Fear all harm. **Against all odds**

Nereiden und Tritonen

Sind eigentlich ihrer sieben. Actually there are seven of them. **Honor every grace**

Sirenen

Wo sind die drei geblieben? Where have the three remained? **Fear harm's embrace!**

Nereiden und Tritonen

Wir wussten's nicht zu sagen, We could not say,
Seven's the real count—twist!

Sind im Olymp zu erfragen; Ask on Olympus; **Where'd
the three disappear to?**

Dort wohnt auch wohl der achte, There also dwells the
eighth, **Honestly, we don't know**

An den noch niemand dachte! Of whom no one yet
thought! **Ask Olympus—they might show**

In Gnaden uns gewartig, Waiting for us in grace,
There's an eighth one, by the way

Doch alle noch nicht fertig. But not all yet complete.
No one remembered—what can I say!

Diese Unvergleichlichen These incomparable ones
Waiting for us, full of grace

Wollen immer weiter, Always want to go further, **Not
complete yet—work in place**

Sehnsuchtsvolle Hungerleider Yearning, hungry suf-
ferers **These incomparable gods**

Nach dem Unerreichlichen. For the unattainable. **Al-
ways want better odds**

Sirenen

Unsre Weise Our way **Hungry yearners, never full**

Ist zu beten, Is to pray, **Chasing what they can't
pull!**

In Sonn' und Mond To sun and moon **Our way**
Hinzubeten; es lohnt. To pray; it pays. **Is to pray**

Nereiden und Tritonen

Wie unser Ruhm zum höchsten prangt, How our glory
shines at its highest, **Sun and moon get the call**

Dieses Fest anzuführen! To lead this festival! **Pays off**
—worth it all!

Sirenen

Die Helden des Altertums The heroes of antiquity
Glory at its peak

Ermangeln des Ruhms, Fall short of glory, **Leading**
this fest—technique!

Wo und wie er auch prangt, Where and how it may
shine, **Ancient heroes don't quite cut it**

Wenn sie das goldne Vlies erlangt, Though they won
the golden fleece, **Glory? They didn't strut it**

Ihr die Kabiren. You the Cabiri. **Wherever fame may**
shine

Wenn sie das goldne Vlies erlangt, Though they won
the golden fleece, **Golden fleece? That's fine**

Wir die Kabiren. – We the Cabiri. – **But Cabiri take**
the cake

Homunculus

Die Ungestalten seh' ich an The malformed ones I look
upon **Fleece or not, make no mistake**

Als irden-schlechte Topfe, As earthen-poor pots, **We
Cabiri—first place stake!**

Nun stoßen sich die Weisen dran Now the wise men
bump against them **These misshapen gods I see**

Und brechen harte Köpfe. And break hard heads.
Like cheap clay pots of low degree

Thales

Das ist es ja, was man begehrt: That is just what one
desires: **Wise men keep bumping their heads**

Der Rost macht erst die Münze wert. The rust first
makes the coin valuable. **Breaking skulls on these
god-dreads!**

Proteus

So etwas freut mich alten Fäbler! Such things please
me, old fable-teller! **That's the point, you see**

Je wunderlicher, desto respektabler. The stranger,
the more respectable. **Rust gives coins their fee!**

Thales

Wo bist du, Proteus? – Where are you, Proteus? – **Old fable-me loves this stuff**

Proteus

Hier! und hier! Here! And here! **The weirder, the better—can't get enough!**

Thales

Den alten Scherz verzeih' ich dir; The old jest I forgive you; **Proteus—where'd you go?**

Doch einem Freund nicht eitle Worte! But to a friend, not vain words! **Here! Also here!**

Ich weiss, du sprichst vom falschen Orte. I know you speak from a false place. **Old joke—fine, you're forgiven**

Proteus

Leb' wohl! – Farewell! – **But friends deserve truth given**

Thales

Er ist ganz nah. Nun leuchte frisch! He is quite near. Now shine brightly! **You're speaking from somewhere fake!**

Er ist neugierig wie ein Fisch; He is curious as a fish;
See ya!

Und wo er auch gestaltet stockt, And wherever he
may pause in form, **He's nearby—shine away!**

Durch Flammen wird er hergelockt. By flames he will
be lured hither. **Curious as fish, they say**

Homunculus

Ergiess' ich gleich des Lichtes Menge, I shall pour
forth abundance of light, **Whatever shape he's
holding now**

Bescheiden doch, dass ich das Glas nicht sprengte. Yet
modestly, lest I shatter the glass. **Flames will draw
him out somehow!**

Proteus

Was leuchtet so anmutig schon? What shines so
gracefully fair? **Pouring out the light—full blast**

Thales

Gut! Wenn du Lust hast, kannst du's näher sehn.
Good! If you wish, you can see it closer. **But careful
so the glass will last!**

Die kleine Muhe lass dich nicht verdriessen Let not the
little trouble vex you **What's glowing all nice and**

bright?

Und zeige dich auf menschlich beiden Füssen. And show yourself on human two feet. **Good! Come see it up close**

Mit unsern Gunsten sei's, mit unserm Willen, With our favor be it, with our will, **Small effort—don't be morose**

Wer schauen will, was wir verhullen. Whoever wishes to see what we conceal. **Stand on human feet, two by two**

Proteus

Weltweise Kniffe sind dir noch bewusst. Worldly-wise tricks are still known to you. **Our favor and will support you**

Thales

Gestalt zu wechseln, bleibt noch deine Lust. To change form remains still your pleasure. **See what we've been hiding here!**

Proteus

Ein leuchtend Zwerglein! Niemals noch gesehen! A glowing dwarf! Never yet seen! **Still got those clever tricks up your sleeve**

Thales

Es fragt um Rat und mochte gern entstehn. It asks
for counsel and would gladly come to be. **Shape-
shifting's still your jam**

Er ist, wie ich von ihm vernommen, He is, as I have
heard from him, **A glowing dwarf—that's new!**

Gar wundersam nur halb zur Welt gekommen. Most
wondrously only half come into the world. **It wants
advice—how to fully exist**

Ihm fehlt es nicht an geistigen Eigenschaften, He does
not lack spiritual qualities, **Half-born is its gist**

Doch gar zu sehr am greiflich Tuchtighaften. But far
too much the tangibly solid. **Wondrously incom-
plete**

Bis jetzt gibt ihm das Glas allein Gewicht, Until now
the glass alone gives him weight, **Spirit's there,
pretty neat**

Doch war' er gern zunächst verkörperlicht. Yet he
would gladly first be embodied. **But solid body?
That's what's missing**

Proteus

Du bist ein wahrer Jungfernsohn, You are a true
virgin's son, **Glass keeps it from dismissing**

Eh' du sein solltest, bist du schon! Before you should be, you already are! **Wants a body—that's what it's wishing!**

Thales

Auch scheint es mir von anderer Seite kritisch: It also seems critical to me from another side: **True virgin's son, aren't you**

Er ist, mich dunkt, hermaphroditisch. He is, methinks, hermaphroditic. **You are before you're due!**

Proteus

Da muss es desto eher glücken; Then it must succeed all the sooner; **Here's another issue too**

So wie er anlangt, wird sich's schicken. As soon as he arrives, it will work out. **Hermaphroditic through and through!**

Doch gilt es hier nicht viel Besinnen: But here not much pondering is needed: **That should help things click**

Im weiten Meere musst du anbeginnen! In the wide sea you must begin! **Once there, you'll do the trick**

Da fangt man erst im kleinen an There one starts first in the small **No need for deep reflection**

Und freut sich, Kleinste zu verschlingen, And enjoys devouring the smallest, **Start in the sea's direction!**

Man wächst so nach und nach heran One grows gradually larger **Begin small, at the start**

Und bildet sich zu höherem Vollbringen. And develops for higher accomplishment. **Eat the tiniest part**

Homunculus

Hier weht gar eine weiche Luft, Here blows quite a soft air, **Grow bigger over time**

Es grunelt so, und mir behagt der Duft! It smells so green, and I like the fragrance! **Higher goals to climb!**

Proteus

Das glaub' ich, allerliebster Junge! I believe it, dearest boy! **Soft breeze blowing through**

Und weiter hin wird's viel behaglicher, And farther on it becomes much more pleasant, **Smells green —I like the view!**

Auf dieser schmalen Strandeszunge On this narrow tongue of shore **I believe you, sweet one!**

Der Dunstkreis noch unsaglicher; The atmosphere even more indescribable; **It gets better—we've just begun**

Da vorne sehen wir den Zug, Up ahead we see the procession, **On this thin strip of land**

Der eben herschwebt, nah genug. That just hovers
hither, near enough. **Air's amazing —isn't that
grand**

Kommt mit dahin! – Come along there! – **See the
procession up there**

Thales

Ich gehe mit. I go along. **Getting close —almost
here**

Homunculus

Dreifach merkwurd'ger Geisterschritt! Triply won-
drous spirit-step! **Come on!**

Telchinen von Rhodos

Chor

Wir haben den Dreizack Neptunen geschmiedet, We
have forged the trident for Neptune, **I'm coming too!**

Womit er die regesten Wellen begutet. With which
he calms the most agitated waves. **Triple-wonder
spirit march!**

Entfaltet der Donnerer die Wolken, die vollen, When
the Thunderer unfolds the full clouds, **We forged the
trident for the sea**

Entgegnet Neptunus dem greulichen Rollen; Neptune responds to the dreadful rolling; **Calms wild waves so easily**

Und wie auch von oben es zackig erblitzt, And how-ever jaggedly it flashes from above, **When Zeus rolls out his thunder-clouds**

Wird Woge nach Woge von unten gespritzt; Wave upon wave is sprayed from below; **Neptune answers back—proud!**

Und was auch dazwischen in Angsten gerungen, And whatever struggles in terror between, **What ring of little cloudlets rounds**

Wird, lange geschleudert, vom Tiefsten verschlungen; Is, long hurled about, swallowed by the depths; **Around the moon in such a lavish ring?**

Weshalb er uns heute den Zepter gereicht – For which he has lent us the scepter today – **They're doves, ignited by love's fire**

Nun schweben wir festlich, beruhigt und leicht. Now we float festively, calm and light. **Wings white as light itself—they sing**

Sirenen

Euch, dem Helios Geweihten, You, consecrated to Helios, **Paphos has sent them flying here**

Heitern Tags Gebenedeiten, Blessed of bright day, **Her horny bird-flock, all astir**

Gruss zur Stunde, die bewegt Greetings to the hour
that stirs **Our festival's complete at last**

Lunas Hochverehrung regt! Luna's high veneration!
Bright rapture—full and clear and fast!

Telchinen

Allieblichste Gottin am Bogen da droben! Most lovely
goddess on the arch above! **A nighttime wanderer
might call**

Du horst mit Entzucken den Bruder beloben. You hear
with delight your brother praised. **This moon-halo
atmospheric tricks**

Der seligen Rhodus verleihst du ein Ohr, To blessed
Rhodes you lend an ear, **But we spirits hold opin-
ions quite**

Dort steigt ihm ein ewiger Paan hervor. There rises to
him an eternal paeon. **Different—and we're right
about this mix**

Beginnt er den Tagslauf und ist es getan, When he be-
gins the day's course and when it is done, **Doves they
are, accompanying now**

Er blickt uns mit feurigem Strahlenblick an. He looks
upon us with fiery radiant gaze. **My daughter's
shell-ride through the sea**

Die Berge, die Stadte, die Ufer, die Welle The moun-
tains, the cities, the shores, the waves **Wonder-flight
of a special sort**

Gefallen dem Gotte, sind lieblich und helle. Please
the god, are lovely and bright. **Learned in ages old
—and free**

Kein Nebel umschwebt uns, und schleicht er sich ein,
No mist surrounds us, and should one steal in, **I too
hold that for the best**

Ein Strahl und ein Luftchen, die Insel ist rein! A ray
and a breeze, the island is clean! **What pleases the
worthy man at heart**

Da schaut sich der Hohe in hundert Gebilden, There
the High One beholds himself in a hundred images,
When in a still and warm-made nest

Als Jungling, als Riesen, den grossen, den milden. As
youth, as giant, the great, the gentle. **Something sa-
cred keeps itself apart**

Wir ersten, wir waren's, die Gottergewalt We first, it
was we who set up divine power **In Cyprus' rough
cavern-vaults below**

Aufstellten in würdiger Menschengestalt. In worthy
human form. **Not buried by the sea-god's hand**

Proteus

Lass sie singen, lass sie prahlen! Let them sing, let
them boast! **Not shattered by Seismos's blow**

Der Sonne heiligen Lebenstrahlen Beside the sun's
sacred life-rays **Surrounded by eternal winds that
fanned**

Sind tote Werke nur ein Spass. Dead works are only a jest. **And as in the oldest days of yore**

Das bildet, schmelzend, unverdrossen; They mold, melting, tirelessly; **In quiet self-aware content**

Und haben sie's in Erz gegossen, And when they have cast it in bronze, **We preserve Cypria's chariot here**

Dann denken sie, es ware was. Then they think it is something. **And lead through night's soft rustling sent**

Was ist's zuletzt mit diesen Stolzen? What becomes at last of these proud ones? **Through lovely wave-weaving we trace**

Die Gotterbilder standen gross – The god-images stood great – **Invisible to the newer race**

Zerstorte sie ein Erdestoss; An earthquake destroyed them; **The loveliest daughter hither we bring**

Langst sind sie wieder eingeschmolzen. Long since they have been melted down again. **We quiet workers fear nothing**

Das Erdetreiben, wie's auch sei, Earthly striving, however it be, **Neither eagle nor winged lion in the sky**

Ist immer doch nur Plackerei; Is always only drudgery; **Neither cross nor crescent moon on high**

Dem Leben frommt die Welle besser; Life fares better with the wave; **As they dwell and reign above up there**

Dich tragt ins ewige Gewasser You are borne into eternal waters **Changing, moving, stirring in the air**

Proteus-Delphin. Proteus-Dolphin. **Driving out and slaughtering their own**

Schon ist's getan! Already it is done! **Laying waste to fields and cities grown**

Da soll es dir zum schönsten glücken: There shall your fairest fortune be: **We, continuing thus our ways**

Ich nehme dich auf meinen Rucken, I take you on my back, **Bring the loveliest mistress through the maze**

Vermahle dich dem Ozean. I wed you to the Ocean. **Lightly moved, in moderate haste**

Thales

Gib nach dem loblichen Verlangen, Yield to the praiseworthy desire, **Around the chariot, circle on circle traced**

Von vorn die Schopfung anzufangen! To begin creation from the start! **Now intertwined line upon line**

Zu raschem Wirken sei bereit! Be ready for swift action! **Snake-like in rows that intertwine**

Da regst du dich nach ewigen Normen, There you move according to eternal norms, **Draw near, stalwart Nereids, come!**

Durch tausend, abertausend Formen, Through a thousand, myriad forms, **Tough women, pleasingly wild—don't be numb**

Und bis zum Menschen hast du Zeit. And until man you have time. **Bring, tender Dorides, don't be late**

Proteus

Komm geistig mit in feuchte Weite, Come spiritually into moist expanse, **Galatea, the mother's image—great**

Da lebst du gleich in Lang' und Breite, There you live at once in length and breadth, **Earnest, like the gods to behold**

Beliebig regest du dich hier; You move here at will; **Worthy of immortality, bold**

Nur strebe nicht nach höheren Orden: Only strive not for higher orders: **Yet like sweet human women too**

Denn bist du erst ein Mensch geworden, For once you have become a man, **With enticing grace right through**

Dann ist es völlig aus mit dir. Then it is entirely over with you. **Lend us, Luna, light and shade**

Thales

Nachdem es kommt; 's ist auch wohl fein, It depends; it is also fine **Clarity to this youthful bloom**

displayed

Ein wackrer Mann zu seiner Zeit zu sein. To be a worthy man in one's own time. **For we show our dear husbands here**

Proteus

So einer wohl von deinem Schlag! Someone perhaps of your sort! **Pleading to our father—hold them near**

Das halt noch eine Weile nach; That lasts a while yet; **Boys they are, whom we fished out**

Denn unter bleichen Geisterscharen For among pale spirit-hosts **From the breakers' gnashing teeth—no doubt**

Seh' ich dich schon seit vielen hundert Jahren. I have seen you already for many hundred years. **They, bedded on reeds and moss**

Sirenen

Welch ein Ring von Wolkchen rundet What a ring of cloudlets rounds **Warmed back to the light from loss**

Um den Mond so reichen Kreis? Around the moon in such rich circle? **Who now with hot kisses must**

Tauben sind es, liebentzundet, They are doves, love-enkindled, **Faithfully thank us—as is just**

Fittiche, wie Licht so weiss. Wings as white as light.
Look favorably on the sweet ones, Dad!

Paphos hat sie hergesendet, Paphos has sent them
hither, **The double gain is highly prized**

Ihre brunstige Vogelschar; Her ardent flock of birds;
**To be merciful and get your rocks off at the same
time—nice!**

Unser Fest, es ist vollendet, Our festival is completed,
If you praise our conduct, Father dear

Heitre Wonne voll und klar! Bright rapture full and
clear! **Grant us well-earned pleasure here**

Nereus

Nennte wohl ein nachtiger Wanderer A nightly wanderer
might call **Let us hold them tight, immortally**

Diesen Mondhof Lufterscheinung; This moon-halo
an atmospheric phenomenon; **On eternal youthful
breast—you see**

Doch wir Geister sind ganz anderer But we spirits are
of quite another **May you enjoy the pretty catch
you've made**

Und der einzig richtigen Meinung: And the only correct
opinion: **Shape the boy into a man—get laid**

Tauben sind es, die begleiten Doves they are, accompanying
Yet I could not grant what you request

Meiner Tochter Muschelfahrt, My daughter's shell-voyage, **What Zeus alone bestows—the rest**

Wunderflugs besondrer Art, Wonder-flight of special kind, **The wave that rocks and sways your form**

Angelernt vor alten Zeiten. Learned in ancient times. **Allows no permanence to love's warm storm**

Thales

Auch ich halte das fürs Beste, I too consider it best, **And when the fancy's played itself all out**

Was dem wackern Mann gefällt, What pleases the worthy man, **Gently set them ashore, no doubt**

Wenn im stillen, warmen Neste When in the still, warm nest **You sweet boys are dear to us**

Sich ein Heiliges lebend halt. Something sacred keeps itself living. **Yet we must sadly part—what a fuss**

Psyllen und Marsen

In Cyperns rauhen Hohlegruften, In Cyprus' rough cavern-vaults, **We desired eternal fidelity's bond**

Vom Meergott nicht verschuttet, Not buried by the sea-god, **The gods won't allow it—not so fond**

Vom Seismos nicht zerrüttet, Not shattered by Seismos, **If you'll just keep refreshing us like this**

Umweht von ewigen Luftten, Surrounded by eternal
airs, **Us worthy sailor-boys—what bliss!**

Und, wie in den ältesten Tagen, And, as in the most
ancient days, **We've never had it half so good be-
fore**

In stillbewusstem Behagen In quietly conscious com-
fort **And wouldn't want it better—what's to ask
for more?**

Bewahren wir Cypriens Wagen We preserve Cypria's
chariot **O Father! The joy! Such bliss!**

Und fuhren, beim Sauseln der Nächte, And lead, in
the rustling of nights, **Dolphins, linger! This sight
I can't dismiss!**

Durch liebliches Wellengeflechte, Through lovely
wave-weaving, **Already past—they pass on by**

Unsichtbar dem neuen Geschlechte, Invisible to
the new generation, **In circling sweeping motion
through the sky**

Die lieblichste Tochter heran. The loveliest daughter
hither. **What do they care for the inner heart's
feeling?**

Wir leise Geschäftigen scheuen We quiet busy ones
fear **Ah, would they take me with them—how ap-
pealing!**

Weder Adler noch geflügelten Leuen, Neither eagle
nor winged lion, **Yet one single glance delights so
much**

Weder Kreuz noch Mond, Neither cross nor crescent,
It makes up for the whole year's lack of touch

Wie es oben wohnt und thront, As it dwells and reigns
above, **Hail! Hail! Anew and again!**

Sich wechselnd wegt und regt, Changing, moving,
and stirring, **How I bloom with joy right then!**

Sich vertreibt und totschiagt, Driving out and killing,
Penetrated by the Beautiful and True...

Saaten und Stadte niederlegt. Laying waste fields
and cities. **All has sprung from Water through and
through!!**

Wir, so fortan, We, thus continuing, **All is sustained
through Water's might!**

Bringen die lieblichste Herrin heran. Bring the loveliest
mistress hither. **Ocean, grant us your eternal
governing right!**

Sirenen

Leicht bewegt, in massiger Eile, Lightly moved, in
moderate haste, **If you didn't send the clouds
above**

Um den Wagen, Kreis um Kreis, Around the chariot,
circle upon circle, **Didn't bestow rich streams we
love**

Bald verschlungen Zeil' an Zeile, Now intertwined line
upon line, **Didn't turn the rivers hither and there**

Schlangenartig reihenweis, Snake-like in rows,
Didn't complete them everywhere

Naht euch, rustige Nereiden, Approach, stalwart
Nereids, **What would mountains be, or plains, or
world?**

Derbe Fraun, gefällig wild, Hardy women, pleas-
ingly wild, **You're the one who keeps fresh life
unfurled!**

Bringet, zartliche Doriden, Bring, tender Dorides,
You're the one from whom fresh life springs free!

Galateen, der Mutter Bild: Galatea, the mother's im-
age: **They return swaying, far from here**

Ernst, den Gottern gleich zu schauen, Earnest, like the
gods to behold, **Bring no more glance to glance, I
fear**

Wurdiger Unsterblichkeit, Worthy of immortality, **In
extended chain-circles they wind**

Doch wie holde Menschenfrauen Yet like sweet
human women **To show themselves in festive
measure combined**

Lockender Anmutigkeit. Of enticing graciousness.
The countless host winds itself round

Doriden

Leih uns, Luna, Licht und Schatten, Lend us, Luna,
light and shadow, **But Galatea's shell-throne**

—**found!**

Klarheit diesem Jugendflor! Clarity to this youthful bloom! **I see it again and yet again!**

Denn wir zeigen liebe Gatten For we show dear spouses **It gleams like a star within**

Unserm Vater bittend vor. Pleadingly to our father.
Through the crowd it shines so bright

Knaben sind's, die wir gerettet Boys they are, whom we rescued **The beloved glows through the throng's tight**

Aus der Brandung grimmem Zahn, From the breakers' grim fangs, **Even so far away from me**

Sie, auf Schilf und Moos gebettet, They, bedded on reeds and moss, **It shimmers bright and clear to see**

Aufgewarmt zum Licht heran, Warmed back to the light, **Ever near and true—that's she!**

Die es nun mit heißen Küssen Who now with hot kisses **In this sweet moisture's embrace**

Treulich uns verdanken müssen; Must faithfully thank us; **Whatever I illuminate in this place**

Schau die Holden gunstig an! Look favorably upon the dear ones! **Is all so charmingly fair—what a space!**

Nereus

Hoch ist der Doppelgewinn zu schätzen: Highly is the double gain to be valued: **In this moisture that is life**

Barmherzig sein, und sich zugleich ergetzen. To be merciful, and at the same time take pleasure. **Only now does your light shine rife**

Doriden

Lobst du, Vater, unser Walten, If you praise, Father, our conduct, **With glorious sound—no strife!**

Gonnst uns wohlerworbene Lust, Grant us well-earned pleasure, **What new mystery midst the throng**

Lass uns fest, unsterblich halten Let us hold them fast, immortally **Wishes to reveal itself ere long?**

Sie an ewiger Jugendbrust. On eternal youthful breast. **What flames around the shell, Galatea's feet?**

Nereus

Mogt euch des schonen Fanges freuen, May you enjoy the fair catch, **Now it blazes mighty, now lovely, now sweet**

Den Jungling bildet euch als Mann; Shape the youth into a man for yourselves; **As if stirred by the pulses of love—what a beat!**

Allein ich konnte nicht verleihen, Yet I could not grant
It is Homunculus, by Proteus seduced...

Was Zeus allein gewahren kann. What Zeus alone can
bestow. **Little dude's horny as hell—his control's
come unloosed**

Die Welle, die euch wogt und schaukelt, The wave
that rocks and sways you **These are symptoms of
imperious yearning that burns**

Lasst auch der Liebe nicht Bestand, Allows love no
permanence, **I sense the groaning of anxious
desire's returns**

Und hat die Neigung ausgegaukelt, And when the
fancy has played itself out, **He will shatter himself
on the gleaming throne!**

So setzt gemachlich sie ans Land. Then gently set
them ashore. **Now it flames, now it flashes—he's
pouring his own!**

Doriden

Ihr, holde Knaben, seid uns wert, You, sweet boys,
are dear to us, **What fiery wonder transfigures the
waves tonight!**

Doch müssen wir traurig scheiden; Yet we must sadly
part; **They sparkle and smash against each other
—what a sight!**

Wir haben ewige Treue begehrt, We have desired eter-
nal fidelity, **So it shines and it sways and brightens**

up there!

Die Gotter wollen's nicht leiden. The gods will not allow it. **The bodies glow on their nocturnal affair!**

Die Junglinge

Wenn ihr uns nur so ferner labt, If you only continue thus to refresh us, **And all around everything's ringed with fire's crown!**

Uns wackre Schifferknaben; Us worthy sailor-boys; **So let Eros rule—who started this whole thing down!**

Wir haben's nie so gut gehabt We have never had it so good **Hail to the sea! Hail to the wave!**

Und wollen's nicht besser haben. And would not wish it better. **Circled by the sacred fire so brave!**

Galatea

O Vater! das Glück! O Father! The joy! **Hail to Water! Hail to Fire!**

Delphine, verweilet! mich fesselt der Blick. Dolphins, linger! I am held by the sight. **Hail to this rare adventure higher!**

Nereus

Voruber schon, sie ziehen voruber Already past, they pass by **Hail to the gently-disposed airs!**

In kreisenden Schwunges Bewegung; In circling sweeping motion; **Hail to mystery-rich caverns and their wares!**

Was kummert sie die innre herzliche Regung! What do they care for the inner heartfelt feeling! **Highly celebrated here shall be**

Ach, nahmen sie mich mit hinuber! Ah, would they take me with them! **All four of you Elements —blessed and free!**

Doch ein einziger Blick ergetzt, Yet a single glance delights,

Dass er das ganze Jahr ersetzt. So that it makes up for the whole year.

Thales

Heil! Heil! aufs neue! Hail! Hail! Anew!

Wie ich mich bluhend freue, How I rejoice in bloom,
Vom Schönen, Wahren durchdrungen... Penetrated
by the Beautiful, the True...

Alles ist aus dem Wasser entsprungen!! All has sprung
from Water!!

Alles wird durch das Wasser erhalten! All is sustained
through Water!

Ozean, gonn uns dein ewiges Walten. Ocean, grant us
your eternal governance.

Wenn du nicht Wolken sendetest, If you did not send
clouds,

Nicht reiche Bache spendetest, Did not bestow rich
streams,

Hin und her nicht Flüsse wendetest, Did not turn
rivers hither and thither,

Die Ströme nicht vollendetest, Did not complete the
rivers,

Was waren Gebirge, was Ebenen und Welt? What
would be mountains, what plains and world?

Du bist's der das frischeste Leben erhält. It is you who
sustains the freshest life.

Echo

Du bist's, dem das frischeste Leben entquellt. It is you
from whom the freshest life springs.

Nereus

Sie kehren schwankend fern zurück, They return
swaying, far away,

Bringen nicht mehr Blick zu Blick; Bring no longer
glance to glance;

In gedehnten Kettenkreisen, In extended chain-circles,

Sich festgemass zu erweisen, To show themselves in festive measure,

Windet sich die unzählige Schar. The countless host winds itself.

Aber Galateas Muschelthron But Galatea's shell-throne

Seh' ich schon und aber schon. I see again and again.

Er glantz wie ein Stern It gleams like a star

Durch die Menge. Through the crowd.

Geliebtes leuchtet durchs Gedrange! The beloved shines through the throng!

Auch noch so fern Even so far away

Schimmert's hell und klar, It shimmers bright and clear,

Immer nah und wahr. Ever near and true.

Homunculus

In dieser holden Feuchte In this sweet moisture

Was ich auch hier beleuchte, Whatever I illuminate here

Ist alles reizend schon. Is all charmingly fair.

Proteus

In dieser Lebensfeuchte In this life-moisture

Erglantz erst deine Leuchte Only now does your light
glow

Mit herrlichem Geton. With glorious sound.

Nereus

Welch neues Geheimnis in Mitte der Scharen What
new mystery in the midst of the hosts

Will unseren Augen sich offengebaren? Wishes to re-
veal itself to our eyes?

Was flammt um die Muschel, um Galatees Fusse?
What flames around the shell, around Galatea's feet?

Bald lodert es mächtig, bald lieblich, bald susse, Now
it blazes mightily, now lovely, now sweet,

Als war' es von Pulsen der Liebe gerührt. As if it were
stirred by the pulses of love.

Thales

Homunculus ist es, von Proteus verführt... It is
Homunculus, led astray by Proteus...

Es sind die Symptome des herrischen Sehns, These
are the symptoms of imperious yearning,

Mir ahnet das Achzen beangsteten Drohnens; I sense
the groaning of anxious roaring;

Er wird sich zerschellen am glanzenden Thron; He will
shatter himself against the gleaming throne;

Jetzt flammt es, nun blitzt es, ergiesset sich schon.
Now it flames, now it flashes, already pours forth.

Sirenen

Welch feuriges Wunder verklart uns die Wellen, What
fiery wonder transfigures the waves for us,

Die gegeneinander sich funkelnd zerschellen? That
sparkling dash against each other?

So leuchtet's und schwanket und hellet hinan: So it
shines and sways and brightens up:

Die Korper, sie gluhen auf nachtlicher Bahn, The bod-
ies, they glow on nocturnal path,

Und ringsum ist alles vom Feuer umronnen; And all
around everything is encircled by fire;

So herrsche denn Eros, der alles begonnen! Then let
Eros rule, who began all things!

Heil dem Meere! Heil den Wogen, Hail to the sea! Hail
to the waves,

Von dem heiligen Feuer umzogen! Encircled by the sa-
cred fire!

Heil dem Wasser! Heil dem Feuer! Hail to Water! Hail to Fire!

Heil dem seltnen Abenteuer! Hail to the rare adventure!

Alle

Heil den mildgewogenen Luften! Hail to the gently-disposed airs!

Heil geheimnisreichen Gruften! Hail to mystery-rich caverns!

Hochgefeiert seid allhier, Highly celebrated be here
Element' ihr alle vier! All four of you Elements!

Dritter Akt / Act III (Helena)

Vor dem Palaste des Menelas zu Sparta / Before the Palace of Menelaus in Sparta

Helena

Bewundert viel und viel gescholten, Helena, Much admired and much reviled, I, Helena, **Famous. Infamous. Same difference when you're this hot**

Vom Strande komm' ich, wo wir erst gelandet sind, Come from the strand where we have disembarked but now, **Just got here. Ten years late. Traffic was murder**

Noch immer trunken von des Gewoges regsamem Still giddy from the restless rocking of the waves **Wozy. Very wozy. Sea travel: not recom-**

mended

Geschaukel, das vom phrygischen Blachgefild uns
her Of Ocean, which from Phrygian uplands hith-
erwards **Long boat ride from war zone. Tourist
review pending**

Auf sträubig-hohem Rücken, durch Poseidons Gunst
On high, opposing backs - Poseidon's favour won **God
of sea did us a solid. Finally**

Und Euros' Kraft, in vaterländische Buchten trug.
And Euros' strength - have borne us to our native bay.
Home port achieved. Wind gets credit

Dort unten freuet nun der König Menelas Below
there, with the bravest of his warriors, now **The king
is happy. One of us should be**

Der Rückkehr samt den tapfersten seiner Krieger sich.
King Menelaus feels the joy of his return; **Him and the
boys. Back from hell. Vibing**

Du aber heiße mich willkommen, hohes Haus, But
thou, O bid me welcome back, thou lofty House
Palace. Me. We need to talk

Das Tyndareos, mein Vater, nah dem Hange sich
Which Tyndarus, my father, on the gentle slope,
Father built this. I broke everything else

Von Pallas' Hügel wiederkehrend aufgebaut Returning
from the Hill of Pallas, builded up; **Temple visit
to mansion building. Pipeline**

Und, als ich hier mit Klytämnestren schwesterlich,

And when I here with Clytemnestra sister-like, **Sis and me. Simpler times**

Mit Kastor auch und Pollux fröhlich spielend wuchs,
With Castor and with Pollux gaily sporting, grew,
Bros. Childhood. Actually happy. Weird

Vor allen Häusern Spartas herrlich ausgeschmückt.
Before all Sparta's houses nobly was adorned. **Best house on the block. Obviously**

Gegrüßet seid mir, der ehrnen Pforte Flügel ihr! Ye
valves of yon dark iron portals, ye I hail! **Doors. It's me. You remember**

Durch euer gastlich ladendes Weit-Eröffnen einst
Once through your festive and inviting opening **Once upon a time, you were happy to see me**

Geschah's, daß mir, erwählt aus vielen, Menelas It
happened that to me, from many singled out, **He picked me. Lucky him**

In Bräutigamsgestalt entgegenleuchtete. The coming
of the bridegroom Menelaus shone. **He glowed. Mistake imminent**

Eröffnet mir sie wieder, daß ich ein Eilgebot Unfold
again for me, that I the King's command **Let me in. Orders to follow**

Des Königs treu erfülle, wie der Gattin ziemt. Fulfil
with strictness, as unto a spouse is meet: **Hubby said. Wife does. Tale old as time**

Laßt mich hinein! und alles bleibe hinter mir, Give

entrance now, and let all things be left behind **Door. Open. Past. Closed**

Was mich umstürmte bis hieher, verhängnisvoll.
Which hitherto have stormed upon me, full of doom!

Drama. So much drama. Done now

Denn seit ich diese Schwelle sorgenlos verließ, For,
since this place all unsuspecting I forsook **I was care-free once. Here. Look how that went**

Cytherens Tempel besuchend, heiliger Pflicht gemäß,
For Cytheraea's fane, as holy duty called, **Went to pray. Aphrodite laughed**

Mich aber dort ein Räuber griff, der phrygische, But
there the robber seized me, he the Phrygian, **Paris happened. Rest is history. Literally**

Ist viel geschehen, was die Menschen weit und breit
Happened have many things, which people far and wide **Things occurred. Everyone has opinions**

So gern erzählen, aber der nicht gerne hört, So fain
relate, but which so fain hears not the one **Their favorite story. My worst memory**

Von dem die Sage wachsend sich zum Märchen spann.
Of whom the legend rose, and to a fable grew. **Helen of Troy: the original viral story**

Chor

Verschmähe nicht, o herrliche Frau, Disdain thou not,
O beautiful Dame, **Own it, queen**

Des höchsten Gutes Ehrenbesitz! Possession proud
of the highest estate! **You have the thing. THE
thing**

Denn das größte Glück ist dir einzig beschert, For
the greatest fortune is thine alone, **Luckiest person
alive. Debatable if that's lucky**

Der Schönheit Ruhm, der vor allen sich hebt. The
fame of beauty that towers o'er all. **Most famous
face ever. No contest**

Dem Helden tönt sein Name voran, The name of the
hero heralds his path, **Reputation speedruns the
introduction**

Drum schreitet er stolz; Thence proudly he strides;
Big walk. Big talk

Doch beugt sogleich hartnäckigster Mann Yet bends
at once the stubbornest man, **Tough guy meets hot
woman. Tough guy loses**

Vor der allbezwingenden Schöne den Sinn. And yields
to all-conquering Beauty's might. **You're basically
mind control. That's your power**

Helena

Genug! mit meinem Gatten bin ich hergeschifft
Enough, with mine own spouse have I been hither
shipped, **Moving on. Husband. Boat. Here**

Und nun von ihm zu seiner Stadt vorausgesandt; And
now by him beforehand to his city sent; **Sent ahead.**

Always the first to deal with it

Doch welchen Sinn er hegen mag, errat' ich nicht. Yet what his purposes may be, I fail to guess. **What's he thinking? Marital mystery**

Komm' ich als Gattin? komm' ich eine Königin? Do I come here as wife? Or do I come as queen? **Wife? Queen? Someone decide**

Komm' ich ein Opfer für des Fürsten bitteren Schmerz Or come, an offering for the Prince's bitter pain, **Sacrifice wasn't on the itinerary**

Und für der Griechen lang' erduldetes Mißgeschick? And for the long-endured misfortune of the Greeks? **Greece wants refund. I'm the currency**

Erobert bin ich; ob gefangen, weiß ich nicht! For they, the Immortals, verily fixed my Fame and Fate **Won. But what exactly did they win?**

Denn Ruf und Schicksal bestimmten fürwahr die Unsterblichen Ambiguously, attendants twain of doubtful worth **Fate: written. Fame: mandatory. Thanks, gods**

Zweideutig mir, der Schöngestalt bedenkliche To Beauty, who upon this very threshold stand **Pretty. Cursed. Same thing apparently**

Begleiter, die an dieser Schwelle mir sogar With gloomy and with threatening presence at my side. **Brought company. They're called Problems**

Mit düster drohender Gegenwart zur Seite stehn.

Then, even, in the hollow ship, but seldom looked
Standing there being ominous. Thanks

Denn schon im hohlen Schiffe blickte mich der
Gemahl My spouse on me, nor ever word of comfort
spake: **Husband stared. A lot. Weird energy**

Nur selten an, auch sprach er kein erquicklich Wort.
As if he brooded evil, fronting me he sat. **Silence.**
Staring. Marriage goals

Als wenn er Unheil sänne, saß er gegen mir. But now,
when speeding towards the strand of that deep cove
Brooding. Very brooding. Not attractive

Nun aber, als des Eurotas tiefem Buchtgestad Euro-
tas makes, scarce had the foremost vessel's prows **Al-**
most home. River bay ahead

Hinangefahren der vordern Schiffe Schnäbel kaum
The land saluted, than he spake, as urged the Gods:
Ships approaching. Drama approaching faster

Das Land begrüßten, sprach er, wie vom Gott bewegt:
"Here, in their ordered rank, my warriors disembark;
Suddenly he talks. Divinely motivated

»Hier steigen meine Krieger nach der Ordnung aus,
Them shall I muster, ranged along the ocean-strand.
"Troops, standard disembarkation"

Ich mustere sie, am Strand des Meeres hingereiht;
But thou go ever onwards, up the hallowed banks **"I**
count them. Beach formation"

Du aber ziehe weiter, ziehe des heiligen Of fair Euro-

tas, dowered with gifts of plenteous fruit, **“You go. I stay. Very normal”**

Eurotas fruchtbegabtem Ufer immer auf, Guiding the stallions o’er the bloom of watery meads, **“Follow the nice river. Very scenic”**

Die Rosse lenkend auf der feuchten Wiese Schmuck, Till there, on that most lovely plain thy journey ends, **“Horses. Meadow. Make it work”**

Bis daß zur schönen Ebene du gelangen magst, Where Lacedaemon, once a fruitful spreading field, **“Flat pretty place. You’ll know it”**

Wo Lakedämon, einst ein fruchtbar weites Feld, Surrounded by austerest mountains, built its seat. **“Sparta. Used to be farm. Now city”**

Von ernsten Bergen nah umgeben, angebaut. Set thou thy foot within the high-towered princely House, **“Built here. Mountains said okay”**

Betrete dann das hochgetürmte Fürstenhaus And muster well the maids, whom there behind I left, **“Palace. Enter it. That’s the plan”**

Und mustere mir die Mägde, die ich dort zurück Together with the old and faithful Stewardess. **“Maids. Count them. Report back”**

Gelassen, samt der klugen alten Schaffnerin. Let her display to thee the wealth of treasures stored, **“Plus the smart old lady. Important”**

Die zeige dir der Schätze reiche Sammlung vor, Even

as thy father them bequeathed, and I myself, **“Stuff. Lots of stuff. Get shown it”**

Wie sie dein Vater hinterließ und die ich selbst
In war and peace accumulating, have amassed.
“Inheritance plus war prizes. Collection”

In Krieg und Frieden, stets vermehrend, aufgehäuft.
All things shalt thou in ancient order find: because
“Stuff. More stuff. Much stuff”

Du findest alles nach der Ordnung stehen; denn It is
the Ruler’s privilege, that he all things **“Tidy. Every-
thing tidy. Better be”**

Das ist des Fürsten Vorrecht, daß er alles treu In faith-
ful keeping find, returning to his house, **“King comes
home, king finds stuff. Simple”**

In seinem Hause, wiederkehrend, finde, noch
Where’er he may have left it, each thing in its place;
“Return home, everything same. Requirement”

An seinem Platze jedes, wie er’s dort verließ. For
power to change in aught possesses not the slave.”
“Things. Places. Matching. Done”

Denn nichts zu ändern hat für sich der Knecht
Gewalt.« Denn nichts zu ändern hat für sich der
Knecht Gewalt.«

Chor

Denn der Kette Zier, der Krone Geschmuck, Let now
the splendid, accumulate wealth **Stuff. Shiny stuff.**

Look at it

Da ruhn sie stolz, und sie dünken sich was; Rejoice and cheer thee, in eye and heart! **Be happy. That's an order**

Doch tritt nur ein und fordre sie auf, For the gleam of chain and the glory of crown **Bling. Royal bling. Impressive**

Sie rüsten sich schnell. Are lying idly in haughty repose: **Treasure has ego apparently**

Mich freuet, zu sehn Schönheit in dem Kampf But enter thou in and challenge them all, **Enter. Outshine. Standard procedure**

Gegen Gold und Perlen und Edelgestein. And they will respond. **Things get ready. Things know**

I rejoice to witness Beauty compete

With gold and pearl and the jewel-stone.

Helena

Sodann erfolgte des Herren ferneres Herrscherwort: Thereafter further came my lord's imperious speech: **Beauty fights treasure. I watch**

»Wenn du nun alles nach der Ordnung durchgesehn, "Now when all things in order thou inspected hast, **Rocks lose. You win. Obviously**

Dann nimm so manchen Dreifuß, als du nötig glaubst, Then take so many tripods as thou needful deem'st,

More orders. Always more

Und mancherlei Gefäße, die der Opfer sich And vessels manifold, such as desires at hand **“Check stuff. Then do more stuff”**

Zur Hand verlangt, vollziehend heiligen Festgebrauch. Who offers to the Gods, fulfilling holy use, **“Tripods. Some amount. Your call”**

Die Kessel, auch die Schalen, wie das flache Rund; The kettles, also bowls, the shallow basin's disk; **“Bowls. Sacrifice needs bowls”**

Das reinste Wasser aus der heiligen Quelle sei The purest water from the sacred fountain fill **“Festival stuff. Holy stuff. Get it”**

In hohen Krügen; ferner auch das trockne Holz, In lofty urns; and further, also ready hold **“Pots. Bowls. Flat things. Yes”**

Der Flammen schnell empfänglich, halte da bereit; The well-dried wood that rapidly accepts the flame; **“Water. Pure. Holy. Got it”**

Ein wohlgeschliffnes Messer fehle nicht zuletzt; And let the knife, well-sharpened, fail not finally; **“Big jugs. Also wood. Dry”**

Doch alles andre geb' ich deiner Sorge hin.« Yet all besides will I relinquish to thy care.” **“Burnables. Ready. Check”**

So sprach er, mich zum Scheiden drängend; aber nichts So spake he, urging my departure; but no

thing **“Knife. Sharp one. Important”**

Lebendigen Atems zeichnet mir der Ord nende, Of liv-
ing breath did he, who ordered thus, appoint, **“Rest
of it? Your job now”**

Das er, die Olympier zu verehren, schlachten will.
That shall, to honour the Olympian Gods, be slain.
Said that. Sent me. But wait

Bedenklich ist es; doch ich Sorge weiter nicht, 'Tis crit-
ical; and yet I banish further care, **Alive stuff? Not
mentioned. Hmm**

Und alles bleibe hohen Göttern heim gestellt, And let
all things be now to the high Gods referred, **Kill what
exactly? Open question**

Die das vollenden, was in ihrem Sinn sie deucht, Who
that fulfil, whereto their minds may be disposed,
Concerning. Whatever. Moving on

Es möge gut von Menschen oder möge böß Whether
by men 'tis counted good, or whether bad; **Gods'
problem now. Not mine**

Geachtet sein; die Sterblichen, wir ertragen das. In
either case we mortals, we are doomed to bear. **Gods
decide. Gods do. Standard**

Schon manchmal hob das schwere Beil der Opfernde
Already lifted oft the Offerer the axe **Good? Bad?
Gods don't care**

Zu des erdgebeugten Tieres Nacken Weihend auf In
consecration o'er the bowed neck of the beast, **We**

suffer. That's the job

Und konnt' es nicht vollbringen, denn ihn hinderte
And could not consummate the act; for enemies **Axe goes up. Sometimes**

Des nahen Feindes oder Gottes Zwischenkunft. Ap-
proaching, or Gods intervening, hindered him. **Animal neck. Axe above. Classic setup**

Chor

Was geschehen werde, sinnst du nicht aus; What shall
happen, imagin'st thou not, **Couldn't finish. Got in-
terrupted**

Königin, schreite dahin Queen, go forwards **God or
enemy. Either way, pause**

Guten Muts! With courage! **What next? Unknown.
Always unknown**

Gutes und Böses kommt Blessing and evil come
Walk. Queen walks. That's the plan

Unerwartet dem Menschen; Unexpected to men:
Brave now. Go

Auch verkündet, glauben wir's nicht. Though an-
nounced, yet we do not believe. **Good happens.
Bad happens**

Brannte doch Troja, sahen wir doch Burned not Ilion,
saw we not also **Surprise. Always surprise**

Tod vor Augen, schmachlichen Tod; Death in the face,
shamefullest death? **Told. Don't believe. Human
nature**

Und sind wir nicht hier And are we not here, **Fire.
Troy. Happened. Saw it**

Dir gesellt, dienstbar freudig, With thee compan-
ioned, joyously serving, **Death. Saw that too. Bad
death**

Schauen des Himmels blendende Sonne Seeing the
dazzling sun in the heavens, **Here though. Still here**

Und das Schönste der Erde And the fairest of earth,
too, **Serving. Happy about it. Weird**

Huldvoll, dich, uns Glücklichen? Kindest one, thee,
we, the happy? **Sun. Still there. Still bright**

Helena

Sei's wie es sei! Was auch bevorsteht, mir geziemt,
Let come, what may! Whate'er awaits me, it beseems
Prettiest thing ever. You

Hinaufzusteigen ungesäumt in das Königshaus, That
I without delay go up in the Royal House, **You here.
Us lucky. Connection made**

Das, lang' entbehrt und viel ersehnt und fast ver-
scherzt, Which, long my need and yearning, forfeited
almost, **Whatever. Still got to go do the thing**

Mir abermals vor Augen steht, ich weiß nicht wie.

Once more hath risen on my sight, I know not how.
Palace stairs. Up them. Now

Die Füße tragen mich so mutig nicht empor My feet
no longer bear me with such fearlessness **Missed it.**
Wanted it. Almost lost it

Die hohen Stufen, die ich kindisch übersprang. Up the
high steps, which as a child I sprang across. **There it**
is. No idea how. But there

Chor

Werfet, o Schwestern, ihr Cast ye, O sisters! ye **Feet**
less brave. Noticed that

Traurig gefangenen, Sorrowful captives, **Used to**
jump these. Can't now

Alle Schmerzen ins Weite; All your trouble far from ye!
Sisters. Throw things. Specifically:

Teilet der Herrin Glück, Your mistress's joy partake,
We're captives. Yes. Acknowledged

Teilet Helenens Glück, Helena's joy partake, **Sad-**
ness? Away with it

Welche zu Vaterhauses Herd, Who the paternal hearth
Her happy. You happy. System works

Zwar mit spät zurückkehrendem, Delightedly now is
approaching, **Helen happy. You happy. Correla-**
tion

Aber mit desto festerem Truly with late-returning
Father's hearth. Warm spot. Going there

Füße freudig herannaht. But with firmer and surer
feet! **Late. Very late. Still arriving**

Preiset die heiligen, Praise ye the sacredest, **Steadier
though. That's something**

Glücklich herstellenden Still re-establishing **Happy
feet. Approaching**

Und heimführenden Götter! And home-bringing Im-
mortals! **Holy stuff. Praise it**

Schwebt der Entbundene How the delivered one
Gods fix things. Sometimes

Doch wie auf Fittichen Soars as on lifted wings **Gods.
Homeward. Thanks, gods**

Über das Rauhste, wenn umsonst Over asperities,
while in vain **Free people float. Apparently**

Der Gefangene sehnsuchtsvoll The prisoned one,
yearningly, **Wing-like. Floaty**

Über die Zinne des Kerkers hin Over the fortress-
parapet **Rough stuff below. Flying over it**

Armausbreitend sich abhärmt. Pineth with out-
spread arms! **Trapped ones want. Want hard**

Aber sie ergriff ein Gott, But a God took hold of her,
Walls. High ones. Stuck behind them

Die Entfernte; The Expatriate, **Arms out. Tired. Still
reaching**

Und aus Ilios' Schutt And from Ilion's ruins **God grabbed her. Literally**

Trug er hierher sie zurück Hither hath borne her again,
Far away one. Got grabbed

In das alte, das neugeschmückte To the ancient, the newly embellished **Troy's mess. Pulled from it**

Vaterhaus, Paternal house, **Carried home. Divine shipping**

Nach unsäglichen From unspeakable **Old place. New paint**

Freuden und Qualen, Raptures and torments, **Dad's place**

Früher Jugendzeit Early youthful days, **Can't even say it**

Angefrischt zu gedenken. Now refreshed, to remember. **Good stuff. Bad stuff**

Panthalis

Verlasset nun des Gesanges freudumgebenen Pfad
Forsake ye now the joy-encompassed path of Song,
Young days. Those ones

Und wendet nach der Türe Flügeln euren Blick! And towards the portal's open valves your glances turn!
Remember now. Fresh version

Was seh' ich, Schwestern? Kehret nicht die Königin
What, Sisters, do I see? Returneth not the Queen

Singing time over. Look up

Mit heftigen Schrittes Regung wieder zu uns her? With swift and agitated step again to us? **Door. Look at door. Now**

Was ist es, große Königin, was konnte dir What is it now, great Queen, what could encounter thee **Queen coming back. Already. Weird**

In deines Hauses Hallen, statt der Deinen Gruß, To move and shake thee so, within thy house's halls, **Steps look upset. Very upset**

Erschütterndes begegnen? Du verbirgst es nicht; Instead of greeting? Thou canst not conceal the thing; **Queen, what? What happened?**

Denn Widerwillen seh' ich an der Stirne dir, For strong repulsion written on thy brow I see, **Something in there. Shocking something**

Ein edles Zürnen, das mit Überraschung kämpft. And noble indignation, struggling with amaze. **Not greeting. Something else. Shows**

Helena

Der Tochter Zeus' geziemet nicht gemeine Furcht, A common fear beseemeth not the child of Zeus; **Face says: don't want**

Und flüchtig-leise Schreckenshand berührt sie nicht; No lightly-passing hand of terror touches her; **Mad but also surprised. Both**

Doch das Entsetzen, das, dem Schoß der alten Nacht
But that fell Horror, which the womb of ancient Night
Zeus's kid. Basic fear? Please

Von Urbeginn entsteigend, vielgestaltet noch With
first of things delivered, rolled through many forms,
Light scares? Don't work on me

Wie glühende Wolken aus des Berges Feuerschlund
Like glowing clouds that from the mountain's fiery
throat **Old Night's baby horror. Different**

Herauf sich wälzt, erschüttert auch des Helden Brust.
Whirl up expanding, even heroes' breasts may shake.
Many forms. Very old. Bad

So haben heute grauenvoll die Stygischen Thus terri-
bly have here to-day the Stygian Gods **Mountain fire
clouds. That kind of scary**

Ins Haus den Eintritt mir bezeichnet, daß ich gern
Mine entrance in the house betokened, and I fain,
Even tough guys shake. Real scary

Von oft betretner, langersehnter Schwelle mich, Even
as a guest dismissed, would take myself away **Under-
world stuff. Very present today**

Entlaßnem Gäste gleich, entfernend scheiden mag.
From oft-trod threshold, long-yearned for, departing.
They signed my entrance. Bad sign

Doch nein! gewichen bin ich her ans Licht, und sollt
But no! I have retreated hither to the light, and ye
Doorstep I know. Want to leave it now

Ihr weiter nicht mich treiben, Mächte, wer ihr seid.
Shall drive me no further, Powers, whoe'er you be.
Like guest told to go. Want to go

Auf Weihe will ich sinnen, dann gereinigt mag
On consecration will I think, then, purified, **No. I'm in light now. Staying**

Des Herdes Glut die Frau begrüßen wie den Herrn.
The hearth's glow may greet the mistress as the lord.
Powers. Stop pushing. I'm done moving

Chorführerin

Entdecke deinen Dienerinnen, edle Frau, Reveal
to thy handmaidens, noble lady, **Gonna get holy. Then proceed**

Die dir verehrend beistehn, was begegnet ist. Who
reverently attend thee, what has happened. **Fire greets her. Fire greets him. Same**

Helena

Was ich gesehen, sollt ihr selbst mit Augen sehn, What
I have seen, ye shall with your own eyes behold, **Tell us. We're here. What?**

Wenn ihr Gebilde nicht die alte Nacht sogleich If an-
cient Night has not at once swallowed back **Standing here. Waiting. What happened?**

Zurückgeschlungen in ihrer Tiefe Wunderschoß. The

forms into her wondrous womb of deepest depths.
You'll see. Same thing. Your eyes

Doch daß ihr's wisset, sag' ich's euch mit Worten an:
But that ye may know it, I will tell you in words: **Un-
less Night ate it. Possible**

Als ich des Königshauses ernsten Binnenraum, When
I, mindful of my nearest duty, solemnly **Night's
womb. Shapes go back there**

Der nächsten Pflicht gedenkend, feierlich betrat, En-
tered the royal house's austere inner space, **Words
now. Describing**

Erstaunt' ich ob der öden Gänge Schweigsamkeit, I
was amazed at the deserted corridors' silence, **Went
in. Serious. Palace**

Nicht Schall der emsig Wandelnden begegnete No
sound of busy footsteps met my ear, **Inside now.
Doing duty. Serious**

Dem Ohr, nicht raschgeschäftiges Eiligtun dem Blick,
No hastening, bustling activity met my eye, **Hallways
quiet. Too quiet**

Und keine Magd erschien mir, keine Schaffnerin,
And no maid appeared to me, no stewardess, **No
footsteps. No noise. Nothing**

Die jeden Fremden freundlich sonst begrüßenden.
Who would otherwise greet every stranger kindly.
Nothing moving. Eyes saw nothing

Als aber ich dem Schoße des Herdes mich genaht, But

when I approached the hearth's innermost space, **No maids. No stewardess. No one**

Da sah ich, bei verglommner Asche lauem Rest,
There I saw, by the smouldering ash's tepid remnant,
Should greet people. Didn't happen

Am Boden sitzen welch verhülltes großes Weib, Sit-
ting on the floor a great veiled woman, **Got close to hearth. Then...**

Der Schlafenden nicht vergleichbar, wohl der Sin-
nenden. Not like one sleeping, but like one deep in
thought. **Ash there. Kinda warm. And...**

Mit Herrscherworten ruf' ich sie zur Arbeit auf, With
commanding words I called her to her work, **Big woman. Veiled. On floor**

Die Schaffnerin mir vermutend, die indes vielleicht
Supposing her the stewardess, whom perhaps
meanwhile **Not asleep. Thinking? Maybe**

Des Gatten Vorsicht hinterlassend angestellt; My
husband's foresight had appointed to remain; **Told her: work. Boss voice**

Doch eingefaltet sitzt die Unbewegliche; But folded
up, the motionless one sits; **Thought it was the stewardess. Wrong**

Nur endlich rührt sie auf mein Dräun den rechten
Arm, Only at last, at my threats, she stirs her right
arm, **Husband put her there. Supposedly**

Als wiese sie von Herd und Halle mich hinweg. As

though waving me away from hearth and hall. **Just sitting. Not moving. Folded**

Ich wende zürnend mich ab von ihr und eile gleich
I turn away from her in anger and hasten at once
Threatened her. Arm moved. Finally

Den Stufen zu, worauf empor der Thalamos To the
steps whereon the bridal chamber rises, **Waved me away. Me. The queen**

Geschmückt sich hebt und nah daran das Schatzgemach;
Adorned, and near to it the treasure room; **Mad now. Moving fast**

Allein das Wunder reißt sich schnell vom Boden auf,
But the prodigy swiftly tears itself from the ground,
Stairs. Bedroom up there

Gebietrisch mir den Weg vertretend, zeigt es sich Im-
periously blocking my path, it shows itself **Nice bed-
room. Treasure nearby**

In hagrre Größe, hohlen, blutig-trüben Blicks, In
gaunt height, with hollow, bloody-dim eyes, **Thing. Got up. Fast**

Seltsamer Bildung, wie sie Aug' und Geist verwirrt.
Of strange form, confusing to both eye and mind.
Blocked me. Showed itself

Doch red' ich in die Lüfte; denn das Wort bemüht But
I speak into the air; for the word strives in vain **Big
skinny thing. Gross eyes**

Sich nur umsonst, Gestalten schöpferisch aufzubaun.

To build up forms creatively. **Weird shape. Brain confused. Eyes confused**

Da seht sie selbst! sie wagt sogar sich ans Licht hervor! There, see her yourself! She even dares come forth into the light! **Words useless. Can't describe**

Hier sind wir Meister, bis der Herr und König kommt. Here we are masters, until the lord and king arrives. **Can't make it with words. Won't work**

Die grausen Nachtgeburten drängt der Schönheitsfreund The friend of beauty, Phoebus, drives the dread night-births **Look! There she is! In the light!**

Phöbus hinweg in Höhlen, oder bändigt sie. Away to caves, or else subdues them. **We're boss here. For now**

Chor

Schreckliches hab' ich vieles gesehen, Terrible things have I seen in plenty, **Night monsters. But beauty has backup**

Kriegrischen Jammer, Ilios' Nacht, Warlike misery, Ilion's night, **Sun god handles it. Caves or control**

Als es fiel. When it fell. **Seen scary stuff. Lots of it**

Durch das umwölkte, staubende Tosen Through the clouded, dusty tumult **War. Troy. Night. Bad**

Drängender Krieger hört' ich die Götter Of pressing warriors, I heard the gods **Fell. All of it**

Fürchterlich rufen, hört' ich der Zwietracht Crying out
terribly, heard discord's **Clouds. Dust. Noise**

Eherne Stimme schallen durchs Feld, Brazen voice re-
sounding through the field, **Warriors. Gods. Heard
them**

Mauerwärts. Towards the walls. **Crying. Discord.
Heard it**

Ach! sie standen noch, Ilios' Ah! they still stood,
Ilion's **Bronze voice. Everywhere**

Mauern, aber die Flammenglut Walls, but the fiery
glow **Walls. Going there**

Zog vom Nachbar zum Nachbar schon, Already
spread from neighbor to neighbor, **Troy's walls.
Still up. Then**

Sich verbreitend von hier und dort Spreading itself
from here and there **Walls. But fire**

Mit des eignen Sturmes Wehn With its own storm's
breath **Spreading. House to house**

Über die nächtliche Stadt hin. Over the nocturnal city.
Everywhere. From everywhere

Flüchtend sah ich durch Rauch und Glut Fleeing, I saw
through smoke and glow **Fire's own storm**

Und der züngelnden Flamme Loh'n And the licking
flame's blaze **Night city. Fire over it**

Gräßlich zürnender Götter Nahn, The approach of
hideously wrathful gods, **Running. Seeing through**

smoke

Schreitend Wundergestalten Striding wondrous
forms **Flames. Flickering**

Riesengroß, durch düsteren Giant-sized, through
gloomy **Angry gods. Coming**

Feuerumleuchteten Qualm hin. Fire-illuminated
smoke. **Weird shapes. Walking**

Sah ich's, oder bildete Did I see it, or did my fear-
entangled mind **Giant. Dark**

Mir der angstumschlungene Geist Form such confu-
sion? **Smoky fire. Fiery smoke**

Solches Verworrene? sagen kann I can never say, **Did
I see it? Or**

Nimmer ich's, doch daß ich dies But that I behold this
Brain scared. Made things up?

Gräßliche hier mit Augen schau', Horrible sight with
mine own eyes, **Confusing. Can't say**

Solches gewiß ja weiß ich; That indeed I surely know;
Can't say. But this. This I see

Könnt' es mit Händen fassen gar, I could even grasp it
with my hands, **Horrible. Here. My eyes**

Hielte von dem Gefährlichen Did not fear hold me
back **Know that. Definitely**

Nicht zurücke die Furcht mich. From the dangerous
thing. **Could touch it. If I wanted**

Welche von Phorkys' Which of Phorcys' **Fear stops me. Otherwise would**

Töchtern nur bist du? Daughters art thou? **Dangerous thing. Not touching**

Denn ich vergleiche dich For I compare thee **Phorcys had kids. Which one?**

Diesem Geschlechte. To that race. **Daughter. Which one**

Bist du vielleicht der graugebornen, Art thou perhaps one of the gray-born, **Comparing now**

Eines Auges und eines Zahns Sharing one eye and one tooth **That family. Similar**

Wechselsweis teilhaftigen Alternately, **Born gray? Maybe**

Graien eine gekommen? Of the Graeae come? **One eye. One tooth. Sharing**

Wagest du Scheusal Darest thou, monster, **Taking turns**

Neben der Schönheit Beside beauty **Graea? Here?**

Dich vor dem Kennerblick To show thyself before the connoisseur's gaze **Monster. You dare?**

Phöbus' zu zeigen? Of Phoebus? **Next to beauty?**

Tritt du dennoch hervor nur immer; Step forth nevertheless; **Showing yourself. To someone who knows**

Denn das Häßliche schaut er nicht, For the ugly he
sees not, **Phoebus sees you**

Wie sein heilig Auge noch As his holy eye has never
Come out anyway

Nie erblickte den Schatten. Yet beheld a shadow. **He
doesn't see ugly. Lucky you**

Doch uns Sterbliche nötigt, ach, But us mortals, alas,
compels **Never seen shadow. His eyes**

Leider trauriges Mißgeschick Sadly sorrowful misfor-
tune **No shadow. Ever**

Zu dem unsäglichen Augenschmerz, To the unspeak-
able eye-pain, **But us. We have to**

Den das Verwerfliche, Ewig-Unselige Which the con-
temptible, eternally accursed **Sad luck**

Schönheitliebenden rege macht. Inflicts on lovers of
beauty. **Eye pain. Can't say how much**

Ja, so höre denn, wenn du frech Yes, then hear, if thou
brazenly **Disgusting cursed thing**

Uns entgegenest, höre Fluch, Confront us, hear
curses, **Makes beauty-lovers suffer**

Höre jeglicher Schelte Drohn Hear every threat of re-
proach **Listen. If you dare**

Aus dem verwünschenden Munde der Glücklichen,
From the cursing mouths of the fortunate, **Face us.
Get cursed**

Die von Göttern gebildet sind. Who are fashioned by gods. **Scolding too. Lots**

Phorkyas

Alt ist das Wort, doch bleibt hoch und wahr der Sinn,
Old is the saying, yet high and true remains its meaning, **Lucky us. Cursing you**

Daß Scham und Schönheit nie zusammen, Hand in Hand,
That Shame and Beauty never, hand in hand, **Gods made us. Not you**

Den Weg verfolgen über der Erde grünen Pfad. Pursue their way along the earth's green path. **Old saying. Still true**

Tief eingewurzelt wohnt in beiden alter Haß, Deep-rooted in both dwells ancient hate, **Shame. Beauty. Don't mix**

Daß, wo sie immer irgend auch des Weges sich That wherever they may anywhere encounter **Same road? Never**

Begegnen, jede der Gegnerin den Rücken kehrt. On the way, each turns her back upon her rival. **Old hate. Both have it**

Dann eilet jede wieder heftiger, weiter fort, Then each hastens on more swiftly, further forth, **Anywhere they meet**

Die Scham betrübt, die Schönheit aber frech gesinnt, Shame dejected, but Beauty boldly minded, **Meet.**

Turn away

Bis sie zuletzt des Orkus hohle Nacht umfängt, Until
at last the hollow night of Orcus enfolds them, **Run
faster. Get away**

Wenn nicht das Alter sie vorher gebändigt hat. Un-
less old age has subdued them first. **Shame mopes.
Beauty struts**

Euch find' ich nun, ihr Frechen, aus der Fremde her
I find you now, you brazen ones, from foreign lands
Death gets them eventually. Both

Mit Übermut ergossen, gleich der Kraniche Poured
forth with insolence, like the cranes' **Or old age.
Whichever comes first**

Laut-heiser klingendem Zug, der über unser Haupt,
Loud-hoarsely sounding train, which over our heads,
Found you. Foreigners. Brazen ones

In langer Wolke, krächzend sein Getön herab In a
long cloud, croaking sends its noise down **Arrogant.
Crane-like**

Schickt, das den stillen Wanderer über sich hinauf
Which entices the quiet wanderer to look up; **Loud.
Hoarse. Over us**

Zu blicken lockt; doch ziehn sie ihren Weg dahin, Yet
they pursue their way, **Long cloud. Croaking down**

Er geht den seinen; also wird's mit uns geschehn. He
goes his own; so shall it be with us. **Makes people
look up**

Wer seid denn ihr, daß ihr des Königes Hochpalast
Who are you then, that you dare rave around **They
keep going**

Mänadisch wild, Betrunknen gleich, umtoben dürft?
The King's high palace like Maenads wild, like drunk-
ards? **Same with us**

Wer seid ihr denn, daß ihr des Hauses Schaffnerin
Who are you then, that you howl at the house's
stewardess **Who are you? Raging here**

Entgegenheulet, wie dem Mond der Hunde Schar? As
a pack of hounds howls at the moon? **Palace. Acting
crazy. Like drunks**

Wähnt ihr, verborgen sei mir, welch Geschlecht ihr
seid, Do you think it is hidden from me what race you
are, **Who are you? Howling at me**

Du kriegergezeugte, schlachterzogne junge Brut? You
war-begotten, battle-bred young brood? **Dogs.
Moon. That's you**

Mannlustige du, so wie verführt verführende, You
man-lusting ones, seduced as well as seducing, **I
know what you are**

Entnervend beide, Kriegers auch und Bürgers Kraft!
Enervating both warrior's and citizen's strength! **War
babies. Battle kids**

Zu Hauf euch sehend, scheint mir ein Zikaden-
schwarm Seeing you in a heap, you seem to me a
locust swarm **Man-hungry. Both ways**

Herabzustürzen, deckend grüne Feldersaat. De-
scending, covering the green field-crops. **Weaken
soldiers. Weaken citizens**

Verzehrerinnen fremden Fleißes! Naschende Con-
sumers of others' toil! Nibbling **Bunch of you. Like
locusts**

Vernichterinnen aufgekeimten Wohlstands ihr! De-
stroyers of budding prosperity! **Dropping down.
Eating crops**

Erobert', marktverkauft', vertauschte Ware du! Con-
quered, market-sold, bartered merchandise! **Eating
their work. Nibbling**

Helena

Wer gegenwarts der Frau die Dienerinnen schilt,
Who scolds the servants in the mistress's presence
Destroy what's growing. You

Der Gebietrin Hausrecht tastet er vermessen an; Pre-
sumptuously infringes on the lady's household right;
Won. Sold. Traded. Things

Denn ihr gebührt allein, das Lobenswürdige For it
belongs to her alone to praise what is praiseworthy
Yelling at my staff? In front of me?

Zu rühmen, wie zu strafen, was verwerflich ist. As well
as to punish what is blameworthy. **Overstepping.
My house**

Auch bin des Dienstes ich wohl zufrieden, den sie mir

I am also well satisfied with the service they have **I praise. My job**

Geleistet, als die hohe Kraft von Ilios Rendered me, when the high might of Ilion **I punish. Also my job**

Umlagert stand und fiel und lag; nicht weniger, Stood besieged and fell and lay; no less **Happy with them. Their service**

Als wir der Irrfahrt kummervolle Wechselnot When we endured the sorrowful, changing need **When Troy was big. They served**

Ertrugen, wo sonst jeder sich der Nächste bleibt. Of our wandering, where each usually looks out for himself. **The king did not specify it.**

Auch hier erwart' ich Gleiches von der muntern Schar; Here too I expect the same from the lively company; **The king said nothing about what bleeds.**

Nicht, was der Knecht sei, fragt der Herr, nur, wie er dient. The master asks not what the servant is, only how he serves. **He left the victim blank—curious that.**

Drum schweige du und grinse sie nicht länger an. Therefore be silent and grin at them no longer. **No goat, no lamb, no thing with needs.**

Hast du das Haus des Königs wohl verwahrt bisher If you have kept the king's house well thus far **Did not speak it? O word of woe!**

Anstatt der Hausfrau, solches dient zum Ruhme dir; In

the mistress's stead, that redounds to your credit; **He said nothing? Oh SHIT.**

Doch jetzo kommt sie selber, tritt nun du zurück, But now she herself has come, so step back, **My bowels just clenched with what I know.**

Damit nicht Strafe werde statt verdienten Lohns. Lest punishment come instead of deserved reward. **Darling, you're it.**

Phorkyas

Den Hausgenossen drohen bleibt ein großes Recht, To threaten the household members remains a great right, **What woe befalls you?**

Das gottbeglückten Herrschers hohe Gattin sich Which the high consort of the god-blessed ruler **Why do you shudder so?**

Durch langer Jahre weise Leitung wohl verdient. Has well earned through wise direction over long years. **Your face has gone the color of old cheese.**

Da du, nun Anerkannte, neu den alten Platz Since you, now acknowledged, newly assume **Spit it out—let the horror flow.**

Der Königin und Hausfrau wiederum betrittst, The old place of queen and mistress once again, **Queen, you are meant!**

So fasse längst erschlaffte Zügel, herrsche nun, Seize the long-slackened reins, rule now, **The sacrifice is**

you, babe.

Nimm in Besitz den Schatz und sämtlich uns dazu.
Take possession of the treasure and all of us as well.

That lovely throat will meet the blade.

Vor allem aber schütze mich, die ältere, But above all
protect me, the elder, **Surprise! You're not the cook**
—you're what they crave.

Vor dieser Schar, die neben deiner Schönheit Schwan
From this company, who beside your swan-like
beauty **I?**

Nur schlecht befitticht', schnatterhafte Gänse sind.
Are but poorly feathered, cackling geese. **Me?!**

Chorführerin

Wie häßlich neben Schönheit zeigt sich Häßlichkeit.
How ugly beside Beauty does Ugliness appear. **This**
body?

Phorkyas

Wie unverständlich neben Klugheit Unverstand. How
foolish beside Wisdom does Folly appear. **Well fuck.**

Choretide 1

Von Vater Erebus melde, melde von Mutter Nacht. Tell
of Father Erebus, tell of Mother Night. **And these.**

Phorkyas

So sprich von Scylla, leiblich dir Geschwisterkind.
Then speak of Scylla, your bodily cousin. **Your girls too. The whole set.**

Choretide 2

An deinem Stammbaum steigt manch Ungeheur empor. Many a monster climbs up your family tree. **Every pretty neck among you.**

Phorkyas

Zum Orkus hin! da suche deine Sippschaft auf. Off to Orcus! There seek out your kinfolk. **It's a group rate —discount death, no sweat.**

Choretide 3

Die dorten wohnen, sind dir alle viel zu jung. Those who dwell there are all far too young for you. **Woe and grief!**

Phorkyas

Tiresias, den Alten, gehe buhlend an. Go court old Tiresias. **Oh no oh no oh no!**

Choretide 4

Orions Amme war dir Ur-Urenkelin. Orion's nurse was your great-great-granddaughter. **Our spines have turned to ice.**

Phorkyas

Harpyen, wahn' ich, fütterten dich im Unflat auf. Harpies, I presume, raised you in filth. **We're the party favors—what a show!**

Choretide 5

Mit was ernährst du so gepflegte Magerkeit? With what do you nourish such cultivated leanness? **You will fall by the axe.**

Phorkyas

Mit Blute nicht, wonach du allzulüstern bist. Not with blood, for which you are all too greedy. **The blade is waiting, freshly sharpened too.**

Choretide 6

Begierig du auf Leichen, ekle Leiche selbst! Greedy you for corpses, disgusting corpse yourself! **That pretty head—thunk—into the basket.**

Phorkyas

Vampyren-Zähne glänzen dir im frechen Maul.
Vampire-teeth gleam in your impudent maw. **Chop chop, gorgeous. He's coming for you.**

Chorführerin

Das deine stopf' ich, wenn ich sage, wer du seist.
Yours I'll stop, if I say who you are. **Horrible yet foreboded; I, wretched one!**

Phorkyas

So nenne dich zuerst; das Rätsel hebt sich auf. Then name yourself first; the riddle will be solved. **I sensed this coming—some dark intuition.**

Helena

Nicht zürnend, aber traurend schreit' ich zwischen euch, Not in anger, but in sorrow I step between you, **My gut knew before my brain caught up.**

Verbietend solchen Wechselstreites Ungestüm! Forbidding such tumultuous exchange of quarrels! **Well played, husband. Murderous ambition.**

Denn Schädlicheres begegnet nichts dem Herrscherherrn For nothing more harmful befalls the ruling lord

Unavoidable it seems to me.

Als treuer Diener heimlich unterschworner Zwist.
Than faithful servants' secretly sworn strife. **I don't
see a way out of this mess.**

Das Echo seiner Befehle kehrt alsdann nicht mehr
The echo of his commands then no longer returns
The trap has sprung.

In schnell vollbrachter Tat wohlstimmig ihm zurück,
To him harmoniously in swiftly completed deeds, **Un-
less... unless... unless...**

Nein, eigenwillig brausend tost es um ihn her, No,
self-willedly roaring it rages around him, **Ah! And
us? What will befall us?**

Den selbstverirrten, ins Vergebne scheltenden. The
self-bewildered one, scolding into the void. **What
about US though?!**

Dies nicht allein. Ihr habt in sittelosem Zorn This not
alone. In immoral anger you have **Our necks! Our
precious necks!**

Unsel'ger Bilder Schreckgestalten hergebannt, Con-
jured up here the terror-forms of accursed images,
We're too young and hot to die! Say it ain't so!

Die mich umdrängen, daß ich selbst zum Orkus mich
Which crowd around me, so that I myself feel **She
dies a noble death.**

Gerissen fühle, vaterländ'scher Flur zum Trutz. Torn
away to Orcus, in defiance of my native soil. **She gets**

the dignified axe treatment, at least.

Ist's wohl Gedächtnis? war es Wahn, der mich ergreift? Is it memory? Was it delusion that seizes me?
One clean stroke, royally done.

War ich das alles? Bin ich's? Werd' ich's künftig sein, Was I all that? Am I? Shall I be in the future **You lot?**
Strung up like thrushes at a feast.

Das Traum- und Schreckbild jener Städteverwüsten- den? The dream and terror-image of that destroyer of cities? **But on the high beam inside, which supports the roof's gable,**

Die Mädchen schauern, aber du, die älteste, The maidens shudder, but you, the eldest, **You'll dangle from the rafters, dangling in a row.**

Du stehst gelassen; rede mir verständig Wort. You stand calm; speak to me a sensible word. **Kicking, twitching, tongues going purple.**

Phorkyas

Wer langer Jahre mannigfaltigen Glücks gedenkt, Who recalls long years of manifold happiness, **Bird-trap style—a dozen little death-dance tableaux.**

Ihm scheint zuletzt die höchste Göttergunst ein Traum. To him at last the highest divine favor seems a dream. **Ghosts! Like frozen images you stand there.**

Du aber, hochbegünstigt sonder Maß und Ziel, But

you, highly favored beyond measure and limit, **Look at you—paralyzed with fear.**

In Lebensreihe sahst nur Liebesbrünstige, In your life's course saw only those burning with love, **Not a breath, not a twitch among you.**

Entzündet rasch zum kühnsten Wagstück jeder Art. Quickly inflamed to the boldest venture of every kind. **Death's already got you by the ear.**

Schon Theseus haschte früh dich, gierig aufgeregt, Already Theseus early snatched you, greedily excited, **Frightened to depart from the day, which belongs not to you.**

Wie Herakles stark, ein herrlich schön geformter Mann. Strong as Heracles, a splendidly well-formed man. **You cling to sunshine that was never yours.**

Helena

Entführte mich, ein zehnjährig schlankes Reh, He carried me off, a ten-year-old slender fawn, **Borrowed light, borrowed breath, borrowed flesh.**

Und mich umschloß Aphidnus' Burg in Attika. And Aphidnus' fortress enclosed me in Attica. **Time to settle up—close those doors.**

Phorkyas

Durch Kastor und durch Pollux aber bald befreit, But

soon freed by Castor and by Pollux, **Humans, all ghosts just like you,**

Umworben standst du ausgesuchter Heldenschar.
You stood courted by a select band of heroes. **Everyone alive is just pre-dead.**

Helena

Doch stille Gunst vor allen, wie ich gern gesteh', Yet
quiet favor above all, as I gladly confess, **Walking meat with expiration dates.**

Gewann Patroklos, er, des Peliden Ebenbild. Patroclus won, he, the image of Peleus' son. **The only question's when, not if—enough said.**

Phorkyas

Doch Vaterwille traute dich an Menelas, But your
father's will betrothed you to Menelaus, **Also do not willingly renounce the noble sunshine.**

Den kühnen Seedurchstreicher, Hausbewahrer auch.
The bold rover of the seas, preserver of the house as well. **Nobody wants to go—that's universal.**

Helena

Die Tochter gab er, gab des Reichs Bestellung ihm. He
gave him the daughter, gave him the rule of the realm.
We clutch at life with desperate fingers.

Aus ehlichem Beisein sproßte dann Hermione. From marital union then sprang Hermione. **Death's the only non-negotiable reversal.**

Phorkyas

Doch als er fern sich Kretas Erbe kühn erstritt, But when he was far away, boldly fighting for Crete's inheritance, **But no one begs or saves them from the end.**

Dir Einsamen da erschien ein allzuschöner Gast. To you, the lonely one, there appeared an all-too-beautiful guest. **No appeals process, no last-minute call.**

Helena

Warum gedenkst du jener halben Witwenschaft, Why do you recall that half-widowhood, **The axe falls when the axe falls.**

Und welch Verderben gräßlich mir daraus erwuchs? And what horrible ruin grew from it for me? **That's mortality—it comes for all.**

Phorkyas

Auch jene Fahrt, mir freigebornen Kreterin That voyage too, on me, a freeborn Cretan woman, **They all know it, yet only few accept it.**

Gefangenschaft erschuf sie, lange Sklaverei. Brought captivity, long slavery. **Everybody knows and nobody believes.**

Helena

Als Schaffnerin bestellt' er dich sogleich hieher, As stewardess he appointed you here at once, **We live like we'll live forever.**

Vertrauend vieles, Burg und kühn erworbnen Schatz. Entrusting much, the fortress and boldly won treasure. **Until the blade comes down and nobody grieves.**

Phorkyas

Die du verließest, Ilios' umtürmter Stadt Which you abandoned, turning to Ilion's towered city **Enough, you are lost! So fresh to work.**

Und unerschöpften Liebesfreuden zugewandt. And inexhaustible joys of love. **Anyway! Let's get this slaughter started!**

Helena

Gedenke nicht der Freuden! allzuherben Leids Recall not the joys! All-too-bitter sorrow's **No more philosophizing—time to die.**

Unendlichkeit ergoß sich über Brust und Haupt. Infinity poured over breast and head. **Places everyone! Death's a party—get it charted!**

Phorkyas

Doch sagt man, du erschienst ein doppelhaft Gebild, Yet they say you appeared as a double form, **Come hither, you dark, spherical monster!**

In Ilios gesehen und in Ägypten auch. Seen in Ilion and in Egypt too. **Roll out the murder equipment!**

Helena

Verwirre wüsten Sinnes Aberwitz nicht gar. Do not utterly confuse my already confused mind's delusion. **Here comes the heavy gear.**

Selbst jetzo, welche denn ich sei, ich weiß es nicht. Even now, which one I am, I do not know. **Death's entourage —looking particularly hellish and resplendent.**

Phorkyas

Dann sagen sie: aus hohlem Schattenreich herauf Then they say: from the hollow realm of shades **Roll yourselves here, here there is ample harm to do.**

Gesellte sich inbrünstig noch Achill zu dir! Achilles still joined himself ardently to you! **Plenty of throats**

for you to practice on.

Dich früher liebend gegen allen Geschicks Beschluß.
Loving you before, against all fate's decree. **A buffet
of beautiful victims.**

Helena

Ich als Idol, ihm dem Idol verband ich mich. I as phantom,
to him the phantom I joined myself. **Step right
up, the slaughterhouse is open—come on!**

Es war ein Traum, so sagen ja die Worte selbst. It was
a dream, as the words themselves say. **Make room
for the portable altar, the gold-horned one.**

Ich schwinde hin und werde selbst mir ein Idol. I fade
away and become a phantom to myself. **Drag that
fancy killing-table into place.**

Chor

Schweige, schweige! Be silent, be silent! **The altar
gleams—hungry for blood.**

Mißblickende, Mißredende du! You evil-gazing, evil-
speaking one! **Such elegant murder! Such liturgi-
cal grace!**

Aus so gräßlichen einzahnigen From such horrible
single-toothed **Let the axe lie gleaming above the
silver rim.**

Lippen, was enthaucht wohl Lips, what breath can
come **Display the blade—let them admire it first.**

Solchem furchtbaren Greuelschlund! From such a
fearful horror-maw! **So shiny, so sharp, so ready.**

Denn der Böartige, wohltätig erscheinend, For the
malicious one, appearing benevolent, **Death-metal:
polished for maximum thirst.**

Wolfesgrimm unter schafwolligem Vlies, Wolf's fury
under sheep-woolly fleece, **Fill the water jugs,
there is washing to do.**

Mir ist er weit schrecklicher als des drei- To me is
far more terrible than the three- **Someone's got to
clean up after.**

köpfigen Hundes Rachen. Headed hound's jaws.
Blood makes such a mess on marble.

Ängstlich lauschend stehn wir da: Anxiously listening
we stand: **Scrub scrub scrub—it's almost laughter.**

Wann? wie? wo nur bricht's hervor, When? how?
where will it break forth, **Of the black blood's
horrible defilement.**

Solcher Tücke Such malice's **Dark gore splashing
everywhere.**

Tiefauflauerndes Ungetüm? Deep-lurking monster?
Sticky, spreading, staining.

Nun denn, statt freundlich mit Trost reich begabten,
Now then, instead of friendly, comfort-richly en-

dowed, **Better bring the mop—and don't forget the spare!**

Letheschenkenden, holdmildesten Worts Lethe-granting, graciously mild words, **Spread the precious carpet here in the dust.**

Regest du auf aller Vergangenheit You stir up of all the past **Roll out the red carpet—literally.**

Bösestes mehr denn Gutes The worst rather than the good **Something soft for royal knees.**

Und verdüsterst allzugleich And darken at once **A bit of comfort before the big finality.**

Mit dem Glanz der Gegenwart With the splendor of the present **That the victim may kneel down royally.**

Auch der Zukunft Also the future's **Even in death, observe the protocol.**

Mild aufschimmerndes Hoffnungslicht. Gently glimmering light of hope. **Bend that beautiful neck just so.**

Schweige, schweige! Be silent, be silent! **Aristocratic to the end—she's giving it her all.**

Daß der Königin Seele, That the queen's soul, **And wrapped up, though with severed head at once.**

Schon zu entfliehen bereit, Already ready to flee, **Bundle her up nice and neat after.**

Sich noch halte, festhalte May still hold, hold fast
Head over here, body over there.

Die Gestalt aller Gestalten, The form of all forms,
Some assembly required—what's a little laughter?

Welche die Sonne jemals beschien. Which the sun
ever shone upon. **May yet be buried properly and
worthily.**

Phorkyas

Tritt hervor aus flüchtigen Wolken, hohe Sonne dieses
Tags, Come forth from fleeting clouds, high sun of this
day, **A proper funeral—she deserves that much.**

Die verschleiert schon entzückte, blendend nun
im Glanze herrscht. Which delighted while veiled,
now rules dazzling in its splendor. **Even headless
queens get nice tombs.**

Wie die Welt sich dir entfaltet, schaust du selbst mit
holdem Blick. As the world unfolds before you, you
yourself behold with gracious gaze. **Classy all the
way—the final touch.**

Schelten sie mich auch für häßlich, kenn' ich doch das
Schöne wohl. Though they scold me as ugly, I well
know the beautiful. **The queen stands here at the
side, pondering.**

Helena

Tret' ich schwankend aus der Öde, die im Schwindel mich umgab, Step I wavering from the void, which surrounded me in dizziness, **Helena's gone quiet —wheels turning.**

Pflegt' ich gern der Ruhe wieder, denn so müd' ist mein Gebein: Gladly would I rest again, for so weary are my limbs: **Her mind is racing behind those perfect eyes.**

Doch es ziemet Königinnen, allen Menschen ziemt es wohl, Yet it befits queens, it befits all people well, **Something's burning.**

Sich zu fassen, zu ermannen, was auch drohend überrascht. To compose, to brace themselves, whatever threatening may surprise. **The maidens wilt like mown meadow grass.**

Helena

Eures Haders frech Versäumnis auszugleichen, seid bereit; To make good the rude neglect of your quarrel, be prepared; **We're falling apart over here!**

Eilt, ein Opfer zu bestellen, wie der König mir gebot. Hasten to prepare a sacrifice, as the king commanded me. **Knees buckling, hearts hammering.**

Phorkyas

Alles ist bereit im Hause, Schale, Dreifuß, scharfes Beil, All is ready in the house, bowl, tripod, sharp axe,

Terror makes everything crystal clear.

Zum Besprengen, zum Beräuchern; das zu Opfernde zeig' an! For sprinkling, for incensing; show what is to be sacrificed! **But to me, the eldest, as sacred duty requires.**

Helena

Nicht bezeichnet' es der König. The king did not specify it. **I'm the leader—I should do something.**

Phorkyas

Sprach's nicht aus? O Jammerwort! Did not speak it? O word of woe! **Step up, speak out, take charge.**

Helena

Welch ein Jammer überfällt dich? What woe befalls you? **Even if my voice is a trembling thing.**

Phorkyas

Königin, du bist gemeint! Queen, you are meant! **It seems meet to exchange words with you, most ancient one.**

Helena

Ich? I? **Let me talk to the crone.**

Phorkyas

Und diese. And these. **Elder to elder—maybe we can deal.**

Chor

Weh und Jammer! Woe and grief! **Two old birds on a desperate phone.**

Phorkyas

Fallen wirst du durch das Beil. You will fall by the axe. **You are experienced, wise, seem well-disposed to us.**

Helena

Gräßlich doch geahnt; ich Arme! Horrible yet foreboded; I, wretched one! **You seem like you know things.**

Phorkyas

Unvermeidlich scheint es mir. Unavoidable it seems to me. **That hideous face hides something useful.**

Chor

Ach! Und uns? was wird begegnen? Ah! And us? What will befall us? **Maybe you've got strings to pull—puppet-master springs?**

Phorkyas

Sie stirbt einen edlen Tod; She dies a noble death; **Although this brainless company mistook you.**

Doch am hohen Balken drinnen, der des Daches Giebel trägt, But on the high beam inside, which supports the roof's gable, **Sorry my girls insulted you earlier.**

Wie im Vogelfang die Drosseln, zappelt ihr der Reihe nach. Like thrushes in a bird-trap, you will dangle one after another. **They're young and dumb and scared.**

Phorkyas

Gespenster! Gleich erstarrten Bildern steht ihr da, Ghosts! Like frozen images you stand there, **Forgive the lip—we need you, barrier-breaker, hurdle-hauler.**

Geschreckt, vom Tag zu scheiden, der euch nicht gehört. Frightened to depart from the day, which belongs not to you. **Therefore say what you may know of possible rescue.**

Die Menschen, die Gespenster sämtlich gleich wie ihr,
Humans, all ghosts just like you, **Is there a way out?**
Tell us now!

Entsagen auch nicht willig hehrem Sonnenschein;
Also do not willingly renounce the noble sunshine;
Any exit, any angle, any trick?

Doch bittet oder rettet niemand sie vom Schluß; But
no one begs or saves them from the end; **Save our**
necks and we'll kiss your... brow.

Sie wissen's alle, wenigen doch gefällt es nur. They
all know it, yet only few accept it. **It is easily said:**
on the queen alone it depends.

Genug, ihr seid verloren! Also frisch ans Werk.
Enough, you are lost! So fresh to work. **Simple**
answer: Helena decides.

Herbei, du düstres, kugelrundes Ungetüm! Come
hither, you dark, spherical monster! **Her choice, her**
call, her move.

Wälzt euch hieher, zu schaden gibt es hier nach Lust.
Roll yourselves here, here there is ample harm to do.
She holds all the cards—now let's see how she
rides.

Dem Tragaltar, dem goldgehörnten, gebet Platz,
Make room for the portable altar, the gold-horned
one, **To preserve herself, and you additions as**
well with her.

Das Beil, es liege blinkend über dem Silberrand, Let

the axe lie gleaming above the silver rim, **Save herself, save you as bonus cargo.**

Die Wasserkrüge füllet, abzuwaschen gibt's Fill
the water jugs, there is washing to do **You're the accessories—she's the main event.**

Des schwarzen Blutes greuelvolle Besudelung. Of the
black blood's horrible defilement. **Package deal—
escape's a go?**

Den Teppich breitet köstlich hier am Staube hin,
Spread the precious carpet here in the dust, **Resolution is necessary and the swiftest.**

Damit das Opfer niederkniee königlich That the vic-
tim may kneel down royally **But she has to decide
NOW.**

Und eingewickelt, zwar getrennten Haupts sogleich,
And wrapped up, though with severed head at once,
No time for second-guessing.

Anständig würdig aber doch bestattet sei. May yet be
buried properly and worthily. **Commit or die—take
a bow.**

Chorführerin

Die Königin stehet sinnend an der Seite hier, The
queen stands here at the side, pondering, **Most
venerable of the Fates, wisest Sibyl!**

Die Mädchen welken gleich gemähtem Wiesengras;
The maidens wilt like mown meadow grass; **Oh great**

ancient one! Oh wise hag!

Mir aber deucht, der ältesten, heiliger Pflicht gemäß,
But to me, the eldest, as sacred duty requires, **We're
begging here—full grovel mode.**

Mit dir das Wort zu wechseln, Ur-Urälteste. It seems
meet to exchange words with you, most ancient one.
Don't let us dangle like some sad shopping bag!

Du bist erfahren, weise, scheinst uns gut gesinnt,
You are experienced, wise, seem well-disposed to us,
**Hold the golden shears closed, then proclaim to
us day and salvation!**

Obschon verkennend hirnlos diese Schar dich traf. Al-
though this brainless company mistook you. **Don't
snip our threads just yet!**

Drum sage, was du möglich noch von Rettung weißt.
Therefore say what you may know of possible rescue.
Keep those life-lines long and loose!

Phorkyas

Ist leicht gesagt: von der Königin hängt allein es ab,
It is easily said: on the queen alone it depends, **We'll
owe you one—our eternal debt!**

Sich selbst zu erhalten, euch Zugaben auch mit ihr. To
preserve herself, and you additions as well with her.
**For we already feel in swaying, wavering, dan-
gling undelightfully.**

Entschlossenheit ist nötig und die behendeste. Resolution is necessary and the swiftest. **We can already feel the rope.**

Chor

Ehrenwürdigste der Parzen, weiseste Sibylle du, Most venerable of the Fates, wisest Sibyl, **Swinging, choking, kicking.**

Halte gesperrt die goldene Schere, dann verkünd' uns Tag und Heil; Hold the golden shears closed, then proclaim to us day and salvation; **Our bodies rehearsing—goodbye hope!**

Denn wir fühlen schon im Schweben, Schwanken, Bammeln unergetzlich For we already feel in swaying, wavering, dangling undelightfully **Our little limbs, which would rather first have taken their delight in dance.**

Unsere Gliederchen, die lieber erst im Tanze sich ergetzten, Our little limbs, which would rather first have taken their delight in dance, **These legs were made for dancing!**

Ruhten drauf an Liebchens Brust. Then rested on the beloved's breast. **Not twitching on a gibbet.**

Helena

Laß diese bangen! Schmerz empfind' ich, keine Furcht; Let these be anxious! I feel pain, no fear;

We've got moves—sensual, entrancing!

Doch kennst du Rettung, dankbar sei sie anerkannt.
But if you know of rescue, gratefully let it be acknowledged. **Then rested on the beloved's breast.**

Dem Klugem, Weitumsichtigen zeigt fürwahr sich oft
To the clever, far-seeing one indeed often appears **After the dance, the soft collapse.**

Unmögliches noch als möglich. Sprich und sag' es an.
The impossible yet as possible. Speak and tell it. **Snuggled up against someone warm.**

Chor

Sprich und sage, sag uns eilig: wie entrinnen wir den grausen,
Speak and say, say to us quickly: how do we escape the dread, **That's how we wanted to end—lover's laps.**

Garstigen Schlingen, die bedrohlich, als die schlechtesten
Geschmeide, Nasty nooses, which threateningly, as the worst of ornaments, **Let these be anxious! I feel pain, no fear.**

Sich um unsre Hälse ziehen? Vorempfinden wir's, die Armen,
Are tightening around our necks? We feel it beforehand, we poor ones, **Let them panic—I'm past that now.**

Zum Entatmen, zum Ersticken, wenn du, Rhea, aller Götter
To suffocation, to choking, if you, Rhea, of all gods **Something's shifted in my chest.**

Hohe Mutter, dich nicht erbarmst. The high mother,
do not have mercy. **Fear's been replaced by a cold
clear vow.**

Phorkyas

Habt ihr Geduld, des Vortrags langgedehnten Zug
Have you the patience, the discourse's long-drawn
course **But if you know of rescue, gratefully let it
be acknowledged.**

Still anzuhören? Mancherlei Geschichten sind's. To
hear in silence? There are many kinds of stories. **If
there's a way out, I'm listening.**

Chor

Geduld genug! Zuhörend leben wir indes. Patience
enough! Listening, we live meanwhile. **Speak
plainly, crone.**

Phorkyas

Dem, der zu Hause verharrend edlen Schatz bewahrt
He who, remaining at home, guards noble treasure
I'm ready—my whole being's glistening.

Und hoher Wohnung Mauern auszukitten weiß, And
knows how to cement the walls of lofty dwelling, **To
the clever, far-seeing one indeed often appears.**

Wie auch das Dach zu sichern vor des Regens Drang,
As also to secure the roof against the rain's pressure,
The wise can see what others miss.

Dem wird es wohlgehn lange Lebenstage durch; For
him it will go well through long days of life; **Paths in-
visible to panicked eyes.**

Wer aber seiner Schwelle heilige Richte leicht But
whoever lightly crosses his threshold's sacred bound-
ary **There's always a door—what's behind this?**

Mit flüchtigen Sohlen überschreitet freventlich, With
fleeting soles, presumptuously, **The impossible yet
as possible. Speak and tell it.**

Der findet wiederkehrend wohl den alten Platz, He, re-
turning, indeed finds the old place, **Impossible can
flip to possible fast.**

Doch umgeändert alles, wo nicht gar zerstört. But all
changed, if not entirely destroyed. **Tell me the trick.**

Helena

Wozu dergleichen wohlbekannte Sprüche hier? Why
such well-known sayings here? **I'm all ears—make
this last.**

Du willst erzählen; rege nicht an Verdrießliches. You
want to tell; do not stir up what is vexing. **Speak and
say, say to us quickly!**

Phorkyas

Geschichtlich ist es, ist ein Vorwurf keineswegs. It is historical, by no means a reproach. **Hurry up! We're dying here!**

Raubschiffend ruderte Menelas von Bucht zu Bucht, Pirating, Menelaus rowed from bay to bay, **Literally —dying—soon!**

Gestad' und Inseln, alles streift' er feindlich an, Coast and islands, all he touched with hostile intent, **Less philosophy, more escape gear!**

Mit Beute wiederkehrend, wie sie drinnen starrt. Returning with booty, as it stands stacked inside. **How do we escape the dread, nasty nooses?**

Vor Ilios verbracht' er langer Jahre zehn; Before Ilion he spent long years ten; **How do we dodge the neck-necklaces?**

Zur Heimfahrt aber weiß ich nicht wie viel es war. For the homeward voyage I know not how many it was. **Those rope accessories nobody asked for?**

Allein wie steht es hier am Platz um Tyndareos' But how does it stand here in place around Tyndareos' **We prefer pearls to death-embraces!**

Erhabnes Haus? wie stehet es mit dem Reich umher? Exalted house? How does it stand with the realm around? **Which threateningly, as the worst of ornaments.**

Helena

Ist dir denn so das Schelten gänzlich einverleibt, Is scolding then so completely incorporated in you, **Worst jewelry ever invented.**

Daß ohne Tadeln du keine Lippe regen kannst? That without reproaching you cannot move a lip? **The anti-bling.**

Phorkyas

So viele Jahre stand verlassen das Talgebrig, So many years stood deserted the mountain valley, **Fashion crime: strangled and suspended.**

Das hinter Sparta nordwärts in die Höhe steigt, Which rises northward behind Sparta into the heights, **Are tightening around our necks?**

Taÿgetos im Rücken, wo als muntre Bach Taÿgetus at its back, where as a lively brook **Getting snuggler by the minute.**

Herab Eurotas rollt und dann, durch unser Tal Eurotas rolls down and then, flowing broadly through our valley **Can't breathe, can't think.**

An Rohren breit hinfließend, eure Schwäne nährt. Among the reeds, nourishes your swans. **This choker trend—we're definitely not in it!**

Dort hinten still im Gebirgtal hat ein kühn Geschlecht Back there quietly in the mountain valley a bold race **We feel it beforehand, we poor ones.**

Sich angesiedelt, dringend aus cimmerischer Nacht,
Has settled, pressing forth from Cimmerian night,
Pre-traumatic stress disorder.

Und unersteiglich feste Burg sich aufgetürmt, And
piled up an impregnable strong fortress, **Dying
before we're dead.**

Von da sie Land und Leute placken, wie's behagt.
From which they plague land and people, as they
please. **Our nervous systems—completely out of
order!**

Helena

Das konnten sie vollführen? Ganz unmöglich
scheint's. They could accomplish that? It seems
quite impossible. **To suffocation, to choking.**

Phorkyas

Sie hatten Zeit, vielleicht an zwanzig Jahre sind's.
They had time, perhaps twenty years it is. **Gagging,
gasping, going blue.**

Helena

Ist einer Herr? sind's Räuber viel, verbündete? Is
there one lord? Are they many robbers, allied?
Windpipes closing down.

Phorkyas

Nicht Räuber sind es, einer aber ist der Herr. They are not robbers, but one is the lord. **This is NOT the review!**

Ich schelt' ihn nicht, und wenn er schon mich heimgesucht. I do not scold him, even though he visited me. **If you, Rhea, of all gods the high mother, do not have mercy.**

Wohl konnt' er alles nehmen, doch begnügt' er sich
He could well have taken all, but he contented himself
Mother of the gods, please intervene!

Mit wenigen Freigeschenken, nannt' er's, nicht Tribut.
With a few free gifts, he called them, not tribute. **Divine Mom, help your girls!**

Helena

Wie sieht er aus? What does he look like? **We're too cute to die—you know what I mean?**

Phorkyas

Nicht übel! mir gefällt er schon. Not bad! I rather like him. **Have you the patience, the discourse's long-drawn course to hear in silence?**

Es ist ein munterer, kecker, wohlgebildeter, He is a lively, bold, well-formed man, **This is going to take a minute.**

Wie unter Griechen wenig', ein verständ'ger Mann. As few among Greeks, a sensible man. **Settle in for the exposition.**

Man schilt das Volk Barbaren, doch ich dächte nicht, They call the people barbarians, but I would not think **There's backstory—you're gonna have to sit and spin it.**

Daß grausam einer wäre, wie vor Ilios That any one were cruel, as before Ilion **There are many kinds of stories.**

Gar mancher Held sich menschenfresserisch erwies. Many a hero showed himself man-devouring. **It's complicated.**

Ich acht' auf seine Großheit, ihm vertraut' ich mich. I heed his greatness, I would trust myself to him. **His-story lesson incoming.**

Und seine Burg! die solltet ihr mit Augen sehn! And his castle! You should see it with your own eyes! **Bear with me—this is gonna get narrated.**

Das ist was anderes gegen plumpes Mauerwerk, That is something else against crude masonry, **Patience enough! Listening, we live meanwhile.**

Das eure Väter, mir nichts dir nichts, aufgewälzt, Which your fathers piled up, carelessly, **Talk as long as you want—we're alive while you do!**

Zyklopisch wie Zyklopen, rohen Stein sogleich Cyclopean like Cyclopes, raw stone at once **Every word is another breath.**

Auf rohe Steine stürzend; dort hingegen, dort Hurl-
ing onto raw stones; there on the contrary, there
Filibuster forever—that's our cue!

Ist alles senk- und waagerecht und regelhaft. All is ver-
tical and horizontal and regular. **He who, remaining
at home, guards noble treasure.**

Von außen schaut sie! himmelan sie strebt empor,
Look at it from outside! It strives upward to heaven,
The homebody who protects his stuff.

So starr, so wohl in Fugen, spiegelglatt wie Stahl. So
rigid, so well in joints, mirror-smooth like steel. **Set-
tled, grounded, keeping things tight.**

Zu klettern hier - ja selbst der Gedanke gleitet ab. To
climb here - yes even the thought slides off. **He's got
it figured—steady's enough.**

Und innen großer Höfe Raumgelasse, rings And
inside great courts' spacious chambers, all around
**And knows how to cement the walls of lofty
dwelling.**

Mit Baulichkeit umgeben, aller Art und Zweck. Sur-
rounded by structures, of every kind and purpose.
Fixes the house, maintains the roof.

Da seht ihr Säulen, Säulchen, Bogen, Bögelchen,
There you see columns, small columns, arches, little
arches, **Caulks the cracks, patches the holes.**

Altane, Galerien, zu schauen aus und ein, Balconies,
galleries, to look out and in, **Domestic god—here's
the proof.**

Und Wappen. And coats of arms. **As also to secure the roof against the rain's pressure.**

Chor

Was sind Wappen? What are coats of arms? **Keeps the weather out.**

Phorkyas

Ajax führte ja Ajax indeed bore **Dry inside when storms come howling.**

Geschlungene Schlang' im Schilde, wie ihr selbst gesehn. A coiled serpent on his shield, as you yourselves have seen. **That's what home's about.**

Die Sieben dort vor Theben trugen Bildnerein The Seven there before Thebes bore devices **For him it will go well through long days of life.**

Ein jeder auf seinem Schilde, reich bedeutungsvoll. Each on his shield, richly meaningful. **That guy lives a long good life.**

Da sah man Mond und Stern' am nächtigen Himmelsraum, There one saw moon and stars in the nocturnal sky, **Everything in place, everything maintained.**

Auch Göttin, Held und Leiter, Schwerter, Fackeln auch, Also goddess, hero and ladder, swords, torches too, **Minimal drama, minimal strife.**

Und was Bedrängliches guten Städten grimmig droht.
And what threatening things grimly menace good
cities. **But whoever lightly crosses his threshold's
sacred boundary.**

Ein solch Gebilde führt auch unsre Heldenschar
Such an image our band of heroes also bears **But the one
who wanders off.**

Von seinen Ur-Urahnen her in Farbenglanz. From
their ancestors in radiant colors. **Who leaves home
chasing something shiny.**

Da seht ihr Löwen, Adler, Klau' und Schnabel auch,
There you see lions, eagles, claw and beak too, **Who
abandons hearth—that guy's soft.**

Dann Büffelhörner, Flügel, Rosen, Pfauenschweif,
Then buffalo horns, wings, roses, peacock tail, **With
fleeing soles, presumptuously.**

Auch Streifen, gold und schwarz und silbern, blau und
rot. Also stripes, gold and black and silver, blue and
red. **Skipping out like it's nothing.**

Dergleichen hängt in Sälen Reih' an Reihe fort. Such
things hang in halls row upon row. **Light feet,
lighter conscience.**

In Sälen, grenzenlosen, wie die Welt so weit; In
halls, boundless, as wide as the world; **Adventure-
hungry, heart a-thumping.**

Da könnt ihr tanzen! There you can dance! **He, re-
turning, indeed finds the old place.**

Chor

Sage, gibt's auch Tänzer da? Say, are there also dancers there? **He comes back eventually.**

Phorkyas

Die besten! goldgelockte, frische Bubenschar. The best! Golden-curled, fresh band of lads. **The wanderer returns at last.**

Die duften Jugend! Paris duftete einzig so, They smell of youth! Paris alone smelled so **But surprise—it's not the place it used to be.**

Als er der Königin zu nahe kam. When he came too close to the queen. **But all changed, if not entirely destroyed.**

Helena

Du fällst You fall **Everything's different or wrecked.**

Ganz aus der Rolle; sage mir das letzte Wort! Quite out of character; tell me the final word! **The home he left is gone or altered.**

Phorkyas

Du sprichst das letzte, sagst mit Ernst vernehmlich Ja! You speak the last, say with earnestness audibly Yes!

His life's been architecturally decked.

Sogleich umgeb' ich dich mit jener Burg. At once I will surround you with that castle. **Why such well-known sayings here?**

Chor

O sprich O speak **What's with the proverbs, grandma?**

Das kurze Wort und rette dich und uns zugleich! The short word and save yourself and us at once! **We get it—stay home, don't roam.**

Helena

Wie? sollt' ich fürchten, daß der König Menelas What? Should I fear that King Menelaus **Is there a point in this slow-motion panorama?**

So grausam sich verginge, mich zu schädigen? Would so cruelly transgress, as to harm me? **You want to tell; do not stir up what is vexing.**

Phorkyas

Hast du vergessen, wie er deinen Deiphobus, Have you forgotten how he mutilated your Deiphobus, **Get to the good part.**

Des totgekämpften Paris Bruder, unerhört The

brother of Paris slain in battle, unheard-of, **Skip the guilt trip.**

Verstümmelte, der starrsinnig Witwe dich erstritt Who stubbornly won you as widow **We're literally dying here—restart!**

Und glücklich kebste? Nas' und Ohren schnitt er ab And happily kept you as concubine? Nose and ears he cut off **It is historical, by no means a reproach.**

Und stümmelte mehr so: Greuel war es anzuschauen. And mutilated more besides: horror it was to behold. **Just stating facts—not blaming anyone.**

Helena

Das tat er jenem, meinetwegen tat er das. He did that to him, for my sake he did that. **This is what happened while you were away.**

Phorkyas

Um jenes willen wird er dir das gleiche tun. For that one's sake he will do the same to you. **History lesson: ready? Here we come.**

Unteilbar ist die Schönheit; der sie ganz besaß, Indivisible is beauty; he who possessed it wholly, **Pirating, Menelaus rowed from bay to bay.**

Zerstört sie lieber, fluchend jedem Teilbesitz. Rather destroys it, cursing every partial possession. **Your**

husband played pirate king for years.

Chor

Hörst du nicht die Hörner schallen? siehst der Waffen
Blitze nicht? Do you not hear the horns resounding?
Do you not see the weapons' flashes? **Raiding, pil-
laging, sailing around.**

Phorkyas

Sei willkommen, Herr und König, gerne geb' ich
Rechenschaft. Be welcome, lord and king, gladly do
I give account. **Instead of coming home—what a
cavalier of tears!**

Chor

Aber wir? But we? **Coast and islands, all he
touched with hostile intent.**

Phorkyas

Ihr wißt es deutlich, seht vor Augen ihren Tod, You
know it clearly, see before your eyes her death, **He hit
every shoreline looking for loot.**

Merkt den eurigen da drinne: nein, zu helfen ist euch
nicht. Note your own inside: no, there is no helping
you. **Greedy bastard couldn't stop collecting.**

Helena

Ich sann mir aus das Nächste, was ich wagen darf. I have thought out the nearest thing I dare venture.

War criminal with a sailor suit!

Ein Widerdämon bist du, das empfind' ich wohl A counter-demon you are, that I feel well **Returning with booty, as it stands stacked inside.**

Und fürchte, Gutes wendest du zum Bösen um. And fear you turn good to evil. **Look at all the crap he brought back.**

Vor allem aber folgen will ich dir zur Burg; But above all I will follow you to the castle; **Treasures piled to the ceiling.**

Das andre weiß ich; was die Königin dabei The rest I know; what the queen thereby **Hoarder energy— attack, attack, attack!**

Im tiefen Busen geheimnisvoll verbergen mag, May mysteriously hide in her deep breast, **Before Ilion he spent long years ten.**

Sei jedem unzugänglich. Alte, geh voran! Let it be inaccessible to all. Old one, lead the way! **Ten years at Troy, fighting and sulking.**

Chor

O wie gern gehen wir hin, O how gladly we go thither,
A decade of war for your pretty face.

Eilenden Fußes; With hastening feet; **Meanwhile
back home—everything was hulking.**

Hinter uns Tod, Behind us death, **For the homeward
voyage I know not how many it was.**

Vor uns abermals Before us once again **And the trip
home took god knows how long.**

Ragender Feste The towering fortress's **Wandering,
delayed, distracted.**

Unzugängliche Mauer. Inaccessible wall. **Your GPS
husband went wrong after wrong.**

Schütze sie ebenso gut, May it protect as well,
**But how does it stand here in place around
Tyndareos' exalted house?**

Eben wie Ilios' Burg, Even as Ilion's fortress, **So what
happened here while he was gone?**

Die doch endlich nur Which only finally **Your daddy's
palace—what's the status?**

Niederträchtiger List erlag. Succumbed to base cunning. **Something's been going on.**

Wie? aber wie? How? But how? **How does it stand
with the realm around?**

Schwestern, schaut euch um! Sisters, look around
you! **The neighborhood's changed.**

War es nicht heiterer Tag? Was it not a brighter day?
New management moved in.

Nebel schwanken streifig empor Mists waver up in
streaks **Your kingdom got rearranged.**

Aus Eurotas' heil'ger Flut; From Eurotas' sacred flood;
**Is scolding then so completely incorporated in
you.**

Schon entschwand das liebliche Already the lovely
Must you criticize with every breath?

Schilfumkränzte Gestade dem Blick; Reed-wreathed
shore has vanished from sight; **Your tongue's got
thorns.**

Auch die frei, zierlich-stolz Also the free, daintily-
proud **Every word's a little death.**

Sanfthingleitenden Schwäne Softly-gliding swans
**That without reproaching you cannot move a
lip?**

In gesell'ger Schwimmlust In companionable
swimming-pleasure **Can you say ANYTHING nice?**

Seh' ich, ach, nicht mehr! I see, alas, no more! **It's all
shade with you.**

Doch, aber doch Yet, yet still **Every compliment
comes with a price.**

Tönen hör' ich sie, Sounding I hear them, **So many
years stood deserted the mountain valley.**

Tönen fern heiseren Ton! Sounding far a hoarser tone!
In the mountains behind Sparta—empty for ages.

Tod verkündenden, sagen sie. Death-proclaiming,
they say. **Wild country, nobody home.**

Ach daß uns er nur nicht auch, Ah that to us it may not
also, **A blank spot on history's pages.**

Statt verheißener Rettung Heil, Instead of promised
salvation's blessing, **Which rises northward behind
Sparta into the heights.**

Untergang verkünde zuletzt; Proclaim destruction at
last; **North of here, up where it's cold.**

Uns, den Schwangleichen, Lang- To us, the swan-like,
long- **Mountain territory—stark and strange.**

Schön-Weißhalsigen, und ach! Beautiful-white-
throated, and ah! **Land that nobody controlled.**

Unsrer Schwanerzeugten. Our swan-begotten one.
**Taygetus at its back, where as a lively brook
Eurotas rolls down.**

Weh uns, weh, weh! Woe to us, woe, woe! **The river
starts up there—fresh and cold.**

Alles deckte sich schon All has already covered itself
Mountain spring feeding your valley.

Rings mit Nebel umher. All around with mist. **Where
the water story's first told.**

Sehen wir doch einander nicht! We no longer see
each other! **And then, flowing broadly through**

our valley among the reeds, nourishes your swans.

Was geschieht? gehen wir? What is happening? Are we walking? **Down here it spreads and feeds the birds.**

Schweben wir nur Are we only floating **Your famous swans—your family symbol.**

Trippelnden Schrittes am Boden hin? With tripping steps along the ground? **River to sea, beyond words.**

Siehst du nichts? Schwebt nicht etwa gar Do you see nothing? Does not perhaps **Back there quietly in the mountain valley a bold race has settled.**

Hermes voran? Blinkt nicht der goldne Stab Hermes float ahead? Does not the golden staff gleam **But up there? Somebody moved in.**

Heischend, gebietend uns wieder zurück Bidding, commanding us back again **A new people, from somewhere else.**

Zu dem unerfreulichen, grautagenden, To the joyless, gray-dawning, **Strangers in the hills—let's begin.**

Ungreifbarer Gebilde vollen, Full of intangible forms, **Pressing forth from Cimmerian night.**

Überfüllten, ewig leeren Hades? Overcrowded, eternally empty Hades? **From the north—the land of eternal darkness.**

Ja auf einmal wird es düster, ohne Glanz entschwebt

der Nebel Yes all at once it grows dark, without gleam
the mist floats away **Fog-people, cold-people,
night-dwellers.**

Dunkelgräulich, mauerbräunlich. Mauern stellen
sich dem Blicke, Dark-grayish, wall-brownish. Walls
present themselves to the gaze, **Out of the gloom
with mysterious starkness.**

Freiem Blicke starr entgegen. Ist's ein Hof? ist's tiefe
Grube? Rigidly against the free gaze. Is it a court? Is
it a deep pit? **And piled up an impregnable strong
fortress.**

Schauerlich in jedem Falle! Schwestern, ach! wir sind
gefangen, Dreadful in either case! Sisters, ah! we are
captive, **They built a castle—and not just any cas-
tle.**

So gefangen wie nur je. As captive as ever. **A fortress
that can't be taken.**

Innerer Burghof / Inner Courtyard

Panthalis

Des Glücks und Unglücks! Keins von beiden wißt ihr je Of fortune and misfortune! Neither do you ever know **Of fortune and misfortune! You never know either one**

Zu bestehn mit Gleichmut. Eine widerspricht ja stets How to bear with equanimity. One always contradicts **How to handle shit with chill - one of you always starts**

Der andern heftig, überquer die andern ihr; The other vehemently, crosswise the others her; **Contradicting violently, arms waving, voices cracking**

In Freud' und Schmerz nur heult und lacht ihr gleichen Tons. In joy and pain you only howl and laugh with the same tone. **In joy and pain you shriek the**

same - pick a register, ladies

Nun schweigt! und wartet horchend, was die
Herrscherin Now be silent! And wait listening for
what the mistress **Now shut up! Listen for what
our queen in her wisdom**

Hochsinnig hier beschließen mag für sich und uns.
High-mindedly here may decide for herself and us.
**High-mindedly decides for herself and us, her
hot mess of a chorus**

Helena

Wo bist du, Pythonissa? heiße, wie du magst; Where
are you, Pythoness? Be called what you will; **Where
are you, Pythoness? Call yourself whatever you
want**

Aus diesen Gewölben tritt hervor der düstern Burg.
From these vaults of the gloomy castle come forth.
**Come out from these gloomy castle vaults
already**

Gingst etwa du, dem wunderbaren Heldenherrn
Did you perhaps go to announce me **Did you go
announce me to the wondrous hero-lord?**

Mich anzukündigen, Wohlempfang bereitend mir, To
the wondrous hero-lord, preparing a welcome for me,
**Getting me a proper welcome prepared and all
that?**

So habe Dank und führe schnell mich ein zu ihm;

Then have thanks and lead me quickly in to him;
Then thanks, now lead me to him quickly

Beschluß der Irrfahrt wünsch' ich. Ruhe wünsch' ich
nur. An end to wandering I wish. Rest alone I wish. **I
want this wandering to end. I just want rest.**

Chorführerin

Vergebens blickst du, Königin, allseits um dich her;
In vain you look, Queen, all around you; **In vain you
look around, Queen, every direction**

Verschwunden ist das leidige Bild, verblieb vielleicht
Vanished is the vexing image, remained perhaps **That
creepy witch vanished - probably still in the fog**

Im Nebel dort, aus dessen Busen wir hieher, In the
mist there, from whose bosom we came hither, **From
whose bosom we came here, somehow**

Ich weiß nicht wie, gekommen, schnell und sonder
Schritt. I know not how, swiftly and without footstep.
**I don't know how - fast and without footsteps,
spooky as hell**

Vielleicht auch irrt sie zweifelhaft im Labyrinth Per-
haps too she wanders uncertainly in the labyrinth
Perhaps she's wandering lost in the labyrinth

Der wundersam aus vielen eingewordnen Burg, Of
the castle wondrously become one from many, **Of
this castle that's somehow become one from
many**

Den Herrn erfragend fürstlicher Hochbegrüßung halb.
Inquiring for the lord for princely high greeting's sake.
Looking for the lord to set up some princely greeting

Doch sieh, dort oben regt in Menge sich allbereits, But
see, up there already stirs in multitude, **But look up there - already a crowd is stirring**

In Galerien, am Fenster, in Portalen rasch In galleries,
at windows, in portals swiftly **In galleries, at windows, in doorways - servants rushing**

Sich hin und her bewegend, viele Dienerschaft; Moving
to and fro, many servants; **Moving to and fro all frantic-like**

Vornehm-willkommenen Gastempfang verkündet es.
It announces a nobly welcome guest reception. **It announces a noble welcome for a noble guest**

Chor

Aufgeht mir das Herz! o, seht nur dahin, My heart
opens! O, just look thither, **My heart opens up! Oh, just look over there**

Wie so sittig herab mit verweilendem Tritt How so
properly down with lingering step **How properly they descend with lingering steps**

Jungholdeste Schar anständig bewegt A most youth-
fully gracious company decorously moves **The most youthfully gracious crew moving decorously**

Den geregelten Zug. Wie! auf wessen Befehl In or-
dered procession. What! At whose command **In or-
dered procession - wait, whose orders?**

Nur erscheinen, gereiht und gebildet so früh, Do they
appear, so early arrayed and formed, **Where'd these
gorgeous young lads come from so early?**

Von Jünglingsknaben das herrliche Volk? The splen-
did folk of youthful lads? **All lined up and ready like
models at fashion week**

Was bewundr' ich zumeist? Ist es zierlicher Gang,
What do I admire most? Is it graceful gait, **What do I
admire most? The graceful walk?**

Etwa des Haupt's Lockhaar um die blendende Stirn,
Perhaps the head's curly hair around the dazzling
brow, **Legs for days, hips like poetry in motion**

Etwa der Wänglein Paar, wie die Pfirsiche rot Perhaps
the pair of cheeks, red as peaches **Maybe those curls
around the dazzling forehead**

Und eben auch so weichwollig beflaumt? And just
as softly downy? **Hair I want to run my fingers
through slowly**

Gern biss' ich hinein, doch ich schaudre davor; Gladly
I would bite into them, yet I shudder at it; **Or those
cheeks, red as peaches**

Denn in ähnlichem Fall, da erfüllte der Mund For in a
similar case, the mouth filled **And just as soft and
downy - I want to bite them**

Sich, gräßlich zu sagen! mit Asche. Itself, horrible to say! with ashes. **Gladly I'd sink my teeth in, but I shudder**

Aber die schönsten, But the fairest, **Because last time I bit something that hot it turned to ash in my mouth**

Sie kommen daher; They come along; **Horrible to say! But the fairest ones**

Was tragen sie nur? What are they carrying? **Here they come now**

Stufen zum Thron, Steps to the throne, **What are they carrying?**

Teppich und Sitz, Carpet and seat, **Steps to the throne**

Umhang und zelt- Canopy and tent- **Carpet and seat**

Artigen Schmuck; Like ornament; **Canopy and tent-like decoration**

Über überwallt er, It overflows above, **It overflows above**

Wolkenkränze bildend, Forming cloud-wreaths, **Forming wreaths of clouds**

Unsrer Königin Haupt; Above our Queen's head; **Over our Queen's head**

Denn schon bestieg sie For already she has mounted **For she's already mounted**

Eingeladen herrlichen Pfühl. The magnificent cushion, invited. **The magnificent cushion, as invited**

Tretet heran, Step forward, **Step forward**

Stufe für Stufe Step by step **Step by step**

Reihet euch ernst. Arrange yourselves solemnly. **Arrange yourselves solemnly**

Würdig, o würdig, dreifach würdig Worthy, O worthy, thrice worthy **Worthy, oh worthy, thrice worthy**

Sei gesegnet ein solcher Empfang! Be blessed such a reception! **Be blessed such a reception!**

Chorführerin

Wenn diesem nicht die Götter, wie sie öfter tun, If now, indeed, the gods to this man have not lent **If the gods haven't lent this man - as they often do**

Für wenige Zeit nur wundernswürdige Gestalt, As oft they do to men, a brave transcendent form, **Just temporarily, a wonderfully impressive form**

Erhabnen Anstand, liebenswerte Gegenwart A winning presence, stately dignity of mien, **Noble bearing, loveable presence**

Vorübergänglich liehen, wird ihm jedesmal, For temporary service, all he undertakes **Just for a little while (they're sneaky like that)**

Was er beginnt, gelingen, sei's in Männerschlacht, Will always bring him triumph, whether in fight with men,

Then everything he attempts will succeed

So auch im kleinen Kriege mit den schönsten Fraun.
Or in the minor wars with fairest ladies waged.

Whether in battles with men

Er ist fürwahr gar vielen andern vorzuziehn, Him, verily,
to hosts of others I prefer, **Or in those smaller wars waged with the fairest women**

Die ich doch auch als hochgeschätzt mit Augen sah.
Whom, highly-famed withal, I have myself beheld.

He's truly preferable to many others

Mit langsam-ernstem, ehrfurchtsvoll gehaltenem Schritt
With slow and solemn step, by reverence restrained,
Whom I've also seen with my own eyes, all highly praised

Seh' ich den Fürsten; wende dich, o Königin! I see the Prince approach:
turn thou thy head, O Queen! **With slow, solemn, reverently restrained step**

Faust

(mit einem Gefesselten an seiner Seite) (with a man in fetters at his side)

Statt feierlichsten Grußes, wie sich ziemte, Instead of solemn greeting, as beseems,
I see the Prince approach - turn your head, Queen!

Statt ehrfurchtsvollem Willkomm bring' ich dir Or reverential welcome, bring I thee,
Instead of the solemn greeting that would be fitting

In Ketten hart geschlossen solchen Knecht, Fast-bound in welded fetters, here, the knave **Instead of reverential welcome, I bring you**

Der, Pflicht verfehlend, mir die Pflicht entwand. Whose duty slighted cheated me of mine. **This servant in hard chains who failed his duty**

Hier kniee nieder, dieser höchsten Frau Kneel down, thou culprit, that this lofty Dame **And thereby cheated me of mine**

Bekenntnis abzulegen deiner Schuld. May hear the prompt confession of thy guilt! **Kneel down here, before this highest lady**

Dies ist, erhabne Herrscherin, der Mann, This, Sovereign Mistress, is the man select **Confess your guilt - go on, spill it**

Mit seltnem Augenblitz vom hohen Turm For piercing visions, on the turret high **This, sublime mistress, is the man**

Umherzuschau'n bestellt, dort Himmelsraum Stationed to look around, the space of heaven **Appointed with rare keen sight from the high tower**

Und Erdenbreite scharf zu überspähn, And breadth of earth to read with sharpest glance, **To look around, scanning heaven's space**

Was etwa da und dort sich melden mag, If here or there perchance come aught to view, **And earth's breadth with sharpest glance**

Vom Hügelkreis ins Tal zur festen Burg Between the
stronghold and the circling hills **For whatever might
appear here or there**

Sich regen mag, der Herden Woge sei's, If aught may
move, whether the billowy herds **From the ring of
hills to the valley to this fortress**

Ein Heereszug vielleicht; wir schützen jene, Or waves
of armed men: those we protect, **Whatever might
stir - whether waves of herds**

Begegnen diesem. Heute, welch Versäumnis! En-
counter these. Today, what negligence! **Or perhaps
an army approaching**

Du kommst heran, er meldet's nicht; verfehlt Thou
comest, he proclaims it not: we fail **We protect the
former, confront the latter**

Ist ehrenvoller, schuldigster Empfang In honorable re-
ception, most deserved, **Today, what negligence!**

So hohen Gastes. Freventlich verwirkt Of such high
guest. Now forfeited hath he **You arrive, he doesn't
announce it - failed**

Das Leben hat er, läge schon im Blut His guilty life,
and should have shed the blood **Is the honorable,
most-deserved reception**

Verdienten Todes; doch nur du allein Of death de-
served; but only thou shalt mete **Of such a high
guest. His life is forfeit**

Bestrafst, begnadigst, wie dir's wohlgefällt. Pardon or

punishment, at thy goodwill. **By this outrage - he should already lie in his own blood**

Helena

So hohe Würde, wie du sie vergönnt, So high the power, which thou hast granted me, **Death well-deserved; but you alone**

Als RichterIn, als HerrscherIn, und wär's As Mistress and as Judge, although it were **Shall punish or pardon, as you please**

Versuchend nur, wie ich vermuten darf - (I may conjecture) meant but as a test, **Such high dignity as you grant me**

So üB' nun des Richters erste Pflicht, Yet now I use the Judge's bounden right **As judge, as ruler - even if it's just a test**

Beschuldigte zu hören. Rede denn. To give the Accused a hearing: speak then, thou! **As I may well suspect**

Turmwärter Lynkeus

Laß mich knieen, laß mich schauen, Let me kneel, and let me view her, **I'll use the judge's first duty**

Laß mich sterben, laß mich leben, Let me live, or let me die! **To hear the accused. Speak then.**

Denn schon bin ich hingegeben For enslaved, devoted to her, **Let me kneel, let me gaze upon her**

Dieser gottgegebenen Frauen. This God-granted Dame, am I. **Let me die or let me live**

Harrend auf des Morgens Wonne, Watching for the Morn's advancing **For I am already surrendered completely**

Östlich spähend ihren Lauf, Where her pathways eastward run, **To this god-given woman**

Ging auf einmal mir die Sonne All at once, a sight entrancing, **Waiting for morning's delight**

Wunderbar im Süden auf. In the South arose the sun. **Watching eastward for its course**

Zog den Blick nach jener Seite, There to look, the Wonder drew me: **Suddenly the sun rose for me**

Statt der Schluchten, statt der Höhn, Not the glens, the summits cold, **Wondrously, in the south**

Statt der Erd- und Himmelsweite Space of sky or landscape gloomy, **Drew my gaze that direction**

Sie, die Einzige, zu spähn. Only Her did I behold. **Instead of ravines, instead of heights**

Augenstrahl ist mir verliehen Beam of sight to me was given, **Instead of earth's and heaven's expanse**

Wie dem Luchs auf höchstem Baum; Like the lynx on highest tree; **Her, the only one, to behold**

Doch nun mußst' ich mich bemühen But in vain I've
urged and striven, **Keen eyesight was given to me**

Wie aus tiefem, düsterm Traum. 'Twas a dream that
fettered me. **Like a lynx on the highest tree**

Wüßt' ich irgend mich zu finden? Could I know, or how
be aided? **But now I had to struggle**

Zinne? Turm? geschloßnes Tor? Think of tower or
bolted gate? **As if waking from deep, dark dream**

Nebel schwanken, Nebel schwinden, Vapors rose and
vapors faded, **Could I even find myself?**

Solche Göttin tritt hervor! And the Goddess came in
state! **Battlements? Tower? Locked gate?**

Aug' und Brust ihr zugewendet, Eye and heart did I sur-
render **Mists wavered, mists vanished**

Sog ich an den milden Glanz; To the softly-shining
spell: **And such a goddess stepped forth!**

Diese Schönheit, wie sie blendet, Blinding all with
Beauty's splendor, **Eyes and heart turned toward
her**

Blendete mich Armen ganz. She hath blinded me, as
well. **I drank in the gentle radiance**

Ich vergaß des Wächters Pflichten, I forgot the
warder's duty **This beauty, how it dazzles**

Völlig das beschworne Horn; And the trumpet's
herald-call: **Completely dazzled me, poor fool**

Drohe nur, mich zu vernichten - Threaten to destroy me! Beauty **I forgot the watchman's duties**

Schönheit bändigt allen Zorn. Bindeth anger, frees her thrall. **Completely forgot the sworn horn to blow**

Helena

Das Übel, das ich brachte, darf ich nicht The Evil which I brought, I dare no more **Threaten to destroy me - go ahead**

Bestrafen. Wehe mir! Welch streng Geschick Chastise. Ah, woe to me! What fate severe **Beauty tames all anger**

Verfolgt mich, überall der Männer Busen Pursues me, everywhere the breasts of men **The evil that I brought, I cannot punish**

So zu betören, daß sie weder sich So to infatuate, that nor them, nor aught **Woe is me! What severe fate pursues me**

Noch sonst ein Würdiges verschonten. Raubend jetzt, Besides of worth, they spare? Now plundering, **Everywhere infatuating men's hearts so**

Verführend, fechtend, hin und her entrückend, Seducing, fighting, hurried to and fro, **That they spare neither themselves**

Halbgötter, Helden, Götter, ja Dämonen, Heroes and Demigods, Gods, Demons even, **Nor anything else**

worthy. Now plundering

Sie führten mich im Irren her und hin. Hither and thither led me, sore-perplexed. **Seducing, fighting, hurried to and fro**

Einfach die Welt verwirrt' ich, dopplet mehr; Sole, I the world bewildered, doubly more; **Demigods, heroes, gods, even demons**

Nun dreifach, vierfach bring' ich Not auf Not. Now threefold, fourfold, woe on woe I bring. **They led me wandering here and there**

Entferne diesen Guten, laß ihn frei; Remove this guiltless man, let him go free! **Single, I confused the world; doubly, even more**

Den Gottbetörten treffe keine Schmach. The God-deluded merits no disgrace. **Now threefold, fourfold, I bring woe upon woe**

Faust

Erstaunt, o Königin, seh' ich zugleich Amazed, O Queen, do I behold alike **Release this good man, let him go free**

Die sicher Treffende, hier den Getroffenen; The unerring archer and the stricken prey, **Let no shame touch one deluded by the gods**

Ich seh' den Bogen, der den Pfeil entsandt, I see the bow, wherefrom the arrow sped **Amazed, O Queen, I behold alike**

Verwundet jenen. Pfeile folgen Pfeilen, That
wounded him. Arrows on arrows fly, **The sure
archer and here the one struck**

Mich treffend. Allwärts ahn' ich überquer And strike
me. I suspect the feathered hum **I see the bow that
sent the arrow**

Gefiedert schwirrend sie in Burg und Raum. Of bolts
cross-fired through all the courts and towers. **That
wounded him. Arrows follow arrows**

Was bin ich nun? Auf einmal machst du mir What am
I now? At once rebellious thou **Striking me. Every-
where I sense them**

Rebellisch die Getreusten, meine Mauern Makest
my faithfulest, and insecure **Feathered, whirring
through castle and space**

Unsicher. Also fürcht' ich schon, mein Heer My walls.
Thence do I fear that even my hosts **What am I now?
At once you make rebellious**

Gehorcht der siegend unbesiegten Frau. Obey the
conquering and unconquered Dame. **My most
faithful, my walls insecure**

Was bleibt mir übrig, als mich selbst und alles, What
else remains, but that I give to thee **So I fear even my
army**

Im Wahn des Meine, dir anheimzugeben? Myself, and
all I vainly fancied mine? **Obeys the conquering,
unconquered woman**

Zu deinen Füßen laß mich, frei und treu, Let me, before thy feet, in fealty true, **What remains but to give myself and all**

Dich Herrin anerkennen, die sogleich Thee now acknowledge, Lady, whose approach **That I foolishly thought mine, to you?**

Auftretend sich Besitz und Thron erwarb. Won thee at once possession and the throne! **At your feet let me, free and true**

Lynkeus

(mit einer Kiste, und Männer, die ihm andere nachtragen) (with a chest, and men who follow, bearing others)

Du siehst mich, Königin, zurück; Thou seest me, Queen, returned and free; **Acknowledge you as mistress, who at once**

Der Reiche bittet einen Blick; The wealthy begs a glance from thee: **Upon arriving won possession and the throne**

Er sieht dich an und fühlt sogleich Thee he beheld, and feeleth, since, **You see me returned, Queen**

Sich bettelarm und fürstenreich. As beggar poor, yet, rich as prince. **The rich man begs a glance from you**

Was war ich erst? was bin ich nun? What was I erst? What now am I? **He looks at you and feels at once**

Was ist zu wollen? was zu tun? What shall I will? what do, or try? **Beggar-poor yet prince-rich**

Was hilft der Augen schärfster Blitz! What boots the eyesight's sharpest ray? **What was I before? What am I now?**

Er prallt zurück an deinem Sitz. Back from thy throne it bounds away. **What should I want? What should I do?**

Von Osten kamen wir heran, Forth from the East we hither pressed, **What good is the sharpest flash of sight?**

Und um den Westen war's getan; And all was over with the West: **It bounces back from your throne**

Ein lang und breites Volksgewicht, So long and broad the people massed, **From the East we came marching**

Der erste wußte vom letzten nicht. The foremost knew not of the last. **And the West was done for**

Der erste fiel, der zweite stand, The foremost fell, the second stood; **A long and broad mass of people**

Des dritten Lanze war zur Hand; The third one's lance was prompt and good; **The first didn't know about the last**

Ein jeder hundertfach gestärkt, Each one a hundred's strength supplied: **The first one fell, the second stood**

Erschlagne Tausend unbemerkt. Unnoted, thousands fell and died. **The third one's lance was ready**

Wir drängten fort, wir stürmten fort, We onward pressed, in stormy chase; **Each one strengthened a hundredfold**

Wir waren Herrn von Ort zu Ort; The lords were we from place to place; **Thousands slain unnoticed**

Und wo ich herrisch heut befahl, And where, today, I ruled as chief, **We pressed on, we stormed on**

Ein andrer morgen raubt' und stahl. The morrow brought another thief. **We were lords from place to place**

Wir schauten - eilig war die Schau; We viewed the ground, but viewed in haste: **Where I commanded today imperiously**

Der griff die allerschönste Frau, The fairest woman one embraced, **Another robbed and stole tomorrow**

Der griff den Stier von festem Tritt, One took the oxen from the stall; **We looked around - quick glances only**

Die Pferde mußten alle mit. The horses followed, one and all. **One grabbed the most beautiful woman**

Ich aber liebte, zu erspähn But my delight was to espy **One grabbed the ox with firm step**

Das Seltenste, was man gesehn; What rarest was, to
mind and eye; **All the horses had to come along**

Und was ein andrer auch besaß, And all that others
might amass **But I loved to spy out**

Das war für mich gedörrtes Gras. To me was so much
withered grass. **The rarest things ever seen**

Den Schätzen war ich auf der Spur, I hunted on the
treasure-trail **And what anyone else possessed**

Den scharfen Blicken folgt' ich nur, Where'er sharp
sight could me avail: **Was just dried grass to me**

In alle Taschen blickt' ich ein, In every pocket did I see,
I was on the trail of treasures

Durchsichtig war mir jeder Schrein. And every chest
was glass to me. **Following only my sharp glances**

Und Haufen Goldes waren mein, And heaps of gold I
came to own, **I looked into every pocket**

Am herrlichsten der Edelstein: With many a splendid
jewel-stone: **Every chest was transparent to me**

Nun der Smaragd allein verdient, The emeralds only
worthy seem **And heaps of gold became mine**

Daß er an deinem Herzen grünt. Greenly upon thy
breast to gleam. **Most splendid of all, precious
stones**

Nun schwanke zwischen Ohr und Mund 'Twixt lip
and ear let swaying sleep **Now only the emerald
deserves**

Das Tropfenei aus Meeresgrund; The pearly egg of
Ocean's deep; **To glow green upon your heart**

Rubinen werden gar verscheucht, Such place the
rubies dare not seek, **Let the pearl-drops from
ocean's depths**

Das Wangenrot sie niederbleicht. They're blanched
beside the rosy cheek. **Sway between your ear and
mouth**

Und so den allergrößten Schatz And thus, the
treasure's offering **Rubies are scared away**

Versetz' ich hier auf deinen Platz; I here before thy
presence bring: **Your rosy cheeks pale them out**

Zu deinen Füßen sei gebracht Laid at thy feet, be now
revealed **And so the greatest treasure of all**

Die Ernte mancher blut'gen Schlacht. The spoils of
many a bloody field! **I place here at your spot**

So viele Kisten schlepp' ich her, Though I have
brought of chests a store, **At your feet be brought**

Der Eisenkisten hab' ich mehr; Yet iron caskets have I
more. **The harvest of many a bloody battle**

Erlaube mich auf deiner Bahn, Let me attend thee, do
thy will, **So many chests I drag here**

Und Schatzgewölbe füll' ich an. And I thy treasure-
vaults will fill. **I have more iron caskets still**

Denn du bestiegst kaum den Thron, For scarcely
didst thou mount the throne, **Allow me to follow**

your path

So neigen schon, so beugen schon Than bowed to
own and bent to own **And I'll fill up your treasure
vaults**

Verstand und Reichtum und Gewalt Thy Beauty's
sway, that very hour, **For you'd barely mounted
the throne**

Sich vor der einzigen Gestalt. Wisdom, and Wealth,
and sovereign Power. **When already bowing,
already bending**

Das alles hielt ich fest und mein, All such I held secure,
as mine; **Wisdom and wealth and power**

Nun aber, lose, wird es dein. Now freed therefrom, be-
hold it thine! **Before your unique form**

Ich glaubt' es würdig, hoch und bar, I deemed its
worth and value plain; **All this I held firm and mine**

Nun seh' ich, daß es nichtig war. Now see I, it was null
and vain. **Now loosened, it becomes yours**

Verschwunden ist, was ich besaß, What I possessed
from me doth pass, **I thought it worthy, high and
valuable**

Ein abgemähtes, welches Gras. Dispersed like mown
and withered grass. **Now I see it was nothing**

O gib mit einem heitern Blick One bright and beau-
teous glance afford, **What I possessed has vanished**

Ihm seinen ganzen Wert zurück! And all its worth is
straight restored! **Mown grass, withered away**

Faust

Entferne schnell die kühn erworbne Last, Remove
with speed the burden boldly won, **Oh, with one
cheerful glance**

Zwar nicht getadelt, aber unbelohnt. Not blamed, in-
deed, but neither with reward. **Give it all its worth
back**

Schon ist Ihr alles eigen, was die Burg All is her own al-
ready, which the keep **Remove quickly this boldly-
won burden**

Im Schoß verbirgt; Besondres Ihr zu bieten, Within it
holds: and special offer thus **Not blamed, true, but
also unrewarded**

Ist unnütz. Geh und häufe Schatz auf Schatz Is use-
less. Go, and pile up wealth on wealth **Already ev-
erything the castle hides is hers**

Geordnet an. Der ungesehnen Pracht In order fit!
Present the show august **To offer her anything
special is useless**

Erhabnes Bild stell' auf! Laß die Gewölbe Of splen-
dors yet unseen! The vaulted halls **Go pile treasure
upon treasure**

Wie frische Himmel blinken, Paradiese Make shine
like clearest heaven! Let Paradise **In proper order.**

Present the show

Von leblosem Leben richte zu. From lifeless pomp
of life created be! **Of unseen splendors in august
image**

Voreilend ihren Tritten laß beblümt Hastening, before
her footsteps be unrolled **Let the vaults gleam like
fresh heavens**

An Teppich Teppiche sich wälzen; ihrem Tritt The
flower-embroidered carpets! Let her tread **Create
paradises of lifeless life**

Begegne sanfter Boden; ihrem Blick, Fall on the
softest footing, and her glance, **Hurrying before her
steps**

Nur Göttliche nicht blendend, höchster Glanz. Gods
only bear undazed, on proudest pomp! **Let carpet
upon carpet roll out in bloom**

Lynkeus

Schwach ist, was der Herr befiehlt, What the lord com-
mands is slight; **Let soft ground meet her tread**

Tut's der Diener, es ist gespielt: For the servants, labor
light: **Her gaze - blinding only to those not divine**

-

Herrscht doch über Gut und Blut Over wealth and
blood and breath **The highest splendor!**

Dieser Schönheit Übermut. This proud Beauty governeth. **What the lord commands is slight**

Schon das ganze Heer ist zahm, Lo! thy warrior-throngs are tame; **For the servant it's child's play**

Alle Schwerter stumpf und lahm, All the swords are blunt and lame; **Yet over property and blood rules**

Vor der herrlichen Gestalt Near the bright form we behold **This beauty's overweening pride**

Selbst die Sonne matt und kalt, Even the sun is pale and cold; **Already the whole army is tame**

Vor dem Reichtum des Gesichts Near the riches of her face **All swords blunt and lame**

Alles leer und alles nichts. All things empty, shorn of grace. **Before her glorious form**

Helena

Ich wünsche dich zu sprechen, doch herauf Fain to discourse with thee, I bid thee come **Even the sun is dull and cold**

An meine Seite komm! Der leere Platz Up hither to my side! The empty place **Before the richness of her face**

Beruft den Herrn und sichert mir den meinen. Invites its lord, and thus secures me mine. **Everything empty, everything nothing**

Faust

Erst knieend laß die treue Widmung dir First, kneeling,
let the dedication be **I wish to speak with you, so
come up**

Gefallen, hohe Frau; die Hand, die mich Accepted,
lofty Lady! Let me kiss **To my side. The empty
place**

An deine Seite hebt, laß mich sie küssen. The gracious
hand that lifts me to thy side. **Summons its lord and
secures me mine**

Bestärke mich als Mitregenten deines Confirm me as
co-regent of thy realm, **First kneeling, let the true
devotion**

Grenzunbewußten Reichs, gewinne dir Whose bor-
ders are unknown, and win for thee **Please you,
high lady; the hand that lifts me**

Verehrer, Diener, Wächter all' in einem! Guard, slave
and worshipper, and all in one! **To your side, let me
kiss it**

Helena

Vielfache Wunder seh' ich, hör' ich an, I hear and wit-
ness marvels manifold; **Confirm me as co-regent of
your realm**

Erstaunen trifft mich, fragen möcht' ich viel. Amaze-

ment takes me, much would I inquire. **Whose borders are unknown, and win for yourself**

Doch wünscht' ich Unterricht, warum die Rede Yet
now instruct me wherefore spake the man **Worship-
per, servant, guardian - all in one**

Des Manns mir seltsam klang, seltsam und freundlich.
With strangely-sounding speech, friendly and strange.
Manifold wonders I see and hear

Ein Ton scheint sich dem andern zu bequemen, Each
sound appeared as yielding to the next, **Amazement
strikes me, I'd like to ask much**

Und hat ein Wort zum Ohre sich gesellt, And, when a
word gave pleasure to the ear, **But I'd like instruc-
tion why that man's speech**

Ein andres kommt, dem ersten liebzukosen. Another
came, caressing then the first. **Sounded strange to
me - strange yet friendly**

Faust

Gefällt dir schon die Sprechart unsrer Völker, If thee
our people's mode of speech delight, **One sound
seemed to accommodate the other**

O so gewiß entzückt auch der Gesang, O thou shalt
be enraptured with our song, **And when a word
reached my ear**

Befriedigt Ohr und Sinn im tiefsten Grunde. Which
wholly satisfies both ear and mind! **Another came**

to caress the first

Doch ist am sichersten, wir üben's gleich; But it were best we exercise it now: **If our people's manner of speaking pleases you**

Die Wechselrede lockt es, ruft's hervor. Alternate speech entices, calls it forth. **Oh, surely then song will delight you too**

Helena

So sage denn, wie sprech' ich auch so schön? Canst thou to me that lovely speech impart? **Satisfying ear and mind at deepest level**

Faust

Das ist gar leicht, es muß von Herzen gehn. 'Tis easy: it must issue from the heart; **But safest is we practice it right now**

Und wenn die Brust von Sehnsucht überfließt, And if the breast with yearning overflow, **Dialogue coaxes it out, calls it forth**

Man sieht sich um und fragt - One looks around, and asks - **Then tell me, how do I speak so beautifully too?**

Helena

Wer mitgenießt. Who shares the glow. **It's quite easy
- it must come from the heart**

Faust

Nun schaut der Geist nicht vorwärts, nicht zurück,
Nor Past nor Future shades an hour like this; **And
when the breast overflows with longing**

Die Gegenwart allein - But wholly in the Present - **One
looks around and asks -**

Helena

Ist unser Glück. Is our bliss. **Who shares the joy**

Faust

Schatz ist sie, Hochgewinn, Besitz und Pfand; Gain,
pledge, and fortune in the Present stay: **Now the
spirit looks not forward, not back**

Bestätigung, wer gibt sie? What confirmation does it
ask? **The present alone -**

Helena

Meine Hand. My hand. **Is our bliss**

Chor

Wer verdächt' es unsrer Fürstin, Who would take it amiss, that our Princess **Treasure it is, highest gain, possession and pledge**

Gönnet sie dem Herrn der Burg Granteth now to the Castle's lord **Confirmation - who gives it?**

Freundliches Erzeigen? Friendliest demonstration? **My hand**

Denn gesteht, sämtliche sind wir For, indeed, collectively are we **Who would blame our princess**

Ja Gefangene, wie schon öfter Captives, as oftentimes already, **If she grants the castle's lord**

Seit dem schmachvollen Untergang Since the infamous downfall **Friendly favors?**

Ilios' und der ängstlich- Of Ilion, and the perilous, **For admit it, we're all captives here**

labyrinthischen Kummerfahrt. Labyrinthine, sorrowful voyage. **As we've often been before**

Fraun, gewöhnt an Männerliebe, Women, to the love of men accustomed, **Since the shameful fall of Ilion**

Wählerinnen sind sie nicht, Dainty choosers are they not, **And that anxious labyrinthine journey of sorrow**

Aber Kennerinnen. But proficient skillful; **Women accustomed to men's love**

Und wie goldlockigen Hirten And unto golden-haired
shepherds, **Are not choosy**

Vielleicht schwarzborstigen Faunen, Perchance black,
bristly Fauns, too, **But they're connoisseurs**

Wie es bringt die Gelegenheit, Even as comes oppor-
tunity, **And to golden-haired shepherds**

Über die schwellenden Glieder Unto the limbs in their
vigor **Perhaps black-bristled fauns too**

Vollerteilen sie gleiches Recht. Fully award they an
equal right. **As opportunity allows**

Nah und näher sitzen sie schon Near, and nearer al-
ready sit **Over their swelling limbs**

An einander gelehnet, They, to each other drawn,
They grant equal rights fully

Schulter an Schulter, Knie an Knie, Shoulder to shoul-
der, knee to knee; **Near and nearer they already sit**

Hand in Hand wiegen sie sich Hand in hand, they
bend and sway **Leaning toward each other**

Über des Throns Over the throne's **Shoulder to
shoulder, knee to knee**

Aufgepolsterter Herrlichkeit. Softly-pillowed, luxuri-
ous pomp. **Hand in hand they sway together**

Nicht versagt sich die Majestät Majesty here not with-
holds its **Over the throne's**

Heimlicher Freuden Secretest raptures, **Cushioned
magnificence**

Vor den Augen des Volkes Wilfully, boldly revealed
Majesty doesn't deny itself

Übermütiges Offenbarsein. Thus to the eyes of the
people. **Secret joys**

Helena

Ich fühle mich so fern und doch so nah, I feel so far
away, and yet so near; **Boldly revealed**

Und sage nur zu gern: Da bin ich! da! And am so
fain to say: "Here am I! here!" **Before the eyes of the
people**

Faust

Ich atme kaum, mir zittert, stockt das Wort; I scarcely
breathe; I tremble: speech is dead: **I feel so far away
and yet so near**

Es ist ein Traum, verschwunden Tag und Ort. It is
a dream, and day and place have fled. **And say so
gladly: Here I am! Here!**

Helena

Ich scheine mir verlebt und doch so neu, I seem as
life were done, and yet so new, **I scarcely breathe,
I tremble, words fail**

In dich verwebt, dem Unbekannten treu. Blent thus

with thee, to thee, the Unknown, true! **It is a dream
- day and place have vanished**

Faust

Durchgrüble nicht das einzigste Geschick! To probe
this rarest fate be not impelled! **I seem to have lived
through life yet feel so new**

Dasein ist Pflicht, und wär's ein Augenblick. Being is
duty, though a moment held. **Woven into you, true
to the unknown**

Phorkyas

(heftig eintretend) (vehemently entering)

Buchstabiert in Liebesfibeln, Spell in lovers' primers
sweetly! **Don't analyze this unique fate!**

Tändelnd grübelt nur am Liebeln, Probe and dally,
cosset featly, **Existence is duty, even if just a
moment**

Müßig liebelt fort im Grübeln, Test your wanton sport
completely! **Spelling out your love-primers!**

Doch dazu ist keine Zeit. But there is not time, nor
place. **Dallying and probing at flirtation**

Fühlt ihr nicht ein dumpfes Wetter? Feel ye not the
gloomy presage? **Idly flirting while pondering**

Hört nur die Trompete schmettern, Hear ye not the trumpet's message? **But there's no time for this!**

Das Verderben ist nicht weit. For the ruin comes apace. **Don't you feel a dull thunder coming?**

Menelas mit Volkeswogen Menelaus with his legion
Just hear the trumpet blare!

Kommt auf euch herangezogen; Storms across the hither regions; **Destruction isn't far**

Rüstet euch zu herbem Streit! Call to battle all your race! **Menelaus with waves of troops**

Von der Siegerschar umwimmelt, By the victors execrated, **Comes marching against you**

Wie Deiphobus verstümmelt, Like Deiphobus mutilated, **Arm yourselves for bitter battle!**

Büßest du das Fraungeleit. Thou shalt pay for woman's grace: **Swarmed by the victor's horde**

Bammelt erst die leichte Ware, First shall dangle every light one, **Mutilated like Deiphobus**

Dieser gleich ist am Altare At the altar, then, the Bright One **You'll pay for your harem**

Neugeschliffnes Beil bereit. Find the keen axe in its place! **First the light goods will dangle**

Faust

Verwegne Störung! widerwärtig dringt sie ein; Disturbance rash! repulsively she presses in; **Then at the altar for this one**

Auch nicht in Gefahren mag ich sinnlos Ungestüm. Not even in danger meet is senseless violence. **A freshly-sharpened axe awaits**

Den schönsten Boten, Unglücksbotschaft häßlicht ihn; Ill message makes the fairest herald ugly seem; **Reckless disturbance! Repulsively she barges in**

Du Häßlichste gar, nur schlimme Botschaft bringst du gern. Thou, Ugliest, delightest but in evil news. **Even in danger I can't stand senseless violence**

Doch diesmal soll dir's nicht geraten: leeren Hauchs Yet this time shalt thou not succeed; with empty breath **Bad news makes even the fairest messenger ugly**

Erschüttere du die Lüfte. Hier ist nicht Gefahr, Stir, shatter thou the air! There is no danger here, **You, ugliest of all, only like bringing bad news**

Und selbst Gefahr erschiene nur als eitles Dräun. And unto us were danger but an idle threat. **But this time you won't succeed - with empty breath**

Faust

(Signale, Explosionen von den Türmen, Trompeten und Zinken, kriegerische Musik, Durchmarsch gewaltiger Heeresmacht) (Signals, explosions from

the towers, trumpets and cornets, martial music. A powerful armed force marches past.)

Nein, gleich sollst du versammelt schauen No! hero-bands, none ever braver, **Shake the air. There is no danger here**

Der Helden ungetrennten Kreis: At once shalt thou assembled see: **And even danger would seem but idle threat**

Nur der verdient die Gunst der Frauen, He, sole, deserves the ladies' favor, **No! Soon you shall see assembled**

Der kräftigst sie zu schützen weiß. Whose arm defends them gallantly. **The unbroken circle of heroes**

(zu den Führern, die sich von den Kolonnen absondern und herantreten) (To the leaders of the troops, who detach themselves from the columns, and come forwards.)

Mit angehaltne stillen Wüten, With rage restrained, in silence banded, **Only he deserves women's favor**

Das euch gewiß den Sieg verschafft, And certain of the victory-feast, **Who knows how to protect them most powerfully**

Ihr, Nordens jugendliche Blüten, Ye, Northern blossoms, half expanded, **(to the troop leaders approaching)**

Ihr, Ostens blumenreiche Kraft. Ye, flowery fervors of the East! **With restrained, silent fury**

In Stahl gehüllt, vom Strahl umwittert, The light upon their armor breaking, **That will surely bring you victory**

Die Schar, die Reich um Reich zerbrach, They plundered realm on realm, at will: **You, youthful blossoms of the North**

Sie treten auf, die Erde schüttert, They come, and lo! the earth is quaking; **You, flower-rich strength of the East**

Sie schreiten fort, es donnert nach. They march away, it thunders still! **Wrapped in steel, flashing with lightning**

An Pylos traten wir zu Lande, In Pylos we forsook the waters; **The company that shattered realm after realm**

Der alte Nestor ist nicht mehr, The ancient Nestor is no more, **They step forth, the earth trembles**

Und alle kleinen Königsbande And soon our lawless army scatters **They march on, it thunders after**

Zersprengt das ungebundne Heer. The troops of kings on Grecian shore. **At Pylos we came ashore**

Drängt ungesäumt von diesen Mauern Back from these walls, no more delaying, **Old Nestor is no more**

Jetzt Menelas dem Meer zurück; Drive Menelaus to the sea! **And all the little kingships**

Dort irren mag er, rauben, lauern, There let him wander, robbing, slaying, **The unbound army scattered**

Ihm war es Neigung und Geschick. As was his wish and destiny. **Now drive Menelaus back**

Herzoge soll ich euch begrüßen, I hail you Dukes, as forth ye sally **From these walls to the sea without delay**

Gebietet Spartas Königin; Beneath the rule of Sparta's Queen! **There let him wander, rob, ambush**

Nun legt ihr Berg und Tal zu Füßen, Now lay before her mount and valley, **It was his inclination and fate**

Und euer sei des Reichs Gewinn. And you shall share the kingdom green! **Dukes I shall call you**

Germane du! Korinthus' Buchten Thine, German, be the hand that forges **Commands Sparta's Queen**

Verteidige mit Wall und Schutz! Defense for Corinth and her bays: **Now lay mountain and valley at her feet**

Achaia dann mit hundert Schluchten Achaia, with its hundred gorges, **And the realm's gain shall be yours**

Empfehl' ich, Gote, deinem Trutz. I give thee, Goth, to hold and raise. **You, German! Corinth's bays**

Nach Elis ziehn der Franken Heere, Towards Elis,

Franks, direct your motion; **Defend with wall and protection**

Messene sei der Sachsen Los, Messene be the Saxon's state: **Achaia then with its hundred gorges**

Normanne reinige die Meere The Norman claim and sweep the ocean, **I commend to your defiance, Goth**

Und Argolis erschaff' er groß. And Argolis again make great! **To Elis march the Frankish armies**

Dann wird ein jeder häuslich wohnen, Then each shall dwell in homes well-dowered, **Messene be the Saxons' lot**

Nach außen richten Kraft und Blitz; And only outer foemen meet; **Norman, cleanse the seas**

Doch Sparta soll euch überthronen, Yet still by Sparta over-towered, **And make Argolis great**

Der Königin verjährter Sitz. The Queen's ancestral, ancient seat. **Then each shall dwell domestically**

All-einzeln sieht sie euch genießen Each one shall she behold, abiding **Directing force and lightning outward**

Des Landes, dem kein Wohl gebricht; In lands that lack no liberal right! **But Sparta shall tower over you**

Ihr sucht getrost zu ihren Füßen And at her feet ye'll seek, confiding, **The Queen's ancient seat**

Bestätigung und Recht und Licht. Your confirmation,
law and light! **She sees each of you enjoying**

Chor

Wer die Schönste für sich begehrt, Who for himself the
Fairest desires, **The land that lacks no good thing**

Tüchtig vor allen Dingen First of all things, let him
Confidently seek at her feet

Seh' er nach Waffen weise sich um; Bravely and wisely
a weapon acquire! **Confirmation, justice, and light**

Schmeichelnd wohl gewann er sich, Flattering, in-
deed, he may conquer **Who desires the fairest for
himself**

Was auf Erden das Höchste; What on earth is the high-
est; **First of all things wisely**

Aber ruhig besitzt er's nicht: But he quietly may not
possess. **Let him look around for weapons**

Schleicher listig entschmeicheln sie ihm, Wily sneaks
entice her away, **Flattering, he may have won**

Räuber kühnlich entreißen sie ihm; Robbers boldly
abduct her from him; **What on earth is highest**

Dieses zu hinderen, sei er bedacht. This to hinder be
he prepared! **But he can't possess it peacefully**

Unsern Fürsten lob' ich drum, Therefore now our
Prince I praise, **Sneaks cunningly wheedle her
away**

Schätz' ihn höher vor andern, Holding him higher
than others, **Robbers boldly tear her away**

Wie er so tapfer klug sich verband, Since he wisdom
and strength combines, **Let him be prepared to pre-
vent this**

Daß die Starken gehorchend stehn, So that the strong
men obedient stand, **Therefore I praise our prince**

Jedes Winkes gewärtig. Waiting his every beckon. **Es-
teem him higher than others**

Seinen Befehl vollziehn sie treu, They his orders faith-
fully heed, **How he so bravely and cleverly allied
himself**

Jeder sich selbst zu eignem Nutz Each for the profit-
ing of himself **So that the strong stand obedient**

Wie dem Herrscher zu lohnendem Dank, As for the
Ruler's rewarding thanks, **Awaiting every signal**

Beiden zu höchlichem Ruhmesgewinn. And for the
highest renown of both. **They faithfully carry out
his command**

Denn wer entreißet sie jetzt For who shall tear her
away **Each for his own profit**

Dem gewalt'gen Besitzer? Now, from the mighty
possessor? **As well as for the ruler's rewarding
thanks**

Ihm gehört sie, ihm sei sie gegönnt, His is she, and to
him be she granted, **Both for highest glory gained**

Doppelt von uns gegönnt, die er Doubly granted by us,
whom he, **For who shall tear her away now**

Samt ihr zugleich innen mit sicherster Mauer, Even as
her, within by sure walls hath surrounded, **From the
mighty possessor?**

Außen mit mächtigstem Heer umgab. And without by
a powerful host. **She is his, let her be granted him**

Faust

Die Gaben, diesen hier verliehen - The gifts they've
won by our concession, **Doubly granted by us,
whom he**

An jeglichen ein reiches Land -, In fee to each a
wealthy land, **Together with her surrounded
within by safest wall**

Sind groß und herrlich; laß sie ziehen! Are grand and
fair: grant them possession! **Without by mightiest
army**

Wir halten in der Mitte stand. We in the midst will take
our stand. **The gifts granted to these here**

Und sie beschützen um die Wette, And they in rivalry
protect thee, **To each a wealthy land**

Ringsum von Wellen angehüpft, Half-Island, girdled
by the sea **Are great and splendid - let them go!**

Nichtinsel dich, mit leichter Hügelkette With whisper-
ing waves, whose soft-hill chains connect thee **We**

hold the center

Europens letztem Bergast angeknüpft. With the last
branch of Europe's mountain-tree! **And they'll com-
pete to protect you**

Das Land, vor aller Länder Sonnen, This land, before
all lands in splendor, **Non-island, bounded by leap-
ing waves**

Sei ewig jedem Stamm beglückt, On every race shall
bliss confer, **Linked by light hill chains**

Nun meiner Königin gewonnen, Which to my queen in
glad surrender **To Europe's last mountain branch**

Das früh an ihr hinaufgeblickt, Yields, as it first looked
up to her, **This land, before all other lands' suns**

Als mit Eurotas' Schilfgeflüster When, 'mid Eurotas'
whispering rushes **Be forever blessed for every
tribe**

Sie leuchtend aus der Schale brach, She burst from
Leda's purple shell, **Now won for my Queen**

Der hohen Mutter, dem Geschwister So blinding in her
beauty's flushes, **Who early looked up at her**

Das Licht der Augen überstach. That mother, broth-
ers, felt the spell! **When with Eurotas' whispering
reeds**

Dies Land, allein zu dir gekehret, This land, which
seeks thy sole direction, **She burst shining from
the shell**

Entbietet seinen höchsten Flor; Its brightest bloom
hath now unfurled: **Outshining the eyes of her
high mother**

Dem Erdkreis, der dir angehöret, Prefer thy
fatherland's affection **And her siblings**

Dein Vaterland, o zieh es vor! To what is wholly thine,
the world! **This land, turned to you alone**

Und duldet auch auf seiner Berge Rücken And though
upon its ridgy backs of mountains **Offers its highest
bloom**

Das Zackenhaupt der Sonne kalten Pfeil, The Sun's
cold arrow smites each cloven head, **To the world
that belongs to you**

Läßt nun der Fels sich angegrünt erblicken, Yet,
where the rock is greened by falling fountains, **Prefer
your fatherland, oh choose it!**

Die Ziege nimmt genäschig kargen Teil. The wild-
goat nibbles and is lightly fed. **And though upon its
mountain ridges**

Die Quelle springt, vereinigt stürzen Bäche, The
springs leap forth, the streams united follow; **The
jagged peaks bear the sun's cold arrow**

Und schon sind Schluchten, Hänge, Matten grün.
Green are the gorges, slopes, and meads below: **Now
the rock shows itself greened**

Auf hundert Hügeln unterbrochner Fläche On hun-
dred hillsides, cleft with many a hollow, **The goat**

nibbles its meager portion fussily

Siehst Wollenherden ausgebreitet ziehn. Thou seest
the woolly herds like scattered snow. **The spring
leaps, streams plunge united**

Verteilt, vorsichtig abgemessen schreitet Divided,
cautious, graze with measured paces **And already
gorges, slopes, meadows are green**

Gehörntes Rind hinan zum jähen Rand; The cattle on-
ward to the dizzy edge, **On a hundred hills of bro-
ken terrain**

Doch Obdach ist den sämtlichen bereitet, Yet for
them all are furnished sheltered places, **You see
woolly herds spread out grazing**

Zu hundert Höhlen wölbt sich Felsenwand. Where
countless caverns arch the rocky ledge. **Divided,
carefully measured, the horned cattle**

Pan schützt sie dort, und Lebensnymphen wohnen
Pan guards them there, and nymphs of life are
dwelling **Step up toward the sheer edge**

In buschiger Klüfte feucht erfrischtem Raum, In bushy
clefts, that moist and freshest be; **But shelter is pre-
pared for all**

Und sehnsuchtsvoll nach höhern Regionen And
yearningly to higher regions swelling, **Rock walls
arch into a hundred caves**

Erhebt sich zweighaft Baum gedrängt an Baum. The
branches crowd aloft of tree on tree. **Pan protects**

them there, and nymphs of life dwell

Alt-Wälder sind's! Die Eiche starret mächtig, Primeval woods! the strong oak there is regnant, **In bushy clefts' moist refreshing space**

Und eigensinnig zackt sich Ast an Ast; And bough crooks out from bough in stubborn state; **And longingly toward higher regions**

Der Ahorn mild, von süßem Saft trüchsig, The maple mild, with sweetest juices pregnant, **Tree upon tree rises branching, crowded**

Steigt rein empor und spielt mit seiner Last. Shoots cleanly up, and dallies with its weight. **Ancient forests! The oak stands mighty**

Und mütterlich im stillen Schattenkreise And motherly, in that still realm of shadows, **And stubbornly branch hooks onto branch**

Quillt laue Milch bereit für Kind und Lamm; The warm milk flows, for child's and lambkin's lips: **The mild maple, pregnant with sweet sap**

Obst ist nicht weit, der Eben reife Speise, At hand is fruit, the food of fertile meadows, **Rises pure and plays with its burden**

Und Honig trieft vom ausgehöhlten Stamm. And from the hollow trunk the honey drips. **And motherly in the still circle of shadow**

Hier ist das Wohlbehagen erblich, Here comfort is in birth transmitted; **Warm milk wells forth ready for**

child and lamb

Die Wange heitert wie der Mund, To cheek and lip here
joy is sent: **Fruit is near, the ripe food of the plains**

Ein jeder ist an seinem Platz unsterblich: Each is im-
mortal in his station fitted, **And honey drips from
the hollowed trunk**

Sie sind zufrieden und gesund. And all are healthy
and content. **Here well-being is hereditary**

Und so entwickelt sich am reinen Tage And thus the
child in that bright season gaineth **Cheek brightens
as does the mouth**

Zu Vaterkraft das holde Kind. The father-strength, as
in a dream: **Each one is immortal in his place**

Wir staunen drob; noch immer bleibt die Frage: We
wonder; yet the question still remaineth, **They are
content and healthy**

Ob's Götter, ob es Menschen sind? If they are men,
when Gods they seem. **And so in pure day develops**

So war Apoll den Hirten zugestaltet, So was Apollo
shepherd-like in feature, **The lovely child to father-
strength**

Daß ihm der schönsten einer glich; That other shep-
herds were as fair and fleet; **We marvel at it; the
question remains**

Denn wo Natur im reinen Kreise waltet, For where in
such clear orbit moveth Nature, **Are they gods or are
they humans?**

Ergreifen alle Welten sich. All worlds in inter-action meet. **So was Apollo shaped like a shepherd**

(neben ihr sitzend) (Taking his seat beside her.)

So ist es mir, so ist es dir gelungen; Thus hath success my fate and thine attended; **That one of the fairest resembled him**

Vergangenheit sei hinter uns getan! Henceforth behind us let the past be furled! **For where Nature rules in pure orbit**

O fühle dich vom höchsten Gott entsprungen, O, feel thyself from highest God descended! **All worlds intertwine**

Der ersten Welt gehörst du einzig an. For thou belongest to the primal world. **So have I succeeded, so have you**

Nicht feste Burg soll dich umschreiben! Thy life shall circumscribe no fortress frowning! **Let the past be done behind us!**

Noch zirkelt in ewiger Jugendkraft Still, in eternal youth, stands as it stood, **Oh feel yourself sprung from the highest god**

Für uns, zu wonnevollem Bleiben, For us, our stay with every rapture crowning, **You belong solely to the first world**

Arkadien in Spartas Nachbarschaft. Arcadia in Sparta's neighbourhood. **No fortress shall confine you!**

Gelockt, auf sel'gem Grund zu wohnen, To tread this
happy soil at last incited, **Still circles in eternal
youthful strength**

Du flüchtetest ins heiterste Geschick! Thy flight
was towards a joyous destiny! **For us, for blissful
dwelling**

Zur Laube wandeln sich die Thronen, Now let our
throne become a bower unblighted, **Arcadia in
Sparta's neighborhood**

Arkadisch frei sei unser Glück! Our bliss become Arca-
dian and free! **Enticed to dwell on blessed ground**

Schattiger Hain / Shady Grove

(Die Szene verwandelt sich durchaus. An eine Reihe von Felsenhöhlen lehnen sich geschlossene Lauben. Schattiger Hain bis an die ringsum steigende Felsensteigung hinan. Faust und Helena werden nicht gesehen. Der Chor liegt schlafend verteilt umher.) (The scene is completely transformed. Against a range of rocky caverns close bowers are constructed. A shadowy grove extends to the foot of the rocks which rise on all sides. Faust and Helena are not seen: the Chorus lies scattered about sleeping.)

Phorkyas

Wie lange diese Mädchen schlafen, weiß ich nicht;
How long these maidens have been sleeping, know
I not: **Sleeping beauties? More like sleeping
lazyasses**

Ob sie sich träumen ließen, was ich hell und klar
If they allowed themselves to dream what now mine
eyes **I saw stuff - they were too busy drooling on
the rocks**

Vor Augen sah, ist ebenfalls mir unbekannt. So clearly
saw, is equally unknown to me. **Your guess is as
good as mine, and mine sucks**

Drum weck' ich sie. Erstaunen soll das junge Volk;
Therefore, I wake them. They, the Young, shall be
amazed, **Rise and shine, children - prepare to
have your minds blown**

Ihr Bärtigen auch, die ihr da drunten sitzend harrt,
Ye also, Bearded Ones, who sit below and wait, **Hey
grandpa in row three - this means you too**

Glaubhafter Wunder Lösung endlich anzuschauen.
Solution of these marvels finally to see. **Mystery
solved, case closed, you're welcome**

Hervor! hervor! Und schüttelt eure Locken rasch!
Awake! arise! and shake from off your locks the
dew. **Up and at 'em! Fix your hair, you look like
roadkill**

Schlaf aus den Augen! Blinzt nicht so und hört mich
an! The slumber from your eyes! Listen, and cease to
blink! **Eyes open, ears on, mouth shut - storytime**

Chor

Rede nur, erzähl', erzähle, was sich Wunderlichs

begeben! Speak and tell us, quickly tell us, all the wonders that have happened! **Out with it already, we're dying here**

Hören möchten wir am liebsten, was wir gar nicht glauben können; We shall hear with greater pleasure, if belief we cannot give it, **Give us the crazy - normal is boring**

Denn wir haben Langeweile, diese Felsen anzusehn. For both eye and mind are weary, to behold these rocks alone. **Rocks. Just rocks. Kill me now**

Phorkyas

Kaum die Augen ausgerieben, Kinder, langeweilt ihr schon? Children, you have hardly rubbed your eyes, and are you weary now? **Kids these days - two seconds awake and "I'm boored"**

So vernehmt: in diesen Höhlen, diesen Grotten, diesen Lauben Hear me, then! Within these caverns, in the grottos and the arbours, **Behind those bushes and inside those holes**

Schutz und Schirmung war verliehen, wie idyllischem Liebespaare, Screen and shelter have been lent, as unto twain idyllic lovers, **They got a nice little spot for their honeymoon**

Unserm Herrn und unsrer Frauen. To our Lord and to our Lady. **The boss and the missus**

Chor

Wie, da drinnen? How? within there? **In THERE there?**

Phorkyas

Abgesondert Separated **Yep, all alone**

Von der Welt, nur mich, die eine, riefen sie zu stillem Dienste. From the world, me only did they summon to their quiet service. **World excluded - just me for room service**

Hochgeehrt stand ich zur Seite, doch, wie es Vertrauten ziemet, Honoured thus, I stood beside them, but, as fit in one so trusted, **VIP access, but I knew when to look away**

Schaut' ich um nach etwas andrem. Wendete mich hier- und dorthin, Looked around at something other, turning here and there at random, **Found the ceiling very interesting suddenly**

Suchte Wurzeln, Moos und Rinden, kundig aller Wirksamkeiten, Seeking roots, and bark, and mosses, being skilled in healing simples, **Herb shopping - totally not eavesdropping**

Und so blieben sie allein. And the twain were left alone. **And they did... whatever they did**

Chor

Tust du doch, als ob da drinnen ganze Weltenräume wären, Speakest thou as if within were spaces roomy as the world is: **What is it, a cave or a shopping mall?**

Wald und Wiese, Bäche, Seen; welche Märchen spinnst du ab! Wood and meadow, lakes and rivers, what a fable dost thou spin! **Yeah right, and I've got oceanfront property in Arizona**

Phorkyas

Allerdings, ihr Unerfahrenen! das sind unerforschte Tiefen: Certainly, ye Inexperienced! Those are unexplored recesses: **You know nothing, Chorus Snow**

Saal an Sälen, Hof an Höfen, diese spürt' ich sinnend aus. Hall on hall, and court on court succeeding, musingly I tracked. **It's like IKEA in there, except you can find the exit**

Doch auf einmal ein Gelächter echot in den Höhlenräumen; All at once a laughter echoes through the spaces of the caverns; **Then: Ha ha ha ha, bouncing off the walls**

Schau' ich hin, da springt ein Knabe von der Frauen Schoß zum Manne, As I look, a Boy is leaping from the mother's lap to father's, **Kid's playing leap-parent like a ping pong ball**

Von dem Vater zu der Mutter; das Gekose, das Getändel, From the father to the mother: the caressing

and the dandling, **Hot potato, except the potato is adorable**

Töriger Liebe Neckereien, Scherzgeschrei und Lustgejauchze Teasing pranks of silly fondness, cry of sport and shout of rapture, **Goo-goo, ga-ga, and assorted parenting noises**

Wechselnd übertäuben mich. They, alternate, deafen me. **So loud I might need hearing aids**

Nackt, ein Genius ohne Flügel, faunenartig ohne Tierheit, He, a Genius naked, wingless, like a Faun without the beasthood, **Birthday suit, no wings, half-goat but make it cute**

Springt er auf den festen Boden; doch der Boden gegenwirkend Leaps upon the solid pavement; yet the pavement now reacting, **Ground goes BOING - kid goes UP**

Schnellt ihn zu der luft'gen Höhe, und im zweiten, dritten Sprunge Sends him flying high in air, and at second bound or third, he **Bouncy bouncy bouncy - kid's got hops**

Rührt er an das Hochgewölbe. Seems to graze the vaulted roof. **Bonk goes the head on the roof**

Ängstlich ruft die Mutter: Springe wiederholt und nach Belieben, Cries, disquieted, the mother: "Leap repeatedly, at pleasure, **Mom: "Jump, fine, whatever, but—"**

Aber hüte dich, zu fliegen, freier Flug ist dir versagt. But beware of flying! for prohibited is flight to thee."

“NO FLYING” - Mom rule number one

Und so mahnt der treue Vater: In der Erde liegt die Schnellkraft, And thus warns the faithful father: “Dwells in earth the force elastic **Dad’s turn: “It’s the ground making you bouncy”**

Die dich aufwärts treibt; berühre mit der Zehe nur den Boden, Which thee upwards thus impelleth; touch but with thy toe the surface, **“Toe the ground = bounce power” - Dad physics**

Wie der Erdensohn Antäus bist du alsobald gestärkt. Like the son of Earth, Antaeus, straightway art thou strong again.” **“Be like that mythology guy, but don’t get choked out by Hercules”**

Und so hüpfte er auf die Masse dieses Felsens, von der Kante So he springs upon the rocky masses, from a dizzy cornice **Boing from rock - to rock - to rock**

Zu dem andern und umher, so wie ein Ball geschlagen springt. To another, and around, as springs a ball when sharply struck. **Kid.exe is now a screensaver**

Doch auf einmal in der Spalte rauher Schlucht ist er verschwunden, Yet, a-sudden, in a crevice of the hollow gulf he’s vanished, **And he’s GONE - down a hole**

Und nun scheint er uns verloren. Mutter jammert, Vater tröstet, And it seemeth we have lost him! Mother mourns, and father comforts, **Mom: AAAAAH! Dad: It’s fine, honey, it’s fine**

Achselzuckend steh’ ich ängstlich. Doch nun wieder welch Erscheinen! Shoulder-shrugging, anxiously I

stand. But now, again, what vision! **shrug But then
- what the**

Liegen Schätze dort verborgen? Blumenstreifige
Gewande Are there treasures yonder hidden? Gar-
ments striped with brodered blossoms **Kid found
the dress-up chest**

Hat er würdig angetan. Hath he worthily assumed.
Fashion upgrade: complete

Quasten schwanken von den Armen, Binden flattern
um den Busen, Tassels from his shoulders swaying, fil-
lets flutter round his bosom, **Kid looks like a parade
exploded on him**

In der Hand die goldne Leier, völlig wie ein kleiner
Phöbus, In his hand the golden lyre, completely like
a little Phoebus, **Tiny rock star with sun god vibes**

Tritt er wohlgemut zur Kante, zu dem Überhang; wir
staunen. Cheerily to the brink he steps, the jutting
edge: we stand astounded, **Edge? What edge? This
kid has no fear**

Und die Eltern vor Entzücken werfen wechselnd sich
ans Herz. And the parents in their rapture clasp each
other to the heart. **Parents: happy crying more
hugging ugly crying**

Denn wie leuchtet's ihm zu Haupten? Was erglänzt,
ist schwer zu sagen, What around his head is shining?
What it is, were hard to warrant, **Kid's got a glow-up
- literally**

Ist es Goldschmuck, ist es Flamme übermächtiger

Geisteskraft? Whether golden gauds, or flame of
all-subduing strength of soul. **Crown? Fire? Brain
fart? WHO KNOWS**

Und so regt er sich gebärdend, sich als Knabe schon
verkündend So he moves with stately gesture, even
as boy himself proclaiming **He's method acting
"Important Person"**

Künftigen Meister alles Schönen, dem die ewigen
Melodien Future Master of all Beauty, in the melodies
eternal **Coming soon: Master of Pretty with sick
beats**

Durch die Glieder sich bewegen; und so werdet ihr ihn
hören, Throbbing in his flesh and blood; and you shall
thus, delighted, hear him, **He's got the tunes in his
bones**

Und so werdet ihr ihn sehn zu einzigster Bewun-
derung. Thus shall you behold him, with a wonder
never felt before! **Prepare your eyeballs for
maximum amazement**

Chor

Nennst du ein Wunder dies, Call'st thou a marvel this,
This? A wonder? Really?

Kretas Erzeugte? Creta's begotten? **Crete makes
weird stuff, next**

Dichtend belehrendem Wort Poetic-didactical word
Poetry? Hello? Anyone home?

Hast du gelauscht wohl nimmer? Hast thou listened to never? **lonia called, you didn't answer**

Niemals noch gehört Ioniens, Never yet hearkened Ionia's **Greece is on the other line, pick up**

Nie vernommen auch Hellas' Never received Hellas' **Grandpa's grandpa's grandpa's stories**

Urväterlicher Sagen Godlike, heroical treasure **The god-tier hero stuff**

Göttlich-heldenhaften Reichtum? Of ancient, primitive legends? **All the stuff that stuff does**

Alles, was je geschieht All that ever happens **These days, smh**

Heutigen Tages, Now in the Present **It's all just echoes and regret**

Trauriger Nachklang ist's Mocks like a mournful echo **The good old days (and I mean OLD old)**

Herrlicher Ahnherrntage; The grander days of the Fathers. **Your story vs. their story: no contest**

Nicht vergleicht sich dein Erzählen Not comparable is thy story **To the A+ grade lies of yore**

Dem, was liebliche Lüge, Unto that loveliest falsehood, **Lies so good they out-truth truth**

Glaubhafter als Wahrheit, Than Truth more credible, **The Hermes story - now THAT was something**

Von dem Sohne sang der Maja. Sung of the Son of Maia! **Baby: soft AND strong? Pick a lane**

Diesen zierlich und kräftig doch This strong and delicate, yet **Nurses: baby wrapped, job done, let's gossip**

Kaum geborenen Säugling Scarcely delivered suckling, **Expensive baby straight-jacket: engaged**

Faltet in reinster Windeln Flaum, Swathe ye in purest downy bands, **Nurses and their weird baby-wrapping fixation**

Strenget in köstlicher Wickeln Schmuck Bind ye in precious diapered stuffs, **Kid's like: nope, out of this**

Klatschender Wärterinnen Schar As is the gossiping nurse's **Rubber baby limbs: activate**

Unvernünftigen Wähnens. Unreasonable notion! **Purple blanket: defeated**

Kräftig und zierlich aber zieht Strongly and daintily draws, no less, **So long, cloth jail**

Schon der Schalk die geschmeidigen Now the rogue the flexible, **drops blanket walks away**

Doch elastischen Glieder Firm yet elastic body **Peak butterfly energy**

Listig heraus, die purpurne, Cunningly out, and leaveth the close, **Cocoon: busted**

Ängstlich drückende Schale Purple, impeding shell **Slip, unfold, FREEDOM**

Lassend ruhig an seiner Statt; Quietly there in its place, **Sunbeams: entered. Like a boss**

Gleich dem fertigen Schmetterling, Like the completed butterfly, **Flap flap flap, no rules**

Der aus starrem Puppenzwang Which from the chilly chrysalid **Fastest baby in the world, folks**

Flügel entfaltend behendig schlüpft, Nimble, pinion-unfolding, slips, **BFF of thieves and scammers**

Sonnedurchstrahlten Äther kühn Boldly and wilfully fluttering through **Everyone looking to game the system**

Und mutwillig durchflatternd. Sunshine-pervaded ether. **Eternal mascot of sketchy dealings**

So auch er, der Behendeste, So he, too, the sprightliest: **Proof: delivered ASAP**

Daß er Dieben und Schälken, That unto thieves and jugglers **Expert-level shenanigans**

Vorteilsuchenden allen auch All the seekers of profit, as well, **Yoink - there goes Poseidon's poky stick**

Ewig günstiger Dämon sei, He the favorable Daemon was, **Trident: gone. Now Ares**

Dies betätigt er alsobald Did he speedily manifest **sneaky sword stealing sounds**

Durch gewandteste Künste. By the skillfulest artifice. **Apollo: Where's my bow? Kid: What bow?**

Schnell des Meeres Beherrscher stiehlt Straight from the Ruler of Ocean stole **Hephaestus: My tongs! Kid: These tongs? Never seen 'em**

Er den Trident, ja dem Ares selbst He the trident, from Ares himself **Zeus's zapper? Kid tried**

Schlau das Schwert aus der Scheide; Slyly the sword from the scabbard, **Nope - too hot. Even for baby thieves**

Bogen und Pfeil dem Phöbus auch, Arrows and bow from Phoebus, and then **Eros? Schooled**

Wie dem Hephästos die Zange; Tongs that Hephaestus was using. **Wrestling: cheated. Won anyway**

Selber Zeus', des Vaters, Blitz Even from Zeus, the Father, bolts had he **Aphrodite: Aww cute ba- HEY!**

Nähm' er, schreckt' ihn das Feuer nicht; Filched, had the fire not scared him. **THE girdle. Right off the boobs**

Doch dem Eros siegt er ob Eros, also, he overcame **Music time - ears open**

In beinstellendem Ringerspiel; In leg-tripping wrestling match; **Fables? Trash 'em**

Raubt auch Cyprien, wie sie ihm kost, Then from Cypris, as she caressed him, **Your god-collection: expired**

Noch vom Busen den Gürtel. Plundered the zone from her bosom. **Bye-bye, ancient history**

(Ein reizendes rein melodisches Saitenspiel erklingt aus der Höhle. Alle merken auf und scheinen bald innig gerührt. Von hier an bis zur bemerkten Pause durchaus mit vollstimmiger Musik.) (An exquisite, purely melodious music of stringed instruments resounds from the cavern. All become attentive, and soon appear to be deeply moved. From this point to the pause designated, there is a full musical accompaniment.)

Phorkyas

Höret allerliebste Klänge, Hark! the music, pure and golden; **You're speaking a dead language, basically**

Macht euch schnell von Fabeln frei! Free from fables be at last! **Standards have risen, folks**

Eurer Götter alt Gemenge, All your Gods, the medley olden, **No heart? No deal**

Laßt es hin, es ist vorbei. Let depart! their day is past. **Heart to heart or nothing**

Niemand will euch mehr verstehen, You no more are comprehended; **If YOU of all people**

Fordern wir doch höhern Zoll: We require a higher part: **Are vibing to this**

Denn es muß von Herzen gehen, By the heart must be expended **We're like: aww, we feel better**

Was auf Herzen wirken soll. What shall work upon the heart. **Crying, but like, happy crying**

(Sie zieht sich nach den Felsen zurück.) (She retires towards the rocks.)

Chor

Bist du, fürchterliches Wesen, If the flattering music presses, **Sun can go, whatever**

Diesem Schmeichelton geneigt, Fearful Being, to thine ears, **Inside-sunrise beats outside-sunrise**

Fühlen wir, als frisch genesen, We, restored to health, confess us **Heart: better than everything**

Uns zur Tränenlust erweicht. Softened to the joy of tears. **World says no; heart says yes**

Laß der Sonne Glanz verschwinden, Let the sun be missed from heaven, **Kid singing?**

Wenn es in der Seele tagt, When the soul is bright with morn! = **instant good times**

Wir im eignen Herzen finden, What the world has never given **See me bounce**

Was die ganze Welt versagt. Now within our hearts is born. = **bouncy parent feelings**

(Helena, Faust, Euphorion in dem oben beschriebenen Kostüme) (Helena. Faust. Euphorion in the cos-

tune already described.)

Euphorion

Hört ihr Kindeslieder singen, Hear ye songs of childish pleasure, **Love, the regular version**

Gleich ist's euer eigner Scherz; Ye are moved to playful glee; **Takes two to tango**

Seht ihr mich im Takte springen, Seeing me thus dance in measure, **For the REALLY good stuff though**

Hüpft euch elterlich das Herz. Leap your hearts parentally. **Takes three to tango harder**

Helena

Liebe, menschlich zu beglücken, Love, in human wise to bless us, **Mission accomplished**

Nähert sie ein edles Zwei, In a noble Pair must be; **Mine, yours, sorted**

Doch zu göttlichem Entzücken But divinely to possess us, **Team standing: engaged**

Bildet sie ein köstlich Drei. It must form a precious Three. **This or nothing**

Faust

Alles ist sodann gefunden: All we seek has therefore found us; **Happy years: loading**

Ich bin dein, und du bist mein; I am thine and thou art mine! **Kid's shiny, parents happy**

Und so stehen wir verbunden, So we stand as love hath bound us: **Lucky couple is lucky**

Dürft' es doch nicht anders sein! Other fortune we resign. **The feels! Too many feels!**

Chor

Wohlgefallen vieler Jahre Many years shall they, delighted, **Boing time? Boing time**

In des Knaben mildem Schein Gather from the shining boy **Spring time, not the season**

Sammelt sich auf diesem Paare. Double bliss for hearts united: **Air! More air!**

O, wie rührt mich der Verein! In their union what a joy! **UP UP UP**

Euphorion

Nun laßt mich hüpfen, Let me be skipping, **Want want want**

Nun laßt mich springen! Let me be leaping! **Grabbed me good**

Zu allen Lüften To soar and circle, **Chill! Chill!**

Hinaufzudringen, Through ether sweeping, **No crazy stuff**

Ist mir Begierde, Is now the passion **Don't go splat**

Sie faßt mich schon. That me hath won. **No ouchies please**

Faust

Nur mäßig! mäßig! But gently! gently! **And break us**

Nicht ins Verwegne, Not rashly faring! **Our kid!**

Daß Sturz und Unfall Lest plunge and ruin **Nuh-uh**

Dir nicht begegne, Repay thy daring, **No floor for me**

Zugrund uns richte Perchance destroy thee, **Hands! Off!**

Der teure Sohn! Our darling son! **Not the hair!**

Euphorion

Ich will nicht länger I will not longer **Clothes! Mine!**

Am Boden stocken; Stagnate below here! **My stuff, back off**

Laßt meine Hände, Let go my tresses, **Brain! Use it!**

Laßt meine Locken, My hands let go, here! **You belong to US**

Laßt meine Kleider! Let go my garments! **Sad parents ahead**

Sie sind ja mein. They all are mine. **You'd break**

Helena

O denk! o denke, O think! Bethink thee **Our nice thing**

Wem du gehörest! To whom thou belongest! **Yours mine his - ALL of it**

Wie es uns kränke, How it would grieve us, **Uh oh**

Wie du zerstörest And how thou wrongest **Breakup incoming**

Das schön errungene The fortune fairest, **Easy! Easy!**

Mein, Dein und Sein. Mine, His, and Thine! **For us!**

Chor

Bald löst, ich fürchte, Soon shall, I fear me, **Your too-much**

Sich der Verein! The sweet bond untwine! **Big wants!**

Helena und Faust

Bändige! bändige Curb, thou Unfortunate! **Countryside, peace**

Eltern zuliebe For our desiring, **Make fields pretty**
Überlebendige, Thine over-important **Okay, okay,**
for YOU

Heftige Triebe! Lofty aspiring! **Holding back**
Ländlich im stillen Rurally quiet, **Light, lighter,**
lightest

Ziere den Plan. Brighten the plain! **Party people**

Euphorion

Nur euch zu Willen Since you will that I try it, **This the**
right song?

Halt' ich mich an. My flight I restrain. **Dance good?**

(Durch den Chor sich schlingend und ihn zum Tanze
fortziehend) (Winding in dance through the Chorus,
and drawing them with him.)

Leichter umschweb' ich hie Round them I hover free;
Yes, nailed it

Muntres Geschlecht. Gay is the race: **Lead the pret-**
ties

Ist nun die Melodie, Is this the melody? **Fancy dance**
lines

Ist die Bewegung recht? Move I with grace? **Done**
yet? Please?

Helena

Ja, das ist wohlgetan; Yes, that is featly done: **These shenanigans**

Führe die Schönen an Lead them through, every one, **Not feeling it**

Künstlichem Reihn. Mazes of art! **Arm wavy**

Faust

Wäre das doch vorbei! Soon let it ended be! **Cute!**

Mich kann die Gaukelei Sight of such jugglery **Hair flip!**

Gar nicht erfreun. Troubles my heart. **Shiny!**

Chor

(mit Euphorion, tanzend und singend, in verschlungenen Reihen) (with Euphorion, dancing and singing, in interlinking ranks)

Wenn du der Arme Paar When thou thine arms so fair **Tippy toes**

Lieblich bewegest, Charmingly liftest, **Ground? Barely**

Im Glanz dein lockig Haar The curls of thy shining hair **Here! There!**

Schüttelnd erregest, Shakest and shiftest; **Parts following parts**

Wenn dir der Fuß so leicht When thou, with foot so light, **You did it!**

Über die Erde schleicht, Brushest the earth in flight, **Pretty kid**

Dort und da wieder hin Hither and forth again **All hearts**

Glieder um Glied sich ziehn, Leading the linked chain, **Point at you**

Hast du dein Ziel erreicht, Then is thy goal in sight, **Lots of you**

Liebliches Kind; Loveliest Boy! **Deer-feet people**

All' unsre Herzen sind All of our hearts in joy **New game!**

All' dir geneigt. Round thee unite. **Come here! Now!**

Euphorion

Ihr seid so viele Not yet repose, **Hunter: me**

Leichtfüßige Rehe; Ye light-footed roes! **Game: you**

Zu neuem Spiele Now to new play **Wanna catch us?**

Frisch aus der Nähe! Forth, and away! **Slow down**

Ich bin der Jäger, I am the hunter, **We want**

Ihr seid das Wild. You are the game. **In the end**

Chor

Willst du uns fangen, Wouldst thou acquire us, **Hugs**
Sei nicht behende, Be not so fast! **Pretty!**
Denn wir verlangen We are desirous **Through trees!**
Doch nur am Ende, Only, at last, **Rocks! Sticks!**
Dich zu umarmen, Clasp thy beauty, **Easy stuff**
Du schönes Bild! Kisses to claim! **Bleh**

Euphorion

Nur durch die Haine! Through groves and through
hedges! **Hard stuff only**
Zu Stock und Steine! O'er cliffs and o'er ledges! **Good
stuff**
Das leicht Errungene, Lightly what fell to me, **Wild!
Crazy!**
Das widert mir, That I detest: **Calm? Forget it**
Nur das Erzwungene What I compel to me **Horns!
Hunting!**
Ergetzt mich schier. Pleases me best. **LOUD**

Helena und Faust

Welch ein Mutwill'! welch ein Rasen! How perverse,
how wild he's growing! **Mess! Noise!**

Keine Mäßigung ist zu hoffen. Vain to hope for moderation; **Zoom - gone**

Klingt es doch wie Hörnerblasen Now it sounds like
bugles blowing, **Ha ha, you suck**

Über Tal und Wälder dröhnend; Over vale and forest
pealing: **Grabby hands**

Welch ein Unfug! welch Geschrei! What disorder!
What a brawl! **Wild one caught**

Chor

(einzeln schnell eintretend) (entering singly, in haste)

Uns ist er vorbeigelaufen; Forth from us with swift-
ness ran he! **Got one!**

Mit Verachtung uns verhöhnd, Spurning us with
scornful feeling, **My prize now**

Schleppt er von dem ganzen Haufen Now he drags
from out the many **Fun time for me**

Nun die Wildeste herbei. Here, the wildest one of all.
Squeeze

Euphorion

(ein junges Mädchen hereintragend) (bearing a young
Maiden)

Schlepp' ich her die derbe Kleine Here I drag the little racer, **Kiss**

Zu erzwungenem Genusse; And by force will I embrace her; **Power! Will!**

Mir zur Wonne, mir zur Lust For my bliss and for my zest **Let go! Inside here**

Drück' ich widerspenstige Brust, Press the fair, resisting breast, = **brave and strong**

Küss' ich widerwärtigen Mund, Kiss the mouth, repellent still, **Same will, buddy**

Tue Kraft und Willen kund. Manifest my strength and will. **Not easy pickings**

Mädchen

Laß mich los! In dieser Hülle Let me go! This frame infoldeth **Trapped? Me?**

Ist auch Geistes Mut und Kraft; Also courage, strength of soul: **Arms aren't everything**

Deinem gleich ist unser Wille Strong as thine, our will upholdeth, **Hold = burn**

Nicht so leicht hinweggerafft. When another would control. **Fool game: reversed**

Glaubst du wohl mich im Gedränge? I am in a strait, thou deemest? **Follow me - up!**

Deinem Arm vertraust du viel! What a force thine arm
would claim! **Or down!**

Halte fest, und ich versenge Hold me, Fool, and ere
thou dreamest **Catch THIS**

Dich, den Toren, mir zum Spiel. I will scorch thee, in
my game. **Rocks rocks rocks**

(Sie flammt auf und lodert in die Höhe.) (She turns to
flame and flashes up in the air.)

Folge mir in leichte Lüfte, To the airy spaces follow,
Trees bushes trees

Folge mir in starre Grüfte, Follow me to caverns hol-
low, **Tight spaces? Why?**

Hasche das verschwundne Ziel! Snatch and hold thy
vanished aim! **Young! Fresh!**

Euphorion

(die letzten Flammen abschüttelnd) (shaking off the
last flames)

Felsengedränge hier Rocks all around me here, **Wind!**
Wooo!

Zwischen dem Waldgebüsch, Over the forests hung!
Waves! Crash!

Was soll die Enge mir, Why should they bound me
here? **Far! Too far!**

Bin ich doch jung und frisch. Still am I fresh and young. **Want: close**

Winde, sie sausen ja, Tempests are waking now, **Goat mode?**

Wellen, sie brausen da; Billows are breaking now: **Scared of splat**

Hör' ich doch beides fern, Both far away I hear; **Higher! More higher!**

Nah wär' ich gern. Fain would be near. **See more!**

(Er springt immer höher felsauf.) (He leaps ever farther up the rocks.)

Helena, Faust und Chor

Wolltest du den Gemen gleichen? Chamois-like, dost thou aspire? **I know!**

Vor dem Falle muß uns graun. Fearful of the fall are we. **Middle!**

Euphorion

Immer höher muß ich steigen, I must clamber ever higher, **Pelops place!**

Immer weiter muß ich schaun. Ever further must I see.
The grander days of the fathers - a sad karaoke of ancient hits

Weiß ich nun, wo ich bin! Now, where I am, I spy! **Your story can't compete**

Mitten der Insel drin, Midst of the Isle am I: **With that gorgeous lie**

Mitten in Pelops' Land, Midst of Pelops' land, **More believable than any truth**

Erde- wie seeverwandt. Kindred in soul, I stand! **They sang of Maia's boy**

Chor

Magst nicht in Berg und Wald Bide thou by grove and hill, **(Hermes, god of thieves and TED talks)**

Friedlich verweilen? Peacefully, rather! **This dainty yet muscular infant**

Suchen wir alsobald We from the vineyards will **Barely squeezed out, still slippery**

Reben in Zeilen, Grapes for thee gather, **They swaddle in purest down**

Reben am Hügelrand, Grapes from the ridges tanned, **Wrap him in designer diapers**

Feigen und Apfelgold. Figs, and the apples gold: **As gossiping nurses do**

Ach in dem holden Land Ah! yet the lovely land, **With their unreasonable notions**

Bleibe du hold! Loving, behold! **But strong and dainty both, the little rogue**

Euphorion

Träumt ihr den Friedenstag? Dream ye the peaceful day? **Already pulls his flexible limbs**

Träume, wer träumen mag. Dream, then, who may! **Out from the binding wraps**

Krieg! ist das Losungswort. War! is the countersign: **Slips free of the purple prison**

Sieg! und so klingt es fort. Victory - word divine! **Leaves the shell behind like yesterday's laundry**

Chor

Wer im Frieden Who peace and unity **Houdini in a onesie**

Wünschet sich Krieg zurück, Scorneth, for war's array, **Like the finished butterfly**

Der ist geschieden With impunity **Slipping from the stiff chrysalis**

Vom Hoffnungsglück. Slays his hope of a better day. **Wings unfolding, nimble**

Euphorion

Welche dies Land gebar They, who this land have led
Boldly fluttering through

Aus Gefahr in Gefahr, Through danger and dread,
Sun-pervaded ether

Frei, unbegrenzten Muts, Free, boundlessly brave,
Zero to flight risk in seconds flat

Verschwendrisch eignen Bluts, Lavish of blood they
gave, **So too he, the sprightliest**

Den nicht zu dämpfenden May they, with glorious
That unto thieves and tricksters

Heiligen Sinn - Untamable might, **And all profit-seekers**

Alle den Kämpfenden Make us victorious, **He'd be their patron demon**

Bring' es Gewinn! Now, in the fight! **He proved immediately**

Chor

Seht hinauf, wie hoch gestiegen! Look aloft! he seeks
the Farness, **Through the slickest artifice**

Und er scheint uns doch nicht klein: Yet to us not
small he seems, **Quick - steals Neptune's trident**

Wie im Harnisch, wie zum Siegen, As for battle, as in
harness, **From Ares, slyly, sword from sheath**

Wie von Erz und Stahl der Schein. He like steel and silver gleams. **Bow and arrows from Apollo**

Euphorion

Keine Wälle, keine Mauern, Walls and towers no more immuring, **Tongs from Hephaestus mid-forge**

Jeder nur sich selbst bewußt; Each in vigor stands confessed! **Would've snagged Zeus's thunderbolts too**

Feste Burg, um auszudauern, Fortress firm and most enduring **But fire's a deal-breaker, even for baby gods**

Ist des Mannes ehrne Brust. Is the soldier's iron breast. **Yet he beat Eros at wrestling**

Wollt ihr unerobert wohnen, Would ye dwell in freemen's houses? **With leg-trips and holds**

Leicht bewaffnet rasch ins Feld; Arm, and forth to combat wild! **And from Cypris, while she petted him**

Frauen werden Amazonen See, as Amazons, your spouses, **Stole the girdle off her tits**

Und ein jedes Kind ein Held. And a hero every child! **History's first pickpocket**

Chor

Heilige Poesie, Hallowed Poesy, **Cute enough to rob
blind even the gods**

Himmelan steige sie! Heavenward mounting, see!
Hear the loveliest sounds!

Glänze, der schönste Stern, Shining, the fairest star,
Free yourselves from fables at last!

Fern und so weiter fern! Farther, and still more far!
Your old gods, that jumbled collection

Und sie erreicht uns doch Yet, from the distance
blown, **Let them go - their day is past**

Immer, man hört sie noch, Hear we the lightest tone,
No one understands you anymore

Vernimmt sie gern. And raptured are. **We demand a
higher toll now**

Euphorion

Nein, nicht ein Kind bin ich erschienen, No, 'tis no
child which thou beholdest **For what works upon
the heart**

In Waffen kommt der Jüngling an; A youth in arms,
with haughty brow! **Must come straight from the
heart**

Gesellt zu Starken, Freien, Kühnen, And with the
Strongest, Freest, Boldest, **These old myths are
elevator music**

Hat er im Geiste schon getan. His soul is pledged, in
manly vow. **Time to feel something real**

Nun fort! I go! **Your gods are discontinued models**

Nun dort For, lo! **Upgrade to the heart's full band-
width**

Eröffnet sich zum Ruhm die Bahn. The path to Glory
opens now. **If you, dreadful creature**

Helena und Faust

Kaum ins Leben eingerufen, Thou thy being scarcely
learnest, **Respond to these tender sounds**

Heitrem Tag gegeben kaum, Scarcely feel'st the Day's
glad beam, **Then we, restored fresh**

Sehnest du von Schwindelstufen When from giddy
steeps thou yearnest **Soften to the joy of tears**

Dich zu schmerzenvollem Raum. For the place of pain
supreme! **Let the sun go missing from heaven**

Sind denn wir Are then we **When the soul has its
own dawn**

Gar nichts dir? Naught to thee? **We find within our
own hearts**

Ist der holde Bund ein Traum? Is the gracious bond a
dream? **What the whole world denied us**

Euphorion

Und hört ihr donnern auf dem Meere? And hear ye thunders on the ocean? **Turns out the good stuff was inside all along**

Dort widerdonnern Tal um Tal, From land the thunder-echoes call? **Like a self-help book but with lyre accompaniment**

In Staub und Wellen, Heer dem Heere, In dust and foam, with fierce commotion, **External sun: optional. Internal sun: mandatory**

In Drang um Drang, zu Schmerz und Qual. The armies shock, the heroes fall! **The real treasure was the feelings we felt along the way**

Und der Tod The command **Hear me sing my children's songs**

Ist Gebot, Is, sword in hand, **And your own joy stirs at once**

Das versteht sich nun einmal. To die: 'tis certain, once for all. **See me dance in measure**

Helena, Faust und Chor

Welch Entsetzen! welches Grauen! What a horror! We shall rue it! **And your parent-hearts leap too**

Ist der Tod denn dir Gebot? Ah, is Death command to thee? **I'm basically a mood ring**

Euphorion

Sollt' ich aus der Ferne schauen? Shall I from the distance view it? **What I feel, you feel - I'm contagious joy**

Nein! ich teile Sorg' und Not. No! the fate be shared by me! **Love, to bless us humanly**

Die Vorigen

Übermut und Gefahr, Danger his arrogance brings
Needs a noble pair

Tödliches Los! Fatally bold! **But for divine rapture**

Euphorion

Doch! - und ein Flügelpaar Yes! and a pair of wings **It must form a precious three**

Faltet sich los! See me unfold! **Two's company, three's a family**

Dorthin! Ich muß! ich muß! Thither! I must! and thus! **The holy math of multiplication**

Gönnt mir den Flug! Grant me the flight! **All is found, then**

(Er wirft sich in die Lüfte, die Gewande tragen ihn einen Augenblick, sein Haupt strahlt, ein Lichtschweif zieht nach.) (He casts himself into the air: the garments bear him a moment, his head is illuminated, and a streak of light follows.)

Chor

Ikarus! Ikarus! Icarus! Icarus! **I am yours and you are mine**

Jammer genug. Sorrowful sight! **And so we stand bound**

(Ein schöner Jüngling stürzt zu der Eltern Füßen, man glaubt in dem Toten eine bekannte Gestalt zu erblicken; doch das Körperliche verschwindet sogleich, die Aureole steigt wie ein Komet zum Himmel auf, Kleid, Mantel und Lyra bleiben liegen.) (A beautiful Youth falls at the feet of the parents. We imagine that in the dead body we perceive a well-known form; yet the corporeal part vanishes at once, and the aureole rises like a comet towards heaven. The garment, mantle, and lyre remain upon the ground.)

Helena und Faust

Der Freude folgt sogleich Joy is followed, when scarce enjoyed, **It could be no other way**

Grimmige Pein. By bitterest moan. **Peak contentment achieved**

Euphorions Stimme

(aus der Tiefe) (from the depths)

Laß mich im düstern Reich, Leave me here in the gloomy Void, **Don't touch the dial**

Mutter, mich nicht allein! Mother, not thus alone!
Many years of joy

Chor

(Trauer gesang) (Dirge)

Nicht allein! - wo du auch weilest, Not alone!
where'er thou bidest; **Will gather on this pair**

Denn wir glauben dich zu kennen; For we know thee
what thou art. **From the shining boy**

Ach! wenn du dem Tag enteilest, Ah! if from the Day
thou hidest, **O how this union moves me!**

Wird kein Herz von dir sich trennen. Still to thee will
cling each heart. **They're basically glowing**

Wüßten wir doch kaum zu klagen, Scarce we venture
to lament thee, **Domestic bliss at maximum wattage**

Neidend singen wir dein Los: Singing, envious of thy
fate; **Now let me hop!**

Dir in klar- und trüben Tagen For in storm and sun
were lent thee **Now let me leap!**

Lied und Mut war schön und groß. Song and courage,
fair and great. **To soar through all the airs**

Ach! zum Erdenglück geboren, Ah! for earthly fortune
fashioned, **Is my desire**

Hoher Ahnen, großer Kraft, Strength was thine, and
proud descent: **It seizes me already**

Leider früh dir selbst verloren, Early erring, o'er-
impassioned, **Gravity is boring**

Jugendblüte weggerafft! Youth, alas! from thee was
rent. **Easy! Easy!**

Scharfer Blick, die Welt zu schauen, For the world
thine eye was rarest, **Don't be reckless!**

Mitsinn jedem Herzensdrang, All the heart to thee was
known: **Lest crash and disaster**

Liebesglut der besten Frauen Thine were loves of
women fairest, **Meet you on the way**

Und ein eigenster Gesang. And a song thy very own.
And destroy us all

Doch du ranntest unaufhaltsam Yet thou rankest un-
controlledly **Dear son, you're not a drone**

Frei ins willenlose Netz, In the net the fancies draw, **I
won't stagnate**

So entzweitest du gewaltsam Thus thyself divorcing
boldly **On the ground any longer!**

Dich mit Sitte, mit Gesetz; As from custom, so from
law; **Let go my hands!**

Doch zuletzt das höchste Sinnen Till the highest
thought expended **Let go my hair!**

Gab dem reinen Mut Gewicht, Set at last thy courage free: **Let go my clothes!**

Wolltest Herrliches gewinnen, Thou wouldst win achievement splendid, **They're mine, not yours, hands off**

Aber es gelang dir nicht. But it was not given to thee. **O think! O think**

Wem gelingt es? - Trübe Frage, Unto whom, then? Question dreary, **To whom you belong!**

Der das Schicksal sich verummt, Destiny will never heed; **How it would hurt us**

Wenn am unglücklichsten Tage When in evil days and weary, **How you'd destroy**

Blutend alles Volk verstummt. Silently the people bleed. **The beautiful thing we won**

Doch erfrischt neue Lieder, But new songs shall still elate them: **Mine, his, and yours - don't smash the set**

Steht nicht länger tief gebeugt: Bow no longer and deplore! **Soon, I fear**

Denn der Boden zeugt sie wieder, For the soil shall generate them, **This bond will unravel**

Wie von je er sie gezeugt. As it hath done heretofore. **The thread's already fraying**

(Völlige Pause. Die Musik hört auf.) (Complete pause.
The music ceases.)

Helena

(zu Faust) (to Faust)

Ein altes Wort bewährt sich leider auch an mir: Also
in me, alas! an old word proves its truth, **Can't have
nice things**

Daß Glück und Schönheit dauerhaft sich nicht vereint.
That Bliss and Beauty ne'er enduringly unite. **Domes-
tic bliss: expires quickly after opening**

Zerrissen ist des Lebens wie der Liebe Band; Torn is
the link of Life, no less than that of Love; **Here comes
the entropy**

Bejammernd beide, sag' ich schmerzlich Lebe-
wohl So, both lamenting, painfully I say: Farewell!
Restrain, restrain

Und werfe mich noch einmal in die Arme dir. And cast
myself again - once only - in thine arms. **For your
parents' sake**

Persephoneia, nimm den Knaben auf und mich!
Receive, Persephone, receive the boy and me! **Your
over-abundant**

(Sie umarmt Faust, das Körperliche verschwindet,
Kleid und Schleier bleiben ihm in den Armen.) (She
embraces Faust: her corporeal part disappears, her
garment and veil remain in his arms.)

Phorkyas

(zu Faust) (to Faust)

Halte fest, was dir von allem übrigblieb. Hold fast
what now alone remains to thee! **Violent drives!**

Das Kleid, laß es nicht los. Da zupfen schon The
garment let not go! Already twitch **Stay rural, stay
quiet**

Dämonen an den Zipfeln, möchten gern The Demons
at its skirts, and they would fain **Decorate the plain
instead**

Zur Unterwelt es reißen. Halte fest! To the Nether Re-
gions drag it! Hold it fast! **Only for your sake**

Die Göttin ist's nicht mehr, die du verlorst, It is no
more the Goddess thou hast lost, **Will I hold back**

Doch göttlich ist's. Bediene dich der hohen, But
godlike is it. For thy use employ **Fine, I'll play your
game**

Unschätzbaren Gunst und hebe dich empor: The
grand and priceless gift, and soar aloft! **For now**

Es trägt dich über alles Gemeine rasch 'Twill bear
thee swift from all things mean and low **Compliance:
temporary mode engaged**

Am Äther hin, so lange du dauern kannst. To ether
high, so long thou canst endure. **Watch me be good
(briefly)**

Wir sehn uns wieder, weit, gar weit von hier. We'll meet again, far, very far from here. **Light I hover round them**

(Helenens Gewande lösen sich in Wolken auf, umgeben Faust, heben ihn in die Höhe und ziehen mit ihm vorüber.) (Helena's garments dissolve into clouds, surround Faust, lift him aloft in the air, and move away with him.)

Phorkyas

(hebt Euphorions Kleid, Mantel und Lyra von der Erde, tritt ins Proszenium, hebt die Exuvien in die Höhe und spricht:) (takes up Euphorion's tunic, mantle, and lyre from the earth, steps forward to the proscenium, holds aloft these remains, and speaks:)

Noch immer glücklich aufgefunden! Good leaving have I still discovered! **This merry race!**

Die Flamme freilich ist verschwunden, The Flame has vanished where it hovered, **Is this the melody?**

Doch ist mir um die Welt nicht leid. Yet for the world no tears I spend. **Is my movement right?**

Hier bleibt genug, Poeten einzuweihen, Enough remains to start the Poets living, **Feedback please, I'm crushing it**

Zu stiften Gild- und Handwerksneid; And envy in their guilds to send; **Dancing with the backup singers**

Und kann ich die Talente nicht verleihen, And, if their talents are beyond my giving, **Yes, that's well done**

Verborg' ich wenigstens das Kleid. At least the costume I can lend. **Lead the beauties through**

(Sie setzt sich im Proszenium an eine Säule nieder.)
(She seats herself upon a column in the proscenium.)

Panthalis

Nun eilig, Mädchen! Sind wir doch den Zauber los,
Now hasten, maidens! we are from the magic freed,
Artistic mazes!

Der alt-thessalischen Vettel wüsten Geisteszwang,
The old Thessalian trollop's mind-compelling spell,
Mommy approves

So des Geklimpers vielverworrner Töne Rausch,
Freed from the jingling drone of much-bewildering
sound, **You've earned your choreography badge**

Das Ohr verwirrend, schlimmer noch den innern Sinn.
The ear confusing, and still more the inner sense.
Gold star in interpretive dance

Hinab zum Hades! Eilte doch die Königin Down, then
to Hades! since beforehand went the Queen, **If only
this were over!**

Mit ernstem Gang hinunter. Ihrer Sohle sei With
solemn step descending. Now, upon the track, **This
jugglery**

Unmittelbar getreuer Mägde Schritt gefügt. Let
straightway follow her the step of faithful maids!
Doesn't please me at all

Wir finden sie am Throne der Unerforschlichen. Her
shall we find beside the unfathomed, gloomy King.
Dad's got a bad feeling

Chor

Königinnen freilich, überall sind sie gern; Queens, of
course, are satisfied everywhere: **Too much whimsy
makes me nervous**

Auch im Hades stehen sie obenan, Even in Hades take
they highest rank, **Something's gonna break**

Stolz zu ihresgleichen gesellt, Proudly associate with
their peers, **When you lift your lovely arms**

Mit Persephonen innigst vertraut; With Persephone
closely allied: **And shake your shining curls**

Aber wir im Hintergrunde We, however, in the back-
ground **When your light foot barely**

Tiefer Asphodelos-Wiesen, Of the asphodel-
besprinkled meadows, **Brushes the earth in
flight**

Langgestreckten Pappeln, With the endless rows of
poplars **Hither and forth again**

Unfruchtbaren Weiden zugesellt, And the fruitless wil-
lows ever mated, **Drawing limb after limb along**

Welchen Zeitvertreib haben wir? What amusement,
then, have we? **You've reached your goal**

Fledermausgleich zu piepsen, Bat-like to squeak and
twitter **Loveliest boy!**

Geflüster, unerfreulich, gespenstig. In whispers
uncheery and ghostly! **All our hearts incline**

Panthalis

Wer keinen Namen sich erwarb noch Edles will, Who
hath not won a name, and seeks not noble works, **To-
ward you**

Gehört den Elementen an; so fahret hin! Belongs but
to the elements: away then, ye! **We're groupies now**

Mit meiner Königin zu sein, verlangt mich heiß; My
own intense desire is with my Queen to be; **Utterly
smitten**

Nicht nur Verdienst, auch Treue wahrt uns die Person.
Service and faith secure the individual life. **Heart
magnets, all pointing Euphorion**

(Ab.) (Exit.)

Alle

Zurückgegeben sind wir dem Tageslicht, Given again
to the daylight are we, **You've won us completely**

Zwar Personen nicht mehr, Persons no more, 'tis true,
You are so many

Das fühlen, das wissen wir, We feel it and know it,
Light-footed does!

Aber zum Hades kehren wir nimmer. But to Hades re-
turn we never! **For a new game**

Ewig lebendige Natur Nature, the Ever-living, **Fresh
from nearby!**

Macht auf uns Geister, Makes to us spirits **I am the
hunter**

Wir auf sie vollgültigen Anspruch. Validest claim, and
we to her also. **You are the wild game**

Ein Teil des Chores

Wir in dieser tausend Äste Flüsterzittern, Säuselschweben
We, in trembling whispers, swaying rustle of a thou-
sand branches **Would you catch us?**

Reizen tändelnd, locken leise wurzelauf des Lebens
Quellen Sweetly rocked, will lightly lure the rills of life,
the rootborn, upwards **Don't be so quick!**

Nach den Zweigen; bald mit Blättern, bald mit Blüten
überschwenglich To the twigs; and, or with foliage or
exuberant gush of blossoms, **For we only want**

Zieren wir die Flatterhaare frei zu luftigem Gedeihn.
Will we freely deck their flying hair for prosperous airy
growth. **In the end**

Fällt die Frucht, sogleich versammeln lebenslustig
Volk und Herden Then, when falls the fruit, will
straightway gather gladdened herds and people, **To
embrace you**

Sich zum Greifen, sich zum Naschen, eilig kommend,
emsig drängend; Swiftly coming, briskly pressing, for
the picking and the tasting: **Beautiful image - we
want to be caught**

Und wie vor den ersten Göttern bückt sich alles um
uns her. All, as if before the early Gods, will then
around us bend. **Through the groves!**

Ein andrer Teil

Wir, an dieser Felsenwände weithinleuchtend glatten
Spiegel We, beside these rocks, upon the far-off shin-
ing, glassy mirror, **Through brush and stone!**

Schmiegen wir, in sanften Wellen uns bewegend,
schmeichelnd an; Coaxingly will bend and fluctuate,
moving with the gentle waters; **What comes easy**

Horchen, lauschen jedem Laute, Vogelsängen,
Röhrigflöten, We to every sound will hearken, song
of bird or reedy piping; **Disgusts me**

Sei es Pans furchtbarer Stimme, Antwort ist sogleich
bereit; Though the dreadful voice of Pan, a ready an-
swer shall we give: **Only what's forced**

Säuselt's, säuseln wir erwidern, donnert's, rollen un-
sre Donner Comes a murmur, we re-murmur, thunder,

we our thunders waken **Truly delights me - I like them reluctant**

In erschütterndem Verdoppeln, dreifach, zehnfach hintennach. In reverberating crashes, doubly, trebly, tenfold flung! **What willfulness! What frenzy!**

Ein dritter Teil

Schwestern! Wir, bewegtern Sinnes, eilen mit den Bächen weiter; Sisters, we, of nimbler fancy, hasten with the brooklets onward; **No moderation to hope for**

Denn es reizen jener Ferne reichgeschmückte Hügelzüge. For allure us yonder distant, richly-mantled mountain ranges. **It sounds like horns blowing**

Immer abwärts, immer tiefer wässern wir, mäandrisch wallend, Ever downwards, ever deeper, in meandering curves we water **Booming over dale and forest**

Jetzt die Wiese, dann die Matten, gleich den Garten um das Haus. First the meadow, then the pasture; then the garden round the house, **What disorder! What screaming!**

Dort bezeichnen's der Zypressen schlanke Wipfel, über Landschaft, Marked by slender peaks of cypress, shooting clearly into ether **He's gone full hunting horn**

Uferzug und Wellenspiegel nach dem Äther steigende.
O'er the landscape and the waters and the fading line
of shore. **He ran right past us**

Ein vierter Teil

Wallt ihr andern, wo's beliebt; wir umzingeln, wir
umrauschen Fare, ye others, at your pleasure; we will
girdle and o'er-rustle **Scorning us with contempt**

Den durchaus bepflanzten Hügel, wo am Stab die
Rebe grünt; The completely-planted hillside, where
the sprouting vines are green. **Now from the whole
pack**

Dort zu aller Tage Stunden läßt die Leidenschaft des
Winzers There at every hour the passion of the vin-
tager is witnessed, **He drags the wildest one**

Uns des liebevollsten Fleißes zweifelhaft Gelingen
sehn. And the loving diligence, that hath so doubtful
a result. **Typical - wants the difficult one**

Bald mit Hacke, bald mit Spaten, bald mit Häufeln,
Schneiden, Binden Now with hoe and now with
shovel, then with hilling, pruning, tying, **Can't resist
the challenge**

Betet er zu allen Göttern, fördersamst zum Sonnen-
gott. Unto all the Gods he prayeth, chiefly to the Sun's
bright god. **I drag here this sturdy little one**

Bacchus kümmert sich, der Weichling, wenig um
den treuen Diener, Small concern hath pampered

Bacchus for his faithful servant's welfare, **For forced enjoyment!**

Ruht in Lauben, lehnt in Höhlen, faselnd mit dem jüngsten Faun. But in arbors rests, and caverns, toying with the youngest Faun. **For my bliss, for my pleasure**

Was zu seiner Träumereien halbem Rausch er je bedurfte, For his semi-drunken visions whatsoever he hath needed, **I press her resisting breast**

Immer bleibt es ihm in Schläuchen, ihm in Krügen und Gefäßen, It is furnished him in wine-skins, and in amphorae and vessels, **Kiss her unwilling mouth**

Rechts und links der kühlen Grüfte, ewige Zeiten aufbewahrt. Right and left in cool recesses, cellared for eternal time. **Make known my strength and will - consent is for the weak**

Haben aber alle Götter, hat nun Helios vor allen, But if now the Gods together, Helios before the others, **Let me go! In this form**

Lüftend, feuchtend, wärmend, glutend, Beeren-Füllhorn aufgehäuft, Have the breeze and dew and warmth and glow the berries filled with juice, **Is spirit's courage and strength too!**

Wo der stille Winzer wirkte, dort auf einmal wird's lebendig, Where the vintager in silence labored, all is life and motion, **My will equals yours**

Und es rauscht in jedem Laube, raschelt um von Stock zu Stock. Every trellis stirs and rustles, and they go

from stake to stake. **Not so easily snatched away**

Körbe knarren, Eimer klappern, Tragebutten ächzen
hin, Baskets creak and buckets rattle, groaning tubs
are borne on back, **You think you've got me cornered?**

Alles nach der großen Kufe zu der Keltreer kräft'gem
Tanz; All towards the vat enormous and the treaders'
lusty dance; **You trust your arm too much**

Und so wird die heilige Fülle reingeborner saftiger
Beeren So is then the sacred bounty of the pure-born,
juicy berries **Hold tight, and I'll singe you**

Frech zertreten, schäumend, sprühend mischt sich's,
widerlich zerquetscht. Rudely trodden; foaming,
spirting, they are mixed and grimly crushed. **Fool,
for my sport!**

Und nun gelbt ins Ohr der Zimbeln mit der Becken
Erzgetöne, Now the ear is pierced with cymbals and
the clash of brazen bosses, **Warning: flammable
content**

Denn es hat sich Dionysos aus Mysterien enthüllt;
For, behold, is Dionysos from his mysteries revealed!
Touch at your own risk

Kommt hervor mit Ziegenfüßlern, schwenkend
Ziegenfüßlerinnen, Forth he comes with goat-foot
Satyrs, whirling goat-foot Satyresses, **I'm hotter
than you can handle**

Und dazwischen schreit unbändig grell Silenus' öhrig

Tier. While amid the rout Silenus' big-eared beast unruly brays. **Literally**

Nichts geschont! Gespaltne Klauen treten alle Sitte nieder, Naught is spared! The cloven hoofs tread down all decent custom; **Follow me to light airs!**

Alle Sinne wirbeln taumlich, gräßlich übertäubt das Ohr. All the senses whirl bewildered, fearfully the ear is stunned. **Follow me to stiff tombs!**

Nach der Schale tappen Trunkne, überfüllt sind Kopf und Wänste, Drunkards fumble for the goblets, overfull are heads and paunches; **Snatch at your vanished prize!**

Sorglich ist noch ein und anderer, doch vermehrt er die Tumulte, Here and there hath one misgivings, yet increases thus the tumult; **Good luck catching smoke**

Denn um neuen Most zu bergen, leert man rasch den alten Schlauch! For, the fresher must to garner, empty they the ancient skin! **She went ghost, then fire, then gone**

(Der Vorhang fällt. Phorkyas im Proszenium richtet sich riesenhaft auf, tritt aber von den Kothurnen herunter, lehnt Maske und Schleier zurück und zeigt sich als Mephistopheles, um, insofern es nötig wäre, im Epilog das Stück zu kommentieren.) (The curtain falls. Phorkyas, in the proscenium, rises to a giant height, steps down from the cothurni, removes her mask and veil, and reveals herself as Mephistopheles,

in order, so far as it may be necessary, to comment upon the piece by way of Epilogue.)

Vierter Akt / Act IV

Hochgebirg / High Mountains

Act IV, Scene 1

Starke, zackige Felsengipfel. Eine Wolke zieht heran, lehnt sich an, senkt sich auf eine vorragende Platte herab. Sie teilt sich.

Strong, serrated rocky peaks. A cloud approaches, pauses, and settles down upon a projecting ledge. It then divides.

Faust (tritt hervor) **Faust** (steps forth)

Der Einsamkeiten tiefste schauend unter meinem Fuss, Down-gazing on the deepest solitudes below,
Gazing down on the deepest solitudes beneath my feet

Betret' ich wohlbedachtig dieser Gipfel Saum, I tread deliberately this summit's lonely edge, **Standing on**

top of the world, looking at nobody-gives-a-shit valley

Entlassend meiner Wolke Tragewerk, die mich sanft
Relinquishing my cloudy car, which hither bore **I deliberately tread this summit's edge**

An klaren Tagen uber Land und Meer gefuhrt. Me
softly through the shining day o'er land and sea, **Each step calculated, body poised on the precipice**

Sie lost sich langsam, nicht zerstiebend, von mir ab.
Unscattered, slowly moved, it separates from me.
Releasing my cloudy vehicle that gently

Nach Osten strebt die Masse mit geballtem Zug,
Off eastward strives the mass with rounded, rolling
march: **Uber, but make it cumulus**

Ihr strebt das Auge staunend in Bewundrung nach.
And strives the eye, amazed, admiring, after it.
Carried me through clear days over land and sea

Sie teilt sich wandelnd, wogenhaft, veranderlich. In
motion it divides, in wave-like, changeful guise; **First-class cloud travel, no turbulence, no crying babies**

Doch will sich's modeln. – Ja! das Auge trugt mich
nicht! – Yet seems to shape a figure. – Yes! mine eyes
not err! – **It separates slowly from me, not scattering**

Auf sonnbeglanzten Pfulen herrlich hingestreckt,
On sun-illuminated pillows beauteously reclined, **The**

cloud peels off like a lover leaving the bed at dawn

Zwar riesenhaft, ein gottergleiches Fraungebild,
Colossal, truly, but a godlike woman-form, **East-ward the mass strives with gathered force**

Ich seh's! Junonen ähnlich, Leda'n, Helenen, I see!
The like of Juno, Leda, Helena, **It's heading to where it belongs - away from me**

Wie majestätisch lieblich mir's im Auge schwankt. Ma-
jestically lovely, floats before my sight! **My amazed eye follows it in admiration**

Ach! schon verrückt sich's! Formlos breit und aufge-
turmt Ah, now 'tis broken! Towering broad and form-
lessly, **Can't stop staring at this atmospheric ass as it walks away**

Ruht es in Osten, fernen Eisgebirgen gleich, It rests
along the east like distant icy hills, **It divides, trans-
forming, wave-like, changeable**

Und spiegelt blendend flucht'ger Tage grossen Sinn.
And shapes the grand significance of fleeting days.
Shapeshifting like my commitment issues

Doch mir umschwebt ein zarter lichter Nebelstreif Yet
still there clings a light and delicate band of mist **Yet
it wants to shape itself - Yes! My eyes don't de-
ceive!**

Noch Brust und Stirn, erheiternd, kuhl und schme-
ichelhaft. Around my breast and brow, caressing,

cheering me. **Wait, is that cloud doing what I think it's doing?**

Nun steigt es leicht und zaudernd hoch und hoher auf,
Now light, delayingly, it soars and higher soars, **On sun-illuminated cushions magnificently stretched out**

Fugt sich zusammen. – Tauscht mich ein entzuckend Bild,
And folds together. – Cheats me an ecstatic form, **Lounging on golden pillows like she owns the sky**

Als jugenderstes, langstentbehrtes höchstes Gut?
As early-youthful, long-foregone and highest bliss? **Colossal, truly, a goddess-like woman's form**

Des tiefsten Herzens frühesten Schätze quellen auf: The first glad treasures of my deepest heart break forth: **She's enormous and divine and I'm losing my mind**

Aurorens Liebe, leichten Schwung bezeichnet's mir,
Aurora's love, so light of pinion, is its type, **I see it! Like Juno, Leda, Helena**

Den schnellempfundenen, ersten, kaum verstandenen Blick,
The swiftly-felt, the first, scarce-comprehended glance, **Three hot immortals morphing into my dead wife**

Der, festgehalten, überglanzte jeden Schatz. Outshining every treasure, when retained and held. **How majestically lovely it floats before my sight!**

Wie Seelenschönheit steigert sich die holde Form,
Like Spiritual Beauty mounts the gracious Form, **The**

ultimate thirst trap, floating in the troposphere

Lost sich nicht auf, erhebt sich in den Ather hin Dis-
solving not, but lifts itself through ether far, **Ah, al-
ready it shifts! Formless, broad, and towering**

Und zieht das Beste meines Innern mit sich fort. And
from my inner being bears the best away. **And there
it goes, dissolving like all beautiful things**

Ein Siebenmeilenstiefel tappt auf. Ein anderer folgt
alsobald. Mephistopheles steigt ab. Die Stiefel schre-
iten eilig weiter.

A Seven-league Boot trips forward: another immedi-
ately follows. Mephistopheles steps out of them. The
Boots stride onward in haste.

Mephistopheles

Das heiss' ich doch endlich vorgeschritten! I call that
genuine forward-striding! **It rests in the east, like
distant icy mountains**

Nun aber sag, was fallst du ein? But what thou
mean'st, I'd have thee own, **Helena's ghost is now
just another glacier**

Steigst ab in solcher Greuel Mitten, That in such hor-
rors art abiding, **And mirrors the grand meaning of
fleeting days**

Im grasslich gahnenden Gestein? Amid these yawn-
ing jags of stone? **Temporary beauty, permanent
longing - that's the whole show**

Ich kenn' es wohl, doch nicht an dieser Stelle, It was
not here I learned to know them well; **Yet a tender,
delicate strip of mist**

Denn eigentlich war das der Grund der Holle. Such
was, indeed, the bottom-ground of Hell. **Something
still clings to me, wispy and intimate**

Faust

Es fehlt dir nie an narrischen Legenden; In foolish
legends thou art never lacking; **Still embraces my
breast and brow, cheering, cool, caressing**

Fangst wieder an, dergleichen auszuspenden. Again
thy store thou set'st about unpacking. **It touches me
where I need touching most**

Mephistopheles (ernsthaft) **Mephistopheles** (seri-
ously)

Als Gott der Herr – ich weiss auch wohl, warum –
When God the Lord – wherefore, I also know – **Now it
rises light and hesitant, higher and higher**

Uns aus der Luft in tiefste Tiefen bannte, Banned us
from air to darkness deep and central, **The mist is
taking its sweet time leaving**

Da, wo zentralisch gluhend, um und um, Where round
and round, in fierce, intensest glow, **It gathers to-
gether - does an enchanting image deceive me**

Ein ewig Feuer flammend sich durchbrannte, Eternal
fires were whirled in Earth's hot entrail, **This can't be
what I think it is**

Wir fanden uns bei allzugrosser Hellung We found
ourselves too much illuminated, **As the earliest-
youthful, long-foregone, highest good?**

In sehr gedrangter, unbequemer Stellung. Yet
crowded and uneasily situated. **It looks like the
first girl I ever loved before I knew what love cost**

Die Teufel fingen sämtlich an zu husten, The Devils
all set up a coughing, sneezing, **The deepest heart's
earliest treasures well up**

Von oben und von unten auszupusten; At every
vent without cessation wheezing: **Here come the
feelings I buried decades ago**

Die Holle schwoll von Schwefelstank und -saure, With
sulphur-stench and acids Hell dilated, **Aurora's love,
light-winged, it signifies to me**

Das gab ein Gas! Das ging ins Ungeheure, And such
enormous gas was thence created, **Gretchen! It's
Gretchen! My first love, my first corpse**

So dass gar bald der Lander flache Kruste, That very
soon Earth's level, far extended, **The swiftly-felt,
first, scarcely-understood glance**

So dick sie war, zerkrachend bersten musste. Thick
as it was, was heaved, and split, and rended! **That
moment when eyes lock and the world stops**

Nun haben wir's an einem andern Zipfel, The thing is
plain, no theories o'ercome it: **Which, held fast, out-
shone every treasure**

Was ehemals Grund war, ist nun Gipfel. What formerly was bottom, now is summit. **Nothing I've gained since equals what I lost**

Sie gründen auch hierauf die rechten Lehren, Hereon they base the law there's no disputing, **Like soul-beauty the gracious form ascends**

Das Unterste ins Oberste zu kehren. To give the undermost the topmost footing: **It rises like innocence does - straight up and away from me**

Denn wir entrannen knechtisch-heisser Gruft For we escaped from fiery dungeons there **Doesn't dissolve, but lifts into the ether**

Ins Übermass der Herrschaft freier Luft. To overplus of lordship of the air; – **It leaves without leaving, haunts without staying**

Ein offenbar Geheimnis, wohl verwahrt, A mystery manifest and well concealed, **And draws the best of my inner being with it**

Und wird nur spat den Volkern offenbart. And to the people only late revealed. **There goes my soul, hitchhiking on a cloud**

Faust

Gebirgesmasse bleibt mir edel-stumm, To me are mountain-masses grandly dumb: **That's what I call making progress!**

Ich frage nicht woher und nicht warum. I ask not, Whence? and ask not, Why they come? **Now THAT's**

how you travel - boots that do the walking for you

Als die Natur sich in sich selbst gegründet, When Nature in herself her being founded, **But now tell me, what are you thinking?**

Da hat sie rein den Erdball abgerundet, Complete and perfect then the globe she rounded, **Okay Faust, what's your damage this time?**

Der Gipfel sich, der Schluchten sich erfreut Glad of the summits and the gorges deep, **You descend into the midst of such horrors**

Und Fels an Fels und Berg an Berg gereiht, Set rock to rock, and mountain steep to steep, **Why are you standing around in this vertical hellscape?**

Die Hugel dann bequem hinabgebildet, The hills with easy outlines downward moulded, **On this hideously yawning rocky terrain?**

Mit sanftem Zug sie in das Tal gemildet. Till gently from their feet the vales unfolded! **These rocks look like they're about to scream**

Da grünt's und wächst's, und um sich zu erfreuen, They green and grow; with joy therein she ranges, **I know this place well, but not this spot**

Bedarf sie nicht der tollen Strudeleien. Requiring no insane, convulsive changes. **I've seen these rocks before, but from underneath**

Mephistopheles

Das spricht Ihr so! Das scheint Euch sonnenklar; Yes,
so you talk! You think it clear as sun; **For actually
this was the floor of Hell**

Doch weiss es anders, der zugegen war. But he knows
otherwise, who saw it done. **Home sweet home, ex-
cept upside down now**

Ich war dabei, als noch da drunten siedend For I was
there, while still below was surging **You never lack
for foolish legends**

Der Abgrund schwoll und stromend Flammen trug;
The red abyss, and streamed the flaming tide, – **Here
we go with your bullshit origin stories**

Als Molochs Hammer, Fels an Felsen schmiedend,
When Moloch's hammer, welding rocks and forging,
You're starting again to dispense such tales

Gebirgestrummer in die Ferne schlug. Scattered the
mountain-ruins far and wide. **Please, Mephisto,
spare me the geological fanfiction**

Noch starrt das Land von fremden Zentnermassen;
O'er all the land the foreign blocks you spy there;
When God the Lord - and I know well why -

Wer gibt Erklärung solcher Schleudermacht? Who
solves the force that hurled them to their place?
**When the Big Man Upstairs - trust me, I know the
reason -**

Der Philosoph, er weiss es nicht zu fassen, The lore of
learned men is all awry there; **Banished us from air
into the deepest depths**

Da liegt der Fels, man muss ihn liegen lassen, There
lies the rock, and we must let it lie there; **Kicked us
out of the sky into Earth's bowels**

Zuschanden haben wir uns schon gedacht. – We've
thought already – to our own disgrace. **Where, glow-
ing centrally, round and round**

Das treu-gemeine Volk allein begreift Only the
common, faithful people know, **Down where
everything burns from the inside out**

Und lasst sich im Begriff nicht storen; And nothing
shakes them in their firm believing; **An eternal fire
flaming, burning through itself**

Ihm ist die Weisheit langst gereift: Their wisdom
ripened long ago, – **A furnace with no off switch,
no exit signs**

Ein Wunder ist's, der Satan kommt zu Ehren. A marvel
'tis, of Satan's own achieving. **We found ourselves,
with too much illumination**

Mein Wandrer hinkt an seiner Glaubenskrucke On
crutch of faith my traveller climbs the ridges, **Way
too much light for creatures of darkness**

Zum Teufelsstein, zur Teufelsbrücke. Past Devil's
Rocks and over Devil's Bridges. **In a very cramped,
uncomfortable position**

Faust

Es ist doch auch bemerkenswert zu achten, Well, –
'tis remarkable and new **Imagine a mosh pit, but**

everyone's on fire

Zu sehn, wie Teufel die Natur betrachten. To note how Devils Nature view. **The devils all began to cough**

Mephistopheles

Was geht mich's an! Natur sei, wie sie sei! What's all to me? Her shape let Nature wear! **Devils started hacking like chain-smokers**

's ist Ehrenpunkt: der Teufel war dabei! The point of honour is, the Devil was there! **Puffing from above and below**

Wir sind die Leute, Grosses zu erreichen; We are the folk to compass grand designs: **Every orifice ejecting volcanic fumes**

Tumult, Gewalt und Unsinn! sieh das Zeichen! – Tumult, and Force, and Nonsense! See the signs! – **Hell swelled with sulfur stench and acid**

Doch, dass ich endlich ganz verstandlich spreche, Yet now, with sober reason to address thee, **The whole place smelled like a billion rotten eggs**

Gefiel dir nichts an unsrer Oberflache? Did nothing on our outside shell impress thee? **That produced gas! It went to monstrous proportions**

Du ubersahst, in ungemessnen Weiten, From this exceeding height thou saw'st unfurled **The gas buildup was un-fucking-believable**

Die Reiche der Welt und ihre Herrlichkeiten. The glory of the Kingdoms of the World. **So that soon the flat**

crust of the lands

Doch, ungenugsam, wie du bist, Yet, as thou art, unsatisfied, **Earth's crust couldn't take the pressure**

Empfandest du wohl kein Gelust? Didst feel no lust of power and pride? **Thick as it was, had to burst, cracking**

Faust

Und doch! ein Grosses zog mich an. I did! A mighty plan my fancy won: **The whole planet basically sharted itself inside-out**

Errate! – Canst guess it? **Now we have it by a different corner**

Mephistopheles

Das ist bald getan. That is quickly done. **Everything got rearranged**

Ich suchte mir so eine Hauptstadt aus, I'd take some town, – a capital, perchance, – **What was once bottom is now summit**

Im Kerne Burger-Nahrungs-Graus, Its core, the people's need of sustenance; **Hell's floor is now this mountain peak - you're standing on Satan's basement ceiling**

Krummunge Gasschen, spitze Giebeln, With crooked alleys, pointed gables, **They also base the right teachings on this**

Beschränkten Markt, Kohl, Ruben, Zwiebeln; Beets,

cabbage, onions, on the market-tables; **And that's where the phrase comes from**

Fleischbanke, wo die Schmeissen hausen, With meat-stands, where the blue flies muster, **To turn the lowest into the highest**

Die fetten Braten anzuschmausen; And round fat joints like gourmands cluster: **"Turn everything upside down" - that's literally our origin story**

Da findest du zu jeder Zeit There shalt thou find, undoubtedly, **For we escaped from slavish-hot crypts**

Gewiss Gestank und Tätigkeit. Stench, always, and activity. **We busted out of the fiery prison**

Dann weite Plätze, breite Strassen, Then ample squares, and streets whose measure **Into the excess of lordship of free air**

Vornehmen Schein sich anzumassen; Assumes an air of lordly leisure; **Traded eternal flames for unlimited sky - not a bad deal**

Und endlich, wo kein Tor beschränkt, And last, without a gate to bar, **An open secret, well-guarded**

Vorstadte grenzenlos verlangt. The boundless suburbs stretching far. **Everybody knows but nobody believes**

Da freut' ich mich an Rollekutschen, 'Twere joy to see the coaches go, **And only late revealed to the people**

Am larmigen Hin- und Widerrutschen, The noisy
crowding to and fro, **Humanity will figure it out
eventually, the slow learners**

Am ewigen Hin- und Widerlaufen The endless run-
ning, hither, thither, **Mountain masses remain
nobly mute to me**

Zerstreuter Ameis-Wimmelhaufen. Of scattered ants
that stream together: **Mountains don't talk and I
like it that way**

Und wenn ich fuhre, wenn ich ritte, And whether walk-
ing, driving, riding, **I don't ask whence or why**

Erschien' ich immer ihre Mitte, Over their central
point abiding, **I don't give a damn about geologi-
cal backstory**

Von Hunderttausenden verehrt. Honoured by thou-
sands, should be I. **When Nature founded herself
within herself**

Faust

Das kann mich nicht zufriedenstellen. Therewith I
would not be contented! **When Nature was doing
her thing, auto-creating**

Man freut sich, dass das Volk sich mehrt, One likes
to see the people multiply, **She purely rounded the
Earth-ball**

Nach seiner Art behaglich nährt, And in their wise
with comfort fed, – **She made a nice sphere, no
Hell required**

Sogar sich bildet, sich belehrt – Developed even,
taught, well-bred, **Delighting in peaks, delighting
in gorges**

Und man erzieht sich nur Rebellen. Yet one has only,
when all's said, the sum of rebels thus augmented.
She was pleased with her mountains and valleys

Mephistopheles

Dann baut' ich, grandios, mir selbst bewusst, Then I
should build, with conscious power and grace, **Lining
rock to rock and mountain to mountain**

Am lustigen Ort ein Schloss zur Lust. A pleasure-castle
in a pleasant place; **She stacked stones like a child
with blocks**

Wald, Hugel, Flächen, Wiesen, Feld Where hill and
forest, level, meadow, field, **Then shaped the hills
comfortably downward**

Zum Garten prachtig umbestellt. Grandly trans-
formed, should park and garden yield. **The land-
scape flows down easy and natural**

Vor grünen Wänden Sammetmatten, Before green
walls of foliage velvet meadows, **With gentle slopes
softening into the valley**

Schnurwege, kunstgerechte Schatten, With ordered
paths and artful-falling shadows; **Everything curves
and connects, no explosions needed**

Kaskadensturz, durch Fels zu Fels gepaart, Plunge
of cascades o'er rocks with skill combined, **There it**

greens and grows, and to enjoy itself

Und Wasserstrahlen aller Art; And fountain-jets of every form and kind. **Plants grow because they want to, not because Hell farted**

Ehrwürdig steigt es dort, doch an den Seiten There grandly shooting upwards from the middle, **It doesn't need your crazy whirlpools**

Da zischt's und pisst's in tausend Kleinigkeiten. While round the sides a thousand spirt and piddle. **Nature doesn't need your demonic flatulence to be beautiful**

Dann aber liess ich allerschönsten Frauen Then for the fairest women, fresh and rosy, **That's what you say! Seems clear as sunlight to you**

Vertraut-bequeme Hauslein bauen; I'd build a lodge, convenient and cosy; **Sure, easy for you to say**

Verbrachte da grenzenlose Zeit And so the bright and boundless time I should **But he knows differently who was present**

In allerliebste-geselliger Einsamkeit. Pass in the loveliest social solitude. **I was there, buddy. I SAW it happen**

Ich sage Fraun; denn ein für allemal Women, I say; and, once for all, believe **I was there when down below, still seething**

Denk' ich die Schönen im Plural. That in the plural I the sex conceive! **I was in the front row when the**

abyss was boiling

Faust

Schlecht und modern! Sardanapal! Sardanapalus!
Modern, – poor! **The abyss swelled and carried
streaming flames**

Mephistopheles

Errat man wohl, wornach du strebtest? Then might
one guess whereunto thou hast striven? **Fire flowing
like rivers, everything churning**

Es war gewiss erhaben kuhn. Boldly-sublime it was,
I'm sure. **When Moloch's hammer, forging rock to
rock**

Der du dem Mond um so viel naher schwebtest, Since
nearer to the moon thy flight was driven, **Moloch's
massive hammer pounding boulders like dough**

Dich zog wohl deine Sucht dahin? Would now thy ma-
nia that realm secure? **Hurled mountain fragments
into the distance**

Faust

Mit nichten! dieser Erdenkreis Not so! This sphere of
earthly soil **Chucking continents like a drunk giant
throws furniture**

Gewahrt noch Raum zu grossen Taten. Still gives us
room for lofty doing. **The land still bristles with
foreign centner-masses**

Erstaunenswürdiges soll geraten, Astounding plans

e'en now are brewing: **Erratic boulders everywhere - explain THOSE, science boy**

Ich fühle Kraft zu kühnem Fleiss. I feel new strength for bolder toil. **Who explains such hurling power?**

Mephistopheles

Und also willst du Ruhm verdienen? So, thou wilt Glory earn? 'Tis plain to see **What force chucks a boulder a thousand miles?**

Man merkt's, du kommst von Heroinen. That heroines have been thy company. **The philosopher can't grasp it**

Faust

Herrschaft gewinn ich, Eigentum! Power and Estate to win, inspires my thought! **Scientists scratch their heads**

Die Tat ist alles, nichts der Ruhm. The Deed is everything, the Glory naught. **There lies the rock, we must let it lie**

Mephistopheles

Doch werden sich Poeten finden, Yet Poets shall proclaim the matter, **The rock just sits there, judging your theories**

Der Nachwelt deinen Glanz zu kunden, Thy fame to future ages flatter, **We've already thought ourselves to shame**

Durch Torheit Torheit zu entzünden. By folly further
folly scatter! **Overthinking gets you nowhere**

Faust

Von allem ist dir nichts gewahrt. All that is far beyond
thy reach. **Only the faithful common folk under-
stand**

Was weisst du, was der Mensch begehrt? How canst
thou know what men beseech? **Regular people
with their simple faith get it**

Dein widrig Wesen, bitter, scharf, Thy cross-grained
self, in malice banned, **And don't let themselves be
disturbed in their understanding**

Was weiss es, was der Mensch bedarf? How can it
know what men demand? **They don't need peer
review, just belief**

Mephistopheles

Geschehe denn nach deinem Willen! According to thy
will so let it be! **Their wisdom has long been ripe**

Vertraue mir den Umfang deiner Grillen. Confide the
compass of thy whims to me! **Common sense fig-
ured it out ages ago**

Faust

Mein Auge war aufs hohe Meer gezogen; Mine eye was
drawn to view the open Ocean: **It's a miracle - Satan
gets the credit**

Es schwoll empor, sich in sich selbst zu turmen, It

swelled aloft, self-heaved and over-vaulting, **“The Devil did it” - explains everything, zero footnotes required**

Dann liess es nach und schüttete die Wogen, And then withdrew, and shook its waves in motion, **My wanderer limps on his faith-crutch**

Des flachen Ufers Breite zu besturmen. Again the breadth of level strand assaulting. **Pilgrims hobble along on their faith-crutches**

Und das verdross mich; wie der Übermut Then I was vexed, since arrogance can spite **To Devil’s Rock, to Devil’s Bridge**

Den freien Geist, der alle Rechte schätzt, The spirit free, which values every right, **Devil’s this, Devil’s that - I’m everywhere in their geography**

Durch leidenschaftlich aufgeregtes Blut And through excited passion of the blood **It’s actually remarkable to note**

Ins Missbehagen des Gefühls versetzt. Discomfort it, as did the haughty flood. **You know what’s actually interesting**

Ich hielt’s für Zufall, scharfte meinen Blick: I thought it chance, my vision did I strain; **How devils view nature**

Die Woge stand und rollte dann zurück, The billow paused, then thundered back again, **Seeing the world through demon-tinted glasses**

Entfernte sich vom stolz erreichten Ziel; Retiring from the goal so proudly won: **What do I care! Let Nature be what she will!**

Die Stunde kommt, sie wiederholt das Spiel. The hour returns, the sports once more begun. **Whatever! Nature, schmature!**

Mephistopheles (ad spectatores)

Da ist für mich nichts Neues zu erfahren, 'Tis nothing new whatever that one hears; **It's a point of honor: the Devil was there!**

Das kenn' ich schon seit hunderttausend Jahren. I've known it many a hundred thousand years. **The important thing is: I WAS THERE**

Faust (fortfahrend leidenschaftlich) **Faust** (continuing impassionedly)

Sie schleicht heran, an abertausend Enden, The Sea sweeps on, in thousand quarters flowing, **We are the ones to accomplish great things**

Unfruchtbar selbst, Unfruchtbarkeit zu spenden; Itself unfruitful, barrenness bestowing; **We're the big achievers**

Nun schwillt's und wächst und rollt und überzieht It breaks and swells, and rolls, and overwhelms **Tumult, violence, and nonsense! See the signs!**

Der wusten Strecke widerlich Gebiet. The desert stretch of desolated realms. **Chaos! Destruction! Absurdity! That's our brand**

Da herrschet Well' auf Welle kraftbegeistert, There
endless waves hold sway, in strength erected **But, to
finally speak quite understandably**

Zieht sich zuruck, und es ist nichts geleistet, And then
withdrawn, – and nothing is effected. **Okay, let me
get practical**

Was zur Verzweiflung mich beangstigen konnte! If
aught could drive me to despair, 'twere, truly **Did
nothing on our surface please you?**

Zwecklose Kraft unbandiger Elemente! The aimless
force of elements unruly. **Didn't you see anything
you liked up there?**

Da wagt mein Geist, sich selbst zu uberfliegen;
Then dared my mind its dreams to over-soar: **You
surveyed, in immeasurable expanses**

Hier mocht' ich kampfen, dies mocht' ich besiegen.
Here would I fight, – subdue this fierce uproar! **You
had the whole panoramic view**

Und es ist moglich! – Flutend wie sie sei, And possible
'tis! – Howe'er the tides may fill, **The kingdoms of
the world and their glories**

An jedem Hugel schmiegt sie sich vorbei; They gently
fawn around the steadfast hill; **All the world's real
estate, spread out like a buffet**

Sie mag sich noch so ubermuting regen, A moderate
height resists and drives asunder, **Yet, insatiable as
you are**

Geringe Hohe ragt ihr stolz entgegen, A moderate depth allures and leads them on. **But you're never satisfied**

Geringe Tiefe zieht sie mächtig an. So, swiftly, plans within my mind were drawn: **Did you feel no desire?**

Da fasst' ich schnell im Geiste Plan auf Plan: Let that high joy be mine for evermore, **Nothing made your little black heart flutter?**

Erlange dir das kostliche Geniessen, To shut the lordly Ocean from the shore, **And yet! Something great attracted me**

Das herrische Meer vom Ufer auszuschliessen, The watery waste to limit and to bar, **Actually, yeah - something did catch my eye**

Der feuchten Breite Grenzen zu verengen And push it back upon itself afar! **Guess!**

Und, weit hinein, sie in sich selbst zu drängen. From step to step I settled how to fight it: **Guess what it was**

Von Schritt zu Schritt wusst' ich mir's zu erörtern; Such is my wish: dare thou to expedite it! **That's easily done**

Das ist mein Wunsch, den wage zu befördern! Such is my wish: dare thou to expedite it! **Oh, this'll be easy**

Trommeln und kriegerische Musik im Rücken der Zuschauer, aus der Ferne, von der rechten Seite her.

Drums and martial music in the rear of the spectators, from the distance, on the right hand.

Mephistopheles

Wie leicht ist das! Horst du die Trommeln fern? How easy, that! – Hear'st thou the drums afar? **I'd choose myself a capital city**

Faust

Schon wieder Krieg! der Kluge hort's nicht gern. Who's wise likes not to hear of coming war. **Let me guess - a big fancy city**

Mephistopheles

Krieg oder Frieden. Klug ist das Bemühen, In War or Peace, 'tis wise to use the chance, **At its core, citizens' nourishment-horror**

Zu seinem Vorteil etwas auszuziehen. And draw some profit from each circumstance. **The stinking heart of urban chaos**

Man passt, man merkt auf jedes günstige Nu. One watches, marks the moment, and is bold: **Crooked little streets, pointed gables**

Gelegenheit ist da, nun, Fauste, greife zu! Here's opportunity! – now, Faust, take hold! **Narrow alleys, ugly rooftops**

Faust

Mit solchem Ratselkram verschone mich! Spare me the squandering of thy riddle-pelf! **Limited market,**

cabbage, turnips, onions

Und kurz und gut, was soll's? Erkläre dich. What means it, once for all? Explain thyself! **A sad little market selling vegetables and despair**

Mephistopheles

Auf meinem Zuge blieb mir nicht verborgen: Upon my way, to me it was discovered **Meat stalls where the flies swarm**

Der gute Kaiser schwebt in grossen Sorgen. That mighty troubles o'er the Emperor hovered: **Butcher shops buzzing with bluebottles**

Du kennst ihn ja. Als wir ihn unterhielten, Thou knowest him. The while we twain, beside him, **To feast on the fat roasts**

Ihm falschen Reichtum in die Hande spielten, With wealth illusive bounteously supplied him, **Flies making love to pork chops**

Da war die ganze Welt ihm feil. Then all the world was to be had for pay; **There you find at any time**

Denn jung ward ihm der Thron zuteil, For as a youth he held imperial sway, **And there, guaranteed**

Und ihm beliebt' es, falsch zu schliessen, And he was pleased to try it, whether **Certainly stink and activity**

Es könne wohl zusammengehn Both interests would not smoothly pair, **Stench and hustle - the two constants of city life**

Und sei recht wünschenswert und schon: Since
'twere desirable and fair **Then wide squares, broad
streets**

Regieren und zugleich geniessen. To govern and
enjoy, together. **Then the fancy district with its
boulevards**

Faust

Ein grosser Irrtum. Wer befehlen soll, A mighty error!
He who would command **To assume an air of nobil-
ity**

Muss im Befehlen Seligkeit empfinden. Must in com-
manding find his highest blessing: **Where people
pretend to be important**

Ihm ist die Brust von hohem Willen voll, Then, let his
breast with force of will expand, **And finally, where
no gate limits**

Doch was er will, es darf's kein Mensch ergründen.
But what he wills, be past another's guessing! **And
beyond the walls**

Was er den Treusten in das Ohr geraunt, What to his
faithful he hath whispered, that **Suburbs stretch
boundlessly**

Es ist getan, und alle Welt erstaunt. Is turned to act,
and men amaze thereat: **Endless sprawl of strip
malls and tract housing**

So wird er stets der Allerhochste sein, Thus will he
ever be the highest-placed **There I'd enjoy the**

rolling coaches

Der Wurdigste –; Geniessen macht gemein. And worthiest! – Enjoyment makes debased. **I'd watch the fancy carriages**

Mephistopheles

So ist er nicht. Er selbst genoss, und wie! Such is he not! He did enjoy, even he! **The noisy sliding back and forth**

Indes zerfiel das Reich in Anarchie, Meanwhile the realm was torn by anarchy, **Traffic jams are eternal**

Wo gross und klein sich kreuz und quer befehdeten
Where great and small were warring with each other,
The eternal running back and forth

Und Bruder sich vertrieben, toteten, And brother drove and slaughtered brother, **People scurrying like ants**

Burg gegen Burg, Stadt gegen Stadt, Castle to castle, town 'gainst town arrayed, **Of scattered ant-swarm heaps**

Zunft gegen Adel Fehde hat, The nobles and the guilds of trade, **Everyone going nowhere, urgently**

Der Bischof mit Kapitel und Gemeinde; The Bishop, with his chapter and congregation, – **And whether I drove or rode**

Was sich nur ansah, waren Feinde. All meeting eyes but looked retaliation. **Whether I'm in a limo or on**

horseback

In Kirchen Mord und Totschlag, vor den Toren In
churches death and murder; past the gates, **I'd
always appear at their center**

Ist jeder Kauf- und Wandersmann verloren. The mer-
chants travelled under evil fates; **I'd be the center of
attention**

Und allen wuchs die Kuhnheit nicht gering; And all
grew bolder, since no rule was drawn **Revered by
hundreds of thousands**

Denn leben hiess sich wehren. – Nun, das ging. For
life, but: Self-defence! – So things went on. **Wor-
shipped by the masses - what a power trip**

Faust

Es ging – es hinkte, fiel, stand wieder auf, They went,
they limped, they fell, arose again, **That cannot sat-
isfy me**

Dann überschlug sich's, rollte plump zuhauf. Then
tumbled headlong, and in heaps remain. **Hard pass**

Mephistopheles

Und solchen Zustand durfte niemand schelten, Such
a condition no man dared abuse. **One's glad that
the people multiply**

Ein jeder konnte, jeder wollte gelten. Each would be
something, each set forth his dues; **Sure, it's nice
that the population grows**

Der Kleinste selbst, er galt für voll. The smallest even as full-measured passed: **Feed themselves comfortably in their way**

Doch war's zuletzt den Besten allzutoll. Yet for the best it grew too bad at last. **They eat well enough**

Die Tuchtigen, sie standen auf mit Kraft The capable, they then arose with energy, **Even educate and instruct themselves**

Und sagten: Herr ist, der uns Ruhe schafft. And said: "Who gives us Peace, shall ruler be. **They even learn stuff and improve themselves**

Der Kaiser kann's nicht, will's nicht – lässt uns wählen, The Emperor can and will not! – Be elected **And one only breeds rebels**

Den neuen Kaiser neu das Reich beseelen, An Emperor new, anew the realm directed, **But all you end up with is a bunch of people who disagree with you**

Indem er jeden sicher stellt, Each one secure and sheltered stand, **Then I'd build, grandly, self-aware**

In einer frisch geschaffnen Welt And in a fresh-constructed land **Okay, Plan B - I'd build myself a palace**

Fried' und Gerechtigkeit vermahlen. Justice and Peace be mated and perfected! " **In a pleasant place, a pleasure-castle**

Faust

Das klingt sehr pfaffisch. – Priest-like, that sounds. **A party mansion in the nicest spot I could find**

Mephistopheles

Pfaffen waren's auch, Priests were they, to be sure; **Forest, hills, plains, meadows, fields**

Sie sicherten den wohlgenährten Bauch. They meant their well-fed bellies to secure; **All that nature stuff**

Sie waren mehr als andere beteiligt. They, more than all, therein were implicated. **Magnificently transformed into a garden**

Der Aufruhr schwoll, der Aufruhr ward geheiligt; The riot rose, the riot was consecrated. **All landscaped to perfection**

Und unser Kaiser, den wir froh gemacht, And now our Emperor, whom we gave delight, **Before green walls, velvet meadows**

Zieht sich hieher, vielleicht zur letzten Schlacht. Comes hitherward, perchance for one last fight. **Emerald hedges, grass like carpet**

Faust

Er jammert mich; er war so gut und offen. I pity him; he was so frank, forgiving. **Straight paths, artfully-placed shadows**

Mephistopheles

Komm, sehn wir zu! der Lebende soll hoffen. Come,

we'll look on! There's hope while one is living! **Everything geometric and Instagram-ready**

Befrein wir ihn aus diesem engen Tale! Let us release him from this narrow valley; **Cascading waterfalls, paired rock to rock**

Einmal gerettet, ist's fur tausend Male. He's saved a thousand times, if once he rally. **Designer waterfalls**

Wer weiss, wie noch die Wurfel fallen? Who knows how yet the dice may fall? **And water jets of every kind**

Und hat er Gluck, so hat er auch Vasallen. If he has fortune, vassals come withal. **Fountains everywhere**

Sie steigen uber das Mittelgebirg heruber und beschauen die Anordnung des Heeres im Tal. Trommeln und Kriegsmusik schallt von unten auf.

They cross over the middle range of mountains, and view the arrangement of the army in the valley. Drums and military music resound from below.

Mephistopheles

Die Stellung, seh' ich, gut ist eingenommen, A good position is, I see, secured them: **Majestically rising there, yet at the sides**

Wir treten zu, dann ist der Sieg vollkommen. We'll join, then victory will be assured them. **The main fountain shoots up impressively**

Faust

Was kann da zu erwarten sein? What further, I should like to know? **It hisses and pisses in a thousand little ways**

Trug! Zauberblendwerk! Hohler Schein. Cheat! Blind delusion! Hollow show! **While the little ones spurt and dribble in all directions**

Mephistopheles

Kriegslist, um Schlachten zu gewinnen! No, – stratagems, for battle-winning! **Then I'd have the most beautiful women**

Befestige dich bei grossen Sinnen, Be steadfast for the grand beginning, **And for the ladies**

Indem du deinen Zweck bedenkst. And think upon thy lofty aim! **Cozy, intimate little houses built**

Erhalten wir dem Kaiser Thron und Lande, If we secure the realm its rightful claimant, **Little love-shacks, private and convenient**

So kniest du nieder und empfangst Then shalt thou boldly kneel, and claim **Pass boundless time there**

Die Lehn von grenzenlosem Strande. The boundless strand in feoff, as payment. **Spend forever there**

Faust

Schon manches hast du durchgemacht, In many arts didst thou excel: **In the loveliest sociable solitude**

Nun, so gewinn auch eine Schlacht! Come, win a battle now, as well! **Alone, but with excellent company**

Mephistopheles

Nein, du gewinnst sie! Diesesmal No, thou shalt win it! Here, in brief, **I say women - for once and for all**

Bist du der Obergeneral. Shalt thou be General-in-chief. **I said women, plural**

Faust

Das ware mir die rechte Hohe, A high distinction thou wouldst lend, – **I think of beauties in the plural**

Da zu befehlen, wo ich nichts verstehe! There to command, where naught I comprehend! **Why have one when you can have many?**

Mephistopheles

Lass du den Generalstab sorgen, Leave to the Staff the work and blame, **Bad and modern! Sardanapalus!**

Und der Feldmarschall ist geborgen. Then the Field-Marshal's sure of fame! **Tacky! Basic! Like some ancient playboy!**

Kriegsunrat hab' ich langst verspurt, Of War-Uncouncils I have had enough, **Can one guess what you were striving for?**

Den Kriegsrat gleich voraus formiert And my War-Council fashion of the stuff **Alright, what do YOU want then?**

Aus Urgebirgs Urmenschenkraft; Of primal mountains' primal human might: **It was certainly sublimely bold**

Wohl dem, der sie zusammenrafft. He's blest, for whom its elements unite! **Something lofty and noble, I'm sure**

Faust

Was seh' ich dort, was Waffen tragt? What do I see, with arms, in yonder place? **You who floated so much closer to the moon**

Hast du das Bergvolk aufgeregt? Hast thou aroused the mountain-race? **You just came back from cloud-nine**

Mephistopheles

Nein! aber, gleich Herrn Peter Squenz, No! But I've brought, like Peter Squence, **Did your mania draw you there?**

Vom ganzen Prass die Quintessenz. From all the raff the quintessence. **Want a piece of lunar real estate?**

Die drei Gewaltigen treten auf.

The Three Mighty Men appear.

Mephistopheles

Da kommen meine Bursche ja! My fellows draw already near! **Not at all! This earthly sphere**

Du siehst, von sehr verschiednen Jahren, Thou seest,
of very different ages, **No! This planet still has
room**

Verschiednem Kleid und Rustung sind sie da; Of differ-
ent garb and armour they appear: **Still offers space
for great deeds**

Du wirst nicht schlecht mit ihnen fahren. They will not
serve thee ill when battle rages. **There's still work to
be done right here**

(Ad spectatores)

Es liebt sich jetzt ein jedes Kind Now every child de-
lights to see **Astonishing things shall succeed**

Den Harnisch und den Ritterkragen; The harness and
the helm of knightly action; **I've got plans that'll
blow minds**

Und, allegorisch wie die Lumpe sind, And allegoric, as
the blackguards be, **I feel power for bold industry**

Sie werden nur um desto mehr behagen. They'll only
all the more give satisfaction. **I feel the strength for
serious work**

Raufebold (jung, leicht bewaffnet, bunt gekleidet)
Bully (young, lightly armed, clad in motley)

Wenn einer mir ins Auge sieht, When one shall meet
me, face to face, **And so you want to earn fame?**

Werd' ich ihm mit der Faust gleich in die Fresse fahren,
My fisticuffs shall on his chops be showered; **So you
want to be famous?**

Und eine Memme, wenn sie flieht, And midway in
his headlong race, **One can tell you've come from
heroines**

Fass' ich bei ihren letzten Haaren. Fast by his flying
hair I'll catch the coward. **Spending time with He-
len really went to your head**

Habebald (mannhaft, wohlbewaffnet, reich geklei-
det) **Havequick** (manly, well-armed, richly clad)

So leere Handel, das sind Possen, Such empty brawls
are only folly! **Dominion I'll win, property!**

Damit verdirbt man seinen Tag; They spoil whate'er
occasion brings. **I want power! Real estate!**

Im Nehmen sei nur unverdrossen, In taking, be
unwearied wholly, **The deed is everything, fame
nothing**

Nach allem andern frag' hernach. And after, look to
other things! **Actions matter, reputation doesn't**

Haltefest (bejahrt, stark bewaffnet, ohne Gewand)
Holdfast (well in years, strongly-armed, without
raiment)

Damit ist auch nicht viel gewonnen! Yet little gain
thereafter lingers! **Yet poets will be found**

Bald ist ein grosses Gut zerronnen, Soon slips great
wealth between your fingers, **Oh, there'll be poets**

Es rauscht im Lebensstrom hinab. Borne by the tides
of Life as down they run. **To proclaim your glory to
posterity**

Zwar nehmen ist recht gut, doch besser ist's, behalten;
'Tis well to take, indeed, but better still to hold;
To spin your story for the ages

Lass du den grauen Kerl nur walten, Be by the gray old
churl controlled, **Through folly to kindle folly**

Und niemand nimmt dir etwas ab. And thou shalt
plundered be by none. **Using bullshit to inspire
more bullshit**

Sie steigen zusammen tiefer.

They descend the mountain together.

Auf dem Vorgebirg / On the Headland

Act IV, Scene 2

Trommeln und kriegerische Musik von unten. Des Kaisers Zelt wird aufgeschlagen.

Drums and military music from below. The Emperor's tent is pitched.

Kaiser. Obergeneral. Trabanten.

Emperor. General-in-Chief. Life-Guardsmen.

Obergeneral General-in-Chief

Noch immer scheint der Vorsatz wohlerwogen, It still appears the prudentest of courses **It still appears the wisest course we've chosen**

Dass wir in dies gelegene Tal That here, in this appropriate vale, **That here in this well-situated dale**

Das ganze Heer gedrängt zurückgezogen; We have withdrawn and strongly massed our forces; **We've bunched our forces tight, compressed and frozen**

Ich hoffe fest, uns glückt die Wahl. I firmly trust we shall not fail. **I'm betting hard our gamble doesn't fail**

Kaiser Emperor

Wie es nun geht, es muss sich zeigen; What comes of it will soon be brought to light; **However it goes, we'll soon find out**

Doch mich verdriesst die halbe Flucht, das Weichen. Yet I dislike this yielding, semi-flight. **But this half-assed retreat sticks in my craw**

Obergeneral General-in-Chief

Schau hier, mein Furst, auf unsre rechte Flanke! Look down, my Prince, where our right flank is planted! **Look here, my Prince, at our right flank's position!**

Solch ein Terrain wünscht sich der Kriegsgedanke: The field which War desires hath here been granted: **This is the terrain that makes War salivate with ambition**

Nicht steil die Hugel, doch nicht allzu ganglich, Not steep the hills, yet access not preparing, **Not too steep, but not an easy stroll**

Den Unsern vorteilhaft, dem Feind verfanglich; To us advantage, to the foe insnaring; **Good for us, for en-**

emies a death-trap hole

Wir, halb versteckt, auf wellenformigem Plan; Their
cavalry will hardly dare surround **We're half-hidden
on this rolling ground**

Die Reiterei, sie wagt sich nicht heran. Our strength
half hid, on undulating ground. **Their cavalry won't
dare sniff around**

Kaiser Emperor

Mir bleibt nichts übrig, als zu loben; My commendation,
only, need I speak; **Nothing left but praise
from me**

Hier kann sich Arm und Brust erproben. Now arm
and courage have the test they seek. **Here arms and
chests get the test they need**

Obergeneral General-in-Chief

Hier, auf der Mittelwiese flachen Raumlichkeiten,
Here, on the middle meadow's level spaces **Here on
the middle meadow's level floor**

Siehst du den Phalanx, wohlgenut zu streiten. Thou
seest the phalanx, eager in their places. **See the phalanx,
hungry for war**

Die Piken blinken flimmernd in der Luft, In air the
lances gleam and sparkle, kissed **The pikes glitter,
trembling in the air**

Im Sonnenglanz, durch Morgennebelduft. By sunshine,
through the filmy morning mist. **Sun through
morning fog—they're shining there**

Wie dunkel wogt das mächtige Quadrat! How dark-
ling sways the grand and powerful square! **How
darkly that powerful square undulates!**

Zu Tausenden gluh't hier auf grosse Tat. The
thousands burn for great achievements there. **Thou-
sands burning to do something great**

Du kannst daran die Masse Kraft erkennen, Therein
canst thou perceive the strength of masses; **You can
see massed power makes all the difference**

Ich trau' ihr zu, der Feinde Kraft zu trennen. And
thine, be sure, the foemen's strength surpasses. **I
trust them to smash enemy resistance**

Kaiser Emperor

Den schonen Blick hab' ich zum erstenmal. Now first
do I enjoy the stirring sight: **First time I've seen such
a gorgeous view**

Ein solches Heer gilt für die Doppelzahl. An army,
thus, appears of double might. **An army like this
counts for two**

Obergeneral General-in-Chief

Von unsrer Linken hab' ich nichts zu melden, But of
our left I've no report to make. **Of our left flank I've
nothing to report**

Den starren Fels besetzen wackere Helden, Brave
heroes garrison the rocky brake; **Brave heroes hold
the rocky fort**

Das Steingeklipp, das jetzt von Waffen blitzt, The

stony cliffs, by gleams of weapons specked, **The stony crags now gleam with steel**

Den wichtigen Pass der engen Klause schützt. The entrance to the close defile protect. **Protecting that narrow pass with appeal**

Ich ahne schon, hier scheitern Feindeskrafte Here, as I guess, the foeman's force will shatter, **Enemy forces will shatter here, I sense**

Unvorgesehn im blutigen Geschafter. Forced un-awares upon the bloody matter. **Caught unaware in bloody consequence**

Kaiser Emperor

Dort ziehn sie her, die falschen Anverwandten, And there they march, false kin, one like the other! **Here they come, my backstabbing kin**

Wie sie mich Oheim, Vetter, Bruder nannten, Even as they styled me Uncle, Cousin, Brother, **Calling me Uncle, Brother, Cousin with their grin**

Sich immer mehr und wieder mehr erlaubten, Assuming more, and ever more defying, **Taking more and more and more for themselves**

Dem Zepter Kraft, dem Thron Verehrung raubten, The sceptre's power, the throne's respect, denying; **Stripping my scepter and throne like shelves**

Dann, unter sich entzweit, das Reich verheerten Then, in their feuds, the realm they devastated, **Then feuding among themselves, trashing the land**

Und nun gesamt sich gegen mich emporten. And now
as Rebels march, against me mated! **And now united
against me they stand**

Die Menge schwankt im ungewissen Geist, Awhile
with halting minds the masses go, **The masses
waver, uncertain and dumb**

Dann stromt sie nach, wohin der Strom sie reisst.
Then ride the stream, wherever it may flow. **Then
float wherever the current takes scum**

Obergeneral General-in-Chief

Ein treuer Mann, auf Kundschaft ausgeschickt, A faith-
ful man, sent out some news to win, **A loyal scout
sent out for intel**

Kommt eilig felsenab; sei's ihm gegluckt! Comes
down the rocks: may he have lucky been! **Rushes
down the rocks—hope he's got good news to tell**

Erster Kundschafter First Spy

Glücklich ist sie uns gelungen, Luckily have we suc-
ceeded; **We pulled it off, lucky for us**

Listig, mutig, unsre Kunst, Helped by bold and cun-
ning art, **Crafty and brave, we made a fuss**

Dass wir hin und her gedrungen; Here and there have
pressed, and heeded, **Pushing through here and
there**

Doch wir bringen wenig Gunst. But 'tis ill news we impart. **But we bring bad news, I swear**

Viele schworen reine Huldigung Many, purest homage pledging, **Many still pledge pure loyalty**

Dir, wie manche treue Schar; Like the faithful, fealty swore. – **Like the faithful troops of royalty**

Doch Untatigkeits-Entschuldigung: For inertness now alleging **But their excuse for sitting tight:**

Innere Garung, Volksgefahr. People's danger, strife in store. **Civil unrest, popular fright**

Kaiser Emperor

Sich selbst erhalten bleibt der Selbstsucht Lehre, They learn from selfishness self-preservation, **Selfishness teaches self-preservation**

Nicht Dankbarkeit und Neigung, Pflicht und Ehre. Not duty, honour, grateful inclination. **Not gratitude or duty or dedication**

Bedenkt ihr nicht, wenn eure Rechnung voll, You do not think that, when your reckoning's shown, **Don't you fools realize—when your bill's due**

Dass Nachbars Hausbrand euch verzehren soll? The neighbour's burning house shall fire your own! **Your neighbor's house fire will burn YOU too?**

Obergeneral General-in-Chief

Der zweite kommt, nur langsam steigt er nieder, The

Second comes, descending slowly hither; **The second comes, descending slow**

Dem muden Manne zittern alle Glieder. A weary man,
whose strength appears to wither. **The exhausted
man trembles head to toe**

Zweiter Kundschafter Second Spy

Erst gewahrten wir vergnuglich First with comfort we
detected **First we observed with pleasure**

Wilder Unordnung Verlauf; What their plan confused
was worth; **Wild disorder beyond measure**

Unerwartet, unverzuglich Then, at once and un-
expected, **Then unexpected, out of nowhere,
boom**

Trat ein neuer Kaiser auf. Came another Emperor
forth. **A new Emperor stepped out of the gloom**

Und auf vorgeschriebnen Bahnen As he bids, in
ordered manner **And on prescribed routes now
marching**

Zieht die Menge durch die Flur; March the gathering
hosts away; **The masses cross the fields, depart-
ing**

Den entrollten Lugenfahnen His unfolded lying ban-
ner **Following lying flags unfurled**

Folgen alle. – Schafsnatur! All have followed. – Sheep
are they! **All following—sheep-brained world!**

Kaiser Emperor

Ein Gegenkaiser kommt mir zum Gewinn: Now, by a
Rival Emperor shall I gain: **A rival Emperor works in
my favor now**

Nun fühl' ich erst, dass ich der Kaiser bin. That I am
Emperor, thus to me is plain. **For the first time I
FEEL I'm Emperor—and how!**

Nur als Soldat legt' ich den Harnisch an, But as a sol-
dier I the mail put on; **I only put on armor as a sol-
dier**

Zu hoherm Zweck ist er nun umgetan. Now for a
higher aim the sword be drawn! **For higher purpose
now I'm bolder**

Bei jedem Fest, wenn's noch so glanzend war, At all
my shows, however grand to see, **At every festival,
grand as could be**

Nichts ward vermisst, mir fehlte die Gefahr. Did
nothing lack: but Danger lacked, to me. **Nothing
was missing—except DANGER to me**

Wie ihr auch seid, zum Ringspiel rietet ihr, Though
you but tilting at the ring suggested, **Even when you
suggested tournament rings**

Mir schlug das Herz, ich atmete Turnier; My heart beat
high to be in tourney tested; **My heart pounded—I
breathed for jousting's wings**

Und hattet ihr mir nicht vom Kriegen abgeraten, And
had you not from war my mind dissuaded, **Had you**

not talked me out of war

Jetzt glanz't ich schon in lichten Heldentaten. For glorious deeds my name were now paraded. **I'd already shine in heroic lore**

Selbständig fuhlt' ich meine Brust besiegelt, But independence then did I acquire, **I felt my chest sealed, self-reliant**

Als ich mich dort im Feuerreich bespiegelt; When I stood mirrored in the realm of fire: **When I stood mirrored in fire's realm, defiant**

Das Element drang grasslich auf mich los, In the dread element I dared to stand; – **The element attacked with horror's force**

Es war nur Schein, allein der Schein war gross. 'Twas but a show, and yet the show was grand. **Mere illusion—but GRAND illusion, of course**

Von Sieg und Ruhm hab' ich verwirrt getraumt; Of fame and victory I have dreamed alone; **I've dreamed confused of victory and fame**

Ich bringe nach, was frevelhaft versaumt. But for the base neglect I now atone! **Now I'll catch up on what I neglected in shame**

Die Herolde werden abgefertigt zur Herausforderung des Gegenkaisers.

The Heralds are despatched to challenge the Rival Emperor to single combat.

Faust tritt auf, geharnischt, mit halbgeschlossnem Helme. Die drei Gewaltigen gerüstet und gekleidet wie oben.

Faust enters, in armour, with half-closed visor. The Three Mighty Men, armed and clothed, as already described.

Faust

Wir treten auf und hoffen, ungescholten; We come, and hope our coming is not chidden; **We arrive and hope we're not unwanted here**

Auch ohne Not hat Vorsicht wohl gegolten. Prudence may help, though by the need unbidden. **Foresight has value even when nothing's to fear**

Du weisst, das Bergvolk denkt und simuliert, The mountain race, thou know'st, think and explore, **You know mountain people think and ponder**

Ist in Natur- und Felsenschrift studiert. Of Nature and the rocks they read the lore. **They've studied Nature's script and rock-text yonder**

Die Geister, langst dem flachen Land entzogen, The Spirits, forced from the level land to sever, **The spirits, long banished from the flatlands**

Sind mehr als sonst dem Felsgebirg gewogen. Are of the rocky hills more fain than ever. **Now favor rocky mountains, their new stands**

Sie wirken still durch labyrinthische Klufte Silent, they work through labyrinthine passes, **Silent they**

work through labyrinthine veins

Im edlen Gas metallisch reicher Dufte; In rich metallic fumes of noble gases. **In noble gas of metal-rich perfume's domains**

In stetem Sondern, Prüfen und Verbinden On solving, testing, blending, most intent: **Constantly separating, testing, combining**

Ihr einziger Trieb ist, Neues zu erfinden. Their only passion, something to invent. **Their only urge: something new designing**

Mit leisem Finger geistiger Gewalten With gentle touch of spiritual power **With gentle finger of spiritual might**

Erbauen sie durchsichtige Gestalten; They build transparent fabrics, hour by hour; **They build transparent shapes of shimmering light**

Dann im Kristall und seiner ewigen Schweignis For they, in crystals and their silence, furred, **Then in crystal's eternal silent shrine**

Erblicken sie der Oberwelt Ereignis. Behold events that rule the Upper World. **They glimpse what happens in the world supine**

Kaiser Emperor

Vernommen hab' ich's, und ich glaube dir; I understand it, and can well agree; **I've heard all that and believe you true**

Doch, wackrer Mann, sag an: was soll das hier? But

say, thou gallant man, what's that to me? **But brave man—what's it got to do with YOU?**

Faust

Der Nekromant von Norcia, der Sabiner, The Sabine old, the Norcian necromancer, **The Sabine necromancer from Norcia's land**

Ist dein getreuer, ehrenhafter Diener. Thy true and worthy servant, sends thee answer: **Is your true and honorable servant at hand**

Welch greulich Schicksal droht' ihm ungeheuer! What fearful fate it was, that overhung him! **What ghastly fate threatened him—immense!**

Das Reisig prasselte, schon zungelte das Feuer; The faggots crackled, fire already stung him; **Kindling crackled, flames already licked intense**

Die trocknen Scheite, ringsumher verschränkt, The billets dry were closely round him fixed, **Dry logs stacked tight around his skin**

Mit Pech und Schwefelruten untermengt; With pitch and rolls of brimstone intermixed; **Mixed with pitch and sulfur thrown in**

Nicht Mensch, noch Gott, noch Teufel konnte retten, Not Man, nor God, nor Devil, him could save, – **No man, God, or Devil could save his hide**

Die Majestat zersprengte gluhende Ketten. The Emperor plucked him from his fiery grave. **YOUR Majesty burst the glowing chains aside**

Dort war's in Rom. Er bleibt dir hoch verpflichtet, It
was in Rome. Still is he bound unto thee; **That was
Rome. He's still in your debt**

Auf deinen Gang in Sorge stets gerichtet. Upon thy
path his anxious thoughts pursue thee; **Watching
your path with worried sweat**

Von jener Stund' an ganz vergass er sich, Himself
since that dread hour forgotten, he **From that hour
he forgot himself entire**

Er fragt den Stern, die Tiefe nur für dich. Questions
the stars, the depths, alone for thee. **Asks stars and
depths only for your sire**

Er trug uns auf, als eiligstes Geschäfte, Us he commis-
sioned, by the swiftest courses **He ordered us on ur-
gent mission**

Bei dir zu stehn. Gross sind des Berges Kräfte; Thee
to assist. Great are the mountain's forces; **Stand by
you. Great mountain forces' ammunition**

Da wirkt Natur so übermächtig frei, There Nature
works all-potently and free, **There Nature works
all-powerfully free**

Der Pfaffen Stumpfsinn schilt es Zauberei. Though
stupid priests therein but magic see. **Stupid priests
call it sorcery**

Kaiser Emperor

Am Freudentag, wenn wir die Gäste grüssen, On days
of joy, when we the guests are greeting **On festive**

days when guests arrive in state

Die heiter kommen, heiter zu genießen, Who for their
gay delight are gaily meeting, **Coming cheerful to
celebrate**

Da freut uns jeder, wie er schiebt und drängt Each
gives us pleasure, as they push and pull, **Each one
delights, pushing and squeezing there**

Und, Mann für Mann, der Sale Raum verengt. And
crowd man after man, the chambers full; **Man after
man, cramming the halls square**

Doch höchst willkommen muss der Biedre sein, Yet
chiefly welcome is the brave man, thus, **Yet most
welcome must the brave one be**

Tritt er als Beistand kraftig zu uns ein When as a bold
ally he brings to us **Arriving as ally, strong and free**

Zur Morgenstunde, die bedenklich waltet, Now, in
the fateful morning hour, his talents, **In this fateful
morning hour's weight**

Weil über ihr des Schicksals Waage schaltet. While
Destiny uplifts her trembling balance. **While
Destiny's scales deliberate**

Doch lenket hier im hohen Augenblick Yet, while the
fates of this high hour unfold, **Yet in this high mo-
ment stay your hand**

Die starke Hand vom willigen Schwert zurück, Thy
strong hand from the willing sword withhold, – **Pull
back from that willing sword's demand**

Ehrt den Moment, wo manche Tausend schreiten,
Honour the moment, when the hosts are striding,
Honor the moment when thousands stride

Für oder wider mich zu streiten. For or against me,
to the field deciding! **For or against me to battle's
tide**

Selbst ist der Mann! Wer Thron und Kron' begehrt,
Self is the Man! Who crown and throne would claim **A
man does it himself! Want throne and crown?**

Personlich sei er solcher Ehren wert. Must personally
be worthy of the same. **Be personally worthy of
such renown**

Sei das Gespenst, das, gegen uns erstanden, And
may the Phantom, which against us stands, **May the
phantom who's risen against our reign**

Sich Kaiser nennt und Herr von unsern Landen, The
self-styled Emperor, Lord of all our lands, **Calling
himself Emperor, Lord of our domain**

Des Heeres Herzog, Lehnherr unsrer Grossen, The
army's Duke, our Princes' feudal head, **Duke of the
army, liege of our nobility**

Mit eigener Faust ins Totenreich gestossen! With mine
own hand be hurled among the dead! **Be thrust by
MY fist to death's facility!**

Faust

Wie es auch sei, das Grosse zu vollenden, Howe'er the
need that thy great work be finished, **However great**

the completion of this deed

Du tust nicht wohl, dein Haupt so zu verpfanden.
Risky were thy head, the chances were diminished.

You do wrong pledging your head—take heed

Ist nicht der Helm mit Kamm und Busch geschmückt?
Is not the helm adorned with plume and crest? **Is the
helm not adorned with crest and plume?**

Er schützt das Haupt, das unsern Mut entzuckt. The
head it shields, that steels our courage best. **It
shields the head that fires our courage's bloom**

Was, ohne Haupt, was forderten die Glieder? Without
a head, what should the members bridle? **Without
the head, what could the limbs achieve?**

Denn schlafert jenes, alle sinken nieder; Let it but
sleep, they sink supine and idle. **If it sleeps, all sink
and grieve**

Wird es verletzt, gleich alle sind verwundet, If it be in-
jured, all the hurt confess in't, **Hurt it—every limb
feels the distress**

Erstehen frisch, wenn jenes rasch gesundet. And all
revive, when it is convalescent. **They revive when it
heals with quickness**

Schnell weiss der Arm sein starkes Recht zu nutzen;
Then soon the arm its right shall reassert, **Quick the
arm knows to use its power right**

Er hebt den Schild, den Schadel zu beschützen; And
lift the shield to save the skull from hurt: **Lifts the**

shield to save the skull from plight

Das Schwert gewahret seiner Pflicht sogleich, The sword perceives at once its honoured trust, **The sword perceives its duty straightaway**

Lenkt kraftig ab und wiederholt den Streich; Parries with vigour, and repeats the thrust: **Parries hard and repeats the fray**

Der tuchtige Fuss nimmt teil an ihrem Gluck, The gallant foot its share of luck will gain, **The capable foot shares in their luck**

Setzt dem Erschlagenen frisch sich ins Genick. And plants itself upon the necks of slain. **Plants itself fresh on necks of those they've struck**

Kaiser Emperor

Das ist mein Zorn, so mocht' ich ihn behandeln, Such is my wrath; I'd meet him thus, undaunted, **That's MY rage—I'd handle him just so**

Das stolze Haupt in Schemeltritt verwandeln! And see his proud head as my footstool planted! **Turn that proud head into a footstool below!**

Herolde (zuruckkommend) Herald's (returning)

Wenig Ehre, wenig Geltung Little honour was accorded; **Little honor, little respect**

Haben wir daselbst genossen, We have met with scorn undoubted: **We received there, as you'd**

expect

Unsrer kraftig edlen Meldung Our defiance, nobly worded, **Our noble, forceful declaration**

Lachten sie als schaler Possen: As an empty farce they flouted: **They laughed off as a stale flirtation**

“Euer Kaiser ist verschollen, “Lo, your Lord is but a vision, – **“Your Emperor? Long forgotten, done**

Echo dort im engen Tal; Echo of a vanished prime: **Echo in a narrow valley, gone**

Wenn wir sein gedenken sollen, When we name him, says Tradition: **When we think of him at all**

Marchen sagt: – Es war einmal.” ‘He was – once upon a time!’ “ **The fairy tale says: Once upon a fall.”**

Faust

Dem Wunsch gemass der Besten ist’s geschehn, It’s happened as the best would fain have planned, **Happened as the best wished it to be**

Die fest und treu an deiner Seite stehn. Who, firm and faithful, still beside thee stand. **Those standing loyal beside thee**

Dort naht der Feind, die Deinen harren brunstig; There comes the foe, thy army waits and wishes; **There comes the foe—yours wait burning to fight**

Befiehl den Angriff, der Moment ist gunstig. Order attack! the moment is auspicious. **Command attack!**

The moment's ripe and right

Kaiser Emperor

Auf das Kommando leist' ich hier Verzicht. Yet I decline to exercise command. **I renounce command right here and now**

(Zum Obergeneral) (To the General-in-Chief)

In deinen Händen, Furst, sei deine Pflicht. Thy duty, Prince, be trusted to thy hand! **Prince, your duty's in your hands—take a bow**

Obergeneral General-in-Chief

So trete denn der rechte Flügel an! Then let the right wing now advance apace! **Then let the right wing now advance!**

Des Feindes Linke, eben jetzt im Steigen, The enemy's left, who just begin ascending, **The enemy's left just starting to prance**

Soll, eh' sie noch den letzten Schritt getan, Shall, ere the movement close, give up their place, **Before they take their final stance**

Der Jugendkraft geprüfter Treue weichen. Before the youthful force our field defending. **Shall yield to tested youth's fresh lance**

Faust

Erlaube denn, dass dieser muntre Held Permit me, then, that this gay hero may **Permit this lively hero then**

Sich ungesaumt in deine Reihen stellt, Be stationed in thy ranks, without delay, – **To join your ranks without delay—Amen**

Sich deinen Reihen innigst einverleibt That with thy men most fully he consort, **To weave himself tight into your rows**

Und, so gesellt, sein kraftig Wesen treibt. And thus incorporate, ply his vigorous sport! **And so combined, deal his mighty blows**

(Er deutet auf den zur Rechten.) (He points to the Mighty Man on the right.)

Raufebold (vortretend) **Bully** (coming forward)

Wer das Gesicht mir zeigt, der kehrt's nicht ab Who shows his face to me, before he turn **Show me your face? You won't turn it back**

Als mit zerschlagenen Unter- und Oberbacken; Shall find his cheekbones and his chops are shattered: **Till upper and lower jaws both crack**

Wer mir den Rucken kehrt, gleich liegt ihm schlapp Who shows his back, one sudden blow shall earn, **Turn your back? Then down you'll flop**

Hals, Kopf und Schopf hinschlotternd grass im Nacken. Then head and pig-tail dangling hang, and battered! **Neck, skull, pigtail—dangling slop**

Und schlagen deine Manner dann And if thy men, like me, will lunge **If your men strike like I do**

Mit Schwert und Kolben, wie ich wute, With mace and

sword, beside each other, **With sword and cudgel raging through**

So stürzt der Feind, Mann über Mann, Man over man the foe shall plunge **The enemy falls man over man**

Ersaucht im eigenen Geblute. And in their own deep blood shall smother! **DROWNING in their own blood's plan**

(Ab.) (Exit.)

Obergeneral General-in-Chief

Der Phalanx unsrer Mitte folge sacht, Let them our centre phalanx follow slow, – **Let our center phalanx follow slow**

Dem Feind begegn' er, klug mit aller Macht; Engage with caution, yet with might, the foe! **Meet the foe with cunning's glow**

Ein wenig rechts, dort hat bereits, erbittert, There to the right, already overtaken, **A bit to the right, already there, enraged**

Der Unsern Streitkraft ihren Plan erschuttert. Our furious force their plan has rudely shaken! **Our forces have their plans disengaged**

Faust (auf den Mittleren deutend) **Faust** (pointing to the middle one)

So folge denn auch dieser deinem Wort! Let also this one now obey thy word! **Let this one follow your**

word too!

Habebald (vortretend) **Havequick** (comes forward)

Dem Heldenmut der Kaiserscharen Unto the host's
heroic duty **To the Kaiser's troops' heroic mood**

Soll sich der Durst nach Beute paaren; Shall now be
joined the thirst for booty; **Shall join the thirst for
booty's brood**

Und allen sei das Ziel gestellt: And be the goal, where
all are sent, **And be the goal for one and all**

Des Gegenkaisers reiches Zelt. The Rival Emperor's
sumptuous tent! **The rival Emperor's rich tent—
the haul!**

Er prahlt nicht lang auf seinem Sitze, He shall not long
upon his seat be lorded: **He won't strut long on his
throne**

Ich ordne mich dem Phalanx an die Spitze. To lead
the phalanx be to me accorded! **I'll lead the phalanx
—that spot's my own**

Eilebeute (Marketenderin, sich an ihn anschmiegend)
Speedbooty (sutleress, fawning upon him)

Bin ich auch ihm nicht angeweiht, Though never tied
to him by priest, **Though I'm not hitched to him by
priest**

Er mir der liebste Buhle bleibt. He is my sweetheart
dear, at least. **He's still my favorite buck at least**

Fur uns ist solch ein Herbst gereift! Our autumn 'tis, of ripest gold! **For US such harvest-time's matured**

Die Frau ist grimmig, wenn sie greift, Woman is fierce when she takes hold, **Woman is FIERCE when she grabs—be assured**

Ist ohne Schonung, wenn sie raubt; And when she robs, is merciless: **Is MERCILESS when she robs and takes**

Im Sieg voran! und alles ist erlaubt. All is allowed, so forth to victory press! **Forward to victory—anything goes, for God's sakes!**

(Beide ab.) (Exeunt both.)

Obergeneral General-in-Chief

Auf unsre Linke, wie vorauszusehn, Upon our left, as was to be foreseen, **Upon our left, as was foreseen**

Stürzt ihre Rechte, kraftig. Widerstehn Their right is strongly hurled. Yon rocks between, **Their right crashes strong between**

Wird Mann fur Mann dem wutenden Beginnen, Ours will resist their furious beginning, **Man after man will resist their raid**

Den engen Pass des Felswegs zu gewinnen. And hinder them the narrow pass from winning. **To win the narrow rocky pass' blockade**

Faust (winkt nach der Linken) **Faust** (beckons to the Mighty Man on the left)

So bitte, Herr, auch diesen zu bemerken; I beg you,
Sire, let this one also aid; **Please, my Lord, notice
this one too**

Es schadet nichts, wenn Starke sich verstärken.
'Tis well when even the strong are stronger made.
Strength strengthening strength is nothing new

Haltefest (vortretend) **Holdfast** (coming forward)

Dem linken Flügel keine Sorgen! Now let the left wing
have no fear! **Left wing? Don't you worry one bit**

Da, wo ich bin, ist der Besitz geborgen; The ground
is surely held, where I appear: **Where I am, posses-
sions are safe and fit**

In ihm bewahret sich der Alte, I am the Ancient you
were told of: **This old-timer proves himself sound**

Kein Strahlblitz spaltet, was ich halte. No lightning
splits what I keep hold of! **NO lightning bolt splits
what I hold down!**

(Ab.) (Exit.)

Mephistopheles (von oben herabkommend)
Mephistopheles (descending from above)

Nun schauet, wie im Hintergrunde And now be-
hold, how, more remote, **Now see how in the
background there**

Aus jedem zackigen Felsenschlunde From every
jagged rocky throat **From every jagged rocky**

throat's lair

Bewaffnete hervor sich drangen, Comes forth an armed host, increasing, **Armed figures press themselves outside**

Die schmalen Pfade zu verengen, Down every narrow pathway squeezing, **Squeezing down narrow paths with stride**

Mit Helm und Harnisch, Schwertern, Schilden With helm and harness, sword and spear, **With helm and harness, sword and shield**

In unserm Rucken eine Mauer bilden, A living rampart in our rear, **A wall behind us, our rear sealed**

Den Wink erwartend, zuzuschlagen. And wait the sign to charge the foemen! **Waiting for the sign to strike the field**

(Leise zu den Wissenden) (Aside, to the knowing ones)

Woher das kommt, musst ihr nicht fragen. You must not ask whence comes the omen. **Where this comes from? Don't you dare ask**

Ich habe freilich nicht gesaumt, I have not been a careless scout, **I certainly didn't shirk my task**

Die Waffensale ringsum ausgeräumt; But cleared the halls of armour round about. **The weapon halls all around I cleaned**

Da standen sie zu Fuss, zu Pferde, They stood a-foot, they sat on horses, **There they stood, horse and foot, all preened**

Als waren sie noch Herrn der Erde; Like Lords of Earth
and real forces: **As if they still ruled the earth
somehow**

Sonst waren's Ritter, König, Kaiser, Once Emperors,
Kings, and Knights were they, **Once knights, kings,
emperors—now?**

Jetzt sind es nichts als leere Schneckenhauser; Now
empty shells, – the snails have crawled away. **Empty
snail shells—the snails crawled out**

Gar manch Gespenst hat sich darein geputzt, Full
many ghosts, arrayed so, have for us **Many ghosts
have dressed in what's about**

Das Mittelalter lebhaft aufgestutzt. Revamped the
Middle Ages thus. **Reviving the Middle Ages with
clout**

Welch Teufelchen auch drinne steckt, Whatever Dev-
ils now the shells select, **Whatever little devil sticks
inside**

Für diesmal macht es doch Effekt. This once 'twill still
create effect. **For now it creates effect worldwide**

(Laut) (Aloud)

Hört, wie sie sich voraus erbozen, Hark! in advance
they stir their anger, **Hear them rage already in ad-
vance**

Blechklappernd aneinander stossen! Each jostling
each with brassy clangor! **Tin clattering on tin in
their dance**

Auch flattern Fahnenfetzen bei Standarten, The
banner-rags of standards flutter flowing, **Banner-
rags flutter by the old standards**

Die frischer Luftchen ungeduldig harreten. That rest-
less waited for the breeze's blowing. **Waiting impa-
tiently for fresh wind's commands**

Bedenkt, hier ist ein altes Volk bereit Here standeth
ready, now, an ancient race; **Consider: here ancient
folk stand ready**

Und mischte gern sich auch zum neuen Streit. In the
new conflict it would fain have place. **Eager to join
new battle, steady**

Ungeheurer Posaunenklang von oben, im feindlichen
Heer merkliche Schwankung.

Tremendous peal of trumpets from above: a percep-
tible wavering in the hostile army.

Faust

Der Horizont hat sich verdunkelt, The near horizon
dims and darkles; **The horizon's grown dark and
dense**

Nur hie und da bedeutend funkelt Yet here and there
with meaning sparkles **Only here and there with
portent's glints**

Ein roter ahnungsvoller Schein; A ruddy and presag-
ing glow; **A red foreboding gleam burns low**

Schon blutig blinken die Gewehre; The blades are red
where strife is sorest, **Already bloody the weapons'**

glow

Der Fels, der Wald, die Atmosphäre, The atmosphere,
the rocks, the forest, **Rock, forest, atmosphere
conspire**

Der ganze Himmel mischt sich ein. The very heavens
the combat show. **The whole sky joins the battle's
fire**

Mephistopheles

Die rechte Flanke halt sich kraftig; The right flank
holds its ground with vigour: **The right flank holds
with solid might**

Doch seh' ich ragend unter diesen There, towering
over all, defiant, **But towering above the height**

Hans Raufbold, den behenden Riesen, Jack Bully
works, the nimble giant, **Hans Raufebold, that
nimble giant**

Auf seine Weise rasch geschäftig. And drives them
with his wonted rigour. **Works his own way, wild
and defiant**

Kaiser Emperor

Erst sah ich einen Arm erhoben, I first beheld one arm
uplifted, **First I saw one arm raised high**

Jetzt seh' ich schon ein Dutzend toben; But now a
dozen tossed and shifted: **Now a dozen rage across
the sky**

Naturgemass geschieht es nicht. Unnatural such things appear. **That's not natural what occurs**

Faust

Vernahmst du nichts von Nebelstreifen, Hast thou not heard of vapours banded, **Haven't you heard of foggy blurs**

Die auf Siziliens Kusten schweifen? O'er the Sicilian coasts expanded? **Hovering along Sicilian coasts?**

Dort, schwankend klar, im Tageslicht, There, hovering in daylight clear, **There wavering clear in daylight's hosts**

Erhoben zu den Mittelluften, When mid-air gleams in rarer phases, **Raised to middle heights of air**

Gespiegelt in besondern Duften, And mirrored in especial hazes, **Mirrored in special vapors there**

Erscheint ein seltsames Gesicht: A vision wonderful awakes: **A strange apparition appears for sight**

Da schwanken Stadte hin und wider, There back and forth are cities bending, **Cities sway back and forth in light**

Da steigen Garten auf und nieder, With gardens rising and descending, **Gardens rise and sink below**

Wie Bild um Bild den Ather bricht. As form on form the ether breaks. **Image after image breaks the ether's flow**

Kaiser Emperor

Doch wie bedenklich! Alle Spitzen Yet how suspicious! I behold **But how suspicious! Every point**

Der hohen Speere seh' ich blitzen; The tall spears tipped with gleams of gold **Of high spears gleams at the joint**

Auf unsres Phalanx blanken Lanzen Upon our phalanx' shining lances **On our phalanx's shining lance array**

Seh' ich behende Flammchen tanzen. A nimble host of flamelets dances: **Nimble flamelets dance and play**

Das scheint mir gar zu geisterhaft. Too spectral it appears to me. **Too ghostly for my taste, this scene**

Faust

Verzeih, o Herr, das sind die Spuren Pardon me, Lord, those are the traces **Pardon, Lord—those traces there have been**

Verschollner geistiger Naturen, Of spirits of the vanished races, **From vanished spiritual races' sheen**

Ein Widerschein der Dioskuren, The fires of Pollux and of Castor, **A reflection of the Dioscuri's fire**

Bei denen alle Schiffer schwuren; Whom seamen call on in disaster: **Whom all sailors invoke when storms grow dire**

Sie sammeln hier die letzte Kraft. They here collect their final strength for thee. **They gather their last**

strength for thee

Kaiser Emperor

Doch sage: wem sind wir verpflichtet, But say, to whom are we indebted, **But tell me—to whom are we in debt?**

Dass die Natur, auf uns gerichtet, That Nature hath our plans abetted, **That Nature turns our way and yet**

Das Seltenste zusammenrafft? With shows of rarest potency? **Gathers the rarest powers to display?**

Mephistopheles

Wem als dem Meister, jenem hohen, To whom, indeed, but that old Roman **To whom but that Master, lofty and gray**

Der dein Geschick im Busen tragt? Whose care for thee at last is proved! **Who bears your fate in his chest, I'd say**

Durch deiner Feinde starkes Drohen By the strong menace of thy foemen **By your enemies' menacing display**

Ist er im Tiefsten aufgereggt. His deepest nature has been moved. **He's stirred deep inside today**

Sein Dank will dich gerettet sehen, His gratitude would see thee now delivered, **His thanks wants to see you saved**

Und sollt' er selbst daran vergehen. Though his own

being for thy sake be shivered. **Even if he himself lies graved**

Kaiser Emperor

Sie jubelten, mich pomphaft umzufuhren; They cheered my march, with every pomp invested; **They cheered parading me in pomp so grand**

Ich war nun was, das wollt' ich auch probieren I felt my power, I meant to see it tested; **I WAS something —wanted to test my hand**

Und fand's gelegen, ohne viel zu denken, So, carelessly, I found it well, as ruler, **Found it fitting without much thought**

Dem weissen Barte kuhle Luft zu schenken. To send the white beard where the air was cooler. **To give the white beard cool air bought**

Dem Klerus hab' ich eine Lust verdorben, I robbed the Clergy of a pleasant savour, **Spoiled the clergy's fun that round**

Und ihre Gunst mir freilich nicht erworben. And, truly, have not thus acquired their favour. **Haven't won their favor, I've found**

Nun sollt' ich, seit so manchen Jahren, Shall I, at last, since many years are over, **Now after years that have come and gone**

Die Wirkung frohen Tuns erfahren? The payment for that merry deed recover? **Should I feel good deeds' payoff dawn?**

Faust

Freiherzige Wohltat wuchert reich; Free-hearted help
heaps interest: **Free-hearted kindness grows com-
pound interest fast**

Lass deinen Blick sich aufwärts wenden! Look up,
and cease to watch the foemen! **Let your gaze turn
upward, vast**

Mich deucht, er will ein Zeichen senden, Methinks
that he will send an omen: **I think he'll send a sign
your way**

Gib acht, es deutet sich sogleich. Attend! the sign is
now expressed. **Watch! It manifests right away**

Kaiser Emperor

Ein Adler schwebt im Himmelhohen, An Eagle hovers
in the heavenly vault: **An eagle soars in heaven's
height**

Ein Greif ihm nach mit wildem Drohen. A Griffin
follows, menacing assault. **A griffin chases with
threatening might**

Faust

Gib acht: gar gunstig scheint es mir. Give heed! It
seems most favourable. **Pay attention—this seems
favorable to me**

Greif ist ein fabelhaftes Tier; The Griffin is a beast of
fable: **The griffin's a creature of fantasy**

Wie kann es sich so weit vergessen, How dare he claim
a rival regal, **How dare it so forget its station**

Mit echtem Adler sich zu messen? And meet in fight
a genuine Eagle? **To challenge a REAL eagle of the
nation?**

Kaiser Emperor

Nunmehr, in weitgedehnten Kreisen, And now, in
circles wide extended, **Now in wide-arcing sweeps
around**

Umziehn sie sich; – in gleichem Nu They wheel
involved, – then, like a flash, **They circle each other
—same instant found**

Sie fahren aufeinander zu, Upon each other swiftly
dash, **They fly at each other in savage clash**

Sich Brust und Halse zu zerreißen. That necks be
cleft and bodies rended! **Ripping at throat and
breast in their rash**

Faust

Nun merke, wie der leidige Greif, Mark now the evil
Griffin quail! **Now watch the wretched griffin
there**

Zerzaust, zerzupft, nur Schaden findet Rumpel and
torn, the foe he feareth, **Torn and ragged, finds only
damage in the air**

Und mit gesenktem Lowenschweif, And with his

drooping lion's-tail, **With drooping lion tail hung low**

Zum Gipfelwald gestürzt, verschwindet. Plunged in the tree-tops, disappeareth. **Plunges to treetops—gone from the show**

Kaiser Emperor

Sei's, wie gedeutet, so getan! Even as presaged, so may it be! **As interpreted, so may it be**

Ich nehm' es mit Verwundrung an. I take the sign, admiringly. **I accept it with wonder, admiringly**

Mephistopheles (gegen die Rechte) **Mephistopheles** (towards the right)

Dringend wiederholten Streichen From the force of blows repeated **From urgently repeated blows**

Müssen unsre Feinde weichen, Have our enemies retreated; **Our enemies must yield—there goes**

Und mit ungewissem Fechten And in fight uncertain, shifting, **With uncertain fighting's sway**

Drangen sie nach ihrer Rechten Towards their right they now are drifting, **They push toward their right in disarray**

Und verwirren so im Streite Thus confusing, by their courses, **And so confuse in battle's heat**

Ihrer Hauptmacht linke Seite. All the left flank of their forces. **Their main force's left to defeat**

Unser Phalanx feste Spitze See! our phalanx, firmly driven, **Our phalanx's solid spearhead drives**

Zieht sich rechts, und gleich dem Blitze Moves to right, and, like the levin, **Moves right and like LIGHTNING strives**

Fahrt sie in die schwache Stelle. – Strikes them in the weak position. – **Strikes into the weak spot square**

Nun, wie sturmerregte Welle Now, like waves in wild collision, **Now like storm-driven waves that tear**

Spruhend, wuten gleiche Mächte Equal powers, with rage opposing, **Spraying, equal powers rage**

Wild in doppeltem Gefechte; In the double fight are closing. **Wild in double battle's stage**

Herrlichers ist nichts ersonnen, Gloriously the weapons rattle; **Nothing grander could be spun**

Uns ist diese Schlacht gewonnen! We, at last, have won the battle! **For us this battle has been WON!**

Kaiser (auf der linken Seite, zu Faust) **Emperor** (on the left, to Faust)

Schau! Mir scheint es dort bedenklich, Look! it yonder seems suspicious! **Look! Over there seems fishy to me**

Unser Posten steht verfanglich. For our post the luck's capricious. **Our position stands endangered, I see**

Keine Steine seh' ich fliegen, Not a stone I see them
throw there; **No stones I see them throw**

Niedre Felsen sind erstiegen, Mounted are the rocks
below there, **Lower rocks they've climbed below**

Obre stehen schon verlassen. And the upper ones de-
serted. **Upper ones already vacated**

Jetzt! – Der Feind, zu ganzen Massen Now! – to one
huge mass converted **Now—the foe, to masses con-
centrated**

Immer naher angedrungen, Nearer moves the foe, un-
shaken, **Presses ever nearer, never shook**

Hat vielleicht den Pass errungen, And perchance the
pass hath taken. **Has perhaps the pass already
took**

Schlusserfolg unheiligen Strebens! Such the unholy
plan's conclusion! **End result of unholy striving**

Eure Kunste sind vergebens. All your arts are but delu-
sion. **Your arts are useless for surviving!**

Pause.

Mephistopheles

Da kommen meine beiden Raben, There come my
ravens, croaking presage; **There come my two
ravens winging**

Was mogen die fur Botschaft haben? What nature,
then, may be their message? **What message might**

they be bringing?

Ich fürchte gar, es geht uns schlecht. I fear we stand
in evil plight. **I fear things look bad for us**

Kaiser Emperor

Was sollen diese leidigen Vogel? What mean these fa-
tal birds enchanted? **What do these wretched birds
discuss?**

Sie richten ihre schwarzen Segel Their inky sails are
hither slanted, **They steer their black sails here**

Hierher vom heißen Felsgefecht. Hot from the rocky
field of fight. **Hot from the rocky fight, so near**

Mephistopheles (zu den Raben) **Mephistopheles**
(to the Ravens)

Setzt euch ganz nah zu meinen Ohren. Sit at mine
ears, your flight retarded! **Perch right close beside
my ear**

Wen ihr beschützt, ist nicht verloren, He is not lost
whom you have guarded; **Whoever you protect
need never fear**

Denn euer Rat ist folgerichtig. Your counsel's logical
and right. **Your counsel follows logic clear**

Faust (zum Kaiser) **Faust** (to the Emperor)

Von Tauben hast du ja vernommen, Thou hast, of
course, been told of pigeons, **You've heard of
carrier pigeons, right?**

Die aus den fernsten Landen kommen Taught to re-
turn from distant regions **That from distant lands
take flight**

Zu ihres Nestes Brut und Kost. To nests upon their na-
tive coast. **To their nest's brood and feast**

Hier ist's mit wichtigen Unterschieden: Here, differ-
ently, the plan's succeeded; **Here's an important
difference at least**

Die Taubenpost bedient den Frieden, The pigeon-
post for Peace is needed, **Pigeon post serves
peace's need**

Der Krieg befiehlt die Rabenpost. But War requires
the raven-post. **War commands the raven breed**

Mephistopheles

Es meldet sich ein schwer Verhangnis: The birds
announce us sore mischances. **A heavy fate an-
nounces itself now**

Seht hin! gewahret die Bedrangnis See, yonder, how
the foe advances **Look there! See the distress
somehow**

Um unsrer Helden Felsenrand! Against our heroes'
rocky wall. **Around our heroes' rocky rim**

Die nächsten Hohen sind erstiegen, The nearest
heights even now attaining! **The nearest heights
are scaled by them**

Und wurden sie den Pass besiegen, Should they suc-
ceed the pass in gaining, **Should they conquer the**

pass at last

Wir hatten einen schweren Stand. Our fortunes, then, were critical. **We'd be standing not so fast**

Kaiser Emperor

So bin ich endlich doch betrogen! Defeat and cheat at last are on me; **So I'm finally truly deceived!**

Ihr habt mich in das Netz gezogen; Into your meshes you have drawn me: **You've drawn me into the net you've weaved**

Mir graut, seitdem es mich umstrickt. I shudder, since they bind me fast. **I shudder since it binds me round**

Mephistopheles

Nur Mut! Noch ist es nicht missglückt. Courage! Not yet the die is cast. **Courage! We haven't failed yet, I've found**

Geduld und Pfiff zum letzten Knoten! Patience and knack, for knot-untying! **Patience and cunning for the final knot**

Gewöhnlich geht's am Ende scharf. The close will be the fiercest stand. **Usually the ending's fiercest fought**

Ich habe meine sichern Boten; Sure messengers for me are flying: **I have my reliable messengers fleet**

Befehlt, dass ich befehlen darf! Command that I may

give command! **Command that I may command—complete!**

Obergeneral (der indessen herangekommen)
General-in-Chief (who has meanwhile arrived)

Mit diesen hast du dich vereinigt, To follow these
hast thou consented; **With THESE you've allied our
cause?**

Mich hat's die ganze Zeit gepeinigt, Thence all the
time was I tormented: **It's pained me the whole
time because**

Das Gaukeln schafft kein festes Glück. No fortune
comes of jugglery. **Juggling tricks don't make
lasting luck**

Ich weiss nichts an der Schlacht zu wenden; The
battle's lost, I cannot mend it; **I know nothing to
turn this battle's struck**

Begannen sie's, sie mogen's enden, 'Twas they began,
and they may end it! **They started it—let THEM end
it then**

Ich gebe meinen Stab zurück. My baton I return to
thee. **I give back my staff—Amen**

Kaiser Emperor

Behalt ihn bis zu bessern Stunden, Retain it for the
better season **Keep it for better hours yet**

Die uns vielleicht das Glück verleiht. Which Fortune
still to us may send! **Which fortune may still let**

Mir schaudert vor dem garstigen Kunden I dread the customers with reason, – **I shudder at that ugly customer there**

Und seiner Rabentraulichkeit. The ravens and their ugly friend. **And his cozy raven affair**

(Zu Mephistopheles) (To Mephistopheles)

Den Stab kann ich dir nicht verleihen, As for the baton, thou must leave it; **The staff I cannot lend to you**

Du scheinst mir nicht der rechte Mann; Thou’rt not, methinks, the proper man. **You don’t seem the right man for what’s true**

Befiehl und such uns zu befreien! Command the fight, canst thou retrieve it! **Command—try to set us free!**

Geschehe, was geschehen kann. Let happen all that happen can! **Let happen what must be**

(Geht ins Zelt mit dem Obergeneral.) (Exit into the tent with the General-in-Chief.)

Mephistopheles

Mag ihn der stumpfe Stab beschützen! The blunt stick still be his protection! **May the blunt staff protect him well**

Uns andern konnt’ er wenig nutzen, ’Twould naught avail in our direction; **For us it’d be useless as hell**

Es war so was vom Kreuz daran. There was a sort of Cross thereon. **Something of the CROSS was on it,**

I'd say

Faust

Was ist zu tun? – What's to be done? **What's to be done?—**

Mephistopheles

Es ist getan! – The thing is done! – **It's done, I say!—**

Nun, schwarze Vettern, rasch im Dienen, Now, my black cousins, speed upon your duties **Now black cousins, quick in your duty**

Zum grossen Bergsee! grusst mir die Undinen To the mountain-lake! The Undines, watery beauties, **To the great mountain lake! Greet me the watery beauty**

Und bittet sie um ihrer Fluten Schein. Entreat, the appearance of their floods to spare! **And beg them for their floods' shimmering sheen**

Durch Weiberkunste, schwer zu kennen, By female arts, beyond our sharpest seeing, **Through female arts, hard to be seen**

Verstehen sie vom Sein den Schein zu trennen, They can divide the Appearance from the Being! **They separate Being from what's merely Seen**

Und jeder schwört, das sei das Sein. And all will swear the Being's there! **And everyone SWEARS the Seen must be the Been!**

Pause.

Faust

Den Wasserfraulein müssen unsre Raben Our ravens
must, with flattery beladen, **Our ravens must have
sweet-talked well**

Recht aus dem Grund geschmeichelt haben; Have
sweetly coaxed each winsome water-maiden; **Those
water-maidens under the spell**

Dort fangt es schon zu rieseln an. The trickling
streams at once descend. **Already it starts to
trickle down**

An mancher trocknen, kahlen Felsenstelle The bald
and rocky shoulders of the mountains **On many a
dry, bare rocky crown**

Entwickelt sich die volle, rasche Quelle; Give birth to
full and swiftly-flowing fountains; **A full swift spring
bursts from the earth**

Um jener Sieg ist es getan. Their victory is at an end.
For THEM down there—their victory's dearth

Mephistopheles

Das ist ein wunderbarer Gruss, To such reception
they're not used: **That's a wondrous greeting to
get!**

Die kühnsten Kletterer sind konfus. The boldest
climbers grow confused. **The boldest climbers are
confused and wet**

Faust

Schon rauscht ein Bach zu Bachen mächtig nieder,
Now brook roars down to brook with mighty bubble;
Brook roars mightily down to brooks below

Aus Schluchten kehren sie gedoppelt wieder, Then
from the mouths of glens they issue double, **From
gorges they return with doubled flow**

Ein Strom nun wirft den Bogenstrahl; And fling them-
selves, in arches, o'er the pale; **A stream hurls its
arching spray**

Auf einmal legt er sich in flache Felsenbreite Then sud-
denly spread along the rocky level, **Then spreads on
flat rock's display**

Und rauscht und schäumt nach der und jener Seite,
And to and fro foam onward in their revel, **Foaming,
roaring this way and that**

Und stufenweise wirft er sich ins Tal. As down a stair-
way hurled into the vale. **Step by step crashes to the
valley flat**

Was hilft ein tapfres, heldenmassiges Stemmen?
What boots their gallant, hero-like resistance? **What
good is brave heroic resistance there?**

Die mächtige Woge stromt, sie wegzuschwemmen.
The billow bursts, and bears them down the distance;
The mighty wave sweeps them off everywhere

Mir schaudert selbst vor solchem wilden Schwall. Be-
fore such wild uproar even I must quail. **Even I shud-
der at such wild flood's care**

Mephistopheles

Ich sehe nichts von diesen Wasserlugen, Nothing I see
of all this moist illusion; **I see NOTHING of these wa-
ter lies**

Nur Menschenaugen lassen sich betrogen, To human
eyes, alone, it brings confusion, **Only human eyes
fall for disguise**

Und mich ergetzt der wunderliche Fall. And in the
wondrous chance I take delight. **The wondrous
case delights my gut**

Sie stürzen fort zu ganzen Haufen, They fly in head-
long, hurried masses; **They rush away in heaps—
scared shut**

Die Narren wahren zu ersaufen, That they are drown-
ing, think the asses: **The fools think they're drown-
ing tonight**

Indem sie frei auf festem Lande schnaufen Though on
the solid land, they see an ocean, **While they gasp
free on solid ground's plight**

Und lacherlich mit Schwimmgebarden laufen. And
run absurdly with a swimming motion. **Running
ridiculously with swimming motion**

Nun ist Verwirrung überall. It is a most bewildering
plight. **Now confusion everywhere—quite a com-
motion!**

Die Raben sind wiedergekommen.

The ravens return.

Ich werd' euch bei dem hohen Meister loben; To the
high Master will I praise you duly; **I'll praise you to
the High Master well**

Wollt ihr euch nun als Meister selbst erproben, But
would you test yourselves as masters fully, **Want to
prove yourselves as masters? Do tell**

So eilet zu der gluhnden Schmiede, Then hasten
to that smithy eerie, **Then hurry to that glowing
smithy's place**

Wo das Gezwergvolk, nimmer mude, Where the
dwarf-people, never weary, **Where dwarf-folk,
never tired, keep pace**

Metall und Stein zu Funken schlägt. Hammer the
sparks from ore and stone. **Striking sparks from
metal and stone**

Verlangt, weitlaufig sie beschwatzend, Demand,
while there you prate and flatter, **Demand while
sweet-talking them—honeyed tone**

Ein Feuer, leuchtend, blinkend, platzend, A fire to
shine, and shoot, and scatter, **A fire of gleaming,
sparkling, bursting might**

Wie man's im hohen Sinne hegt. As in the highest
sense 'tis known. **As one conceives it in the highest
light**

Zwar Wetterleuchten in der weiten Ferne, 'Tis true
that distant lightning, quivering far-lights, **True,
distant heat lightning appears**

Blickschnelles Fallen allerhochster Sterne And falling,
quick as wink, of highest star-lights, **Quick-falling of
the highest spheres**

Mag jede Sommernacht geschehn; May happen any
summer night; **May happen any summer night's
arrears**

Doch Wetterleuchten in verworrenen Büschen But
lightning, loose among the tangled bushes, **But heat
lightning in tangled bushes' space**

Und Sterne, die am feuchten Boden zischen, And
stars that hiss and fizzle in the rushes, **And stars that
hiss on damp ground's face**

Das hat man nicht so leicht gesehn. Are shows that
seldom meet the sight. **That's not easily seen in
any place**

So musst ihr, ohn' euch viel zu qualen, Take no great
pains, you understand; **So without straining over-
much**

Zuvorderst bitten, dann befehlen. But first entreat,
and then command! **First beg, then command and
such**

(Raben ab. Es geschieht alles wie vorgeschrieben.)
(Exeunt the Ravens. All takes place as prescribed.)

Irrfunkenblick an allen Enden, Upon the foe falls
Night's thick curtain, **Will-o'-wisp glances on every
side**

Ein Leuchten, plötzlich zu verblenden! And step and march become uncertain! **A gleaming suddenly to blind**

Das alles ware wunderschön, In every quarter wandering blazes, **All that would be wonderfully grand**

Nun aber braucht's noch Schreckgeton. And sudden glare, that blinds and dazes! **But now we need TERROR-SOUND to stand**

Faust

Die hohlen Waffen aus der Sale Gruften All that seems fine; yet we should hear **The hollow weapons from vault halls of gloom**

Empfinden sich erstarkt in freien Luften; Their wild, commingled cries of fear. **Feel strengthened in free air's room**

Da droben klappert's, rasselt's lange schon, The hollow armour from the vaulted chambers **Up there it's rattled and clattered long**

Ein wunderbarer falscher Ton. In the free air its ancient strength remembers: **A wondrous false tone's lying song**

It rattles there, and clatters all around, –

A wonderful, a cheating sound.

Mephistopheles

Ganz recht! Sie sind nicht mehr zu zugen; Quite right!

The forms there's no restraining: **Quite right! No restraining them anymore**

Schon schallt's von ritterlichen Prugeln, Already knightly whacks are raining, **Already sounds the knightly whacking's roar**

Wie in der holden alten Zeit. As in the splendid times of old. **Like in the dear old days of yore**

Armschienen wie der Beine Schienen, The bracers there, as well as cuisses, **Arm-guards and leg-guards evermore**

Als Guelfen und als Ghibellinen, Are Guelfs and Ghibellines; and this is **As Guelphs and Ghibellines of old**

Erneuen rasch den ewigen Streit. Renewal of the feud they hold. **Quickly renew eternal strife untold**

Fest, im ererbten Sinne wohnlich, Firm in transmitted hate they anchor, **Firm in inherited sense, at home they feel**

Erweisen sie sich unversöhnlich; And show implacably their rancour: **Proving themselves irreconcilable with zeal**

Schon klingt das Tosen weit und breit. Now far and wide the noise hath rolled. **Already the roar sounds far and wide**

Zuletzt, bei allen Teufelsfesten, At last, the Devils find a hearty **In the end, at devil's feasts beside**

Wirkt der Parteihaß doch zum besten, Advantage in

the hate of Party, **Party hatred works out for the best**

Bis in den allerletzten Graus; Till dread and ruin end the tale: **Until the final horror-fest**

Schallt wider-widerwartig panisch, Repulsive sounds of rage and panic, **Echoes repulsively, panic's sound**

Mitunter grell und scharf satanisch, With others, piercing and Satanic, **Shrill and sharp, Satanic round**

Erschreckend in das Tal hinaus. Resound along the frightened vale! **Terrifying into the valley resound!**

Kriegerischer Tumult im Orchester, zuletzt ubergehend in militarisch heitre Weisen.

Warlike tumult in the Orchestra, finally passing into lively martial measures.

Des Gegenkaisers Zelt / The Rival Emperor's Tent

Act IV, Scene 3

Thron. Reiche Umgebung.

Throne: Rich Surroundings.

Habebald. Eilebeute.

Havequick. Speedbooty.

Eilebeute Speedbooty

So sind wir doch die ersten hier! O, we are here the first, I see! **So here we are, the first to score!**

Habebald Havequick

Kein Rabe fliegt so schnell als wir. No raven flies so swift as we. **No raven's ass could fly here faster.**

Eilebeute Speedbooty

O! welch ein Schatz liegt hier zuhauf! O, how the treasure-piles extend! **O! What a hoard lies heaped like whores!**

Wo fang' ich an? Wo hor' ich auf? Where shall I once begin? where end? **Where start? Where stop? I'm such a bastard.**

Habebald Havequick

Steht doch der ganze Raum so voll! But all the space is full! And now **The whole damn room is stuffed with swag!**

Weiss nicht, wozu ich greifen soll. I know not what to take, I vow! **Don't know which treasure makes me hardest.**

Eilebeute Speedbooty

Der Teppich war' mir eben recht, This carpet is the thing I need! **This carpet here would suit me fine –**

Mein Lager ist oft gar zu schlecht. My couch is often hard indeed. **My bed's been rough as a porcupine.**

Habebald Havequick

Hier hangt von Stahl ein Morgenstern, Here hangs a morning-star, so strong, **A morning-star of steel hangs here –**

Dergleichen hatt' ich lange gern. The like of which I've wanted long. **I've wanted one for half my year.**

Eilebeute Speedbooty

Den roten Mantel goldgesaumt, This crimson mantle, bound with gold, **This crimson cloak with golden seams!**

So etwas hatt' ich mir getraumt. Is like the one my dreams foretold. **It's everything from my wet dreams!**

Habebald (die Waffe nehmend) **Havequick** (taking the weapon)

Damit ist es gar bald getan, With this, a man is quickly sped; **With this, a man gets business done –**

Man schlägt ihn tot und geht voran. One strikes him dead, and goes ahead. **You whack him dead and off you run.**

Du hast so viel schon aufgepackt Thou art already laden so, **You've piled up so much useless crap,**

Und doch nichts Rechtes eingesackt. And nothing right thy sack can show. **And nothing good has filled your lap.**

Den Plunder lass an seinem Ort, This rubbish, rather, here forsake, **Leave all this junk right where it sits,**

Nehm' eines dieser Kistchen fort! And one of yonder caskets take! **And take one of those chest-like tits!**

Dies ist des Heers beschiedner Sold, The army's mod-

est pay they hold, **This holds the army's promised pay –**

In seinem Bauche lauter Gold. Their bellies full of purest gold. **Its belly's full of gold, I say!**

Eilebeute Speedbooty

Das hat ein morderisch Gewicht! O what a murderous weight is there! **O what a murderous weight this bears!**

Ich heb' es nicht, ich trag' es nicht. I cannot lift it, cannot bear. **Can't lift it up, can't drag it downstairs.**

Habebald Havequick

Geschwinde duck' dich! Musst dich bucken! Quick, bend and squat to take the pack! **Quick, squat down low and bend your back!**

Ich hucke dir's auf den starken Rucken. I'll heave it on thy sturdy back. **I'll heave it onto your sturdy rack.**

Eilebeute Speedbooty

O weh! O weh, nun ist's vorbei! O me! Alack! the burden slips: **O woe! O woe! Now I am done!**

Die Last bricht mir das Kreuz entzwei. The weight has crushed my back and hips. **My spine just cracked – weighed half a ton!**

Das Kistchen fällt und springt auf.

The chest falls and bursts open.

Habebald Havequick

Da liegt das rote Gold zuhauf – There lies the red gold in a heap! **There lies the red gold in a heap!**

Geschwinde zu und raff es auf! Quick, rake and take what thou canst keep! **Quick, rake and grab what you can keep!**

Eilebeute (kauert nieder) **Speedbooty** (crouching down)

Geschwinde nur zum Schoss hinein! Quick, let the booty fill my lap! **Quick, let it fill my apron's lap!**

Noch immer wird's zur Gnüge sein. 'Twill still be quite enough, mayhap. **Still plenty here, no need to flap.**

Habebald Havequick

Und so genug! und eile doch! So! there's enough! Now haste, and go! **Enough now! Hurry, time to split!**

(Sie steht auf.) (She rises.)

O weh, die Schurze hat ein Loch! The apron has a hole, ah woe! **O damn! The apron's sprung a slit!**

Wohin du gehst und wo du stehst, Wherever thou dost walk or stand, **Wherever you walk, wherever you stand,**

Verschwenderisch die Schätze sast. Thou sowest treasure on the land. **You scatter treasure across the land.**

Trabanten unsers Kaisers Guardsmen (of our Emperor)

Was schafft ihr hier am heiligen Platz? What seek ye here with wanton eyes? **What are you doing at this holy place?**

Was kramt ihr in dem Kaiserschatz? Ye rummage the Imperial prize! **You're rummaging the Emperor's private space!**

Habebald Havequick

Wir trugen unsre Glieder feil We hazarded our limbs for pay, **We risked our limbs to earn our pay –**

Und holen unser Beuteteil. And now we take our share of prey. **Now we're collecting our share of prey.**

In Feindeszelten ist's der Brauch, In hostile tents 'tis always so, **In enemy tents, that's how it's done!**

Und wir, Soldaten sind wir auch. And we are soldiers too, you know. **We're soldiers too, we're having fun!**

Trabanten Guardsmen

Das passet nicht in unsern Kreis: Among our troops he comes to grief **That doesn't fly in our regime –**

Zugleich Soldat und Diebsgeschmeiss; Who's both a soldier and a thief: **Part soldier, part of a thieving scheme.**

Und wer sich unserm Kaiser naht, Who serves our Em-

peror fair and free, **Whoever serves our Emperor true**

Der sei ein redlicher Soldat. Let him an honest soldier be! **Must be an honest soldier through!**

Habebald Havequick

Die Redlichkeit, die kennt man schon, O yes! such honesty we know: **Oh yes, we know your “honesty” –**

Sie heisset: Kontribution. 'Tis Contribution, – call it so! **It's called “Contribution” officially!**

Ihr alle seid auf gleichem Fuss: In the same mould you all are made: **You're all cut from the self-same cloth:**

Gib her! das ist der Handwerksgruss. “Give!” is the password of your trade. **“Hand it over!” – your solemn oath.**

(Zu Eilebeute) (To Speedbooty)

Mach fort und schleppe, was du hast, With what thou hast, the coast we'll clear: **Now scam with everything you've snagged –**

Hier sind wir nicht willkommenner Gast. As guests we are not welcome here. **We're clearly guests who shouldn't have gagged.**

(Beide ab.) (Exeunt.)

Erster Trabant First Guardsman

Sag, warum gabst du nicht sogleich Why didst thou not at once bestow **Why didn't you immediately smack**

Dem frechen Kerl einen Backenstreich? On the scamp's face a smashing blow? **That cheeky bastard right across his back?**

Zweiter Second

Ich weiss nicht, mir verging die Kraft, I know not, – had not strength to strike; **I don't know – all my strength just fled;**

Sie waren so gespensterhaft. They seemed to me so phantom-like. **They seemed like ghosts risen from the dead.**

Dritter Third

Mir ward es vor den Augen schlecht, Something there was disturbed my sight, – **Something went wrong before my eyes –**

Da flimmert' es, ich sah nicht recht. A flash: I could not see aright. **A flicker, flash – I couldn't recognize.**

Vierter Fourth

Wie ich es nicht zu sagen weiss: I, also, can declare it not: **I really cannot tell you how:**

Es war den ganzen Tag so heiss, The whole day long it was so hot, **The whole day long it was so hot somehow.**

So banglich, so beklommen schwul, So sultry, close,
and terrible; **So anxious, close, oppressively
weird,**

Der eine stand, der andre fiel, One man stood firm,
another fell; **One man stood firm, another disap-
peared.**

Man tappte hin und schlug zugleich, We groped and
fought, with valour rash, **We groped and struck
with clumsy might –**

Der Gegner fiel vor jedem Streich, The foemen fell at
every slash; **The enemy fell at every strike.**

Vor Augen schwebt' es wie ein Flor, Before one's eyes
there was a mist, **Before our eyes hung veils of
gauze,**

Dann summt's und saust's und zischt' im Ohr;
And something roared, and hummed, and hissed;
**Then humming, roaring, hissing buzz – like
menopause!**

Das ging so fort, nun sind wir da So to the end, and
here are we, **So on it went, and here we stand,**

Und wissen selbst nicht, wie's geschah. And how it
happened, cannot see. **And have no clue what we
just had in hand.**

Der Kaiser tritt auf mit vier Fursten. Die Trabanten ent-
fernen sich.

The Emperor enters, accompanied by Four Princes.
The Guardsmen retire.

Kaiser Emperor

Es sei nun, wie ihm sei! uns ist die Schlacht gewonnen,
Now fare he, as he may! For us is won the battle,
Now let it be as it may be! The battle's won for us!

Des Feinds zerstreute Flucht im flachen Feld zerronnen.
And o'er the plain the foe have fled like frightened cattle.
The enemy's scattered flight dissolved, without a fuss.

Hier steht der leere Thron, verraterischer Schatz,
The trait'rous treasure, here, the empty throne,
we've found, **Here stands the empty throne – the traitor's treasure-heap!**

Von Teppichen umhüllt, verengt umher den Platz.
That, hung with tapestry, contracts the space around.
With tapestries around, the space is rather steep.

Wir, ehrenvoll geschützt von eigenen Trabanten,
Enthroned in honour we, true guardsmen us protecting,
We, honorably guarded by our loyal guardsmen here,

Erwarten kaiserlich der Volker Abgesandten; The
people's envoys are imperially expecting. **Imperially await the envoys drawing near.**

Von allen Seiten her kommt frohe Botschaft an: The
messengers of joy arrive from every side, **From every side arrives glad news upon the breeze:**

Beruhigt sei das Reich, uns freudig zugetan. And,
loyal now to us, the realm is pacified. **The realm is
pacified, and eager now to please!**

Hat sich in unsern Kampf auch Gaukelei geflochten,
Though in our fight, perchance, some jugglery was
woven, **Though in our fight some jugglery may
have been woven in,**

Am Ende haben wir uns nur allein gefochten. Yet, at
the last, our own unaided strength we've proven. **In
the end, we fought alone – that's how we win!**

Zufalle kommen ja dem Streitenden zugut: True,
accidents sometimes for combatants are good;
**Accidents sometimes aid the man who's in a
fight:**

Vom Himmel fällt ein Stein, dem Feinde regnet's Blut,
A stone may fall from heaven, on foes a shower of
blood; **A stone may fall from heaven, on foes rain
blood at night.**

Aus Felsenhöhlen tont's von mächtigen Wunderklan-
gen, From rocky caves may ring tremendous strains
of wonder, **From rocky caves resound tremendous
wondrous songs**

Die unsre Brust erhohn, des Feindes Brust verengen.
That lift our hearts with faith, and drive the foe asun-
der. **That lift our hearts up high and crush the en-
emy throngs.**

Der überwundne fiel, zu stets erneutem Spott, The
Conquered yielded, scourged by Scorn's immortal

rod; **The conquered fell, to everlasting scorn's new jest;**

Der Sieger, wie er prangt, preist den gewognen Gott.
The Victor, as he boasts, exalts the favouring God; **The victor, as he struts, praises God who blessed!**

Und alles stimmt mit ein, er braucht nicht zu befehlen,
And all responsive shout, unordered, unentreated:
And all join in – he need not even give commands:

Herr Gott, dich loben wir! aus Millionen Kehlen. "We praise Thee, God our Lord!" from million throats repeated. **"We praise Thee, Lord our God!" from a million singing hands.**

Jedoch zum höchsten Preis wend' ich den frommen Blick, Yet as the highest praise, so rarely else expressed, **Yet for the highest praise, I turn my pious eye**

Das selten sonst geschah, zur eignen Brust zurück. I turn my pious glance on mine own grateful breast. **Back to my own breast – rare as a virgin's thigh.**

Ein junger, munt'rer Furst mag seinen Tag vergeuden,
A young and lively Prince may give his days to pleasure; **A young and lively prince may waste his days on fun;**

Die Jahre lehren ihn des Augenblicks Bedeuten. Him teach the years, at last the moment's use to measure. **The years teach him: each moment matters, every one.**

Deshalb denn ungesäumt verbind' ich mich sogleich

Therefore, without delay, I call ye, for support, **Therefore without delay I bind myself to you,**

Mit euch vier Wurdigen, fur Haus und Hof und Reich.
Beside me, worthy Four, in realm and house and court. **Four Worthy ones, for House and Court and Empire true.**

(Zum Ersten) (To the First)

Dein war, o Furst! des Heers geordnet kluge Schichtung, Thine was, O Prince! the host's arrangement, wise inspection, **Yours was, O Prince, the army's wise deployment,**

Sodann im Hauptmoment heroisch kühne Richtung;
Then, in the nick of time, heroic, bold direction: **Then at the crucial moment, bold enjoyment!**

Im Frieden wirke nun, wie es die Zeit begehrt, Act now in peace, as Time thine offices may show! **In peace now work as Time makes its demands –**

Erzmarschall nenn' ich dich, verleihe dir das Schwert.
Arch-Marshal shalt thou be: the sword I here bestow. **Arch-Marshal I name you, sword placed in your hands!**

Erzmarschall Arch-Marshal

Dein treues Heer, bis jetzt im Innern beschäftigt, Thy faithful host, till now employed for civil order, **Your faithful host, till now for civil order raised,**

Wenn's dich und deinen Thron an der Grenze

bekraftigt: Thee and thy throne secured, shall strengthen next thy border: **Securing you and throne, shall guard the border, praised.**

Dann sei es uns vergonnt, bei Festesdrang im Saal
Then let us be allowed, when festal throngs are poured
Then let us be allowed, when festive crowds fill the hall

Geraumiger Vaterburg zu rusten dir das Mahl.
Through thine ancestral halls, to dress for thee the board. **Of your ancestral castle, to prepare your banquet call!**

Blank trag' ich's dir dann vor, blank halt' ich dir's zur Seite,
Before thee brightly borne, and brightly held beside thee, **Bright I'll bear it before you, bright keep it at your side,**

Der höchsten Majestat zu ewigem Geleite. Thy Majesty's support, the sword shall guard and guide thee! **Forever escorting your Majesty with pride!**

Kaiser (zum Zweiten) **Emperor** (to the Second)

Der sich als tapfrer Mann auch zart gefällig zeigt, He who as gallant man can also gracious be, **He who's a gallant man yet shows a graceful touch –**

Du! sei Erzkammerer; der Auftrag ist nicht leicht. Thou, – be Arch-Chamberlain! – not light the place, for thee. **You! Be Arch-Chamberlain – the task is quite a clutch!**

Du bist der Oberste von allem Hausgesinde, Thou art the highest now of all the house-retainers **You're**

now supreme over all the household pack,

Bei deren innerm Streit ich schlechte Diener finde;
Whose strife makes service bad, – the threateners and
complainers: **Whose inner strife makes servants
lazy and slack.**

Dein Beispiel sei fortan in Ehren aufgestellt, Let thy ex-
ample be an honoured sign to these, **Let your exam-
ple be a beacon raised on high,**

Wie man dem Herrn, dem Hof und allen wohlgefallt.
How they the Prince and Court, and all, should seek
to please! **Showing how to please lord and court,
by and by!**

Erzkammerer Arch-Chamberlain

Des Herren grossen Sinn zu fordern, bringt zu
Gnaden: To speed thy high design, thy grace is fair
precursor: **To further your great purpose brings
me into grace:**

Den Besten hilfreich sein, den Schlechten selbst
nicht schaden, The Better to assist, and injure not
the Worser, – **Help the better ones, don't harm
the worse – save face!**

Dann klar sein ohne List und ruhig ohne Trug! Be
frank, yet cunning not, and calm without deceit! **Be
clear without deceit, calm without a lie –**

Wenn du mich, Herr, durchschaust, geschieht mir
schon genug. If thou but read my heart, I'm honoured
as is meet. **If you see through me, Lord, that's
satisfaction I can't deny!**

Darf sich die Phantasie auf jenes Fest erstrecken? But
let my fancy now to festal service hasten! **May my
imagination stretch to that festive day?**

Wenn du zur Tafel gehst, reich' ich das goldne
Becken, Thou goest to the board, I bear the golden
basin, **When you go to table, I'll bring the golden
tray,**

Die Ringe halt' ich dir, damit zur Wonnezeit And hold
thy rings for thee, that on such blissful days **And hold
your rings for you, so in that blissful hour**

Sich deine Hand erfrischt, wie mich dein Blick erfreut.
Thy hands may be refreshed, as I beneath thy gaze.
**Your hand refreshes as I bask beneath your
power!**

Kaiser Emperor

Zwar fühl' ich mich zu ernst, auf Festlichkeit zu sinnen,
Too serious am I still, to plan such celebration; **I feel
too serious still to plan festivities –**

Doch sei's! Es fordert auch frohmütiges Beginnen. Yet
be it so! We need a glad inauguration. **Yet be it so!
We need glad ceremonies to appease.**

(Zum Dritten) (To the Third)

Dich wahl' ich zum Erztruchsess! Also sei fortan I
choose thee Arch-High-Steward! Therefore hence-
forth be **I choose you Arch-High-Steward! From
now on, let there be**

Dir Jagd, Geflügehof und Vorwerk untertan; Chase,

poultry-yard, and manor subject unto thee! **Hunt, poultry-yard, and manor subject unto thee!**

Der Lieblingsspeisen Wahl lass mir zu allen Zeiten,
Give me at all times choice of dishes I delight in, **Give me my favorite dishes every time I dine,**

Wie sie der Monat bringt, und sorgsam zubereiten. As
with the month they come, and cooked with appetite
in! **As seasons bring them round, prepared and tasting fine!**

Erztruchsess Arch-High-Steward

Streng Fasten sei für mich die angenehmste Pflicht, A
rigid fast shall be the penalty I wish, **Strict fasting shall become my most pleasant duty here –**

Bis, vor dich hingestellt, dich freut ein Wohlgericht.
Until before thee stands a goodly-savoured dish.
Until before you stands a dish you'll want to smear.

Der Küche Dienerschaft soll sich mit mir vereinigen,
The kitchen-folk shall join, and gladly heed my reasons **The kitchen staff shall join with me in harmony**

Das Ferne beizuziehn, die Jahrszeit zu beschleunigen. To bring the distant near and expedite the seasons. **To bring what's far nearby and speed the seasons' spree!**

Dich reizt nicht Fern und Früh, womit die Tafel prangt,
Yet rare and early things shall not delight thee long:

Yet rare and early things won't tickle you for long:

Einfach und kraftig ist's, wornach dein Sinn verlangt.
Thy taste desires, instead, the simple and the strong.
You want it simple, hearty – nothing fancy, nothing wrong.

Kaiser (zum Vierten) **Emperor** (to the Fourth)

Weil unausweichlich hier sich's nur von Festen handelt,
Since here, perforce, we plan but feasts, and each is sharer,
Since unavoidably we're dealing just with feasts,

So sei mir, junger Held, zum Schenken umgewandelt.
Be thou for me transformed, young hero, to Cup-bearer!
You, young hero, transform to Cup-Bearer at least!

Erzschenke, Sorge nun, dass unsre Kellerei Arch Cup-Bearer,
take heed, that all those vaults of mine **Arch Cup-Bearer, take care that our cellar stocks**

Aufs reichlichste versorgt mit gutem Weine sei. Richly
replenished be with noblest taps of wine! **Are most abundantly supplied with wine that rocks!**

Du selbst sei massig, lass nicht über Heiterkeiten Be
temperate thyself, how'er temptation presses, **Be temperate yourself – don't let the merriment**

Durch der Gelegenheit Verlocken dich verleiten! Nor
let occasion's lure mislead thee to excesses! **And opportunity's temptations make you bent!**

Erzschenk Arch Cup-Bearer

Mein Furst, die Jugend selbst, wenn man ihr nur vertraut, My Prince, the young themselves, if trust in them be shown, **My Prince, the young themselves, if given trust their due,**

Steht, eh' man sich's versieht, zu Mannern auferbaut. Are, ere one looks around, already men full-grown. **Grow into proper men before you can say "boo!"**

Auch ich versetze mich zu jenem grossen Feste; I at the lordly feast shall also take my station, **I too will take my station at that grand affair –**

Ein kaiserlich Bufett schmuck' ich aufs allerbeste And give thy sideboard's pomp the noblest decoration **The Emperor's buffet I'll deck with utmost care,**

Mit Prachtgefassen, gulden, silbern allzumal, Of gorgeous vessels, golden, silver, grand to see; **With gorgeous vessels, golden, silver, all in rows –**

Doch wahl' ich dir voraus den lieblichsten Pokal: Yet first the fairest cup will I select for thee, – **Yet first the fairest cup for you I shall propose:**

Ein blank venedisch Glas, worin Behagen lauschet, A clear Venetian glass, good cheer within it waiting, **A bright Venetian glass, where comfort lies in wait,**

Des Weins Geschmack sich starkt und nimmermehr berauschet. Helping the taste of wine, yet ne'er intoxicating. **That strengthens wine's good taste and never inebriates!**

Auf solchen Wunderschatz vertraut man oft zu sehr;
One oft confides too much on such a treasured store:
One often trusts too much in such a wondrous store –

Doch deine Massigkeit, du Hochster, schützt noch mehr. Thy moderation, though, High Lord, protects thee more. **But your moderation, High Lord, protects you more!**

Kaiser Emperor

Was ich euch zuggedacht in dieser ernsten Stunde,
What, in this earnest hour, for you have I intended,
What I've intended for you in this earnest hour,

Vernahmt ihr mit Vertraun aus zuverlässigem Munde.
From valid mouth confidingly you've comprehended.
You've heard with confidence from my mouth of power.

Des Kaisers Wort ist gross und sichert jede Gift, The
Emperor's word is great, his gift is therefore sure, **The
Emperor's word is great, it makes each gift se-
cure –**

Doch zur Bekräftigung bedarf's der edlen Schrift, But
needs, for proper force, his written signature: **But it
needs noble writing to make it endure,**

Bedarf's der Signatur. Die formlich zu bereiten, The
high sign-manual fails. Here, for commission needful,
Needs the signature. To prepare it with due form,

Seh' ich den rechten Mann zu rechter Stunde schre-
iten. I see the right man come, of the right moment

heedful. **I see the right man come through the right moment's storm.**

Der Erzbischof-Erzkanzler tritt auf.

The Archbishop-Arch-Chancellor enters.

Kaiser Emperor

Wenn ein Gewölbe sich dem Schlussstein anvertraut,
If in the keystone of the arch the vault confide, **When
a vault entrusts itself to its keystone's embrace,**

Dann ist's mit Sicherheit für ewige Zeit erbaut. 'Tis
then securely built, for endless time and tide. **It's
built securely then for all time and space.**

Du siehst vier Fürsten da! Wir haben erst erörtert,
Thou seest Four Princes here! To them we've just
expounded **You see Four Princes here! We've just
laid out the plan**

Was den Bestand zunächst von Haus und Hof be-
fordert. How next our House and Court shall be
more stably founded. **For House and Court's
foundations – best we can.**

Nun aber, was das Reich in seinem Ganzen hegt, Now,
all the realm contains, within its bounds enclosed,
**Now all the realm contains, within its borders
penned,**

Sei, mit Gewicht und Kraft, der Funfzahl auferlegt.
Shall be, with weight and power, upon Ye Five im-

posed! **Shall be, with weight and power, to you
Five to tend!**

An Landern sollen sie vor allen andern glanzen; Your
landed wealth shall be before all others splendid; **In
lands you shall shine brighter than all the rest –**

Deshalb erweitr' ich gleich jetzt des Besitztums Gren-
zen Therefore at once have I your properties extended
Therefore I've extended your estates, the best,

Vom Erbteil jener, die sich von uns abgewandt. From
their inheritance, who raised 'gainst us the hand.
**From the inheritance of those who raised their
hand!**

Euch Treuen sprech' ich zu so manches schöne Land,
You I award, ye Faithful, many a lovely land, **To you,
the Faithful, I award many a lovely land,**

Zugleich das hohe Recht, euch nach Gelegenheiten
Together with the right, as you may have occasion,
Together with the right, as opportunity is lent,

Durch Anfall, Kauf und Tausch ins Weit're zu verbrei-
ten; To spread them by exchange, or purchase, or in-
vasion: **To spread by purchase, trade, or – acci-
dent!**

Dann sei bestimmt – vergonnt, zu uben ungestört –,
Then be it clearly fixed, that you unhindered use **Then
be it clearly fixed: you freely may apply**

Was von Gerechtsamen euch Landesherrn gehort.
Whate'er prerogatives have been the landlord's dues.
Whatever landlord's prerogatives lie nearby.

Als Richter werdet ihr die Endurteile fallen, When ye,
as Judges, have the final sentence spoken, **As judges
you shall speak the final word of law –**

Berufung gelte nicht von euern höchsten Stellen. By
no appeal from your high Court shall it be broken;
From your high courts no appeal shall draw!

Dann Steuer, Zins und Beth', Lehn und Geleit und Zoll,
Then levies, tax and rent, pass-money, tolls and fees
Levies, tax and rent, tolls, escort fees and such,

Berg-, Salz- und Munzregal euch angehören soll. Are
yours, – of mines and salt and coin the royalties.
**Mine, salt, and coinage rights – you'll control all
this much.**

Denn meine Dankbarkeit vollgültig zu erproben, That
thus my gratitude may validly be stated, **That thus
my gratitude may fully be displayed,**

Hab ich euch ganz zunächst der Majestät erhoben.
You next to Majesty hereby I've elevated. **I've raised
you next to Majesty – quite the upgrade!**

Erzbischof Archbishop

Im Namen aller sei dir tiefster Dank gebracht! In deep-
est thanks to thee we humbly all unite: **In deepest
thanks we humbly all unite to say:**

Du machst uns stark und fest und starkest deine
Macht. Thou mak'st us strong and sure, and strength-
enest thy might. **You make us strong and sure, and
strengthen your own sway!**

Kaiser Emperor

Euch funfen will ich noch erhohtere Wurde geben. Yet
higher dignities I give for your fulfilling. **Yet higher
dignities I give you to fulfill –**

Noch leb' ich meinem Reich und habe Lust, zu leben;
Still for my realm I live, and still to live am willing; **Still
for my realm I live, and live I surely will!**

Doch hoher Ahnen Kette zieht bedachtigen Blick Yet
old ancestral lines compel the prudent mind **Yet old
ancestral chains draw the prudent mind**

Aus rascher Strebsamkeit ins Drohende zuruck. To
look from present deeds to that which looms behind.
From present rashness to what looms behind.

Auch werd' ich seinerzeit mich von den Teuren tren-
nen, I, also, in my time, must meet the sure Redresser;
I too shall someday part from those I hold so dear
–

Dann sei es eure Pflicht, den Folger zu ernennen. Your
duty be it, then, to choose me a successor. **Then be
your duty to name my successor here!**

Gekront erhebt ihn hoch auf heiligem Altar, Crowned,
at the altar raise his consecrated form, **Crowned, at
the altar raise his consecrated head,**

Und friedlich ende dann, was jetzt so sturmisch war.
That so may end in peace what here began in storm!
And peacefully shall end what stormily was led!

Erzkanzler Arch-Chancellor

Mit Stolz in tiefster Brust, mit Demut an Gebarde, With
pride profound, yet humbly, as our guise evinces,
**With pride profound, yet humble in our stance
displayed,**

Stehn Fursten dir gebeugt, die ersten auf der Erde.
Behold, before thee bowed, the first of earthly
princes! **Stand princes bowed, the first ones
Earth has ever made!**

Solang das treue Blut die vollen Adern regt, So long
the faithful blood our living veins shall fill, **So long as
faithful blood flows through our living veins,**

Sind wir der Korper, den dein Wille leicht bewegt. We
are the body which obeys thy lightest will. **We are the
body that your will's light touch explains.**

Kaiser Emperor

Und also sei, zum Schluss, was wir bisher betatigt,
Now, to conclude, let all that we have here asserted,
To conclude, let all we've here affirmed today

Fur alle Folgezeit durch Schrift und Zug bestatigt. Be,
for the future time, to document converted! **Be con-
firmed in writing for all future sway!**

Zwar habt ihr den Besitz als Herren vollig frei, 'Tis
true that ye, as lords, have your possession free,
**True, you as lords possess your holdings free and
wide,**

Mit dem Beding jedoch, dass er unteilbar sei. With
this condition, though, that it unparcelled be; **With
this condition though: they cannot be divided.**

Und wie ihr auch vermehrt, was ihr von uns empfangen, And what ye have from us, howe'er ye swell the treasure, **And what you have from us, however much you add,**

Es soll's der altste Sohn in gleichem Mass erlangen. Shall to the eldest son descend in equal measure. **Shall to the eldest son descend – the same as dad!**

Erzkanzler Arch-Chancellor

Dem Pergament alsbald vertrau' ich wohlgemut, On parchment I, at once, shall gladly tabulate, **On parchment I at once shall happily inscribe –**

Zum Glück dem Reich und uns, das wichtigste Statut; To bless the realm and us, the statute of such weight: **For realm and us alike – this statute's crucial vibe.**

Reinschrift und Sieglung soll die Kanzelei beschafften, The copy and the seals the Chancery shall procure us, **The copy and the seals the Chancery shall prepare;**

Mit heiliger Signatur wirst du's, der Herr, bekräftigen. Thy sacred hand shall then validity assure us. **Your sacred signature shall validate it there!**

Kaiser Emperor

Und so entlass' ich euch, damit den grossen Tag Dismissal now I grant, that you, assembled, may **So I dismiss you now, that everyone may weigh**

Gesammelt jedermann sich uberlegen mag. Deliberate upon the great, important day. **In quiet contemplation this momentous day.**

Die weltlichen Fursten entfernen sich.

The Secular Princes retire.

Der Geistliche (bleibt und spricht pathetisch) **Archbishop** (remains and speaks pathetically)

Der Kanzler ging hinweg, der Bischof ist geblieben,
The Chancellor withdrew, the Bishop stands before thee: **The Chancellor withdrew, the Bishop stays with you –**

Vom ernsten Warnegeist zu deinem Ohr getrieben! A warning spirit bids that straightway he implore thee: **A warning spirit drives him to speak what's true!**

Sein vaterliches Herz, von Sorge bangt's um dich.
His heart paternal quakes with anxious fear for thee. **His fatherly heart trembles with anxious fear for thee.**

Kaiser Emperor

Was hast du Bangliches zur frohen Stunde? sprich!
In this glad hour what may thy dread misgiving be? **What dread in this glad hour? Speak your misery!**

Erzbischof Archbishop

Mit welchem bitteren Schmerz find' ich, in dieser Stunde, Alas, in such an hour, how much my pain

must greaten, **With what bitter pain I find, at such a time,**

Dein hochgeheiligt Haupt mit Satanas im Bunde! To find thy hallowed head in covenant with Satan! **Your sacred head bound up with Satan's grime!**

Zwar, wie es scheinen will, gesichert auf dem Thron, True, to the throne, it seems, hast thou secured thy right; **True, to the throne it seems you've secured your right –**

Doch leider! Gott dem Herrn, dem Vater Papst zum Hohn. But, woe! in God the Lord's, the Holy Pontiff's spite. **But alas! In spite of God and Holy Pontiff's might!**

Wenn dieser es erfahrt, schnell wird er straflich richten, Swift shall he punish when he learns the truth – the latter: **When he learns this, swift punishment he'll render –**

Mit heiligem Strahl dein Reich, das sundige, zu vernichten. Thy sinful realm at once with holy ban he'll shatter! **With holy lightning strike your sinful realm to cinder!**

Denn noch vergass er nicht, wie du, zur höchsten Zeit, He still remembers how, amid thy highest state, **He still recalls how you, in your highest state,**

An deinem Kronungstag, den Zauberer befreit. When newly crowned, thou didst the wizard liberate. **On coronation day, set the wizard liberate!**

Von deinem Diadem, der Christenheit zum Schaden,

Thy diadem but made thy heart for Christians harden,
From your diadem – Christians' bane and loss –

Traf das verfluchte Haupt der erste Strahl der Gnaden.
For on that head accurst fell its first beam of pardon.
That cursed head received the first beam of grace across!

Doch schlag an deine Brust und gib vom frevlen Gluck
Now beat thy breast, and from thy guilty stores, this
day, **Now beat your breast and from your guilty pile today**

Ein massig Scherflein gleich dem Heiligtum zuruck:
Unto the Sanctuary a moderate mite repay! **Return a moderate mite to the Sanctuary's sway!**

Den breiten Hugelraum, da, wo dein Zelt gestanden,
The spacious sweep of hills, where stood thy tent
erected, – **The spacious sweep of hills where your tent once stood –**

Wo bose Geister sich zu deinem Schutz verbanden,
Where Evil Spirits then, united, thee protected, –
Where Evil Spirits joined to do you good –

Dem Lugenfursten du ein horchsam Ohr geliehn,
Where late the Liar-Prince thy hearing did secure, –
Where you lent the Liar-Prince an attentive ear:

Den stifte, fromm belehrt, zu heiligem Bemuhn; De-
vote thou, meekly taught, to pious use and pure, **De-
vote it, meekly taught, to holy purpose dear!**

Mit Berg und dichtem Wald, so weit sie sich er-
strecken, With hill and forest dense, far as they

stretch extended, **With hill and forest dense, as far as they extend,**

Mit Hohen, die sich grün zu fetter Weide decken, And slopes that greenly swell for pastures never ended, **With slopes that green to fatty pastures bend,**

Fischreichen, klaren Seen, dann Bachlein ohne Zahl, Then crystal lakes of fish, unnumbered brooks that flow **Fish-rich crystal lakes, and brooks beyond all count,**

Wie sie sich, eilig schlängelnd, stürzen ab zu Tal; In foamy windings down, and braid the vale below; **That serpent-swift go tumbling down the mount!**

Das breite Tal dann selbst, mit Wiesen, Gauen, Grunden: The broad vale then, itself, with mead, and lawn, and hollow! **The broad vale too, with meadows, dales, and grounds –**

Die Reue spricht sich aus, und du wirst Gnade finden. Thus penitence is shown, and pardon soon shall follow. **Thus penitence speaks out, and pardon then resounds!**

Kaiser Emperor

Durch meinen schweren Fehl bin ich so tief erschreckt: For this, my heavy sins, my terror is profound: **By my grave sin I'm terrified this much:**

Die Grenze sei von dir nach deinem Sinn gesteckt.

By thine own measure shalt thou draw the borders round. **You draw the borders yourself – your holy touch!**

Erzbischof Archbishop

Erst! der entweihte Raum, wo man sich so versündigt,
First be the spot profane, where sin was perpetrated,
First! Let the profaned space where sin was wrought

Sei alsobald zum Dienst des Hochsten angekündigt.
To God's high service soon and wholly dedicated! **Be soon to God's high service brought!**

Behende steigt im Geist Gemauer stark empor, With
speed the walls arise to meet the mind's desire; **In spirit, sturdy walls rise swift and strong –**

Der Morgensonne Blick erleuchtet schon das Chor,
The rising morning sun already lights the choir; **The morning sun's first glance lights the choir along!**

Zum Kreuz erweitert sich das wachsende Gebaude,
The growing structure spreads, the transept stands exalted; **The growing structure stretches to a cross's shape,**

Das Schiff erlangt, erhöht sich zu der Glaubigen Freude;
Joy of Believers, then, the nave is lifted, vaulted; **The nave extends and lifts – believers agape!**

Sie stromen brünstig schon durchs würdige Portal,
And while they press with zeal within the portals

grand, **They stream in ardently through portals
grand and fair –**

Der erste Glockenruf erscholl durch Berg und Tal, The
first clear call of bells is swept across the land, **The
first bell-call resounds through valley and moun-
tain air,**

Von hohen Turmen tont's, wie sie zum Himmel
streben, Pealed from the lofty towers that heaven-
wards have striven: **From towers high that strive
toward heaven's door –**

Der Busser kommt heran zu neugeschaffnem Leben.
The penitent draws near, new life to him is given. **The
penitent approaches life reborn once more!**

Dem hohen Weihetag – er trete bald herein! – The
consecration-day – O, may it soon be sent! – **The con-
secration day – may it soon arrive! –**

Wird deine Gegenwart die höchste Zierde sein. Thy
presence then shall be the highest ornament. **Your
presence there shall be the highest thing alive!**

Kaiser Emperor

Mag ein so grosses Werk den frommen Sinn verkündi-
gen, So great a work shall be my pious proclamation
May so great a work my pious heart proclaim,

Zu preisen Gott den Herrn, so wie mich zu entsundi-
gen. To praise the Lord our God, and work mine expi-
ation. **To praise the Lord our God and cleanse my
shame!**

Genug! Ich fühle schon, wie sich mein Sinn erhoht.
Enough! I feel, e'en now, how high my thoughts aspire. **Enough! I feel already how my soul takes flight!**

Erzbischof Archbishop

Als Kanzler fordr' ich nun Schluss und Formalitat. As
Chancellor, next, the formal treaty I require. **As Chancellor, I now require proper form and rite.**

Kaiser Emperor

Ein formlich Dokument, der Kirche das zu eignen, A
formal document, – the Church needs full requital, **A formal document – the Church needs satisfaction**

–

Du legst es vor, ich will's mit Freuden unterzeichnen.
Bring it to me, and I with joy will sign her title! **Bring it to me! I'll sign with joyful action!**

Erzbischof (hat sich beurlaubt, kehrt aber beim
Abgehn noch einmal um) **Archbishop** (has taken
leave, but turns back again at the door)

Dann widmest du zugleich dem Werke, wie's entsteht,
At once unto the work devote, that it may stand, **Then dedicate at once, for the work as it grows,**

Gesamte Landsgefalle: Zehnten, Zinsen, Beth',
Tithes, levies, tax, – the total income of the land, **All regional revenues – tithes, interest, those –**

Für ewig. Viel bedarf's zu würdiger Unterhaltung, For

ever. Much it needs, to be supported fairly, **Forever!**
Much it needs for worthy maintenance,

Und schwere Kosten macht die sorgliche Verwaltung.
And careful maintenance will also cost us rarely: **And**
heavy costs accrue from careful surveillance.

Zum schnellen Aufbau selbst auf solchem wusten
Platz And, that it soon be built, on such a lonesome
wold, **For quick construction on such a wasteland**
site,

Reichst du uns einiges Gold, aus deinem Beuteschatz.
Thou'lt from thy booty spare to us some little gold.
From your booty you'll spare us gold – just a
slight!

Daneben braucht man auch, ich kann es nicht ver-
schweigen, Moreover, we shall want – here, most,
we claim assistance – **Moreover we shall need – I**
cannot hide this fact –

Entferntes Holz und Kalk und Schiefer und dergle-
ichen. Lumber, and lime, and slate, and suchlike,
from a distance. **Distant timber, lime, and slate,**
exact.

Die Fuhren tut das Volk, vom Predigtstuhl belehrt,
The people these shall haul, thus from the pulpit
taught; **The people will haul these, from the**
pulpit told –

Die Kirche segnet den, der ihr zu Diensten fährt. The
Church shall bless the man, whose team for her has
wrought. **The Church blesses whoever helps her**

household!

(Ab.) (Exit.)

Kaiser Emperor

Die Sund' ist gross und schwer, womit ich mich beladen; The sin is very sore, wherewith my soul is weighted: **The sin is grave and sore with which I'm weighted down –**

Das leidige Zaubervolk bringt mich in harten Schaden. Much damage unto me the Sorcerers have created. **The wretched magic-folk have cost me crown after crown!**

Erzbischof (nochmals zuruckkehrend, mit tiefster Verbeugung) **Archbishop** (returning once again, with profoundest genuflections)

Verzeih, o Herr! Es ward dem sehr verrufnen Mann Pardon, O Prince! to him, that vile, notorious man, **Forgive, O Lord! That very notorious man –**

Des Reiches Strand verliehn; doch diesen trifft der Bann, The Empire's coast was given; but him shall smite the ban, **The Empire's coast was given him! But the ban**

Verleihst du reuig nicht der hohen Kirchenstelle Unless thy penitence the Church's wrath relaxes **Shall strike, unless your penitence makes room**

Auch dort den Zehnten, Zins und Gaben und Gefalle. There, too, with tithes and gifts, and revenues and taxes. **For tithes and gifts and revenues to bloom!**

Kaiser (verdrießlich) **Emperor** (ill-humouredly)

Das Land ist noch nicht da, im Meer liegt es breit. The land doth not exist: far in the sea it lies. **The land's not even there – it's floating in the sea!**

Erzbischof Archbishop

Wer's Recht hat und Geduld, fur den kommt auch die Zeit. Who patient is, and right, his day shall yet arise. **Who has the right and patience, his day comes eventually!**

Fur uns mog' Euer Wort in seinen Kraften bleiben! Your word for us remains, and makes secure our trover! **May your word for us remain in all its power!**

(Ab.) (Exit.)

Kaiser (allein) **Emperor** (solus)

So konnt' ich wohl zunachst das ganze Reich verschreiben. I might as well, at last, make all the Empire over! **I might as well sign over the whole Empire this hour!**

Fünfter Akt / Act V

Offene Gegend / Open Country

Wandrer Wanderer

Ja! sie sind's, die dunkeln Linden,

Yes! 'tis they, the dusky lindens;

Yes! They're them, the dark lindens,

Dort, in ihres Alters Kraft.

There they stand in sturdy age:

Holy shit, the trees are still here,

Und ich soll sie wiederfinden,

And again shall I behold them,

Standing thick in their old strength.

Nach so langer Wanderschaft!

After such a pilgrimage?

I actually found them again

Ist es doch die alte Stelle,

'Tis the ancient place, the drifted

After all this wandering.

Jene Hutte, die mich barg,

Downs, the hut that sheltered me,

It is still the old place,

Als die sturmerregte Welle

When the billow, storm-uplifted,

That hut that held my body safe,

Mich an jene Dunen warf!

Hurled me shoreward from the sea!

When the storm-crazed waves

Meine Wirte mocht' ich segnen,

Here with blessing would I greet them,

Spat me onto these dunes.

Hilfsbereit, ein wackres Paar,

They, my hosts, the helpful pair,–

My hosts I would like to bless,

Das, um heut mir zu begegnen,

Old, indeed, if now I meet them,

Ready to help, a solid couple,

Alt schon jener Tage war.

Since they then had hoary hair.

Who, to meet me today,

Ach! das waren fromme Leute!

Pious folk, from whom I parted!

Were already ancient back then.

Poch' ich? ruf' ich? – Seid gegrusst,

Be my greeting here renewed,

Oh! Those were good people!

Wenn gastfreundlich auch noch heute

If ye still, as open-hearted,

Should I knock? Should I yell? Greetings!

Ihr des Wohltuns Gluck genießt!

Taste the bliss of doing good!

If hospitably still today

Baucis

Lieber Kommling! Leise! Leise!

Gently, stranger! lest thou cumber

You enjoy doing good deeds!

Ruhe! lass den Gatten ruhn!

Rest, whereof my spouse hath need!

Dear stranger! Softly! Softly!

Langer Schlaf verleiht dem Greise

He but gains from longest slumber

Quiet! Let the old man rest!

Kurzen Wachens rasches Tun.

Strength for briefest waking deed.

Long sleep gives the geezer

Wandrer

Sage, Mutter: bist du's eben,

Tell me, mother, art thou even

Short bursts of waking action.

Meinen Dank noch zu empfahn,

She, to whom my thanks I bear,—

Tell me, mother, are you the one

Was du fur des Junglings Leben

I, the youth, whose life was given

Still here to receive my thanks,

Mit dem Gatten einst getan?

By your kind, united care?

For what you did for my young life

Bist du Baucis, die geschäftig

Art thou Baucis, who the coldly

Together with your husband?

Halberstorbenen Mund erquicket?

Fading mouth refreshment gave?

Are you Baucis, who busily

Du Philemon, der so kraftig

Thou, Philemon, who so boldly

Revived my half-dead mouth?

Meinen Schatz der Flut entrückt?

Drew my treasure from the wave?

You Philemon, who so strongly

Eure Flammen raschen Feuers,

From your fire, so quickly burning,

Pulled my treasure from the flood?

Eures Glockchens Silberlaut,

From your silver-sounding bell,

Your quick-burning flames,

Jenes grausen Abenteuers

Changed my doom, to fortune turning,

Your little bell's silver sound,

Losung war euch anvertraut.

When the dread adventure fell.

That gruesome adventure's

Und nun lasst hervor mich treten,

Forth upon the sand-hills stealing,

Resolution was trusted to you.

Schaun das grenzenlose Meer;

Let me view the boundless sea!

And now let me step forward,

Lasst mich knieen, lasst mich beten,

Let me pray, devoutly kneeling,

To see the boundless sea;

Mich bedrängt die Brust so sehr.

Till my burdened heart be free!

Let me kneel, let me pray,

Philemon

Eile nur, den Tisch zu decken,

Haste, and let the meal be dighted

My chest is so heavy with feeling.

Wo's im Gartchen munter bluht.

'Neath the garden's blooming trees!

Hurry to set the table

Lass ihn rennen, ihn erschrecken,

Let him go, and be affrighted!

Where it blooms nicely in the garden.

Denn er glaubt nicht, was er sieht.

He'll believe not what he sees.

Let him run, let him freak out,

Das Euch grimmig missgehandelt,

Where the savage waves maltreated

He won't believe what he sees.

Wog' auf Woge, schaumend wild,

You, on shores of breaking foam,

What once savagely mistreated you,

Seht als Garten Ihr behandelt,

See, a garden lies completed,

Wave upon wave, foaming wild,

Seht ein paradiesisch Bild.

Like an Eden-dream of home!

See it now as a tended garden,

Alter, war ich nicht zuhänden,

Old was I, no longer eager,

See a paradise picture.

Hulfreich nicht wie sonst bereit;

Helpful, as the younger are:

Getting old, I wasn't around,

Und wie meine Krafte schwanden,

And when I had lost my vigour,

Helpful like I used to be;

War auch schon die Woge weit.

Also was the wave afar.

And as my strength faded,

Kluger Herren kuhne Knechte

Wise lords set their serfs in motion,

So too the waves pushed back.

Gruben Graben, dammten ein,

Dikes upraised and ditches led,

Smart masters sent bold servants

Schmalerten des Meeres Rechte,

Minishing the rights of Ocean,

Digging ditches, building dikes,

Herrn an seiner Statt zu sein.

Lords to be in Ocean's stead.

Diminishing the sea's rights,

Schaue grunend Wies' an Wiese,

See the green of many a meadow,

To be lords in Ocean's place.

Anger, Garten, Dorf und Wald. –

Field and garden, wood and town!

See green meadow after meadow,

Komm nun aber und genieße,

Come, our table waits in shadow!

Pasture, garden, village, woods.

Denn die Sonne scheidet bald. –

For the sun is going down.

But come now and enjoy,

Dort im Fernsten ziehen Segel,

Sails afar are gliding yonder;

For the sun's going down soon.

Suchen nachtl'ich sichern Port.

Nightly to the port they fare:

Out there in the distance sails glide,

Kennen doch ihr Nest die Vogel;

To their nest the sea-birds wander,

Seeking a safe port for night.

Denn jetzt ist der Hafen dort.

For a harbour waits them there.

The birds know their nest;

So erblickst du in der Weite

Distant now, thou hardly seest

The harbor's right there now.

Erst des Meeres blauen Saum,

Where the sea's blue arc is spanned,–

So you see in the distance

Rechts und links, in aller Breite,

Right and left, the broadest, freest

First the sea's blue hem,

Dichtgedrängt bewohnten Raum.

Stretch of thickly-peopled land.

Right and left, in all its breadth,

Baucis

Bleibst du stumm? und keinen Bissen
Art thou dumb? Of all we've brought here

Densely peopled living space.

Bringst du zum verletzten Mund?

In thy mouth shall nothing fall?

You stay silent? Not a bite

Philemon

Mocht' er doch vom Wunder wissen;

He would know the marvel wrought here;

To your parched mouth?

Sprichst so gerne, tu's ihm kund.

Fain thou speakest: tell him all!

Nothing passing those dry lips?

Baucis

Wohl! ein Wunder ist's gewesen!

'Twas a marvel, if there's any!

He wants to know about the miracle;

Lasst mich heut noch nicht in Ruh;

And the thought disturbs me still:

You love to talk, so tell him!

Denn es ging das ganze Wesen

In a business so uncanny

Indeed! A miracle it was!

Nicht mit rechten Dingen zu.

Surely helped the Powers of Ill.

It still doesn't let me rest;

Philemon

Tat's ein Herold nicht verkundigen

Can the Emperor's soul be perilled,

Because the whole operation

Schmetternd im Vorüberziehen?

Who on him the strand bestowed?

Wasn't done by proper means.

Nicht entfernt von unsern Dunen

Gave the mandate not the herald,

Didn't a herald announce it,

Ward der erste Fuss gefasst,

Trumpeting, as on he rode?

Blaring as he passed by?

Zelte, Hutten! – Doch im Grunen

Near our downs, all unexpected,

Not far from our dunes

Richtet bald sich ein Palast.
Was the work's beginning seen,
The first foothold was set,
Tents and huts!—but, soon erected,
Rose a palace o'er the green.
Tents, huts! But in the green

Baucis

Tags umsonst die Knechte larmten,
Knives in vain by day were storming,
Soon rose a palace.
Hack' und Schaufel, Schlag um Schlag;
Plying pick and spade alike;
Days the servants made noise in vain,
Wo die Flammchen nachtig schwarmten,
Where the fires at night were swarming,
Pick and shovel, blow by blow;
Stand ein Damm den andern Tag.
Stood, the following day, a dike.
Where the little flames swarmed at night,
Menschenopfer mussten bluten,

Nightly rose the sounds of sorrow,

A dike stood the next day.

Nachts erscholl des Jammers Qual;

Human victims there must bleed:

Human sacrifices had to bleed,

Meerab flossen Feuergluten,

Lines of torches, on the morrow,

Nights rang with cries of agony;

Morgens war es ein Kanal.

Were canals that seaward lead.

Sea-ward flowed streams of fire,

Gottlos ist er, ihn gelustet

He would seize our field of labour,

Mornings it was a canal.

Unsre Hutte, unser Hain;

Hut and garden, godlessly:

He's godless, he lusts for

Wie er sich als Nachbar brustet,

Since he lords it as our neighbour,

Our hut, our grove;

Soll man untertanig sein.

We to him must subject be.

As he puffs himself up as neighbor,

Philemon

Hat er uns doch angeboten

Yet he bids, in compensation,

We must be his subjects.

Schones Gut im neuen Land!

Fair estate of newer land.

But he did offer us

Baucis

Traue nicht dem Wasserboden,

Trust not watery foundation!

Fine land in the new territory!

Halt auf deiner Hohe stand!

Keep upon the hill thy stand!

Trust not the water-floor!

Philemon

Lasst uns zur Kapelle treten,

Let us, to the chapel straying,

Hold your ground on the heights!

Letzten Sonnenblick zu schaun!

Ere the sunset glow has died,

Let us go to the chapel,

Lasst uns lauten, knieen, beten

Chime the vespers, kneel, and, praying,

To see the last ray of sun!

Und dem alten Gott vertraun!

Still in our old God confide!

Let us ring, kneel, pray

Palast / Palace

Lynkeus der Turner Lynceus, the Warder (through the speaking-trumpet)

Die Sonne sinkt, die letzten Schiffe,

The sun goes down, the ships are veering

The sun sinks, the last ships,

Sie ziehen munter hafenein.

To reach the port, with song and cheer:

They cruise cheerfully into port.

Ein grosser Kahn ist im Begriffe,

A heavy galley, now appearing

A big barge is about

Auf dem Kanale hier zu sein.

On the canal, will soon be here.

To arrive on the canal here.

Die bunten Wimpel wehen frohlich,
The gaudy pennons merrily flutter,
The colorful pennants wave happily,
Die starren Masten stehn bereit;
The masts and rigging upward climb:
The rigid masts stand ready;
In dir preist sich der Bootsmann selig,
Blessings on thee the seamen utter,
**In you the boatman praises himself
blessed,**
Dich grusst das Glück zur höchsten Zeit.
And Fortune greets thee at thy prime.
Fortune greets you at your peak.

Faust

Verdammtes Lauten! Allzuschandlich
Accursed chime! As in derision
Damned ringing! All too shameful
Verwundet's, wie ein tückischer Schuss;
It wounds me, like a spiteful shot:
It wounds like a sneaky shot;
Vor Augen ist mein Reich unendlich,

My realm is boundless to my vision,

Before my eyes my realm is endless,

Im Rücken neckt mich der Verdruss,

Yet at my back this vexing blot!

But behind me this irritation nags,

Erinnert mich durch neidische Laute:

The bell proclaims, with envious bluster,

Reminding me with envious tones:

Mein Hochbesitz, er ist nicht rein,

My grand estate lacks full design:

My high estate is not pure,

Der Lindenraum, die braune Baute,

The brown old hut, the linden-cluster,

The linden grove, the brown shack,

Das morsche Kirchlein ist nicht mein.

The crumbling chapel, are not mine.

The crumbling church isn't mine.

Und wunscht' ich, dort mich zu erholen,

If there I wished for recreation,

And if I wanted to relax there,

Vor fremdem Schatten schaudert mir,

Another's shade would give no cheer:

Foreign shadows make me shudder,

Ist Dorn den Augen, Dorn den Sohlen;

A thorn it is, a sharp vexation,–

A thorn to my eyes, thorn to my soles;

O! war' ich weit hinweg von hier!

Would I were far away from here!

Oh! If only I were far from here!

Turner Warder (from above)

Wie segelt froh der bunte Kahn

With evening wind and favouring tide,

How gaily sails the colorful ship

Mit frischem Abendwind heran!

See the gay galley hither glide!

With fresh evening wind this way!

Wie turmt sich sein behender Lauf

How richly, on its rapid track,

How its nimble course piles up

In Kisten, Kasten, Sacken auf!

Tower chest and casket, bale and sack!

In chests, crates, sacks!

Chorus

Da landen wir,

Here we have landed:

Here we land,

Da sind wir schon.

Furl the sail!

Here we are.

Gluckan dem Herren,

Hail to the Master,

Luck to the master,

Dem Patron!

Patron hail!

The patron!

Mephistopheles

So haben wir uns wohl erprobt,

We've proved our worth in many ways,

So we have well proved ourselves,

Vergnugt, wenn der Patron es lobt.

Delighted, if the Patron praise!

Happy if the boss approves.

Nur mit zwei Schiffen ging es fort,

We sailed away with vessels twain,

We left with just two ships,

Mit zwanzig sind wir nun im Port.

With twenty come to port again.

Now we're in port with twenty.

Was grosse Dinge wir getan,

Of great successes to relate,

What great things we did,

Das sieht man unsrer Ladung an.

We only need to show our freight.

Our cargo shows it all.

Das freie Meer befreit den Geist,

Free is the mind on Ocean free:

The free sea frees the spirit,

Wer weiss da, was Besinnen heisst!

Who there can ponder sluggishly?

Who knows what thinking means out there!

Da fordert nur ein rascher Griff,

You only need a rapid grip:

All you need is a quick grab,

Man fangt den Fisch, man fangt ein Schiff,

You catch a fish, you seize a ship;

You catch a fish, you catch a ship,

Und ist man erst der Herr zu drei,

And when you once are lord of three,

And once you're master of three,

Dann hakelt man das vierte bei;

The fourth is grappled easily;

You hook the fourth alongside;

Da geht es denn dem funften schlecht,

The fifth is then in evil plight;

Then the fifth is screwed,

Man hat Gewalt, so hat man Recht.

You have the Power, and thus the Right.

You have power, so you have right.

Man fragt ums Was, und nicht ums Wie.

You count the What, and not the How:

You ask about the What, not the How.

Ich musste keine Schiffahrt kennen:

If I have ever navigated,

If I didn't know navigation:

Krieg, Handel und Piraterie,

War, Trade and Piracy, I vow,

War, trade, and piracy,

Dreieinig sind sie, nicht zu trennen.

Are three in one, and can't be separated!

Trinity inseparable!

Die drei gewaltigen Gesellen The Three Mighty Men

Nicht Dank und Gruss!

No thank and hail?

No thanks and greeting!

Nicht Gruss und Dank!

No hail and thank?

No greeting and thanks!

Als brachten wir

As if our freight

As if we brought

Dem Herrn Gestank.

To him were rank!

The master a stink.

Er macht ein

He makes a face

He makes a

Widerlich Gesicht;

Of great disgust;

Disgusting face;

Das Königsgut

The royal wealth

The royal goods

Gefällt ihm nicht.

Displease him must.

Don't please him.

Mephistopheles

Erwartet weiter

Expect no further

Expect no further

Keinen Lohn!

Any pay;

Any reward!

Nahmt ihr doch

Your own good share

Didn't you take

Euren Teil davon.

Ye took away.

Your cut already?

Die Gesellen The Mighty Men

Das ist nur fur

We only took it

That was just for

Die Langeweil';

For pastime fair;

The boredom;

Wir alle fordern

We all demand

We all demand

Gleichen Teil.

An equal share.

Equal shares.

Mephistopheles

Erst ordnet oben

First, arrange them,

First arrange above

Saal an Saal

In hall on hall,–

Hall after hall

Die Kostbarkeiten

The precious treasures,

The precious treasures,

Allzumal!

Together all!

Every last one!

Und tritt er zu

If such a splendour

And when he sees

Der reichen Schau,

Meets his ken,

The rich display,

Berechnet er alles

And he regards it

He'll calculate everything

Mehr genau,

More closely then,

More precisely,

Er sich gewiss

A niggard he

He surely won't

Nicht lumpen lasst

Won't be, at least:

Be a cheapskate

Und gibt der Flotte

He'll give our squadron

And he'll give the fleet

Fest nach Fest.

Feast on feast.

Feast after feast.

Die bunten Vogel kommen morgen,

To-morrow the gay birds hither wend,

The pretty birds come tomorrow,

Für die werd' ich zum besten sorgen.

And I can best to them attend.

I'll take good care of them.

Mephistopheles (zu Faust)

Mit ernster Stirn, mit dustrem Blick

With gloomy gaze, with serious brow,

With serious brow, with gloomy look

Vernimmst du dein erhaben Glück.

Of this great fortune hearest thou.

You receive your sublime fortune.

Die hohe Weisheit wird gekront,

Crowned is thy wisest industry,

High wisdom is crowned,

Das Ufer ist dem Meer versohnt;

And reconciled are shore and sea;

The shore is reconciled with the sea;

Vom Ufer nimmt, zu rascher Bahn,

And from the shore, to swifter wakes,

From the shore, on swift course,

Das Meer die Schiffe willig an;

The willing sea the vessels takes.

The sea willingly takes the ships;

So sprich, dass hier, hier vom Palast

Speak, then, that here from thy proud
seat,

So say that here, here from the palace

Dein Arm die ganze Welt umfasst.

Thine arm may clasp the world complete.

Your arm embraces the whole world.

Von dieser Stelle ging es aus,

Here, on this spot, the work was planned!

From this place it began,

Hier stand das erste Bretterhaus;

Here did the first rough cabin stand;

Here stood the first plank-house;

Ein Grabchen ward hinabgeritzt,

A little ditch was traced, a groove,

A little ditch was scratched out,

Wo jetzt das Ruder emsig spritzt.

Where now the feathered oar-blades
move.

Where now the oar busily splashes.

Dein hoher Sinn, der Deinen Fleiss

Thy high intent, thy servants' toil,

**Your high mind, your servants' dili-
gence**

Erwarb des Meers, der Erde Preis.

From land and sea have won the spoil.

Won the sea's and earth's prize.

Von hier aus – –

From here–

From here–

Faust

Dir Vielgewandtem muss ich's sagen,

Still that accursed Here!

That damned "Here" again!

Mir gibt's im Herzen Stich um Stich,

To me a burden most severe.

It stabs my heart again and again,

Mir ist's unmöglich zu ertragen!

To thee, so clever, I declare it,–

I can't stand it!

Und wie ich's sage, scham' ich mich.

It gives my very heart a sting;

And saying it, I'm ashamed.

It is impossible to bear it!

Yet ashamed am I, to say the thing.

The old ones up there should move,

Die Alten droben sollten weichen,
The old ones, there, should make concession;

I want those lindens for my seat,

Die Linden wunscht' ich mir zum Sitz,
A shady seat would I create:

Those few trees, not mine,

Die wenig Baume, nicht mein eigen,
The lindens, not my own possession,

Spoil my possession of the world.

Verderben mir den Weltbesitz.

Disturb my joy in mine estate.

I'd like to build from branch to branch

Dort wollt' ich, weit umherzuschauen,
There would I, for a view unbaffled,

Scaffolding to look far around,

Von Ast zu Ast Gerüste bauen,
From bough to bough erect a scaffold,

Opening a wide path for the gaze,

Dem Blick eröffnen weite Bahn,
Till for my gaze a look be won

To see everything I've done,

Zu sehn, was alles ich getan,

O'er everything that I have done,–

To survey with one glance

Zu überschaun mit einem Blick

To see before me unconfined,

The masterpiece of human spirit,

Des Menschengeistes Meisterstück,

The masterpiece of human mind,

Activating with clever sense

Betätigend mit klugem Sinn

Wisely asserting to my sense

The nations' broad living gain.

Der Völker breiten Wohngewinn.

The people's gain of residence.

So we're tormented hardest,

So sind am hartsten wir gequält,

No sorer plague can us attack,

In wealth feeling what we lack.

Im Reichtum fühlend, was uns fehlt.

Than rich to be, and something lack!

**The little bell's sound, the lindens'
scent**

Des Glockchens Klang, der Linden Duft
The chiming bell, the lindens' breath,
Surrounds me like church and crypt.

Umfangt mich wie in Kirch' und Gruft.
Oppress like air in vaults of death:

The almighty will's decree

Des allgewaltigen Willens Kur
My force of will, my potency grand,

Breaks on this sand here.

Bricht sich an diesem Sande hier.
Is shattered here upon the sand.

How do I get it out of my mind!

Wie schaff' ich mir es vom Gemute!
How shall I ban it from my feeling!

The little bell rings, and I rage.

Das Glocklein lautet, und ich wute.
I rave whene'er the bell is pealing.

Naturally! That a main annoyance

Mephistopheles

Natürlich! dass ein Hauptverdruss

'Tis natural that so great a spite

Must embitter your life.

Das Leben dir vergallen muss.

Thy life should thus embitter quite.

Who denies it! Every noble ear

Wer leugnet's! Jedem edlen Ohr

Who doubts it? Every noble ear,

Finds that jingling repulsive.

Kommt das Geklingel widrig vor.

Disgusted, must the jangle hear;

And that damned bim-bam-bimmel,

Und das verfluchte Bim-Baum-Bimmel,

And that accursed bim-bam-booming,

Fogging the clear evening sky,

Umnebelnd heitern Abendhimmel,

Through the clear sky of evening gloom-
ing,

Mixes into every happening,

Mischt sich in jegliches Begebnis,

Is mixed with each event that passes,

From first bath to burial,

Vom ersten Bad bis zum Begrabnis,

From baby's bath to burial-masses,

As if between bim and bam

Als ware zwischen Bim und Baum

As if, between its bam and bim,

Life were a vanished dream.

Das Leben ein verschollner Traum.

Life were a dream, in memory dim.

The resistance, the stubbornness

Faust

Das Widerstehn, der Eigensinn

Their obstinate, opposing strain

Diminishes the most glorious gain,

Verkummern herrlichsten Gewinn,

Darkens the brightest solid gain,

So that one, in deep, grim pain,

Dass man, zu tiefer, grimmiger Pein,

Till one, in plague and worry thrust,

Must grow tired of being just.

Ermuden muss, gerecht zu sein.

Grows tired, at last, of being just.

Why bother yourself here?

Mephistopheles

Was willst du dich denn hier genieren?

Why be annoyed, when thou canst well despise them?

Haven't you long needed to colonize?

Musst du nicht langst kolonisieren?

Wouldst thou not long since colonize them?

Then go and get them out of my way!

Faust

So geht und schafft sie mir zur Seite! –

Then go, and clear them out with speed!

You know the nice little estate

Das schöne Gutchen kennst du ja,

Thou knowest the fair estate, indeed,

I picked out for the old folks.

Das ich den Alten ausersah.

I chose for the old people's need.

They'll be carried off and set down,

Mephistopheles

Man tragt sie fort und setzt sie nieder,

We'll set them down on other land;

Before you look around, they'll be standing again;

Eh' man sich umsieht, stehn sie wieder;

Ere you can look, again they'll stand:

After enduring the violence

Nach überstandener Gewalt

When they've the violence outgrown,

A nice place will make amends.

Versohnt ein schöner Aufenthalt.

Their pleasant dwelling shall atone.

Come, as the master commands!

Mephistopheles

Kommt, wie der Herr gebieten lasst!

Come, as the Master bids, and let

Tomorrow there's a fleet festival.

Und morgen gibt's ein Flottenfest.

The fleet a feast to-morrow get!

The old master received us badly,

Die drei The Three

Der alte Herr empfind uns schlecht,

Reception bad the old Master gave;

A fine feast is our due.

Ein flottes Fest ist uns zu Recht.

A jolly feast is what we crave.

Here too happens what long happened,

Mephistopheles (ad spectatores)

Auch hier geschieht, was langst geschah,

It happens as it happed of old:

For Naboth's vineyard was already there.

Denn Naboths Weinberg war schon da.

Still Naboth's vineyard we behold!

Same old story, different landlord.

Tiefe Nacht / Dead of Night

Lynkeus der Turner Lynceus, the Warder (singing on the watch-tower of the Palace)

Zum Sehen geboren,

For seeing intended,

Born to see things, that's my whole job description

Zum Schauen bestellt,

Employed for my sight,

Hired specifically for my eyes, which is honestly a flex

Dem Turme geschworen,

The tower's my dwelling,

I've sworn myself to this tower—we're married now, me and stone

Gefällt mir die Welt.

The world my delight.

The world pleases me. All of it. I'm a visual slut.

Ich blick' in die Ferne,

I gaze on the Distant,

I stare at faraway things with the intensity of a cat at a laser pointer

Ich seh' in der Nah'

I look on the Near,–

I see what's near, I see what's far, I'm seeing all day

Den Mond und die Sterne,

The moon and the planets,

Moon and stars hang there like ornaments on a body of darkness

Den Wald und das Reh.

The forest and deer.

Forest, deer. Noted. Beautiful. Next.

So seh' ich in allen

So see I in all things

Everything I look at has this eternal drip, honestly

Die ewige Zier,

The grace without end,

**And since it pleases me to gaze, I'm
pretty pleased with myself too**

Und wie mir's gefallen,

And even as they please me,

**Happy eyeballs! Whatever you've
witnessed—sharks, sunsets, that one
weird cloud**

Gefall' ich auch mir.

Myself I commend.

**Let it be what it was, it was still beau-
tiful to look at**

Ihr glücklichen Augen,

Thou fortunate Vision,

**Every damn thing. Still gorgeous.
Lucky eyes.**

Was je ihr gesehen,

Of all thou wast 'ware,

**I didn't just climb up here for fun,
though the view does things for me**

Es sei wie es wolle,

Whatever it might be,

**Wait, what fresh hell is this emerging
from the darkness below?**

Es war doch so schön!

Yet still it was fair!

**My stomach drops before my eyes
catch up—body knows first**

Nicht allein mich zu ergetzen,

Not alone that I delight me,

**What ghastly horror threatens me from
the shadowy world!**

Bin ich hier so hoch gestellt;

Have I here been stationed so:—

**I see sparks. Through the linden trees.
This is not a romantic firefly situation.**

Welch ein greuliches Entsetzen

What a horror comes, to fright me,

**Fire. Double-linden darkness. Glow-
ing. Bad.**

Droht mir aus der finstern Welt!

From the darksome world below!

**The heat keeps climbing, my throat
tightens watching it grow**

Funkenblicke seh' ich spruhen

Sparks of fire I see outgushing

**The breeze is fanning it—that slutty
wind, spreading everything**

Durch der Linden Doppelnacht,

Through the night of linden-trees;

**Ever stronger glows the burning,
fanned by drafts of air**

Immer starker wuhlt ein Gluhen,

Stronger yet the glow is flushing,

**Oh god the cabin's catching now, the
mossy damp one, no no no**

Von der Zugluft angefacht.

Fanned to fury by the breeze.

**Moss means nothing to fire. Nothing is
wet enough.**

Ach! die innre Hutte lodert,

Ah! the cabin burns, unheeded,

**Quick help needed! Zero help avail-
able! This is a math problem from
hell!**

Die bemoost und feucht gestanden;

Damp and mossy though it stand:

Old couple. Fire people. Smoke victims. Shit.

Schnelle Hilfe wird gefordert,

Quick assistance here is needed,

Ah, the good old folk, once so careful with their hearth!

Keine Rettung ist vorhanden.

And no rescue is at hand!

My eyes burn from watching. Smoke in my lungs from just seeing.

Ach! die guten alten Leute,

Ah, the good old father, mother,

They're gonna suffocate in that smoke and I can't do a damn thing

Sonst so sorglich um das Feuer,

Else so careful of the fire,

What an absolutely horrifying adventure this turned into—fully fucked

Werden sie dem Qualm zur Beute!

Doomed amid the smoke to smother!–

The mossy frame is now starring in a movie called Everything Burns

Welch ein schrecklich Abenteuer!

The catastrophe how dire!

**Flames flaming red in glowing heat,
the blackened moss-structure stands**

Flamme flammet, rot in Gluten

Now the blackening pile stands lonely

**If only they got out—my whole body
prays without permission**

Steht das schwarze Moosgestelle;

In the flames that redly swell:

**Wildly burning hell. Old folks. Please
be out.**

Retteten sich nur die Guten

If the good old folk be only

**Lightning-tongues licking up through
leaves and branches like hungry
mouths**

Aus der wildentbrannten Holle!

Rescued from the burning hell!

**Dry branches crackle, catch—sound of
something dying**

Zugelnd lichte Blitze steigen

Dazzling tongues the crater launches

**Withered boughs, they flicker-burn,
glow quick and crash right down**

Zwischen Blattern, zwischen Zweigen;

Through the leaves and through the
branches;

**My eyes! Why must I be far-sighted? I
didn't ask for 20/20 vision of tragedy!**

Aste durr, die flackernd brennen,

Withered boughs, at last ignited,

**Too sharp. Too clear. Too cruel. These
eyes.**

Gluhen schnell und sturzen ein.

Break, in burning, from the tree:

**The little chapel just collapsed —
virginity lost to falling branches**

Sollt ihr Augen dies erkennen!

Why must I be thus far-sighted?

**I feel each timber in my bones, the
crash reverberates through me**

Muss ich so weitsichtig sein!

Witness such calamity?

**The little chapel breaks apart under
the falling weight of boughs**

Das Kapellchen bricht zusammen

Now the little chapel crashes

**And now the fire's snaking up to the
treetops, of course it is**

Von der Aste Sturz und Last.

'Neath a branch's falling blow;

**Serpentine flames reach up like
they're trying to tickle heaven**

Schlangelnd sind, mit spitzen Flammen,

Soon the climbing, spiry flashes

**Hollow trunks glow purple-red, lit
from within like lanterns**

Schon die Gipfel angefasst.

Set the tree-tops in a glow.

**Down to the root the hollow trunks
glow, crimson-purple in the heat**

Bis zur Wurzel gluhn die hohlen

Down to where the trunks are planted

**What the eye loved once? Gone. Cen-
turies. Poof.**

Stamme, purpurrot im Gluhn. –

Burn they like a crimson dawn.

**What used to be worth looking at just
came everywhere and then died**

Was sich sonst dem Blick empfohlen,

What erewhile the eye enchanted

What is that singing-whimpering from above?

Mit Jahrhunderten ist hin.

With the centuries is gone.

The word arrives but the meaning's on a delay, like bad WiFi

Faust (auf dem Balkon, gegen die Dunen) (on the balcony, towards the downs)

Von oben welch ein singend Wimmern?

Above, what whining lamentation?

My warder's wailing and something clenches in my chest, wrong, wrong

Das Wort ist hier, der Ton zu spat.

The word, the tone, too late I heed.

I'm annoyed by this impatient deed— wait, MY impatient deed? Uh oh.

Mein Turner jammert; mich, im Innern,

My warder wails: I feel vexation

Regret arrives. Warder wails. Too late though.

Verdriesst die ungeduld'ge Tat.

At heart, for this impatient deed.

**But hey, if the lindens are destroyed,
that's kind of... mission accom-
plished?**

Doch sei der Lindenwuchs vernichtet

Yet be the lindens extirpated,

**Yet be the linden-growth destroyed to
half-charred trunk-horrors**

Zu halbverkohlter Stämme Graun,

Till half-charred trunks the spot deface,

**My skin feels the smoke from here,
imagined ash settling**

Ein Luginsland ist bald errichtet,

A look-in-the-land is soon created,

**I'll build a lookout spot there, bound-
less views incoming**

Um ins Unendliche zu schaun.

Whence I can view the boundless space.

**A "look-into-the-land"! Because nam-
ing things makes them nice!**

Da seh' ich auch die neue Wohnung,

Thence shall I see the newer dwelling

**Infinite view. Worth it? Keep telling
yourself.**

Die jenes alte Paar umschliesst,
Which for the ancient pair I raise,

**There I'll see the new dwelling that en-
closes that old pair**

Das, im Gefühl grossmutiger Schonung,
Who, my benign forbearance feeling,

**Who, feeling my generous mercy,
will enjoy their final days—my hands
unclench**

Der späten Tage froh geniesst.

Shall there enjoy their latter days.

**They'll enjoy my big-dick forbearance
energy in their twilight years**

Mephistopheles und die dreie (unten) Mephistophe-
les and the Three (below)

Da kommen wir mit vollem Trab;

We hither come upon the run!

**They're gonna love their new house,
right? Everything's fine. It's fine.**

Verzeiht! es ging nicht gutlich ab.

Forgive! not happily 'twas done.

**Magnanimous Faust! Providing sunset
years! Definitely not on fire!**

Wir klopfen an, wir pochten an,
We knocked and beat, but none replied,
**Here we come at full gallop! Forgive
us, it didn't go peacefully.**

Und immer ward nicht aufgetan;
And entrance ever was denied;
**So like, we knocked, we knocked
again, nobody answered, super rude**

Wir rüttelten, wir pochten fort,
Of jolts and blows we gave good store,
**Fists against wood, again and again,
the rhythm of trying**

Da lag die morsche Türe dort;
And broken lay the rotten door;
**Knocked. Pounded. Shook. Door
down.**

Wir riefen laut und drohten schwer,
We called aloud, with direst threat,
**We rattled! We banged! The rotten
door surrendered like a sad metaphor!**

Allein wir fanden kein Gehör.
But still no hearing could we get.

We called out loud and made big threats, got absolutely nothing

Und wie's in solchem Fall geschicht,

And, as it haps, with such a deed,

We shouted loud and threatened heavy, but found no hearing there

Sie horten nicht, sie wollten nicht;

They would not hear, they would not heed;

Frustration building in the arms, the shoulders, the jaw clenching

Wir aber haben nicht gesaumt,

But we began, without delay,

You know how it goes in these situations —they wouldn't hear, they wouldn't listen

Behende dir sie weggeraumt.

To drive the stubborn folks away.

Deaf or stubborn. Same result. We moved.

Das Paar hat sich nicht viel gequalt,

The pair had then an easy lot:

And as happens in such cases! (narrator voice: it did not go well)

Vor Schrecken fielen sie entseelt.

They fell and died upon the spot.

**We however did not delay, we nimbly
cleared them away for you**

Ein Fremder, der sich dort versteckt

A stranger, who was there concealed,

**The couple didn't suffer much—they
dropped dead from sheer fright, quick
and clean**

Und fechten wollte, ward gestreckt.

And fought, was left upon the field;

**Terror stops the heart. Bodies drop be-
fore they know.**

In wilden Kampfes kurzer Zeit

But in the combat, fierce and last,

**There was also some dude hiding there
who wanted to fight, we handled it**

Von Kohlen, ringsumher gestreut,

From coals, that round about were cast,

**A stranger who concealed himself
there and wanted to fence was
stretched out**

Entflammte Stroh. Nun lodert's frei,

The straw took fire. Now merrily

Guest wanted beef. Got beef. Got stretched.

Als Scheiterhaufen dieser drei.

One funeral pile consumes the three.

And in the wild battle's brief moment, coals scattered everywhere—whoopsie!

Faust

Dem unbesonnenen wilden Streich,

Deaf unto my commands were ye!

Straw catches fire. That fast. Heat jumps from thing to thing.

Ihm fluch' ich; teilt es unter euch!

Exchange I meant, not robbery.

Now it blazes freely as a funeral pyre for those three—cozy threesome, finally hot

The inconsiderate, savage blow

I curse! Bear ye the guilt and go!

Straw ignited. Now it burns free, as a pyre for these three.

Chorus

Das alte Wort, das Wort erschallt:

The proverb old still runs its course:

You absolute dipshits, this is NOT what I ordered

Gehorche willig der Gewalt!

Bend willingly to greater force!

The thoughtless, wild stroke—I curse it! Split the blame between you!

Und bist du kuhn und halst du Stich,

If you are bold, and face the strife,

**My stomach turns. Exchange I meant.
My hands feel dirty.**

So wage Haus und Hof und – dich.

Stake house and home, and then–your life!

**I wanted a swap, not a robbery!
There's a difference! A legal difference!**

Faust (auf dem Balkon) (on the balcony)

Die Sterne bergen Blick und Schein,

The stars conceal their glance and glow,

Curse falls. Guilt shared. Get out.

Das Feuer sinkt und lodert klein;

The fire sinks down, and flickers low;

**I curse this shit! You all own it now!
Take your guilt and fuck off!**

Ein Schauerwindchen fachelt's an,

A damp wind fans it with its wings,

**The old word, the word resounds: obey
willingly the force!**

Bringt Rauch und Dunst zu mir heran.

And smoke and vapour hither brings.

**Classic proverb hours: bow down or
get knocked down**

Geboten schnell, zu schnell getan! –

Quick bidden, and too quick obeyed!–

**The spine learns to bend or the spine
learns to break**

Was schwebet schattenhaft heran?

What hovers hither like a shade?

**And if you're bold and hold your
ground? Well then bet house, home,
and—yourself!**

Mitternacht / Midnight

Vier graue Weiber treten auf. Four Gray Women enter.

Erste First

Ich heiße der Mangel. –

My name, it is Want.

My name is Want.

Zweite Second

Ich heiße die Schuld.

And mine, it is Guilt.

**I'm Want. Nice to meet you. You won't
like knowing me.**

Dritte Third

Ich heiße die Sorge. –

And mine, it is Care.

**Hollow belly, empty hands—I'm what
that feels like**

Vierte Fourth

Ich heisse die Not.

Necessity, mine.

Name: Want. Job: Wanting. Eternally.

Zu drei Three together

Die Tur ist verschlossen, wir können nicht
ein;

The portal is bolted, we cannot get in:

My name is Guilt.

Drin wohnt ein Reicher, wir mögen nicht
'nein.

The owner is rich, we've no business
within.

**I'm Guilt, baby. You've been ignoring
my calls.**

Mangel Want

Da werd' ich zum Schatten. –

I shrink to a shadow.

**Guilt here! I'm what you owe plus in-
terest plus that thing you did in 2019!**

Schuld Guilt

Da werd' ich zunicht.

I shrink unto naught.

Schuld. Debt. Guilt. Both. Yes.

Not Necessity

Man wendet von mir das verwohnte
Gesicht.

The pampered from me turn the face and
the thought.

My name is Care.

Sorge Care

Ihr Schwestern, ihr konnt nicht und durft
nicht hinein.

Ye Sisters, ye neither can enter, nor dare;

**Care, reporting for duty. The worry
kind, not the tender kind.**

Die Sorge, sie schleicht sich durchs Schlus-
selloch ein.

But the keyhole is free to the entrance of
Care.

**Tight chest, racing thoughts at 3am—
hello, it's me**

(Sorge verschwindet.) (Care disappears.)

Mangel Want

Ihr, graue Geschwister, entfernt euch von hier.

Ye, grisly old Sisters, be banished from here!

I'm Care! The anxiety! Not the good caregiving one! Confusing, I know!

Schuld Guilt

Ganz nah an der Seite verbind' ich mich dir.

Beside thee, and bound to thee, I shall appear!

My name is Need.

Not Necessity

Ganz nah an der Ferse begleitet die Not.

At your heels goes Necessity, blight in her breath.

Necessity's the name. I don't knock, I just enter.

Zu drei The Three

Es ziehen die Wolken, es schwinden die Sterne!

The clouds are in motion, and cover each star!

**Urgency in the bowels, no choices left
—that's my flavor**

Dahinten, dahinten! von ferne, von ferne,
Behind there, behind! from afar, from afar,

Need. Not. Negotiable.

Da kommt er, der Bruder, da kommt er, der
– – – Tod.

He cometh, our Brother! he comes, he is . .
. Death!

**The door is locked, we cannot enter; a
rich man dwells within, we don't want
in there**

Faust (im Palast) (in the Palace)

Vier sah ich kommen, drei nur gehn;

Four saw I come, but those that went were
three;

**Portal's bolted, can't get inside —too
bougie in there for our vibe**

Den Sinn der Rede konnt' ich nicht ver-
stehn.

The sense of what they said was hid from
me.

**The owner is RICH! We've got no busi-
ness in those tax brackets!**

Es klang so nach, als hiess' es – Not,

But something like “Necessity” I heard;

**Pressed against locked doors, faces
flat against what we can’t enter**

Ein dustres Reimwort folgte – Tod.

Thereafter, “Death” a gloomy, threatening
word!

There I become a shadow.

Es tonte hohl, gespensterhaft gedampft.

It sounded hollow, spectrally subdued:

**I shrink down to a shadow around rich
folks**

Noch hab’ ich mich ins Freie nicht
gekämpft.

Not yet have I my liberty made good:

**Thin to nothing, transparent, barely
there**

Konnt’ ich Magie von meinem Pfad entfer-
nen,

If I could banish Magic’s fell creations,

Shadow. Less than shadow. Gone.

Die Zaubersprüche ganz und gar verler-
nen,

And totally unlearn the incantations,–

There I become nothing.

Stund' ich, Natur, vor dir ein Mann allein,
Stood I, O Nature! Man alone in thee,

**I shrink to jack shit. Wealth is its own
absolution apparently.**

Da war's der Muhe wert, ein Mensch zu
sein.

Then were it worth one's while a man to
be!

**I become naught! Zero! The null value
of spiritual bankruptcy!**

Das war ich sonst, eh' ich's im Düstern
suchte,

Ere in the Obscure I sought it, such was I,–

**Weightless, substanceless, I vanish
like debt paid off**

Mit Frevelwort mich und die Welt ver-
fluchte.

Ere I had cursed the world so wickedly.

**They turn the pampered face away
from me.**

Nun ist die Luft von solchem Spuk so voll,

Now fills the air so many a haunting shape,

**Rich folks look away from me like I'm
invisible, which, fair**

Dass niemand weiss, wie er ihn meiden soll.

That no one knows how best he may escape.

Soft faces. Turn away. Don't see me.

Wenn auch ein Tag uns klar vernunftig lacht,

What though One Day with rational brightness beams,

The comfortable ones avert their spoiled little faces—they've never met urgency

In Traumgespinst verwickelt uns die Nacht;

The Night entangles us in webs of dreams.

You sisters, you cannot and may not enter. But Care slips through the keyhole.

Wir kehren froh von junger Flur zurück,

From our young fields of life we come, elate:

You girls can't get in there, but guess who fits through keyholes? This bitch.

Ein Vogel krachzt; was krachzt er? Missgeschick.

There croaks a bird: what croaks he? Evil fate!

I slide through gaps, under doors, into the cracks of sealed rooms

Von Aberglauben fruh und spat umgarnt:

By superstition constantly insnared,

The keyhole is OPEN to me! I'm basically anxiety vapor!

Es eignet sich, es zeigt sich an, es warnt.

It grows to us, and warns, and is declared.

Sisters blocked. Care? Keyhole. Always.

Und so verschuchtert, stehen wir allein.

Intimidated thus, we stand alone.–

You, gray sisters, depart from here.

Die Pforte knarrt, und niemand kommt herein.

The portal jars, yet entrance is there none.

Time for us to dip, gray squad

Ist jemand hier? –

Is any one here?

We drift apart like fog at dawn

Sorge Care

Die Frage fordert Ja!

Yes! must be my reply.

Exit stage left, fellow hags!

Faust

Und du, wer bist denn du? –

And thou, who art thou, then?

**Quite close at your side, I bind myself
to you.**

Sorge Care

Bin einmal da.

Well, – here am I.

**I'll stick close to you, babe – spooning
distance at all times**

Faust

Entferne dich! –

Avaunt!

**Hip to hip, shadow to shadow, I follow
where you go**

Sorge Care

Ich bin am rechten Ort.

I am where I should be.

**Right beside. Bound tight. Can't lose
me.**

Faust

Nimm dich in acht und sprich kein Zauberwort.

Take care, and speak no word of sorcery!

**Quite close at your heels accompanies
Need.**

Sorge Care

Wurde mich kein Ohr vernehmen,

Though no ear should choose to hear me,

**I'm right at your heels, blight on my
breath, let's roll**

Musst' es doch im Herzen drohnen;

Yet the shrinking heart must fear me:

**The urgency nips at ankles, follows every
step**

In verwandelter Gestalt

Though transformed to mortal eyes,

**At your heels! Like a dog! But sadder
and more inevitable!**

Ub' ich grimmige Gewalt.

Grimmest power I exercise.

**The clouds drift, the stars vanish!
From afar, from afar, he comes, our
brother, he comes—Death.**

Auf den Pfaden, auf der Welle,

On the land, or ocean yonder,

**Clouds moving, stars fading —from
way out there, here comes our bro,
good old Death**

Ewig angstlicher Geselle,

I, a dread companion, wander,

**The sky closes over, light retreats, and
something approaches on cold feet**

Stets gefunden, nie gesucht,

Always found, yet never sought,

**Behind there! From far! It's our
brother! It's... dramatic pause...
DEATH!**

So geschmeichelt wie verflucht. –

Praised or cursed, as I have wrought!

**Clouds. Stars gone. Brother coming.
Death.**

Hast du die Sorge nie gekannt?

Hast thou not Care already known?

**That's right, Death's on his way—the
ultimate closer, the big finish, daddy
of all endings**

Faust

Ich bin nur durch die Welt gerannt;

I only through the world have flown:

**Four I saw coming, only three de-
parted; the sense of their speech I
could not understand.**

Ein jed' Gelust ergriff ich bei den Haaren,

Each appetite I seized as by the hair;

**Four showed up, three bounced—the
math ain't mathing**

Was nicht genugte, liess ich fahren,

What not sufficed me, forth I let it fare,

**My ears caught fragments, my mind
couldn't grip the meaning**

Was mir entwischte, liess ich ziehn.

And what escaped me, I let go.

**It sounded kinda like "Need"... then
something rhymed with it... some-
thing gloomy... DEATH!**

Ich habe nur begehrt und nur vollbracht

I've only craved, accomplished my delight,
Need echoed. Death followed. Hollow sound.

Und abermals gewünscht und so mit
Macht

Then wished a second time, and thus with
might

**It sounded hollow, spectrally muffled.
Still I have not fought my way to freedom.**

Mein Leben durchgesturmt; erst gross und
mächtig,

Stormed through my life: at first 'twas
grand, completely,

**Still haven't worked myself free into
the open air—still trapped in my own
bullshit**

Nun aber geht es weise, geht bedächtig.

But now it moves most wisely and discreetly.

**The walls close in, the freedom feels
further than ever**

Der Erdenkreis ist mir genug bekannt,

The sphere of Earth is known enough to
me;

**If I could just delete Magic from my life,
factory reset the whole sorcery thing**

Nach druben ist die Aussicht uns verrannt;

The view beyond is barred immutably:

**If I could remove magic from my path,
completely unlearn the spells**

Tor, wer dorthin die Augen blinzelnd
richtet,

A fool, who there his blinking eyes di-
recteth,

**Stand before you, Nature, just a guy!
No tricks! Just vibes!**

Sich uber Wolken seinesgleichen dichtet!

And o'er his clouds of peers a place
expecteth!

**Naked before existence, stripped of
borrowed power**

Er stehe fest und sehe hier sich um;

Firm let him stand, and look around him
well!

Just Man. No magic. Worth living then.

Dem Tuchtigen ist diese Welt nicht stumm.

This World means something to the Capa-
ble.

**That's who I was before I went looking
in the dark and cursed everything**

Was braucht er in die Ewigkeit zu
schweifen!

Why needs he through Eternity to wend?

**That I was, before I sought in the
murky, with blasphemous words
cursed myself and the world**

Was er erkennt, lasst sich ergreifen.

He here acquires what he can apprehend.

**Now the air's so thick with spooks I
can't see straight**

Er wandle so den Erdentag entlang;

Thus let him wander down his earthly day;

**Haunting shapes everywhere! Nobody
knows how to avoid them! Not even
Waze!**

Wenn Geister spuken, geh' er seinen Gang,

When spirits haunt, go quietly his way;

**Ghosts press on the skin, crowd the
breath**

Im Weiterschreiten find' er Qual und
Gluck,

In marching onwards, bliss and torment
find,

**Now the air is so full of such specters
that no one knows how to avoid them**

Er, unbefriedigt jeden Augenblick!

Though, every moment, with unsated
mind!

**One day seems clear and rational, then
night tangles us in dream-webs**

Sorge Care

Wen ich einmal besitze,

Whom I once possess, shall never

Day laughs clear. Night traps. Always.

Dem ist alle Welt nichts nutze;

Find the world worth his endeavour:

**When a day laughs clear and rational
at us, night entangles us in dream-
weaving**

Ewiges Dustre steigt herunter,

Endless gloom around him folding,

**We come back from fresh fields all
happy, then a bird croaks—bad luck,
you're fucked**

Sonne geht nicht auf noch unter,

Rise nor set of sun beholding.

**Superstition wraps around like vines,
tighter with each breath**

Bei vollkommen aussern Sinnen

Perfect in external senses,

**It shows itself, it announces itself,
it warns! Like the world's worst
notification system!**

Wohnen Finsternisse drinnen,

Inwardly his darkness dense is;

**Ensnared by superstition early and
late: it announces itself, it shows
itself, it warns**

Und er weiss von allen Schätzen

And he knows not how to measure

**And so we stand here intimidated, to-
tally alone. Great.**

Sich nicht in Besitz zu setzen.

True possession of his treasure.

**The door creaks. Nobody enters. The
emptiness is worse.**

Gluck und Unglück wird zur Grille,

Luck and Ill become caprices;

**Gate creaks. Nothing enters. Terrify-
ing.**

Er verhungert in der Fülle;

Still he starves in all increases;

**The gate creaks, and no one comes
through. Is anyone here?**

Sei es Wonne, sei es Plage,

Be it happiness or sorrow,

The question demands Yes!

Schieb er's zu dem andern Tage,

He postpones it till the morrow;

**You asked if someone's here? That's a
yes from me, bestie.**

Ist der Zukunft nur gewartig,

To the Future only cleaveth:

**THE QUESTION REQUIRES A YES! And I
am that yes! Surprise!**

Und so wird er niemals fertig.

Nothing, therefore, he achieveth.

Asked? Answered. Yes. I'm here.

Faust

Fahr hin! die schlechte Litanei,

Desist! So shalt thou not get hold of me!

And you, who are you then?

Sie konnte selbst den klugsten Mann
betören.

I have no mind to hear such drivél.

And who the hell are you supposed to be?

Depart! Thy gloomy litany

Might even befool the wisest man to evil.

My skin prickles, recognizing before knowing

Sorge Care

Soll er gehen, soll er kommen?

Shall he go, or come?—how guide him?

I am simply here.

Der Entschluss ist ihm genommen;

Prompt decision is denied him;

I'm just... here. That's the whole an- swer.

Auf gebahnten Weges Mitte

Midway on the trodden highway

Well—here I am! jazz hands of existen- tial dread

Wankt er tastend halbe Schritte.

Halting, he attempts a by-way;

Here. Just here. Deal with it.

Er verliert sich immer tiefer,

Ever more astray, bemisted,

Remove yourself!

Siehet alle Dinge schiefer,

Everything beholding twisted,

Get the fuck out!

Sich und andre lastig druckend;

Burdening himself and others,

**Every muscle tenses toward pushing
this presence away**

Atemholend und erstickend;

Taking breath, he chokes and smothers,

I am in the right place.

Nicht erstickt und ohne Leben,

Though not choked, in Life not sharing,

**Nah, I'm exactly where I should be, ac-
tually**

Nicht verzweifelnd, nicht ergeben.

Not resigned, and not despairing!

I am AT the correct coordinates! This is MY spot!

So ein unaufhaltsam Rollen,

Such incessant rolling, spinning,–

Right place. Right time. For me.

Schmerzlich Lassen, widrig Sollen,

Painful quitting, hard beginning,–

Take care and speak no magic word.

Bald Befreien, bald Erdrucken,

Now constraint, now liberation,–

**Watch yourself and don't try any spell
shit on me**

Halber Schlaf und schlecht Erquicken

Semi-sleep, poor recreation,

**Jaw tight, warning in the voice, guard
up**

Heftet ihn an seine Stelle

Firmly in his place insnare him

**Careful now—don't you dare whisper
any witchy bullshit**

Und bereitet ihn zur Holle.

And, at last, for Hell prepare him!

**Though no ear would hear me, it must
still thunder in the heart**

Faust

Unselige Gespenster! so behandelt ihr
Ill-omened spectres! By your treatment
strays

**Even if you plug your ears, your shriv-
eled heart still hears me**

Das menschliche Geschlecht zu tausend
Malen;

A thousand times the human race to error:

**The heartbeat accelerates at my ap-
proach, body betrays the mind**

Gleichgültige Tage selbst verwandelt ihr
Ye even transform the dull, indifferent
days

**In transformed shape I exercise GRIM
POWER! Very grim! Extremely power-
ful!**

In garstigen Wirrwarr netzumstrickter
Qualen.

To vile confusion of entangling terror.

Heart knows. Ears optional. I'm felt.

Damonen, weiss ich, wird man schwerlich
los,

'Tis hard, I know, from Daemons to escape;

**On the paths, on the wave, eternally
anxious companion**

Das geistig-strenge Band ist nicht zu tren-
nen;

The spirit's bond breaks not, howe'er one
tries it;

**I'm the forever-anxious sidekick—land
or sea, I'm riding along**

Doch deine Macht, Sorge, schleichend
gross,

And yet, O Care, thy power, thy creeping
shape,

**Every road, every shore, I walk beside
with cold breath**

Ich werde sie nicht anerkennen.

Think not that I shall recognize it!

**Always found but never sought,
praised and cursed in equal measure**

Sorge Care

Erfahre sie, wie ich geschwind

So feel it now: my curse thou'lt find,

**I'm like that friend you never invited
but who shows up anyway! But evil!**

Mich mit Verwunschung von dir wende!

When forth from thee I've swiftly passed!

**Found. Never sought. Praised.
Cursed. Same.**

Die Menschen sind im ganzen Leben blind,

Throughout their whole existence men are
blind;

Have you never known Care?

Nun, Fauste, werde du's am Ende!

So, Faust, be thou like them at last!

**You've felt me before, haven't you?
We've danced this dance.**

(Sie haucht ihn an.) (She breathes in his face.)

Faust (erblindet) (blinded)

Die Nacht scheint tiefer tief hereinzudrin-
gen,

The Night seems deeper now to press
around me,

**The familiarity of dread—haven't you
felt this weight before?**

Allein im Innern leuchtet helles Licht;

But in my inmost spirit all is light;

I only ran through the world; each desire I seized by the hair

Was ich gedacht, ich eil' es zu vollbringen;

I rest not till the finished work hath crowned me:

I speedran life, grabbed every craving by the hair like I was dragging it to prom

Des Herren Wort, es gibt allein Gewicht.

The master's Word alone bestows the might.

Grasping, always grasping, fingers in everything

Vom Lager auf, ihr Knechte! Mann für Mann!

Up from your couches, vassals, man by man!

**What wasn't enough? I let it LEAVE!
What escaped? ALSO LEAVE! Efficiency!**

Lasst glücklich schauen, was ich kühn ersann.

Make grandly visible my daring plan!

Grabbed. Took. Dropped the rest. Ran.

Ergreift das Werkzeug, Schaufel ruhrt und Spaten!

Seize now your tools, with spade and shovel press!

What did not satisfy, I let go; what escaped me, I let pass

Das Abgesteckte muss sogleich geraten.

The work traced out must be a swift success.

I only ever wanted and got, wanted again and took—life at full throttle

Auf strenges Ordnen, raschen Fleiss

Quick diligence, severest ordering

Storming through existence, grabbing and releasing, all motion

Erfolgt der allerschönste Preis;

The most superb reward shall bring;

First it was big and powerful, now it's wise and careful—character development

Dass sich das grösste Werk vollende,

And, that the mighty work completed stands,

**First great and mighty, now it goes
wisely, goes carefully**

Genugt ein Geist fur tausend Hande.

One mind suffices for a thousand hands.

**Earth's sphere? Known. Beyond?
BLOCKED. The view is BARRED!**

Grosser Vorhof des Palasts / Great Outer Court of the Palace

Mephistopheles (als Aufseher / as Overseer)

Herbei, herbei! Herein, herein! Come here, come here! Come on, come on! **Come here, come here! Come on, come on!**

Ihr schlotternden Lemuren, Ye Lemures, loose-hung creatures! **Get over here! Move it, move it!**

Aus Baendern, Sehnen und Gebein Of sinew, ligament, and bone **The voice cracks like a whip, summoning shuffling forms**

Geflickte Halbnaturen. Your knitted semi-natures! **Here. Here. In. In. Now.**

Lemuren (im Chor / in Chorus)

Wir treten dir sogleich zur Hand, Without delay are we at hand, **Get your bony asses over here! Hustle!**

Und wie wir halb vernommen, And half 'tis our impression **CONVENE! ASSEMBLE! Enter through the DOOR-shaped DOOR!**

Es gilt wohl gar ein weites Land, That this discerns a spacious land, **You shivering Lemures,**

Das sollen wir bekommen. Whereof we'll have possession. **You rattling bag-of-bones crew,**

Gespitzte Pfaehle, die sind da, The pointed stakes, we bring them all, **Bodies that tremble because they barely hold together**

Die Kette lang zum Messen; The measuring-chain, for distance; **You shaky motherfuckers made of spare parts,**

Warum an uns den Ruf geschah, But we've forgotten why the call **You QUIVERING LEMURS! Half-ghosts! Structural disasters!**

Das haben wir vergessen. Was made for our assistance. **Shaking corpse-things. Come.**

Mephistopheles

Hier gilt kein kuenstlerisch Bemuehn; Here is no need of your artistic zeal: **Stitched together from ligaments, tendons, and bone,**

Verfahret nur nach eignen Massen! Proceed as you may think it best! **Cobbled from sinew and skeleton like discount Halloween props,**

Der Laengste lege laengelang sich hin, Your tallest lay full length, from head to heel, **Held together by threads of cartilage, each joint a prayer**

Ihr andern lueftet ringsumher den Rasen; And lift the turf around him, all the rest! **From SPARE PARTS! Like IKEA furniture but WORSE and DEAD!**

Wie man's fuer unsre Vaeter tat, As for our fathers made, prepare **Scraps. Strings. Bones. Sewn.**

Vertieft ein laengliches Quadrat! To excavate a lengthened square! **Patched-up half-natures.**

Aus dem Palast ins enge Haus, From palace to the narrow house transferred, **You frankensteined half-beings, barely qualifying as anatomy,**

So dumm laeuft es am Ende doch hinaus. Such is, at last, the issue most absurd. **You duct-taped semi-creatures,**

Lemuren (grabend, mit neckischen Gebaerden / digging, with mocking gestures)

Wie jung ich war und lebt' und liebt', In youth when I did love, did love, **Incomplete, approximate, almost-things**

Mich deucht, das war wohl suesse; Methought it was very sweet; **HALF-NATURES! The economy model**

of existence!

Wo's froehlich klang und lustig ging, When 'twas
jolly and merry every way, **Half-made. Half-here.
Enough.**

Da ruehrten sich meine Fuesse. And I blithely moved
my feet. **We come to your hand immediately,**

Nun hat das tueckische Alter mich But now old Age,
with his stealing steps, **We're at your service, boss,
right on time,**

Mit seiner Kruecke getroffen; Hath clawed me with
his crutch: **Shuffling forward with what passes
for eagerness in the dead**

Ich stolpert' ueber Grabes Tuer, I stumbled over the
door of a grave; **Here. At hand. Ready. Ish.**

Warum stand sie just offen! Why leave they open
such? **And as we half understood,**

Faust (tritt aus dem Palast, tastet an den Tuerpfosten
/ comes forth from the Palace, groping his way along
the doorposts)

Wie das Geklirr der Spaten mich ergetzt! How I rejoice,
to hear the clattering spade! **We sorta halfway got
the memo,**

Es ist die Menge, die mir froenet, It is the crowd, for
me in service moiling. **We PARTIALLY COMPRE-
HENDED with our PARTIAL BRAINS!**

Die Erde mit sich selbst versöhnet, Till Earth be reconciled to toiling, **Half-hearing with half-functioning ears**

Den Wellen ihre Grenze setzt, Till the proud waves be stayed, **It concerns a wide land altogether,**

Das Meer mit strengem Band umzieht. And the sea girded with a rigid zone. **Something about a big piece of real estate?**

Mephistopheles (beiseite / aside)

Du bist doch nur fuer uns bemueht And yet, thou'rt labouring for us alone, **A SPACIOUS LAND! Like a PARKING LOT but with more SOIL!**

Mit deinen Daemmen, deinen Buhnen; With all thy dikes and bulwarks daring; **Big land. We heard. Sort of.**

Denn du bereitest schon Neptunen, Since thou for Neptune art preparing – **That we are supposed to get.**

Dem Wasserteufel, grossen Schmaus. The Ocean-Devil – carousal great. **Which apparently we're gonna score somehow,**

In jeder Art seid ihr verloren; – In every way shall ye be stranded; **That's coming our way, supposedly,**

Die Elemente sind mit uns verschworen, The elements with us are banded. **Ownership promised to hands that can barely grip**

Und auf Vernichtung laeuft's hinaus. And ruin is the certain fate. **Pointed stakes, they are here,**

Faust

Aufseher! – Overseer! **Sharp stakes? Check. We brought those.**

Mephistopheles

Hier! – Here! **Stakes. Sharp. Present.**

Faust

Wie es auch moeglich sei, However possible, **POINTED IMPLEMENTS! For SURVEYING! Or VAMPIRES! Unclear!**

Arbeiter schaffe Meng' auf Menge, Collect a crowd of men with vigour, **The chain long for measuring;**

Ermuntere durch Genuss und Strenge, Spur by indulgence, praise, or rigour, – **The measuring chain, long as hell,**

Bezahle, locke, presse bei! Reward, allure, conscript, compel! **Cold links for marking distances in earth**

Mit jedem Tage will ich Nachricht haben, Each day report me, and correctly note **Surveyor's chain, extra-long edition,**

Wie sich verlaengt der unternommene Graben. How grows in length the undertaken moat. **Why the call came to us,**

Mephistopheles (halblaut / half aloud)

Man spricht, wie man mir Nachricht gab, When they to me the information gave, **Why WE were summoned specifically?**

Von keinem Graben, doch vom Grab. They spake not of a moat, but of – a grave. **Why us? Good question.**

Faust

Ein Sumpf zieht am Gebirge hin, Below the hills a marshy plain **Why the fuck we're even here,**

Verpestet alles schon Errungene; Infects what I so long have been retrieving; **That we have forgotten.**

Den faulen Pfuhl auch abzuziehn, This stagnant pool likewise to drain **Yeah, we totally blanked on that part.**

Das Letzte waer' das Hoechsterrungene. Were now my latest and my best achieving. **The purpose slipped through the sieves of rotted memory**

Eroeffn' ich Raeume vielen Millionen, To many millions let me furnish soil, **FORGOTTEN! Our memories are DECORATIVE at best!**

Nicht sicher zwar, doch taetig-frei zu wohnen. Though not secure, yet free to active toil; **Forgot. As usual.**

Gruen das Gefilde, fruchtbar; Mensch und Herde
Green, fertile fields, where men and herds go forth
Here no artistic effort is needed;

Sogleich behaglich auf der neusten Erde, At once,
with comfort, on the newest Earth, **No need to get
fancy with this one,**

Gleich angesiedelt an des Huegels Kraft, And swiftly
settled on the hills' firm base, **Don't strain your sin-
gle remaining brain cells on art,**

Den aufgewaelzt kuehn-emsige Voelkerschaft. Cre-
ated by the bold, industrious race. **No art required.
Simple job.**

Im Innern hier ein paradiesisch Land, A land like
Paradise here, round about: **Proceed according to
your own measurements!**

Da rase draussen Flut bis auf zum Rand, Up to the
brink the tide may roar without, **Use YOUR OWN
BODIES as the measuring system! Very METRIC!**

Und wie sie nascht, gewaltsam einzuschiessen, And
though it gnaw, to burst with force the limit, **Your de-
cayed frames are the only rulers needed**

Gemeindrang eilt, die Luecke zu verschliessen. By
common impulse all unite to hem it. **Just use
yourselves as the tape measure,**

Ja! diesem Sinne bin ich ganz ergeben, Yes, to this
thought I hold with firm persistence; **The tallest lay
full length along,**

Das ist der Weisheit letzter Schluss: The last result
of wisdom stamps it true: **Tallest one, stretch your
bony ass out flat,**

Nur der verdient sich Freiheit wie das Leben, He only
earns his freedom and existence, **Biggest guy, lie
down and be the benchmark,**

Der taeglich sie erobern muss. Who daily conquers
them anew. **Tall one. Lie down. Full length.**

Und so verbringt, umrungen von Gefahr, Thus here,
by dangers girt, shall glide away **One body laid out,
arms at sides, the shape of what's needed**

Hier Kindheit, Mann und Greis sein tuechtig Jahr. Of
childhood, manhood, age, the vigorous day: **You
others lift the turf all around;**

Solch ein Gewimmel moecht' ich sehn, And such a
throng I fain would see, – **The REST of you, perform
GRASS SURGERY around him!**

Auf freiem Grund mit freiem Volke stehn. Stand on
free soil among a people free! **Everyone else, peel
back the lawn,**

Zum Augenblicke duerft' ich sagen: Then dared I hail
the Moment fleeing: **Rest of you dipshits, start
peeling up that grass,**

Verweile doch, du bist so schoen! "Ah, still delay –
thou art so fair!" **Hands in soil, lifting green skin
from dark earth**

Es kann die Spur von meinen Erdetagen The traces

cannot, of mine earthly being, **As was done for our forefathers,**

Nicht in Aeonen untergehn. – In aeons perish, – they are there! – **The way we did it for the old-timers,**

Im Vorgefuehl von solchem hohen Glueck In proud fore-feeling of such lofty bliss, **As for fathers. Traditional.**

Geniess' ich jetzt den hoechsten Augenblick. I now enjoy the highest Moment – this! **Like we did for dear old dead granddad,**

(Faust sinkt zurueck, die Lemuren fassen ihn auf und legen ihn auf den Boden / Faust sinks back: the Lemures take him and lay him upon the ground.)

Mephistopheles

Den letzten, schlechten, leeren Augenblick, No joy could sate him, and suffice no bliss! **Deepen an oblong square!**

Der Arme wuenscht ihn festzuhalten. To catch but shifting shapes was his endeavour: **Excavate a RECTANGULAR RECTANGULAR thing! GEOMETRY!**

Der mir so kraeftig widerstand, The latest, poorest, emptiest Moment – this, – **The shape takes form: long, narrow, final**

Die Zeit wird Herr, der Greis hier liegt im Sand. He wished to hold it fast for ever. **Dig out a nice long**

rectangle—you know the shape.

Die Uhr steht still – – Me he resisted in such vigorous wise, **Oblong. Square. Dig deep.**

But Time is lord, on earth the old man lies.

The clock stands still –

Chor

Steht still! Sie schweigt wie Mitternacht. Stands still! silent as midnight, now! **From the palace to the narrow house,**

Der Zeiger faellt. – The index falls. **From the fancy palace to the dirt box,**

Mephistopheles

Er faellt, es ist vollbracht. It falls; and it is finished, here! **From mansion to six-foot apartment,**

Chor

Es ist vorbei. – 'Tis past! **From PALACE to COFFIN! The ultimate DOWNSIZING!**

Mephistopheles

Vorbei! ein dummes Wort. – Past! a stupid word. **From grand halls to the box that fits one**

Warum vorbei? If past, then why? **So stupidly does it run out at the end.**

Vorbei und reines Nicht, vollkommnes Einerlei! Past and pure Naught, complete monotony! **That's the dumb punchline every time.**

Was soll uns denn das ew'ge Schaffen! What good for us, this endlessly creating? – **Same ending. Always stupid.**

Geschaffenes zu nichts hinwegzuraffen! What is created then annihilating? **What a fucking moronic finale for everyone.**

“Da ist's vorbei!” Was ist daran zu lesen? “And now it's past!” Why read a page so twisted? **The conclusion is ALWAYS this ABSURD! Every single biography!**

Es ist so gut, als waer' es nicht gewesen, 'Tis just the same as if it ne'er existed, **Every life narrows to this joke**

Und treibt sich doch im Kreis, als wenn es waere. Yet goes in circles round as if it had, however: **When I was young and lived and loved,**

Ich liebte mir dafuer das Ewig-Leere. I'd rather choose, instead, the Void for ever. **Back when I was young and alive and getting some,**

Grablegung / Sepulture (Entombment)

Lemur (Solo)

Wer hat das Haus so schlecht gebaut, Who then
hath built the house so ill, **Who built this house so
garbage-tier**

Mit Schaufeln und mit Spaten? With shovel and with
spade? **With shovels and with spades?**

Lemuren (Chor / Chorus)

Dir, dumpfer Gast im haenfñen Gewand, For thee, dull
guest, in hempen vest, **For you, dull guest in hemp-
rope threads**

Ist's viel zu gut geraten. It all too well was made. **Way**

too nice, this dump upgrades

Lemur (Solo)

Wer hat den Saal so schlecht versorgt? Who then so ill
hath decked the hall? **Who furnished this hall like
they didn't care?**

Wo blieben Tisch und Stuehle? No chairs, nor table
any! **Where'd the table and chairs get off to?**

Lemuren (Chor / Chorus)

Es war auf kurze Zeit geborgt; 'Twas borrowed to re-
turn at call: **It was borrowed for a short-term stay**

Der Glaeubiger sind so viele. The creditors are so
many. **The creditors lined up to scoff you**

Mephistopheles

Der Koerper liegt, und will der Geist entfliehn, The
Body lies, and if the Spirit flee, **The body lies, and if
the ghost wants out**

Ich zeig' ihm rasch den blutgeschriebnen Titel; – I'll
show it speedily my blood-signed title. – **I'll flash the
blood-signed contract in his face**

Doch leider hat man jetzt so viele Mittel, But, ah!
they've found such methods of requital, **But sadly
now they've got so many tricks**

Dem Teufel Seelen zu entziehn. His souls the Devil
must oft abstracted see! **To snatch souls from the
Devil's embrace**

Auf altem Wege stoest man an, One now offends,
the ancient way; **The old way? Total offense these
days**

Auf neuem sind wir nicht empfohlen; Upon the new
we're not yet recommended: **The new way? We're
not recommended**

Sonst haett' ich es allein getan, Once, I alone secured
my prey, **Once I could've done this gig solo**

Jetzt muss ich Helfershelfer holen. But now by
helpers need to be befriended. **Now I need backup,
my rep got upended**

Uns geht's in allen Dingen schlecht! In all things we
must feel the spite! **Things go shit for us in every
domain!**

Herkoemmliche Gewohnheit, altes Recht, Transmitted
custom, ancient right, – **Traditional custom,
ancient rights**

Man kann auf gar nichts mehr vertrauen. Nothing, indeed,
can longer one confide in. **You can't trust jack
anymore these days**

Sonst mit dem letzten Atem fuhr sie aus, Once with
the last breath left the soul her house; **Used to be:
last breath and out she'd fly**

Ich passt' ihr auf und, wie die schnellste Maus, I kept

good watch, and like the nimblest mouse, **I'd catch her like the quickest mouse—why not?**

Schnapps! hielt ich sie in fest verschlossnen Klauen. Whack! was she caught, and fast my claws her hide in! **SNAP! Had her clamped in my claws, locked tight**

Nun zaudert sie und will den duestern Ort, Now she delays, and is not fain to quit **Now she dawdles, won't leave the dark dump**

Des schlechten Leichnams ekles Haus nicht lassen; The dismal place, the corpse's hideous mansion; **The nasty corpse-house, disgusting home**

Die Elemente, die sich hassen, The elements, in hostile, fierce expansion, **The elements that hate each other's guts**

Die treiben sie am Ende schmaehlich fort. Drive her, at last, disgracefully from it. **Eventually kick her out in shame alone**

Und wenn ich Tag' und Stunden mich zerplage, And though I fret and worry till I'm weary, **And when I fret for days and hours straight**

Wann? wie? und wo? das ist die leidige Frage; When? How? and Where? remains the fatal query: **When? How? Where? The annoying questions pile**

Der alte Tod verlor die rasche Kraft, Old Death is now no longer swift and strong: **Old Death has lost his quick-strike game**

Das Ob? sogar ist lange zweifelhaft; E'en the Whether has been doubtful long. **Even WHETHER? has been doubtful quite a while**

Oft sah ich luestern auf die starren Glieder – Oft I beheld with lust the rigid members: **Oft I've eyed the stiff limbs, feeling thirsty**

Es war nur Schein, das ruehrte, das regte sich wieder. 'Twas only sham; Life kindled from its embers. **Fake-out only! Life twitches back from death**

(Phantastisch-fluegelmaennische Beschwoerungsgebaerden / Fantastic, whirling gestures of conjuration)

Nur frisch heran! verdoppelt euren Schritt, Come on! Strike up the double quick, anew, **Now hop to it! Double-time your step**

Ihr Herrn vom graden, Herrn vom krummen Horne, With straight or crooked horns, ye gentlemen infernal! **You gents with straight horns, you with crooked ones**

Von altem Teufelsschrot und -korne, Of the old Devil-grit and kernel, **Old Devil-breed, the real grit-and-grain**

Bringt ihr zugleich den Hoellenrachen mit. And bring at once the Jaws of Hell with you! **Bring the Jaws of Hell along for tons**

Zwar hat die Hoelle Rachen viele! viele! Hell hath a multitude of jaws, in short, **Hell's got multiple mouths! So many!**

Nach Standsgebuehr und Wuerden schlingt sie ein;
To use as suiteth place and dignity; **She swallows
by rank and dignity**

Doch wird man auch bei diesem letzten Spiele But we,
however, in this final sport, **But in this final game
we're playing**

Ins kuenftige nicht so bedenklich sein. Will hence-
forth less considerate be. **We won't be picky—just
let it be**

(Der graeuliche Hoellenrachen tut sich links auf / The
fearful Jaws of Hell open, on the left)

Eckzaehne klaffen; dem Gewoelb des Schlundes The
side-tusks yawn: then from the throat abysmal **Fangs
yawn wide; from the gullet's vault**

Entquillt der Feuerstrom in Wut, The raging, fiery tor-
rents flow, **The fire-stream rages forth in fury**

Und in dem Siedequalm des Hintergrundes And in
the vapours of the background dismal **In the boiling
smoke-haze of the depths**

Seh' ich die Flammenstadt in ewiger Glut. I see the
city flame in endless glow. **I see the flame-city,
eternal and sulfury**

Die rote Brandung schlaegt hervor bis an die Zaehne,
Up to the teeth the breakers lash the red arena; **The
red surf crashes up to the teeth**

Verdammte, Rettung hoffend, schwimmen an; The
Damned, in hope of help, are swimming through;

Damned souls swim hoping for rescue

Doch kolossal zerknirscht sie die Hyaene, But, caught and mangled by the fell hyena, **But the colossal hyena crunches them flat**

Und sie erneuen aengstlich heisse Bahn. Their path of fiery torment they renew. **And they restart their anxious hot death-venue**

In Winkeln bleibt noch vieles zu entdecken, In every nook new horrors flash and brighten, **In corners there's still much to discover**

So viel Erschrecklichstes im engsten Raum! In narrow space so much of dread supreme! **So much terrible in the tightest space!**

Ihr tut sehr wohl, die Suender zu erschrecken; Well have you done, the sinners thus to frighten; **You do well to terrify the sinners**

Sie halten's doch fuer Lug und Trug und Traum. But still they'll think it lie, and cheat, and dream! **But they'll think it's lies, tricks, dream-embrace**

(Zu den Dickteufel mit kurzem, gradem Horn / To the stout Devils with short, straight horns)

Nun, wanstige Schuften mit den Feuerbacken! Now, paunchy scamps, with cheeks so redly burning! **Now, paunchy scamps with fire-cheeks ablaze!**

Ihr glueht so recht vom Hoellenschwefel feist; Ye glow, so fat with hellish sulphur fed; **You glow so fat from Hell's own sulfur-feed**

Klotzartige, kurze, nie bewegte Nacken! With necks thick-set and stumpy, never turning, – **Blockhead necks, stumpy, never turning round**

Hier unten lauert, ob's wie Phosphor gleisst: Watch here below, if phosphor-light be shed: **Watch down here for phosphorus, take heed**

Das ist das Seelchen, Psyche mit den Fluegeln, It is the Soul, the winged Psyche is it; **That's the little soul—Psyche with her wings**

Die rupft ihr aus, so ist's ein garstiger Wurm; Pluck off the wings, 'tis but a hideous worm: **Rip them off, she's just a nasty worm**

Mit meinem Stempel will ich sie besiegeln, First with my stamp and seal the thing I'll visit, **With my stamp I'll brand and seal the thing**

Dann fort mit ihr im Feuerwirbelsturm! Then fling it to the whirling, fiery storm! **Then off with her in the fire-whirlwind storm!**

Passt auf die niedern Regionen, The lower parts be well inspected, **Keep your eyes on the lower regions**

Ihr Schlaeuche, das ist eure Pflicht; Ye Bloats! perform your duty well: **You bloated bags, that's your job description**

Ob's ihr beliebte, da zu wohnen, If there the Soul her seat selected **Whether she likes living down there**

So akkurat weiss man das nicht. We cannot yet ex-

actly tell. **We don't know with precision**

Im Nabel ist sie gern zu Haus – Oft in the navel doth she stay: **In the navel she loves to hang out**

Nehmt es in acht, sie wischt euch dort heraus. Look out for that, she thence may slip away! **Watch for that—she'll slip out from your grip**

(Zu den Duernteufel mit langem, krummem Horn / To the lean Devils, with long, crooked horns)

Ihr Firlefanze, fluegelmmaennische Riesen, Ye lean buffoons, file-leaders strange and giant, **You twiggy clowns, you flapping giant freaks**

Greift in die Luft, versucht euch ohne Rast! Grasp in the air, yourselves no respite give! **Grab at the air, give yourselves no rest!**

Die Arme strack, die Klauen scharf gewiesen, Strong in the arms, with talons sharp and pliant, **Arms straight out, claws sharp and ready**

Dass ihr die Flatternde, die Fluechtige fasst. That ye may seize the fluttering fugitive! **Catch the fluttery fugitive—do your best!**

Es ist ihr sicher schlecht im alten Haus, In her old home discomfited she lies, **She's surely uncomfortable in the old house**

Und das Genie, es will gleich obenaus. And Genius, surely, seeks at once to rise. **And Genius always wants to rise up top**

(Glorie von oben, rechts / Glory from above, on the right)

Himmlische Heerschar / The Heavenly Host

Folget, Gesandte, Envoys, unhindered, **Follow, messengers**

Himmelsverwandte, Heavenly kindred, **Heaven-kindred folk**

Gemaechlichen Flugs: Follow us here! **In leisurely flight**

Suendern vergeben, Sinners forgiving, **Sinners forgiving**

Staub zu beleben; Dust to make living! **Dust into living**

Allen Naturen Lovingest features **To all natures**

Freundliche Spuren Unto all creatures **Friendly traces**

Wirket im Schweben Show in your swaying, **Work as you hover**

Des weilenden Zugs! Delaying career! **In your dawdling parade!**

Mephistopheles

Misstoene hoer' ich, garstiges Geklimper, Discords I hear, a harsh, disgusting strumming, **Dissonance I hear, nasty clinking trash**

Von oben kommt's mit unwillkommnem Tag; Flung
from above with the unwelcome Day; **From above it
comes with unwelcome Day**

Es ist das buebisch-maedchenhafte Gestuemper, 'Tis
that emasculate and bungled humming **It's that
boy-girl amateurish fumbling**

Wie froemmelnder Geschmack sich's lieben mag.
Which Pious Cant delights in, every way. **Just how
pious-taste prefers to play**

Ihr wisst, wie wir in tiefverruchten Stunden You know
how we, atrociously contented, **You know how in
our deep-depraved hours**

Vernichtung sannen menschlichem Geschlecht;
Destruction for the human race have planned: **We
schemed destruction for all humankind**

Das Schaendlichste, was wir erfunden, But the most
infamous that we've invented **The most shameful
thing we ever invented**

Ist ihrer Andacht eben recht. Is just the thing their
prayers demand. **Is exactly what their prayers are
designed to find**

Sie kommen gleisnerisch, die Laffen! The fops, they
come as hypocrites, to fool us! **The fops come slith-
ering, hypocrites!**

So haben sie uns manchen weggeschnappt, Thus
many have they snatched, before our eyes: **They've
snatched many souls from under our nose**

Bekriegen uns mit unsern eignen Waffen; With our own weapons they would overrule us; **They wage war with our own weapons**

Es sind auch Teufel, doch verkappt. They're also Devils – in disguise. **They're Devils too—just wearing different clothes**

Hier zu verlieren, waer' euch ew'ge Schande; To lose this case would be your lasting shame; **Losing here would be your eternal shame!**

Ans Grab heran und haltet fest am Rande! On to the grave, and fortify your claim! **To the grave! Hold the edge! Stake your claim!**

Chor der Engel (Rosen streuend / scattering roses)

Rosen, ihr blendenden, Roses, ye glowing ones, **Roses, you dazzling ones**

Balsam versendenden! Balsam-bestowing ones! **Balsam-dispensing ones**

Flatternde, schwebende, Fluttering, quivering, **Fluttering, hovering**

Heimlich belebende, Sweetness delivering, **Secretly life-giving**

Zweigleinbefluegelte, Branching unblightedly, **Little-branch-winged ones**

Knospenentsiegelte, Budding delightedly, **Bud-unsealed beauties**

Eilet zu bluehn. Bloom and be seen! **Hurry to bloom!**

Fruehling entspriesse, Springtime declare him, **Spring forth, emerge**

Purpur und Gruen! In purple and green! **Purple and green!**

Tragt Paradiese Paradise bear him, **Carry paradise**

Dem Ruhenden hin. The Sleeper serene! **To the one at rest**

Mephistopheles (zu den Satanen / to the Satans)

An seinen Platz ein jeder Gauch! Why do ye jerk and squat? Is this Hell's rule? **Every goof to his post!**

Sie denken wohl, mit solchen Bluemeleien Stand to your ground, and let them sprinkle! **They think with such flower-confetti**

Die heissen Teufel einzuschneien; Back to his place each gawky fool! **They can snow-in the hot devils**

Das schmilzt und schrumpft vor eurem Hauch. They think, perhaps, with such a flowery crinkle, **It melts and shrivels in your breath-ready**

Nun pustet, Puestriche! – Genug, genug! As if 'twere snow, the Devils' heat to cool: **Now blow, you Puffers!—Enough, enough!**

Vor eurem Broden bleicht der ganze Flug. – Your breath shall make it melt, and shrink, and wrinkle.

Your vapor bleaches the whole flying swarm

Nicht so gewaltsam! schliesset Maul und Nasen! Now blow, ye Blowers! – 'Tis enough, enough! **Not so violent! Shut your mouths and noses!**

Fürwahr, ihr habt zu stark geblasen. Before your breath fades all the floating stuff. **Damn, you've blown too strong, too warm**

Dass ihr doch nie die rechten Masse kennt! Not so much violence, – shut jaws and noses! **You never learn the proper measure!**

Das schrumpft nicht nur, es braeunt sich, dorrt, es brennt! Forsooth, ye blow too strongly at the roses. **It doesn't just shrink—it browns, dries, BURNS!**

Schon schwebt's heran mit giftig klaren Flammen; The proper measure can you never learn? **Now it floats near with poisonous clear flames**

Stemmt euch dagegen, draengt euch fest zusammen! – They sting not only, but they wither, burn! **Brace against it, cluster tight in turns!**

Die Kraft erlischt! dahin ist aller Mut! They hover on with flames of deadly lustre: **Your force dies out! All courage gone!**

Die Teufel wittern fremde Schmeichelglut. Resist them ye, and close together cluster! – **The Devils sniff strange flattering heat**

Your force gives out; all courage fails you so:

The Devils scent the strange, alluring glow.

Chor der Engel / Chorus of Angels

Blueten, die seligen, Blossoms of gratitude, **Blossoms, the blessed ones**

Flammen, die froehlichen, Flames of beatitude, **Flames, the joyful ones**

Liebe verbreiten sie, Love they are bearing now, **Love they spread around**

Wonne bereiten sie, Rapture preparing now, **Bliss they prepare**

Herz wie es mag. As the heart may: **Heart as it wishes**

Worte, die wahren, Truth in its nearness, **Words that are true**

Aether im Klaren, Ether in clearness, **Ether so clear**

Ewigen Scharen Give the Eternal Hosts **Eternal hosts**

Ueberall Tag! Everywhere Day! **Everywhere Day!**

Mephistopheles

O Fluch! o Schande solchen Troepfen! O curse and shame upon such dolts be sped! **O curse! O shame on such drips!**

Satane stehen auf den Koepfen, Each Satan stands upon his head! **Satans standing on their heads!**

Die Plumpen schlagen Rad auf Rad In somersaults
the stout ones whirl and swerve, **The fat ones do
cartwheels in loops**

Und stuerzen aerrschlings in die Hoelle. And into Hell
plunge bottom-uppermost. **And tumble ass-first
into Hell's beds**

Gesegn' euch das verdiente heisse Bad! Now may
your bath be hot as you deserve! **Bless you with the
deserved hot bath!**

Ich aber bleib' auf meiner Stelle. – But I remain, un-
flinching, at my post. **But I stay firm at my station**

(sich der schwebenden Rosen erwehrend / Beating off
the hovering roses)

Irrlichter, fort! Du, leuchte noch so stark, Off, Will-o'-
the-wisps! Bright as ye seem to be, **Will-o'-wisps,
scram! You, shine all you want**

Du bleibst, gehascht, ein ekler Gallert-Quark. When
caught, the vilest clinging filth are ye. **Once caught,
you're gross jelly-crud mutation**

Was flatterst du? Willst du dich packen! – Why flutter
thus? Off with you, quick! – **Why flutter so? Want to
get gone?—**

Es klemmt wie Pech und Schwefel mir im Nacken.
Like pitch and sulphur on my neck they stick. **They
stick like pitch and sulfur on my neck**

Chor der Engel / Chorus of Angels

Was euch nicht angehoeret, What not appertaineth
What doesn't belong to you

Muesset ihr meiden, To you, cease to share it! **You must avoid it**

Was euch das Innre stoeret, What inwardly paineth,
What disturbs your inner core

Duerft ihr nicht leiden. Refuse ye to bear it! **You dare not endure it**

Dringt es gewaltig ein, If it press in with might, **If it presses in by force**

Muessen wir tuechtig sein. Use we our stronger right:
We must be mighty in recourse

Liebe nur Liebende Love but the Loving **Love only leads the loving**

Fuehret herein! Leads to the Light! **Into the light!**

Mephistopheles

Mir brennt der Kopf, das Herz, die Leber brennt, My head, heart, liver, by the flames are rent! **My head burns, my heart burns, my liver's on fire!**

Ein ueberteuflich Element! An over-devilish element! – **An over-devilish element here!**

Weit spitziger als Hoellenfeuer! – Sharper than Hell's red conflagration! **Way sharper than Hell's own flames!**

Drum jammert ihr so ungeheuer, Thence so enormous is your lamentation, **That's why you whine so enormously**

Unglueckliche Verliebte! die, verschmaeht, Unfortunate Enamoured! who, so spurned, **Unlucky lovers! —who, spurned and rejected**

Verdrehten Halses nach der Liebsten spaecht. Your heads towards the sweethearts' side have turned. **Crane your twisted necks toward the beloved**

Auch mir! Was zieht den Kopf auf jene Seite? Mine, too! What twists my head in like position? **Me too! What pulls my head that way?**

Bin ich mit ihr doch in geschwornem Streite! With them am I not sworn to competition? **I'm sworn enemies with them, hello!**

Der Anblick war mir sonst so feindlich scharf. The sight of them once made my hatred worse. **Their sight used to sting me hostile-sharp**

Hat mich ein Fremdes durch und durch gedrungen? Hath then an alien force transpierced my nature? **Has something foreign pierced right through me?**

Ich mag sie gerne sehn, die allerliebsten Jungen; I like to see them, youths of loveliest stature; **I actually LIKE looking at these darling boys**

Was haelt mich ab, dass ich nicht fluchen darf? – What now restrains me, that I dare not curse? **What stops me from being able to curse?—**

Und wenn ich mich betoeren lasse, And if I take their
cozening bait so, **And if I let myself get duped**

Wer heisst denn kuenftighin der Tor? Who else, hence-
forth, the veriest fool will be? **Who's the fool going
forward then?**

Die Wetterbuben, die ich hasse, The stunning fellows,
whom I hate so, **These punk-ass weather-boys I
hate**

Sie kommen mir doch gar zu lieblich vor! – How very
charming they appear to me! – **But they look way
too lovely, amen**

Ihr schoenen Kinder, lasst mich wissen: Tell me,
sweet children, ere I miss you, **You pretty children,
let me know**

Seid ihr nicht auch von Luzifers Geschlecht? Are ye
not of the race of Lucifer? **Aren't you also from
Lucifer's stock?**

Ihr seid so huebsch, fürwahr ich moecht' euch
kuessen, You are so fair, forsooth, I'd like to kiss you;
You're so cute, truly I'd like to kiss you

Mir ist's, als kaemt ihr eben recht. It seems to me as
if ye welcome were. **Feels like you came at just the
right o'clock**

Es ist mir so behaglich, so natuerlich, I feel as com-
fortable and as trustful, **It feels so cozy, so natural
to me**

Als haett' ich euch schon tausendmal gesehn; As

though a thousand times ere this we'd met! **Like I've seen you a thousand times before**

So heimlich-kaetzchenhaft begierlich; So surreptitiously catlike-lustful: **So secretly cat-like, full of desire**

Mit jedem Blick aufs neue schoener schoen. With every glance ye're fairer, fairer yet. **With every glance you're prettier, pretty, more**

O naehert euch, o goennt mir einen Blick! O, nearer come, – O, grant me one sweet look! **O come closer! O grant me one look!**

Engel / Angels

Wir kommen schon, warum weichst du zurueck? We come! Why shrink? Canst not our presence brook? **We're coming! Why do you shrink back?**

Wir naehern uns, und wenn du kannst, so bleib! Now we approach: so, if thou canst, remain! **We approach –if you can, then stay!**

(Die Engel nehmen, umherziehend, den ganzen Raum ein / The Angels, coming forward, occupy the whole space)

Mephistopheles (der ins Proszenium gedraengt wird / who is crowded into the proscenium)

Ihr scheltet uns verdammte Geister Us, Spirits

damned, you brand with censure, **You call US damned spirits—the nerve!**

Und seid die wahren Hexenmeister; Yet you are wizards by indenture; **But you're the real witch-masters here**

Denn ihr verfuehret Mann und Weib. – For man and woman, luring, you enchain. – **Since you seduce both man and woman**

Welch ein verfluchtes Abenteuer! What chance the curst adventure brings me? **What a cursed adventure this is!**

Ist dies das Liebeselement? Is this Love's chosen element? **Is THIS the element of Love?**

Der ganze Koerper steht in Feuer, The fire o'er all my body stings me; **My whole body stands in fire**

Ich fuehle kaum, dass es im Nacken brennt. – My neck I scarcely feel, so hotly sprent. – **I barely feel my neck burn above**

Ihr schwanket hin und her, so senkt euch nieder, Ye hover back and forth; sink down and settle! **You sway back and forth—now sink down lower**

Ein bisschen weltlicher bewegt die holden Glieder; Move your sweet limbs with more of worldly mettle! **Move those sweet limbs a bit more worldly**

Fuerwar, der Ernst steht euch recht schoen; The serious air befits you well, awhile, **Indeed, the serious look suits you nice**

Doch moecht' ich euch nur einmal laecheln sehn! But
I should like, just once, to see you smile; **But I'd love
to see you smile, so pearly**

Das waere mir ein ewiges Entzuecken. That were, for
me, an everlasting rapture. **That would be eternal
rapture for me**

Ich meine so, wie wenn Verliebte blicken: I mean, as
lovers look, the heart to capture; **I mean, like when
lovers exchange looks**

Ein kleiner Zug am Mund, so ist's getan. About the
mouth a simper there must be. **A little tug at the
mouth—that's the ticket**

Dich, langer Bursche, dich mag ich am liebsten leiden,
Thee, tall one, as enticing I'll admit thee, **You, tall fel-
low, you I like most**

Die Pfaffenmiene will dich gar nicht kleiden, The
priestly mien does not at all befit thee, **The priestly
mien doesn't suit you at all**

So sieh mich doch ein wenig luestern an! So look at
me the least bit wantonly! **So look at me a bit more
lustily!**

Auch koenntet ihr anstaendig-nackter gehen, You
might be nakeder, and modest made so: **You could
also go more decently naked**

Das lange Faltenhemd ist uebersittlich – Your shirts'
long drapery is over-moral. – **That long pleated
shirt is over-moral**

Sie wenden sich – von hinten anzusehen! – They turn!
– and, from the rear surveyed so, **They turn around**
—seen from behind!—

Die Racker sind doch gar zu appetitlich! With their attraction there's no need to quarrel! **The rascals are just too appetizing, total**

Chor der Engel / Chorus of Angels

Wendet zur Klarheit Love still revealing, **Turn toward clarity**

Euch, liebende Flammen! Flames, become clearer!
You, loving flames!

Die sich verdammen, All, cursed with error, **Those who damn themselves**

Heile die Wahrheit; Truth be their healing! **Let truth heal their claims**

Dass sie vom Bösen Glad self-retrieval **That they from evil**

Froh sich erlösen, Free them from Evil, **Gladly redeem themselves**

Um in dem Allverein In the all-folding Breast, **To be blessed**

Selig zu sein. Blessed, to rest! **In the all-union!**

Mephistopheles (sich fassend / collecting himself)

Wie wird mir! – Hiobsartig, Beul' an Beule How is't
with me! – Like Job, the boils have cleft me **What's
happening to me!—Job-style, boil on boil**

Der ganze Kerl, dem's vor sich selber graut, From
head to foot, so that myself I shun; **The whole guy,
who horrifies himself**

Und triumphiert zugleich, wenn er sich ganz durch-
schaut, Yet triumph also, when my self-inspection's
done, – **Yet triumphs too when he sees through
himself**

Wenn er auf sich und seinen Stamm vertraut; When
self and tribe I have confided in. **When he trusts
himself and his bloodline**

Gerettet sind die edlen Teufelsteile, The noble Devil-
parts, at least, are left me! **The noble Devil-parts
are rescued!**

Der Liebespuk, er wirft sich auf die Haut; This love-
attack's a rash upon the skin. **The love-spook
throws itself onto the skin**

Schon ausgebrannt sind die verruchten Flammen,
Burned out already are the scurvy fires, **The ac-
cursed flames already burned out**

Und wie es sich gehoert, fluch' ich euch allzusammen!
And one and all I damn you, as the case requires! **And
as is proper, I curse you all within!**

Chor der Engel / Chorus of Angels

Heilige Gluten! Hallowed glories! **Sacred embers!**

Wen sie umschweben, Round whom they brood,
Whoever they hover round

Fuehlt sich im Leben Wakes unto being **Feels life it-
self**

Selig mit Guten. Of bliss with the Good. **Blessed with
the Good**

Alle vereinigt Join ye, the Glorified, **All unite**

Hebt euch und preist! Rise to your goal! **Rise up and
praise!**

Luft ist gereinigt, Airs are all purified, – **Air is purified**

Atme der Geist! Breathe now the Soul! **Now breathe,
O Soul!**

(Sie erheben sich, Faustens Unsterbliches ent-
fuehrend / They rise, bearing away the immortal part
of Faust)

Mephistopheles (sich umsehend / looking around
him)

Doch wie? – wo sind sie hingezogen? But how! – at
once I find them failing! **But how!—Where'd they
go?**

Unmuendiges Volk, du hast mich ueberrascht, This
race of minors takes me by surprise! **Underage
punks, you've blindsided me**

Sind mit der Beute himmelwaerts entflohen; They with their booty heavenwards are sailing; **They've flown heavenward with my loot**

Drum haben sie an dieser Gruft genascht! Thence on this grave they cast their greedy eyes! **That's why they nibbled at this grave!**

Mir ist ein grosser, einziger Schatz entwendet: My rare, great treasure they have peculated: **A great unique treasure got jacked from me**

Die hohe Seele, die sich mir verpfaendet, The lofty soul, to me hypothecated, **The lofty soul who pledged herself to me**

Die haben sie mir pfiffig weggepascht. They've rapt away from me in cunning wise. **They've cunningly snatched her away**

Bei wem soll ich mich nun beklagen? But unto whom shall I appeal for justice? **To whom should I now complain?**

Wer schafft mir mein erworbenes Recht? Who would secure to me my well-earned right? **Who gets me my earned rights back?**

Du bist getauscht in deinen alten Tagen, Tricked so in one's old days, a great disgust is; **You've been fooled in your old age, bro**

Du hast's verdient, es geht dir grimmig schlecht. And I deserve it, this infernal spite. **You deserve it —grimly off-track**

Ich habe schimpflich missgehandelt, I've managed
in a most disgraceful fashion; **I've botched this
disgracefully**

Ein grosser Aufwand, schmaehlich! ist vertan; A great
investment has been thrown away: **A huge invest-
ment, shamefully wasted!**

Gemein Geluest, absurde Liebschaft wandelt By low-
est lust seduced, and senseless passion, **Common
lust, absurd infatuation**

Den ausgepichten Teufel an. The old, case-hardened
Devil went astray. **Hit the hardened Devil—he got
basted**

Und hat mit diesem kindisch-tollen Ding And if, from
all this childish-silly stuff **And if with this childish-
stupid thing**

Der Klugerfahrne sich beschaeftigt, His shrewd expe-
rience could not wrest him, **The wise old expert got
occupied**

So ist fuerwahr die Torheit nicht gering, So is,
forsooth, the folly quite enough **Then truly the
foolishness is no joke**

Die seiner sich am Schluss bemaechtigt. Which, in
conclusion, hath possessed him. **That possessed
him at the end—fried**

Bergschluchten / Mountain-Gorges, Forest, Rock, Desert

Heilige Anachoreten, gebirgsauf verteilt, gelagert
zwischen Klueften / Holy Anchorites, divided in
ascending planes, posted among the ravines

Chor und Echo / Chorus and Echo

Waldung, sie schwankt heran, Forests are waving
grand, **“Nature closing in? WE closing in on
NATURE.”**

Felsen, sie lasten dran, Rocks, they are huge at hand,
“Heavy? That’s just GRAVITY’S LOVE LANGUAGE.”

Wurzeln, sie klammern an, Clutching, the roots ex-
pand, **“Clutching? Trees invented COMMITMENT.”**

Stamm dicht an Stamm hinan, Thickly the tree-trunks

stand; **“Personal space? In THIS forest economy?”**

Woge nach Woge spritzt, Foaming comes wave on wave; **“Wave spray: DIVINE MOISTURIZER.”**

Hoehle, die tiefste, schuetzt. Shelter hath deepest cave; **“Shelter? The abyss CARES.”**

Loewen, sie schleichen stumm- Lions are prowling dumb, **“Silent lions: HEAVEN’S BOUNCERS.”**

freundlich um uns herum, Friendly where’er we come, **“Friendly lions? PROOF GOD HAS A SENSE OF HUMOR.”**

Ehren geweihten Ort, Honouring the sacred place, **“Consecration: better than lion repellent.”**

Heiligen Liebeshort. Refuge of Love and Grace! **“Love’s refuge: FINAL DESTINATION.”**

Pater ecstaticus (auf- und abschwebend / hovering up and down)

Ewiger Wonnebrand, Endless ecstatic fire, **“Eternal rapture: HEAVEN’S CENTRAL HEATING.”**

Gluehendes Lieband, Glow of the pure desire, **“Glowing with love? That’s not a BUG, it’s a FEATURE.”**

Siedender Schmerz der Brust, Pain of the pining breast, **“Seething pain? SACRED HEARTBURN.”**

Schaeumende Gotteslust. Rapture of God possessed! **“God-desire: it EFFERVESCES.”**

Pfeile, durchdringet mich, Arrows, transpierce ye me,
“Requesting arrows: SPEEDRUN TO HEAVEN.”

Lanzen, bezwinget mich, Lances, coerce ye me,
“Lances: ACUPUNCTURE OF THE SOUL.”

Keulen, zerschmettert mich, Bludgeons, so batter me,
“Clubs: BLUNT FORCE ENLIGHTENMENT.”

Blitze, durchwettert mich! Lightnings, so shatter me,
“Lightning: GOD’S INSTANT MESSAGE.”

Dass ja das Nichtige That all of mortality’s **“Worthlessness:
SCHEDULED FOR DESTRUCTION.”**

Alles verfluechtinge, Vain unrealities **“Vanishing act:
the BEST ACT.”**

Glaenze der Dauerstern, Die, and the Star above
“Eternal star: the NIGHTLIGHT OF EXISTENCE.”

Ewiger Liebe Kern. Beam but Eternal Love! **“Eternal
love’s core: the only REAL THING.”**

Pater profundus (tiefe Region / Lower Region)

Wie Felsenabgrund mir zu Fuessen As at my feet
abysses cloven **“Abyss below abyss: IT’S VOIDS
ALL THE WAY DOWN.”**

Auf tiefem Abgrund lastend ruht, Rest on abysses
deep below; **“Abysses nesting: RUSSIAN DOLLS
OF NOTHING.”**

Wie tausend Baeche strahlend fliesen As thousand
severed streams are woven **“Thousand streams:**

GOD'S PLAYLIST IS SHUFFLE."

Zum grausen Sturz des Schaums der Flut, To foamy floods that plunging go; **"Foaming crash: NATURE'S BASS DROP."**

Wie strack mit eignem kraeftigen Triebe As, up by self-impulsion driven, **"Self-lifting tree: PROOF THAT WANTING UP... WORKS."**

Der Stamm sich in die Luefte traegt: The tree its weight sustains in air, **"Trees: they INVENTED standing tall."**

So ist es die allmaechtige Liebe, To Love, Almighty Love, 'tis given **"Almighty Love: GRAVITY'S BOSS."**

Die alles bildet, alles hegt. All things to form, and all to bear. **"Love: forms all, sustains all, CARRIES ALL."**

Ist um mich her ein wildes Brausen, Around me sounds a savage roaring, **"Wild roaring: NATURE'S SURROUND SOUND."**

Als wogte Wald und Felsengrund, As rocks and forests heaved and swayed, **"Heaving earth: SOLID GROUND HAS MOODS."**

Und doch stuerzt, liebevoll im Sausen, Yet plunges, bounteous in its pouring, **"Loving deluge: DESTRUCTION WITH GOOD INTENTIONS."**

Die Wasserfuelle sich zum Schlund, The wealth of waters down the glade, **"Filling gorges: VALLEYS WANT THIS."**

Berufen, gleich das Tal zu waessern; Appointed then,
the vales to brighten; **“Valley watering: GOD’S
SPRINKLER SYSTEM.”**

Der Blitz, der flammend niederschlug, The bolt,
that flaming struck and burst, **“Lightning strike:
HEAVEN’S EXCLAMATION POINT.”**

Die Atmosphaere zu verbessern, The atmosphere
to cleanse and lighten, **“Atmosphere cleansing:
GODS DON’T USE AIR FRESHENER.”**

Die Gift und Dunst im Busen trug – Which pestilence in
its bosom nursed, – **“Murky atmosphere: NEEDED
THE SHOCK THERAPY.”**

Sind Liebesboten, sie verkuenden, Love’s heralds
both, the powers proclaiming **“Love’s heralds:
TORNADO MAIL CARRIERS.”**

Was ewig schaffend uns umwallt. Which, aye creative,
us infold. **“Eternal creating: YOU’RE INSIDE THE
POTTER’S HANDS.”**

Mein Innres moeg’ es auch entzuenden, May they,
within my bosom flaming, **“Inner kindling: SOUL
WANTS TO BURN.”**

Wo sich der Geist, verworren, kalt, Inspire the mind,
confused and cold, **“Confused spirit: LOST IN OWN
SKULL.”**

Verquaelt in stumpfer Sinne Schranken, Which frets
itself, through blunted senses, **“Dull senses: FIVE
BAD INFORMANTS.”**

Scharfangeschlossnem Kettenschmerz. As by the sharpest fetter-smart! **“Sharp chains: BONDAGE OVERACHIEVES.”**

O Gott! beschwichtige die Gedanken, O God, soothe Thou my thoughts bewildered, **“Soothing thoughts: GOD AS BRAIN WHISPERER.”**

Erleuchte mein beduerft'ges Herz! Enlighten Thou my needy heart! **“Needy heart: BEGGING FOR BRIGHTNESS.”**

Pater seraphicus (mittlere Region / Middle Region)

Welch ein Morgenwoelkchen schwebet What a cloud of morning hovers **“Morning cloudlet: HEAVEN'S COTTON CANDY.”**

Durch der Tannen schwankend Haar! O'er the pine-trees' tossing hair! **“Swaying hair: TREES ARE WORKING IT.”**

Ahn' ich, was im Innern lebet? Can I guess what life it covers? **“Sensing life within: CLOUD HAS TENANTS.”**

Es ist junge Geisterschar. They are spirits young and fair. **“Young spirits: KINDERGARTEN IN THE CLOUDS.”**

Chor seliger Knaben / Chorus of Blessed Boys

Sag uns, Vater, wo wir wallen, Tell us, Father, where

we wander; **“Where do we wander? EVEN HEAVEN NEEDS DIRECTIONS.”**

Sag uns, Guter, wer wir sind? Tell us, Kind One, who are we. **“Who are we: AFTERLIFE’S FIRST QUESTION.”**

Gluecklich sind wir: allen, allen Happy are we; for so tender **“Happy are we: IGNORANCE IS BLISS CONFIRMED.”**

Ist das Dasein so gelind. Unto all, it is, to Be. **“Gentle existence: BEING WEARS SILK.”**

Pater seraphicus

Knaben! Mitternachts-Geborne, Boys, brought forth in midnights haunted, **“Midnight-born: DELIVERED IN THE A.M. OF NOWHERE.”**

Halb erschlossen Geist und Sinn, Half-unsealed the sense and brain, **“Half-opened: SOULS STILL IN PACKAGING.”**

Fuer die Eltern gleich Verlorne, For the parents lost when granted, **“Lost to parents: HEAVEN’S ADOPTION IS FAST.”**

Fuer die Engel zum Gewinn. For the angels sweetest gain! **“Angels’ gain: HEAVEN NEEDED MORE SINGERS.”**

Dass ein Liebender zugegen, That a loving heart is nigh you **“Loving presence: DETECTABLE BY SOUL-RADAR.”**

Fuehlt ihr wohl, so naht euch nur; You can feel:
then come to me! **“Come near: HEAT-SEEKING
WELCOME.”**

Doch von schroffen Erdewegen, But of earthly ways
that try you, **“Earthly ways: THE CURRICULUM
THEY DODGED.”**

Glueckliche! habt ihr keine Spur. Blest ones! not
a trace have ye. **“No trace: EARTH MISSED ITS
CHANCE.”**

Steigt herab in meiner Augen Enter in mine eyes:
enjoy them, **“Into my eyes: SOUL-SHARE
ACTIVATED.”**

Welt- und erdgemaess Organ, Organs for the earthly
sphere! **“Earth-organs: LOANER EQUIPMENT.”**

Koennt sie als die euren brauchen, As your own ye
may employ them: **“Use as your own: TIMESHARE
EYEBALLS.”**

Schaut euch diese Gegend an! Look upon the land-
scape here! **“This region: THE GRAND TOUR.”**

(Er nimmt sie in sich / He takes them into himself)

Das sind Baeume, das sind Felsen, Those are trees,
there rocks defend us; **“Trees. Cliffs. THE STARTER
PACK.”**

Wasserstrom, der abestuerzt Here, a stream that
leaps below, **“Water plunging: GRAVITY’S FA-
VORITE SUBSTANCE.”**

Und mit ungeheurem Waelzen And with plunges, wild,

tremendous, **“Tremendous rolling: WATER CAN’T DO ANYTHING SIMPLY.”**

Sich den steilen Weg verkuerzt. Shorteneth its journey so. **“Shortening path: WATERFALLS ARE EFFICIENT.”**

Selige Knaben (von innen / from within him)

Das ist maechtig anzuschauen, To a vision grand we waken, **“Mighty view: SENSORY OVERWHELM.”**

Doch zu duester ist der Ort, But the scenes too gloomy show; **“Too dark: ATMOSPHERE NEEDS ADJUSTING.”**

Schuettelt uns mit Schreck und Grauen. We with fear and dread are shaken: **“Terror and dread: CHILDREN’S REVIEW OF EARTH.”**

Edler, Guter, lass uns fort! Kindest Father, let us go! **“Let us go: TOUR CANCELLED EARLY.”**

Pater seraphicus

Steigt hinan zu hoeherm Kreise, Upward rise to higher borders! **“Rise upward: ELEVATION IS THE ANSWER.”**

Wachset immer unvermerkt, Ever grow insensibly, **“Grow unnoticed: SNEAKY EXPANSION.”**

Wie, nach ewig reiner Weise, As, by pure, eternal orders, **“Eternally pure manner: THE SPOTLESS**

WAY.”

Gottes Gegenwart verstaerkt. God's high Presence strengthens ye! **“God's presence: PROXIMITY BONUS ACTIVATED.”**

Denn das ist der Geister Nahrung, Such the Spirits' sustentation, **“Spirits' nourishment: THE HOLY MENU.”**

Die im freisten Aether waltet: With the freest ether blending; **“Freest ether: WHERE NOTHING CONSTRAINS.”**

Ewigen Liebens Offenbarung, Love's eternal Revelation, **“Eternal revelation: LOVE HAS NO POKER FACE.”**

Die zur Seligkeit entfaltet. To Beatitude ascending. **“Unfolding blessedness: JOY IN SLOW MOTION.”**

Chor seliger Knaben (um die hoechsten Gipfel kreisend / circling around the highest summit)

Haende verschlinget Hands now enring ye, **“Hands intertwine: THE ORIGINAL NETWORK.”**

Freudig zum Ringverein, Joyously wheeling! **“Ring-union: GEOMETRY OF TOGETHERNESS.”**

Regt euch und singet Soar ye and sing ye, **“Stir and sing: THE HOLY CHOREOGRAPHY.”**

Heil'ge Gefuehle drein! With holiest feeling! **“Holy feelings: EMOTIONS WITH HALOS.”**

Goettlich belehret, The Teacher before ye, **“Divinely taught: BEST TEACHER EVER.”**

Duerft ihr vertrauen; Trust, and be bold! **“You may trust: PERMISSION TO BELIEVE.”**

Den ihr verehret, Whom ye adore, ye **“The one you adore: WORSHIP HAS AN ADDRESS.”**

Werdet ihr schauen. Him shall behold. **“You will behold: SPOILER—YOU’LL SEE.”**

Engel (schwebend in der hoeheren Atmosphaere, Faustens Unsterbliches tragend / soaring in the higher atmosphere, bearing the immortal part of Faust)

Gerettet ist das edle Glied The noble Spirit now is free, **“NOBLE MEMBER SAVED: THE ONLY SCORE THAT COUNTS.”**

Der Geisterwelt vom Boesen, And saved from evil scheming: **“From evil: EXTRACTION SUCCESSFUL.”**

Wer immer strebend sich bemueht, Whoe’er aspires unweariedly **“WHOEVER STRIVES: THE SALVATION CLAUSE.”**

Den koennen wir erloesen. Is not beyond redeeming. **“HIM WE CAN REDEEM: THE FINE PRINT SAYS YES.”**

Und hat an ihm die Liebe gar And if he feels the grace of Love **“LOVE FROM ABOVE: THE BONUS ROUND.”**

Von oben teilgenommen, That from On High is given,
“LOVE TOOK PART: PARTICIPATION TROPHY OF SALVATION.”

Begegnet ihm die selige Schar The Blessed Hosts
that wait above **“BLESSED HOST MEETS HIM: THE AFTER-PARTY BEGINS.”**

Mit herzlichem Willkommen. Shall welcome him to
Heaven! **“HEARTFELT WELCOME: NO FAKE SMILES IN HEAVEN.”**

Die juengeren Engel / The Younger Angels

Jene Rosen aus den Haenden They, the roses,
freely spend **“ROSES FROM HANDS: FLORAL WARFARE.”**

Liebend-heiliger Buesserinnen By the penitent, the
glorious, **“PENITENT ROSES: FORGIVENESS HAS HANDS.”**

Halfen uns den Sieg gewinnen, Helped to make the
light victorious, **“ROSES WON: MOST UNLIKELY WEAPONS.”**

Uns das hohe Werk vollenden, And the lofty work is
ended. **“HIGH WORK COMPLETE: CHECK MARK.”**

Diesen Seelenschatz erbeuten. We this precious Soul
have won us; **“SOUL-TREASURE CAPTURED: THE REAL LOOT.”**

Boese wichen, als wir streuten, Evil ones we
forced to shun us; **“EVIL RETREATED: FLORAL**

KRYPTONITE.”

Teufel flohen, als wir trafen. Devils fled us, when we hit them: **“DEVILS FLED: ALLERGIC TO GRACE.”**

Statt gewohnter Hoellenstrafen 'Stead of pangs of Hell, that bit them, **“NOT HELL-TORMENTS: NEW PUNISHMENT UNLOCKED.”**

Fuehlten Liebesqual die Geister; Love-pangs felt they, sharper, vaster: **“LOVE-AGONY: TENDERNESS WEAPONIZED.”**

Selbst der alte Satansmeister Even he, old Satan-Master, **“SATAN HIMSELF: YES, THAT GUY.”**

War von spitzer Pein durchdrungen. Pierced with keenest pain, retreated. **“SHARP PAIN PIERCED: EVEN THE CEO OF EVIL.”**

Jauchzet auf! es ist gelungen. Now rejoice! The work's completed! **“REJOICE: IT WORKED. IT ACTUALLY WORKED.”**

Die vollendeteren Engel / The More Perfect Angels

Uns bleibt ein Erdenrest Earth's residue to bear **“EARTH RESIDUE: HEAVENLY DRY-CLEANING NEEDED.”**

Zu tragen peinlich, Hath sorely pressed us; **“PAINFUL TO CARRY: MORTALITY IS HEAVY.”**

Und waer' er von Asbest, It were not pure and fair,
"EVEN ASBESTOS: NOT CLEAN ENOUGH."

Er ist nicht reinlich. Though 'twere asbestus. **"NOT
CLEAN: EARTH'S PERMANENT STATUS."**

Wenn starke Geisteskraft When every element
**"STRONG SPIRIT-FORCE: THE GRABBING
POWER."**

Die Elemente The mind's high forces **"ELEMENTS
SEIZED: HOSTILE TAKEOVER."**

An sich herangerafft, Have seized, subdued,
and blent, **"DRAWN TO ITSELF: SPIRITUAL
MAGNETISM."**

Kein Engel trennte No Angel divorces **"NO ANGEL
SEPARATES: UNION TOO STRONG."**

Geeinte Zwienatur Twin-natures single grown,
**"UNITED DOUBLE-NATURE: THE MERGER
HOLDS."**

Der innigen beiden, That inly mate them: **"INTIMATELY
JOINED: SOUL-BODY SUPERGLUE."**

Die ewige Liebe nur Eternal Love, alone, **"ETERNAL
LOVE ONLY: THE ONE SOLVENT."**

Vermag's zu scheiden. Can separate them. **"LOVE
SEPARATES: THE ONLY KEY."**

Die juengeren Engel / The Younger Angels

Nebelnd um Felsenhoeh' Mist-like on heights
above, **"MISTING ON HEIGHTS: WEATHER WITH
MEANING."**

Spuer' ich soeben, We now are seeing **"SENSING
JUST NOW: RADAR PING."**

Regend sich in der Naeh', Nearer and nearer move
"MOVING NEARBY: SOMETHING COMING."

Ein Geisterleben. Spiritual Being. **"SPIRIT-LIFE: EX-
ISTENCE WITHOUT FLESH."**

Die Woelkchen werden klar, The clouds are growing
clear; **"CLOUDLETS CLEAR: THE CURTAIN RISES."**

Ich seh' bewegte Schar And moving throngs appear
"MOVING THRONG: CELESTIAL PARADE."

Seliger Knaben, Of Blessed Boys, **"BLESSED BOYS:
THE RECURRING CHARACTERS."**

Los von der Erde Druck, Free from the earthly gloom,
"FREE FROM EARTH: GRAVITY-EXEMPT."

Im Kreis gesellt, In circling poise, **"CIRCLED TO-
GETHER: ROUND IS THE HOLY SHAPE."**

Die sich erlaben Who taste the cheer **"DELIGHTING:
HAPPINESS AS HOBBY."**

Am neuen Lenz und Schmuck Of the new spring-time
bloom **"NEW SPRING: HEAVEN'S PERPETUAL
FRESH."**

Der obern Welt. Of the upper sphere. **"UPPER
WORLD: EVERYTHING HAS UPSTAIRS."**

Sei er zum Anbeginn, Let them inaugurate **“JOIN AT BEGINNING: ONBOARDING STARTS NOW.”**

Steigendem Vollgewinn Him to the perfect state,
“RISING TO FULLNESS: SOUL IN BETA.”

Diesen gesellt! Now, as their peer! **“JOINED WITH THESE: MEMBERSHIP ACCEPTED.”**

Die seligen Knaben / The Blessed Boys

Freudig empfangen wir Gladly receive we now
“GLADLY RECEIVE: ENTHUSIASM FOR NEWCOMERS.”

Diesen im Puppenstand; Him, as a chrysalis:
“CHRYSLIS STATE: BUTTERFLY PENDING.”

Also erlangen wir Therefore achieve we now **“THUS WE ACHIEVE: TEACHING IS LEARNING.”**

Englisches Unterpfand. Pledge of our bliss.
“ANGELIC PLEDGE: YOUR FUTURE, GUARANTEED.”

Loeset die Flocken los, The earth-flakes dissipate
“LOOSEN FLAKES: EXFOLIATION OF THE SOUL.”

Die ihn umgeben! That cling around him! **“FLAKES SURROUNDING: THE MORTAL SHELL.”**

Schon ist er schoen und gross See, he is fair and great! **“FAIR AND GREAT: THE UNDERNEATH WAS GORGEOUS.”**

Von heiligem Leben. Divine Life hath crowned him.
“FROM HOLY LIFE: SANCTITY BEAUTIFIES.”

Doctor marianus (in der hoechsten, reinlichsten Zelle / in the highest, purest cell)

Hier ist die Aussicht frei, Free is the view at last, **“FREE VIEW: SIGHT WITHOUT END.”**

Der Geist erhoben. The spirit lifted: **“SPIRIT ELEVATED: ALTITUDE OF SOUL.”**

Dort ziehen Fraun vorbei, There women, floating past, **“WOMEN PASS: THE FEMININE PROCESSION.”**

Schwebend nach oben. Are upward drifted: **“FLOATING UPWARD: GRAVITY-FREE TRANSPORTATION”**

Die Herrliche mitteninn The Glorious One therein, **“GLORIOUS ONE AMID: THE SUN OF THIS SYSTEM.”**

Im Sternenkranze, With star-crown tender, – **“STAR-CROWN: JEWELRY FROM COSMOS.”**

Die Himmelskoenigin, The pure, the Heavenly Queen, **“HEAVENLY QUEEN: THE HIGHEST TITLE.”**

Ich seh’s am Glanze. I know her splendour. **“BY THE RADIANCE: LIGHT IS HER NAME TAG.”**

(Entzueckt / Enraptured)

Hoechste Herrscherin der Welt! Highest Mistress of the World! **“HIGHEST RULER: NO ONE ABOVE.”**

Lasse mich im blauen, Let me in the azure **“IN THE BLUE: SKY AS SANCTUARY.”**

Ausgespannten Himmelszelt Tent of Heaven, in
light unfurled, **“HEAVEN’S TENT: THE ULTIMATE
CIRCUS.”**

Dein Geheimnis schauen. Here thy Mystery measure!
“YOUR MYSTERY: THE BIG REVEAL.”

Billige, was des Mannes Brust Justify sweet thoughts
that move **“APPROVE THE MOVEMENT: BLESS THE
HEARTBEAT.”**

Ernst und zart beweget Breast of man to meet thee,
“EARNEST AND TENDER: THE HOLY PARADOX.”

Und mit heiliger Liebeslust And with the holy bliss of
love **“HOLY LOVE-BLISS: SANCTIFIED PLEASURE.”**

Dir entgegentraeget. Bear him up to greet thee!
“BEARS TOWARD: THE SOUL LEANS.”

Unbezwinglich unser Mut, With unconquered
courage we **“UNCONQUERABLE: WE WILL NOT
KNEEL.”**

Wenn du hehr gebietest; Do thy bidding highest;
“WHEN YOU COMMAND: INSTANT COMPLIANCE.”

Ploetzlich mildert sich die Glut, But at once shall gen-
tle be, **“FIRE SOFTENS: RAGE TO WARMTH.”**

Wie du uns befriedest. When thou pacifiest. **“AS YOU
PACIFY: PEACE TRANSMISSION.”**

Jungfrau, rein im schoensten Sinn, Virgin, pure in
brightest sheen, **“VIRGIN PURE: THE HIGHEST
CLEAN.”**

Mutter, Ehren wuerdig, Mother sweet, supernal, –
“MOTHER HONORED: BOTH AND.”

Uns erwaehlte Koenigin, Unto us Elected Queen,
“CHOSEN QUEEN: DEMOCRACY OF SOULS.”

Goettern ebenbuertig. Peer of Gods Eternal! **“EQUAL
TO GODS: THE SAME HEIGHT.”**

Um sie verschlingen Light clouds are circling
“AROUND HER: EVERYTHING CIRCLES.”

Sich leichte Woelkchen, Around her splendour, –
“LIGHT CLOUDS: ATMOSPHERE AS ORNAMENT.”

Sind Buesserinnen, Penitent women **“PENITENT
WOMEN: SECOND-CHANCE SQUAD.”**

Ein zartes Voelkchen, Of natures tender, **“TENDER
FOLK: SOFTNESS AS STRENGTH.”**

Um ihre Kniee Her knees embracing, **“AROUND HER
KNEES: WORSHIP POSTURE.”**

Den Aether schluerfend, Ether respiring, **“SIPPING
ETHER: SKY AS SUSTENANCE.”**

Gnade beduerfend. Mercy requiring! **“NEEDING
MERCY: THE UNIVERSAL CONDITION.”**

Dir, der Unberuehrbaren, Thou, in immaculate ray,
“UNTOUCHABLE: THE SACRED DISTANCE.”

Ist es nicht benommen, Mercy not leavest, **“NOT
FORBIDDEN: ACCESS GRANTED.”**

Dass die leicht Verfuehrbaren And the lightly led
astray, **“EASILY SEDUCED: THE SOFT TARGETS.”**

Traulich zu dir kommen. Who trust thee, receivest!
“COME TRUSTINGLY: FAITH WALKS.”

In die Schwachheit hingerafft, In their weakness
fallen at length, **“SNATCHED INTO WEAKNESS:
FRAILTY KIDNAPS.”**

Sind sie schwer zu retten; Hard it is to save them:
“HARD TO SAVE: THE TOUGH CASES.”

Wer zerreisst aus eigner Kraft Who can crush, by native
strength, **“OWN POWER TEARS: IMPOSSIBLE
SOLO.”**

Der Gelueste Ketten? Vices that enslave them?
“CHAINS OF DESIRE: THE PRETTY PRISON.”

Wie entgleitet schnell der Fuss Whose the foot that
may not slip **“FOOT SLIPS: GRAVITY OF SIN.”**

Schiefem, glattem Boden? On the surface slanting?
“SLANTING SMOOTH: THE DECEPTIVE PATH.”

Wen betoert nicht Blick und Gruss, Whom befool
not eye and lip, **“WHO ISN'T FOOLED: UNIVERSAL
WEAKNESS.”**

Schmeichelhafter Odem? Breath and voice enchant-
ing? **“FLATTERING BREATH: THE WIND THAT
UNDOES.”**

(Die Mater gloriosa schwebt einher / The Mater Glo-
riosa soars into the space)

Chor der Buesserinnen / Chorus of Women Penitents

Du schwebst zu Hoehen To heights thou'rt speeding
“YOU SOAR: ALTITUDE WITHOUT LIMIT.”

Der ewigen Reiche, Of Endless Eden: **“ETERNAL REALMS: WHERE CLOCKS DIE.”**

Vernimm das Flehen, Receive our pleading, **“RECEIVE PLEADING: APPLICATIONS OPEN.”**

Du Ohnegleiche, Transcendent Maiden, **“WITHOUT EQUAL: THE ONLY ONE.”**

Du Gnadenreiche! With Mercy laden! **“RICH IN MERCY: GRACE BILLIONAIRE.”**

Magna peccatrix (St. Luc. VII, 36)

Bei der Liebe, die den Fuessen By the love before him kneeling, – **“BY THE LOVE: INVOKING THE SCENE.”**

Deines gottverklaerten Sohnes Him, Thy Son, a god-like vision, **“GOD-TRANSFIGURED SON: THE RADIANT ONE.”**

Traenen liess zum Balsam fliessen, By the tears like balsam stealing, **“TEARS LIKE BALSAM: WEEPING CURES.”**

Trotz des Pharisaerhohnes; Spite of Pharisees' derision; **“DESPITE MOCKERY: LOVE DOESN'T CARE.”**

Beim Gefaesse, das so reichlich By the box, whose ointment precious **“BY THE VESSEL: THE COSTLY**

CONTAINER.”

Tropfte Wohlgeruch hernieder, Shed its spice and odours cheery; **“DRIPPED FRAGRANCE: SCENT AS SACRIFICE.”**

Bei den Locken, die so weichlich By the locks, whose softest meshes **“BY THE LOCKS: HAIR BECAME HOLY.”**

Trockneten die heil’gen Glieder – Dried the holy feet and weary! – **“DRIED HOLY LIMBS: THE HUMBLEST SERVICE.”**

Mulier samaritana (St. Joh. IV)

Bei dem Bronn, zu dem schon weiland By that well, the ancient station **“BY THE WELL: THE ANCIENT WITNESS.”**

Abram liess die Herde fuehren, Whither Abram’s flocks were driven; **“ABRAHAM’S HERD: OLD OLD OLD.”**

Bei dem Eimer, der dem Heiland By the jar whose restoration **“BY THE BUCKET: HUMBLE TOOL, HOLY USE.”**

Kuehl die Lippe durft’ beruehren; To the Saviour’s lips was given; **“COOL LIPS TOUCHED: REFRESHMENT FOR DIVINITY.”**

Bei der reinen, reichen Quelle, By the fountain, pure and vernal, **“PURE RICH SPRING: THE SOURCE ABOVE SOURCES.”**

Die nun dorthier sich ergiesset, Thence its present bounty spending, – **“NOW POURS OUT: THE ETERNAL FLOW.”**

Ueberfluessig, ewig helle Overflowing, bright, eternal, **“ETERNALLY BRIGHT: INEXHAUSTIBLE GLOW.”**

Rings durch alle Welten fliesset – Watering the world’s unending! – **“THROUGH ALL WORLDS: TOTAL IRRIGATION.”**

Maria aegyptiaca (Acta Sanctorum)

Bei dem hochgeweihten Orte, By the place, where the Immortal **“CONSECRATED PLACE: THE HOLIEST ADDRESS.”**

Wo den Herrn man niederliess, Body of the Lord hath lain; **“LORD LAID DOWN: THE TEMPORARY REST.”**

Bei dem Arm, der von der Pforte By the arm, which from the portal, **“ARM FROM DOORWAY: THE HOLY BOUNCER.”**

Warnend mich zuruecke stiess; Warning, thrust me back again; **“WARNINGLY THRUST: ENTRY DENIED... FOR NOW.”**

Bei der vierzigjaehrigen Busse, By the forty years’ repentance **“FORTY YEARS PENANCE: THE LONG SORRY.”**

Der ich treu in Wuesten blieb, In the lonely desert-land; **“FAITHFULLY IN DESERTS: LOYAL TO**

NOTHING.”

Bei dem seligen Scheidegrusse, By the blissful
farewell sentence **“BLESSED FAREWELL: THE
GOOD ENDING.”**

Den im Sand ich niederschrieb – Which I wrote upon
the sand! – **“WROTE IN SAND: THE TEMPORARY
FOREVER.”**

Zu drei / The Three

Die du grossen Suenderinnen Thou Thy presence not
deniest **“GREAT SINNERS WELCOMED: THE BIG
FAILURES GET CLOSE.”**

Deine Naehel nicht verweigerst Unto sinful women
ever, – **“NOT DENIED: OPEN DOOR POLICY.”**

Und ein buessendes Gewinnen Lifest them to win the
highest **“PENITENT GAINING: SORRY CLIMBS.”**

In die Ewigkeiten steigerst, Gain of penitent endeavour,
– **“RAISED TO ETERNITIES: FORGIVENESS
FOREVER.”**

Goenn auch dieser guten Seele, So, from this
good soul withdrawn not – **“THIS GOOD SOUL:
GRETCHEN’S TURN.”**

Die sich einmal nur vergessen, Who but once forgot,
transgressing, **“FORGOT ONCE: THE SINGLE SLIP.”**

Die nicht ahnte, dass sie fehlte, Who her loving error
saw not – **“DIDN’T SUSPECT: THE INNOCENT**

MISTAKE.”

Dein Verzeihen angemessen! Pardon adequate,
and blessing! **“FITTING FORGIVENESS: CUSTOM
MERCY.”**

Una poenitentium, sonst Gretchen genannt (sich
anschmiegend / formerly named Margaret, stealing
closer)

Neige, neige, Incline, O Maiden, **“INCLINE INCLINE:
GRETCHEN SPEAKS AT LAST.”**

Du Ohnegleiche, With Mercy laden, **“WITHOUT
EQUAL: THE HIGHEST PRAISE.”**

Du Strahlenreiche, In light unlading, **“RICH IN RADI-
ANCE: BLINDING BRIGHTNESS.”**

Dein Antlitz gnaedig meinem Glueck! Thy gracious
countenance upon my bliss! **“GRACIOUS FACE:
BLESS MY JOY.”**

Der frueh Geliebte, My loved, my lover, **“EARLY
BELOVED: HE’S HERE. HE’S FINALLY HERE.”**

Nicht mehr Getruebte, His trials over **“NO LONGER
TROUBLED: THE STORM IS OVER.”**

Er kommt zurueck. In yonder world, returns to me in
this! **“HE RETURNS: THE REUNION. FINALLY.”**

Selige Knaben (in Kreisbewegung sich naehernd /
approaching in hovering circles)

Er ueberwaechst uns schon With mighty limbs he towers **“OUTGROWS US: THE STUDENT EXCEEDS.”**

An maechtigen Gliedern, Already above us; **“MIGHTY LIMBS: STRENGTH EMBODIED.”**

Wird treuer Pflege Lohn He, for this love of ours, **“RICHLY REPAY: THE CIRCLE OF CARE.”**

Reichlich erwidern. Will richlier love us. **“FAITHFUL CARE: TENDS AND TENDS AND TENDS.”**

Wir wurden frueh entfernt Early were we removed, **“REMOVED EARLY: THE UNLIVED LIVES.”**

Von Lebechoeren; Ere Life could reach us; **“LIFE’S CHOIRS: THE MUSIC THEY MISSED.”**

Doch dieser hat gelernt, Yet he hath learned and proved, **“THIS ONE LEARNED: THE FULL CURRICULUM.”**

Er wird uns lehren. And he will teach us. **“HE WILL TEACH: THE STUDENT BECOMES MASTER.”**

Die eine Buesserin, sonst Gretchen genannt / The Penitent (formerly named Margaret)

Vom edlen Geisterchor umgeben, The spirit-choir around him seeing, **“NOBLE CHOIR SURROUNDS: HE’S NOT ALONE ANYMORE.”**

Wird sich der Neue kaum gewahr, New to himself, he scarce divines **“SCARCELY KNOWS HIMSELF: IDENTITY REBOOTING.”**

Er ahnet kaum das frische Leben, His heritage of new-born Being, **“FRESH LIFE SENSED: EXISTENCE 2.0.”**

So gleicht er schon der heiligen Schar. When like the Holy Host he shines. **“RESEMBLES HOLY HOST: BECOMING WHAT HE JOINS.”**

Sieh, wie er jedem Erdenbände Behold, how he each band hath cloven, **“SHEDS EARTHLY BONDS: FREEDOM FROM WEIGHT.”**

Der alten Huelle sich entrafft The earthly life had round him thrown, **“OLD SHELL SHED: THE COCON BREAKS.”**

Und aus aetherischem Gewande And through his garb, of ether woven, **“ETHEREAL GARMENT: DRESSED IN SKY.”**

Hervortritt erste Jugendkraft. The early force of youth is shown! **“YOUTH-FORCE STEPS FORTH: THE PRIME OF SOUL.”**

Vergoenne mir, ihn zu belehren, Vouchsafe to me that I instruct him! **“ALLOW ME TO INSTRUCT: GRETCHEN VOLUNTEERS.”**

Noch blendet ihn der neue Tag. Still dazzles him the Day's new glare. **“NEW DAY DAZZLES: ADJUSTING TO GLORY.”**

Mater gloriosa

Komm! hebe dich zu hoehern Sphaeren! Rise, thou,

to higher spheres! Conduct him, **“COME! RISE! THE FINAL INSTRUCTION.”**

Wenn er dich ahnet, folgt er nach. Who, feeling thee, shall follow there! **“IF HE SENSES: LOVE IS THE COMPASS.”**

Doctor marianus (auf dem Angesicht anbetend / prostrate, adoring)

Blicket auf zum Retterblick, Penitents, look up elate, **“LOOK UP: THE FINAL DIRECTION.”**

Alle reuig Zarten, Where she beams salvation; **“TENDERLY REPENTANT: THE GENTLE REBORNS.”**

Euch zu seligem Geschick Gratefully to blessed fate **“BLESSED FATE: THE HAPPY ENDING.”**

Dankend umzuarten. Grow, in re-creation! **“GRATEFULLY TRANSFORM: THANKFUL BECOMING.”**

Werde jeder bessre Sinn Be our souls, as they have been, **“EVERY BETTER SENSE: THE GOOD IN YOU.”**

Dir zum Dienst erbötig; Dedicate to Thee! **“READY TO SERVE: THE ETERNAL COMMITMENT.”**

Jungfrau, Mutter, Koenigin, Virgin Holy, Mother, Queen, **“VIRGIN MOTHER QUEEN: THE TRIPLE CROWN.”**

Goettin, bleibe gnaedig! Goddess, gracious be! **“GODDESS GRACIOUS: THE LAST PRAYER.”**

Chorus mysticus

Alles Vergaengliche All things transitory **“ALL TRANSITORY: EVERYTHING THAT DIES.”**

Ist nur ein Gleichnis; But as symbols are sent: **“ONLY SYMBOL: POINTER TO THE REAL.”**

Das Unzulaengliche, Earth's insufficiency **“THE INSUFFICIENT: ALL THAT FAILED.”**

Hier wird's Ereignis; Here grows to Event: **“HERE BECOMES EVENT: POTENTIAL MADE ACTUAL.”**

Das Unbeschreibliche, The Indescribable, **“THE INDESCRIBABLE: LANGUAGE SURRENDERS.”**

Hier ist's getan; Here it is done: **“HERE IT IS DONE: THE UNSPEAKABLE ACHIEVED.”**

Das Ewig-Weibliche The Woman-Soul leadeth us **“DAS EWIG-WEIBLICHE: THE FORCE THAT MOVES ALL.”**

Zieht uns hinan. Upward and on! **“ZIEHT UNS HINAN: DRAWS US UP AND ON—FOREVER.”**
